

Astrology, Gently

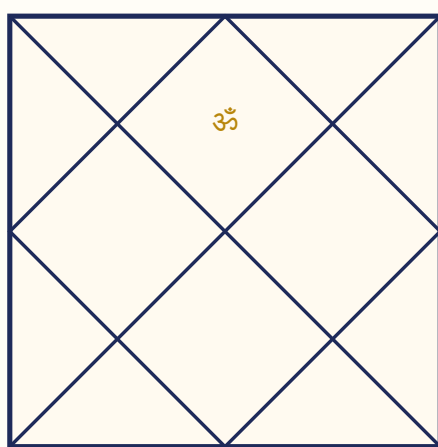
A kind, beginner-friendly guide to
understanding your chart and yourself



No complicated jargon. No gatekeeping.
Just a gentle place to begin.

Astrology, Gently

A kind, beginner-friendly guide to understanding your chart and yourself



Anushka Bharti

Astrology, Gently: A kind, beginner-friendly guide to understanding your chart and yourself

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A note on what this book is and is not. This book teaches Vedic astrology (Jyotish) as a way of understanding tendencies and timings. It is not medical, legal, financial or psychological advice, and nothing in it should be used to make decisions about health, money or law in place of a qualified professional. Every person named in the examples is a composite, and the three case-study charts are constructed for teaching.

Sources. The backbone is Parashari astrology (*Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra*). Anything drawn from *Lal Kitab* (Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, Urdu editions 1939 to 1952) appears only inside boxes labelled **From Lal Kitab** with the source stated. Jaimini, Tajaka and KP appear where named.

Boxes used in this book: Anushka's rule of thumb · Why? · Story · Did you know? · Common beginner mistake · Consultation tip · From Lal Kitab (red dashed border) · Practice. **Colour dots:** ● good or friendly · ● mixed or neutral · ○ difficult or hostile.

*For everyone who bought the books and understood nothing.
This one is for you.*

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A Love Letter, Before We Begin

Dear reader,

If you have picked up this book, I think I know something about you. You are curious about the sky, or about yourself, or about why the same year that was wonderful for your sister was so hard for you. Somewhere along the way you decided to learn astrology properly. So you bought the books everyone recommends. You opened them with real hope. And within ten pages you felt stupid.

I know, because that was me.

I bought the thick classics. I bought the modern ones with the confident titles. I joined a course and downloaded a hundred pages of notes that said "Saturn in the 7th house gives..." followed by a list, and "Mercury in the 8th house gives..." followed by another list, and I copied them into a notebook and forgot them by the weekend. Nobody told me *why*. Nobody told me why Saturn and the Sun cannot stand each other, or why the same planet that ruins one person's marriage house is the best thing in another person's chart. Without the why, nothing stayed.

So I did the only thing I could. I went back to the beginning and rebuilt the subject for myself, one reason at a time, until every rule had a story I could retell and a reason I could defend. It took years. It should not have. The grammar of astrology is small: nine planets, twelve signs, twelve houses, twenty-seven stars. What makes it hard is not the size of it. It is that the books were written for students who already knew the sky, and nobody translated them for the rest of us.

This book is that translation. It is my love letter to everyone who is struggling the way I struggled. I have tried to make it as simple as I possibly can without making it false, and I have tried to give you a reason for everything, because reasons are what stay.

Let me tell you honestly what I hope for you.

I hope that by the last page you can pick up any birth chart and read it, calmly, from the first line to the last. I hope you can time the seasons of a life with the dashas, answer the questions people actually ask (work, money, love, health, children), and sit across from someone with kindness and confidence. Part V of this book is about exactly that: how to consult, and how to do it ethically.

But I hope for something more basic too, and it is the real reason I wrote this. Life does not always let us do what we planned. You may learn all of this and never take a single paid consultation, because of work, family, health, or simply because life turned a corner. That is fine. If that happens, I want you to still have this: the ability to open your own chart and understand your own nature without fear. To look at your mother's chart, your child's, your partner's, your friend's, and know what season they are in and why they are behaving the way they are. To recognise a hard year as a hard year and not as a verdict on your worth. To know, when the ground shifts under someone you love, what is happening and roughly how long it will last.

That knowledge is quieter than a consulting practice, and I have come to believe it is the more important gift.

A few promises, so you know what kind of book this is.

Every rule comes with its reason. Where the reason is astronomy, I say so. Where it is the internal logic of the system, I show the derivation. Where it is the word of a classical author, I name them. Where it is tradition or folk practice, I tell you that too, so you always know how firm the ground is under your feet.

Every hard idea comes with a story. The nine planets are a royal court in this book: a King and a Queen Mother, a Commander, a clever young Prince, a Priest, a Minister of Pleasure, an old Judge, and two strangers at the gate. Who likes whom, who

resents whom, what happens when two of them share a room: you will remember these as stories long after you have forgotten the tables. And every table that judges anything is colour-coded, because our eyes remember colour when our memory fails.

Everything from Lal Kitab is clearly labelled as Lal Kitab, in its own boxes, with the source stated. The mixing of systems without labels is, I believe, one of the biggest reasons students get confused today, and I refuse to do it to you.

And there is no fear in this book. Astrology has been damaged by people who frighten others into buying stones and rituals. You will learn the remedies, and you will learn to offer them gently, as a friend suggests a diet, with reasons and without threats.

Read it in order. Do the little exercises at the end of each chapter, because reading about swimming has never kept anyone afloat. Keep a notebook. Cast your own chart in the first chapter and carry it with you through the whole book; by the end, you will know that chart the way you know your own handwriting.

I am not writing to you as a guru on a hill. I am writing as someone who sat where you are sitting, with the same closed books and the same feeling of being locked out, and who found the door. Come, I will show you where it is.

With love,

Anushka Bharti

Chapter 1: Welcome. Why the Books Confused You, and How This One Won't

Sit down. Make some chai. Let me tell you what happened to you, because it happened to me first.

You bought the classics. Maybe *Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra* in two fat volumes, maybe a famous modern author, maybe a stack of PDFs from an online course. You opened page one and were hit by forty Sanskrit words, a table of degrees, and a sentence like "the lord of the Lagna in the eighth in a dusthana aspected by a maraka gives...". You closed it. You felt stupid. You are not stupid.

Here is the secret nobody tells beginners: **those books were never written for beginners**. Parashara was dictating to his student Maitreya, who already knew the sky. The modern books mostly copy the old ones and add lists. Lists of "Saturn in the 7th house gives...", "Sun in the 3rd house gives...". You memorise 108 lists, forget 100 of them, and still cannot read a chart, because nobody taught you *why* Saturn in the 7th gives what it gives.

I know because I did exactly this. I had the notebook of lists. I had the highlighters. What I did not have was a single reason, and without reasons nothing stayed. The day things changed for me was the day I stopped asking "what does this placement give?" and started asking "why would it give that?" Every time I found the why, the rule stuck forever, and usually three other rules fell into place with it.

Astrology is not a memory game. It is a **language with a small grammar**. Nine planets, twelve signs, twelve houses, twenty-seven stars. That is the whole alphabet. Once you understand how the pieces *combine*, you never need a list again, because you can derive any list yourself, in your head, while the chart is still loading on your phone.

This book teaches the grammar. Every rule comes with the reason behind it, a picture, a story, and a worked example. By the last chapter you will read a full chart, time events with dashas, answer the five questions everyone asks (career, money, marriage, health, children), give remedies with humility, and know what to say and what never to say to a person who trusts you with their birth details. And if you never read for anyone but yourself and your family, you will still understand your own life a great deal better. That was my real reason for writing this, and I said so in the letter at the front.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: If you cannot explain a rule to a twelve-year-old with a drawing and a reason, you do not yet understand it. I hold myself to this in every chapter, and I will show you the reason every time.

What astrology actually claims (and what it does not)

Let us be honest with each other from the first page, because honesty is what will make people trust you.

Jyotish, the Sanskrit word means "the science of light", is an ancient system that reads the positions of the Sun, Moon and planets at the moment of your birth as a **map of tendencies**. Not a script. A map. It says: this road is downhill, that one is uphill, there is a bridge at age thirty-two. It does not say you must walk. The tradition itself is clear about this: the chart shows *prarabdha* karma, the portion of your past actions that has ripened for this life, and it always leaves room for *kriyamana* karma, what you do now.

WHY? This is the tradition's own reasoning, not my softening of it. The classical view divides karma into three: *sanchita* (the whole store), *prarabdha* (the part allotted to this life) and *kriyamana* (what you are creating now). A birth chart can only show the allotted part, so by the system's own logic it cannot be a complete script. Everyday parallel: your school timetable tells you which classes you have this year. It does not tell you whether you will pay attention in them.

So when someone asks "Will I get the job?", the honest astrologer does not say yes or no like a coin toss. She says: "Your career house is being activated this year, and the timing is strong from March. Apply. Push. The wind is behind you." That is prediction in the Jyotish sense, and, you will find, it is also what actually helps people.

DID YOU KNOW? *Jyotisha* is one of the six *Vedangas*, the "limbs of the Veda". Its original job was timekeeping: fixing when to perform rituals by the Moon and stars. Predictive astrology (*Hora Shastra*) grew from that calendar science. The great texts, *Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra* (Parashara), *Brihat Jataka* (Varahamihira, 6th century CE, Ujjain), *Saravali* (Kalyana Varma), *Phaladeepika* (Mantreswara), *Jataka Parijata* (Vaidyanatha), are our textbooks even today.

The sky as a clock

Forget mysticism for a moment and picture the sky as the world's oldest clock.

The Earth goes around the Sun once a year. From where we stand, it *looks* like the Sun slowly travels through a ring of background stars over the year. That ring is the **zodiac belt** (*Rashi Chakra*). Ancient astronomers divided the ring into twelve equal slices of 30° each and named them after the star-patterns roughly behind them: Aries the ram, Taurus the bull, and so on. Those twelve slices are the **signs** (*Rashis*).

The Zodiac Belt (Rashi Chakra)

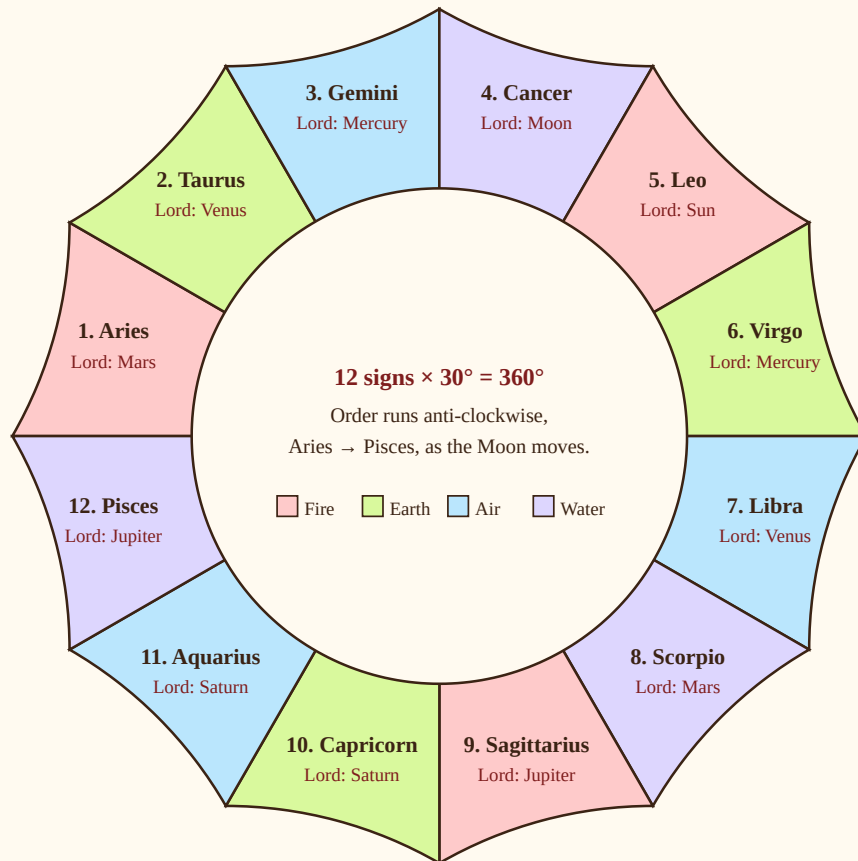


Figure 1.1: The zodiac belt. Count anti-clockwise from Aries.

Figure 1.1: The zodiac belt. Twelve signs of 30° each make the full 360° circle. The order runs anti-clockwise, the same direction the Moon and planets move against the stars.

Now, the Moon and the planets also travel along (or very near) this same ring. So at any moment, each planet is "in" some sign. The Moon takes about 2¼ days to cross a sign, the Sun a month, Jupiter a year, Saturn two and a half years. That gives us hands of different speeds on one clock face: a second hand, a minute hand, an hour hand, and a very slow hand that takes thirty years to go round.

WHY DO THE PLANETS ALL TRAVEL ALONG THE SAME RING? Astronomy. The planets orbit the Sun in nearly the same flat plane, like coins lying on one table. Seen from Earth, which is also on that table, they all appear to move along one narrow band of sky. The Moon's orbit is tilted only about 5° from it. Everyday parallel: cars on a ring road. They move at different speeds, but they are all on the same road, so you always know which stretch each one is on.

A **birth chart** (*kundali* or *janma patrika*) is simply a photograph of this clock at the minute you were born, taken from the place you were born.

Why the place? Because of the last ingredient, the one that makes your chart yours and not everyone-born-that-day's: the horizon. As the Earth spins, a new sign rises in the east roughly every two hours. The sign rising on the eastern horizon at your birth is the **rising sign** (*Lagna*, also called the ascendant). It sets the frame of your whole chart. Two babies born on the same day in different hours, or in Chennai and in London at the same clock time, have different Lagnas and different charts.

WHY EVERY TWO HOURS? Astronomy again. The Earth turns 360° in 24 hours, so the whole zodiac rises over the eastern horizon once a day: 12 signs in 24 hours, about one sign every 2 hours (a little more or less depending on the sign and your latitude). Everyday parallel: a Ferris wheel with twelve cabins turning once a day. Which cabin is at the loading platform depends on the exact minute you look. The Sun tells you the month you were born, the Moon narrows it to the day, but only the Lagna knows the hour.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: The Sun tells you the *month*, the Moon tells you the *day*, the Lagna tells you the *hour*. A chart without an accurate birth time is a photo without focus.

Why your "Sun sign" moved

The first shock for anyone coming from newspaper horoscopes: "But I'm a Virgo! This app says my Sun is in Leo!"

Both are right; they are using different rulers. Western astrology anchors the start of Aries to the **spring equinox point**, which slowly drifts backwards against the stars because of a wobble in the Earth's axis (called precession). Vedic astrology anchors Aries to the **actual stars**. The two rulers were aligned around 285 CE; today they differ by roughly 24 degrees, almost a whole sign. The gap is called the **ayanamsa**.

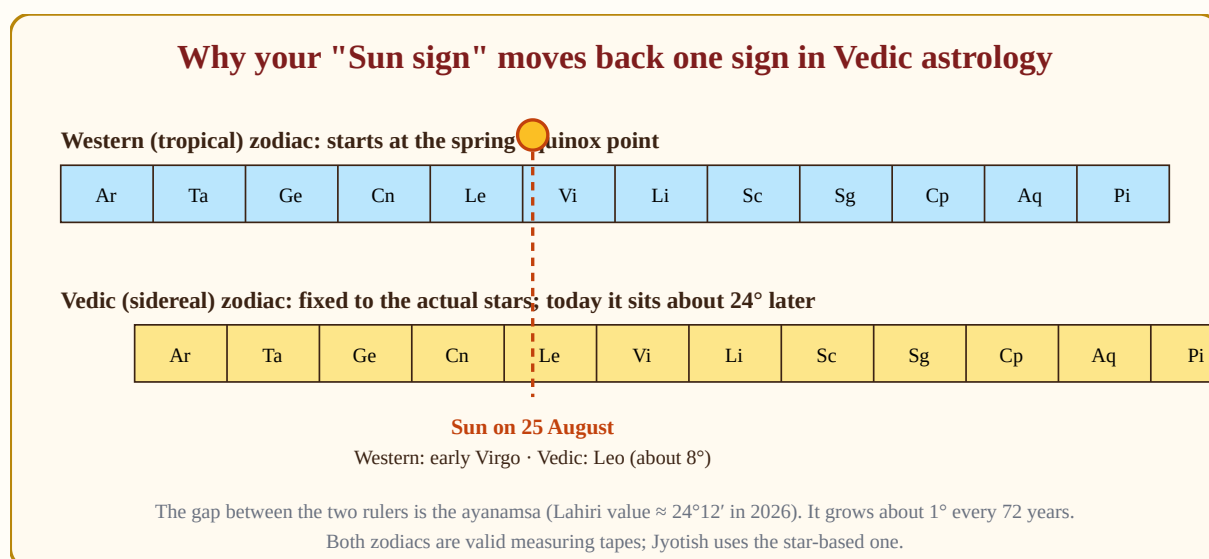


Figure 1.2: The same Sun on the same day lands in a different sign depending on which ruler you hold against the sky. Jyotish uses the star-fixed (sidereal) ruler.

WHY DOES THE EQUINOX DRIFT? The Earth's axis wobbles like the axis of a spinning top that is slowing down, taking about 25,800 years for one full wobble. That shifts the equinox point backwards through the stars by about 1° every 72 years. Western astrology chose the seasons as its anchor; Jyotish chose the stars. Neither is wrong; they measure different things. Everyday parallel: two friends give directions to the same shop, one saying "third door from the temple" and the other "third door from the bus stop". Both are correct, but only if you know which landmark they started from.

Which ayanamsa value? Indian astrologers overwhelmingly use **Lahiri** (also called Chitrapaksha), adopted by the Government of India's Calendar Reform Committee in 1955. Set your software to Lahiri and never think about it again. Do not mix systems: a chart made with one ayanamsa and read with another will put planets in the wrong signs.

DID YOU KNOW? In roughly 2,000 years the two zodiacs will be a full sign apart, and Western astrology's "Aries" will sit entirely on the stars of Pisces. Vedic astrologers say: this is exactly why we tied our zodiac to the stars.

Meet the cast: a royal court

The nine "planets" (*Grahas*, the word means "that which grasps") are not all planets in the astronomer's sense. Two are luminaries (Sun and Moon), five are true planets (Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn), and two are mathematical points (Rahu and Ketu), the places where the Moon's path crosses the Sun's, which is why eclipses happen only near them. Astrology treats all nine as *actors*.

The old texts describe them as a royal court, and I have never found a better way to hold them in mind:

Graha	Role in the court	In one word
Sun (Surya)	The King	Authority
Moon (Chandra)	The Queen Mother	Mind
Mars (Mangala)	The Commander of the army	Energy
Mercury (Budha)	The clever young Prince, the secretary	Intellect
Jupiter (Guru)	The Royal Priest and minister	Wisdom
Venus (Shukra)	The Minister of Pleasure and the arts	Love
Saturn (Shani)	The old Judge of Labour	Discipline
Rahu	The smoke-headed Stranger at the gate	Obsession
Ketu	The headless Sadhu	Detachment

STORY: THE COURT ASSEMBLES. Picture a kingdom. The **King** (Sun) sits on the throne, proud, warm, impossible to ignore; when he is strong the whole court has confidence, and when he is weak nobody knows who is in charge. Beside him the **Queen Mother** (Moon) runs the household and knows every servant's troubles; she is the mood of the palace, changing a little every day. The **Commander** (Mars) guards the gates and starts the fights. The clever young **Prince** (Mercury) writes the letters and counts the money. The **Royal Priest** (Jupiter) advises, blesses and teaches the children. The **Minister of Pleasure** (Venus) arranges music, weddings and comfort. The old **Judge of Labour** (Saturn), once the King's neglected son, keeps the accounts of every debt and lets nobody leave until the work is done. At the gate stand two strangers: **Rahu**, a smoke-headed traveller who wants everything he sees, and **Ketu**, a headless sadhu who wants nothing at all. Every chart you will ever read is a story about which of these nine sits in which room of the palace, and who is on speaking terms with whom. **Rule:** learn the nine characters first; the rest of astrology is watching them interact.

WHY A COURT AND NOT JUST A LIST? Because the tradition itself built the meanings this way. Parashara and Varahamihira call the Sun and Moon the royals, Mars the commander, Mercury the prince, Jupiter and Venus the ministers, Saturn the servant. The friendships and enmities you will learn in Chapter 3 follow from these roles, so when you know the court you can derive the table instead of memorising it. Everyday parallel: you do not memorise who gets along in your office; you know it from what each person's job makes them want.

Every planet "owns" one or two signs; those are its home ground. Every planet also has a sign where it feels strongest (its **exaltation**) and one where it feels weakest (its **debilitation**). We will go through each planet's personality slowly in Chapter 3. For now, just meet them.

The stage: twelve rooms of a house

If the planets are the actors and the signs are their costumes, the **houses** (*Bhavas*) are the rooms where the drama plays out. There are twelve houses, counted from the Lagna. The Lagna sign is the 1st house; the next sign is the 2nd house; and so on around.

Each house governs an area of life. The 1st is you and your body. The 2nd is wealth, speech and family. The 4th is mother, home and inner peace. The 7th is marriage and partnerships. The 10th is career. The 12th is loss, sleep and foreign lands. Chapter 4 walks through all twelve with the logic behind each meaning, and there is logic; the houses are not random.

WHY IS THE 1ST HOUSE "YOU" AND THE 7TH "THE PARTNER"? Because the houses are laid out on the sky at your birth. The 1st house is the eastern horizon, where the sky is rising: the beginning, the self coming into the world. The 7th is the western horizon directly opposite: what faces you, the other person. The 10th is the top of the sky at noon, where everything is visible: your public work. The 4th is the bottom, hidden underfoot: home, mother, the private foundation. Four of the twelve meanings come straight from the four directions of the sky; the rest are derived from these (Chapter 4). Everyday parallel: in a house the front door is where you meet the world, the room facing it is where guests sit, the roof is what the neighbours see, and the foundation is what nobody sees but everything rests on.

Here is how the three layers stack:

- **Planet** = *who* is acting (Mars: energy, aggression, courage).
- **Sign** = *how* they behave, their mood and costume (Mars in Cancer: energy that turns emotional and defensive).
- **House** = *where in life* the action lands (Mars in Cancer in the 4th house: that emotional energy plays out at home, with mother, in matters of property).

Once this three-layer idea clicks, half the "lists" in the old books become obvious. Saturn in the 7th "delays marriage" not because a book says so but because Saturn is delay and the 7th is marriage. You could have written that line yourself.

Reading your first chart (just looking, no pressure)

Below is Chart A. I call her Meera; she is a composite, born in Jaipur in December 1988 at 6:40 in the morning. We will meet her again and again through the book.

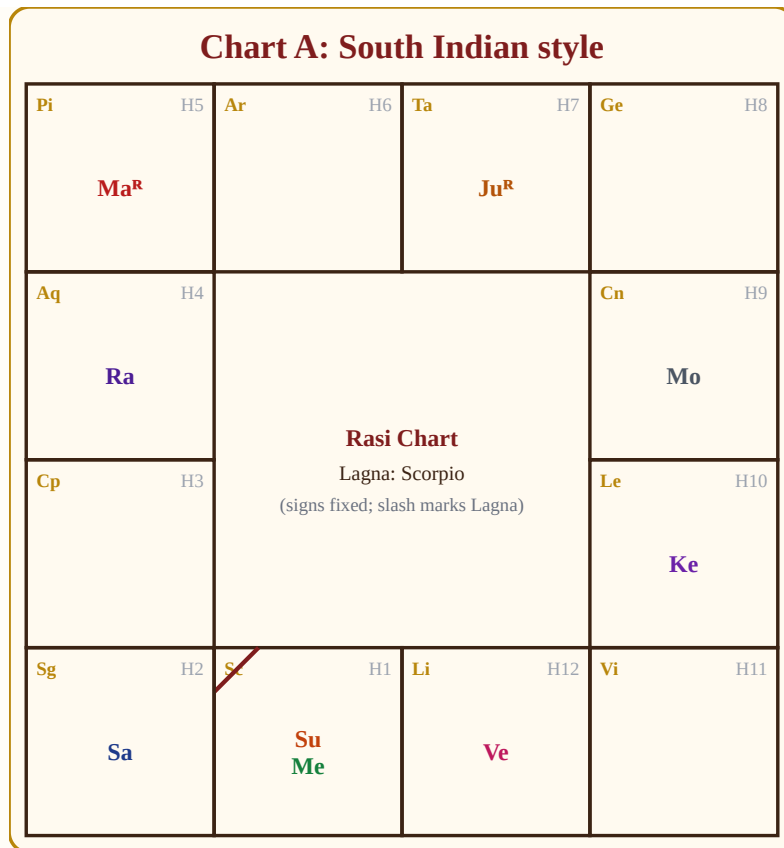


Figure 1.4: The same chart in the South Indian format. Pisces is always top-left; the signs run clockwise; the slash marks the Lagna in Scorpio.

WHY TWO STYLES? Because they answer two different first questions. The North Indian chart asks "what is in my 1st house, my 2nd house...?", so it keeps the houses still and lets the signs rotate into them. The South Indian chart asks "where is Aries, where is Taurus...?", so it keeps the signs still and marks where the Lagna fell. Same sky, two filing systems. Everyday parallel: one railway timetable is sorted by platform, another by train; both list the same trains.

Neither is "correct". North India, Nepal, and most Hindi-speaking practitioners use the diamond; Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Karnataka and Andhra use the grid; Bengal and Odisha have their own variant. Learn to read both, because people bring you whatever their family astrologer made. I use the North Indian style throughout this book and show the South Indian version wherever it teaches something.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: In the North Indian chart, the numbers inside the houses are **sign numbers**, not house numbers. The house numbers never change (top diamond = 1, then anti-clockwise). The sign numbers change with every Lagna. Half of all beginner errors come from mixing these two up. I made this mistake for weeks.

Your toolkit: software, not arithmetic

Not long ago an astrologer spent the first hour of any reading doing arithmetic with an almanac (*panchanga*) and logarithm tables. You do not have to. Any of these will cast an accurate chart in a second:

- **Jagannatha Hora** (free, Windows): the professional's workhorse; every divisional chart, every dasha.

- **Parashara's Light** (paid): the standard in many Indian institutes.
- **AstroSage / Drik Panchang / Kundli apps** (free, mobile): fine for beginners; check the ayanamsa is Lahiri.
- **Maitreya** (free, open source): clean and reliable.

Set: Lahiri ayanamsa, sidereal zodiac, whole-sign houses (the default in Jyotish: one sign = one house), and Vimshottari dasha. That is the configuration every chapter in this book assumes.

What you *must* still do by hand is **think**. Software gives you positions; it cannot judge, weigh, or speak kindly to a frightened person. That is the whole job, and this book is about that job.

How to use this book

The book is in five parts, built to be read in order, because each chapter leans on the one before it.

1. **Part I, Foundations (Chapters 1 to 5):** signs, planets, houses, and how to read a chart's basic layout. Do not skip these even if you "know" them; the reasoning is the point.
2. **Part II, Core tools (Chapters 6 to 12):** aspects, the 27 nakshatras, which planets are good or bad *for your particular Lagna*, house lords, yogas, divisional charts, and planetary strength. This is where you become an astrologer.
3. **Part III, Timing (Chapters 13 to 17):** Vimshottari dasha, transits (including the famous Sade Sati), other dashas, the calendar (panchanga and muhurta), and horary questions.
4. **Part IV, Life questions (Chapters 18 to 21):** career and money, marriage and matching, health and longevity, children, education, property, travel, spirituality, organised the way people actually ask.
5. **Part V, Lal Kitab, remedies, and the consulting room (Chapters 22 to 25):** the distinct Lal Kitab system, clearly attributed; remedies with ethics; how to run a consultation (and how to use all this for yourself if you never consult); and three complete case studies from birth data to final advice.

At the back: Appendix A holds every table you will ever need at the desk (keep it open); a glossary; a reading list and cheat sheets; and the Story Bank, every memory story in the book gathered in one place for revision.

Watch for these recurring boxes:

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: a heuristic worth memorising.

WHY? the reason behind a rule, with its kind named (astronomy, the system's own logic, a classical author, or tradition) and an everyday parallel. This is the box the first draft of this book lacked, and the one I most wish my own teachers had used.

STORY boxes are memory stories. Lists do not stay; stories do. So every rule that is normally memorised, who is whose enemy, which conjunctions help, which planets serve which Lagna, comes with a short tale from the royal court and then the rule in one line. The cast never changes, so by Chapter 6 you will know these characters like family.

DID YOU KNOW? an interesting fact: history, astronomy, culture.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: where students trip; read these twice.

CONSULTATION TIP: how to phrase it to a real person, and the ethics of doing so.

FROM LAL KITAB: material drawn from *Lal Kitab* (Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, Urdu editions 1939 to 1952). Everything from that tradition lives **only** in these boxes, with the source stated, so you always know which system you are using. Mixing the two without labels is one of the biggest sources of confusion in today's online courses. (*Source: Lal Kitab, Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, 1939–1952 Urdu editions; Hindi translations vary.*)

PRACTICE: exercises at the end of every chapter, with answers. Do them. Reading about swimming has never kept anyone afloat.

Colour dots mark every judgement in every table: a green filled circle for good or friendly, an amber half circle for mixed or neutral, a red empty circle for difficult or hostile. The three shapes differ, so the meaning survives on a black-and-white screen too.

A word about the voice in this book

I write as a practising astrologer who learned this the slow way, and the examples are drawn from ordinary life: friends' charts, family charts, my own, and composites of people I have read for. Every named person here is a composite, and the three case-study charts (Meera, Arjun, Devika) are constructed for teaching so that we can dissect them freely without exposing anyone's private life.

Three promises, and one request

Promise one: no rule without a reason. If I cannot tell you *why* Saturn delays, I will not ask you to remember that it does.

Promise two: no fear. Astrology has been damaged by people who frighten others into buying stones. You will learn the remedies, and you will learn to offer them the way a good doctor offers a diet: gently, with reasons, without threats.

Promise three: no gatekeeping. There is nothing here you cannot learn. Sanskrit is a bonus, not an entry ticket.

My request: keep a notebook. Every time you meet a chart, a friend's, a relative's, your own, write three observations and one prediction with a date. Come back in a year. That notebook will teach you more than any book, including this one.

Let us begin with the twelve signs.

In one breath

- The classics were written for students who already knew the sky; that is why they confused you, not because you lack ability.
- Jyotish reads the sky at your birth as a map of tendencies and timings, never as a fixed script; the tradition's own theory of karma says so.
- The zodiac is a 360° belt cut into twelve 30° signs; planets move through it at different speeds like clock hands, all on one ring because the solar system is flat.
- The Lagna (rising sign) is fixed by birth time and place because the Earth turns one sign past the horizon roughly every two hours; it makes the chart yours.
- Vedic astrology uses the star-fixed (sidereal) zodiac with the Lahiri ayanamsa; that is why your Sun sign shifts about one sign back from Western astrology.
- Planet = who, Sign = how, House = where. Every "list" in the old books is a combination of these three, and you can derive them yourself.
- The nine planets are a royal court: King, Queen Mother, Commander, Prince, Priest, Minister of Pleasure, Judge, and two strangers at the gate. Stories about them carry the rules; ●●○ dots mark good, mixed and difficult in every table.
- North Indian charts fix the houses; South Indian charts fix the signs. Learn to read both.
- Lal Kitab material appears only in marked boxes with its source stated.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. In Figure 1.3, which sign is in Meera's 4th house? Which planet sits there?
2. Meera's Jupiter is in the 7th house. Using the North Indian layout, which sign number is that, and what is the sign's name?
3. Your friend says, "I'm a Sagittarius Sun, born 5 December." In which sign would Vedic astrology most likely place their Sun? Why?
4. Write down, in one line each, what the Sun, Moon and Lagna each tell you about the timing of a birth, and the astronomical reason for each.
5. Set up a chart program with Lahiri ayanamsa and cast your own chart. Note your Lagna, your Moon sign, and how many planets sit in your 1st house. Keep it; we will use it all through the book.

Answers

1. The 4th house holds sign 11, Aquarius. Rahu sits there. 2. The 7th house shows sign 2, Taurus. (Scorpio is 8; count 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 1, 2 for houses 1 to 7.) 3. Most likely Scorpio. The Vedic zodiac sits about 24° "later" than the Western one, so a Sun in the first two-thirds of Western Sagittarius falls in sidereal Scorpio. (A Sun born after about 16 December would be in sidereal Sagittarius.) 4. Sun: the month, because it moves one sign a month as the Earth orbits it. Moon: the day, because it moves one sign every 2¼ days in its 27-day orbit. Lagna: the hour, because the Earth's daily rotation brings a new sign over the eastern horizon roughly every two hours. 5. Your own answers. Keep the notebook.

Chapter 2: The Twelve Signs (Rashis): The Costumes

When I was small, my nani would take me to the Ramlila in her town. The same actor played Ravana one night and Hanuman the next. Same man, same voice. But put him in the ten-headed costume and he strutted; put him in the monkey's tail and he leapt about. The costume changed how he behaved. It did not change who he was.

That is exactly what a sign does to a planet. Mars is always Mars, energy, courage, heat. But Mars dressed in Cancer is a soldier defending his mother's kitchen; Mars dressed in Capricorn is a general with a five-year plan. In Chapter 1 we said: planet = *who*, sign = *how*, house = *where*. This chapter is entirely about the *how*. If you learn the twelve costumes well, you will never again need to memorise "Mars in Cancer gives..." lists, because you will be able to feel the answer.

What a sign actually is

Let me start with the plain astronomy, because everything else grows from it.

The Sun, Moon and planets all travel along roughly the same road through the sky, the ecliptic, the ring of background stars I called the zodiac belt in Chapter 1. The ancients cut that 360° ring into twelve equal slices of 30° each. Each slice is a **sign** (*Rashi*, which simply means "heap" or "group"). The slices are named after the star-pictures that sat roughly behind them when the system was fixed: the ram, the bull, the twins, and so on.

So when we say "the Moon is in Taurus", we mean only this: right now the Moon sits somewhere in the second 30° slice of the ring, between 30° and 60° measured from the start of Aries. Nothing mystical. A postal code.

Why does the postal code matter? Because each sign has a *lord*, a planet that owns it, and a temperament built from its element and quality. A planet visiting a sign is a guest in that lord's house, wearing its dress code; a guest in a friend's home relaxes, a guest in an enemy's home is on edge. That is the whole idea of sign strength, made precise in Chapter 3.

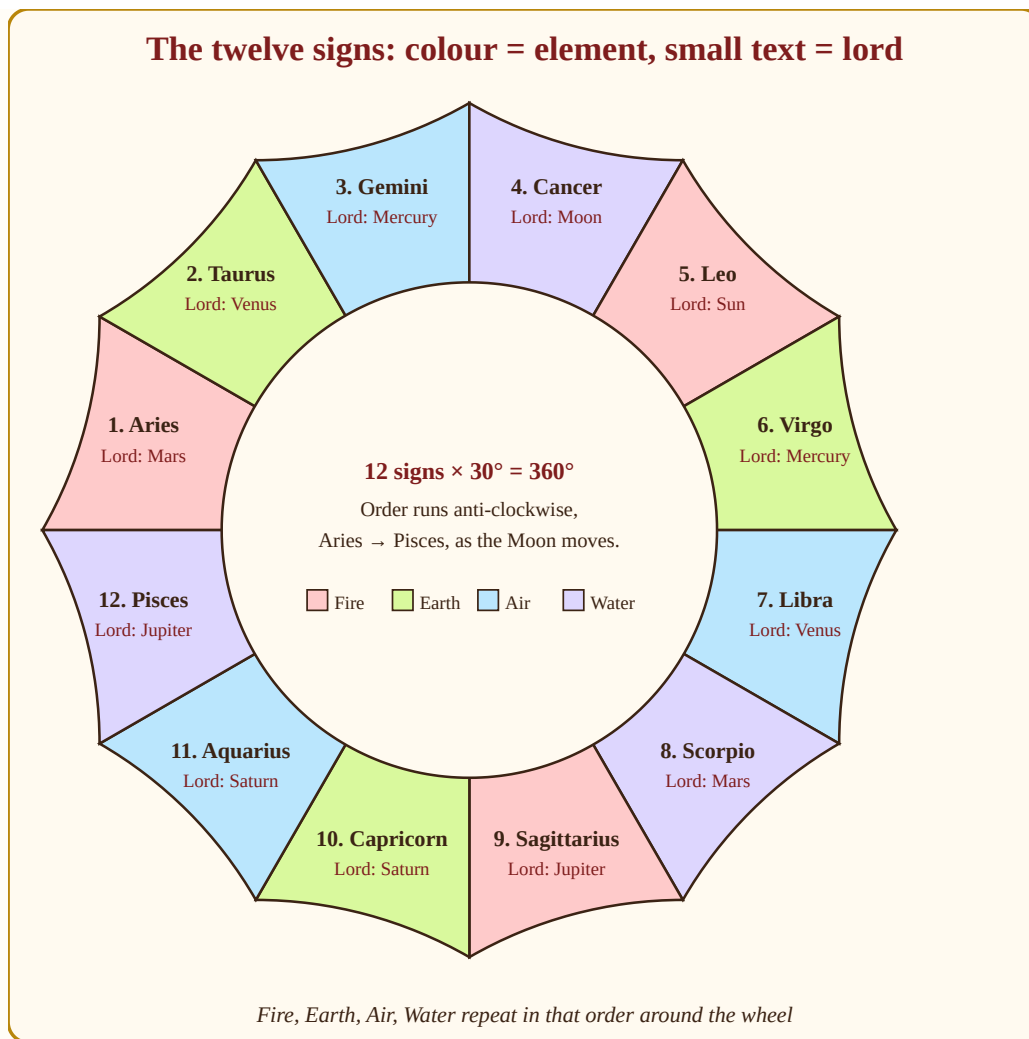


Figure 2.1: The twelve signs. The colours show the four elements, fire, earth, air, water, which repeat in that order three times around the wheel. The small text under each name is the sign's lord.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: A sign never *does* anything by itself. An empty sign is an empty costume on a hook. It matters only when a planet puts it on, or when it sits in a house and colours that house's affairs through its lord.

The four elements: what kind of energy

Every sign belongs to one of four elements (*Tattvas*), and they repeat in a strict order around the wheel: fire, earth, air, water, fire, earth, air, water, fire, earth, air, water. Aries is fire, Taurus earth, Gemini air, Cancer water, and then Leo starts the cycle again with fire.

I think of the elements as four kinds of people you meet at any Indian wedding.

Fire signs (Aries, Leo, Sagittarius) are the uncle organising everything, loudly. Fire is initiative, heat, faith, ego, action before thought. Fire people want to *do*, to lead, to be seen. Their gift is courage and warmth; their trap is impatience and pride. Fire signs face east in the classical scheme, the direction of sunrise, of beginnings.

Earth signs (Taurus, Virgo, Capricorn) are the aunt who has counted the plates and knows the caterer's rate. Earth is practicality, patience, the body, money, things you can touch. Earth people build slowly and keep what they build. Their gift is reliability; their trap is stubbornness and worry about material things. Earth faces south.

Air signs (Gemini, Libra, Aquarius) are the cousins who have talked to everyone in the hall and know all the gossip. Air is thought, speech, relationships, ideas, movement between people. Air people connect and communicate. Their gift is intelligence and fairness; their trap is restlessness and living in the head. Air faces west.

Water signs (Cancer, Scorpio, Pisces) are the grandmother in the corner who has noticed who is unhappy and why. Water is feeling, memory, intuition, depth. Water people absorb the mood of a room. Their gift is empathy and imagination; their trap is moodiness and holding on to old hurts. Water faces north.

STORY: FOUR KINDS OF VILLAGE. *Walk the ring road of the kingdom and you pass four kinds of village, over and over. First a festival village (fire), where somebody is always drumming, a new temple is always being started, and nobody has finished the last one. Then a granary village (earth), where every sack is counted, the walls are thick, and a stranger is fed before he is questioned. Then a market town (air), where everyone is talking, bargaining, carrying news from the last village to the next. Then a river village (water), where the old women remember every flood and every kindness, and the mood of the whole place changes with the tide. Then the drum starts again. Whatever planet moves into a village takes on its habits: the Commander in the market town argues instead of fighting; the Prince in the river village writes poetry instead of accounts. Rule: Fire acts, earth keeps, air connects, water feels, and they repeat in that order, Aries to Pisces.*

Now watch what the element does to a planet. Mercury (speech, intellect) in a fire sign speaks fast and boldly, sometimes before thinking. Mercury in earth speaks carefully about practical matters. Mercury in air is the natural debater and salesman. Mercury in water speaks from feeling, in poetry and hints. One planet, four costumes, four kinds of speech. You did not memorise that; you *derived* it.

The three qualities: how the energy moves

Cut the wheel a second way. Every sign is also one of three qualities (some teachers say "modes"), and these repeat in the order movable, fixed, dual.

Movable signs (Chara: Aries, Cancer, Libra, Capricorn) start things. They are the first sign of each season in the old calendar, the pushers, the movers, the ones who pack their bags. A planet in a movable sign acts quickly, changes direction easily, likes travel and new projects. A client with many planets in movable signs will tell you she has lived in six cities.

Fixed signs (Sthira: Taurus, Leo, Scorpio, Aquarius) hold things. They are the middle of each season, when the weather has settled. A planet here is steady, loyal, slow to begin and very slow to stop. Fixed-sign people keep the same job, the same barber for twenty years, and the same grudge.

Dual signs (Dwiswabhava, "two-natured": Gemini, Virgo, Sagittarius, Pisces) adapt. They sit at the turn of the season, one foot in each. A planet here is flexible, thoughtful, capable of seeing both sides, and capable of never quite deciding. Dual signs give teachers, writers, advisers: people who carry information from one world to another.

STORY: THREE KINDS OF SHOPKEEPER. *In every one of those villages you meet three kinds of shopkeeper. The hawker (movable) arrives with the season, sets up a bright new stall, sells fast, and is gone to the next town before you have learned his name. The old shop (fixed) has stood on the same corner for forty years; the owner will not change the sign, the prices or his opinion, and his customers' grandchildren still come. The trader (dual) keeps one foot in each town, buying here and selling there, always able to see both sides of a bargain and sometimes unable to close it. A planet that moves in becomes that shopkeeper: Saturn in a movable sign hurries, which is not like him; Mars in a fixed sign digs in for a siege; Jupiter in a dual sign teaches by comparing. Rule: Movable starts, fixed holds, dual adapts, repeating in that order round the wheel.*

WHY? *Why do the elements run fire-earth-air-water, and the qualities movable-fixed-dual, in those fixed orders? Two layers. Logic of the system: twelve signs are four elements times three qualities, and interleaving them this way guarantees that every element gets exactly one movable, one fixed and one dual sign, fire is Aries (movable), Leo (fixed) and Sagittarius (dual); no combination repeats and none is missed. Tradition, from the calendar: in the old seasonal zodiac a movable sign began each season, a fixed sign was mid-season when the weather had settled, and a dual sign was the change-over month with one foot in each. Varahamihira's Brihat Jataka states the three-fold division; the seasonal reading is how the tradition explains it. Everyday parallel: the school year. The new term (movable) is all fresh notebooks and resolutions; mid-term (fixed) is routine, the same bench, the same tiffin; the exam-and-holiday month (dual) is when everything changes hands and nobody is quite sure which year they are in.*

Put element and quality together and each sign has a two-word character before you have learned anything else about it. Aries is *movable fire*: a spark that jumps. Taurus is *fixed earth*: a rock. Gemini is *dual air*: a breeze that changes direction. Cancer is *movable water*: a river. Leo is *fixed fire*: a steady hearth. Virgo is *dual earth*: garden soil, worked and reworked. Libra is *movable air*: wind. Scorpio is *fixed water*: a deep well. Sagittarius is *dual fire*: a torch carried from place to place. Capricorn is *movable earth*: a mountain road. Aquarius is *fixed air*: the atmosphere itself, the still sky. Pisces is *dual water*: the ocean, always two tides.

Odd and even: active and receptive

One more cut, and it is the simplest. Count the signs from Aries. The odd-numbered ones (Aries 1, Gemini 3, Leo 5, Libra 7, Sagittarius 9, Aquarius 11) are called male, or active. The even-numbered ones (Taurus 2, Cancer 4, Virgo 6, Scorpio 8, Capricorn 10, Pisces 12) are female, or receptive.

WHY? *Why are the odd signs "male, active" and the even ones "female, receptive"? Classical statement: Parashara and Varahamihira both assign the signs alternately, odd and even, from Aries. Logic of the system: alternation is the simplest rhythm there is, day and night, inhale and exhale, and it lines up perfectly with the elements: the two outward elements (fire, air) always land on odd numbers and the two inward ones (earth, water) on even. So odd/even is not a separate fact to learn; it is the same rhythm seen from another side. Everyday parallel: the dhol at a wedding, *dha* out, *dhin* in, and everyone's feet know which beat is which without counting.*

Do not read "male" and "female" as gender predictions; that is a beginner's mistake and a client's embarrassment. Read them as *outgoing* and *inward-drawing*. All fire and air signs are odd; all earth and water signs are even. So the odd signs push energy out, and the even signs pull energy in and hold it. A planet in an odd sign expresses; a planet in an even sign absorbs. We will use odd/even again in Chapter 11 when dividing signs into smaller charts, and in Chapter 19 when we judge, for instance, whether a planet's promise shows outwardly or privately.

Who owns what: the lordship symmetry

Every sign has an owner, the **sign lord** (*Rashi Adhipati*). Here they are:

Sign	Lord	Sign	Lord
Aries	Mars	Libra	Venus
Taurus	Venus	Scorpio	Mars
Gemini	Mercury	Sagittarius	Jupiter
Cancer	Moon	Capricorn	Saturn
Leo	Sun	Aquarius	Saturn
Virgo	Mercury	Pisces	Jupiter

I groaned at this table when I first met it. Twelve facts to memorise! But look at it the way it finally clicked for me one evening, and it collapses into six facts you cannot forget.

Put the two lights at the top: the Moon owns Cancer, the Sun owns Leo. They sit side by side, at the height of summer in the old calendar, the brightest, warmest part of the year, owned by the two brightest bodies. Now walk away from them in both directions at once. One step from Cancer backwards is Gemini; one step from Leo forwards is Virgo. Both belong to **Mercury**, the planet closest to the Sun. Another step each way: Taurus and Libra, both **Venus**, the next planet out. Another step: Aries and Scorpio, both **Mars**. Another: Pisces and Sagittarius, both **Jupiter**. The last step: Aquarius and Capricorn, both **Saturn**, the farthest planet the ancients could see, sitting at the coldest, darkest bottom of the wheel, opposite the lights.

WHY? Which layer is this? The lordship list itself is a *classical statement* (Parashara gives it flatly). The mirror pattern is *astronomy*: read from the two lights outward, the lords appear in order of the planets' distance from the Sun as the ancients ranked them, Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn, so the scheme was clearly built to be remembered. Everyday parallel: seating at a wedding dinner, the couple's parents nearest the stage, then the closest relatives, then the rest, in order of closeness, on both sides of the aisle.

Why the sign lords are easy to remember: a perfect mirror

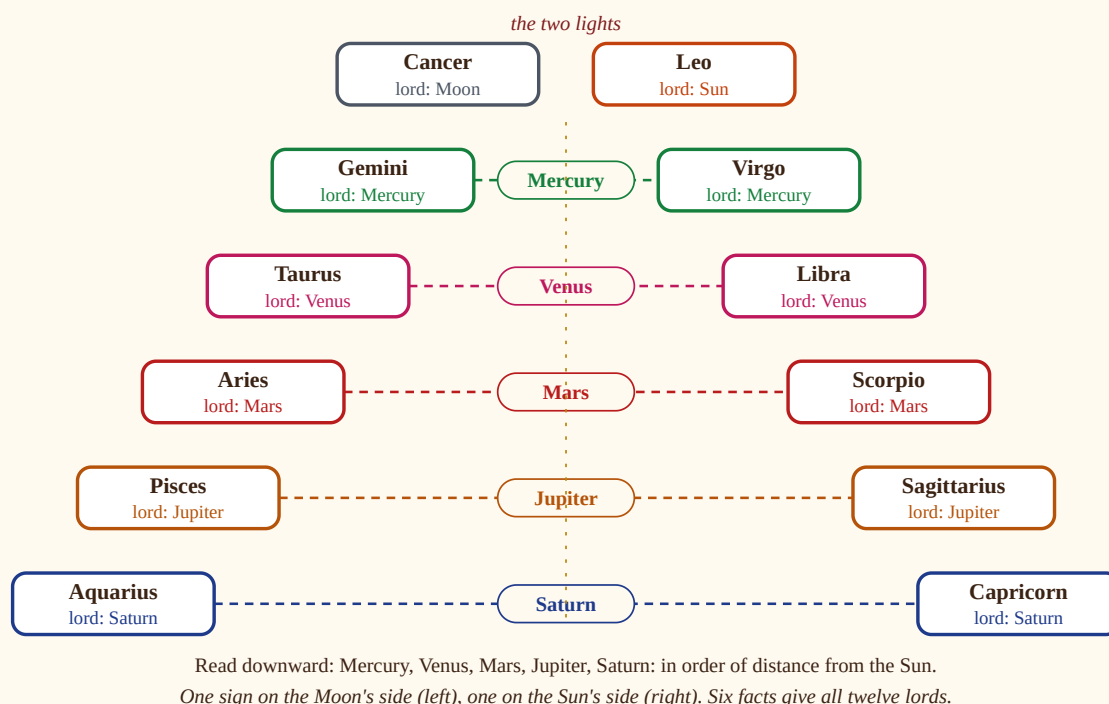


Figure 2.2: The lordship mirror. Cancer and Leo, owned by the Moon and Sun, sit at the top. Each planet further from the Sun owns the next pair outward, Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn, one sign on the Moon's side and one on the Sun's side.

STORY: THE TWELVE DISTRICTS OF THE KINGDOM. Picture the kingdom as a ring of twelve districts. At the summer end of the ring stand two palaces side by side: the Queen Mother's (Cancer, the Moon) and the King's (Leo, the Sun). The King does not govern the outer districts himself. He posts his ministers outward in pairs, one on the Queen Mother's side, one on his own, nearest first. The young Prince-Secretary (Mercury), who must run back and forth with messages, gets the two districts touching the palaces: Gemini and Virgo. The Minister of Arts (Venus), next in the procession, receives Taurus and Libra. The Commander (Mars), who guards the borders, takes Aries and Scorpio. The Royal Priest (Jupiter) is sent further out to teach the towns, Pisces and Sagittarius. And the old Judge of Labour (Saturn) governs the two cold districts farthest from the palaces, at the winter end of the ring: Aquarius and Capricorn. Each minister's two districts have different soil, so each has a day-side manner and a night-side manner. **Rule:** Sign lords mirror outward from Cancer and Leo in order of distance from the Sun: Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn.

This is not a coincidence; it is the design. The ancients arranged the lordships by *distance from the Sun*, and made the pattern a mirror so it could be remembered by anyone who knew the order of the planets. Once you see it, you will never look up a sign lord again. Ask yourself: which side of the mirror, and how many steps from the lights?

Notice one more thing the mirror gives you for free. Each planet's two signs are always of *different* elements and *different* qualities: Mercury owns airy, dual Gemini and earthy, dual Virgo; Mars owns fiery, movable Aries and watery, fixed Scorpio. A planet with two homes has two moods. Mars in Aries is an open-field warrior; Mars in Scorpio is the same warrior working at night. Which home suits a planet better will occupy us in a moment when we come to Moolatrikona.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Western books give Uranus, Neptune and Pluto as rulers of Aquarius, Pisces and Scorpio. Jyotish does not. In every Parashari text, Saturn owns Aquarius, Jupiter owns Pisces, Mars owns Scorpio. If your software shows the outer planets, switch them off; the whole system of lords, aspects and dashas assumes nine grahas and no more.

The Cosmic Man: signs as the body

The old texts imagine the whole zodiac as one enormous being, the **Cosmic Man** (*Kala Purusha*, "the person made of time"). Aries is his head, Taurus his face and throat, and so on down to Pisces, his feet. This is not poetry for its own sake. It is the basis of medical astrology, and, as you will see in Chapter 4, of why the houses mean what they mean.

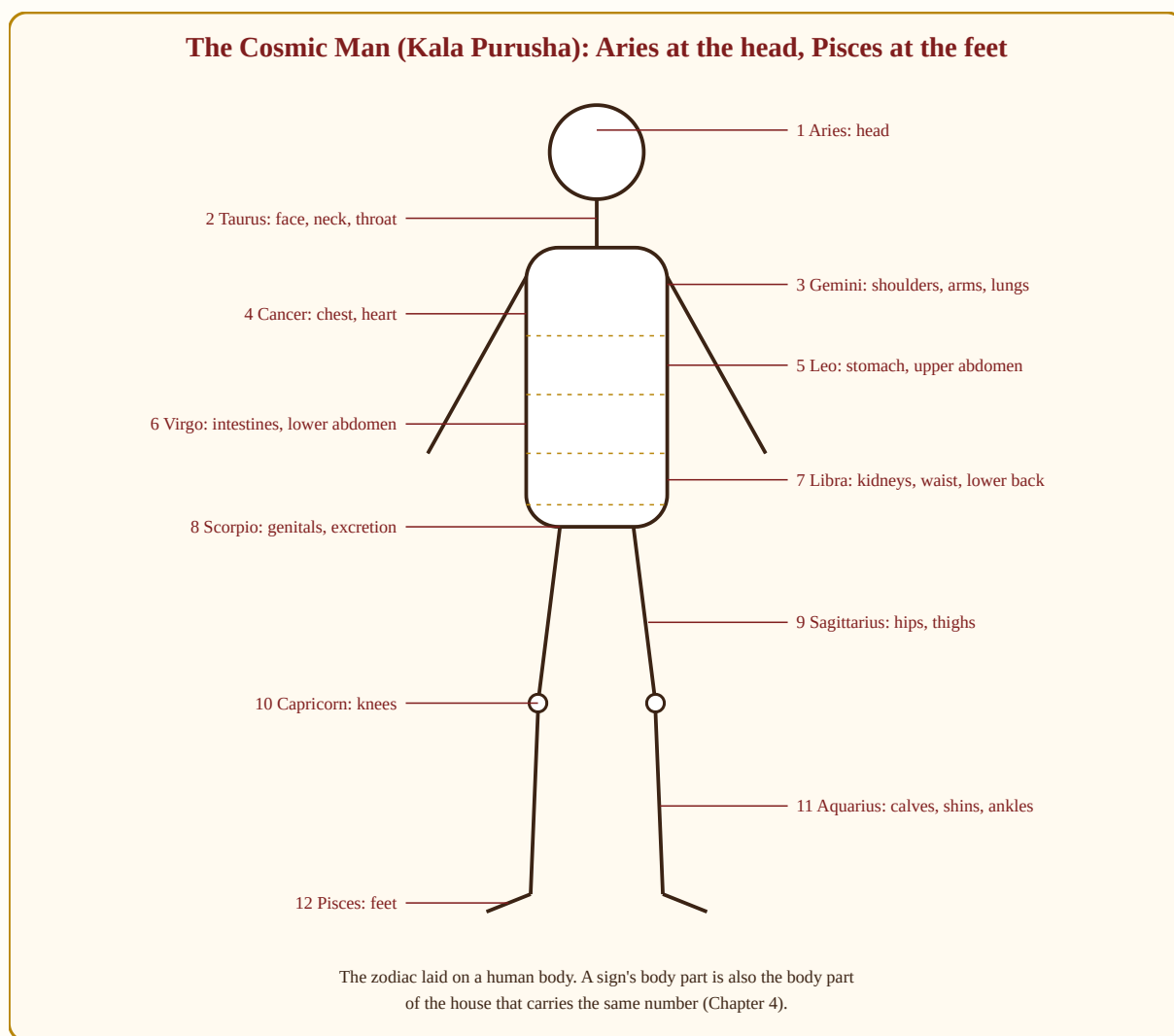


Figure 2.3: The Kala Purusha. Read from head to feet. A sign's body part is also the body part of the house with the same number in the natural chart.

WHY? Why head to feet, Aries to Pisces, and not some other order? *Classical statement:* Varahamihira's *Brihat Jataka* opens with exactly this limb list for the Cosmic Man, head first. *Tradition's logic:* the zodiac is imagined as one standing body, and the first sign is placed at the top because Aries is where the count begins, the Cosmic Man rises head-first out of the eastern horizon, as every baby is meant to. Once the head is Aries, the rest follows in order down the body, and medical astrology inherits a ready-made map. Everyday parallel: measuring a child's height on the kitchen wall, you start the pencil at the top of the head and every year the marks run downward in order.

Keep this picture in mind as we now walk through the twelve signs one by one. For each I give the symbol, lord, element, quality, body part, temperament, what the sign does to a visiting planet, a one-line sketch of the sign as a rising sign (the full treatment of each Lagna is in Chapter 5), and one example. Do not try to memorise the paragraphs. Try to *see* the person.

1. Aries (Mesha), the Ram

Lord Mars; movable fire; odd; the head. Symbol: the ram that charges head-first. Aries is the first breath of the zodiac, the infant's cry, the starting gun. Its temperament is direct, quick, impatient, physically brave, occasionally tactless. Aries does not plan; Aries goes.

A planet placed in Aries becomes faster, hotter and more assertive. Gentle planets can lose their softness here (Venus in Aries loves impulsively; Saturn in Aries, its sign of debilitation, is a patient old man forced to run). Bold planets thrive: the Sun is exalted in Aries, a king leading from the front.

As a Lagna: a lean, energetic body, a scar on the head or face is common, a person who speaks first and thinks later, and who recovers from every fall by standing up again. Example: Mercury in Aries, a quick, blunt speaker who is good at starting arguments and better at ending them by walking away.

2. Taurus (Vrishabha), the Bull

Lord Venus; fixed earth; even; the face, neck and throat. The bull grazes, stores fat for winter, and does not move unless it wishes to. Taurus is comfort, possessions, food, beauty, the pleasure of the senses, and a stubbornness that outlasts every argument.

A planet in Taurus slows down and becomes practical and sensual. The Moon is exalted here, the mind at rest, well fed, secure. Rahu, by mainstream teaching, is also exalted here: the hunger for more finds a bottomless plate. Fiery planets lose some fire (Mars in Taurus works hard but resents being told to hurry).

As a Lagna: a solid build, a pleasant voice (the throat is Taurus), a love of good food and a fine house, and a temper that takes a long time to rise and a longer time to fall. Example: Jupiter in Taurus, as in Chart A (Meera's 7th house), makes the teacher's wisdom practical and financial, the guru who also manages the temple accounts.

3. Gemini (Mithuna), the Couple

Lord Mercury; dual air; odd; the shoulders, arms and lungs. The symbol is a man and a woman, two natures in conversation. Gemini is curiosity, speech, writing, trade, humour, the mind that wants to know a little about everything.

A planet in Gemini becomes talkative, adaptable and mentally busy. It gains cleverness and loses some staying power. The Moon in Gemini is a mind that never stops chattering; Saturn in Gemini becomes the disciplined researcher, and is comfortable, since Mercury and Saturn are friends.

As a Lagna: a tall or wiry frame, expressive hands, a quick wit, and a tendency to have two jobs, two hobbies, or two opinions at once. Example: Mars and Venus in Gemini in Chart C (Devika's 3rd house), energy and charm poured into communication, siblings and short journeys; she talks her way into and out of everything.

4. Cancer (Karka), the Crab

Lord Moon; movable water; even; the chest, heart and breasts. The crab carries its home on its back and moves sideways towards what it wants. Cancer is nourishment, mother, memory, home, tides of feeling, and a fierce protectiveness once you are inside its circle.

A planet in Cancer softens, becomes emotional, caring and cautious. Jupiter is exalted here, wisdom becomes compassion, the guru becomes the mother. Mars is debilitated here, the soldier does not know whom to fight when the enemy is a feeling.

As a Lagna: a round face, a soft body that gains weight easily, a person who remembers every kindness and every insult, and who is most themselves at home. Example: the Moon in Cancer in Chart A: Meera's Moon sits in its own sign in the 9th house, an emotional mind that finds rest in faith, teachers and philosophy.

5. Leo (Simha), the Lion

Lord Sun; fixed fire; odd; the upper abdomen and stomach. The lion does not hunt often, but when it walks everyone notices. Leo is dignity, authority, generosity, performance, and the need to be respected.

A planet in Leo becomes proud, visible and steady. It wants an audience and a title. Mercury in Leo speaks with authority (and sometimes lectures); Saturn in Leo, in the house of its enemy the Sun, is the servant who resents the king, hard-working but sullen.

As a Lagna: a broad forehead, a strong upper body, a commanding presence even when short, and a hunger for recognition that, well handled, becomes leadership. Example: Ketu in Leo in Chart A (Meera's 10th house), a career in which the ego is gradually dissolved; she teaches and consults but shrinks from titles.

6. Virgo (Kanya), the Maiden

Lord Mercury; dual earth; even; the intestines and lower abdomen. The maiden carries a sheaf of grain, harvest, sorting, separating the good seed from the chaff. Virgo is analysis, detail, service, health, craft, and the critic's eye that sees the one crooked tile in a floor of a thousand.

A planet in Virgo becomes precise, careful and useful, and sometimes anxious. Mercury is both lord and exalted here; the analytical mind at its sharpest. Venus is debilitated here, love put under a microscope loses its warmth.

As a Lagna: a neat, youthful appearance, a sensitive digestion, a habit of correcting other people's grammar, and a genuine desire to be of use. Example: Saturn in Virgo, the auditor, the quality inspector, the person who reads the fine print and is right about it.

7. Libra (Tula), the Scales

Lord Venus; movable air; odd; the kidneys, lower back and waist. The scales weigh. Libra is balance, partnership, justice, diplomacy, beauty in proportion, and the trader's instinct for a fair price.

A planet in Libra becomes social, refined and concerned with the other person's view. Saturn is exalted here, discipline becomes justice; the judge. The Sun is debilitated here, the king cannot rule by consensus, and Libra insists on consensus.

As a Lagna: a graceful build, attractive features, a pleasing manner, a deep dislike of ugliness and rudeness, and a tendency to see so many sides that deciding becomes hard. Example: Venus in Libra in Chart A (Meera's 12th house): Venus in its own sign, charm and taste turned inward, expressed through private life and foreign connections.

8. Scorpio (Vrishchika), the Scorpion

Lord Mars; fixed water; even; the genitals and excretory organs. The scorpion lives under a stone and strikes when stepped on. Scorpio is intensity, secrecy, transformation, research, healing and surgery, loyalty unto death, and a memory for betrayal.

A planet in Scorpio becomes deep, guarded and forceful, working beneath the surface. The Moon is debilitated here, the sensitive mind in a sign that never forgets a wound. Ketu, by mainstream teaching, is exalted here: detachment learned through crisis.

As a Lagna: a magnetic gaze, a compact strong body, a private nature that reveals nothing until it trusts, and a gift for professions dealing with what is hidden, medicine, investigation, the occult, insurance. Example: the Sun and Mercury in Scorpio in Chart A, Meera's first house, a penetrating mind that speaks little and sees much.

9. Sagittarius (Dhanu), the Archer

Lord Jupiter; dual fire; odd; the hips and thighs. The archer aims at a distant target, half man, half horse, the philosopher on the move. Sagittarius is faith, teaching, law, ethics, long journeys, optimism, and an urge to find the meaning behind things.

A planet in Sagittarius becomes expansive, principled and a little preachy. It thinks in big pictures and speaks in sermons. Saturn in Sagittarius, as in Chart A, becomes the disciplined student of philosophy: slow, thorough, respectful of tradition.

As a Lagna: a tall or long-legged body, a wide smile, a love of horses, travel and argument about God, and the risk of promising more than the day allows. Example: the Moon in Sagittarius in Chart C (Devika's 9th house), a mind that is happiest with a book of philosophy and a train ticket.

10. Capricorn (Makara), the Crocodile

Lord Saturn; movable earth; even; the knees. The Indian symbol is not a goat but the *makara*, a crocodile-like river creature, patient, armoured, waiting. Capricorn is ambition, structure, duty, hierarchy, and the long climb that reaches the top by not stopping.

A planet in Capricorn becomes serious, methodical and status-conscious. Mars is exalted here, energy given a plan and a chain of command; the engineer, the general. Jupiter is debilitated here, generosity is asked to pass an audit.

As a Lagna: a lean, bony frame, a face that looks old when young and young when old, a dry humour, and a life that improves steadily after thirty. Example: Venus in Capricorn in Chart B (Arjun's 7th house), love that is loyal, practical and slow to declare itself; a spouse met through work or an elder.

11. Aquarius (Kumbha), the Water-pot

Lord Saturn; fixed air; odd; the calves, shins and ankles. The pot holds water for the whole village. Aquarius is the community, the network, science, reform, the outsider who works for the group, and a stubborn attachment to principles.

A planet in Aquarius becomes detached, idealistic and unconventional. It thinks of systems and crowds rather than individuals. Saturn is at home here (and its Moolatrikona, which we come to shortly); this is Saturn's public face, the builder of institutions. Rahu in Aquarius, as in Chart A's 4th house, is the mind pulled towards foreign lands, technology and unconventional homes.

As a Lagna: a tall frame with strong calves, a philosophical detachment, many acquaintances and a few deep friends, and a habit of arriving at conclusions nobody else has reached yet. Example: Sun, Mercury and Saturn in Aquarius in Chart B: Arjun's 8th house holds three planets in Saturn's sign: research, insurance, hidden systems, the patient uncovering of secrets.

12. Pisces (Meena), the Fishes

Lord Jupiter; dual water; even; the feet. Two fish swimming in opposite directions, tied together. Pisces is compassion, imagination, dreams, sacrifice, faith without argument, and the dissolving of boundaries between self and other.

A planet in Pisces becomes gentle, intuitive and unworldly. Venus is exalted here, love without conditions. Mercury is debilitated here, the analytical mind loses its edges in the sea of feeling. Mars in Pisces, as in Chart A's 5th house, is the warrior turned poet: energy that comes in waves and prefers a cause to a fight.

As a Lagna: a soft, often plump body, large expressive eyes, a tendency to be swept along by others' needs, and a natural leaning towards healing, art, or the spiritual life. Example: Jupiter in Pisces, the compassionate teacher who cannot say no to a student, and whose wisdom arrives as feeling before it arrives as words.

Where each planet is strongest and weakest

You have met, in passing, the idea that a planet has a sign where it is **exalted** (*Uchcha*, "high") and a sign where it is **debilitated** (*Neecha*, "low"). Here is the complete picture, with the exact degree of deepest exaltation and deepest fall. These numbers agree with Appendix A.2, and every chapter in this book uses them.

Planet	Exaltation (deepest at)	Debilitation (deepest at)	Own signs	Moolatrikona
Sun	Aries 10°	Libra 10°	Leo	Leo 0°–20°
Moon	Taurus 3°	Scorpio 3°	Cancer	Taurus 3°–30° (some texts 4°–20°)
Mars	Capricorn 28°	Cancer 28°	Aries, Scorpio	Aries 0°–12°
Mercury	Virgo 15°	Pisces 15°	Gemini, Virgo	Virgo 16°–20°
Jupiter	Cancer 5°	Capricorn 5°	Sagittarius, Pisces	Sagittarius 0°–10°
Venus	Pisces 27°	Virgo 27°	Taurus, Libra	Libra 0°–15°
Saturn	Libra 20°	Aries 20°	Capricorn, Aquarius	Aquarius 0°–20°
Rahu	Taurus (some say Gemini)	Scorpio (some say Sagittarius)	none	,
Ketu	Scorpio (some say Sagittarius)	Taurus (some say Gemini)	none	,

Three things to notice, and one memory trick.

First: **debilitation is always exactly opposite exaltation.** Sun exalted in Aries, debilitated in Libra, the 7th sign from Aries.

Moon: Taurus and Scorpio. Mars: Capricorn and Cancer. Learn the exaltations and you get the debilitations free.

Second: **the degrees are the same on both sides.** Sun 10° and 10°; Mars 28° and 28°. So there are only seven numbers to learn: 10, 3, 28, 15, 5, 27, 20.

Third: a planet is not weak the moment it enters its debilitation sign, nor a hero the moment it enters its exaltation. Strength rises towards the deepest degree and fades away from it. Mars at 2° Capricorn is comfortable; Mars at 28° Capricorn is at the summit.

The memory trick that saved me: **the exaltation is where the planet's nature is most needed.**

WHY? The exaltation table is a *classical statement*, Parashara and Varahamihira both give it, degrees included, and the reasons below are the *tradition's symbolic logic*, the way teachers have always made sense of it. The **Sun** is exalted in Aries, the sign that opened the old year at the spring equinox: the king at the moment the year needs a leader. The **Moon** in Taurus: the mind at rest in stable, well-fed earth. **Mars** in Capricorn: raw energy given a plan and a chain of command. **Mercury** in Virgo: the analyst in his own accounts office. **Jupiter** in Cancer: wisdom that nourishes, the priest who has become a mother. **Venus** in Pisces: love that dissolves the boundary between self and other. **Saturn** in Libra: judgement in the sign of the balance, the slow judge weighing evidence. Debilitation is simply the *opposite* sign, the place where that same nature is most out of place: a king in the sign of consensus (Libra), the tender mind in the scorpion's well (Scorpio), the soldier in the nursery (Cancer), the analyst adrift in the ocean (Pisces), the generous priest in the audit office (Capricorn), love itemised under a microscope (Virgo), the slow judge told to charge (Aries). Everyday parallel: the strict aunt who runs a wedding's catering desk flawlessly is exalted there; put her in charge of the children's games and she is debilitated, same aunt, wrong room.

CONSULTATION TIP: When a client's chart has a debilitated planet, say what it *asks for* before you say what it lacks: "Your Moon is in Scorpio, it asks you to make peace with intensity; people with this Moon make fine counsellors and researchers once they stop fearing their own depth." Then, and only then, mention any caution. The order of the sentences is the difference between a client who leaves frightened and one who leaves understood.

Moolatrikona: the planet's office

A planet with two own signs prefers one of them for *work*. That preferred stretch is its **Moolatrikona** ("root triangle"). The Sun, with only Leo, uses the first 20° of Leo as Moolatrikona and the last 10° as merely "own". The Moon's Moolatrikona is in Taurus, not Cancer, the Moon works best where it is fed. Mars prefers Aries (0°–12°); Mercury prefers Virgo (16°–20°); Jupiter prefers Sagittarius (0°–10°); Venus prefers Libra (0°–15°); Saturn prefers Aquarius (0°–20°).

The order of strength, from top to bottom, is a ladder of seven rungs. Colour it in your mind, green for comfortable, amber for indifferent, red for uncomfortable:

Rung	Dignity	Picture	Comfort
1	Exaltation	the summit	●
2	Moolatrikona	the office	●
3	Own sign	the home	●
4	Friend's sign	a friend's house	●
5	Neutral's sign	a hotel	◐
6	Enemy's sign	an enemy's house	○
7	Debilitation	the ditch	○

We will weigh these formally in Chapter 12 (planetary strength). For now, just get the ladder into your bones.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Beginners see "debilitated" and predict disaster. A debilitated planet is not a broken planet; it is a planet in unfamiliar clothes. A friend of mine who is a surgeon has a debilitated Moon in Scorpio, the mind that can look steadily at what others turn away from. Debility is a *style* before it is a *weakness*, and it is frequently cancelled (Neecha Bhanga, Chapter 10). Never frighten a client over one word in a table.

Putting a costume on a planet: a small drill

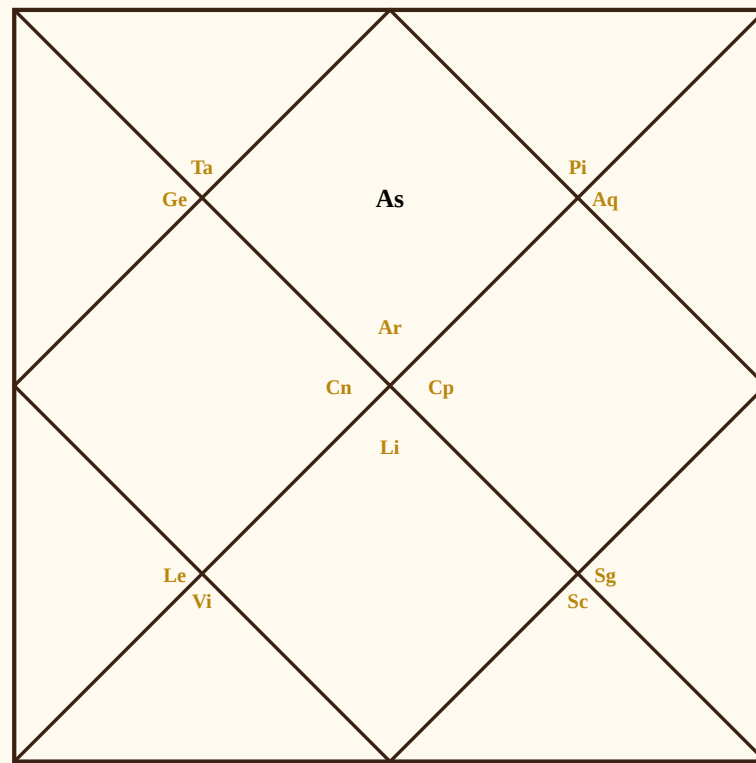
Let me show you how I think it through, using the one chart you already know.

Meera's Saturn is in Sagittarius. Do not reach for a list. Ask: who is Saturn? Discipline, delay, labour, the servant who does the long work. What is Sagittarius? Dual fire, Jupiter's sign, faith, teaching, law, the search for meaning. Now dress the planet. Saturn in Sagittarius: discipline applied to learning; the slow, thorough student of tradition; someone who takes faith seriously and works at it rather than merely inheriting it. Saturn and Jupiter are neutral to each other, so Saturn is neither delighted nor uncomfortable here, a tenant in a respectable hotel. That is the reading, and it took three questions.

Try Arjun's Mars in Leo. Who? Mars: energy, courage, command. Costume? Leo: fixed fire, the Sun's sign, dignity, authority, visibility. Mars and the Sun are friends, so Mars is at ease here: proud, steady energy that likes a title and a stage. Add that Mars is retrograde (we explain that in Chapter 3), and you get energy that is intensified and turned inward, the commander who plans in private and moves decisively in public.

Three questions, every time: *Who is the planet? What does the sign ask of it? Are the two friends?* The lists in the old books are the answers other people got to those three questions. You can get your own.

es Lagna: the twelve signs sit in the twelve houses in or



With Aries rising, house 1 = Aries, house 2 = Taurus ... house 12 = Pisces

Figure 2.4: The twelve signs in the twelve houses when Aries rises. Each house holds the sign of the same number. This is the "natural" arrangement we will use in Chapter 4 to explain why the houses mean what they mean.

In one breath

- A sign is a 30° slice of the zodiac belt; it is *how* a planet behaves, its costume, not its identity.
- Four elements repeat in order (fire, earth, air, water): action, substance, thought, feeling.
- Three qualities repeat in order (movable, fixed, dual): start, hold, adapt.
- Odd signs push outward; even signs draw inward. All fire/air signs are odd; all earth/water signs are even.
- Sign lords form a mirror: Moon-Cancer and Sun-Leo at the top, then Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn fanning out on both sides in order of distance from the Sun.
- The Kala Purusha maps Aries (head) to Pisces (feet); this body map returns as the houses' body parts.
- Exaltation and debilitation are exactly opposite, at the same degree; Moolatrikona is a planet's working office within its own signs.
- Read any planet in any sign with three questions: who is the planet, what does the sign ask, are they friends.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. Without looking at the table, write the lords of Pisces, Virgo and Aquarius. Then check them against the mirror in Figure 2.2 and explain, in one sentence, how the mirror gave you each answer.
2. Name the element and quality of Scorpio, Gemini and Capricorn, and give each a two-word nature (like "movable fire").
3. Meera's Venus is in Libra. Answer the three questions (who, what does the sign ask, are they friends) and write a two-sentence reading.
4. A client's Jupiter is at 4° Capricorn. Is it exalted, debilitated, or neither? Is it near the deepest point? What would you say to the client that is honest and not frightening?
5. Look at Figure 2.3. If someone with Aries rising complains of recurring knee trouble, which sign, and therefore which house in their chart, would you examine first? (Chapter 4 will confirm the logic.)

Answers

1. Pisces → Jupiter; Virgo → Mercury; Aquarius → Saturn. Pisces is four steps back from Cancer on the Moon's side, and the fourth planet out from the Sun is Jupiter. Virgo is one step forward from Leo on the Sun's side, and the first planet out is Mercury. Aquarius is five steps back from Cancer; the fifth planet out is Saturn. 2. Scorpio: fixed water, a deep well. Gemini: dual air, a shifting breeze. Capricorn: movable earth, a mountain road. 3. Venus is love, beauty, harmony and pleasure. Libra is Venus's own sign, balance, partnership, refinement, so Venus is at home and comfortable. Reading: Meera has refined taste and a strong sense of fairness in relationships; because this Venus sits in the 12th house, her love of beauty and comfort shows in private life, foreign connections and quiet luxuries rather than public display. 4. Jupiter is debilitated in Capricorn, and 4° is close to the deepest point (5°). Honest phrasing: "Your Jupiter is in a sign that asks it to be practical and cautious rather than expansive. Generosity and optimism may feel like they need justification, and faith may be something you earn slowly through work. Many people with this placement become excellent at building real, lasting institutions." Then check for cancellation (Neecha Bhanga) before saying more. 5. Knees belong to Capricorn, the 10th sign. With Aries rising, Capricorn is the 10th house, so examine the 10th house and its lord Saturn first.

Chapter 3: The Nine Planets (Grahas): The Actors

Every drama needs actors, and ours has exactly nine. Nine characters whose natures you can learn as well as you know your own relatives, and, like relatives, once you understand what each one wants, you can predict what they will do at any wedding.

The Sanskrit word *graha* means "that which seizes". Two of the nine are the lights (Sun and Moon), five are the naked-eye planets (Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn), and two are shadows (Rahu and Ketu), the points where eclipses happen. Astrology treats all nine as persons with temperaments, friendships and grudges. This chapter introduces each properly: their stories, what they stand for, where they are strong and weak, how fast they move, and how you can see a strong or weak planet in the person across the table.

The royal court

The oldest and best way to hold all nine in mind is the court of a king, which the texts themselves use and which this whole book will keep returning to. The **Sun** is the King; the **Moon** the Queen Mother; **Mars** the Commander; **Mercury** the clever young Prince-Secretary; **Jupiter** the Royal Priest and chief minister, Guru-ji; **Venus** the Minister of Arts and Pleasure, Shukracharya; **Saturn** the old Judge of Labour, Shani-ji, who rose from the servants' quarters. **Rahu** is the smoke-headed Stranger at the gate; **Ketu** the Headless Sadhu outside the wall. Put the Commander in the Queen Mother's rooms and you already expect friction; seat the Priest in the throne room and you expect dignity.

Benefics and malefics, and why

The texts sort the planets into gentle ones (**natural benefics**, *Shubha*) and harsh ones (**natural malefics**, *Krura* or *Papa*). Jupiter and Venus are benefics. Saturn, Mars, Rahu and Ketu are malefics; the Sun is a mild malefic, a king is cruel by office, not by temperament. Two planets change sides, and the reason is worth knowing because it is the first piece of logic in the whole system.

The **Moon** is benefic when bright and malefic when dark: from about the eighth day after the new moon to about the eighth day after the full moon it is strong in light and counts as a benefic; in the dark fortnight around the new moon it counts as a malefic. A well-fed mind is kind; a starved mind frets. The *tithi* (lunar day) of birth tells you which Moon you have.

Mercury takes the nature of its company: alone or with benefics it is a benefic; with malefics it turns malefic. Mercury with Jupiter is a scholar; with Saturn a shrewd auditor; with Mars a sharp tongue.

Planet	Natural nature
Jupiter	● great benefic
Venus	● benefic
Moon	● when bright (waxing) · ○ when dark (waning)
Mercury	👤 takes the nature of its company
Sun	○ mild malefic (cruel by office)
Mars	○ malefic
Saturn	○ great malefic
Rahu, Ketu	○ shadow malefics

WHY? Why should the Moon's goodness depend on its phase, and Mercury's on its company? *Astronomy first:* the Moon has no light of its own; what we see is reflected sunlight, and the tradition reads that light as the mind's clarity. A full, bright Moon is a mind flooded with light, steady, generous, kind; a dark Moon is a mind with the lamp turned low, anxious and easily frightened. Parashara states the rule; the light explains it. Mercury's rule is *the system's own logic*: Mercury is speech and message, and a messenger carries whatever message he is handed. Sit him beside Jupiter and he carries scripture; beside Mars, abuse. Everyday parallel: the cousin who forwards everything on the family WhatsApp group is neither good nor bad, the wedding invitation and the rumour arrive in the same font. The message decides, not the messenger.

"Malefic" does not mean "evil". A malefic gives results through pressure, effort, separation and delay; a benefic through ease, growth and support. The surgeon's knife is malefic, the nurse's hand benefic; you need both to get well. And in Chapter 8 you will see a natural malefic become a *functional* benefic for a particular Lagna, and vice versa.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Benefics *give*; malefics *make you earn*. A house with a benefic receives; a house with a malefic works, and what is earned by work usually lasts longer.

Sun (Surya), the King

Story. Surya, son of the sage Kashyapa and Aditi, rides a chariot of seven horses driven by the dawn. His wife Sanjna could not bear his blaze and left her shadow, Chhaya, in her place; from Chhaya was born Saturn, whom the Sun never fully accepted, which is why father and son are enemies in the friendship table.

What it signifies. The soul, the father, authority, government and administration, the right eye, bones, the heart as the seat of vitality, ego, fame, health in general, kings and heads of organisations.

Positions. Own sign Leo; Moolatrikona Leo 0°–20°; exalted at Aries 10°; debilitated at Libra 10°. Speed: about one sign a month, the whole zodiac in a year.

Strong Sun in a person. Steady confidence without noise; natural authority that others accept; good digestion and stamina; a healthy relationship with the father; the ability to say "no" once and mean it. *Weak Sun.* Shrinking from the spotlight or over-

claiming it; low vitality; difficulty with fathers and bosses; a need for approval. Neither is a sentence: the weak Sun learns dignity, the strong Sun humility.

Example. Meera's Sun sits in Scorpio in her 1st house at 28°. It is neither exalted nor debilitated; Scorpio is Mars's sign and Mars is the Sun's friend, so the king is comfortable, and in the 1st house he is visible. The reading: a quietly authoritative presence, a strong constitution, an identity tied to depth and investigation rather than display.

Moon (Chandra), the Queen

Story. Chandra married the twenty-seven daughters of Daksha, the twenty-seven nakshatras, but loved only Rohini. The neglected sisters complained, and Daksha cursed him to waste away. Shiva, moved by Chandra's penance, could not undo a father-in-law's curse, but he softened it: Chandra would wane for fifteen days and wax for fifteen. That is why the Moon has phases, and why the Moon spends a day in each nakshatra, it is visiting each wife in turn.

What it signifies. The mind and emotions, the mother, the public and its moods, fluids, nourishment, milk, the left eye, sleep, home comfort, the queen, and everything that ebbs and flows.

Positions. Own sign Cancer; Moolatrikona Taurus 3°–30° (some texts 4°–20°); exalted at Taurus 3°; debilitated at Scorpio 3°. Speed: about 2¼ days a sign, round the zodiac in 27.3 days, by far the fastest hand on the clock.

Strong Moon. A steady, receptive mind; emotional resilience; good sleep; warmth towards others; a nourishing relationship with the mother; popularity without effort. *Weak Moon.* Mood swings, anxiety, poor sleep, a sense of never being quite at home; sensitivity that becomes fragility.

Example. Meera's Moon is in Cancer, its own sign, in the 9th house at 21°. The queen is in her own palace, in the house of faith and teachers. Her emotional life is anchored in belief and learning; her mother is likely a devout or educated woman; she teaches from the heart.

Mars (Mangala), the Commander

Story. Mars is Bhauma, the son of the Earth. In the Puranic tellings a drop of Shiva's sweat fell to the ground during his war with a demon, and from the earth sprang a red, fierce child whom Bhumi Devi raised. Mars belongs to the soil, to land, property, and the blood that is spilled defending them.

What it signifies. Energy, courage, anger, younger siblings, land and property, blood and muscles, surgery and weapons, the army and police, engineers, athletes, competition, the commander of the forces.

Positions. Own signs Aries and Scorpio; Moolatrikona Aries 0°–12°; exalted at Capricorn 28°; debilitated at Cancer 28°. Speed: about 45 days a sign, round in roughly two years.

Strong Mars. Decisiveness; physical courage; the ability to start and to finish; a healthy competitive streak; protective of family.

Weak Mars. Aggression that misfires, quarrels, accidents, burns, or its opposite, difficulty asserting oneself; often chronic tiredness and letting others decide.

Example. Arjun's Mars is in Leo in the 2nd house at 21°, retrograde. Leo is the Sun's sign and the Sun is Mars's friend, so the commander is comfortable. In the 2nd house (speech, wealth, family) he speaks forcefully and earns through drive. Retrograde, a word we will unpack shortly, turns that force inward: he thinks before he strikes, and strikes harder for it.

Mercury (Budha), the Prince

Story. Budha is the son of the Moon and Tara, the wife of Jupiter, whom the Moon carried away. When Tara returned, the child's brilliance made both Jupiter and the Moon claim him; Tara named the Moon as father. Mercury therefore carries the Moon's quickness and Jupiter's learning, and, in the friendship table, is uneasy with his own father the Moon.

What it signifies. Intellect, speech, writing, communication, trade and commerce, mathematics and accounts, nerves and skin, the maternal uncle, students, messengers, the prince and secretary.

Positions. Own signs Gemini and Virgo; Moolatrikona Virgo 16°–20°; exalted at Virgo 15°; debilitated at Pisces 15°. Speed: about a month a sign, never more than about 28° from the Sun, it darts ahead of the king and falls back, turning retrograde three times a year.

Strong Mercury. Clear speech, quick learning, wit, good handwriting and arithmetic, ease with languages and technology, a steady nervous system. *Weak Mercury.* Muddled speech, difficulty concentrating, nervousness, poor decisions in money and paperwork, or a cleverness that outruns honesty.

Example. Meera's Mercury is in Scorpio in the 1st house at 9°, with the Sun. Sun and Mercury together form Budha-Aditya yoga, intelligence and articulation, *provided* Mercury is not burnt by the Sun's closeness. It is 19° away, safely outside the 14° orb we will meet below. A penetrating, investigative intellect, expressed with care.

Jupiter (Guru / Brihaspati), the Priest

Story. Brihaspati, son of the sage Angiras, is the teacher of the gods, the priest who knows the mantras that make sacrifices work. He is called *Guru*, "the heavy one", heavy with wisdom, and, in the sky, the largest planet.

What it signifies. Wisdom, the teacher, children, wealth and expansion, dharma and religion, law, the husband in a woman's chart, the liver and fat, optimism, ministers and advisers.

Positions. Own signs Sagittarius and Pisces; Moolatrikona Sagittarius 0°–10°; exalted at Cancer 5°; debilitated at Capricorn 5°. Speed: about a year a sign, round in roughly twelve years.

Strong Jupiter. Generosity, faith that needs no proving, good judgement, children and students who flourish, money that arrives when needed. *Weak Jupiter.* Poor judgement in whom to trust, difficulties with teachers or children, over-optimism or cynicism, liver trouble, a hollow feeling about meaning.

Example. Meera's Jupiter is in Taurus in the 7th house at 8°, retrograde. Taurus is Venus's sign, and Venus is Jupiter's enemy, the priest in the house of pleasure, slightly stiff. Yet the 7th house is marriage and partnership, and a Jupiter there, even a slightly uncomfortable one, gives a partner who is learned, principled, and a little older in spirit.

Venus (Shukra), the Minister of the Arts

Story. Shukracharya, son of the sage Bhrigu, is the teacher of the asuras. Through fierce penance he won from Shiva the *Mrita Sanjeevani* knowledge, the art of reviving the dead, which made his side unbeatable until the gods sent Brihaspati's son Kacha to learn it as his student.

What it signifies. Love, marriage, the wife in a man's chart, beauty and the arts, luxury, vehicles, music, perfume, diplomacy, the reproductive system, and ministers of pleasure and culture.

Positions. Own signs Taurus and Libra; Moolatrikona Libra 0°–15°; exalted at Pisces 27°; debilitated at Virgo 27°. Speed: about a month a sign, but, like Mercury, tied to the Sun, never more than about 48° from it.

Strong Venus. Charm without effort, taste, a happy marriage, comfort with money and pleasure, a good singing voice or an eye for design, ease in the body. *Weak Venus.* Difficulties in love, either from over-indulgence or from a fear of it; poor taste, or taste that money cannot satisfy; reproductive or kidney complaints.

Example. Meera's Venus is in Libra in the 12th house at 22°. Own sign, so comfortable; but the 12th is the house of expenses, bed pleasures, foreign lands and quiet withdrawal. Her love of beauty is real but private; she spends on comfort; a partner from far away, or a life abroad, is a thread to check.

Saturn (Shani), the Servant and the Judge

Story. Shani is the son of the Sun and Chhaya, the shadow. Dark, slow and lame, he was not welcomed by his brilliant father. Saturn is the god of the labourer, the widow and the outcaste, everyone the court overlooks, and he does not forget a debt.

What it signifies. Longevity, discipline, sorrow and patience, labour and servants, delay, chronic disease, old age, bones, teeth and nerves, iron and oil, justice over the long run.

Positions. Own signs Capricorn and Aquarius; Moolatrikona Aquarius 0°–20°; exalted at Libra 20°; debilitated at Aries 20°. Speed: about 2½ years a sign, round in roughly 29½ years, the slow hand of the clock.

Strong Saturn. Endurance, method, honesty, respect for time and rules, achievement that comes late and stays. *Weak Saturn.* Fear, pessimism and chronic delay, or a rigid harshness towards oneself and others; joint and dental trouble; a sense of carrying the world alone.

Example. Arjun's Saturn is in Aquarius, its own sign and Moolatrikona, in the 8th house at 25°. Saturn is the natural karaka of the 8th and here it is at home: research, insurance, the long patient study of hidden systems. But it sits only 7° from the Sun, and that brings us to combustion.

DID YOU KNOW? Saturn takes about 29½ years to circle the zodiac. So around age 29–30, and again around 58–60, Saturn returns to where it was at your birth. Almost every tradition, East and West, marks these as turning points, the end of youth, the beginning of elderhood. Many a client who "suddenly got serious" at 29 was simply meeting Saturn again.

Rahu and Ketu, the Shadows

Story. When the gods and demons churned the ocean for the nectar of immortality (*Samudra Manthan*), a demon named Svarbhanu disguised himself and sat among the gods to drink it. The Sun and Moon recognised him and told Vishnu, who cut off his head with his discus, but the nectar had already passed his throat. The head lived on as **Rahu**, the body as **Ketu**. Rahu still chases the Sun and Moon to swallow them, which is why we see eclipses; Ketu, the body without a head, wants nothing and sees everything.

What they are. Not bodies at all. The Moon's orbit is tilted about 5° to the Sun's path, and the two crossing points are the **lunar nodes**: Rahu the north node, Ketu the south. Always exactly opposite, they slide backwards through the zodiac, about 18 months a sign, a full circle in about 18.6 years.

Rahu and Ketu: where the Moon's path crosses the Sun's

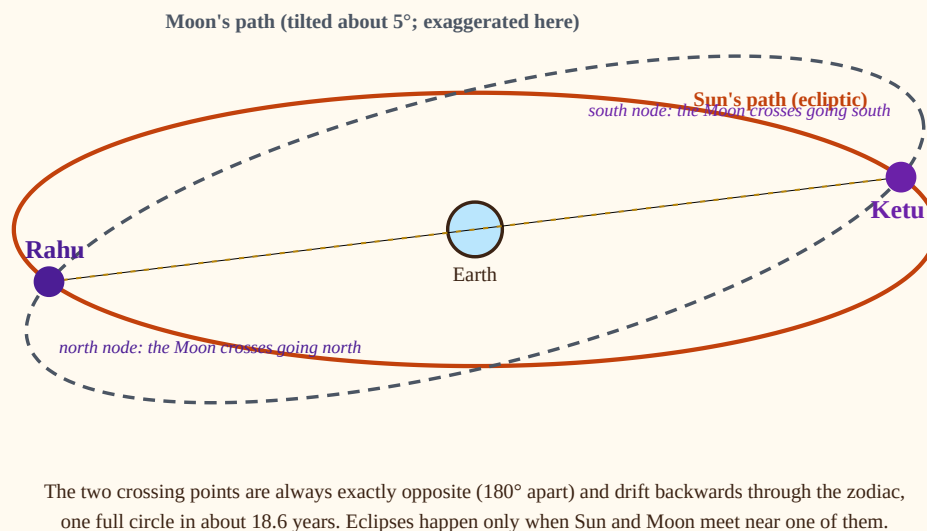


Figure 3.1: The eclipse axis. The Sun's path and the Moon's path cross at two points, Rahu and Ketu, always 180° apart. Eclipses happen only when the Sun and Moon meet near one of them, which is exactly what the story says.

STORY: THE STRANGER AND THE SADHU. At the gate stands a Stranger with smoke for a head (Rahu): foreign clothes, restless eyes, hungry for everything inside. The King and Queen Mother exposed him at the churning of the ocean and the Commander threw him out, so he hates all three; his friends are in the People's Party, the Minister of Arts sells him pleasures, the Judge respects his patience, the Prince enjoys his cleverness. Outside the wall sits the Headless Sadhu (Ketu), his severed other half, who wants nothing. He too hates the two lights that unmasked him, but counts the fierce Commander, the detached Judge and the flower-bringing Minister of Arts as friends. **Rule:** Rahu is friendly to Venus, Saturn and Mercury, hostile to Sun, Moon and Mars; Ketu is friendly to Mars, Venus and Saturn, hostile to Moon and Sun (a working convention; sources vary).

WHY? Why "shadows", and why do they move backward? Astronomy: Rahu and Ketu are not bodies but the two points where the Moon's tilted orbit crosses the Sun's path. An eclipse can happen only when the Sun and Moon meet at one of those crossings, the Moon's shadow falls on the Earth, or the Earth's on the Moon, so the tradition named the crossings after the thing they produce: shadow. They move backward because the Sun's pull slowly swings the whole plane of the Moon's orbit round the other way, one full turn in 18.6 years, the "regression of the nodes" of any astronomy textbook. Everyday parallel: two roads crossing at a junction. Traffic flows along both roads all day, but the accident (the eclipse) can only happen at the crossing, and if the road crew keeps re-laying the junction a little further back each year, the crossing itself creeps backward along the road.

What they signify. **Rahu:** obsession, ambition without limit, foreigners and foreign lands, technology, illusion and glamour, smoke and poison, sudden rise, the paternal grandfather. **Ketu:** detachment, liberation (*moksha*), past-life skills that come without effort, the occult and the mystical, sudden loss, wounds, the maternal grandfather.

Positions. They own no signs. The mainstream shorthand is "Rahu acts like Saturn, Ketu acts like Mars". Exaltation and debilitation are disputed: the common view is Rahu exalted in Taurus and debilitated in Scorpio, Ketu the reverse; some authors say Gemini and Sagittarius instead. I use the Taurus/Scorpio view and say so whenever it matters.

Strong Rahu is the immigrant who builds an empire; *afflicted Rahu* the person forever chasing the next thing. *Strong Ketu* is the healer or mathematician; *afflicted Ketu* cannot stay attached to anything, including their own well-being.

Example. Meera's Rahu is in Aquarius in the 4th (home, mother, property): an unconventional home, perhaps far from where she was born, a pull towards technology and foreign ways of living. Her Ketu is in Leo in the 10th: a career in which recognition matters less and less, and mastery that arrives without visible effort, very typical of teachers and consultants.

Who likes whom: the friendship table

Planets in each other's signs behave like guests, and how a guest behaves depends on the host. Here is Parashara's table of **natural friendship** (*Naisargika Maitri*), exactly as it stands in Appendix A.3.

Planet	● Friends	◐ Neutral	◑ Enemies
Sun	● Moon, Mars, Jupiter	◐ Mercury	◑ Venus, Saturn
Moon	● Sun, Mercury	◐ Mars, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn	(none)
Mars	● Sun, Moon, Jupiter	◐ Venus, Saturn	◑ Mercury
Mercury	● Sun, Venus	◐ Mars, Jupiter, Saturn	◑ Moon
Jupiter	● Sun, Moon, Mars	◐ Saturn	◑ Mercury, Venus
Venus	● Mercury, Saturn	◐ Mars, Jupiter	◑ Sun, Moon
Saturn	● Mercury, Venus	◐ Jupiter	◑ Sun, Moon, Mars

Natural friendship (Naisargika Maitri): who likes whom

row planet →
feels about column planet

	Sun	Moon	Mars	Mercury	Jupiter	Venus	Saturn
Sun	,	Friend	Friend	Neutral	Friend	Enemy	Enemy
Moon	Friend	,	Neutral	Friend	Neutral	Neutral	Neutral
Mars	Friend	Friend	,	Enemy	Friend	Neutral	Neutral
Mercury	Friend	Enemy	Neutral	,	Neutral	Friend	Neutral
Jupiter	Friend	Friend	Friend	Enemy	,	Enemy	Neutral
Venus	Enemy	Enemy	Neutral	Friend	Neutral	,	Friend
Saturn	Enemy	Enemy	Enemy	Friend	Neutral	Friend	,

The royal party: Sun, Moon, Mars, and their priest Jupiter

The other party: Mercury, Venus, Saturn

Read across a row. The Moon has no enemies; Mercury dislikes its own mother the Moon; friendship is not always mutual.

Figure 3.2: The friendship grid, colour coded, green friend, amber neutral, red enemy. Read across a row: how the row planet feels about the column planet. The two "parties" are bracketed underneath.

WHY? Where does this table come from? It is not arbitrary. *Classical derivation (Parashara, BPHS chapter on planetary relations; Varahamihira gives the same):* take a planet's Moolatrikona sign and count from it. The lords of the 2nd, 4th, 5th, 8th, 9th and 12th signs from it, plus the lord of its exaltation sign, are its friends; the lords of the remaining signs are enemies; a planet that lands on both lists is neutral. Walk the Sun: Moolatrikona Leo. The 2nd is Virgo (Mercury), 4th Scorpio (Mars), 5th Sagittarius (Jupiter), 8th Pisces (Jupiter), 9th Aries (Mars, also the Sun's exaltation), 12th Cancer (Moon), so Mars, Jupiter and the Moon are friends. Mercury also owns Gemini, the 11th, which puts him on the enemy list too: on both lists, so neutral. Venus (Libra 3rd, Taurus 10th) and Saturn (Capricorn 6th, Aquarius 7th) appear only on the enemy list. That is the Sun's row exactly. Try Mercury from Virgo yourself; it works. The court stories below are the *symbolic* layer the tradition adds so that the result is remembered. Everyday parallel: in a joint family, your natural allies are the relatives whose rooms open onto your courtyard; the ones down the far corridor you rarely see, and rarely warm to.

Do not memorise this grid cell by cell. Listen to the court instead, every cell is a grudge or a loyalty with a reason.

STORY: THE TWO PARTIES. Every court has two parties. At the King's right hand sits the **Royal Party**: the King himself (Sun), the Queen Mother (Moon), the Commander (Mars) and the Royal Priest, Guru-ji (Jupiter). They believe in throne, dharma and duty. Across the hall sits the **People's Party**: the clever young Prince-Secretary (Mercury), the Minister of Arts and Pleasure, Shukracharya (Venus), and the old Judge of Labour, Shani-ji (Saturn), who rose from the servants' quarters. They believe in trade, comfort, cleverness and the working man. Inside a party everyone is a friend or at least civil; across the aisle there is coolness, and a few open feuds that the next stories explain. **Rule:** Sun, Moon, Mars and Jupiter are friends or neutral to one another; so are Mercury, Venus and Saturn; every enmity in the table runs across the aisle.

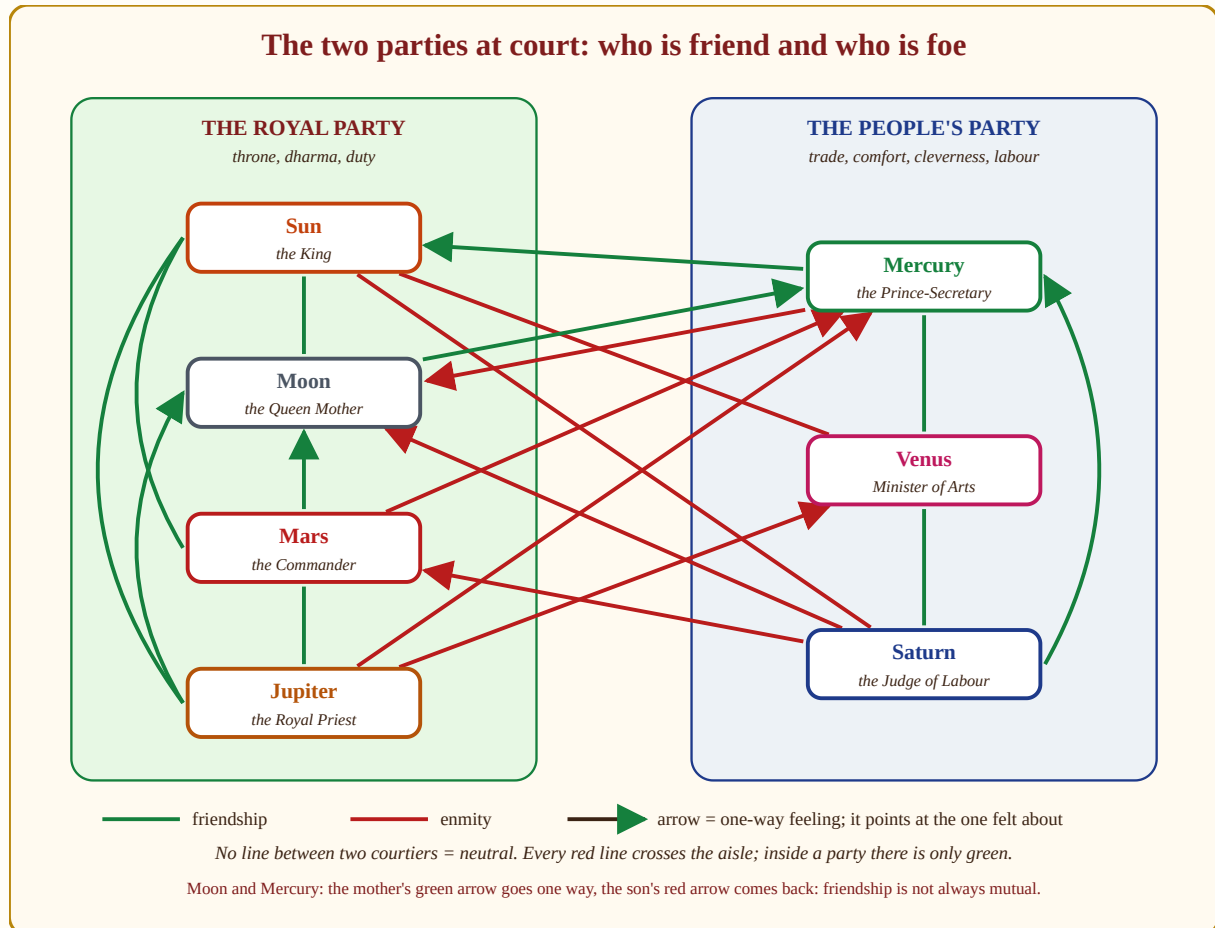


Figure 3.3: The two parties. Green lines are friendships, red lines enmities; an arrowhead means the feeling runs one way only; pairs with no line are neutral to each other.

STORY: THE KING AND THE MINISTER OF PLEASURE. The King (Sun) rises before dawn, bathes in cold water and expects the court to do the same. Shukracharya (Venus) keeps the court up till midnight with music, perfume and wine, and, worse, is the guru of the asuras, the King's sworn enemies, whom he has taught to revive their dead. The King calls him decadent; the Minister calls the King a bore. Neither has ever forgiven the other. **Rule:** Sun and Venus are mutual enemies.

STORY: THE REJECTED SON. Shani-ji (Saturn) was born dark and slow to the King and his wife's shadow, Chhaya. His brilliant father never accepted him. The Queen Mother's household (Moon) looked past the awkward boy; the hot young Commander (Mars) mocked his lame foot. Shani left, worked among the labourers, and slowly became the Judge of Labour, who keeps the ledger of everyone's work and forgets nothing. He counts all three as enemies. The King and the Commander return the feeling. The Queen Mother, who quarrels with no one, merely looks away. **Rule:** Saturn's enemies are Sun, Moon and Mars; Sun and Mars return the enmity; the Moon stays neutral.

STORY: TARA'S SON. The Moon carried away Tara, the wife of Guru-ji, and from that scandal the Prince, Budha (Mercury), was born. When Tara returned, both Guru-ji and the Moon claimed the brilliant child, and Tara named the Moon. The boy grew up quick, clever and ashamed of the story; he resents the parent who caused it and keeps his distance. But a parent's love does not depend on the child's gratitude: the Moon still counts Budha a friend. **Rule:** Mercury calls the Moon an enemy; the Moon calls Mercury a friend. Friendship in this table is not always mutual.

STORY: THE PRIEST'S TWO HEADACHES. Guru-ji (Jupiter) preaches restraint, tradition and the sacred texts. Two people at court give him indigestion. Shukracharya (Venus), the rival guru who teaches the other side and laughs at restraint; and the Prince (Mercury), who is too clever by half and questions every sermon with a footnote. Guru-ji calls both enemies. Neither is much bothered, one is busy with a concert, the other with his accounts, so they hold nothing against the old priest and count him neutral. **Rule:** Jupiter regards Mercury and Venus as enemies; Mercury and Venus regard Jupiter as neutral.

STORY: THE COMMANDER AND THE SECRETARY. The Commander (Mars) wants his orders obeyed now. The Prince-Secretary (Mercury) wants them in writing, in triplicate, with three questions attached. Mars calls him an enemy and a coward. Mercury shrugs and files the complaint, he has no strong feelings about the loud man in armour. **Rule:** Mars counts Mercury an enemy; Mercury counts Mars neutral.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER HAS NO ENEMIES. Rani Ma (Moon) has fed everyone at this court. She is the King's closest friend, she loves the difficult Prince, and to the Commander, the Priest, the Minister of Arts and the Judge she is simply the one who asks whether they have eaten. Nobody is her enemy, and she is nobody's. Notice, too, that the King tolerates the Prince, the clever boy is always at his elbow, and so is neutral to him, though the Prince counts the King a friend and patron. **Rule:** The Moon's friends are Sun and Mercury, all others neutral, none enemies; the Sun is neutral to Mercury.

Rahu and Ketu are not in Parashara's table; their working conventions are in the Stranger-and-Sadhu story above, and I always add that sources vary.

Guest houses and humiliations: exaltation retold

Chapter 2 gave you the exaltation table. Here it is as a court story, because a story is remembered when a table is not.

STORY: EVERY COURTIER'S FAVOURITE GUEST HOUSE. Each courtier has one district where the host's ways suit him perfectly, and one where he is quietly humiliated. The King (Sun) is honoured in Aries, the Commander's frontier fort, where a king is needed to lead the charge; he is humiliated in Libra, the Minister of Arts' salon, where every decision is put to a vote. The Queen Mother (Moon) rests in Taurus, the Minister's well-stocked kitchen; she is miserable in Scorpio, the Commander's night barracks. The Commander (Mars) is honoured in Capricorn, the Judge's fortress of five-year plans, and humiliated in Cancer, the Queen Mother's nursery. The Prince (Mercury) shines in Virgo, his own accounts office, and drowns in Pisces, the Priest's ashram by the sea. Guru-ji (Jupiter) is honoured in Cancer, the Queen Mother's house of compassion, and humiliated in Capricorn, the Judge's audit office. Shukracharya (Venus) is honoured in Pisces, the Priest's house of boundless kindness, and humiliated in Virgo, the Prince's office where love is itemised. And the Judge (Saturn) is honoured in Libra, the Minister's hall of scales where justice is weighed, and humiliated in Aries, the Commander's barracks, where the slow old man is told to run. **Rule:** Exaltation and debilitation are always opposite signs at the same degree, 10, 3, 28, 15, 5, 27, 20 for Sun, Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn.

Combustion: too close to the king

A planet that comes too near the Sun disappears in the glare: **combustion** (Asta, "set"). It does not stop giving results, but it gives them through the Sun's agenda, ego, father, authority, and its own matters suffer.

The approximate orbs are: Moon 12°, Mars 17°, Mercury 14° (12° when retrograde), Jupiter 11°, Venus 10° (8° when retrograde), Saturn 15°. Rahu and Ketu are never combust. Authors differ by a degree or two; these are the mainstream figures.

STORY: BLINDED BY THE KING. A courtier who stands too close to the throne is blinded by the King's glare. He can still speak, but he can only echo the King's words; his own business is forgotten. Each courtier can stand a different distance before he is dazzled: the Commander is blinded from 17° away, the Judge from 15°, the Prince from 14° (12° when he is walking backward), the Queen Mother from 12°, Guru-ji from 11°, and the Minister of Arts, who is used to bright lights, only from 10° (8° when retrograde). The Stranger and the Sadhu are smoke and shadow; no glare touches them. **Rule:** Within its orb of the Sun a planet is combust, it serves the Sun's agenda (ego, father, authority) rather than its own.

WHY? Why does each planet have a different orb? Astronomy: combustion began as a visibility rule, a planet is "set" (asta) when it is too near the Sun to be seen in the twilight. How near depends on brightness. Venus, the brightest object after the Moon, stays visible closest to the Sun, so its orb is the smallest (10°); dim, distant Mars and Saturn vanish from much further away (17°, 15°). Mercury and Venus are inner planets: when retrograde they pass between Earth and Sun, closer and larger, so their orbs shrink further (12°, 8°). The exact numbers are tradition, authors differ by a degree or two, but the ranking is physics. Everyday parallel: stand near the floodlight at a wedding. A candle beside it disappears from ten paces; a bright torch is still seen right next to it.

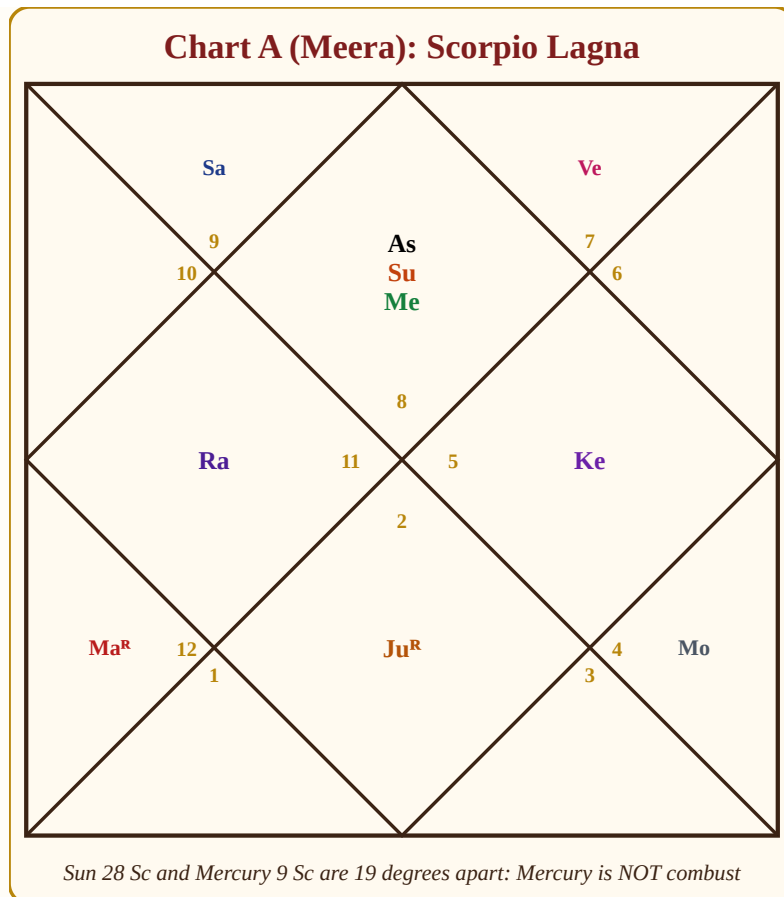


Figure 3.4: Chart A. Sun at 28° Scorpio, Mercury at 9° Scorpio, same sign, 19° apart. Mercury is well outside its 14° orb, so it is not combust, and the Budha-Aditya yoga holds.

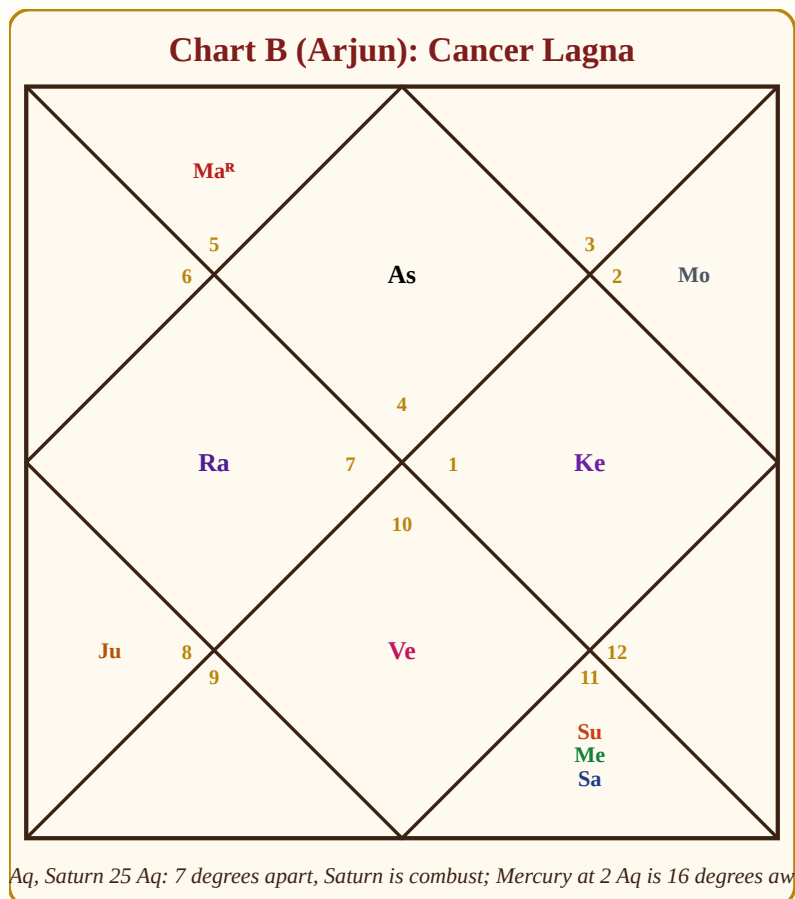


Figure 3.5: Chart B. Sun 18° Aquarius, Saturn 25°, only 7° apart, inside Saturn's 15° orb: Saturn is combust. Mercury at 2° is 16° away and safe.

In Chart A, Sun and Mercury share the 1st house but are 19° apart, no combustion. In Chart B, Saturn sits 7° from the Sun: combust. What does that *look like*? Not disaster. Arjun's discipline is real but must serve his sense of self and his father's expectations; he is methodical when a boss or a cause demands it. Combustion is a planet that has lost its independence, not its existence.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Declaring a planet "combust and useless" because it shares a sign with the Sun.

Combustion is measured in *degrees*, not signs. Always read the longitudes. Sharing a sign with the Sun at 25° apart is a conjunction with dignity; at 3° apart it is combustion.

Retrogression: the planet that seems to go backwards

Three or four times a year Mercury appears to stop against the stars, move backwards for some weeks, stop again and resume. Venus does it every year and a half, Mars every two years, Jupiter and Saturn for four to five months every year. This is **retrogression** (*Vakra*, "crooked"). Nothing actually reverses: the Earth, on an inner and faster lane, overtakes the outer planets and our line of sight swings backwards. Mercury and Venus, on inner lanes, do the same to us.

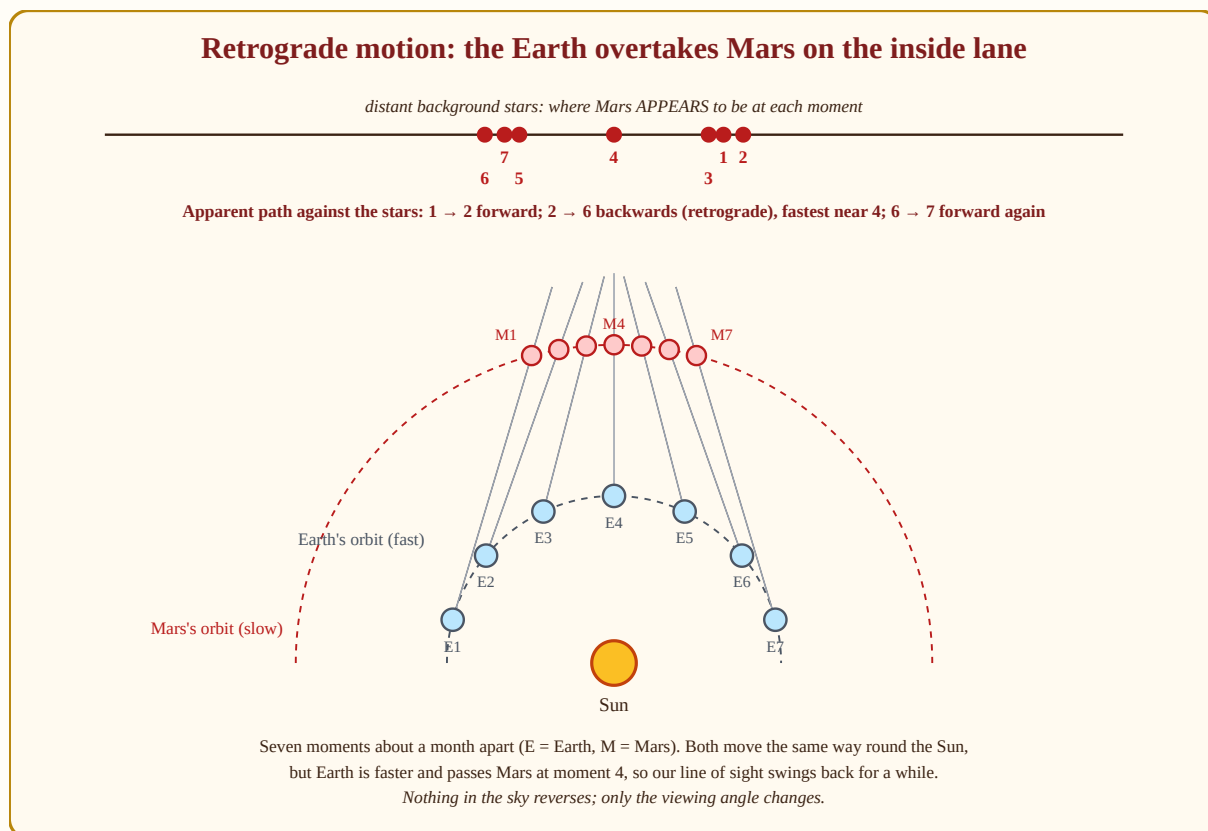


Figure 3.6: Seven monthly snapshots. Earth (inner lane) passes Mars (outer lane) at moment 4. Against the background stars Mars appears to go forward, then back, then forward again.

STORY: THE MINISTER WHO WALKS BACKWARD. *Once in a while a minister is seen walking backward through the great hall, slowly, lost in thought. The junior courtiers giggle: he has gone the wrong way. The old ones know better. At that moment he is nearer to you than he ever is otherwise, and brighter, you can see every line on his face. He is not reversing his duties; he is turning them over inside himself. When he finally speaks, it is after long reflection, and it lands harder.*

Rule: *A retrograde planet is intensified and internalised, results come later, from within, often on a second attempt. Never read it as "reversed".*

WHY? *The layer here is pure astronomy, and the diagram above is the proof. Everyday parallel: you are on the fast train and a slower train is running on the parallel track in the same direction. As you overtake it, for a few moments the slower train seems to slide backwards past your window. It never reversed; you were simply faster. Mars is that slower train, and the retrograde weeks are the overtaking.*

How to read it: a retrograde planet is at its closest to the Earth, brightest in the sky, and its energy is **intensified and internalised**. Retrograde Mercury rewrites every message before sending; retrograde Mars trains in private and surprises everyone on the day; retrograde Jupiter holds a faith that is personal and hard-won. Do **not** call retrograde "reversed" or "bad"; Parashara actually counts retrograde planets as *stronger*. The Sun and Moon are never retrograde; Rahu and Ketu are always retrograde, which is simply their normal motion.

Meera has two retrograde planets: Mars in Pisces (5th house) and Jupiter in Taurus (7th house). Her creativity comes in inward-turning waves; her marriage is with someone whose wisdom is private and grows over time.

Planetary war: two planets in one degree

When two of the five true planets (Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn) come within one degree of each other, the texts call it a **planetary war** (*Graha Yuddha*): one wins, one loses, and the loser's significations are weakened. Which one wins is disputed, the older rule favours the planet further north in latitude, many moderns the planet with the lower longitude, and brightness is the practical tie-breaker (Venus rarely loses). For a beginner: note a war, read the loser's houses with extra care, and never build a prediction on the war alone. The Sun, Moon and nodes do not fight.

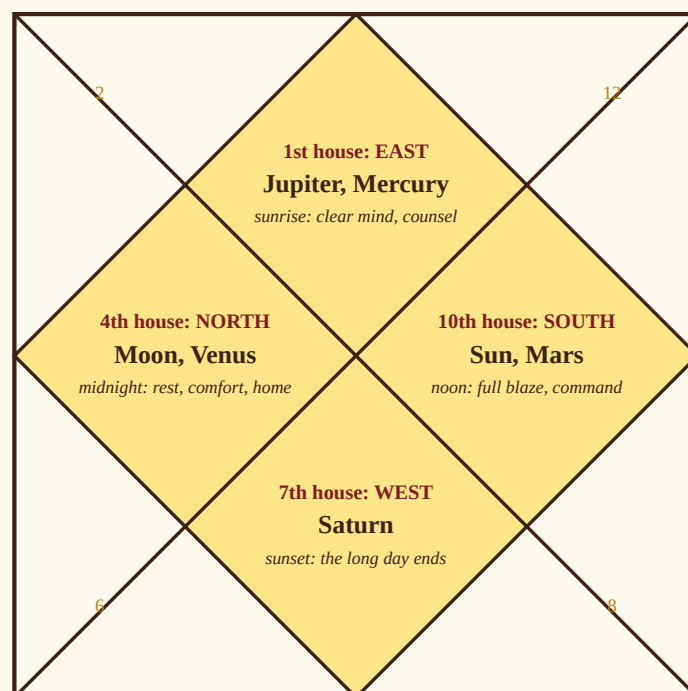
Directional strength: where each planet stands tallest

Every planet has a house in which it is said to have full **directional strength** (*Dig Bala*): Jupiter and Mercury in the 1st; the Moon and Venus in the 4th; Saturn in the 7th; the Sun and Mars in the 10th. The logic is a day.

STORY: WHO STANDS AT WHICH GATE. The palace has four gates, and the day decides who stands at each. At dawn the East gate (the 1st house) opens, and there stand Guru-ji and the Prince, the Priest and the Secretary, because counsel is given while the mind is fresh. At noon the King and the Commander are on the rooftop above the South gate (the 10th house), in full blaze, giving orders the whole city can see. At sunset the tired old Judge closes the West gate (the 7th house): the labourer's day is done and the accounts are settled. At midnight the Queen Mother and the Minister of Arts keep the North gate (the 4th house), the inner rooms of rest, food and comfort. Stand a courtier at the wrong gate, the Judge at dawn, the King at midnight, and he has no strength of direction at all. **Rule:** Dig bala: Jupiter and Mercury in the 1st; Sun and Mars in the 10th; Saturn in the 7th; Moon and Venus in the 4th. The opposite house gives zero.

WHY? Dig bala is a classical statement (Parashara lists it in the strength chapter), and its logic is astronomy read symbolically: the four kendras are the four turning points of the Sun's day, rising in the east (1st), overhead at noon (10th), setting in the west (7th), underfoot at midnight (4th). Each planet is given the hour whose quality matches its own: the fierce hour of noon to the Sun and Mars, the dark restful hour to the Moon and Venus, the clear first light to Jupiter and Mercury, and the tired end of the working day to Saturn. Everyday parallel: any office. The planners want the 9 a.m. meeting; the boss makes announcements at noon when everyone is in; the accounts clerk closes the books at six; and the house, the food and the music belong to the night.

Directional strength (Dig Bala)



The 1st house is the eastern (rising) point, the 10th is overhead at noon, the 7th is the setting point, the 4th is underfoot at midnight. Each planet stands tallest in the house that matches its hour of the day.

Figure 3.7: Directional strength. Each planet stands tallest in the house that matches its hour of the day. A planet in the opposite house has no directional strength at all.

Meera's Mercury in the 1st has full directional strength, the clever secretary at the sunrise table, which fits her articulate first impression. Her Jupiter in the 7th, opposite its strong 1st, has none: its wisdom must work through the partner rather than through her own presence. Dig bala is one of the six strengths of *Shadbala* (Chapter 12); for now, note it as a modifier.

DID YOU KNOW? The days of the week are named for the planets in the order of the *horas*, the planetary hours. The hours run in the order Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Sun, Venus, Mercury, Moon (slowest to fastest) and repeat. Start a Sunday with the Sun ruling the first hour; count twenty-four hours and the twenty-fifth, the first hour of the next day, falls to the Moon. Hence Sunday, Monday (Moon), Tuesday (Mars, *Mangal-var*), Wednesday (Mercury, *Budh-var*), Thursday (Jupiter, *Guru-var*), Friday (Venus, *Shukra-var*), Saturday (Saturn: *Shani-var*). Hindi, Latin and English all keep this order.

The planets in a nutshell

Keep this table by your desk until you no longer need it. Every value agrees with Appendix A.

Planet	Court role	Nature	Own signs	Exalted	Debilitated	Moolatrikona	Speed per sign	Dig bala house	Key words
Sun (Su)	King	○ Mild malefic	Leo	Aries 10°	Libra 10°	Leo 0°–20°	1 month	10th	Soul, father, authority
Moon (Mo)	Queen	● bright / ○ dark	Cancer	Taurus 3°	Scorpio 3°	Taurus 3°–30°	2¼ days	4th	Mind, mother, public
Mars (Ma)	Commander	○ Malefic	Aries, Scorpio	Capricorn 28°	Cancer 28°	Aries 0°–12°	45 days	10th	Energy, courage, land
Mercury (Me)	Prince	● Takes company's nature	Gemini, Virgo	Virgo 15°	Pisces 15°	Virgo 16°–20°	~1 month	1st	Intellect, speech, trade
Jupiter (Ju)	Priest, minister	● Great benefic	Sagittarius, Pisces	Cancer 5°	Capricorn 5°	Sagittarius 0°–10°	1 year	1st	Wisdom, children, wealth
Venus (Ve)	Minister of arts	● Benefic	Taurus, Libra	Pisces 27°	Virgo 27°	Libra 0°–15°	~1 month	4th	Love, beauty, luxury
Saturn (Sa)	Servant, judge	○ Great malefic	Capricorn, Aquarius	Libra 20°	Aries 20°	Aquarius 0°–20°	2½ years	7th	Discipline, delay, longevity
Rahu (Ra)	Foreigner, smoke	○ Malefic (shadow)	none (like Saturn)	Taurus (some: Gemini)	Scorpio (some: Sagittarius)	none	18 months, backwards	none	Obsession, foreign, technology
Ketu (Ke)	Headless ascetic	○ Malefic (shadow)	none (like Mars)	Scorpio (some: Sagittarius)	Taurus (some: Gemini)	none	18 months, backwards	none	Detachment, moksha, occult

CONSULTATION TIP: Never describe a planet to a client as "bad". Say what it *asks*. "Your Saturn sits in the house of marriage; it asks for patience and rewards loyalty" is true, useful, and leaves the person with something to do. "Saturn in the 7th is bad for marriage" is lazy, frightening, and, as you will see in Chapter 8, often simply wrong for their Lagna.

In one breath

- Nine actors: two lights, five planets, two shadows. The royal-court picture gives you their characters and their quarrels.
- Jupiter and Venus are natural benefics; Saturn, Mars, Rahu, Ketu and (mildly) the Sun are malefics; the Moon depends on its brightness and Mercury on its company.
- Each planet has own signs, an exaltation and an exactly opposite debilitation at the same degree, and a Moolatrikona "office", all as in Appendix A.2.
- Friendship follows two parties: Sun-Moon-Mars-Jupiter against Mercury-Venus-Saturn, with three memorable exceptions.
- Combustion is measured in degrees from the Sun; retrogression is intensified, internalised energy, never "reversed"; planetary war weakens the loser.
- Directional strength follows the hours of a day: thinkers at sunrise (1st), king and commander at noon (10th), servant at sunset (7th), queen and pleasure at midnight (4th).
- Rahu and Ketu are the two points where the Moon's tilted orbit crosses the Sun's path, the eclipse axis, always opposite and always moving backwards.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. A client's Moon is at 5° Scorpio, born two days before a new moon. Comment on the Moon's sign dignity and its natural nature, and write one gentle sentence you could say about it.
2. In Chart C (Devika), Mercury is at 1° Leo and the Sun at 5° Cancer. Are they in the same sign? How many degrees apart are they? Is Mercury combust?
3. Which planets are friends of Venus? A chart has Venus in Sagittarius. How does Venus feel there, and why?
4. Arjun's Mars is retrograde in Leo in the 2nd house. Write a two-sentence reading that uses "intensified and internalised" rather than "reversed".
5. Name the dig bala house of each of the seven planets without looking, using the "hours of the day" logic.

Answers

1. Scorpio is the Moon's debilitation sign, and 5° is near the deepest point (3°). Two days before the new moon the Moon is dark, so it counts as a natural malefic: a sensitive, intense mind that may brood. Gentle sentence: "Your mind goes deep and does not forget easily, which is a gift in any work that needs insight, and a burden only if you carry old hurts without setting them down."
2. No: Mercury is in Leo and the Sun in Cancer, different signs. The distance is from 5° Cancer to 1° Leo: 25° to the end of Cancer plus 1° = 26°. Mercury's orb is 14°, so it is not combust.
3. Venus's friends are Mercury and Saturn. Sagittarius belongs to Jupiter, who is neutral to Venus (from Venus's side), though Jupiter regards Venus as an enemy. Venus is in a neutral's sign, a hotel guest, comfortable enough, but its indulgence is tempered by Sagittarius's principles.
4. Arjun's Mars in the 2nd house gives forceful, direct speech and the drive to earn; Leo, a friend's sign, makes that drive proud and steady. Being retrograde, the energy

is intensified and internalised: he rehearses what he will say, holds back until sure, and then speaks with unusual weight. 5.
Sunrise (1st): Mercury and Jupiter. Noon (10th): Sun and Mars. Sunset (7th): Saturn. Midnight (4th): Moon and Venus.

Chapter 4: The Twelve Houses (Bhavas): The Rooms

Planet is *who*. Sign is *how*. Now the third and last layer of the grammar: the house is *where*. Where in a life does this energy land, in the body, in the bank, in the marriage, in the career, in the quiet hours of sleep?

Think of a house in the old sense: a big joint-family home with twelve rooms. The same uncle (planet) behaves differently in the kitchen, the prayer room and the room where the accounts are kept. Put Saturn in the room of marriage and he asks for patience there; put him in the room of career and he builds a slow, solid reputation. The room does not change Saturn. It decides *which part of the person's life* gets Saturn's lessons.

The Sanskrit word is **Bhava**, which means "state of being" or "becoming". Twelve bhavas, twelve areas in which a life unfolds. This chapter teaches you what each room is for, and, more importantly, *why*, so that you can derive any house meaning you have forgotten from first principles.

STORY: THE HAVELI OF TWELVE ROOMS. Walk through the old family haveli once and you will never forget the houses. You enter at the **front door and veranda** (1st), the face the family shows the street. Just inside is the **kitchen with the family purse** (2nd), where grain and money are kept and everyone eats and talks. Beyond it the **courtyard** (3rd), where brothers wrestle and letters are written. Off the courtyard, the **mother's inner room** (4th), the heart of the house. Next the **children's study** (5th). Down a passage, the **store-room** (6th), where the servants work, the debts are recorded and the sick are nursed. Straight ahead, the **bridal room** (7th), whose second door opens on the world. Behind it the dark **back stairs** (8th). Up those stairs the **prayer room** (9th) where the grandfather sits, and above it the **office on the roof** (10th) that the whole street can see. Down again to the **guest hall** (11th) where friends gather, and finally across the lane to the **guest-house** (12th), where one goes to sleep, to hide, or to leave. **Rule:** House *n* is the *n*th room of the haveli, picture the room and its meanings follow.

Where the rooms come from

In Jyotish the rooms are counted from the rising sign (Lagna). The Lagna sign is the 1st house, whole. The next sign is the 2nd house, whole. And so on round the zodiac. This is the **whole-sign house** system (*Rashi-bhava*), the default of the Parashari tradition and the one this book uses throughout. In Chart A, Scorpio rises, so Scorpio is the 1st house, Sagittarius the 2nd, Capricorn the 3rd, right round to Libra as the 12th.

You will meet a second method in software: **Bhava Chalit** (often the Sripati system), which divides the space around the exact Lagna degree into twelve unequal houses. Most of the time the two agree. They disagree only for a planet near the edge of a house, in Chart A, the Sun at 28° Scorpio sits in the 1st house by sign but slips into the 2nd bhava in a Chalit chart. My working rule: read the whole-sign house first; when a planet is within a few degrees of a house boundary, let it speak for *both* houses. Meera's Sun gives authority both to her presence (1st) and to her speech and family (2nd). Argue about systems later; for now, whole signs.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Reading house meanings from the *sign number* instead of counting from the Lagna. In Chart A, Cancer is sign 4, but it is Meera's *9th house*. The house is always the count from the Lagna; the sign number is only the costume the room happens to be wearing.

The natural zodiac: why the houses mean what they mean

Here is the key that unlocks the twelve rooms. Imagine a chart in which Aries rises. Then the 1st house is Aries, the 2nd is Taurus, and so on to the 12th, which is Pisces. This is the **natural zodiac**, the Kala Purusha's own chart, the chart of the Cosmic Man we met in Chapter 2. The classical meanings of the houses are simply the meanings of the signs that live there in this natural chart.

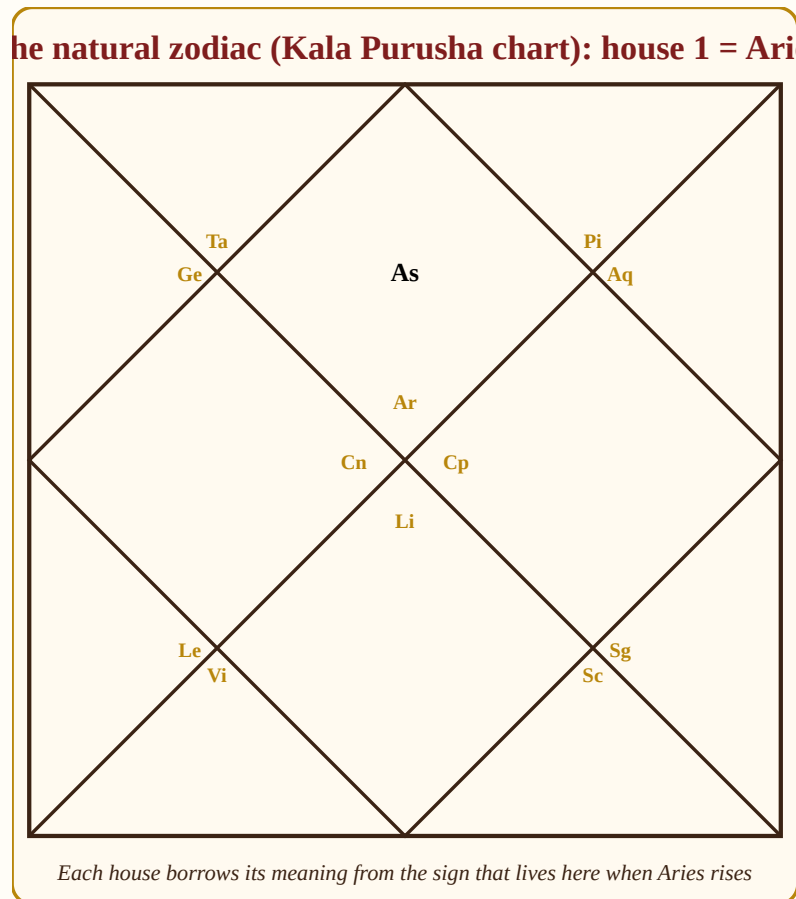


Figure 4.1: The natural zodiac. When Aries rises, house 1 is Aries, house 2 Taurus, and so on. Each house borrows its core meaning, and its body part, from the sign that sits here.

Walk it once and you will never need to memorise a house table again. The 1st is Aries, Mars's fire, the head, the charging self: **the body and the self**. The 2nd is Taurus, Venus's earth, the face and throat, food and possessions: **wealth, food, speech, family**. The 3rd is Gemini, Mercury's air, arms and shoulders, the couple: **communication, siblings, courage, short journeys**. The 4th is Cancer, the Moon's water, the chest and heart, the crab's shell: **mother, home, inner peace**. The 5th is Leo, the Sun's fire, the stomach, the lion's pride in his cubs: **children, creativity, intelligence**. The 6th is Virgo, Mercury's earth, the intestines, the maiden sorting grain: **work, health, service, enemies, debts**. The 7th is Libra, Venus's air, the scales: **partnership and marriage**. The 8th is Scorpio, Mars's water, the hidden organs, the scorpion under the stone: **death, transformation, secrets, inheritance**. The 9th is Sagittarius, Jupiter's fire, the thighs that carry us far, the archer aiming high: **fortune, faith, father, guru, long journeys**. The 10th is Capricorn, Saturn's earth, the knees that bend to duty, the climb: **career, status, authority**. The 11th is Aquarius, Saturn's air, the calves, the pot for the whole village: **gains, friends, networks, elder siblings**. The 12th is Pisces, Jupiter's water, the feet, the two fish in the ocean: **loss, sleep, foreign lands, hospitals, liberation**.

Every house meaning in the classical texts is an elaboration of this. When someone asks about something you have never seen in a table, "which house is my YouTube channel?", you do not panic: communication (3rd) that reaches a network (11th) as public work (10th). You *derive* it.

WHY? The natural zodiac is the first derivation. There is a second, purely from *the system's own logic*, and when both point the same way the ground is firm. Two counting rules do most of the work: the **12th from any house is its loss or ending**, and the ***n*th from the *n*th** repeats the theme (Bhavat Bhavam, below). Now derive: the **3rd** is the 12th from the 4th, leaving home, hence courage, siblings who leave with you, short journeys, effort. The **6th** is the 12th from the 7th, what partnership costs you, hence debts, disease (the body paying), service and competition. The **8th** is the 12th from the 9th, the loss of fortune, hence sudden events and transformation; it is also the 2nd from the 7th, the partner's wealth, hence inheritance and in-laws. The **11th** is the 6th from the 6th, the enemy of your enemies, hence gains and allies; it is also the 2nd from the 10th, the income of the career. The **12th** is the 12th from the 1st, the loss of the self, hence sleep, foreign lands, hospital beds and, at the far end, liberation. Everyday parallel: a joint-family ledger where every room's bill is paid by the room before it, the bridal room's expenses show up in the store-room's accounts.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: House meaning = natural sign + its lord + its body part. If you forget what the 8th means, remember Scorpio, Mars, and the organs we keep hidden. The rest follows.

Benefics and malefics in the rooms

Before the tour, one rule you will apply in every room. Natural benefics (Jupiter, Venus, bright Moon, unafflicted Mercury) do their best work in the **kendras** (1, 4, 7, 10) and **trikonas** (1, 5, 9), the pillars and the blessing houses, where their gentleness builds. Natural malefics (Saturn, Mars, Sun, Rahu, Ketu) do their best work in the **upachaya** houses (3, 6, 10, 11), the "growing" houses where struggle is the point and toughness pays.

The reasoning is *the system's own logic*: a benefic *gives*, so put it where you want giving, self, home, marriage, career, children, fortune. A malefic *fight*s, so put it where there is something to fight, rivals (3), enemies and disease (6), the competitive world of work (10), the effort to gain (11). A malefic in a gentle house (say Mars in the 4th, the mother's room) fights where there is nothing to fight and breaks the furniture; a benefic in a fighting house (Jupiter in the 6th) is too polite to argue with the enemy and gives away the case. We will refine this by Lagna in Chapter 8. For now, it is a sound first instinct.

The tour: twelve rooms

I give each room its meanings, body part and natural significator (*karaka*, the planet that stands for that house in every chart: Appendix A.5), the *why*, what a benefic and a malefic do there, and an example from our case charts.

1st house: Tanu, the body

Self, body, appearance, health, temperament, the start of life, general fame. Body: the head. Karaka: the Sun.

Why: it is Aries, the head, the first breath. The 1st house is the front door through which every other house is entered; a strong 1st carries a weak chart, a weak 1st spoils a strong one. The Sun is its karaka because the Sun is the self.

A benefic here gives an attractive, healthy body and a pleasant disposition. A malefic gives a strong, marked body and a forceful temperament, often scars or a distinctive feature, and intensifies whatever the planet stands for. Sun and Mercury in Meera's 1st: intelligence and authority on the face; a person you notice and remember.

2nd house: Dhana, wealth

Wealth and savings, speech, food and what we take in through the mouth, the family we are born into, the face, early education, the right eye. Body: the face and mouth. Karaka: Jupiter.

Why: Taurus, Venus's earth, the throat, accumulation. Everything we *gather and hold*, money, food, words, kin. Jupiter is karaka because Jupiter is expansion and provision.

A benefic here gives a sweet voice, a well-fed family and money that stays. A malefic makes speech blunt, spending abrupt or earning laborious, but a Saturn here often gives wealth through long patience. Meera's Saturn in the 2nd (Sagittarius): measured, careful speech; savings that grow slowly; a family that values duty and learning.

3rd house: Sahaja, siblings and courage

Younger siblings, courage, effort, communication and writing, short journeys, hobbies, the arms and hands, hearing. Body: arms, ears. Karaka: Mars.

Why: Gemini, two people side by side (siblings), Mercury's talk, the arms that do and the courage to use them. Mars is karaka because courage is Mars.

Malefics here are welcome: they give the fighting spirit and the willingness to do hard work. A benefic makes one gentle with siblings and gifted in writing, but sometimes short of push. Devika (Chart C) has Mars and Venus in the 3rd: enormous energy and charm poured into communication and siblings; she can argue and console in the same breath.

4th house: Sukha, happiness and home

Mother, home and land, vehicles, comforts, formal schooling, the heart, inner peace. Body: the chest. Karakas: the Moon and Mercury.

Why: Cancer, the Moon's water, the chest and heart, the crab's shell that is its home. The 4th is the bottom of the chart, underfoot, the roots. The Moon stands for the mother; Mercury, in the old lists, for education.

A benefic here gives a happy childhood home, property, vehicles and a peaceful heart: Venus in the 4th is a house full of music. A malefic disturbs the peace: moves, a strict or absent mother, restlessness at home. Meera's Rahu in the 4th (Aquarius): an unconventional home, possibly far from her birthplace; a mother who is unusual; a pull towards foreign or technological ways of living. Arjun's Rahu in the 4th (Libra) shows the same restless roots, expressed through relationships and aesthetics.

5th house: Putra, children and intelligence

Children, intelligence and judgement, creativity, past-life merit (*Poorva Punya*), romance, mantra and devotion, speculation and gambling. Body: the stomach, upper belly. Karaka: Jupiter.

Why: Leo, the Sun's pride in what it creates. The 5th is the fruit of the 1st: what comes out of you, a child, a poem, a decision. Jupiter is karaka because Jupiter gives children and wisdom.

A benefic here is wonderful: bright children, a fine mind, luck in the stock market and in love. A malefic strains one of these, delayed children, a sharp but harsh intelligence, gambling that hurts. Arjun's Jupiter in the 5th (Scorpio): deep, investigative intelligence; children who matter greatly; the past-life merit that shows as a knack for understanding hidden things. Meera's retrograde Mars in the 5th (Pisces): creative bursts, and a need to watch impulsive speculation.

6th house: Ari, enemies, disease and service

Enemies and competitors, disease, debts, service and employment, litigation, the maternal uncle, pets. Body: the intestines. Karakas: Mars and Saturn.

Why: Virgo: Mercury's earth, the intestines that digest and discard, the maiden who sorts good from bad. The 6th is where we deal with what is *wrong*: sickness, debt, opposition, and the daily labour that fixes them. Mars fights the enemy; Saturn does the

labour.

Malefics here are at their best: they defeat enemies, resist disease and pay off debts. A benefic here is too kind to fight; Jupiter in the 6th is generous to rivals and lends money it does not get back, though it protects health. None of our three case charts has a planet in the 6th, which happens often, and teaches a rule: **an empty house is read through its lord**. Meera's 6th is Aries, lord Mars, sitting retrograde in her 5th: her competition and health matters are handled through creativity and children's affairs, with internal rather than open struggle.

7th house: Kalatra, spouse and partnership

Spouse and marriage, business partners, sexual life, travel, the public and how we deal with the other. Body: the lower belly and pelvis. Karaka: Venus.

Why: Libra, the scales, Venus's air, the balancing of two. The 7th is directly opposite the 1st: the *other* who completes the self. Venus is love and marriage.

A benefic here gives a gracious partner and good partnerships; a malefic gives a partner who is demanding, or delay and friction in marriage, though Saturn in the 7th often gives a loyal, long-lasting bond once it forms. Meera's retrograde Jupiter in the 7th (Taurus): a learned, principled partner whose wisdom is private; marriage that matures with time. Arjun's Venus in the 7th (Capricorn), in its own house by karaka, a spouse who is loyal, practical and slow to declare.

8th house: Randhra, longevity and transformation

Longevity and death, transformation, inheritance and insurance, hidden things and the occult, chronic disease, sudden events, in-laws. Body: the genitals and excretory organs. Karaka: Saturn.

Why: Scorpio, Mars's water, the organs kept hidden, the scorpion under the stone. The 8th is the *end* of the 7th's partnership (the 2nd from the 7th, the partner's money, hence inheritance and in-laws) and the deep well of what is not spoken about. Saturn is karaka because Saturn is time and endings.

A benefic here softens crises and can give inherited wealth; but the benefic itself is muffled. Malefics here are mixed, they toughen a person and give research ability, but bring sudden events. Arjun has Sun, Mercury and Saturn in the 8th (Aquarius): a life turned towards hidden systems, research, insurance, the occult, forensic work, with a father (Sun) whose life had upheavals, and a mind (Mercury) that enjoys mysteries.

9th house: Dharma, fortune and faith

Fortune and grace, the father, the guru, religion and philosophy, higher learning, long journeys, law. Body: thighs and hips. Karakas: Jupiter and the Sun.

Why: Sagittarius: Jupiter's fire, the archer aiming far, the thighs that carry a pilgrim. The 9th is the highest of the trikonas: what we are *given* by grace rather than earned by work. Jupiter is wisdom; the Sun is the father.

Any benefic here is a blessing; the Moon in the 9th gives a mind at peace with the divine and a supportive father figure. A malefic here can make one argue with tradition: Saturn in the 9th is the sceptic who becomes devout late. Meera's Moon in the 9th (Cancer, own sign): faith held emotionally, teachers who feel like family, fortune that flows through learning and travel. Devika's Moon in the 9th (Sagittarius) is similar in a more philosophical costume.

10th house: Karma, career

Career and profession, status and reputation, authority, government, fame earned by work; the father in some schools. Body: the knees. Karakas: the Sun, Mercury, Jupiter and Saturn.

Why: Capricorn: Saturn's earth, the mountain climbed step by step, the knees that bend to duty. The 10th is the top of the chart, the Sun at noon: the most visible point, what the world sees you *do*. Four karakas because career has four faces: authority (Sun), skill (Mercury), wisdom (Jupiter) and labour (Saturn).

Both benefics and malefics can shine here: a benefic gives a respected, comfortable career; a malefic gives a hard-working, powerful one. Rahu in the 10th is the outsider who reaches the top; Ketu in the 10th, as in both Meera's and Arjun's charts (Leo and Aries respectively), is the person who does excellent work and steadily cares less about the title, consultants, researchers, healers.

11th house: Labha, gains

Gains and income, elder siblings, friends and networks, the fulfilment of wishes. Body: calves and shins. Karaka: Jupiter.

Why: Aquarius, Saturn's air, the water-pot for the whole community. The 11th is the 2nd from the 10th, the *income* of the career, and the house of all that comes to us from the group. Jupiter is karaka because Jupiter gives.

Everybody's favourite house: even malefics give gains here, because the 11th is upachaya. Saturn in the 11th gives income late but large; Mars gives gains through effort. Arjun's Moon in the 11th (Taurus, the Moon's exaltation sign): a mind that is popular and well networked, gains through friends and elder siblings, and an emotional life that is comfortable and steady.

12th house: Vyaya, loss and liberation

Expenses and losses, sleep and the pleasures of the bed, foreign lands, hospitals and confinement, isolation, and *moksha*, liberation. Body: the feet. Karaka: Saturn.

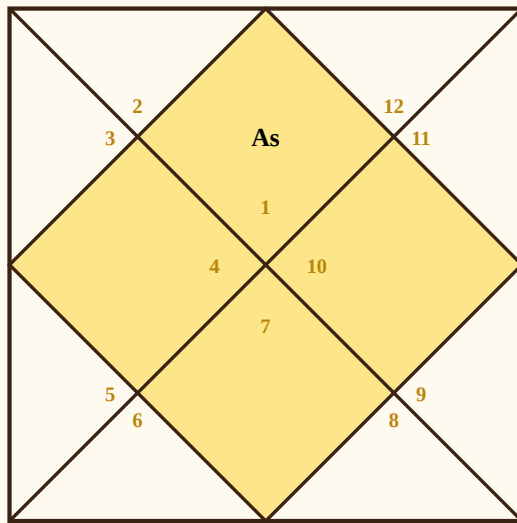
Why: Pisces: Jupiter's water, the feet that carry us away, the ocean where the self dissolves. The 12th is the 12th from the 1st: the *loss* of the self, in every sense from expenses to enlightenment. Saturn is karaka because Saturn is isolation and letting go.

A benefic here gives comfortable spending, good sleep, pleasant foreign stays and a spiritual bent; the benefic's own affairs, however, go somewhat "abroad" or behind closed doors. A malefic here can mean hospital stays, losses, or a hard road to inner peace, though Ketu in the 12th is classically excellent for moksha. Meera's Venus in the 12th (Libra, own sign): private pleasures, money spent on comfort and beauty, a partner or partnership linked to foreign lands; a natural taste for solitude.

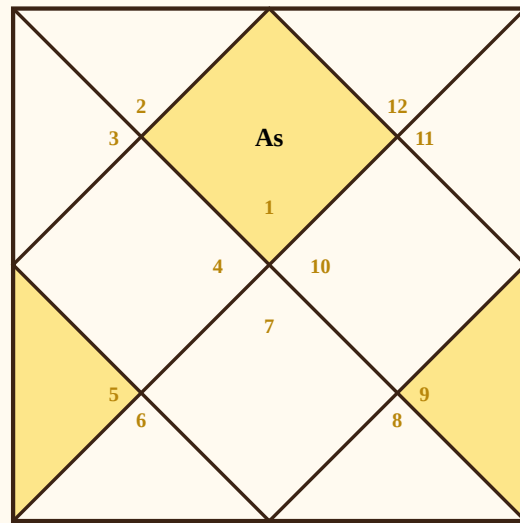
The house groups

Astrologers rarely think of houses one at a time; they think in groups, and the groups are where most of the reasoning happens.

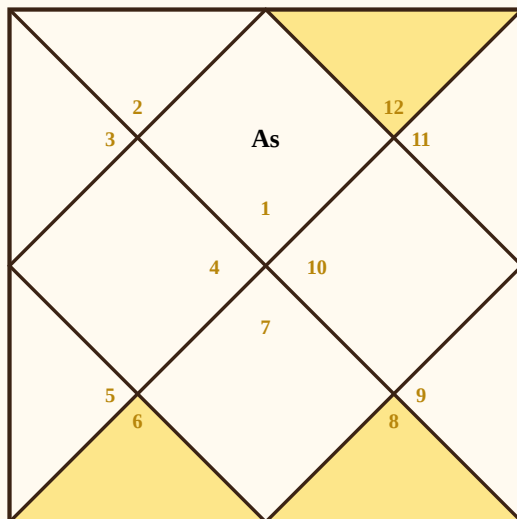
House groups every astrologer memorises



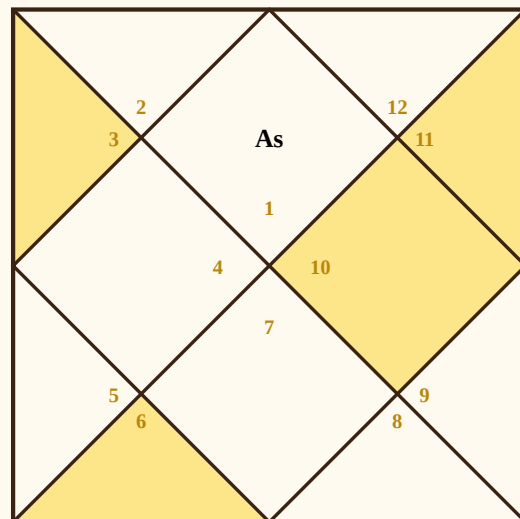
Kendra (1,4,7,10): pillars



Trikona (1,5,9): Lakshmi's houses



Dusthana (6,8,12): the difficult trio



Upachaya (3,6,10,11): growth with time

Figure 4.2: The four groups every astrologer memorises. Kendras are the pillars; trikonas the blessings; dusthanas the struggles; upachayas the houses that improve with effort.

Group	Houses	Colour	Sense
Kendra	1, 4, 7, 10	●	pillars; planets act strongly
Trikona	1, 5, 9	●	blessings; lords always benefic
Upachaya	3, 6, 10, 11	■	grow with effort; malefics do well
Panapara	2, 5, 8, 11	■	medium strength
Apoklima	3, 6, 9, 12	■	weaker (except the 9th)
Dusthana / Trik	6, 8, 12	○	struggle, hidden, loss
Maraka	2, 7	○ in their periods	health and life-span are "spent" here
Trishadaya	3, 6, 11	○ lords	lords give results with a sting

Kendras (1, 4, 7, 10), the pillars. The four corners of the diamond: self, home, partner, career. Called Vishnu's houses; planets here act *strongly*, whatever their nature. A chart with several planets in kendras belongs to a person who is visible and effective in the world.

WHY? Why are the kendras strong? *Astronomy:* the 1st, 10th, 7th and 4th are the four turning points of the Sun's daily path, rising, overhead, setting, underfoot. A planet in a kendra stands at one of the sky's corners, where its light is most emphatic and its effects most visible. *Classical:* Parashara names them Vishnu's houses, the sustainer's. Everyday parallel: the four poles of a wedding shamiana, take one away and the whole tent sags; whatever hangs from a pole is what every guest sees.

Trikonas (1, 5, 9), the blessings. Lakshmi's houses: the self, its merit, its fortune. Lords of these houses are always functional benefics (Chapter 8). Planets here give grace.

Dusthanas or Trik (6, 8, 12), the struggles. Disease and enemies, death and secrets, loss and exile. Planets here have their matters troubled; lords of these houses become functional troublemakers. But remember: the 6th is also service, the 8th also research, the 12th also liberation. Nothing in a chart is only bad.

STORY: STORE-ROOM, BACK STAIRS AND GUEST-HOUSE. Why are 6, 8 and 12 the difficult rooms? Because they are the three rooms of the haveli where the family does not receive guests. The **store-room** (6th) is where the servants labour, the account of debts is kept, and a sick child is nursed away from the others, work, debt, illness, service. The **back stairs** (8th) are dark, steep and used at night: this is where the locked chest of inheritance sits, where the secrets are whispered, where someone once fell. The **guest-house across the lane** (12th) is where you go when you leave the family, to sleep, to travel, to a hospital bed, or, if you are a sadhu, to freedom. Nothing is wrong with these rooms; they simply are not where the family's daily happiness lives. A gentle planet placed there is out of sight; a tough planet placed there gets useful work done. **Rule:** 6, 8 and 12 are dusthanas, struggle, hidden things, loss; their lords are functional troublemakers, and malefics there do useful work.

WHY? Why exactly 6, 8 and 12? Logic of the system: they are the three "loss" houses, the 12th from the 7th (partnership), from the 9th (fortune) and from the 1st (the self), and none of them is a kendra or a trikona, so nothing structural holds them up. Everything else in the chart has a pillar or a blessing beneath it; these three have only what the person brings. Everyday parallel: in any house there are three rooms guests are never shown, the store-room, the back stairs, the outhouse, not because they are shameful, but because the family's daily happiness does not live there.

Upachayas (3, 6, 10, 11), the growing houses. These improve with time and effort; malefics here toughen and deliver. Notice that the 6th is both dusthana and upachaya, struggle *and* growth through struggle, which is exactly what illness, debt and hard work are.

WHY? Why should these four "grow"? The name is *classical*, Parashara and Varahamihira both call 3, 6, 10 and 11 *upachaya*, "increase", and the reasoning is the *tradition's*: they are the houses of effort. The 3rd is your own arms, the 6th is daily labour and competition, the 10th is work, the 11th is what the work brings in. Effort compounds; what you push at improves. That is also why malefics do well here, a soldier is useful on the frontier, not in the bedroom. Put Mars in the 6th and he fights your illness and your rivals; put him in the 4th and he fights your mother. Everyday parallel: exam preparation. The first month is misery; by the third the marks climb, the struggle is the growth, and the strict tutor you resented is the one you thank.

Panapara (2, 5, 8, 11) and Apoklima (3, 6, 9, 12). Each kendra is followed by a panapara ("succeeding") house of medium strength, the wealth that follows the self, the child that follows the home, and then an apoklima ("falling away") house, weaker, except the 9th, which is saved by being a trikona. The classical texts use these to grade a planet's strength by position; you will meet them in Shadbala.

Trishadaya (3, 6, 11). Parashara says the lords of these three become malefic. Why? They are the houses where we push *against* others, rivals and siblings, enemies, the competition for gains. Their lords serve the self at others' expense, and so give results with a sting.

Marakas (2 and 7), the "killers". This one frightens beginners, so let me give you the logic and take the fear out. The 8th house is longevity (*Ayu*). The 8th from the 8th is the 3rd, so the 3rd is *also* a longevity house (Bhavat Bhavam, below). Now, the 12th house from any house is its loss or ending. The 12th from the 3rd is the 2nd; the 12th from the 8th is the 7th. So the 2nd and 7th are the houses where *longevity is spent*. Their lords, and planets in them, are the ones whose periods can bring the end of life, or, far more often, illness, or the end of a phase. That is all "maraka" means. You will use it in Chapter 20 with great care, and never as a threat. This is a *logical derivation* from the system's own grammar, not a decree.

STORY: THE TWO DOORS OUT OF THE LIFE-ROOMS. *The 8th room, the back stairs, is where the family's life-span is kept, the old texts call the 8th Ayu, longevity. Count eight rooms on from the back stairs and you reach the 3rd, the courtyard: the 8th from the 8th, its twin, and so also a life-room. Now, in this haveli, every room's exit door is the room just before it, the 12th from it. The exit from the courtyard (3rd) is the kitchen (2nd); the exit from the back stairs (8th) is the bridal room (7th). Those two exits are where life-span leaks out, and so the 2nd and 7th are called maraka, the killers. In practice their lords' periods far more often bring illness or the end of a phase than the end of a life. Rule: Marakas are 2 and 7 because they are the 12th houses from the two longevity houses, 3 and 8.*

The four aims. The twelve houses also split into four triangles matching the four aims of a Hindu life. The fire houses (1, 5, 9) are the **dharma trikona**, purpose, merit, faith. The earth houses (2, 6, 10) are the **artha trikona**, wealth, work, career: the means. The air houses (3, 7, 11) are the **kama trikona**, desire, relationship, gain. The water houses (4, 8, 12) are the **moksha trikona**, home, transformation, release: the inner life and its letting-go.

The four aims of life: four triangles hidden in the chart

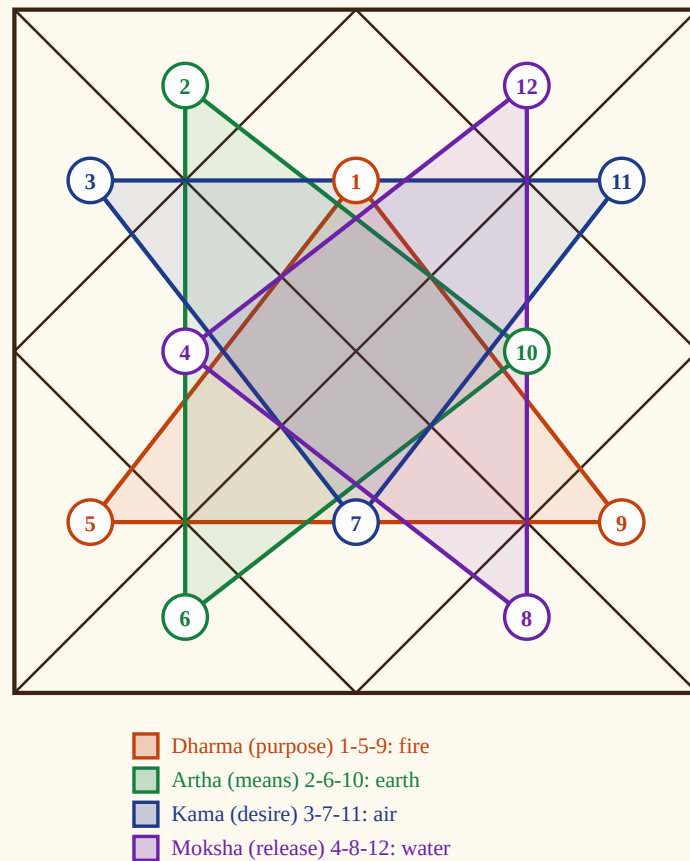


Figure 4.3: The four aims hidden in the chart. Count which triangle holds most of a client's planets and you have their life's centre of gravity in one glance.

STORY: THE FOUR WINGS OF THE HAVELI. Seen from the roof, the haveli has four wings, and each wing serves one of the four aims of a Hindu life. The **prayer wing** (dharma: 1, 5, 9) runs from the front veranda through the children's study to the grandfather's prayer room, who you are, what you create, what you believe. The **working wing** (artha: 2, 6, 10) holds the kitchen-purse, the store-room and the roof office, money, labour, career. The **meeting wing** (kama: 3, 7, 11) holds the courtyard, the bridal room and the guest hall, siblings, spouse, friends: every room where you meet another person. The **inner wing** (moksha: 4, 8, 12) holds the mother's room, the back stairs and the guest-house across the lane, roots, transformation, and leaving. Count where a client's planets sleep, and you know which wing the life is lived in. **Rule:** Dharma 1-5-9 (fire), artha 2-6-10 (earth), kama 3-7-11 (air), moksha 4-8-12 (water).

Try it on Chart B. Arjun's planets: Mars 2nd, Rahu 4th, Jupiter 5th, Venus 7th, Sun-Mercury-Saturn 8th, Ketu 10th, Moon 11th. Moksha triangle: four planets (Rahu in the 4th; Sun, Mercury, Saturn in the 8th). Artha: two (Mars in the 2nd, Ketu in the 10th). Kama: two (Venus in the 7th, Moon in the 11th). Dharma: one (Jupiter in the 5th). A life weighted towards the inner, the hidden and the transformative, which is exactly what the three planets in the 8th told us.

Bhavat Bhavam: the house from the house

A second signal for any matter is found by counting the *same number* again. The *n*th house from the *n*th house, **Bhavat Bhavam**, "the house of the house", shows the same matter from a second angle.

Three examples you will use constantly. *Career*: the 10th from the 10th is the 7th. So the 7th house, partnerships, the public, is a second career house; a strong 7th lord often shows business success or a career dealing with the public. *Mother*: the 4th from the 4th is the 7th again. A 7th-house affliction can therefore also point to the mother's wellbeing, especially when the 4th itself is ambiguous. *Children*: the 5th from the 5th is the 9th. Grandchildren, and the fortune that comes through children, live in the 9th; a fine 9th can rescue a troubled 5th in matters of progeny. And one more for free: the 8th from the 8th is the 3rd, which is why the 3rd is a longevity house and why 2 and 7 are marakas.

The mirror pairs: six axes

Opposite houses are not enemies; they are two ends of one axis, and every axis is a conversation.

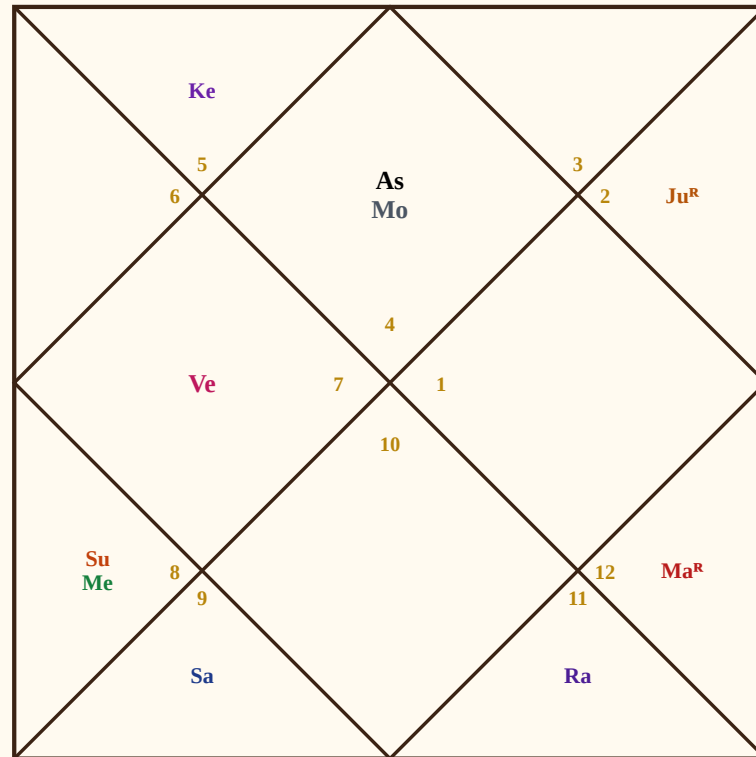
1 and 7, self and other. Who I am, and who I meet. Planets on this axis shape identity through relationship. **2 and 8, my resources and others' resources.** My money, speech and family; the partner's money, inheritance, what is hidden. **3 and 9, effort and grace.** What I achieve by my own arms, and what is given by the guru, the father, the gods; short journeys and long ones; younger siblings and elders. **4 and 10, home and world.** Mother and father, private and public, roots and summit. **5 and 11, creation and reward.** What I make (children, ideas) and what returns to me (gains, friends). **6 and 12, the daily struggle and the final release.** Illness and hospital, service and retreat, the enemy in front and the enemy unseen.

When a planet aspects across the chart (Chapter 6), it always joins the two ends of an axis. Meera's Jupiter in the 7th looks straight at her 1st: her partner's wisdom shapes her own identity. Arjun's Venus in the 7th looks at his 1st: he is drawn to be defined by relationship.

A second frame: reading from the Moon

The Lagna is the primary frame. But the Moon is the mind, and the mind is where a person *lives*. So Jyotish reads the whole chart a second time with the Moon's sign as the 1st house, the **Chandra Lagna**. Every dasha result, every transit (Sade Sati is counted from the Moon, not the Lagna), and every yoga involving the Moon uses this frame.

Chart A counted from the Moon (Chandra Lagna = Cancer)



Same planets, same signs; only the counting starts from the Moon's sign

Figure 4.4: Chart A counted from the Moon. Nothing has moved in the sky; only the counting starts from Cancer. Sun and Mercury are now in the 5th, Saturn in the 6th, Jupiter in the 11th.

Look what changes for Meera. From the Lagna, her Saturn is in the 2nd, speech and money. From the Moon, Saturn is in the 6th, an upachaya, where a malefic does well: she wins against competitors and works through illness with discipline. Her Sun and Mercury, 1st from the Lagna, are 5th from the Moon: her intelligence and authority also express as creativity, teaching and a gifted child. Her Jupiter, 7th from the Lagna, is 11th from the Moon: the partner brings gains and friends. When the two frames agree, speak with confidence. When they disagree, the client shows both, the Lagna frame in how they act, the Moon frame in how they feel.

There is a third frame, less used but useful for matters of the father, health and career: counting from the Sun (**Surya Lagna**). In Chart A the Sun sits in the Lagna sign, so the first and third frames coincide, one reason Meera's chart reads so consistently. In Chart B the Sun is in the 8th, so from the Sun, Arjun's Lagna sign Cancer becomes the 6th house: his very self, seen from the father's or the body's viewpoint, is a matter of service and struggle, a young man who had to prove himself.

CONSULTATION TIP: A client will often say, "But my friend's astrologer said my Saturn is in the 6th, and you say 2nd!"

Both may be right, one counted from the Moon. Explain the two frames in one sentence and you turn a moment of doubt into a moment of trust.

Reading Chart A and Chart B by houses

Let us put the whole chapter on the table. The picture below shows Meera's chart with the kendras shaded.

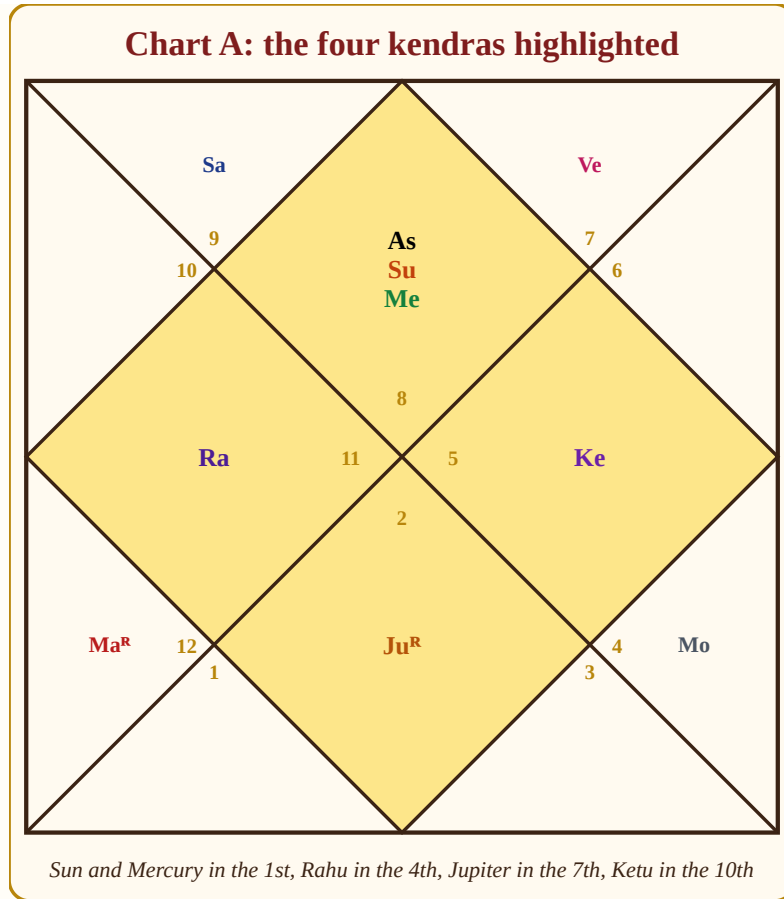


Figure 4.5: Chart A's pillars. Sun and Mercury in the 1st, Rahu in the 4th, Jupiter in the 7th, Ketu in the 10th, every kendra is occupied.

Meera has a planet in every kendra: the self is strong (Sun, Mercury), the home unconventional (Rahu), the partner wise (Jupiter), the career detached (Ketu). Her trikonas are well held: the 5th with Mars, the 9th with the Moon in own sign. Her only dusthana planet is Venus in the 12th, comfortable in its own sign. Read whole: a visible, articulate person anchored in faith, with a marriage that matures and a career leaning towards teaching rather than titles. Benefic Jupiter in a kendra, benefic Moon in a trikona, malefic Saturn in a money house, the pattern is mostly followed, which is why the chart reads as steady.

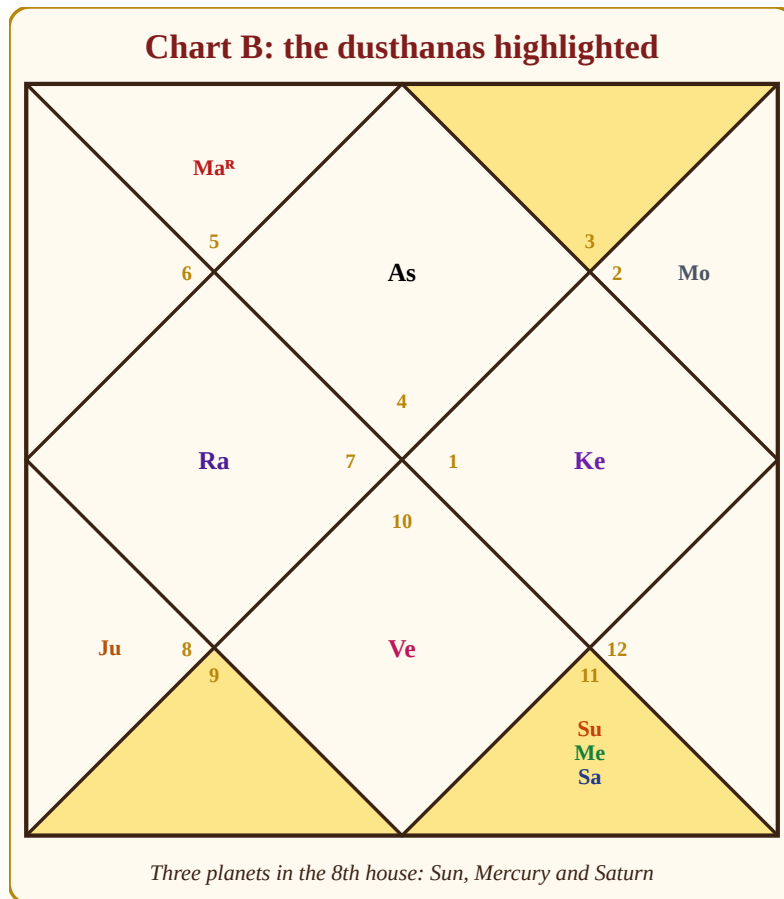


Figure 4.6: Chart B's difficult houses. Three planets crowd the 8th; the 6th and 12th are empty.

Arjun's chart concentrates in the 8th: Sun, Mercury, Saturn. Three planets in one dusthana is not a tragedy; it is a *specialisation*. The 8th is research, insurance, inheritance, the occult, hidden systems, and Saturn, the karaka of the 8th, is in its own sign there. His kendras hold Rahu (4th), Venus (7th) and Ketu (10th): a restless home, a loyal spouse, a career that dissolves ego. His trikonas: Jupiter in the 5th, the great benefic exactly where it gives most. His 11th holds the exalted Moon: gains, friends, a popular temperament. Read whole: a young man who works with what is hidden, finds his footing through partnership, and gains through people.

In one breath

- A house is *where* a planet's energy lands in life. Whole-sign houses: the Lagna sign is the 1st house; check Bhava Chalit only for planets near a boundary.
- House meanings derive from the natural zodiac: house n = sign n of the Kala Purusha, with its lord and body part. Derive; do not memorise.
- Benefics do best in kendras and trikonas; malefics do best in upachayas (3, 6, 10, 11).
- Kendras are pillars, trikonas blessings, dusthanas struggles, upachayas growth; 3, 6, 11 lords sting; 2 and 7 are marakas because they are the 12th from the two longevity houses (3 and 8).
- The four aims, dharma 1-5-9, artha 2-6-10, kama 3-7-11, moksha 4-8-12, show where a life's weight lies.
- Bhavat Bhavam: the nth from the nth gives a second signal (10th from 10th = 7th for career; 4th from 4th = 7th for mother; 5th from 5th = 9th for children).
- Opposite houses are axes: self/other, mine/theirs, effort/grace, home/world, creation/reward, struggle/release.
- Read every chart from the Lagna, then from the Moon (Chandra Lagna), and for father and health also from the Sun.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. Without a table, derive the meanings of the 11th house from its natural sign, lord and body part. Then name its karaka.
2. Devika (Chart C) has Sun and Jupiter in the 4th (Cancer) and Saturn, Rahu and Mercury in the 5th (Leo). Which planets sit in kendras? Which in trikonas? Which house group is the 5th, and does a malefic there follow the "benefics in kendra/trikona, malefics in upachaya" preference?
3. Explain in two sentences why the 7th house is called a maraka, using the 12th-from logic.
4. Count Chart B from the Moon (Taurus). In which house from the Moon does Jupiter fall? Is it a kendra from the Moon (which would form Gaja Kesari yoga, Appendix A.11)?
5. Use Bhavat Bhavam to name a second house for (a) the father (9th), (b) elder siblings (11th), (c) enemies (6th).

Answers

1. The 11th is Aquarius: Saturn's air, the calves, the water-pot for the community. So: gains that come from the group, income, friends, networks, elder siblings, the fulfilment of wishes; Saturn's touch means gains grow with time. Karaka: Jupiter. 2. Kendras: Sun and Jupiter (4th). Trikonas: Saturn, Rahu and Mercury (5th), and, though the question did not ask, her Moon in the 9th is also in a trikona. The 5th is a trikona and a panapara house, not an upachaya. So the malefics Saturn and Rahu there go against the preference: children and education are areas of struggle first and success later (the chart's stated theme), while Mercury, with malefics, takes on their nature. 3. The 8th house rules longevity, and the 3rd is the 8th from the 8th, so both are longevity houses. The 12th from any house is its loss; the 12th from the 8th is the 7th, so the 7th is where longevity is "spent", a maraka. 4. Taurus as 1st: Gemini 2, Cancer 3, Leo 4, Virgo 5, Libra 6, Scorpio 7. Jupiter in Scorpio is 7th from the Moon, a kendra, so Gaja Kesari yoga is formed. 5. (a) 9th from 9th = 5th. (b) 11th from 11th = 9th. (c) 6th from 6th = 11th.

Chapter 5: Reading Your First Chart: Layout, Lagna, and the Twelve Ascendants

You now know the actors, the costumes and the rooms. This chapter puts you in front of an actual chart and teaches you what to do with your eyes and hands in the first ten minutes. Then it introduces the twelve rising signs one by one, because the Lagna is the single most important fact in any chart, and anyone who knows the twelve Lagnas well can say something true and useful to a person within a minute of sitting down.

Reading a North Indian chart, step by step

The North Indian chart is a square with a diamond inside it. **The houses never move.** The top diamond is always the 1st house. From there the houses run anti-clockwise: the top-left triangle is the 2nd, the left-hand triangle is the 3rd, the left diamond is the 4th, and so on round, ending with the top-right triangle as the 12th. **The signs rotate.** Each house has a small number in it; that is the *sign* sitting in that house for this particular chart.

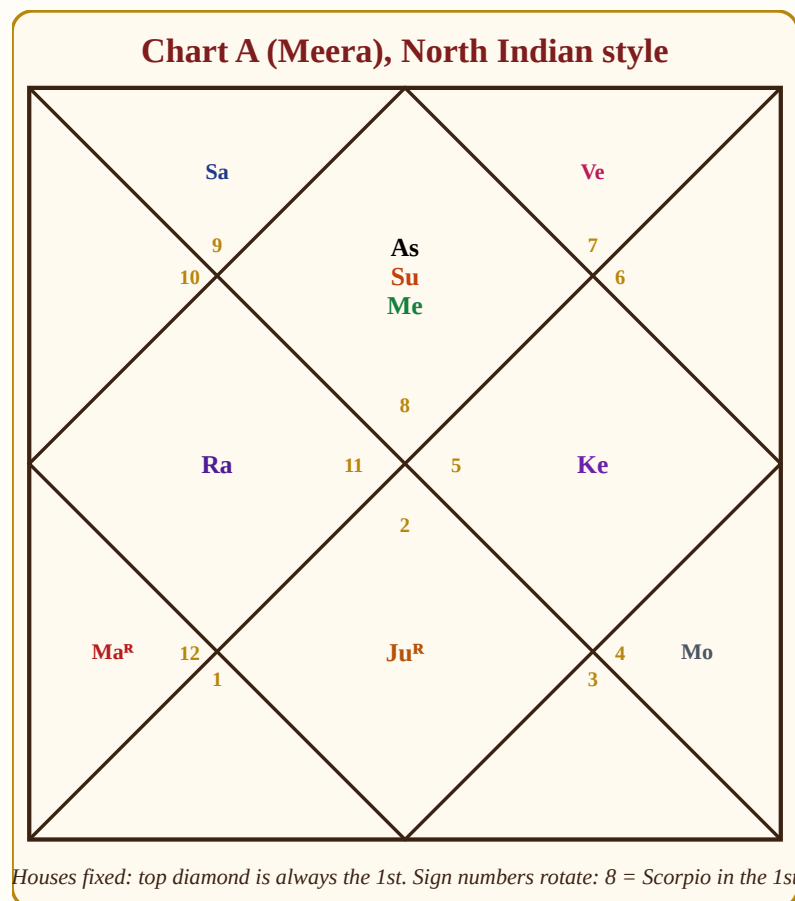


Figure 5.1: Chart A, North Indian style. The houses are fixed; the small gold numbers are sign numbers. 8 in the top diamond means Scorpio is the 1st house.

Here is how I read it, every time, in this order.

1. **Find the Lagna sign.** Look at the number in the top diamond. Chart A: 8, Scorpio. Say it aloud: "Scorpio rising."

2. **Check the sequence.** Going anti-clockwise, the numbers should run 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7. If they do not, the chart is drawn wrongly or you are reading clockwise. This one check saves you from half of all beginner errors.
3. **Name the four kendras.** Top (1st): Scorpio with Sun and Mercury. Left (4th): Aquarius with Rahu. Bottom (7th): Taurus with Jupiter. Right (10th): Leo with Ketu. You have just seen the pillars of the life.
4. **Name the two remaining trikonas.** Bottom-left triangle (5th): Pisces with Mars. Bottom-right triangle (9th): Cancer with the Moon.
5. **Name the dusthanas.** 6th (bottom-left, below the 5th): Aries, empty. 8th (bottom-right, below the 7th): Gemini, empty. 12th (top-right): Libra with Venus.
6. **Note what is left.** 2nd: Sagittarius with Saturn. 3rd and 11th: empty.

Six steps, sixty seconds, and you have the whole chart in your head.

Reading a South Indian chart, step by step

The South Indian chart is a grid of twelve boxes around an empty centre. **The signs never move.** Pisces is always the top-left box, Aries next to it, Taurus, Gemini across the top; then Cancer, Leo, Virgo down the right; Libra, Scorpio, Sagittarius across the bottom from right to left; Capricorn and Aquarius up the left side. Signs run clockwise. **The Lagna is marked**, usually a diagonal slash in one corner of a box, sometimes the letters "As" or "La".

Chart A (Meera), South Indian style			
Pi H5 Ma ^R	Ar H6	Ta H7 Ju ^R	Ge H8
Aq H4 Ra	Rasi Chart Lagna: Scorpio (signs fixed; slash marks Lagna)		Cn H9 Mo
Cp H3			Le H10 Ke
Sg H2 Sa	Sc H1 Su Me	Li H12 Ve	Vi H11

Signs fixed: Pisces always top-left, clockwise. Find the slash: Scorpio is the Lagna

Figure 5.2: The same chart, South Indian style. Signs fixed and running clockwise from Pisces at top-left. The slash in the Scorpio box marks the Lagna. Count clockwise from there for houses 2 to 12.

1. **Find the slash.** Chart A: it is in Scorpio, bottom row, second from the left. That box is the 1st house.
2. **Count clockwise for the houses.** Sagittarius (bottom-left) is the 2nd, Capricorn (left, lower) is the 3rd, Aquarius the 4th, Pisces the 5th, and so on round to Libra as the 12th.

3. **Locate the kendras**, they are always the box with the slash and the boxes three, six and nine steps clockwise. Here: Scorpio, Aquarius, Taurus, Leo. Same four signs you found in the diamond, naturally.
4. Proceed exactly as before: trikonas, dusthanas, the rest.

Now do both formats for Chart B, and notice how the same information looks in each.

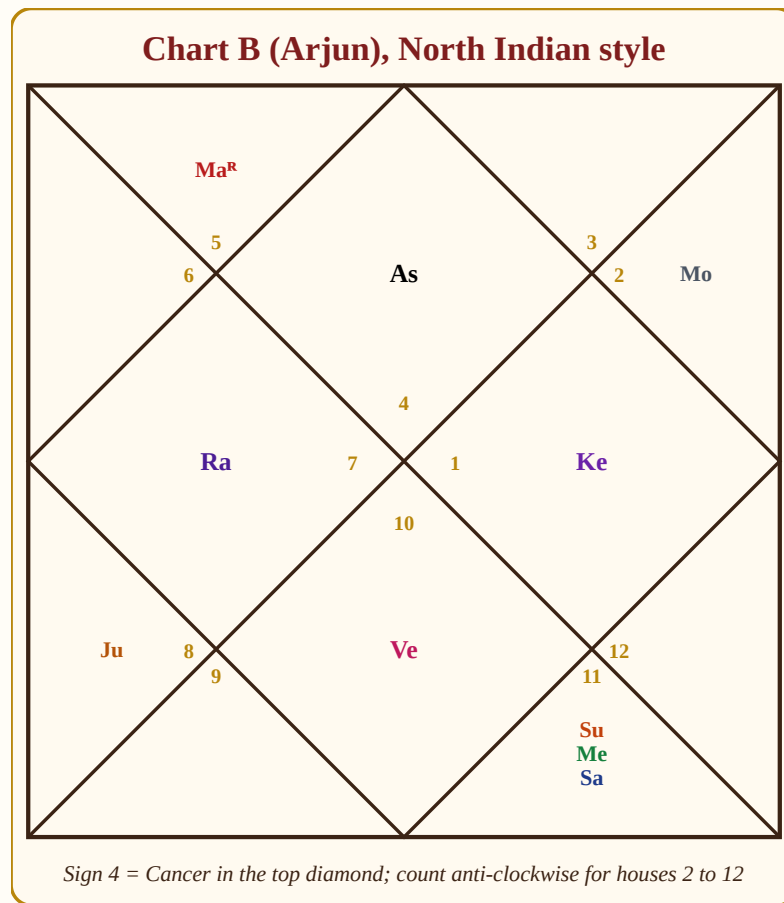


Figure 5.3: Chart B, North Indian. Sign 4 (Cancer) in the top diamond. Three planets crowd the 8th house at the bottom right.

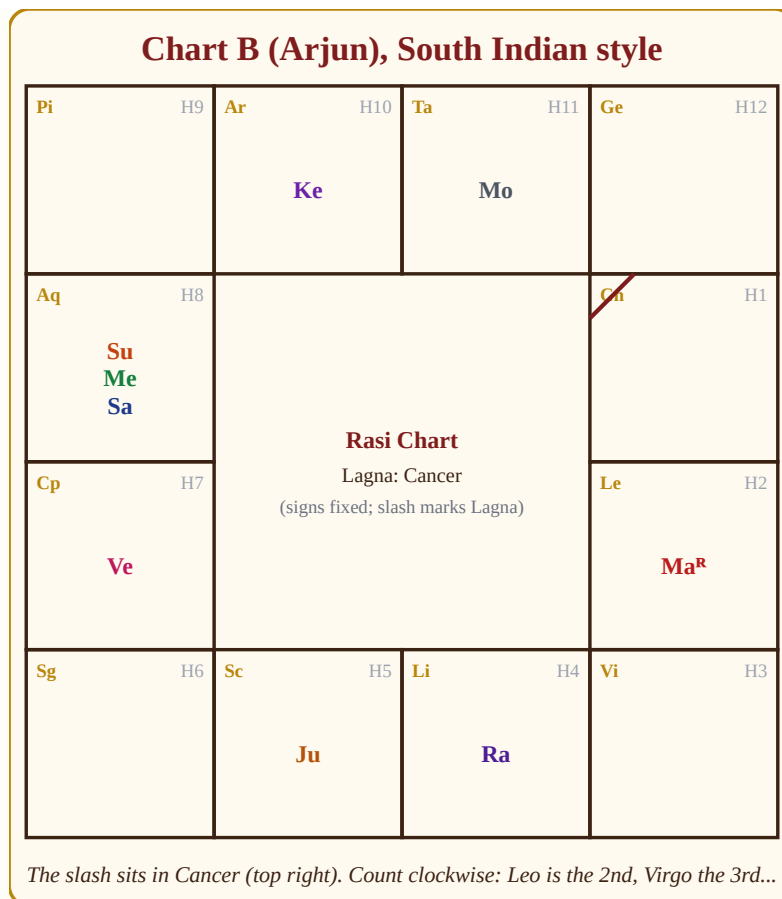


Figure 5.4: Chart B, South Indian. The slash sits in Cancer, top right. Aquarius (left column) holds Sun, Mercury and Saturn, count clockwise from Cancer and it is the 8th.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Counting the South Indian chart anti-clockwise because "the zodiac runs anti-clockwise". In the South Indian grid the signs and houses both run *clockwise*. In the North Indian diamond they run *anti-clockwise*. Keep a chart of each style in your notebook until the difference is automatic.

WHY? Why do the two styles fix different things? Because they answer two different questions. The North Indian diamond answers "what is in my 1st house, my 7th, my 10th?", so the houses stay put and the signs are written in as numbers. The South Indian grid answers "where is Aries, where is Scorpio?", so the signs stay put and you find your own 1st house by the slash. This is *design logic*, not doctrine: two maps of the same city, one centred on your journey and one showing the fixed network. Everyday parallel: the railway map on your phone that puts *you* at the centre, versus the printed network map on the station wall where the stations never move and you have to find yourself.

Finding the Lagna

In software. Enter date, time and place; set Lahiri ayanamsa and whole-sign houses; the program gives you the Lagna to the minute of arc. Check two things before trusting it: that the time zone is right (older Indian births are sometimes recorded in local mean time or in "railway time" that differs from IST), and that daylight-saving time, if the birth was abroad, has been handled.

Roughly, by hand. You can estimate a Lagna in your head, useful when a client says "I was born around dawn" or when checking whether a chart looks right. The principle is simple: at sunrise, the Sun is on the eastern horizon, so **at sunrise the Lagna is the Sun's sign, at roughly the Sun's degree**. From then on the eastern horizon sweeps through the zodiac, and a new sign rises roughly every two hours. Two hours after sunrise the Lagna is one sign ahead of the Sun; at midday it is about three

signs ahead (the Sun is overhead, the 10th house, as directional strength told us); at sunset the Lagna is six signs ahead (the Sun is setting in the 7th); at midnight, nine signs ahead.

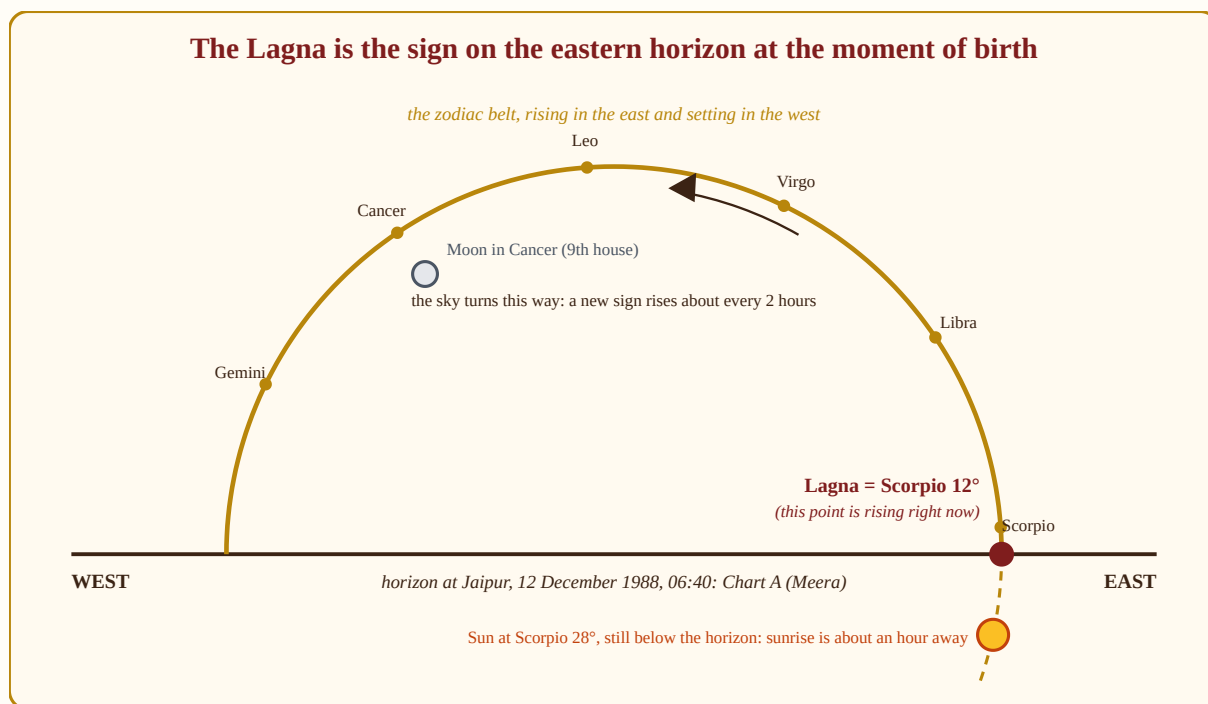


Figure 5.5: The Lagna is simply the point of the zodiac on the eastern horizon. Meera was born a little before sunrise, so her Lagna is in the Sun's sign, a few degrees behind the Sun.

WHY? Why a new sign roughly every two hours? *Astronomy:* the Earth turns 360° in 24 hours, 15° an hour, so the eastern horizon sweeps through a 30° sign in about two hours. The "roughly" is also astronomy: the zodiac is tilted to the Earth's equator, so some signs cross the horizon steeply and quickly and others lie flat and take longer, and the difference grows with latitude. Everyday parallel: a platform where a new train pulls in every two hours by the rotation of a fixed timetable, except that some trains are short and clear the platform fast, and some are long.

Meera is the perfect example. Born at 06:40 in Jaipur in mid-December, a little before sunrise, with the Sun at 28° Scorpio. Before sunrise the Sun is still below the horizon and the rising point is *behind* it, so the Lagna is Scorpio, an earlier degree. Her Lagna is Scorpio 12° . The rule holds.

Now the warning. "Two hours per sign" is an average. Because the zodiac is tilted to the Earth's equator, some signs rise quickly and some slowly, and the effect grows the further you are from the equator. For Indian latitudes (roughly 10° – 30° N) the pattern is:

Sign rising	Approximate time to rise (India)	Sign rising	Approximate time to rise (India)
Aries	1 h 40 min	Libra	2 h 10 min
Taurus	2 h 00 min	Scorpio	2 h 15 min
Gemini	2 h 10 min	Sagittarius	2 h 05 min
Cancer	2 h 15 min	Capricorn	1 h 50 min
Leo	2 h 10 min	Aquarius	1 h 35 min
Virgo	2 h 05 min	Pisces	1 h 35 min

Aquarius, Pisces and Aries hurry over the horizon in about an hour and a half; Cancer, Leo, Libra and Scorpio take well over two hours. In Delhi the spread is wider than in Chennai. So the hand method tells you the *likely* Lagna and its neighbours; it cannot tell you the degree, and near a sign boundary it cannot even be sure of the sign. **Use software for anything you will say to a client.** The hand method is for your own sanity checks and for those "around sunset" conversations.

DID YOU KNOW? The unequal rising times are why old Indian almanacs printed *Lagna tables* for each major city, Ujjain, Varanasi, Madras, giving the rising duration of each sign in *ghatis* (units of 24 minutes). Before software, an astrologer's accuracy depended on owning the right table for the right latitude.

Why the birth time matters so much

The Sun moves one degree a day; the Moon moves one degree in about two hours. But the Lagna moves one degree every *four minutes*. Get the time wrong by two hours and the entire chart re-shuffles: every planet moves to a different house, the lord of the chart changes, and the person you describe is someone else.

WHY? Why does the *time* matter more than the *date*? *Astronomy and logic together:* the date fixes the planets' signs, the Sun changes sign once a month, the Moon every 2¼ days, the rest more slowly, so two people born on the same day share almost all their planet-in-sign placements. The time fixes the Lagna, and the Lagna fixes which house every one of those planets falls in. Same actors in the same costumes; a different room for each. Everyday parallel: two weddings on the same date invite the same relatives, but seat them in different rooms, and the evening goes quite differently.

Even a smaller error matters. A planet near the end of a sign can move from the 9th house to the 10th with a twenty-minute change; a Moon at the edge of a nakshatra can shift the whole dasha sequence. This is why a careful astrologer asks not only "what time?" but "how do you know?", a hospital record is gold; "my mother says around evening" is a starting point for detective work.

That detective work is **birth-time rectification**, and the basics are within your reach by Chapter 13. The method: take the possible range of times; for each candidate Lagna, check whether the dasha periods line up with three or four dated events the client is sure of, a marriage, the birth of a child, a father's death, a major job change or move. Marriage tends to fall in periods of Venus, the 7th lord, or planets in the 7th; a child's birth in periods of Jupiter or the 5th lord; a parent's passing in periods connected with the 9th/4th lords or maraka planets. When one candidate explains all the events and the others do not, you have your time. Add the physical evidence, build, face, temperament, from the Lagna descriptions later in this chapter, and you are usually right.

CONSULTATION TIP: Never guess a Lagna silently and read as if it were certain. Say: "Your time is approximate, so there are two possible rising signs. Let me ask you three questions to decide." The client feels respected, and you avoid the humiliation of describing the wrong person.

The Lagna lord: the captain of the ship

The planet that owns the rising sign is the **Lagna lord** (*Lagnesha*). If the Lagna is the front door, the Lagna lord is the person who holds the key. Its strength is the person's strength; its placement shows *where the self goes to find itself*. > 📖 **Story: The captain at the door.** Every haveli has a captain, the person who actually runs the household, keys at the waist. When you visit, the first thing to learn is *where in the house the captain spends the day*. If she is always at the front door (1st), the household is about itself. If she lives in the kitchen (2nd), it is about food, money and talk. If she is forever in the mother's room (4th), home comes first; in the roof office (10th), work comes first; in the guest-house across the lane (12th), she is half gone already, abroad, in retreat, or in the hospital wing. The Lagna lord is that captain, and its house is where the self goes to find itself. **Rule:** Read the Lagna lord's house as the room where the person's identity is invested.

Here is what its house says, derived logically, the Lagna lord carries the 1st house (the self) into whichever room it sits in.

Lagna lord in	Ease	The self is invested in...
1st	●	Itself: a self-made, physically strong person; identity is the project.
2nd	◐	Family, wealth and speech: earns by own effort; a voice that defines them.
3rd	◐	Courage and communication: the self-made fighter, writer, sibling-bound.
4th	●	Home, mother, land, learning: happiest at home; property and peace matter.
5th	●	Intelligence and children: a creative identity; fortunate (a trikona).
6th	○	Struggle and service: a competitor; health needs care; thrives in service professions.
7th	●	The partner and the public: identity found through relationship; travel.
8th	○	The hidden and the transforming: obstacles early, depth later; research, occult.
9th	●	Fortune, father, guru: graced; travels far; a life carried by faith.
10th	●	Career: defined by work; visible; status-seeking and usually status-achieving.
11th	●	Gains and friends: well networked; wishes tend to be fulfilled.
12th	○	Foreign lands and the inner life: spends, travels, withdraws; a spiritual pull.

Chart A: Scorpio rises, so Mars is the captain, and Mars sits retrograde in the 5th house in Pisces. The self is invested in intelligence, creativity and children; a trikona placement, so fortunate; retrograde, so the drive turns inward before it turns outward. Chart B: Cancer rises, the Moon is captain, sitting exalted in the 11th in Taurus. The self is invested in gains and friendships, and the captain is in excellent shape, whatever else the chart says, this person has a steady mind and people who help him.

The twelve Lagnas

What follows is a page for each rising sign: body and temperament, the Lagna lord, which planets are friends and which are troublemakers for that Lagna (a one-line preview from Appendix A.6, the full logic is Chapter 8), typical strengths and struggles, career leanings, the stereotype, and how to speak to such a client. Read these as sketches of a *tendency*. The rest of the chart adds, softens or contradicts every line.

STORY: TWELVE HOSTS AT THE FRONT DOOR. Knock on twelve havelis and twelve hosts answer. **Aries** flings the door open before you have finished knocking. **Taurus** will not discuss anything until you have eaten. **Gemini** asks you three questions on the doorstep and answers two of them himself. **Cancer** asks after your mother, and means it. **Leo** receives you from his chair and you feel oddly honoured. **Virgo** notices your shoes and quietly moves the doormat. **Libra** asks whether you would prefer tea or coffee, and then asks again. **Scorpio** watches you through the half-open door for a moment before it swings wide. **Sagittarius** tells you about his last pilgrimage before you have sat down. **Capricorn** checks the clock, then gives you exactly the time he promised. **Aquarius** is already telling you about the neighbourhood committee. **Pisces** has made up a bed for you before you said you were staying. **Rule:** The Lagna is the host's manner at the door, the body, the temperament, the first impression; the Lagna lord tells you where in the house that host actually lives.

Aries Lagna (Mesha)

Body and temperament. Lean, energetic, quick-moving; a prominent forehead or a mark on the head; walks fast, talks first. Impatient, direct, brave, generous in a hurry, quick to anger and quick to forget it.

Lagna lord: Mars. ● **Friends for this Lagna:** Sun, Mars, Jupiter. ○ **Troublemakers:** Mercury, Venus, Saturn. ◐ **Neutral:** Moon.

Strengths and struggles. Initiative, courage, honesty that borders on bluntness. Struggles with patience, with finishing what was started, with listening. Health: head, fevers, accidents from haste.

Career leanings. Anything that rewards a fast start: the armed forces, sport, surgery, engineering, entrepreneurship, sales that need nerve.

The stereotype. The young officer who leads the charge and asks questions afterwards.

Talking to this client. Be direct; they respect it. Give them a plan with a first step they can take today. Do not lecture about patience, show them where waiting *wins*.

Taurus Lagna (Vrishabha)

Body and temperament. Solid, well-built, a strong neck, pleasant face and voice; moves unhurriedly. Loyal, sensual, practical, attached to comfort and to people; stubborn once decided.

Lagna lord: Venus. ● **Friends:** Saturn (the yogakaraka), Sun, Mercury. ○ **Troublemakers:** Moon, Jupiter, Mars. ◐ **Neutral:** Venus itself, since it also owns the 6th.

Strengths and struggles. Reliability, taste, financial sense, endurance. Struggles with change, possessiveness, and a temper that arrives late and stays. Health: throat, thyroid, weight.

Career leanings. Finance and banking, real estate, food and hospitality, music and the arts, agriculture, anything built slowly and held.

The stereotype. The family jeweller whose shop has stood on the same corner for three generations.

Talking to this client. Never rush them. Give concrete numbers and dates. Frame every change as a way of *protecting* what they have.

Gemini Lagna (Mithuna)

Body and temperament. Tall or slender, expressive hands, quick eyes, a youthful look kept late. Curious, witty, restless, sociable, easily bored; two of everything, jobs, opinions, phones.

Lagna lord: Mercury. ● **Friends:** Venus, Saturn, Mercury. ○ **Troublemakers:** Mars, Jupiter, Sun. ◆ **Neutral:** Moon.

Strengths and struggles. Communication, adaptability, learning anything fast. Struggles with depth, follow-through and nervous exhaustion. Health: lungs, shoulders, nerves.

Career leanings. Writing, journalism, teaching, trade and marketing, technology, translation, media, anything with words and movement.

The stereotype. The journalist who knows everyone and files three stories a day.

Talking to this client. Keep it interesting; give them the *why* behind every suggestion. They will argue, enjoy it. Offer options, not orders.

Cancer Lagna (Karka)

Body and temperament. Round face, soft body, gains weight easily, gentle eyes. Emotional, protective, nostalgic, deeply attached to family and home; moody, easily hurt, slow to trust and utterly loyal once trust is given.

Lagna lord: Moon. ● **Friends:** Mars (the yogakaraka), Jupiter, Moon. ○ **Troublemakers:** Venus, Mercury. ◆ **Neutral:** Sun, Saturn.

Strengths and struggles. Empathy, memory, nurturing, intuition about people. Struggles with mood swings, holding grudges, letting others go. Health: chest, digestion, fluid balance.

Career leanings. Care professions, nursing, teaching small children, hospitality, food, real estate, the sea and shipping, psychology, anything involving the public's mood.

The stereotype. The mother who runs a hostel and knows every student's problem before they mention it.

Talking to this client. Warmth first, facts second. Acknowledge the feeling before you give the plan. Arjun (Chart B) has this Lagna: begin with his mother and his home, and he will listen to anything.

Leo Lagna (Simha)

Body and temperament. Broad shoulders, an upright bearing, a large head or mane of hair, a commanding voice even when quiet. Proud, generous, loyal, theatrical, needs respect and gives it; can be autocratic and thin-skinned about criticism.

Lagna lord: Sun. ● **Friends:** Mars (the yogakaraka), Jupiter, Sun. ○ **Troublemakers:** Mercury, Venus, Saturn. ◆ **Neutral:** Moon.

Strengths and struggles. Leadership, warmth, courage, dignity under pressure. Struggles with ego, delegation and admitting error. Health: heart, spine, stomach.

Career leanings. Administration, government, politics, management, entertainment, medicine, anything with a chair at the head of the table.

The stereotype. The district collector everyone stands up for when he enters the room.

Talking to this client. Respect the crown; never embarrass them. Frame difficulties as tests of a leader. Praise honestly, then advise.

Virgo Lagna (Kanya)

Body and temperament. Neat, slim, youthful, fine features, a careful way of dressing. Analytical, precise, helpful, modest, anxious; sees the one crooked tile; serves quietly and expects nothing, then resents it.

Lagna lord: Mercury. ● **Friends:** Venus (the yogakaraka), Mercury. ○ **Troublemakers:** Mars, Jupiter, Moon. ◆ **Neutral:** Sun, Saturn.

Strengths and struggles. Skill, discernment, reliability, health-consciousness. Struggles with worry, perfectionism and self-criticism. Health: intestines, digestion, skin.

Career leanings. Medicine and pharmacy, accountancy and audit, editing, research, nutrition, quality control, computing, craft.

The stereotype. The family doctor who remembers every patient's blood-pressure reading.

Talking to this client. Be exact; vague reassurance irritates them. Give details, degrees, dates. Remind them, gently, that "good enough" is a legitimate category.

Libra Lagna (Tula)

Body and temperament. Graceful, well-proportioned, attractive features, a pleasant manner; dislikes ugliness in things and in people. Fair, diplomatic, charming, indecisive; wants everyone to be happy and pays a price for it.

Lagna lord: Venus. ● **Friends:** Saturn (the yogakaraka), Mercury, Venus. ○ **Troublemakers:** Jupiter, Sun, Mars. ◆ **Neutral:** Moon.

Strengths and struggles. Balance, negotiation, aesthetics, partnership. Struggles with decision, confrontation and dependence on others' approval. Health: kidneys, lower back, sugar.

Career leanings. Law, diplomacy, design and fashion, the arts, counselling, trade, human resources, anything requiring an even hand.

The stereotype. The judge who hears both sides so patiently that the court runs late.

Talking to this client. Present two paths with the trade-offs made clear, then help them choose. They will thank you for the *permission* to decide.

Scorpio Lagna (Vrishchika)

Body and temperament. Compact, strong, magnetic eyes, a guarded posture; often a low, controlled voice. Intense, private, loyal, investigative; forgives slowly, forgets never; capable of extraordinary transformation.

Lagna lord: Mars. ● **Friends:** Jupiter, Moon, Sun, Mars (the Sun and Moon together act as yogakarakas). ○ **Troublemakers:** Mercury, Venus, Saturn. ◆ **Neutral:** none.

Strengths and struggles. Depth, focus, resilience, penetrating insight into people. Struggles with suspicion, secrecy, jealousy and letting go. Health: reproductive system, excretion, infections.

Career leanings. Medicine and surgery, research, investigation and intelligence, psychology, the occult and astrology itself, insurance, chemistry, crisis management.

The stereotype. The surgeon who says little, sees everything, and whom patients trust completely.

Talking to this client. Earn trust first; do not perform. Be truthful about difficult things, they can tell when you soften, but always show the transformation on the other side. Meera (Chart A) has this Lagna, and every reading of her chart should begin with respect for its depth.

Sagittarius Lagna (Dhanu)

Body and temperament. Tall or long-limbed, strong thighs, an open face and a ready laugh. Optimistic, principled, philosophical, frank to a fault, restless for horizons; can be preachy and careless with details.

Lagna lord: Jupiter. ● **Friends:** Sun, Mars, Jupiter (the Sun and Mercury together act as yogakarakas). ○ **Troublemakers:** Venus, Saturn. ♦ **Neutral:** Mercury, Moon.

Strengths and struggles. Faith, vision, teaching, honesty, luck that arrives just in time. Struggles with over-promising, impatience with small print, and a tendency to lecture. Health: hips, thighs, liver, weight.

Career leanings. Teaching and academia, law, religion and philosophy, publishing, foreign trade and travel, sport, advisory roles.

The stereotype. The professor who is always about to leave on a pilgrimage.

Talking to this client. Talk about meaning and purpose; they engage with the big picture. Then quietly hand them the details they will otherwise skip.

Capricorn Lagna (Makara)

Body and temperament. Lean, bony, a long face; looks old when young and young when old; a dry, slow humour. Ambitious, disciplined, dutiful, cautious, reserved; carries responsibility early and complains rarely.

Lagna lord: Saturn. ● **Friends:** Venus (the yogakaraka), Mercury, Saturn. ○ **Troublemakers:** Mars, Jupiter, Moon. ♦ **Neutral:** Sun.

Strengths and struggles. Persistence, realism, organisation, integrity. Struggles with pessimism, rigidity, loneliness and the belief that nothing comes without suffering. Health: knees, joints, bones, teeth, skin.

Career leanings. Administration, engineering, construction, government service, mining and heavy industry, management, anything that rewards the long climb.

The stereotype. The chief engineer who built the dam and never made a speech about it.

Talking to this client. Respect their seriousness; do not jolly them along. Show them a timeline. Remind them that Saturn's rewards *do* come, and that rest is also a duty.

Aquarius Lagna (Kumbha)

Body and temperament. Tall, strong calves, a thoughtful face that seems to be listening to something far away. Idealistic, independent, humanitarian, unconventional, detached; many acquaintances, few intimates; fixed in principle.

Lagna lord: Saturn. ● **Friends:** Venus (the yogakaraka), Saturn. ○ **Troublemakers:** Jupiter, Moon, Mars. ♦ **Neutral:** Mercury, Sun.

Strengths and struggles. Vision, originality, fairness, systems thinking. Struggles with emotional distance, stubbornness about ideas and a feeling of not belonging. Health: calves and ankles, circulation, nerves.

Career leanings. Science and technology, social work and reform, engineering, aviation, astrology, large organisations and NGOs, anything that serves the group.

The stereotype. The scientist who is happier with a problem than with a party.

Talking to this client. Treat them as an equal thinker. Explain the principle behind the remedy or they will not do it. Do not appeal to sentiment; appeal to fairness and to the greater good.

Pisces Lagna (Meena)

Body and temperament. Soft, often plump body, large liquid eyes, small feet; a gentle voice. Compassionate, imaginative, adaptable, devotional; easily influenced, prone to escape into dreams, food or others' troubles; sacrifices too readily.

Lagna lord: Jupiter. ● **Friends:** Mars, Moon, Jupiter (Mars and Jupiter together act as yogakarakas). ○ **Troublemakers:** Saturn, Venus, Sun, Mercury. ♦ **Neutral:** none.

Strengths and struggles. Empathy, faith, creativity, healing presence. Struggles with boundaries, decision, self-pity and practical money matters. Health: feet, lymph, sleep, sensitivity to medicines.

Career leanings. Healing and medicine, the arts and music, spiritual vocations, charity work, hospitality, the sea, film and photography.

The stereotype. The temple musician whom everyone brings their sorrows to, and who forgets to eat.

Talking to this client. Gentleness, but with structure. Give them one concrete boundary to keep and one practical step to take. They will feel your kindness; make sure they also leave with a plan.

The ten-minute first read

Whatever the chart, whoever the client, I do the same ten minutes before I say a single word. It is a checklist, and I recommend you write it on the first page of your notebook.

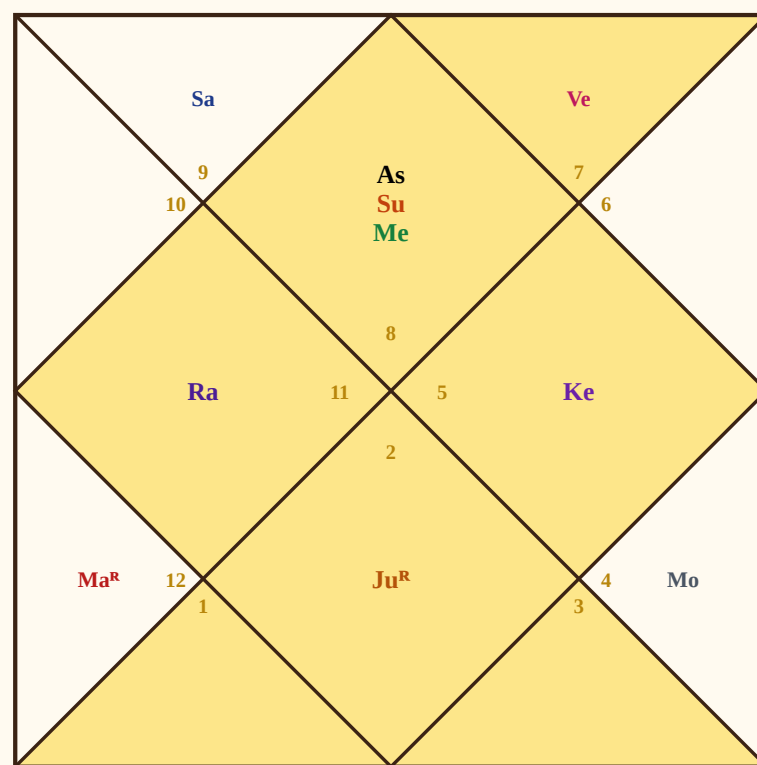
STORY: WALKING THE HAVELI ONCE. *Before I say a word to a client I walk through their haveli once, always by the same route. I stop at the **front door** and ask who owns it and where the captain is (Lagna and its lord). I pay my respects to the **Queen Mother** in her room (the Moon, its sign and star), because she decides how everything I say will be received. I check the **four pillars** that hold the roof (planets in the kendras). I look into the **store-room, the back stairs and the guest-house** (the dusthanas) to see who has been sent there. I note which courtier is being **honoured** and which **humiliated** (exalted and debilitated planets). I read the **railway timetable** pinned to the wall (the current dasha and the next). Then, and only then, I turn to the host and ask **one question** to make sure I am in the right house. **Rule:** Lagna and lord; Moon and nakshatra; kendras; dusthanas; dignities; dasha; one confirming question, in that order, every time.*

1. **Lagna and its lord.** Which sign rises; where is its lord; how strong is it (sign dignity, house, retrograde, combustion)?
2. **Moon sign and nakshatra.** How will this person *feel* what I say? Which dasha sequence does the nakshatra set up?
3. **Planets in kendras.** What are the pillars, what is strong and visible in this life?
4. **Planets in dusthanas.** Where is the struggle, the specialisation, the hidden work?
5. **Exalted and debilitated planets.** Which actor is at the summit; which is in unfamiliar clothes?
6. **Current dasha.** What period is running now, and what is next? (Chapter 13 teaches the calculation; software gives it in a second.)

7. **One confirming question.** Ask the client something the chart should make true, and *listen*. If the answer is no, re-check the birth time before you go on.

WHY? Why this order and not another? *Logic of the system:* from the frame to the detail. Nothing can be judged until the Lagna is known, because the Lagna decides which house every planet is in, so it comes first. The Moon comes second because it is the second frame and it sets the dasha sequence. Kendras before dusthanas because you weigh strength before struggle; dignities next because they modify everything already seen; the dasha last because it only tells you *when* the things you have already found will speak. The confirming question comes at the end because it tests all of it at once. Everyday parallel: reading an exam paper, instructions first, then the marks distribution, then the questions, and only then the pen.

Chart A: kendras and dusthanas for the 10-minute read



Kendras 1,4,7,10 and dusthanas 6,8,12 shaded; only Venus (12th) sits in a dusthana

Figure 5.6: Chart A prepared for the ten-minute read. Kendras and dusthanas are shaded; the eye goes to them first.

Let us do it on Chart A, aloud.

1. Lagna and lord. Scorpio rises. Lord Mars, retrograde at 4° Pisces in the 5th house, a trikona, in Jupiter's sign, and Jupiter is Mars's friend. A comfortable, fortunate captain whose energy turns inward first. Sun and Mercury sit *in* the Lagna, strengthening it considerably: a strong front door.

2. Moon. Cancer, own sign, 21°, in the 9th: Ashlesha nakshatra, Mercury's star. A receptive, emotional, faith-anchored mind; shrewd (Ashlesha) beneath the softness. Because the birth Moon is in Mercury's star, the dasha sequence begins with Mercury.

3. Kendras. Sun and Mercury (1st), Rahu (4th), Jupiter retrograde (7th), Ketu (10th). Every pillar occupied, a visible, effective life. Strong self, unconventional home, a learned partner, a career that lets go of ego.

4. Dusthanas. Only Venus in the 12th, in its own sign Libra: comfortable expenses, private pleasures, foreign or distant connections in love; not a struggle so much as a quiet room.

5. Exalted and debilitated. Strictly, none of the planets is at its exaltation or debilitation sign. The Moon is in its own sign and Venus in its own sign, both dignified. Mercury in Scorpio and Saturn in Sagittarius are in neutral-to-friendly territory. Nothing is in the ditch.

6. Dasha. Mercury Mahadasha at birth, with a balance of about $11\frac{1}{2}$ years (the Moon at 21° Cancer has traversed most of Ashlesha; $(30 - 21) \div 13^\circ 20' \times 17 \approx 11.5$). Then Ketu for 7 years (age 11.5–18.5), Venus for 20 (18.5–38.5), Sun for 6 (38.5–44.5). Born December 1988, she entered the Venus period around mid-2007 and the Sun period around mid-2027. Marriage in 2016, inside Venus, the natural karaka of marriage, fits.

7. One confirming question. With Rahu in the 4th and Ketu in the 10th, I would ask: "Did you settle far from where you were born, or in a home very different from your parents?" With Jupiter in the 7th: "Is your husband a teacher, or older in temperament than his years?" A yes to either, and I proceed with confidence. Two noes, and I would re-examine the birth time before saying anything more.

Ten minutes. You have not predicted anything yet, and already you could describe this woman to her satisfaction.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Never open your mouth before you have finished the seven steps. The client's first impression of you is formed by your first sentence; make sure it is one the chart can defend.

In one breath

- North Indian chart: houses fixed (top diamond = 1st, anti-clockwise), sign numbers rotate. South Indian chart: signs fixed (Pisces top-left, clockwise), find the Lagna slash.
- Always check the sign sequence and locate the four kendras first.
- The Lagna is the zodiac point on the eastern horizon: at sunrise it is the Sun's sign; roughly one sign every two hours after that, but signs rise unequally, so use software for anything you will say aloud.
- Birth time errors re-shuffle the chart; rectify by matching dasha periods to dated life events, and confirm with the physical Lagna description.
- The Lagna lord is the captain; its house shows where the self goes to find itself.
- Each of the twelve Lagnas has a body, a temperament, a set of friendly and unfriendly planets (Appendix A.6), typical careers, and a way it likes to be spoken to.
- The ten-minute read: Lagna and lord, Moon and nakshatra, kendras, dusthanas, exaltations and debilitations, current dasha, one confirming question.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. In Figure 5.3 (Chart B, North Indian), which sign number sits in the 8th house, and which planets are there? Confirm by finding the same box in Figure 5.4.
2. A client was born about two hours after sunrise in late April, when the Sun is in sidereal Aries. Roughly which sign rises? Which neighbouring signs would you also keep in mind, and why?
3. For a Libra Lagna, name the yogakaraka and the two planets Appendix A.6 lists as marakas. In one sentence, why is Saturn friendly to Libra even though it is a natural malefic? (Hint: which houses does it own from Libra?)
4. Arjun's Lagna lord is the Moon, in the 11th house, exalted. Write a two-sentence reading of the captain using the table in this chapter.
5. Run the seven-step checklist on Chart B and write one confirming question you would ask Arjun.

Answers

1. Sign 11, Aquarius, with Sun, Mercury and Saturn. In the South Indian chart Aquarius is the second box down the left-hand column; count clockwise from the Cancer slash and it is the 8th. 2. At sunrise the Lagna is Aries with the Sun; two hours later it is about one sign ahead, so Taurus. Keep Aries and Gemini in mind: Aries rises quickly (about 1 h 40 min at Indian latitudes), so the boundary may already be past, and "about two hours" is only an estimate. Software would settle it. 3. Yogakaraka: Saturn. Marakas: Mars and Jupiter. From Libra, Saturn owns Capricorn (the 4th, a kendra) and Aquarius (the 5th, a trikona), a kendra and a trikona lord in one planet, which is exactly the definition of a yogakaraka; its natural harshness is overruled by its functional role. 4. Arjun's self is invested in gains, friends and networks; wishes tend to come true through people. The captain is exalted in Taurus, so his mind is steady, comfortable and popular, a strong foundation beneath the intense 8th-house cluster. 5. Lagna Cancer, lord Moon exalted in the 11th; Moon in Krittika (Sun's star), so the dasha begins with the Sun (balance about 1.8 years), then Moon, Mars, Rahu (18.8–36.8). Kendras: Rahu 4th, Venus 7th, Ketu 10th. Dusthanas: Sun, Mercury, Saturn in the 8th (Saturn combust). Exalted: Moon. Debilitated: none. Confirming question: "Does your work involve research, insurance, or things most people never see, and did your father's life have a major upheaval?"

Chapter 6: Aspects (Drishti) and Conjunctions (Yuti): How Planets Talk

Until now we have placed the actors on the stage. Nine planets, twelve signs, twelve rooms, and you can already say, from Chapter 5, what a planet sitting in a room *does* there. But a planet does not only act where it sits. It also *looks*. And in a joint family, you know very well that the uncle sitting in the drawing room can run the whole kitchen with one glance.

That glance is what this chapter is about. An **aspect** (*Drishti*, literally "sight") is a planet's gaze falling on a house or on another planet from a distance. A **conjunction** (*Yuti*, "union") is two planets sitting in the same room and being forced to share it. These two, sight and company, are how planets talk to each other. Once you can read the conversation, a chart stops being a list of nine separate facts and becomes one connected story.

Let me give you the grammar first, then the reasons, then a full worked chart.

What an aspect actually is

Picture a planet as a lamp. It lights up the room it sits in, of course. But it also throws a beam across the house to another room. Whatever is in that far room is bathed in the lamp's colour: Jupiter's beam is warm and gold and makes things grow; Saturn's beam is cold and blue and makes things slow down and get serious; Mars's beam is hot and red and makes things urgent.

So "Saturn aspects the 7th house" means: Saturn pours its nature (delay, seriousness, duty) into marriage and partnership, *even though Saturn is not sitting there*. The planet stays; its influence travels.

Two things to hold on to:

1. **Aspects are counted from the planet, not from the Lagna.** If Saturn is in the 4th house, its "7th aspect" falls on the 7th house *from the 4th*, which is the 10th house of the chart. Beginners forget this in the first month and then never again.
2. **An aspect is one-directional.** Saturn looking at the 7th does not mean the 7th looks back. (Two planets *can* look at each other, we come to that, but a house never looks at anything.)

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: A planet acts where it sits and speaks where it looks. Sitting is louder than looking, but looking travels further.

The Parashari rule: the 7th for everyone, plus three specials

Here is the entire rule from *Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra*, and Appendix A.4 has the same table:

Planet	Natural gaze	Full aspect on houses counted from itself
Sun	○ mild pressure	7th only
Moon	● bright / ○ dark	7th only
Mercury	👁️ takes its company's colour	7th only
Venus	● protects	7th only
Rahu, Ketu (by common practice)	○ unsettles	7th only
Mars	○ heats	4th, 7th, 8th
Jupiter	● blesses	5th, 7th, 9th
Saturn	○ slows, tests	3rd, 7th, 10th

That is it. Every planet looks straight across the chart at the house opposite it, the 7th from itself. Three planets have extra eyes. The classroom mnemonic in Hindi-speaking India is simply "**Mangal chaar-aath, Guru paanch-nau, Shani teen-das**": Mars four-eight, Jupiter five-nine, Saturn three-ten. Say it ten times and it is yours for life.

Why the 7th for everyone?

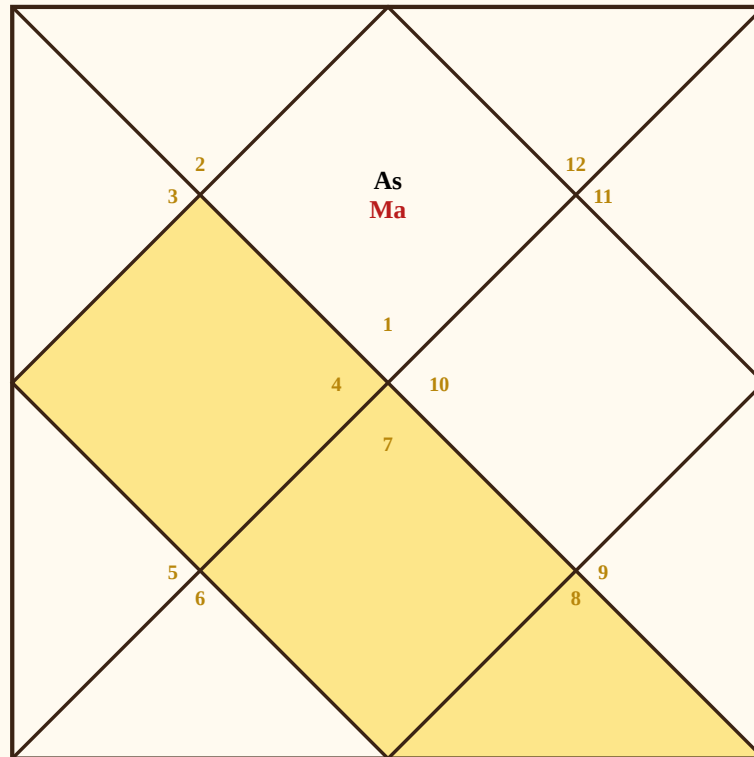
WHY? *Astronomy.* Opposition is the one geometry in which two bodies face each other directly across the sky with the Earth, and you, in between; that is exactly what a full Moon is, the Moon standing opposite the Sun. From every other angle a planet sees its neighbour side-on. So the 7th, the sign directly opposite, is the only place a planet "looks at" another without turning, and every planet has this face-to-face stare. It is also why the 7th house, the one opposite the Lagna, is the house of the *other person*: spouse, partner, the public you face. *Everyday*: at a long dining table, the only person you see full-face without turning your head is the one seated directly opposite you.

Why does Mars look at the 4th and 8th?

Think of Mars as a soldier. He faces the enemy in front (the 7th), leaps forward to strike (the 4th) and turns to strike behind (the 8th).

WHY? *Classical statement, with the system's own grammar.* Parashara simply gives Mars the 4th and 8th; the reasoning the tradition attaches is that the 4th and 8th from any point are the two "square" houses (*Chaturasra*) (90° and 210° away, the angles of friction rather than harmony) and Mars is force and friction. A pressure planet gets the pressure angles. *Everyday*: on a cricket field the captain puts his sharpest fielders at square leg and point, the two sides where the ball flies off the bat hardest: the squares are where the action hurts.

Mars in the 1st aspects the 4th, 7th and 8th



Mars: the soldier leaps forward to the 4th, faces the 7th, strikes back at the 8th

Figure 6.1: Mars in the 1st. The shaded houses receive its full gaze: the 4th (leap forward), the 7th (face to face), and the 8th (strike behind).

Why does Jupiter look at the 5th and 9th?

Jupiter is the royal priest, and a priest blesses. The 5th and 9th are the **trines** (*Trikona*): merit, children, fortune, dharma, "Lakshmi's houses". "Jupiter's aspect" is the phrase you will hear most often when someone explains why a bad period did less harm than expected.

WHY? *System grammar.* The 5th and 9th from any point are 120° away, the trine, the angle of ease and harmony, and the three houses 1–5–9 form the *Dharma trikona*, the houses of merit and purpose. Jupiter is the planet of dharma, so the tradition gives the dharma planet the dharma angles: it blesses where blessing belongs. *Everyday:* the family elder who is asked to bless at exactly two ceremonies, the naming and the wedding, because those are the two occasions where a blessing is the whole point.

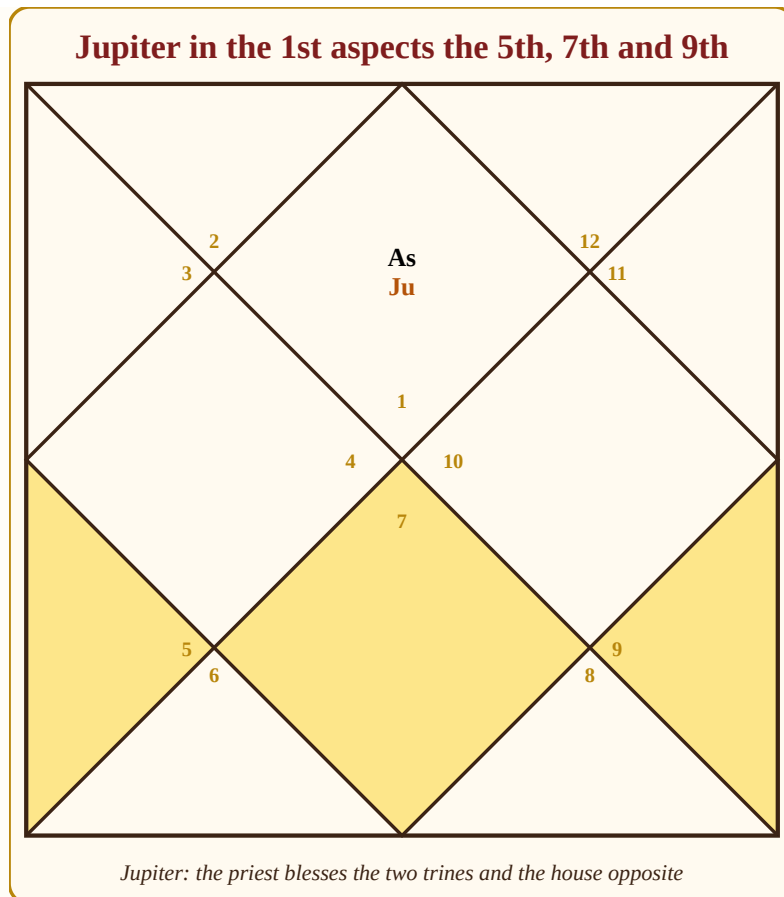


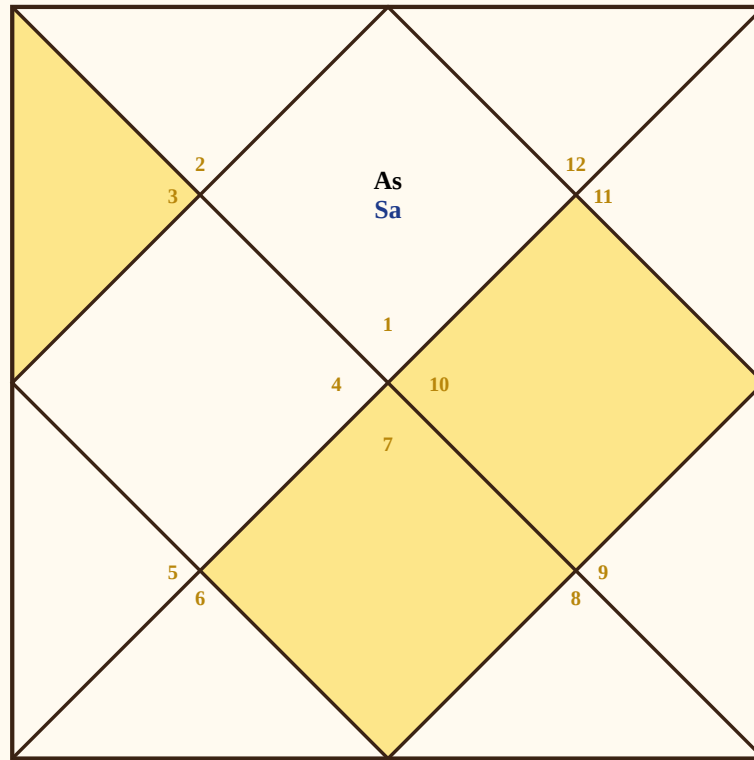
Figure 6.2: Jupiter in the 1st blesses the two trines from itself, the 5th and 9th, along with the 7th.

Why does Saturn look at the 3rd and 10th?

Saturn is the foreman on a construction site. A foreman watches effort (the 3rd (courage, hard work) and output (the 10th) work, duty).

WHY? *System grammar.* The 3rd is the house of effort and the 10th is the house of karma, work done in the world; both are **growing houses** (*Upachaya*), where results come only with time. Saturn is labour and time itself, so the supervisor planet gets the two houses where labour is spent and judged. *Everyday:* the office supervisor checks two registers, the attendance sheet (did you show up and try?) and the delivery report (was the work done?), and nothing else.

Saturn in the 1st aspects the 3rd, 7th and 10th



Saturn: the supervisor watches effort (3rd), partners (7th) and work (10th)

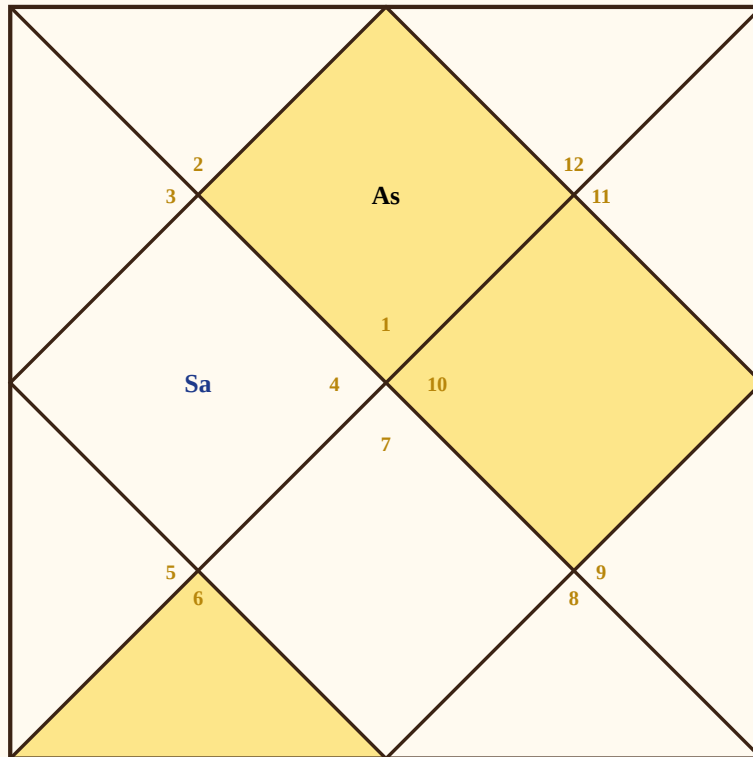
Figure 6.3: Saturn in the 1st supervises the 3rd (effort), the 7th (partnerships) and the 10th (career).

STORY: THREE COURTIER'S AND THEIR HABITS. Every courtier in the haveli stares straight across the hall at whoever sits opposite: that is the 7th aspect, and even the King and the Queen Mother do it. But three courtiers have habits. The Commander, red Mars, never trusts a hall. He stands at his post and keeps glancing to his flanks (the room four steps ahead and the room eight steps ahead) because that is where an ambush comes from. The Royal Priest, golden Jupiter, walks the hall with his hand raised, and he blesses the two rooms where the lamps of merit burn, the 5th and the 9th. The old Judge of Labour, navy Saturn, blesses nobody; he inspects. He walks to the 3rd room to see whether the servants are working and to the 10th to see whether the work is finished. **Rule:** Every planet aspects the 7th; Mars adds the 4th and 8th, Jupiter the 5th and 9th, Saturn the 3rd and 10th, always counted from where the planet sits.

Now count from a different house

Put Saturn in the 4th instead. The 3rd from the 4th is the 6th; the 7th from the 4th is the 10th; the 10th from the 4th is the 1st. So a 4th-house Saturn aspects the 6th, 10th and 1st houses, including the Lagna itself. Trace it on the diagram with your finger until it feels obvious.

Saturn in the 4th aspects the 6th, 10th and 1st



Count from where the planet sits, not from the Lagna: 3rd from the 4th is the 6th

Figure 6.4: The same three aspects, now counted from the 4th. Saturn's 10th aspect lands on the Lagna.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Counting aspects from the Lagna. "Saturn aspects the 3rd, 7th and 10th" is only true when Saturn is *in the 1st*. Always start the count at the house the planet occupies, and count that house as 1.

Reading an aspect on a house versus on a planet

An aspect on an **empty house** colours the *affairs* of that house. Jupiter aspecting an empty 4th: home, mother and property have a protector. Saturn aspecting an empty 2nd: money comes slowly, speech is measured.

An aspect on a **planet** colours the *planet's behaviour*, and through it every house that planet owns, the more powerful case. Saturn aspecting the Moon chills the Moon itself (the mind becomes cautious, worried, mature early) and touches whichever house the Moon rules. Jupiter aspecting Venus makes love generous wherever those two sit.

So when you scan a chart, ask two questions of every aspect: *which room does the beam light?* and *is anyone standing in the beam?*

Benefic and malefic aspects

The simplest usable rule: the gaze of Jupiter, Venus, a bright Moon and an unafflicted Mercury **protects and grows** what it touches ●; the gaze of Saturn, Mars, the Sun (mildly), Rahu and Ketu **tests and pressures** it ○. Neither is "good" or "bad" in the moral sense: a house only ever protected gives a soft, untested life; one only ever pressured gives a hard one. Most houses receive a mixture.

Two refinements worth knowing from the start:

- **A malefic's gaze on a malefic house is often welcome.** Saturn aspecting the 6th (enemies, disease, debts) restrains those things. The cruel planets do well in and on the cruel houses, set a thief to catch a thief.
- **A benefic's gaze on a benefic house is the classical protection.** Jupiter aspecting the 5th or 9th, Venus aspecting the 7th: these are the aspects that soften even a difficult period.

The *functional* nature of a planet, whether it is a friend or an enemy for *your particular Lagna*, modifies all of this, and Chapter 8 is entirely about that. For now, think in natural terms.

When two planets look at each other: mutual aspect

If Mars is in the 1st and Saturn in the 7th, Mars aspects the 7th (Saturn) and Saturn aspects the 7th (Mars). They are staring at each other. This is a **mutual aspect** (*paraspara drishti*), and it is far stronger than a one-way glance, because the two planets are now in a *relationship*. Their natures blend almost as if they were in the same house.

Mutual aspects happen most easily through the 7th, because every planet has it. But watch for the special aspects too: Jupiter in the 1st and Saturn in the 9th: Jupiter's 9th aspect falls on Saturn, and Saturn's 3rd aspect... falls on the 11th, not the 1st. So that one is *one-way*. Check both directions every time; do not assume.

The four kinds of relationship (Sambandha)

This word (**Sambandha**, "connection") is going to matter enormously in Chapter 10, where nearly every great yoga is defined as "the lord of X connected with the lord of Y". Parashara and the tradition recognise four ways two planets can be connected:

#	Relationship	What it means	Strength
1	Conjunction (<i>Yuti</i>)	Both in the same sign/house	Strongest
2	Mutual aspect (<i>paraspara drishti</i>)	Each aspects the other	Strong
3	Exchange of signs (<i>Parivartana</i>)	A sits in B's sign, B sits in A's sign (Chart C: Moon in Jupiter's Sagittarius, Jupiter in the Moon's Cancer)	Strong, and very special (Chapter 9)
4	Sitting in each other's sign one way	A sits in B's sign, but B does not return the favour	Weakest; some teachers do not count it alone

When you see two planets connected in any of these four ways, their houses are fused. A 9th lord connected with a 10th lord fuses fortune with career, the celebrated *Dharma-Karma Adhipati* yoga of the classics. A 6th lord connected with the 7th lord fuses disputes with marriage. The connection itself is neutral machinery; what it produces depends on *which* houses and *which* planets.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Before you name any yoga, prove the Sambandha. If the two lords are not together, not looking at each other, and not in each other's signs, they are not connected, and the yoga is not there, however much you want it to be.

Conjunctions: two planets in one room

A conjunction is the most intimate relationship. Two planets in one house are like two relatives sharing one bedroom: their habits mix whether they like it or not. The house receives *both* natures at once, and each planet takes on some of the other's colour.

The art of reading a conjunction is **blending**: you ask what happens when *authority* (Sun) and *intellect* (Mercury) live together, and you get confident intelligence that speaks, the **Budha-Aditya yoga**, derived rather than memorised.

The table gives the classical flavour of every pair, colour-coded: ● helpful, ○ difficult, ◐ mixed. Thirty-six pairs are possible on paper; Rahu with Ketu never happens, because the nodes are always exactly opposite. These are *starting points*; sign, house, dignity and aspects modify them. The stories after the table are how you will remember them.

	Pair	Traditional name (if any)	Core flavour
☾	Sun + Moon	Amavasya (new-Moon) birth	Mind merged with ego and father; a dim Moon that needs support from Jupiter; strong will, low outward emotion
♂	Sun + Mars	n/a	Commander's fire: courage, engineering, army/police, surgery; temper with father or authority
☿	Sun + Mercury	Budha-Aditya	Articulate intelligence, administration, teaching, mathematics, provided Mercury is not combust
♃	Sun + Jupiter	n/a	Dharmic authority: teacher-fathers, advisors, judges, men of principle; sometimes pride in one's wisdom
♀	Sun + Venus	n/a	Glamour with position: arts in government or corporations; Venus is often combust here, so marriage may need patience
♄	Sun + Saturn	n/a	Friction with father or bosses; late recognition; the discipline of working for a stern authority; a serious childhood
♈	Sun + Rahu	Grahan (eclipse) yoga	Unconventional or foreign fathers/authority; ambition that overshoots; ego confusion, then a distinctive identity
♏	Sun + Ketu	Grahan (eclipse) yoga	Detachment from ego and from the father figure; spiritual or technical depth; low need for applause
♂	Moon + Mars	Chandra-Mangala	Earning drive, competitiveness, quick temper; mother's health or a forceful mother; property through effort
☿	Moon + Mercury	n/a	Quick, verbal, restless mind; writers and traders; Mercury dislikes the Moon, so the mind can second-guess itself
♃	Moon + Jupiter	(Gaja-Kesari, since the same house is a kendra from itself)	Optimism, wisdom, protection, a generous mother; sometimes over-trusting
♀	Moon + Venus	n/a	Artistic, comfort-loving, soft-hearted; beauty and hospitality; can drift into indulgence
♄	Moon + Saturn	Vish (poison) yoga / Punarphoo	Melancholy, early responsibility, delayed comforts, a struggling or distant mother; also great emotional endurance
♈	Moon + Rahu	Grahan yoga	Vivid imagination, anxiety, phobias, fascination with the foreign or the hidden; a mind that needs anchoring
♏	Moon + Ketu	Grahan yoga	Intuitive, detached, "old soul" mind; separation from mother or motherland; meditation comes easily
♂	Mars + Mercury	n/a	Sharp tongue, technical skill, debate, surgery, coding; argumentativeness
♃	Mars + Jupiter	Guru-Mangala	Righteous force: law, property, teaching with authority, defence of the weak; sometimes preachy
♀	Mars + Venus	n/a	Passion: love with heat, arts with drive, sport, design; relationships that begin fast
♄	Mars + Saturn	n/a	Hard labour, frustration, accident-prone when careless; also machines, mining, engineering, and stubborn endurance

	Pair	Traditional name (if any)	Core flavour
○	Mars + Rahu	Angarak (popular name)	Explosive energy, risk-taking, technology, sudden anger; needs an outlet such as sport or surgery
○	Mars + Ketu	n/a	Sudden actions, wounds and cuts, martial arts, surgeons; energy that appears and vanishes
◐	Mercury + Jupiter	n/a	Scholarship, teaching, publishing, counsel; the two are natural enemies, so faith and reason may quarrel inside one head
●	Mercury + Venus	n/a	Poetry, music, commerce, charm; the salesman-artist; pleasant speech
◐	Mercury + Saturn	n/a	Methodical mind, slow careful speech, accountancy, law, research; may stammer or hesitate in youth
◐	Mercury + Rahu	n/a	Clever and unconventional; technology, languages, cunning; watch for exaggeration in speech
◐	Mercury + Ketu	n/a	Intuitive mathematics, cryptic or terse speech, coding, astrology itself
◐	Jupiter + Venus	n/a	Two teachers of wealth together: luxury, learning, wealth; they are enemies, so indulgence can fight principle
◐	Jupiter + Saturn	n/a	Dharma meets karma: slow, steady, institutional careers; priest-administrators; late but durable success
◐	Jupiter + Rahu	Guru-Chandal	An unconventional guru; breaks tradition; can give enormous rise through foreign or modern paths (see below)
◐	Jupiter + Ketu	n/a	Philosophy, spirituality, detachment from wealth or from children; moksha-oriented wisdom
◐	Venus + Saturn	n/a	Mature or late love, practical partnerships, arts with discipline (they are friends); loyalty over romance
◐	Venus + Rahu	n/a	Intense desires, glamour, foreign or unusual partners, illusions in love; entertainment industry
◐	Venus + Ketu	n/a	Detachment in love, refined tastes, past-life relationship karma; the artist-ascetic
○	Saturn + Rahu	Shrapit (popular name)	Heavy karmic weight, delays, fear; also patience, foreign labour, engineering of large systems
○	Saturn + Ketu	n/a	Renunciation, isolation, deep discipline; monks, researchers, mountaineers
n/a	Rahu + Ketu	n/a	Never occurs: the nodes are always seven houses apart

Conjunctions at a glance: who shares the room

	Sun	Moon	Mars	Mercury	Jupiter	Venus	Saturn	Rahu	Ketu
Sun		new-Moon mind	commander's fire	Budha-Aditya	dharmic authority	glamour, may burn	father friction	eclipsed ego	detached ego
Moon	new-Moon mind		Chandra-Mangala	quick, restless mind	wise, protected	artistic, soft	Vish yoga melancholy	anxious imagination	intuitive, detached
Mars	commander's fire	Chandra-Mangala		sharp tongue	righteous force	passion	brake and accelerator	explosive energy	sudden action
Mercury	Budha-Aditya	quick, restless mind	sharp tongue		scholar, divided	charm, commerce	methodical mind	clever, unconventional	intuitive maths
Jupiter	dharmic authority	wise, protected	righteous force	scholar, divided		two ministers, one budget	slow, durable success	Guru Chandal (not a curse)	philosophy, moksha
Venus	glamour, may burn	artistic, soft	passion	charm, commerce	two ministers, one budget		late, lasting love	magnified desire	detached love
Saturn	father friction	Vish yoga melancholy	brake and accelerator	methodical mind	slow, durable success	late, lasting love		heavy karma	renunciation
Rahu	eclipsed ego	anxious imagination	explosive energy	clever, unconventional	Guru Chandal (not a curse)	magnified desire	heavy karma		never (opposite)
Ketu	detached ego	intuitive, detached	sudden action	intuitive maths	philosophy, moksha	detached love	renunciation	never (opposite)	

 helpful

 mixed: read dignity and house

 difficult: a test

Names in the tool's planet colours. Every pair appears twice; read either half.

Figure 6.5: The same thirty-six pairs as a grid. Green cells help, red cells test, amber cells mix. Photograph it.

The court in one room: the pairs as stories

STORY: THE KING'S THREE COMPANIONS. Watch who sits beside the King. When the clever young Prince, green Mercury, sits at his elbow with the ledgers, the court gets a ruler who can explain his decrees: that is Budha-Aditya, authority that speaks. But the Prince must not sit too close to the throne; if the King's glare falls full on him he goes silent: that is combustion. When the Minister of Pleasure, pink Venus, sits beside the King, the court turns glamorous (festivals, arts, fine buildings) yet the King demands discipline and the Minister wants indulgence, so Venus is often burnt, and the person's comforts and love life end up serving the father's or the career's wishes. And when the old Judge, navy Saturn, sits beside the King, the hall goes cold. In the Puranas Saturn is the Sun's own son, whom the Sun refused to recognise; father and son sit together and do not speak. That is friction with father or authority, and recognition that comes late, after long duty. **Rule:** Sun + Mercury ● speaks; Sun + Venus ♀ shines but may burn; Sun + Saturn ○ tests the bond with father and bosses.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER'S VISITORS. The Queen Mother, the grey Moon, is the mind of the kingdom: she feels whatever enters her room. When the Commander marches in, the two of them end up running the treasury together, her care for the household and his drive to win make money, and quarrels; that is Chandra-Mangala, earning capacity with a temper. When the old Judge visits, he sits in silence and reminds her of every duty undone and every year gone; the room fills with melancholy (the tradition calls it Vish yoga, poison) but it also breeds endurance, for she learns to bear anything. When the Smoke-headed Stranger slips in, she cannot see clearly; the room fills with rumours, fascination, fear of things that are not there: Grahan yoga, the eclipsed mind, brilliant at imagining and poor at resting. **Rule:** Moon + Mars ♀ earns and argues; Moon + Saturn ○ sorrows and endures; Moon + Rahu ○ imagines and worries.

STORY: THE COMMANDER'S COMPANY. The Commander, red Mars, is heat and speed. Put the cold old Judge in his room and you have a chariot with one foot on the accelerator and one on the brake: it lurches, it stalls, sometimes it crashes (hard labour, frustration, the accident born of impatience) but a chariot that learns to drive this way can climb any mountain; that is the endurance of engineers and miners. Put the Minister of Pleasure in his room and the Commander falls in love: fast, hot, sometimes reckless: passion in romance, in art, in sport. Put the young Prince in his room and the two argue all night: the sharp tongue, the debate, the surgeon's or coder's precise aggression. **Rule:** Mars + Saturn ○ brakes and accelerates at once; Mars + Venus ♀ is passion; Mars + Mercury ♀ is the sharp, technical tongue.

STORY: THE PRIEST'S COMPANY. The Royal Priest, golden Jupiter, is wisdom and faith. Seat the Minister of Pleasure beside him and you have two ministers who both want the budget, the Priest for temples and schools, the Minister for gardens and music. Both are generous, so wealth flows, but they never quite agree; that is the old enmity between Jupiter and Venus. Seat the Smoke-headed Stranger beside him and the court whispers Guru Chandal, the holy man keeping company with the outsider. But watch what actually happens: the Priest learns things the scriptures never taught, and the Stranger learns restraint. If the Priest is strong (own sign, exalted, in a trine) you get the reformer, the scholar who reads foreign books, the professor who breaks his field open. Only when the Priest is weak does faith go astray. Seat the old Judge beside him and you have dharma and karma at one table: slow, institutional, lasting: the priest-administrator. **Rule:** Jupiter + Venus ♀ is wealth with disagreement; Jupiter + Rahu ♀ is the unconventional guru, not a curse; Jupiter + Saturn ♀ is slow, durable success.

STORY: THE JUDGE'S COMPANY. The old Judge of Labour, navy Saturn, began life as a servant and rose by discipline. Two people are comfortable in his cold room. The Smoke-headed Stranger also came from outside; together they carry the heaviest files in the kingdom: the popular name is Shrapit, "cursed", but what I see is two outsiders doing the long, unglamorous, karmic work nobody else will: foreign labour, large engineering, delays that end in permanence. The Minister of Pleasure surprises everyone by liking the Judge: she brings him flowers, he gives her a schedule. Love that comes late and lasts, art with discipline, loyalty above romance. **Rule:** Saturn + Rahu ○ is heavy, delayed karma; Saturn + Venus ♀ is mature, durable love.

STORY: THE PRINCE, THE MINISTER AND THE STRANGER. *The young Prince, green Mercury, and the Minister of Pleasure, pink Venus, are the People's Party's charming pair: he writes the verse, she sets it to music; he sells, she decorates the shop. Poetry, commerce, pleasant speech, a natural friendship. But when the Minister of Pleasure is found with the Smoke-headed Stranger, the court's desires grow larger than life: foreign lovers, glamour, the screen, the intoxication of wanting. Rahu magnifies whatever he touches, and what he touches here is desire. Rule: Mercury + Venus ● is charm and art; Venus + Rahu ♀ is magnified, unusual desire.*

STORY: THE HEADLESS SADHU EMPTIES THE ROOM. *Purple Ketu has no head, no ego, no appetite for applause. Whichever room he sits in, he quietly removes the furniture. With the King: no craving for position, detachment from the father. With the Queen Mother: an intuitive, unworldly mind, separation from mother or motherland. With the Commander: sudden action and sudden withdrawal, cuts and wounds, the surgeon's knife. With the Priest: philosophy that gives away wealth and expectation. With the Minister of Pleasure: refined taste and detachment in love. With the Judge: renunciation, the researcher in his cell. The emptied room feels like loss for years, and then, often, like freedom. Rule: Ketu with any planet ○ subtracts that planet's worldly appetite and ● sharpens its spiritual or technical skill, read both.*

DID YOU KNOW? *The word Chandala in the old texts meant a person outside the caste order, the ultimate outsider. When the classics call Rahu a Chandala they mean exactly this: the one who does not belong to the system. Reading Guru-Chandal as "the wise outsider" is closer to the original sense than the "cursed" reading you find online.*

Who wins the room? Judging a conjunction

When two planets share a house, one usually dominates. Ask, in order:

1. **Dignity.** A planet in its own or exalted sign is the host; a planet in its enemy's or debilitated sign is the guest. The host sets the mood. Saturn in Aquarius with the Sun beside it: Saturn's house, Saturn's rules.
2. **Degree.** The closer two planets are in degrees, the more completely they blend. Two planets 2° apart are one flavour; two planets 25° apart, in the same sign, are neighbours who nod in the corridor. Under about 8°–10° I call a conjunction tight.
3. **Natural weight.** Saturn and Jupiter are slow and heavy and colour what they touch; the Moon and Mercury are quick and light and *take* colour. In a Moon-Saturn conjunction it is the Moon that becomes Saturnine, not Saturn that becomes moonlike.
4. **Who owns what for this Lagna.** Chapter 8 will teach you that a planet which owns the trines is *your* planet. In a conjunction between your friend and your enemy, ask which is stronger on points 1–3, and you will know whether the friend lifts the enemy or the enemy drags down the friend.

WHY? Astronomy. A "conjunction" in the sky means two planets at nearly the same longitude, in the same spot when you look up. A sign is 30° wide, so two planets in one sign can still be a whole hand-span apart in the sky; only when their degrees are close are they literally sharing one point of light, and only then do their natures fully mix. *Everyday:* two guests at the same wedding are "together" in a loose sense; two guests at the same table share every dish.

Combustion: too close to the Sun

The Sun is a special roommate. A planet that comes within a few degrees of it is said to be **combust** (*Asta*, "set"): dazzled, burnt, unable to show its own light. The classical orbs, from Appendix A.2, are approximately: Moon 12°, Mars 17°, Mercury 14° (12° when retrograde), Jupiter 11°, Venus 10° (8° when retrograde), Saturn 15°. Rahu and Ketu are never combust, you

cannot burn a shadow. Authors differ on the exact orbs by a few degrees; use these as your working figures and say "close to combustion" when a planet is on the edge.

WHY? Astronomy. A planet within a few degrees of the Sun rises and sets with it, hidden in the glare: for those days or weeks the ancient observers literally could not see it. A planet that cannot be seen was judged unable to show its own light, hence "set" (*Asta*). The orbs differ by planet because brightness differs: Venus is bright enough to be seen closer to the Sun than Saturn is, so its orb is smaller. *Everyday:* a phone screen in direct afternoon sunlight: the screen is still on, but nothing on it can be read.

What combustion does: the planet's *own* agenda is absorbed into the Sun's. Combust Venus: love and comforts serve the father's, the boss's or one's own career ego. Combust Mercury: a mind that speaks the Sun's opinions. Combust Jupiter: wisdom overshadowed by authority, sometimes a proud teacher.

Check Chart A: Sun at 28° Scorpio, Mercury at 9° Scorpio, 19° apart. Mercury is well outside its 14° orb, so Meera's Budha-Aditya is clean. That is why she is a teacher who can explain, not merely a speaker who asserts. Chart B: Sun 18° Aquarius, Saturn 25°, only 7° apart, inside Saturn's 15° orb. Arjun's Saturn is combust, in its own sign. We will see what that means in a moment.

Planetary war (Graha Yuddha)

When two of the five true planets (Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn) come within **one degree** of each other, the classics say they are at war, and the one that loses is weakened for the whole life. The Sun and Moon do not fight (the Sun combusts, the Moon is merely "with"), and the nodes do not fight. Rule of thumb for the winner, as most teachers apply it: the planet with the **higher latitude** (further north) wins; when you cannot check latitude, most practitioners take the brighter planet (Venus over anyone, Jupiter over the rest) or the one further advanced in degree. Texts disagree; the safe habit is to note the war, be cautious about the loser's houses, and never build a prediction on it alone. Wars are rare; in our three charts there is none.

WHY? Astronomy. Only the five true planets appear as small, sharp points that can seem to touch or even cover one another when within a degree; that visible collision is the "war". The Sun does not fight, it swallows (combustion). The Moon is a broad disc that passes over planets routinely (an occultation, not a duel). Rahu and Ketu have no body at all, so there is nothing to collide. *Everyday:* two scooters can collide at a crossing; a scooter and a shadow cannot.

The crowded house: three or four planets together

A house with three or more planets (a **stellium**, in the borrowed Western word) is where beginners panic or over-predict. Neither is needed. Here is the method, on a real example.

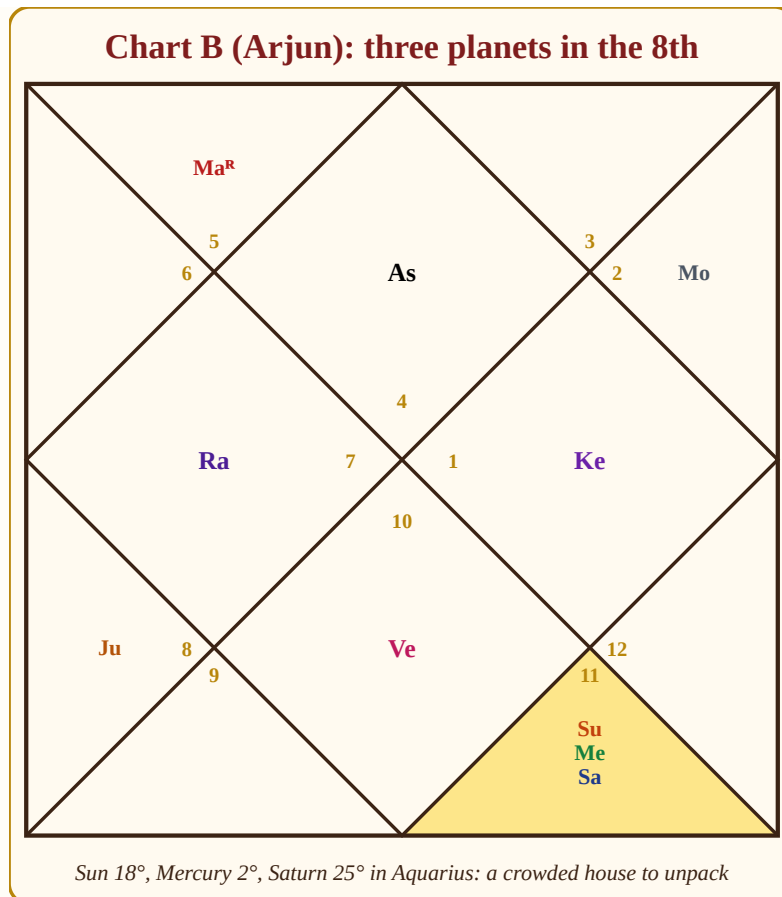


Figure 6.6: Chart B. The 8th house (Aquarius) holds the Sun at 18°, Mercury at 2° and Saturn at 25°.

Step 1: Name the house. The 8th: longevity, transformation, hidden things, research, insurance, inheritance, in-laws, the occult. Three planets here means this department of life is *busy*, not doomed: research, insurance, investigation, depth psychology, astrology itself.

Step 2: Find the host. Aquarius is Saturn's own sign. Saturn is the host; the Sun and Mercury are guests. Saturn also *owns* the 8th, so this is the 8th lord in the 8th, a strong signal for longevity and for the person's capacity to handle crisis (Chapter 9 will call this *swakshetra*).

Step 3: Check dignities and combustion. Saturn in own sign: dignified, but combust (7° from the Sun). Sun in Saturn's sign: in an enemy's house, and it is the 2nd lord for Cancer Lagna sitting in the 8th: family wealth and speech routed through transformation, inheritance, in-laws. Mercury at 2° is 16° from the Sun, *not* combust, and is in a friend's sign (Mercury and Saturn are friendly). Mercury is the 3rd and 12th lord here.

Step 4: Pair them up. Sun + Saturn: friction with father or authority, late recognition, the discipline of a stern environment. Sun + Mercury: Budha-Aditya, articulate intelligence, clean, since Mercury is not combust. Mercury + Saturn: a methodical, research-grade mind, careful speech, accountancy or law or systems.

Step 5: Blend and weigh. The host Saturn sets a serious, patient, secretive tone. The Sun brings ego and father into the mix and is uncomfortable there: a tense relationship with the father in youth, a career that comes into the open late. Mercury, the one planet standing comfortably, is the escape hatch: intellect, analysis, writing. Read together: *a deep, patient researcher of hidden or technical matters, difficult with authority early, recognised late; longevity protected; family wealth linked to inheritance or the spouse's side*. Every clause came from a rule you now know.

Step 6: Ask who aspects the pile. Mars in the 2nd aspects the 5th, 8th and 9th from the Lagna, its 7th aspect from the 2nd lands exactly on the 8th. So Mars, the yogakaraka for Cancer (Chapter 8), stares straight at the whole stellium. That is the energy that pulls this quiet research mind into action. Jupiter in the 5th aspects the 9th, 11th and 1st: it does not reach the 8th.

CONSULTATION TIP: Never say "three planets in the 8th house" to a client without immediately translating it. The number frightens people; the meaning reassures them. "You have a strong pull towards research and hidden systems (insurance, investigation, the occult, deep technical work) and a long life to do it in" is the same fact, spoken as a human being.

The shadow planets and the partial aspects

Two honest footnotes. First, **Rahu and Ketu's aspects are not given in BPHS**. Many practitioners give them the 7th only; some give them Jupiter's 5–7–9 pattern, some Saturn's 3–7–10. Whichever you use, say so, and never build a delicate prediction on a nodal aspect alone. Second, the classics define **partial aspects** (three-quarters on the 5th and 9th, half on the 4th and 8th, a quarter on the 3rd and 10th) used in the strength calculations (*Shadbala*) software does for you. The beginner, and frankly the working astrologer, uses **full aspects only** and is right nineteen times in twenty.

WHY? *Astronomy, then tradition.* *Drishti* means sight, and sight needs an eye, a body. Rahu and Ketu are the two points where the Moon's path crosses the Sun's; there is nothing there to look out from, which is why Parashara gives them no gaze. Later authors, wanting the nodes to do *something* at a distance, lent them a pattern by analogy (Saturn's for Saturn-like Rahu, or Jupiter's) and that is why practitioners differ. *Everyday:* a CCTV camera watches a room; a rumour has no eyes, yet people behave as if watched. Which of the two the nodes are is the whole argument.

Worked example: every aspect in Chart A

Now let us do the whole thing on Meera's chart. Take the method slowly: for each planet, first the 7th from where it sits, then the special aspects if it is Mars, Jupiter or Saturn.

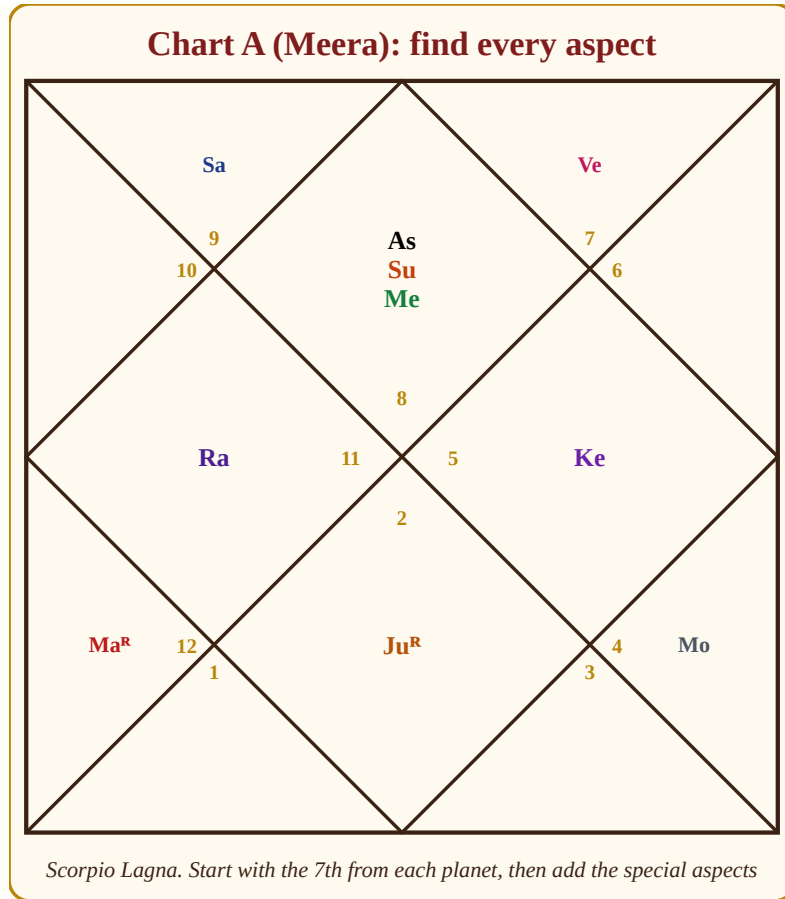


Figure 6.7: Chart A. Sun and Mercury in the 1st, Saturn in the 2nd, Rahu in the 4th, Mars in the 5th, Jupiter in the 7th, Moon in the 9th, Ketu in the 10th, Venus in the 12th.

	Planet (house)	Aspects house(s)	What stands there	Reading in one line
●	Sun (1st)	7th	Jupiter	Authority meets wisdom: the partner is respected, learned; Sun and Jupiter in mutual aspect
●	Mercury (1st)	7th	Jupiter	Intellect meets wisdom: a partner who is a teacher or advisor; mutual aspect
●	Saturn (2nd)	4th, 8th, 11th	Rahu in 4th; 8th and 11th empty	Serious about home and property (4th); patience in hidden matters (8th); gains slow but steady (11th)
●	Rahu (4th)	10th	Ketu	The nodes always face each other; an unconventional pull between home and career
●	Mars (5th)	8th, 11th, 12th	Venus in 12th; 8th and 11th empty	Energy into research (8th), competitive gains (11th); Mars heats Venus: passion, spending on comforts, travel
●	Jupiter (7th)	11th, 1st, 3rd	Sun and Mercury in 1st; 11th and 3rd empty	The great protector blesses the Lagna and its two planets; gains (11th) and courage (3rd) are guarded
●	Moon (9th)	3rd	Empty	The emotional mind reaches towards siblings, writing, short journeys
●	Ketu (10th)	4th	Rahu	Detachment in career facing obsession about home; the nodal axis
●	Venus (12th)	6th	Empty	Grace on the house of service and disputes: enemies soften, work is pleasant

Now the relationships. Sun and Jupiter aspect each other, a **mutual aspect** between the 10th lord (Sun, Leo) and the 2nd-and-5th lord (Jupiter). Mercury and Jupiter also aspect each other. In Chapter 10 you will recognise the first pair as a kendra lord joined with a trikona lord, a Raja yoga formed purely through sight. Mars aspects Venus but Venus does not aspect Mars, a one-way conversation: Mars pushes Venus, Venus does not push back. Saturn aspects Rahu one way. Nothing else connects.

Notice what the table *does not* show: no malefic aspects the Lagna. Saturn's 8th and 11th aspects fall on empty rooms. Jupiter's protective gaze falls on the Lagna with the Sun and Mercury in it. This is why, when Meera's difficult Sade Sati came around 2000–2007, it tested her without breaking her, her front door was guarded.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: After you have listed the aspects, look for the *unaspected* planet and the *most-aspected* house. The lonely planet acts on its own nature without interference. The crowded house is where life will keep happening.

In one breath

- An aspect is a planet's gaze: it pours its nature into a distant house or planet without moving there.
- Every planet fully aspects the 7th from itself; Mars adds the 4th and 8th, Jupiter the 5th and 9th, Saturn the 3rd and 10th. Count from the planet, never from the Lagna.
- Aspects on empty houses colour that house's affairs; aspects on planets change the planet's behaviour and everything it rules.
- Two planets are *connected* (Sambandha) by conjunction, mutual aspect, exchange of signs, or sitting in each other's signs. No connection, no yoga.
- Conjunctions are read by blending the two natures (● helpful, ○ difficult, ▲ mixed); dignity, closeness in degrees, and natural weight decide who dominates the room.
- Combustion weakens a planet too close to the Sun; planetary war (within 1°) weakens the loser; both are noted, not over-read.
- A crowded house means a busy department of life. Name the house, find the host, pair the planets, blend, then check who aspects the pile.
- Rahu/Ketu aspects and partial aspects are advanced and contested; the beginner uses full Parashari aspects only.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. Jupiter sits in the 3rd house. Which three houses does it aspect?
2. In Chart B (Figure 6.6), does Venus in the 7th aspect the Moon in the 11th? Does the Moon aspect Venus? Is there a Sambandha between them?
3. Chart C (Devika, Aries Lagna) has Mars in the 3rd and the Moon in the 9th. Are they in mutual aspect? What is the name of the yoga this forms?
4. Chart B's Mercury is at 2° Aquarius and the Sun at 18° Aquarius. Is Mercury combust? What if Mercury were at 10°?
5. Blend, in two sentences, a Moon-Saturn conjunction in the 4th house. Then say how you would phrase it to the client.

Answers

1. Counting the 3rd as 1: the 5th from it is the 7th house, the 7th from it is the 9th house, the 9th from it is the 11th house. Jupiter in the 3rd aspects the 7th, 9th and 11th. 2. Venus in the 7th aspects the 1st, not the 11th; the Moon in the 11th aspects the 5th. Neither looks at the other, they are not together, and only the Moon sits in Venus's sign (Taurus): Venus is in Saturn's Capricorn, not the Moon's. Only the weakest, fourth kind of link exists; most teachers would say there is no real Sambandha. 3. Yes. The 3rd and the 9th are 7 houses apart, so Mars aspects the Moon and the Moon aspects Mars. This mutual aspect forms the Chandra-Mangala yoga (Appendix A.11 allows "together or in mutual 7th"): earning drive and competitive energy. 4. $18^\circ - 2^\circ = 16^\circ$, which is more than Mercury's 14° orb, so Mercury is not combust. At 10° the gap would be 8° , inside the orb: Mercury would be combust and the Budha-Aditya yoga would be weakened. 5. Blend: the mind (Moon) sits with duty and delay (Saturn) in the house of home and mother; the person matures early, carries family responsibility young, and finds emotional comfort slowly and through discipline; the mother may have struggled or been distant. To the client: "You grew up responsible before your time, and home has been a place of duty more than ease. That same steadiness is your strength: comfort in your life is built, not given, and it lasts once built."

Chapter 7: The 27 Nakshatras: The Street Addresses of the Sky

When I open a chart and want to know *who* this person is (not what will happen, but what kind of person is asking) I do not look at the Sun sign. I do not even look first at the Lagna. I look at the Moon's **nakshatra**. The day this clicked for me, on my own chart, half the "why am I like this" questions of my twenties answered themselves; it is still the fastest personality key I know.

Here is why. A sign (Rashi) is 30° wide. The Moon spends two and a quarter days in it. Everyone born in that window shares a Moon sign, and they are recognisably alike, but only in the way people from the same city are alike. A nakshatra is 13°20' wide; the Moon spends about a day in it. That is the *street*. Two people from Cancer may be as different as two neighbourhoods of Mumbai; two people from Ashlesha are neighbours.

So: **sign = city, nakshatra = street, pada = house number**. This chapter gives you the whole street map.

The arithmetic in one paragraph

The zodiac is 360°. Divide by 27 and you get 13°20': that is one nakshatra (the Sanskrit is often translated "lunar mansion", because the Moon lodges in one each night). Each nakshatra is further cut into four **quarters** (*padas*) of 3°20' each. Twenty-seven times four is 108 padas around the sky, the same 108 as the beads on a japa mala, and not by accident. Each sign of 30° holds exactly nine padas: that is two and a quarter nakshatras. This means some nakshatras straddle two signs: Kritika begins in Aries and ends in Taurus; Punarvasu begins in Gemini and ends in Cancer. Keep Appendix A.7 open the first few times; the spans are all there.

The 27 Nakshatras and their Vimshottari lords

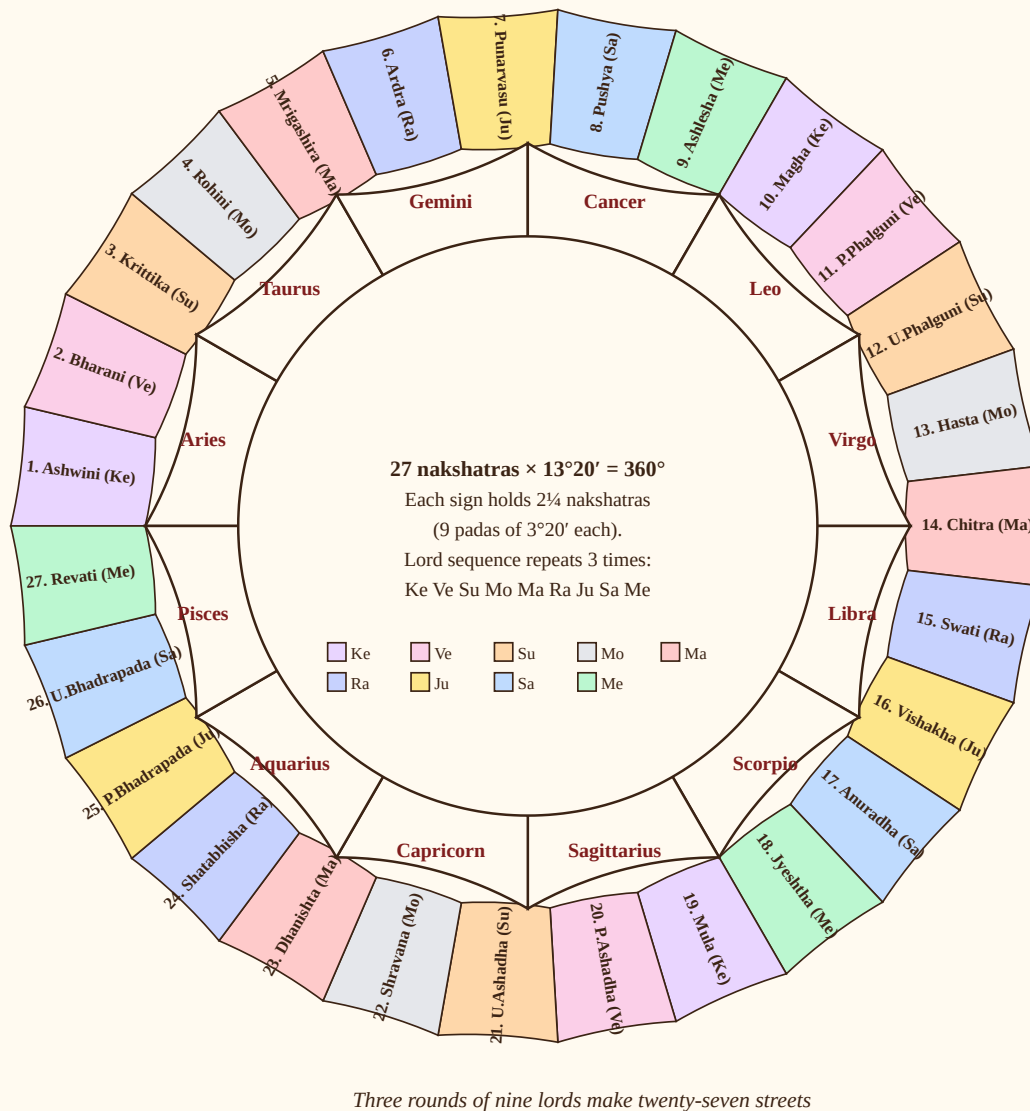


Figure 7.1: The 27 nakshatras around the 12 signs. Colours show the Vimshottari lord. Notice the same nine colours repeating three times around the wheel.

WHY 27? *Astronomy.* The Moon returns to the same background star every 27.3 days (the sidereal month), moving about 13° a night. Divide its path into one camp per night and you get twenty-seven: the nakshatras are literally the Moon's nightly halts, the oldest layer of Indian astronomy, older than the twelve signs. *Everyday:* a night bus that stops at the same twenty-seven villages every trip; the villagers named the stops long before anyone drew the district map.

WHY $13^{\circ}20'$ AND FOUR PADAS? *Arithmetic within the system.* $360^{\circ} \div 27 = 13^{\circ}20'$. Cut each into four and you get 108 padas of $3^{\circ}20'$, and $3^{\circ}20'$ is also $30^{\circ} \div 9$, one Navamsa slice, so 108 padas = 12 signs $\times$ 9 slices exactly. The two systems, lunar and solar, were made to interlock, which is why the pada tells you the Navamsa sign. *Everyday:* a train of 27 coaches with 4 compartments each is 108 berths; the same berths can be counted coach-by-coach or as 12 blocks of 9.

The three rounds of nine: finding any lord by counting

Each nakshatra has a **lord**, one of the nine planets, and this lord is what runs the whole Vimshottari dasha system in Chapter 13. The sequence is fixed and it repeats three times around the wheel:

Ketu, Venus, Sun, Moon, Mars, Rahu, Jupiter, Saturn, Mercury.

Ashwini (1) is Ketu's, Bharani (2) Venus's, Krittika (3) Sun's, and so on to Ashlesha (9), Mercury's. Then Magha (10) starts again with Ketu, and Mula (19) starts the third round with Ketu. So the three "Ketu starters" are Ashwini, Magha and Mula: the first nakshatras of Aries, Leo and Sagittarius, the three fire signs. That is your anchor.

To find any lord: take the nakshatra number, subtract 9 or 18 until you are between 1 and 9, then read off the sequence.

Shravana is number 22; $22 - 18 = 4$; the fourth lord is the Moon. Vishakha is 16; $16 - 9 = 7$; the seventh lord is Jupiter. After a week you will not need the arithmetic, the nine-name chant will simply run in your head.

STORY: NINE RELAY RUNNERS, THREE LAPS. Picture the zodiac as a running track of twenty-seven lanes-lengths, and nine runners from the court passing a baton. The Headless Sadhu, Ketu, always starts, he has nothing to carry, so he runs light. He hands to the Minister of Pleasure, Venus, who runs the longest leg (twenty years of dasha; she likes to linger). She hands to the King, who runs a short, proud six. The King hands to the Queen Mother, she to the Commander, he to the Smoke-headed Stranger (who runs a long, strange eighteen) then the Royal Priest, the old Judge (nineteen; he is slow), and last the young Prince, who sprints seventeen and hands back to the Sadhu. Nine runners, one lap. Then the same nine run the lap again, and again: three laps make twenty-seven. The Sadhu's three starting lines are Ashwini, Magha and Mula, the first streets of the three fire districts. **RULE:** Nakshatra lords run Ketu, Venus, Sun, Moon, Mars, Rahu, Jupiter, Saturn, Mercury, three times round; the lord of nakshatra n is the $((n - 1) \bmod 9) + 1$ -th runner.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Learn the nine lords as a chant, in order, before you learn anything else about nakshatras. Ke-Ve-Su-Mo-Ma-Ra-Ju-Sa-Me. It unlocks dasha, Tara Bala and marriage matching, all at once.

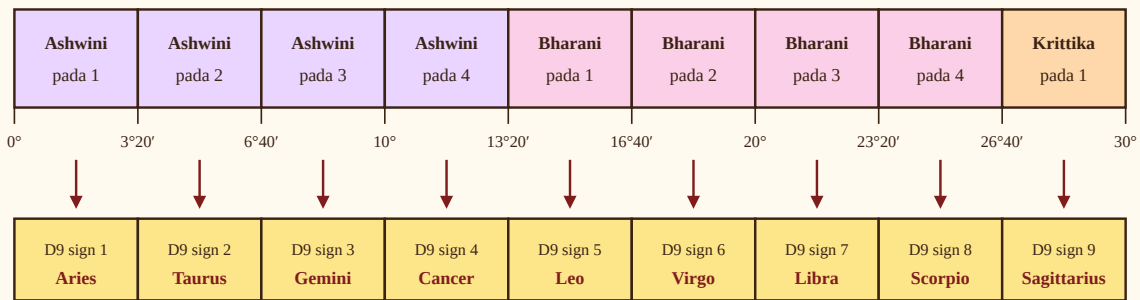
WHY THIS ORDER? Tradition, honestly. There is no astronomical reason the runners line up Ketu, Venus, Sun, Moon, Mars, Rahu, Jupiter, Saturn, Mercury; Parashara states the sequence and the years (7, 20, 6, 10, 7, 18, 16, 19, 17) without deriving them. The only inner logic anyone can point to is that the years total 120, the classical full human lifespan, and that Ketu leads from the first fire sign. Learn it as you learn a batting order (set by the captain, not by physics) and do not let anyone sell you a deeper reason. Everyday: the order of dishes at a wedding feast is fixed by custom; nobody can prove why the sweet comes last, but everyone knows it does.

Padas and the Navamsa: why the quarters matter

Each pada is $3^{\circ}20'$, and $3^{\circ}20'$ is also exactly one-ninth of a sign, which is the unit of the **Navamsa** (D9) chart, the most important divisional chart of all (Chapter 11). This is no coincidence: **each pada is one Navamsa sign**. The first pada of Ashwini is the Aries Navamsa, the second is Taurus, the third Gemini, the fourth Cancer; Bharani's four padas are Leo, Virgo, Libra, Scorpio; Krittika's first pada, still in Aries, is Sagittarius. Then Krittika's second pada, which is the first pada of Taurus, is Capricorn, which is exactly what the Navamsa rule in Appendix A.10 says (a fixed sign starts counting from the 9th sign from itself). Go all the way round and the 108 padas cover the 12 Navamsa signs nine times.

Aries, cut into nine padas: each pada is one Navamsa sign

The sign Aries, 0° to 30° (the whole bar is one Rasi sign)



Ashwini pada 1 = Aries Navamsa, pada 2 = Taurus ... Kritika pada 1 = Sagittarius.

Taurus continues the count: Kritika pada 2 = Capricorn (the 9th from Taurus, as the Navamsa rule says).

108 padas around the zodiac = 9 full rounds of the 12 Navamsa signs.

Figure 7.2: Aries cut into nine padas. Ashwini's four quarters and Bharani's four quarters, then Kritika's first, each is one Navamsa sign, Aries through Sagittarius.

Pada	Degrees of Aries	Nakshatra	Navamsa sign
1	0°00'–3°20'	Ashwini 1	Aries
2	3°20'–6°40'	Ashwini 2	Taurus
3	6°40'–10°00'	Ashwini 3	Gemini
4	10°00'–13°20'	Ashwini 4	Cancer
5	13°20'–16°40'	Bharani 1	Leo
6	16°40'–20°00'	Bharani 2	Virgo
7	20°00'–23°20'	Bharani 3	Libra
8	23°20'–26°40'	Bharani 4	Scorpio
9	26°40'–30°00'	Kritika 1	Sagittarius

So the pada tells you *which flavour* of the nakshatra a planet expresses. A Moon in Ashwini pada 1 (Aries Navamsa) is the pioneer; in pada 4 (Cancer Navamsa) the healer who nurses. When you know the pada, you already know half the Navamsa chart.

STORY: FOUR ROOMS ON ONE STREET. Every street in the kingdom, every nakshatra, has exactly four houses on it, and the houses are numbered round the whole kingdom without a break. Walk down Ashwini Street: house 1 is painted in Aries red, house 2 in Taurus earth, house 3 in Gemini's airy blue, house 4 in Cancer's water-purple. Turn into Bharani Street and the numbering simply continues (Leo, Virgo, Libra, Scorpio) and Kritika Street begins with Sagittarius. After twelve houses the painters run out of colours and start again from Aries red. Walk all 108 houses and you will have passed each of the twelve colours nine times. The colour of the house is the Navamsa sign. **Rule:** Each pada is one Navamsa sign; count padas from Ashwini pada 1 = Aries and cycle through the twelve signs.

The twenty-seven streets

Below is one compact profile for each nakshatra. Read them slowly, and then read the profile of *your own* Moon and see whether your family would recognise you. Spans, lords, deities, symbols and ganas are exactly as in Appendix A.7. The **Gana** (temperament) is Deva (godly, refined), Manushya (human, practical) or Rakshasa (fierce, intense). The colours below are the marriage-matching convention (Deva with Deva is easiest, Rakshasa with Deva the hardest to blend), a code for compatibility, not a verdict on anyone's character.

Gana	Nakshatras
● Deva (refined, gentle)	Ashwini, Mrigashira, Punarvasu, Pushya, Hasta, Swati, Anuradha, Shravana, Revati
● Manushya (human, practical)	Bharani, Rohini, Ardra, Purva Phalguni, Uttara Phalguni, Purva Ashadha, Uttara Ashadha, Purva Bhadrapada, Uttara Bhadrapada
○ Rakshasa (fierce, intense)	Krittika, Ashlesha, Magha, Chitra, Vishakha, Jyeshtha, Mula, Dhanishta, Shatabhisha

1. Ashwini. 0°00'–13°20' Aries · Lord Ketu (7 yrs) · Deity the Ashwini Kumaras, the divine physicians · Symbol a horse's head · Gana Deva. *Theme:* speed, healing, first arrivals. *Moon here:* quick, impatient, kind in a brisk way, always first to help and first to leave. *Often seen:* doctors, paramedics, athletes, couriers, anyone whose value is in being fast.

2. Bharani. 13°20'–26°40' Aries · Lord Venus (20) · Deity Yama · Symbol the yoni (womb) · Gana Manushya. *Theme:* bearing burdens; birth and death; carrying what others cannot. *Moon here:* strong-willed, sensual, fiercely responsible, sometimes judgmental. *Often seen:* midwives, gynaecologists, undertakers, publishers, those who bring things into the world or see them out.

3. Krittika. 26°40' Aries–10°00' Taurus · Lord Sun (6) · Deity Agni · Symbol a razor, a flame · Gana Rakshasa. *Theme:* sharpness, purification by fire. *Moon here:* a cutting intellect, protective of dependants, a warm heart under a sharp tongue. *Often seen:* chefs, critics, surgeons, quality inspectors, disciplinarian teachers. Chart B's Moon is here.

4. Rohini. 10°00'–23°20' Taurus · Lord Moon (10) · Deity Brahma / Prajapati · Symbol an ox-cart, a chariot · Gana Manushya. *Theme:* growth, beauty, fertility, the Moon's own favourite. *Moon here:* magnetic, artistic, fond of good things, loyal, occasionally possessive. *Often seen:* musicians, farmers, fashion and food, anyone who makes things grow or glow.

5. Mrigashira. 23°20' Taurus–6°40' Gemini · Lord Mars (7) · Deity Soma · Symbol a deer's head · Gana Deva. *Theme:* searching, curiosity, the eternal seeker. *Moon here:* restless, inquisitive, gentle, easily bored; the eyes are always scanning. *Often seen:* researchers, travellers, salespeople, poets; the friend who knows a new place every month.

6. Ardra. 6°40'–20°00' Gemini · Lord Rahu (18) · Deity Rudra · Symbol a teardrop, a gem · Gana Manushya. *Theme:* storms that clear the air; effort; breakthrough after breakdown. *Moon here:* intense feeling under a clever surface; grows through loss; brilliant analyst. *Often seen:* engineers, investigators, therapists, storm-chasers of every kind.

7. Punarvasu. 20°00' Gemini–3°20' Cancer · Lord Jupiter (16) · Deity Aditi · Symbol a bow and quiver · Gana Deva. *Theme:* return of the light; renewal; the arrow that comes home. *Moon here:* optimistic, philosophical, forgiving, content with little, bounces back. *Often seen:* teachers, priests, counsellors, the family member everyone returns to.

8. Pushya. 3°20'–16°40' Cancer · Lord Saturn (19) · Deity Brihaspati · Symbol a cow's udder, a lotus · Gana Deva. *Theme:* nourishment; the most auspicious of all. *Moon here:* caring, conservative, dutiful, a provider; protects family and tradition. *Often seen:* nurses, caterers, bankers, administrators, the mother of the whole street.

9. Ashlesha. 16°40'–30°00' Cancer · Lord Mercury (17) · Deity the Nagas (serpents) · Symbol a coiled serpent · Gana Rakshasa. *Theme:* clinging, hypnotic, shrewd, the coil that holds. *Moon here:* perceptive, persuasive, emotionally deep, slow to

trust and slower to release. *Often seen:* psychologists, negotiators, politicians, hypnotists, astrologers. Chart A's Moon is here.

10. Magha. 0°00'–13°20' Leo · Lord Ketu (7) · Deity the Pitris (ancestors) · Symbol a throne, a palanquin · Gana Rakshasa. *Theme:* lineage, authority inherited from the past. *Moon here:* proud, generous, traditional, loyal to family name; dislikes being ordered about. *Often seen:* heads of families, historians, civil servants, those who carry a title.

11. Purva Phalguni. 13°20'–26°40' Leo · Lord Venus (20) · Deity Bhaga · Symbol the front legs of a bed · Gana Manushya. *Theme:* pleasure, creativity, rest, the joy of being alive. *Moon here:* charming, romantic, fond of comfort and company, creative when relaxed. *Often seen:* performers, event planners, hoteliers, artists, the life of every wedding.

12. Uttara Phalguni. 26°40' Leo–10°00' Virgo · Lord Sun (6) · Deity Aryaman · Symbol the back legs of a bed · Gana Manushya. *Theme:* contracts, friendship, patronage; pleasure made responsible. *Moon here:* helpful, principled, a reliable friend, sometimes stubborn about "the right way". *Often seen:* lawyers, HR heads, social workers, philanthropists.

13. Hasta. 10°00'–23°20' Virgo · Lord Moon (10) · Deity Savitar · Symbol a hand · Gana Deva. *Theme:* skill, craft, humour, what the hand can do. *Moon here:* witty, dexterous, practical, a fixer; hides worry under jokes. *Often seen:* craftsmen, surgeons, artisans, comedians, palmists, anyone whose hands are their living.

14. Chitra. 23°20' Virgo–6°40' Libra · Lord Mars (7) · Deity Tvashtar / Vishwakarma, the divine architect · Symbol a pearl, a bright jewel · Gana Rakshasa. *Theme:* design, architecture, glamour. *Moon here:* stylish, visual, ambitious, a builder of beautiful things; can be vain. *Often seen:* architects, designers, jewellers, film-makers, surgeons of the cosmetic kind.

15. Swati. 6°40'–20°00' Libra · Lord Rahu (18) · Deity Vayu · Symbol a young sprout swaying in the wind · Gana Deva. *Theme:* independence, trade, bending without breaking. *Moon here:* diplomatic, adaptable, freedom-loving, a natural trader; avoids commitment until sure. *Often seen:* merchants, diplomats, brokers, musicians, travellers.

16. Vishakha. 20°00' Libra–3°20' Scorpio · Lord Jupiter (16) · Deity Indra-Agni · Symbol a triumphal arch, a potter's wheel · Gana Rakshasa. *Theme:* goal focus, ambition; the arch you march through. *Moon here:* determined, competitive, patient towards one big aim; jealous of rivals. *Often seen:* politicians, entrepreneurs, sportspeople, anyone who plays the long game to win.

17. Anuradha. 3°20'–16°40' Scorpio · Lord Saturn (19) · Deity Mitra · Symbol a lotus, an archway · Gana Deva. *Theme:* devotion, friendship in hardship, the lotus in mud. *Moon here:* loyal, organised, warm to friends, hurt by betrayal, thrives abroad. *Often seen:* team leaders, organisers, devotees, expatriates, group therapists.

18. Jyeshtha. 16°40'–30°00' Scorpio · Lord Mercury (17) · Deity Indra · Symbol an earring, an umbrella, a talisman · Gana Rakshasa. *Theme:* seniority, protection, the eldest's burden. *Moon here:* responsible, proud, protective, secretive; carries others and resents it quietly. *Often seen:* eldest siblings who run the family, police and army officers, senior managers, occultists.

19. Mula. 0°00'–13°20' Sagittarius · Lord Ketu (7) · Deity Nirriti · Symbol a bundle of roots, a lion's tail · Gana Rakshasa. *Theme:* uprooting, going to the root, research. *Moon here:* fearless, blunt, philosophical, destroys to rebuild; restless in the first half of life. *Often seen:* researchers, surgeons, investigators, reformers, root-cause analysts.

20. Purva Ashadha. 13°20'–26°40' Sagittarius · Lord Venus (20) · Deity Apas (the waters) · Symbol a fan, a winnowing basket, a tusk · Gana Manushya. *Theme:* invincibility, purification, the early victory. *Moon here:* confident, persuasive, proud of convictions, inspiring, a little unwilling to hear "no". *Often seen:* orators, lawyers, motivational teachers, water and shipping trades. Chart C's Moon is here.

21. Uttara Ashadha. 26°40' Sagittarius–10°00' Capricorn · Lord Sun (6) · Deity the Vishwadevas · Symbol an elephant tusk, the planks of a bed · Gana Manushya. *Theme:* final victory, leadership that lasts. *Moon here:* principled, patient, respected, slow to start and impossible to stop. *Often seen:* administrators, judges, statesmen, chief engineers, elders people go to for the last word.

- 22. Shravana.** 10°00'–23°20' Capricorn · Lord Moon (10) · Deity Vishnu · Symbol an ear, three footprints · Gana Deva. *Theme:* listening, learning, fame through knowledge. *Moon here:* a great listener, well-read, a connector of people, quietly ambitious. *Often seen:* teachers, translators, counsellors, broadcasters, librarians of every kind.
- 23. Dhanishta.** 23°20' Capricorn–6°40' Aquarius · Lord Mars (7) · Deity the eight Vasus · Symbol a drum, a flute · Gana Rakshasa. *Theme:* wealth, rhythm, music. *Moon here:* ambitious, rhythmic, generous with money, fond of group activity; may feel lonely in marriage. *Often seen:* musicians, property developers, financiers, team sportspeople.
- 24. Shatabhisha.** 6°40'–20°00' Aquarius · Lord Rahu (18) · Deity Varuna · Symbol an empty circle, a hundred flowers or healers · Gana Rakshasa. *Theme:* healing, secrecy, science. *Moon here:* private, analytical, unconventional, a reluctant healer of others; needs solitude. *Often seen:* physicians, researchers, astrologers, engineers, the quiet genius in the corner.
- 25. Purva Bhadrapada.** 20°00' Aquarius–3°20' Pisces · Lord Jupiter (16) · Deity Aja Ekapada · Symbol a sword, the front legs of a funeral cot · Gana Manushya. *Theme:* intensity, penance, transformation through fire. *Moon here:* passionate, idealistic, philosophical, given to extremes; a reformer's heart. *Often seen:* priests, activists, occultists, thriller writers, those who burn for a cause.
- 26. Uttara Bhadrapada.** 3°20'–16°40' Pisces · Lord Saturn (19) · Deity Ahir Budhnya · Symbol the back legs of a funeral cot, the serpent of the deep · Gana Manushya. *Theme:* depth, wisdom, patience; still water. *Moon here:* calm, kind, wise beyond years, slow to anger, a natural counsellor. *Often seen:* teachers, monks, charity workers, deep-sea and deep-mind professions.
- 27. Revati.** 16°40'–30°00' Pisces · Lord Mercury (17) · Deity Pushan · Symbol a fish, a drum · Gana Deva. *Theme:* nourishing journeys, completion, safe passage. *Moon here:* sweet-natured, protective, artistic, a guide for the lost; over-gives. *Often seen:* travel and hospitality, childcare, veterinarians, astrologers, those who see people safely home.

The Moon's nakshatra: your personality key

The Moon's nakshatra at birth is the **birth star** (*Janma nakshatra*), and it is the one thing to find in every chart before anything else, because three things hang on it: the starting dasha (Chapter 13), the Tara Bala (below), and, most useful in conversation, the *feel* of the person.

Here is how it works in conversation. Reading for a friend with an Ashlesha Moon, I did not say "your Moon is in Ashlesha". I said, "You read people very quickly and hold on to what you love, sometimes a little too tightly. Am I right?" She laughed, relaxed, and trusted the rest of the reading. The nakshatra profile gives you that opening sentence. Then the *pada* tells you the flavour: Ashlesha pada 2 is the Capricorn Navamsa, so Meera's perceptiveness is disciplined and career-directed, not merely emotional.

WHY THE MOON'S STAR? *System grammar.* The Moon is the mind (Chapter 3), and a nakshatra is the Moon's own unit, its street, one per night. The Sun sign is shared by everyone born in a month, the Moon sign by everyone born in two and a quarter days, but the Moon's nakshatra narrows to a single day and the pada to six hours. The finest-grained lunar address is the finest key to the lunar thing, the mind. *Everyday:* a pincode tells you the city; the lane number tells you which house serves which kind of chai.

Two more nakshatras deserve a glance in every chart. The **Lagna's nakshatra** describes the body and the outward manner, the coat the person wears into the room. And the **nakshatra of the current dasha lord** tells you the mood of the current period: a Venus dasha with Venus in Rohini feels very different from one with Venus in Ardra.

CONSULTATION TIP: Use the nakshatra profile as a *question*, never a *verdict*. "You seem to be the one in the family who carries everyone, does that feel true?" invites the client in. "Your Moon is in Jyeshtha so you are burdened" pushes them away and, worse, may be wrong for this particular chart.

Worked example: our three Moons

Chart A (Meera). Moon at 21° Cancer. Ashlesha runs from 16°40' to 30°00' Cancer; its padas are 16°40'–20°00' (pada 1), 20°00'–23°20' (pada 2), 23°20'–26°40' (pada 3), 26°40'–30°00' (pada 4). The Moon at 21° is in **pada 2**. Lord: Mercury (Ashlesha is the 9th nakshatra, the last of the first round). So her first dasha was Mercury's, and the balance at birth was the unfinished part of the star: $30^\circ - 21^\circ = 9^\circ$ of 13°20': that is $9 \div 13.33 \times 17 \text{ years} \approx 11.5 \text{ years}$. Pada 2 is the Capricorn Navamsa. A shrewd, persuasive, deep-feeling mind, disciplined in expression, a natural teacher-counsellor. Her Moon is *not* in the Gandanta strip, which begins at 26°40'.

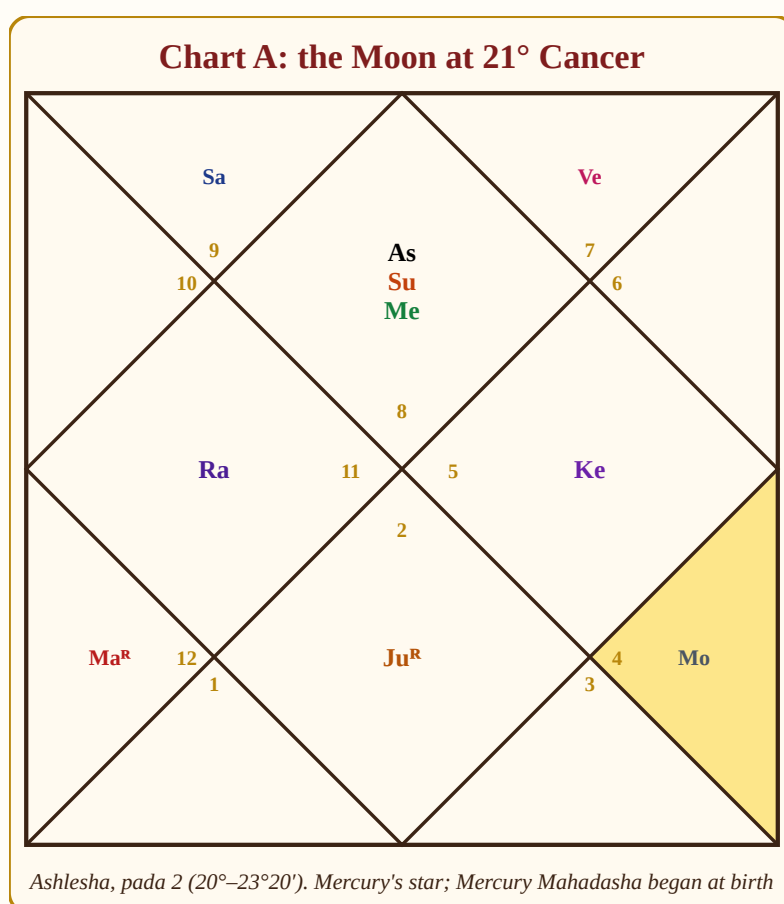


Figure 7.3: Chart A. The Moon at 21° Cancer sits in Ashlesha pada 2, Mercury's star, safely short of the Gandanta zone.

Chart B (Arjun). Moon at 6° Taurus. Kritika runs from 26°40' Aries to 10°00' Taurus; its padas are 26°40'–30°00' Aries (pada 1), 0°00'–3°20' Taurus (pada 2), 3°20'–6°40' Taurus (pada 3), 6°40'–10°00' Taurus (pada 4). At 6° the Moon is in **pada 3**, the Aquarius Navamsa. Lord: the Sun, so the Sun's dasha ran first, with a balance of $(10^\circ - 6^\circ) \div 13.33 \times 6 \approx 1.8 \text{ years}$. A sharp, protective mind with a scientific, unconventional flavour, which fits the research-minded 8th house we unpacked in Chapter 6.

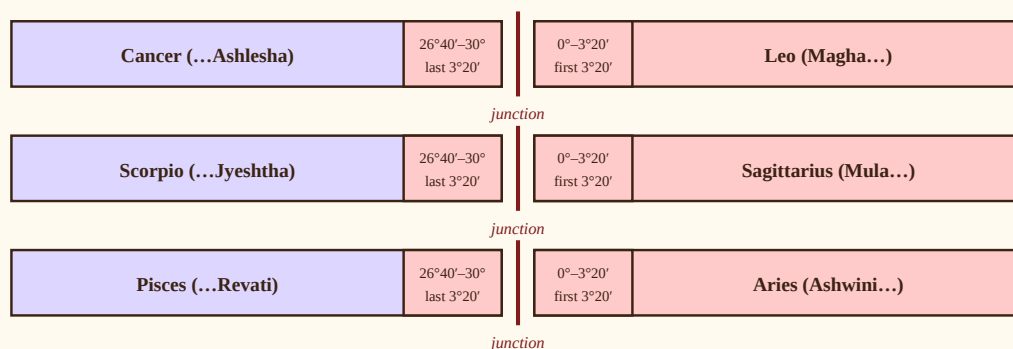
Chart C (Devika). Moon at 14° Sagittarius. Purva Ashadha runs from 13°20' to 26°40'; the Moon at 14° is in **pada 1** (13°20'–16°40'), the Leo Navamsa. Lord: Venus (the 20th nakshatra; $20 - 18 = 2$, the second lord). Venus dasha at birth, with a long balance of about 19 years. Confident, persuasive, proud of her convictions, with a royal Leo flavour: the orator's Moon.

The three knots: Gandanta

Three times around the zodiac a water sign ends and a fire sign begins: Cancer into Leo, Scorpio into Sagittarius, Pisces into Aries. At each join, the last 3°20' of the water nakshatra (Ashlesha, Jyeshtha, Revati (all Mercury's) and the first 3°20' of the fire nakshatra (Magha, Mula, Ashwini) all Ketu's) form a sensitive zone called **Gandanta** (the "knot's end"). The classics ask us to check the Moon and the Lagna here; a Moon in the knot is said to give an emotionally turbulent start to life and a certain rawness of feeling, and the tradition prescribes a simple pacifying ritual. Some texts also flag the tithi and nakshatra junctions, but the degree-based zone above is the one everyone uses.

WHY IS THE KNOT SENSITIVE? *Symbolic logic of the system.* Three times the zodiac passes from a water sign (emotion, dissolving) straight into a fire sign (action, igniting) with no earth or air between, and at each join the last street belongs to Mercury and the first to Ketu, the two planets of the least emotional stability. One element ends and its opposite begins in the same breath; the tradition reads a birth exactly there as a life that starts mid-transition. There is no astronomy in this: it is the grammar of the elements. *Everyday:* changing trains at a junction with all your luggage in the two minutes before the connecting train leaves.

Gandanta: the three knots where water meets fire



A water sign ends in Mercury's star; a fire sign begins in Ketu's star. The 6°40' strip across the join is Gandanta. Check the Moon and Lagna here. Chart A's Moon at 21° Cancer is in Ashlesha but NOT in the knot (it starts at 26°40').

Figure 7.4: The three knots. Each is a 6°40' strip straddling the end of a water sign and the start of a fire sign.

STORY: THE FORD BETWEEN TWO RIVERS. Three times in the kingdom a water district ends and a fire district begins, and there is no bridge, only a ford. On the water bank the last street belongs to the young Prince, Mercury (Ashlesha, Jyeshtha, Revati); on the fire bank the first street belongs to the Headless Sadhu, Ketu (Magha, Mula, Ashwini). A traveller born while crossing the ford, the Queen Mother's carriage in the last 3°20' of the water street or the first 3°20' of the fire street, gets her feet wet: a turbulent start, feelings that run raw. But every pilgrim who reaches the far bank has crossed something the people on either shore never had to. **Rule:** Gandanta is the last 3°20' of Ashlesha, Jyeshtha, Revati and the first 3°20' of Magha, Mula, Ashwini; check the Moon and Lagna there and speak of intensity, not doom.

What to say to a client born with the Moon in a knot: "Your emotional life began with intensity, and you may feel things more rawly than others: that same intensity is also your depth." What *not* to say: anything about danger to parents, early death, or "dosha" as a curse. The Gandanta Moons I have come across belong to people of unusual depth who had a bumpy first few years; the knot marks a transition, not a sentence. A brief note: Chart C's Mercury at 1° Leo sits in the Magha knot; for a planet other than the Moon or Lagna most teachers simply note this and move on.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Calling every planet in Ashlesha, Jyeshtha, Revati, Magha, Mula or Ashwini "Gandanta". The knot is only the 3°20' on either side of the join. Meera's Moon at 21° Cancer is in Ashlesha and nowhere near it.

An advanced pointer: Pushkara

While you are learning padas, know that certain padas and certain degrees are called **Pushkara**, "nourishing", and are held to bless whatever planet sits in them: the Pushkara *navamsa* padas (two in each sign) and the Pushkara *bhaga* degrees (one in each sign). This is a refinement you will enjoy in a year or two; I mention it now only so that when you meet the word you will know it is a good one.

Tara Bala: is today my day?

The **Tara Bala** ("strength of the star") is the oldest everyday use of the nakshatras, and it is beautifully simple. Count from your birth star to the star the Moon is in today, both included. Divide by nine and keep the remainder. The remainder names the day's quality:

Count	Tara	Meaning	Use
1	Janma	birth	● mixed; care for health, avoid big risks
2	Sampat	wealth	● good
3	Vipat	danger	○ avoid starting things
4	Kshema	well-being	● good
5	Pratyari	obstacle	○ avoid
6	Sadhaka	achievement	● good
7	Vadha	harm	○ avoid
8	Mitra	friend	● good
9 (or 0)	Ati-Mitra	great friend	● good

WHY COUNT IN NINES? *System grammar.* Twenty-seven is three nines, and the nakshatra lords already repeat every nine; so the ninth star from yours has the same lord as yours and the same "place in the lap". Counting in nines simply asks: at which of the nine stages of the cycle is today's Moon relative to my birth? The names (birth, wealth, danger, well-being, obstacle, achievement, harm, friend, great friend) are the tradition's reading of those nine stages. *Everyday:* a nine-day duty roster: the same shift comes back every ninth day, whatever the date.

Tara Bala: the nine-fold count from your birth star

1 Janma birth <i>mixed</i>	2 Sampat wealth <i>good</i>	3 Vipat danger <i>avoid</i>	4 Kshema well-being <i>good</i>	5 Pratyari obstacle <i>avoid</i>	6 Sadhaka achievement <i>good</i>	7 Vadha harm <i>avoid</i>	8 Mitra friend <i>good</i>	9 Ati-Mitra great friend <i>good</i>
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Count from the birth nakshatra to the day's nakshatra (both included).

If the count exceeds 9, subtract 9 (or 18). The remainder is the Tara; remainder 0 means the 9th, Ati-Mitra.

Worked example (Chart A, Moon in Ashlesha, star 9):

Day's Moon in Hasta (star 13): count $9 \rightarrow 13 = 5 \rightarrow$ Pratyari (obstacle). Wait a day.

Day's Moon in Chitra (star 14): count $9 \rightarrow 14 = 6 \rightarrow$ Sadhaka (achievement). Go ahead.

Green = favourable · Red = avoid for new beginnings · Grey = neutral, take care of health

Figure 7.5: The nine-fold count. Green days favour new beginnings; red days are for routine work; the birth star itself is a day to rest.

STORY: THE NINE GATES. From your birth street to any other street in the kingdom you must pass through gates, and the gates repeat in a cycle of nine. The first gate is your own front door (Janma, stay home, rest). The second opens onto the treasury (Sampat). The third is guarded by a suspicious sentry (Vipat, turn back). The fourth is the garden gate (Kshema). The fifth is where the rival's men wait (Pratyari, turn back). The sixth is the gate of the workshop where things get finished (Sadhaka). The seventh is the executioner's gate (Vadha, turn back). The eighth is your friend's door (Mitra) and the ninth your best friend's (Ati-Mitra). Then the cycle begins again at your own door. **Rule:** Count from birth star to today's star, both included, subtract nines; 2, 4, 6, 8, 9 are open gates, 3, 5, 7 are closed, 1 is home.

Worked example. Meera's birth star is Ashlesha, number 9. Suppose she wants to sign a lease on a day when the Moon is in Hasta, number 13. Count 9, 10, 11, 12, 13: that is 5. Remainder 5 is Pratyari, obstacle: sign tomorrow instead. Tomorrow the Moon is in Chitra, 14. The count is 6, Sadhaka, achievement: a fine day. When the count runs over 9 (say her birth star is 9 and the Moon is in Revati, 27) count 19, subtract 18, get 1: Janma, a day to rest. The same nine-fold count between two people's birth stars is the *Tara koota* in marriage matching (Appendix A.12).

Naming a child by the star

You have seen this in every Indian family: the priest opens the almanac and says "the name should begin with *Du*". He is reading the **birth-star syllables**, each of the 108 padas has a traditional opening sound, so that the child's name vibrates with the Moon's position. The full table is in every panchanga; here is a working version for the 27 stars, pada by pada.

Nakshatra	Pada 1	Pada 2	Pada 3	Pada 4
Ashwini	Chu	Che	Cho	La
Bharani	Li	Lu	Le	Lo
Krittika	A	I	U	E
Rohini	O	Va	Vi	Vu
Mrigashira	Ve	Vo	Ka	Ki
Ardra	Ku	Gha	Ng	Chha
Punarvasu	Ke	Ko	Ha	Hi
Pushya	Hu	He	Ho	Da
Ashlesha	Di	Du	De	Do
Magha	Ma	Mi	Mu	Me
Purva Phalguni	Mo	Ta	Ti	Tu
Uttara Phalguni	Te	To	Pa	Pi
Hasta	Pu	Sha	Na	Tha
Chitra	Pe	Po	Ra	Ri
Swati	Ru	Re	Ro	Ta
Vishakha	Ti	Tu	Te	To
Anuradha	Na	Ni	Nu	Ne
Jyeshtha	No	Ya	Yi	Yu
Mula	Ye	Yo	Bha	Bhi
Purva Ashadha	Bhu	Dha	Pha	Dha
Uttara Ashadha	Bhe	Bho	Ja	Ji
Shravana	Ju (Khi)	Je (Khu)	Jo (Khe)	Gha (Kho)
Dhanishta	Ga	Gi	Gu	Ge
Shatabhisha	Go	Sa	Si	Su
Purva Bhadrapada	Se	So	Da	Di
Uttara Bhadrapada	Du	Tha	Jha	Na (Da)
Revati	De	Do	Cha	Chi

Meera, Ashlesha pada 2, would have been given a name beginning with *Du*, many families keep this as a private "star name" (*rashi naam*) and use another in public. Arjun, Krittika pada 3, gets *U*; Devika, Purva Ashadha pada 1, gets *Bhu*. Regional almanacs vary a syllable here and there; follow the one the family uses.

Abhijit, the twenty-eighth

The old texts speak of a 28th nakshatra, **Abhijit** ("victorious"), squeezed between Uttara Ashadha and Shravana (the last quarter of Uttara Ashadha and the opening degrees of Shravana, in early Capricorn (about 4 ghatas, or 0°53', of Shravana) almanacs differ slightly). It is used in **muhurta**, choosing auspicious times, where it is prized, and never in *dasha*, which uses only the 27. It is also the name of the daily *Abhijit muhurta*, the auspicious 48 minutes around local noon, the one slot in almost every day when something can be begun.

Three stories worth knowing

DID YOU KNOW? The Moon, in the Puranas, married all twenty-seven daughters of Daksha, the nakshatras, but loved only Rohini and neglected the rest. The furious father-in-law cursed him to waste away; Shiva softened the curse so that he wanes for a fortnight and waxes again. That is why Rohini is the Moon's exaltation neighbourhood (his deepest point is 3° Taurus, Kritika, but his happiness is Rohini), and why the Moon is at his most comfortable and creative there.

DID YOU KNOW? Pushya is called the most auspicious nakshatra for nearly every undertaking, the ancients said "in Pushya, even a task begun by a fool succeeds." The single exception in every almanac is marriage: no weddings in Pushya, because the deity Brihaspati is said to have been cursed in a domestic matter. Every other beginning (a shop, a study, a journey, a purchase of gold) is welcomed.

DID YOU KNOW? Folk tradition in north India fears six "gandmool" stars (Ashwini, Ashlesha, Magha, Jyeshtha, Mula and Revati, the six ruled by Ketu and Mercury) and a child born under them is taken for a *Mula-shanti* ritual on the 27th day. The classical position is narrower and kinder: only the actual junction degrees (the Gandanta zones above) are sensitive, and even there the concern is the Moon and the Lagna, not every planet. Millions of perfectly happy people have Moons in Magha or Mula. If a family is anxious, let them do the ritual (it does no harm and settles the heart) but never let the fear into your reading.

In one breath

- A nakshatra is 13°20' of the zodiac, one day's walk for the Moon; sign = city, nakshatra = street, pada = house number.
- Twenty-seven nakshatras, four padas each, 108 padas in all; each pada is one Navamsa sign.
- The nine lords repeat three times in the fixed order Ketu, Venus, Sun, Moon, Mars, Rahu, Jupiter, Saturn, Mercury; Ashwini, Magha and Mula begin the three rounds.
- The Moon's nakshatra (Janma nakshatra) is the best single personality key and sets the starting *dasha*; also read the Lagna's and the *dasha* lord's stars.
- Gandanta is the 3°20' on each side of the three water-fire joins; check the Moon and Lagna there and speak of intensity, never doom.
- Tara Bala: count from birth star to today's star, divide by nine; 2, 4, 6, 8, 9 are favourable, 3, 5, 7 are not, 1 is a rest day.
- Each pada has a name-syllable; Abhijit is a 28th star used only in *muhurta*; Pushya is the most auspicious, except for weddings.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. Without looking at the table, name the lord of Dhanishta (number 23) by counting.
2. A Moon at 25° Leo: which nakshatra, which pada, and which Navamsa sign?
3. Is a Moon at 28° Scorpio in Gandanta? What about a Moon at 18° Scorpio?
4. Arjun's birth star is Kritika (3). Today the Moon is in Anuradha (17). Is today a good day for him to start a new job?
5. Devika (Chart C) is expecting a child and asks which syllable the baby's name should begin with if the baby's Moon falls in Hasta pada 2. Answer her, and explain in one line how you found it.

Answers

1. $23 - 18 = 5$. The fifth lord in the chant Ke-Ve-Su-Mo-Ma is Mars. Dhanishta is ruled by Mars. 2. Leo runs 0°–30°. Magha is 0°–13°20', Purva Phalguni 13°20'–26°40', so 25° is in Purva Phalguni. Its padas: 13°20'–16°40', 16°40'–20°, 20°–23°20', 23°20'–26°40'; 25° is pada 4. Navamsa: Purva Phalguni is nakshatra 11, pada 4, so the overall pada number is $10 \times 4 + 4 = 44$; $44 - 36 = 8$, the 8th sign, Scorpio. (Check with the A.10 rule: Leo is fixed, so counting starts from the 9th sign from Leo, Aries; 25° is the 8th navamsa, and the 8th from Aries is Scorpio.) 3. 28° Scorpio is in the last 3°20' of Jyeshtha (26°40'–30°), so yes, Gandanta. 18° Scorpio is in Jyeshtha but well short of the knot: not Gandanta. 4. Count from Kritika (3) to Anuradha (17), both included: 15. Subtract 9: 6. Sadhaka, achievement. A favourable day. 5. Hasta pada 2 gives the syllable *Sha*. Found by locating Hasta in the syllable table and reading the second column.

Chapter 8: Which Planets Are Good FOR YOU: Functional Benefics and Malefics

If I had to name the one chapter that separates people who *know about* astrology from people who can *read a chart*, it is this one. When I was learning, I could recite all twenty-seven nakshatras with their deities and still could not say whether Saturn was a friend or an enemy in the chart in front of me. I knew Saturn was "a malefic". I did not know that for the friend whose chart I was reading, a Libra, Saturn was the best planet she had.

The idea is simple once said. Every planet has a **natural** nature (Jupiter is kind, Saturn is harsh) the way every person has a temperament. But in *your* chart, every planet also has a **job**: it owns two houses (the Sun and Moon own one each), and it works for those houses. A planet's **functional** nature is whether the houses it owns are good houses or difficult ones *for your Lagna*. A naturally harsh planet that owns your best houses is a strict uncle who is on your side. A naturally sweet planet that owns your worst houses is a charming cousin who keeps borrowing money.

Saturn for a Libra: the strict uncle who is on your side

Take a Libra Lagna. Libra is the 1st house; count round: Scorpio 2nd, Sagittarius 3rd, **Capricorn 4th, Aquarius 5th**, Pisces 6th, Aries 7th, Taurus 8th, Gemini 9th, Cancer 10th, Leo 11th, Virgo 12th. Saturn owns Capricorn and Aquarius, the 4th and the 5th. The 4th is a pillar house (*kendra*): home, mother, comfort, education. The 5th is a trine (*trikona*): children, intelligence, merit. Saturn, the planet of discipline and time, has been given charge of this person's home and their intelligence. It will deliver both: slowly, seriously, permanently. For a Libra, Saturn's periods are the years when the house is bought and the qualification earned.

Meanwhile Jupiter, the great natural benefic, owns Sagittarius and Pisces for this Libra: the 3rd and the 6th. Effort, siblings, rivals, disputes, debts, illness. Jupiter is still generous by nature, but its generosity is now spent on *those* departments. A Libra in a Jupiter period may find themselves generous to a fault with enemies and expansive in expenses. Jupiter has not become evil. It has become an employee of the wrong houses.

STORY: THE STRICT UNCLE WHO IS ON YOUR SIDE. *In every joint family there is one uncle the children fear: the one who checks homework, switches off the television at nine, and never gives sweets. In the Libra household that uncle, navy Saturn, has been made guardian of two rooms: the study (the 5th, intelligence and children) and the family home itself (the 4th). So the same strictness that frightens the other households builds this one. The Libra child complains about him at fifteen and thanks him at thirty-five, standing in a house she owns, holding a degree she finished. Meanwhile the jolly uncle who brings sweets, golden Jupiter, has been put in charge of the storeroom of debts and the room where the cousins quarrel (the 6th and 3rd). He is still jolly; he is just generous with the wrong things.* **Rule:** Judge a planet by the houses it owns for this Lagna, not by its reputation in the neighbourhood.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Nature is what a planet is; function is who it works for. When you sit with a real chart, function wins. Ask "whose employee is this planet?" before you ask "is it a good planet?"

Parashara's rules

Here are the rules from *Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra*, exactly as summarised in Appendix A.6, with the reason behind each:

1. **Lords of the trines (1, 5, 9) are benefic.** These are Lakshmi's houses: self, merit, fortune. Whoever owns them works for your good.
2. **Lords of 3, 6 and 11 are malefic.** These are the houses of effort, enemies and greed, the "growing houses" where you fight for things. Their lords make you struggle, compete, want. (Yes, the 11th, house of gains, has a malefic lord: gains come at the cost of wanting them.)
3. **Lords of the angles (4, 7, 10) are neutral**, with a twist. A natural benefic owning an angle *loses* its goodness (*kendradhipatya dosha*, "the fault of angle-lordship"); a natural malefic owning an angle *loses* its badness. The angles are neutral ground: they flatten whoever owns them.
4. **Lords of 2, 8 and 12 take the colour of their other sign.** These houses are neither trines nor angles nor the fighting three; their lords are judged by their second job. Mars owning the 2nd and 7th for a Libra is read mainly as a 7th lord.
5. **The 8th lord is bad unless it also owns the Lagna.** The 8th is the house of endings and hidden trouble; its lord is a functional malefic, except that Mars for Aries and Venus for Libra own both the 1st and the 8th, and Lagna lordship wins.
6. **The Lagna lord is treated as benefic in practice**, even when its other house is difficult. It is the captain; you do not call your captain an enemy.

WHY EACH RULE? *Parashara's statement, with the reasons the system's grammar supplies.* Parashara (BPHS, the chapter on benefics and malefics by Lagna) gives the six rules; here is why each makes sense. (1) **Trine lords are good** because 1, 5, 9 are the *Dharma trikona*, the houses of merit earned and grace received; their lords deliver what you have already earned. (2) **Lords of 3, 6, 11 are bad** because these are the desire-and-effort houses: courage, competition, gain; the 11th is the 6th from the 6th, the enemy of enemies, and everything these houses give must be paid for in effort and wanting; their lords keep presenting the bill. (3) **Angle lords are neutral** because the kendras are power without moral colour: Vishnu's pillars hold the house up but do not judge it; a good planet given power becomes merely powerful, a harsh planet given power becomes merely firm. (4) **The 8th lord is bad** because the 8th is the 12th from the 9th, the loss of fortune, the house where what you did not earn happens to you. (5) **The 2nd and 12th lords take their other sign's colour** because these two houses are the immediate neighbours of the self, with no agenda of their own (the 2nd is what the self holds, the 12th is what the self lets go) so their lords are judged by their other job. (6) **The Lagna lord is treated as good** because the self cannot be its own enemy. *Everyday:* in a joint family, the relative in charge of the shrine and the children (trines) is always a blessing; the relative in charge of collecting rent and fighting the neighbours (3, 6, 11) is useful and exhausting; the one holding the keys to the main gate (kendra) is simply powerful; and the one who manages the house's losses (8th) is never popular, however kind.

Two words you need. A **functional benefic** is a planet whose houses are good for you. A **functional malefic** is one whose houses are difficult for you. Every Lagna has some of each, and the planets that fall into neither are **neutral**, read them by their placement and their company.

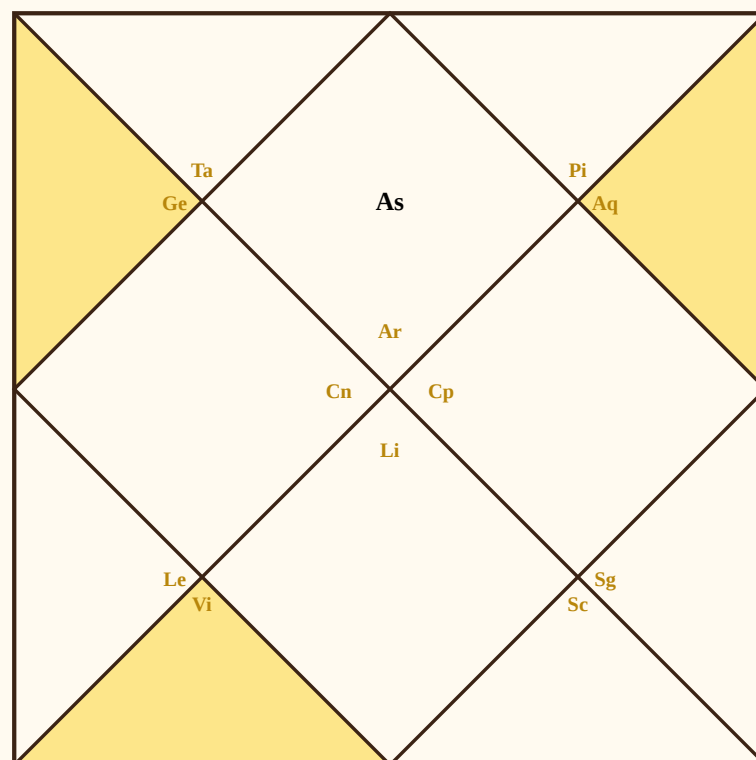
STORY: THE COURTYARD WHERE EVERYONE IS EQUAL. *The haveli has four rooms that open straight onto the central courtyard: the 1st, 4th, 7th and 10th, the pillars. The courtyard is public ground: whoever is appointed to guard those rooms stands in full daylight, watched by the whole family. The Royal Priest, who in a private room could hand out favours freely, finds that in the courtyard he must be fair to everyone; his generosity is flattened into mere duty. The old Judge, who in a private room could be harsh, finds that in the courtyard he too must be seen to be fair; his harshness is flattened into mere firmness. The courtyard makes everybody ordinary. Only the trines (the 5th and 9th, the lamp-lit rooms at the back) and the Lagna itself let a planet be fully good. **Rule:** Angle lords are neutral: natural benefics lose goodness there, natural malefics lose badness.*

STORY: WHOSE EMPLOYEE IS THIS PLANET? *A new steward arrives at the haveli and asks, sensibly, not "who is a nice man?" but "who works for whom?" He walks the twelve rooms and reads the nameplate on each door, the sign, and so its lord. Whoever's name is on the doors of the lamp-lit rooms (1, 5, 9) works for the family's good fortune and is paid well. Whoever's name is on the doors of the storeroom of debts, the sick-room and the room of losses (6, 8, 12), or on the rooms where the cousins fight and scheme (3, 6, 11), is employed to manage trouble, and trouble is what he will bring into any conversation. The steward writes two columns in his ledger, works for us and tests us, and only then asks about anybody's character. **Rule:** Read the lord of each house from the Lagna, sort by house quality, and you have the functional table without memorising it.*

Deriving the table for Aries, step by step

Let us do it slowly once, so that you never again have to memorise it. Aries Lagna: Aries is the 1st house, Taurus the 2nd, Gemini 3rd, Cancer 4th, Leo 5th, Virgo 6th, Libra 7th, Scorpio 8th, Sagittarius 9th, Capricorn 10th, Aquarius 11th, Pisces 12th.

Aries Lagna: the three houses whose lords turn malefic



3rd Gemini and 6th Virgo belong to Mercury; 11th Aquarius to Saturn

Figure 8.1: Aries Lagna. The shaded houses (3rd Gemini, 6th Virgo, 11th Aquarius) are the ones whose lords turn malefic. Read off the owner of each shaded sign: Mercury, Mercury, Saturn.

- **Mars** owns Aries (1st) and Scorpio (8th). Lagna lord, rule 6, **benefic**. The 8th lordship is forgiven by rule 5.
- **Venus** owns Taurus (2nd) and Libra (7th). Rule 4 sends the 2nd to its other sign; the 7th is an angle, and Venus is a natural benefic, so it loses goodness there. Both 2 and 7 are also **maraka** houses (below). Venus is **malefic**, specifically the maraka planet.
- **Mercury** owns Gemini (3rd) and Virgo (6th). Two of the fighting three. **Malefic**.
- **Moon** owns Cancer (4th). An angle lord, and the Moon's natural nature depends on its brightness. **Neutral**.
- **Sun** owns Leo (5th). A trine lord. **Benefic**.
- **Jupiter** owns Sagittarius (9th) and Pisces (12th). The 9th is the best trine; the 12th takes its colour from the 9th. **Benefic**.
- **Saturn** owns Capricorn (10th) and Aquarius (11th). The 10th is an angle (neutralising), but the 11th is one of the fighting three. **Malefic**, the 11th lordship decides it.

Result: benefics Sun, Mars, Jupiter; malefics Mercury, Venus, Saturn; Moon neutral. Compare with Appendix A.6: it is the same row. You have just derived it. Do this for your own Lagna now, before reading on, and then check yourself against the table.

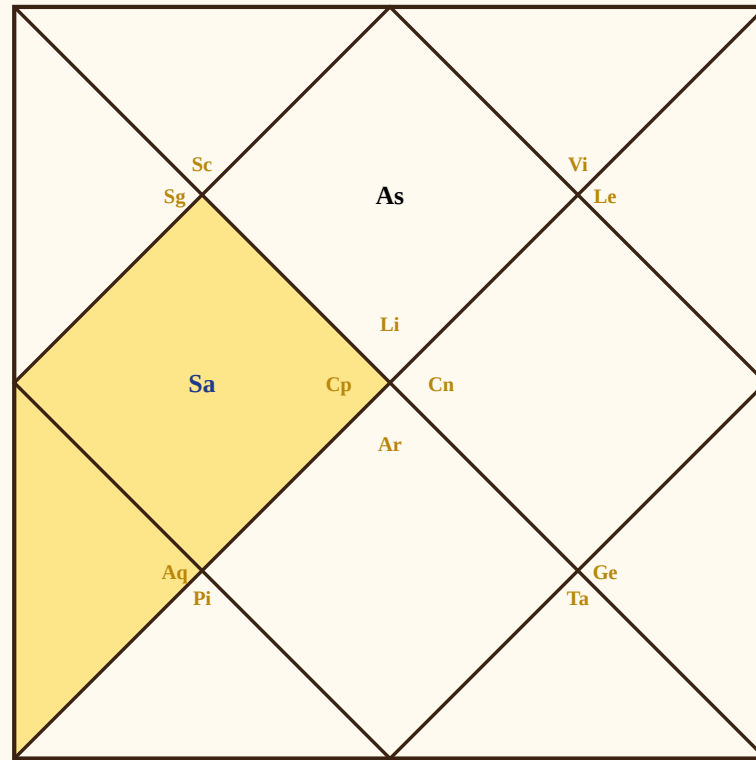
COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Treating Rahu and Ketu as owning houses. They own nothing in Parashara's scheme. Read their functional nature from the *sign lord* of the house they sit in and from the planets they sit with. A Rahu in Saturn's sign for a Libra borrows Saturn's good function; a Rahu in Mercury's sign for an Aries borrows Mercury's bad one.

The Yogakaraka: one planet, an angle and a trine

Now the most valuable word in this chapter. When a *single* planet owns both an angle (4, 7 or 10) and a trine (5 or 9), it holds in one hand the power of the pillar and the grace of the trine. Parashara calls such a planet a **Yogakaraka**: "the maker of yoga", the planet that by itself can raise a life. Its periods are the best years of that chart, and strengthening it is the one remedy that never misfires.

WHY BOTH? *System grammar.* An angle lord has *power*, the strength to make things happen, but no guarantee they will be good. A trine lord has *merit*, the earned right to good results, but not necessarily the muscle to enforce it. Only a planet holding both can act *and* deserve the outcome, which is exactly what a rise in life needs. This is also why Raja yoga, when no single planet qualifies, is defined as a kendra lord *connected* with a trikona lord: power and merit have to shake hands. *Everyday:* the department head who has both the authority to sign and the budget to spend; give someone only one of the two and nothing gets built.

ra Lagna: Saturn owns a kendra (4th) and a trikona (5th)



One planet, one angle, one trine: the definition of a yogakaraka

Figure 8.2: Libra Lagna. Saturn owns Capricorn (4th, an angle) and Aquarius (5th, a trine). One planet, one angle, one trine: Saturn is the yogakaraka.

STORY: THE MINISTER WHO HOLDS TWO KEYS. The King keeps two rings of keys. One ring opens the pillar rooms on the courtyard, the angles, where the kingdom's strength is stored. The other opens the lamp-lit back rooms, the trines, where its grace and merit are kept. Most ministers are trusted with one key from one ring. But now and then a single minister is handed a key from each ring: he can walk from the strong-room to the shrine without asking anyone. In the Libra court that minister is the old Judge, Saturn, with the keys to the 4th and 5th. In the Cancer court it is the Commander, Mars, with the 5th and 10th. In the Capricorn court it is the Minister of Pleasure, Venus, with the 5th and 10th. When his years come round, the whole household rises with him. **Rule:** A yogakaraka owns one angle and one trine by itself; strengthen it, and its dasha is the best of the life.

Only some Lagnas have one. Run the ownership yourself and you will find:

- **Taurus and Libra:** Saturn (9th and 10th for Taurus; 4th and 5th for Libra).
- **Cancer and Leo:** Mars (5th and 10th for Cancer; 4th and 9th for Leo).
- **Capricorn and Aquarius:** Venus (5th and 10th for Capricorn; 4th and 9th for Aquarius).
- **Virgo:** Venus, owning the 2nd and 9th, is named yogakaraka by BPHS and the tradition even though the strict angle-plus-trine test is not met, treat it as the honourable exception.

The other Lagnas have no single yogakaraka; there the good is done by a *pair*, an angle lord and a trine lord who must be connected (Chapter 6's Sambandha) to form a Raja yoga. A.6 names the pair for each.

The full table, and what is interesting about each Lagna

Here is the working table every Indian teacher uses, reproduced from Appendix A.6 with colour dots added (● works for you, ○ tests you, ◐ depends on placement). Below it, a short paragraph for each Lagna on what makes that row interesting.

Lagna	Benefics	Malefics	Neutral / mixed	Yogakaraka (single planet giving rajayoga)	Marakas to watch
Aries	● Sun, ● Mars, ● Jupiter	○ Mercury, ○ Venus, ○ Saturn	◐ Moon	(Sun + Jupiter together act as yogakarakas)	○ Venus, ○ Mercury
Taurus	● Saturn, ● Sun, ● Mercury	○ Moon, ○ Jupiter, ○ Mars	◐ Venus (own lagna but 6th lord)	Saturn	○ Jupiter, ○ Venus, ○ Mars
Gemini	● Venus, ● Saturn, ● Mercury	○ Mars, ○ Jupiter, ○ Sun	◐ Moon	(Venus + Saturn combination)	○ Moon, ○ Jupiter
Cancer	● Mars, ● Jupiter, ● Moon	○ Venus, ○ Mercury	◐ Sun, ◐ Saturn	Mars	○ Saturn, ○ Venus
Leo	● Mars, ● Jupiter, ● Sun	○ Mercury, ○ Venus, ○ Saturn	◐ Moon	Mars	○ Saturn, ○ Mercury
Virgo	● Venus, ● Mercury	○ Mars, ○ Jupiter, ○ Moon	◐ Sun, ◐ Saturn	Venus	○ Venus, ○ Jupiter
Libra	● Saturn, ● Mercury, ● Venus	○ Jupiter, ○ Sun, ○ Mars	◐ Moon	Saturn (Moon + Mercury together too)	○ Mars, ○ Jupiter
Scorpio	● Jupiter, ● Moon, ● Sun, ● Mars	○ Mercury, ○ Venus, ○ Saturn	(none)	(Sun + Moon together)	○ Venus, ○ Mercury
Sagittarius	● Sun, ● Mars, ● Jupiter	○ Venus, ○ Saturn	◐ Mercury, ◐ Moon	(Sun + Mercury together)	○ Saturn, ○ Venus
Capricorn	● Venus, ● Mercury, ● Saturn	○ Mars, ○ Jupiter, ○ Moon	◐ Sun	Venus	○ Mars, ○ Moon
Aquarius	● Venus, ● Saturn	○ Jupiter, ○ Moon, ○ Mars	◐ Mercury, ◐ Sun	Venus	○ Jupiter, ○ Sun, ○ Mars
Pisces	● Mars, ● Moon, ● Jupiter	○ Saturn, ○ Venus, ○ Sun, ○ Mercury	(none)	(Mars + Jupiter together)	○ Mercury, ○ Saturn

Functional nature by Lagna (BPHS working table)

Lagna	Sun	Moon	Mars	Mercury	Jupiter	Venus	Saturn
Aries	benefic	neutral	Lagna lord	malefic	benefic	malefic	malefic
Taurus	benefic	malefic	malefic	benefic	malefic	Lagna lord	YOGAKARAKA
Gemini	malefic	neutral	malefic	Lagna lord	malefic	benefic	benefic
Cancer	neutral	Lagna lord	YOGAKARAKA	malefic	benefic	malefic	neutral
Leo	Lagna lord	neutral	YOGAKARAKA	malefic	benefic	malefic	malefic
Virgo	neutral	malefic	malefic	Lagna lord	malefic	YOGAKARAKA	neutral
Libra	malefic	neutral	malefic	benefic	malefic	Lagna lord	YOGAKARAKA
Scorpio	benefic	benefic	Lagna lord	malefic	benefic	malefic	malefic
Sagittarius	benefic	neutral	benefic	neutral	Lagna lord	malefic	malefic
Capricorn	neutral	malefic	malefic	benefic	malefic	YOGAKARAKA	Lagna lord
Aquarius	neutral	malefic	malefic	neutral	malefic	YOGAKARAKA	Lagna lord
Pisces	malefic	benefic	benefic	malefic	Lagna lord	malefic	malefic

Green = works for you · Red = tests you · Grey = depends on placement. No single yogakaraka? A.6 names a pair (Sun + Jupiter for Aries).

Taurus: Venus is Lagna lord but also 6th lord (A.6 calls it mixed). Neutral cells: read by placement, dignity and company.

Figure 8.3: The same table as colours. Green works for you, red tests you, grey depends on placement. Photograph this page; you will use it every time you open a chart.

Aries. A fiery, straightforward row: the fire-sign lords (Sun of Leo, Jupiter of Sagittarius) plus Mars are the friends; the two natural benefics Mercury and Venus turn malefic because they own the fighting houses and the maraka houses. Sun and Jupiter, 5th and 9th lords, working together are as good as a yogakaraka. Note that Jupiter's 12th lordship does not spoil it, the 9th decides.

Taurus. The famous Saturn Lagna. Saturn owns the 9th and 10th, fortune and career in one hand, and is the finest yogakaraka in the zodiac. Venus, the Lagna lord, also owns the 6th, so A.6 marks it mixed: it protects the self but can bring disputes or health issues in its periods. Jupiter, owning 8 and 11, is a functional malefic here, the classic surprise.

Gemini. Mercury's own row, where Jupiter again disappoints: it owns the 7th and 10th, two angles, and a natural benefic loses its goodness in angles. Venus (5th and 12th) and Saturn (8th and 9th, the 9th deciding) are the friends. The Moon as 2nd lord is a maraka and is watched.

Cancer. Mars owns the 5th and 10th, yogakaraka. The naturally cruel commander becomes the Cancer person's engine of intelligence and career. Jupiter, 6th and 9th lord, is benefic by its 9th lordship but carries a 6th-house tinge (disputes with gurus, debts through generosity). Saturn owns the 7th and 8th: neutral, and the chief maraka. Chart B is a Cancer Lagna; we derive it below.

Leo. The mirror of Cancer: Mars owns the 4th and 9th, yogakaraka. The Sun is the captain; Jupiter (5th and 8th) is benefic through the 5th. Saturn owns the 6th and 7th, a malefic and maraka; Mercury owns 2 and 11, another maraka.

Virgo. Venus owns the 2nd and 9th and is named yogakaraka by the tradition. Jupiter, owning two angles again (4th and 7th), is malefic by function, a hard truth for a Virgo who expects the great benefic to help. Saturn (5th and 6th) is neutral; Mars (3rd and 8th) and the Moon (11th) are malefic.

Libra. Saturn, yogakaraka (4th and 5th), as we saw. Mercury (9th and 12th) is a friend. Mars owns 2 and 7, the double maraka, and Jupiter owns 3 and 6. The Sun, 11th lord, is malefic. The Moon (10th) and Mercury (9th) together also make a Raja yoga.

Scorpio. A generous row: four benefics. Mars is Lagna lord (with the 6th forgiven); Jupiter owns 2 and 5; the Moon owns the 9th; the Sun owns the 10th. Sun and Moon, the king and queen, are the angle-trine pair whose connection gives Raja yoga. Mercury (8th and 11th), Venus (7th and 12th) and Saturn (3rd and 4th) are the malefics; the two marakas are Venus and Mercury. Chart A is a Scorpio Lagna.

Sagittarius. Jupiter is captain (1st and 4th). The Sun (9th) and Mars (5th and 12th) are the friends. Saturn (2nd and 3rd) and Venus (6th and 11th) are malefic. Mercury, owning the 7th and 10th, two angles, is neutral and forms the Raja-yoga pair with the Sun. The Moon as 8th lord is neutral.

Capricorn. Venus owns the 5th and 10th: yogakaraka. Mercury (6th and 9th) is a friend through the 9th. Saturn is captain (1st and 2nd). Mars (4th and 11th), Jupiter (3rd and 12th) and the Moon (7th, a maraka house) are malefic. The Sun (8th) is neutral.

Aquarius. Venus again, owning the 4th and 9th: yogakaraka. Saturn is captain (1st and 12th). Jupiter owns 2 and 11, malefic and a maraka; Mars owns 3 and 10; the Moon owns the 6th. Mercury (5th and 8th) and the Sun (7th) are neutral.

Pisces. Jupiter is captain (1st and 10th). Mars owns the 2nd and 9th, benefic through the 9th, and the Moon owns the 5th; Mars and Jupiter together are the powerful pair. Mercury, owning the 4th and 7th, two angles, is malefic by function, as are Saturn (11th and 12th), Venus (3rd and 8th) and the Sun (6th).

DID YOU KNOW? The fact that Jupiter is a functional malefic for four Lagnas (Taurus, Gemini, Virgo and Libra) shocked me when I first saw it, and it is why a yellow sapphire, prescribed on the basis of "Jupiter is always good", backfires so often. Appendix A.13's rule follows directly from this chapter: a gemstone strengthens a planet, so you strengthen only a functional *benefic*.

Marakas: the planets that take, and how to talk about them

The 2nd and the 7th houses are called **maraka** ("killer") houses in the classics. Their lords, and planets sitting in them, are the ones whose periods bring illness, exhaustion, and, at the end of a long life, death.

WHY 2 AND 7? *System grammar, stated by Parashara and spelled out by Mantreswara in Phaladeepika.* The 8th house is longevity, and the 3rd, being the 8th from the 8th, is its second store. The 12th from any house is that house's loss. Count: the 12th from the 8th is the 7th; the 12th from the 3rd is the 2nd. So the 2nd and the 7th are, by pure counting, the two houses through which life is *spent*. *Everyday:* a house has two doors through which everything eventually leaves, the front door and the back door; whoever holds those keys decides when the household empties.

STORY: THE TWO ROOMS TWELFTH FROM THE LIFE-ROOMS. In the haveli, the room *twelfth* from any room is its back door, the way things leave. Life itself is kept in the 8th room (longevity) and, as a second store, in the 3rd (which is the 8th from the 8th). Count twelve rooms on from the 8th and you arrive at the 7th; count twelve on from the 3rd and you arrive at the 2nd. Those two rooms, the 2nd and the 7th, are the back doors through which vitality slips out. Whoever holds the keys to those doors (their lords), whoever is standing in them (occupants), and the old Judge who patrols all exits (Saturn) are the *marakas*. In their years, the household runs low: illness, drained savings, a partnership that ends. That is all the word means in practice. **Rule:** Marakas are the 2nd and 7th lords, malefics in 2 or 7, the 12th lord, and Saturn; their periods call for care of health and money, never for a prophecy.

The standard hierarchy of marakas, strongest first:

1. ○ The **2nd lord**.

2. ○ The **7th lord**.
3. ○ **Malefics sitting in the 2nd or 7th**.
4. ● The **12th lord**, and malefics with it.
5. ● **Saturn**, which is a general maraka in any chart when it is a functional malefic and the dasha coincides with a low ebb.

What marakas *actually do*, in ordinary life, is bring **health crises, financial drains and relationship endings** during their periods. That is how you should read and speak of them.

CONSULTATION TIP: You will never predict a death. Not to the client, not to their family, not as a hint, not "between us". Longevity reading is the hardest branch of the science, every classical author warns against pronouncing on it, and even a correct prediction does harm, it steals the years before it. When a maraka dasha approaches, you say: "This is a period to take health seriously, get the check-ups, do not postpone treatment, keep insurance in order, and be careful with money and with people you depend on." That sentence is true, useful, and kind. Anything more is neither.

Badhaka: the obstructing house

A rule from the horary (*Prashna*) and southern traditions that many northern astrologers also use: each Lagna has one **Badhaka** ("obstructing") house whose lord causes unexplained delays and interference.

Lagna type	Signs	Badhaka house
Movable (<i>Chara</i>)	Aries, Cancer, Libra, Capricorn	11th
Fixed (<i>Sthira</i>)	Taurus, Leo, Scorpio, Aquarius	9th
Dual (<i>Dwiswabhava</i>)	Gemini, Virgo, Sagittarius, Pisces	7th

WHY THOSE HOUSES? Tradition (*Prashna Marga* and the southern school), with a symbolic reasoning that is thinner than Parashara's. The explanation usually given: a movable sign is always moving forward, so its obstacle is the house of desire and gain (the 11th), it wants too much; a fixed sign stays put, so its obstacle is fortune and long journeys (the 9th): it will not go where luck is; a dual sign is torn, so its obstacle is the other person (the 7th), it cannot settle on one partner. Treat this as a useful folk-logic, not a derivation. *Everyday*: the restless cousin is tripped by ambition, the stubborn one by refusing to travel for the job, the indecisive one by never choosing a spouse.

For a Cancer Lagna (movable) the Badhaka is the 11th, Taurus, and its lord Venus, which agrees with Venus being a functional malefic for Cancer. For Scorpio (fixed) it is the 9th, Cancer, and its lord the Moon, a benefic by the Parashari table, which shows you that the two systems are answering different questions: Parashara asks *who works for you*, the Badhaka rule asks *where obstacles hide*. I reach for the Badhaka mainly when someone describes a chronic, unexplained block, and I say clearly that it is from the Prashna tradition, not BPHS.

A preview: functional malefics in the difficult houses

Something that will seem paradoxical until Chapter 10: the lord of a difficult house (6, 8, 12) sitting in *another* difficult house often produces good results. The 6th lord in the 8th, the 8th lord in the 12th, the 12th lord in the 6th: these are the **Viparita Raja**

yogas (Harsha, Sarala, Vimala in Appendix A.11): a functional malefic locked in a dusthana turns its harm on the house's enemies instead of on you. Loss of loss is gain. Keep the thought; it becomes a tool later.

What functional nature does to time

Here is the practical payoff. A dasha (Chapter 13) or a major transit (Chapter 14) of a planet is like handing that planet the keys for a few years. If the planet is a **functional benefic**, its years *lift*: doors open in the houses it owns and the house it sits in. If it is a **functional malefic**, its years *test*: the same houses are pressured, the person works harder for less, and the lessons are the planet's lessons. If it is *neutral*, the years take the colour of the planet's placement, dignity and company.

WHY DOES FUNCTION DECIDE THE DASHA? *System grammar.* A dasha activates a planet, and a planet can only deliver through the houses it owns and occupies: it has no other channels. So the Saturn dasha of a Libra pours Saturn's energy into the 4th and 5th (home, children, learning), while the same dasha for a Cancer pours it into the 7th and 8th (partners, crises). Same planet, different pipes. *Everyday:* the same monsoon fills the reservoir in one district and floods the low-lying colony in the next; the rain did not change, the ground did.

This is why two people in a Saturn Mahadasha at the same time can have opposite decades. The Libra buys the house and finishes the doctorate; the Cancer changes jobs three times and nurses a parent. Both are "Saturn". The difference is function.

Worked example: Chart A (Scorpio Lagna)

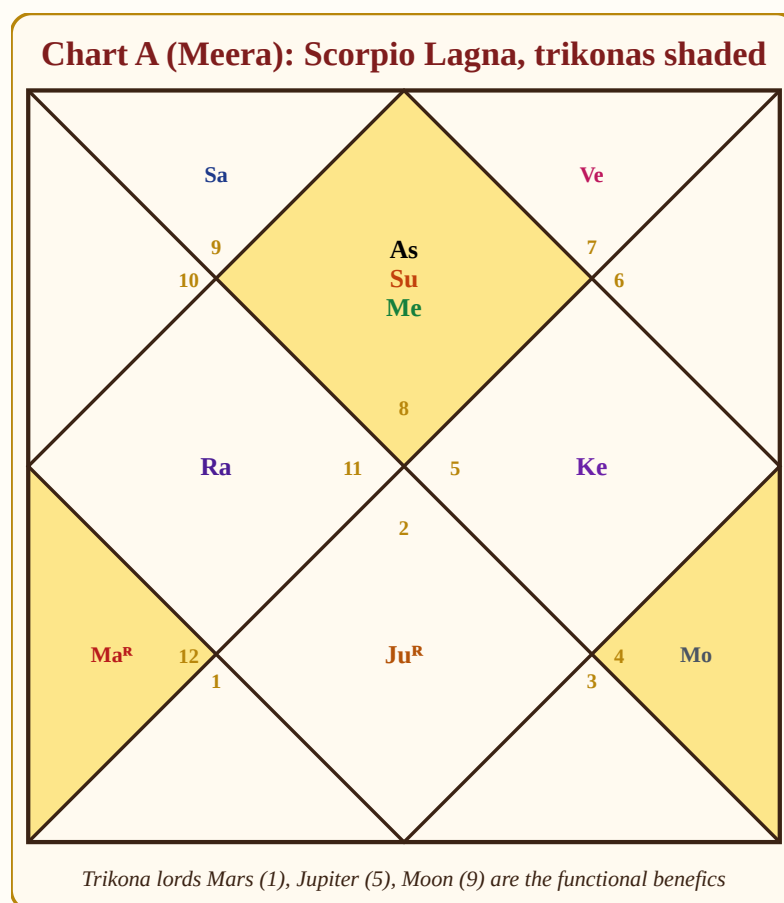


Figure 8.4: Chart A. The trines are the 1st (Scorpio), 5th (Pisces) and 9th (Cancer). Their lords (Mars, Jupiter, Moon) are Meera's functional benefics.

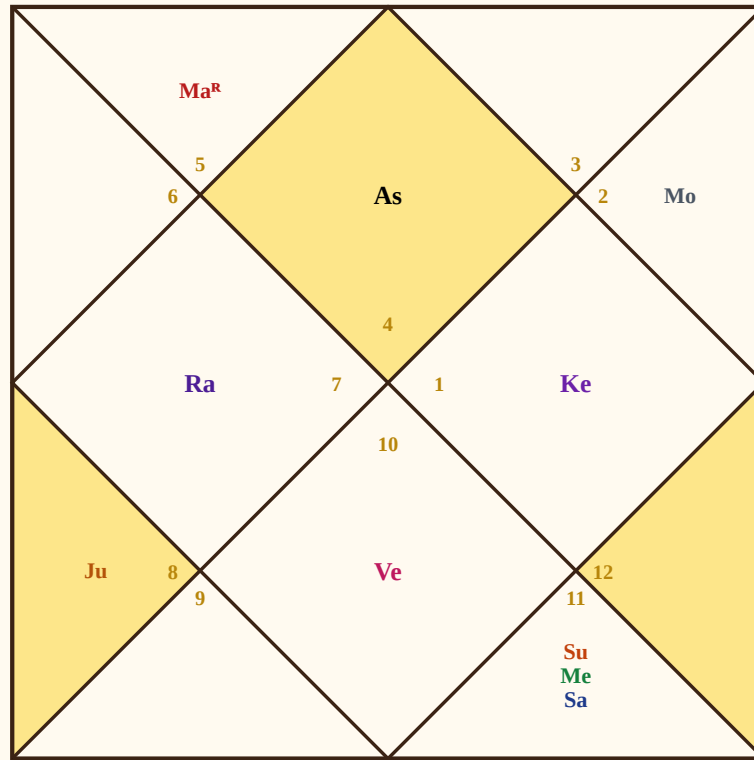
Scorpio 1st, Sagittarius 2nd, Capricorn 3rd, Aquarius 4th, Pisces 5th, Aries 6th, Taurus 7th, Gemini 8th, Cancer 9th, Leo 10th, Virgo 11th, Libra 12th.

Planet	Owns	Function	Why
Mars	1st, 6th	● Benefic (Lagna lord)	Captain; the 6th lordship is forgiven, but Mars periods can bring competition and health tests
Jupiter	2nd, 5th	● Benefic	Trine lord; wealth and speech (2nd) ride with intelligence and children (5th)
Saturn	3rd, 4th	○ Malefic (mild)	3rd lordship makes it malefic; 4th (an angle) softens; A.6 lists it malefic
Sun	10th	● Benefic	Angle lord, natural malefic losing badness, friend of the Lagna lord; A.6 counts it a benefic and pairs it with the Moon
Moon	9th	● Benefic	The best trine; fortune, father, grace
Mercury	8th, 11th	○ Malefic	8th and one of the fighting three; also a maraka
Venus	7th, 12th	○ Malefic (maraka)	7th is a maraka house; the 12th adds expense and distance

Now look at where they sit. Sun (benefic) and Mercury (malefic) share the Lagna, mixed, but the Sun is the 10th lord in the 1st, a career-defining placement, and Mercury, though functionally malefic, gives her the articulate mind that makes her a teacher. Jupiter (benefic) sits in the 7th, protecting marriage. The Moon (benefic) sits in its own sign in the 9th, the house it owns, fortune guarded. Venus, the maraka, sits in its own sign in the 12th: her expenses and her marriage will be tied to distance, comfort and foreign or far places, and her Venus dasha (age 18½ to 38½) was a mixed period, the marriage in 2016 came in it, but so did the spending and the distance.

Worked example: Chart B (Cancer Lagna)

Chart B (Arjun): Cancer Lagna, trikonas shaded



Trikona lords Moon (1), Mars (5), Jupiter (9); Mars also owns the 10th: yogakaraka

Figure 8.5: Chart B. Trines: 1st Cancer, 5th Scorpio, 9th Pisces. Their lords are the Moon, Mars and Jupiter, and Mars also owns the 10th, making it the yogakaraka.

Cancer 1st, Leo 2nd, Virgo 3rd, Libra 4th, Scorpio 5th, Sagittarius 6th, Capricorn 7th, Aquarius 8th, Pisces 9th, Aries 10th, Taurus 11th, Gemini 12th.

Planet	Owns	Function	Why
Moon	1st	● Benefic (Lagna lord)	Captain
Sun	2nd	● Neutral	Only the 2nd; a maraka house, read by placement
Mars	5th, 10th	● Yogakaraka	A trine and an angle in one hand
Mercury	3rd, 12th	○ Malefic	Effort and loss
Jupiter	6th, 9th	● Benefic	The 9th decides; a 6th-house tinge
Venus	4th, 11th	○ Malefic	The 11th decides; also the Badhaka lord
Saturn	7th, 8th	● Neutral / maraka	Angle neutralises; 8th is difficult; chief maraka

Where they sit: Mars, the yogakaraka, in the 2nd house Leo, retrograde, in the Sun's sign, a friend's house. Career and intelligence feed wealth and speech; Arjun earns by his mind and his voice, and his Mars dasha (age 11.8 to 18.8) was when he found his subject. Jupiter, a benefic, sits in the 5th, its own trine. The Moon, captain, sits in the 11th in Venus's Taurus, well placed for gains through the public. Saturn, the maraka, sits in the 8th in its own sign, combust: a long life, and health matters that surface in Saturn's periods and must not be ignored. Venus, malefic, sits in the 7th in Saturn's sign, a partner who is disciplined and older-seeming; the 11th-lord flavour brings the partner's family and friends into the marriage. The three in the

8th we already read in Chapter 6; now you know that of those three, the Sun is neutral, Mercury malefic, Saturn neutral-maraka, which is why I read that house as research and depth, not as disaster.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: For any chart, write the seven planets in two columns, *works for me* and *tests me*, before you read anything else. Then look at the dasha. In under a minute you know whether the person is living through a lift or a test.

In one breath

- Natural nature is a planet's temperament; functional nature is whose houses it works for in *your* chart. Function decides results.
- Parashara: trine lords benefic; lords of 3, 6, 11 malefic; angle lords neutral (benefics lose goodness, malefics lose badness); 2, 8, 12 lords go by their other sign; 8th lord bad unless Lagna lord; Lagna lord always treated as benefic.
- Derive, do not memorise: list the twelve houses from the Lagna, read the owner of each, apply the rules.
- A yogakaraka owns an angle and a trine by itself: Saturn for Taurus and Libra, Mars for Cancer and Leo, Venus for Capricorn and Aquarius (and Virgo by tradition).
- Marakas (2nd lord, 7th lord, malefics in 2 or 7, 12th lord, Saturn) bring health and money tests in their periods. Never predict death.
- Badhaka (11th for movable, 9th for fixed, 7th for dual Lagnas) is a Prashna-tradition tool for hidden obstacles.
- A benefic's dasha lifts, a malefic's dasha tests, a neutral's dasha follows its placement.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. Derive the functional nature of Jupiter for a Gemini Lagna. Which houses does it own, and what does Parashara's rule say?
2. Which two Lagnas have Venus as yogakaraka by the strict angle-plus-trine test? Show the houses.
3. Chart C (Devika) is an Aries Lagna. Her Saturn is in the 5th. Is Saturn a functional benefic or malefic for her, and which house group does its placement fall in?
4. A Leo Lagna client is entering a Mercury Mahadasha. Using only functional nature, will these years lift or test? Which life areas?
5. Name the Badhaka house and its lord for a Pisces Lagna.

Answers

1. For Gemini, Sagittarius is the 7th and Pisces the 10th. Jupiter owns two angles; a natural benefic owning angles loses its goodness (kendradhipatya dosha). Functional malefic, and the 7th lordship also makes it a maraka, exactly as A.6 lists it. 2. Capricorn (Venus owns Taurus, the 5th, and Libra, the 10th) and Aquarius (Venus owns Taurus, the 4th, and Libra, the 9th). Virgo is the traditional exception where Venus owns the 2nd and 9th. 3. For Aries, Saturn owns Capricorn (10th) and Aquarius (11th); the 11th lordship makes it a functional malefic. It sits in the 5th, a trine, in Leo, the sign of its enemy the Sun. A malefic in a trine pressures the trine's matters (children, education) which fits the "struggle then success" theme of her 5th house. 4. For Leo, Mercury owns Virgo (2nd) and Gemini (11th): a functional malefic and a maraka. Its years test rather than lift, in the areas of

money and speech (2nd) and gains, friends and elder siblings (11th), with health to be watched because of the maraka role. If Mercury is well placed and dignified, the test is milder and the gains still come, but with effort. 5. Pisces is a dual sign, so the Badhaka is the 7th house, Virgo, and its lord is Mercury.

Chapter 9: House Lords: Where Did the Owner Go?

Every house in the chart has an owner. You have known this since Chapter 2: each sign has a lord, and each house contains a sign, so the lord of that sign is the **lord of that house** (*Bhavesha*). For a Scorpio Lagna, the 7th house is Taurus, and Venus is the lord of the 7th. So far, a fact.

Now the idea that turns the fact into a tool. The owner of a house is like the owner of a shop. If he sits in his own shop, it runs beautifully. If he is always at the temple, the shop's affairs get mixed up with religion. If he is in the hospital, the shop suffers. **The lord carries the matters of its house to wherever it sits.** That sentence, applied twelve times, is most of what the classics mean by "read the lords".

This chapter gives you the method, the 144 basic combinations, and three refinements: dispositors, exchanges, and lords in their own houses.

The master principle

Three questions about any house lord, in this order:

1. **Which house has it gone to?** A lord in a good house (an angle (1, 4, 7, 10), a trine (5, 9), the 2nd or the 11th) makes its house's matters flourish. A lord in a difficult house (6, 8, 12) struggles or is *transformed*: the matters arrive through service, crisis or distance. A lord in the 3rd works hard for its results.
2. **How is it doing there?** Own sign or exaltation: strong owner, matters prosper. Enemy's sign or debilitation: weak owner, matters need help. Combust, in a planetary war, hemmed by malefics: weakened. Aspected by Jupiter: protected.
3. **What does the destination house mean?** This is where the reading comes alive. The 4th lord in the 10th: mother, home, education and comfort (4th) have gone to career and public life (10th). Perhaps a family business, a career in real estate or teaching, work from home, a mother who shaped the career. You do not memorise which; you offer the possibilities and let the rest of the chart choose.

WHY DOES THE LORD CARRY THE HOUSE? *Parashara's method, and the system's grammar.* Parashara judges every bhava through three things (its occupants, its aspects and its lord) because the lord is the house's *agent*: the planet whose sign the house wears, and so the only planet that acts *for* that house wherever it happens to be. A house with no occupant still has a lord; that is why the lord's placement is the one signal every house always has. *Everyday*: when a bank posts the branch manager to another city, the branch's files, its problems and half its customers' loyalty go with him; the building stays, the business travels.

STORY: THE OWNER WHO WENT TO ANOTHER ROOM. Each of the twelve rooms in the haveli has an owner whose name is on the door, but owners wander. The owner of the kitchen (the 4th, home and mother) is found every day in the office (the 10th), so the family's meals are eaten at the desk, the mother keeps the accounts, and the business is run from home. The owner of the marriage room (the 7th) is found in the guest-house at the edge of the estate (the 12th), so the spouse comes from far away and the couple's happiest hours are private ones. The owner of the treasury (the 2nd) is found lying in the sick-room (the 6th), so money goes on medicines and disputes until he recovers. Wherever the owner sits, that is where his room's business is done, and the state of the room he sits in decides how well it goes. **Rule:** A house lord carries its house's matters to the house it occupies; good destination, good results; difficult destination, struggle or transformation.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Say it as a sentence: "The matters of house N have gone to house M." Then ask what happens when those two departments of life share an office. That sentence is worth more than any list.

WHY DO LORDS STRUGGLE IN 6, 8 AND 12? *System grammar.* Each of the three is a house of *loss* by counting: the 12th is the 12th from the 1st (loss of self), the 8th is the 12th from the 9th (loss of fortune), the 6th is the 12th from the 7th (loss of partnership). A lord sitting there has its house's business spent on debts, crises or distance instead of on growth. The exceptions follow from the same counting: a lord in its *own* dusthana guards the gate from inside, and a dusthana lord in *another* dusthana turns loss against loss (Viparita, Chapter 10). *Everyday*: a department whose budget is diverted to the hospital wing does less this year, unless the department is the hospital wing.

The five-step method for judging any house

When someone asks about children, marriage, career, or health, they are asking about a house. Here is how I answer, every time, in the same order, so that I never skip a signal.

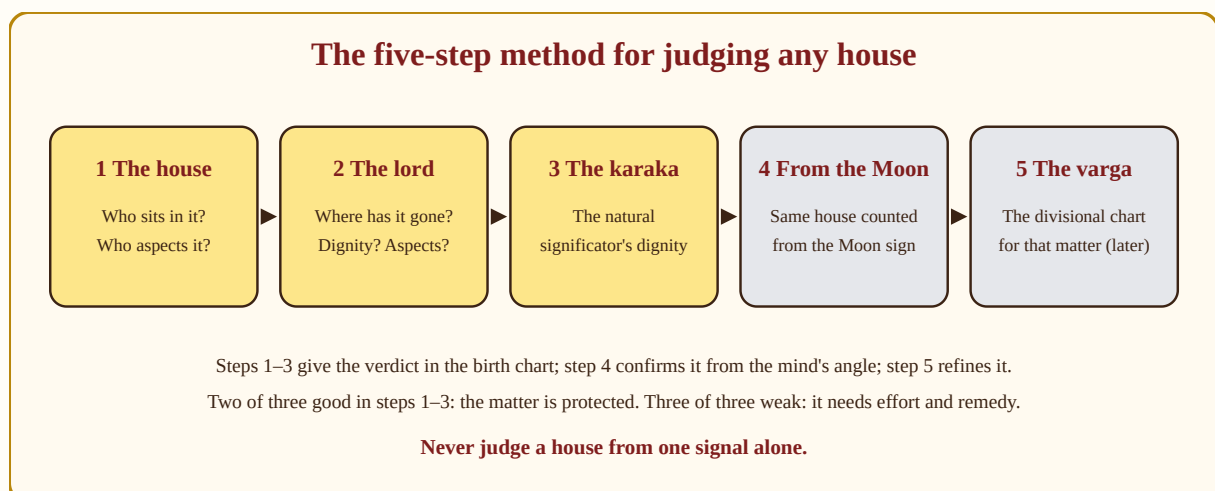


Figure 9.1: The five steps. The first three give the verdict in the birth chart; the fourth confirms from the Moon; the fifth refines with a divisional chart.

1. **The house itself.** Who sits in it? Who aspects it (Chapter 6)? Benefics and functional benefics (Chapter 8) protect; malefics pressure.
2. **The lord.** Where has it gone? What is its dignity, and who is with it or aspecting it?
3. **The natural significator (karaka).** Appendix A.5 lists one for each house: Jupiter for children, Venus for spouse, Sun for father, and so on. A strong karaka rescues a weak house; a weak karaka makes even a good house work harder.
4. **The same house counted from the Moon.** The Moon is the mind, and the chart from the Moon (*Chandra Lagna*) shows how the person *experiences* the matter. If the Lagna chart and the Moon chart agree, speak with confidence. If they disagree, the truth is mixed.
5. **The divisional chart** for that matter: D7 for children, D9 for marriage, D10 for career (Appendix A.10). Chapter 11 teaches these; for now, know that the step exists.

Two of the first three strong, and the matter is protected. All three weak, and it needs effort and remedy.

STORY: VISITING A HOUSE. When the steward is asked "how are the children of this family?", he does not guess. First he visits the children's room itself (the 5th) and sees who is living there and who keeps peering in through the windows, occupants and aspects. Then he goes looking for the landlord of that room, wherever he has wandered, and checks whether he is well-dressed or in rags, the lord and its dignity. Then he visits the shrine of the room's patron deity (the karaka, Jupiter for children) and sees whether the lamp is lit. Then he looks at the room's reflection in the Queen Mother's mirror, the same house counted from the Moon, to learn how the family feels about it. Last, he unrolls the district map for that matter, the divisional chart. Only then does he speak. **Rule:** House, lord, karaka, from the Moon, varga, five steps, every time.

Worked example: Chart C, the 5th house (children)

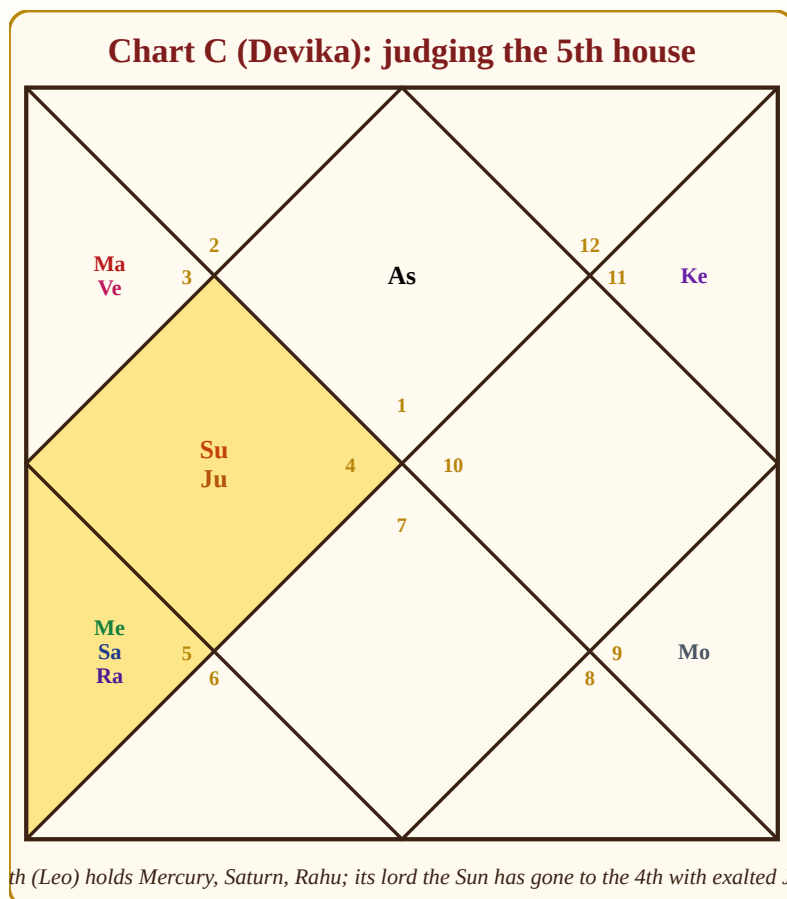


Figure 9.2: Chart C. The 5th house Leo holds Mercury, Saturn and Rahu. Its lord, the Sun, has gone to the 4th house Cancer, where exalted Jupiter also sits.

Devika (Aries Lagna) asks about children.

Step 1, the house. The 5th is Leo, and it is crowded: Mercury at 1°, Rahu at 3°, Saturn at 18°. Saturn is a functional malefic for Aries (it owns the 11th), in its enemy the Sun's sign. Rahu is tightly conjunct Mercury, and Ketu aspects the house from the 11th. A pressured house: delay, anxiety about children, unconventional routes (Rahu), much thinking about education (Mercury). Mercury and Rahu at 1°–3° Leo also sit in the Magha Gandanta strip (Chapter 7), an intensifier, not a verdict.

Step 2: the lord. The Sun, lord of Leo, has gone to the 4th house Cancer. The 4th is an angle, a good house. Cancer is the Moon's sign, a friend of the Sun. And the Sun sits with **Jupiter, exalted at 26° Cancer**. The 5th lord in a good house, in a friendly sign, in the company of an exalted great benefic: the children *come*, and they come through the home and the mother's line (4th), and they are a source of learning and comfort.

Step 3: the karaka. Jupiter, the significator of children, is exalted in an angle. This is the strongest possible karaka. It rescues the crowded 5th.

Step 4, from the Moon. The Moon is in Sagittarius. The 5th from Sagittarius is Aries, which is the 1st house of the chart, and it is empty; its lord Mars sits in the 3rd. From the Moon's angle, children are simply a matter of the self and of effort, with no malefic pressure. Mild, clean confirmation.

Step 5: D7 later. We will check the Saptamsa in Chapter 11.

Verdict. Pressure in the house (delay, worry, an unconventional path, perhaps medical help, perhaps late motherhood) but a strong lord and the strongest karaka: children, and a deep bond of learning with them. "Struggle, then success" is exactly what these steps say. The crowded 5th alone would have frightened a beginner into a wrong answer.

Worked example: Chart A, the 7th house (marriage)

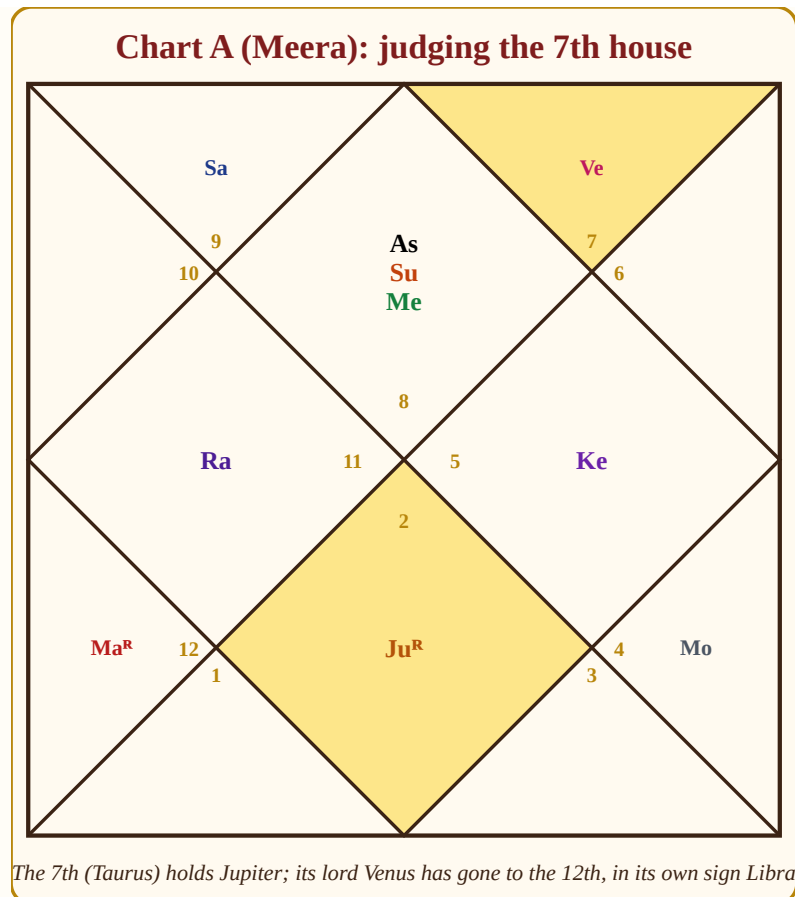


Figure 9.3: Chart A. The 7th house Taurus holds Jupiter, retrograde. Its lord Venus has gone to the 12th house, in its own sign Libra.

Step 1: the house. Taurus, with Jupiter at 8°, retrograde. Jupiter is a functional benefic for Scorpio (lord of the 2nd and 5th). A benefic in the 7th is classical protection for marriage, though Jupiter is in the sign of its enemy Venus, and retrograde, so the partner is learned but has a mind of their own, and the match may be reconsidered once before it is settled. Aspects: the Sun and Mercury from the 1st both aspect the 7th (Chapter 6). An articulate, confident partner; a marriage in which two strong personalities face each other.

Step 2, the lord. Venus has gone to the 12th, a difficult house, but it is in **its own sign, Libra**. A lord in a dusthana in its own sign is a shop-owner who has opened a branch in a distant town: the matters are far away but well run. The 12th is distance, foreign places, expenses and the pleasures of the bed. Marriage linked to another city or country, spending on the partner and the home, and a private, comfortable intimacy. Not denial, distance.

Step 3, the karaka. In a woman's chart the classics take Jupiter as the significator of the husband (Appendix A.2), and Jupiter is *in the 7th house itself*. The karaka sitting in the house it signifies is a strong yes.

Step 4, from the Moon. The Moon is in Cancer; the 7th from it is Capricorn, the 3rd house of the chart, empty, its lord Saturn in the 2nd in Jupiter's Sagittarius. Neutral confirmation: no pressure, no extra push.

Verdict. Marriage assured and protected; a learned, articulate, independent partner; a link with distance and a comfortable private life. Timed in Venus's period, and her marriage came in 2016, within her Venus Mahadasha (age 18½ to 38½).

The 144 combinations

Here are the twelve lords in the twelve houses, one line each, **derived** from the master principle: combine the meaning of the lord's house with the meaning of the destination, coloured by the destination's quality. These are starting sentences, not verdicts;

dignity, company, aspects and Chapter 8's functional nature always adjust them.

The 1st lord, the captain

The Lagna lord gets a paragraph per placement, because it is the person walking around their own chart. *Why these rows:* the 1st is the self, so wherever its lord sits is where the person's own energy, health and attention are invested; the quality of that house becomes the quality of the life's main effort.

In the 1st. The owner is home. Strong constitution, self-reliance, an independent mind, a life shaped by one's own effort. Such people recover from setbacks quickly.

In the 2nd. The self is invested in family, wealth and speech. Earns by personal effort, is known for what they say, and identifies strongly with the family name. Money matters feel personal.

In the 3rd. A self built on courage and effort. Close to siblings for good or ill, restless, communicative, fond of short journeys and hobbies. Achievement comes from initiative rather than luck.

In the 4th. The self is rooted at home. A strong bond with the mother, love of land, house and vehicles, a good education, a need for inner peace.

In the 5th. The self expressed through intelligence, creativity and children. Bright, often lucky in speculation, blessed by past merit. Romance and learning colour the personality.

In the 6th. A self tested early: health, competition, debts or hard service. Such people become fighters, excellent in medicine, law or any competitive field, but must guard health and avoid needless quarrels.

In the 7th. The self is completed by others. Partner-centred, drawn to business and travel, happiest in a pair; the spouse shapes the personality.

In the 8th. A private, deep self drawn to hidden things: research, the occult, insurance, surgery, psychology. Life has clear chapters, sometimes abrupt ones; health needs attention.

In the 9th. A fortunate, dharmic self. Father and guru matter; long journeys, higher learning and philosophy shape the life. Often teachers, often travellers.

In the 10th. Career is identity. Ambitious, visible, hard-working, respected; known by their work, and able to lose themselves in it.

In the 11th. A self that gains. Wide networks, generous friends, elder siblings who help, wishes that come true with effort. Comfortable later in life.

In the 12th. The self is spent far away or in solitude: foreign lands, hospitals, ashrams, research libraries. Expenses run high; spirituality runs deep. Such people need a retreat and often live abroad.

The other eleven lords

Each row carries a dot for the quality of the destination house: ● angle, trine, 2nd or 11th; ● the 3rd (effort); ○ the 6th, 8th or 12th. Where a ○ destination is the lord's own house or forms a Viparita yoga, the row is marked ●, because the difficult house then works in your favour.

Lord of the 2nd (wealth, speech, family) in the... *Why these rows:* the 2nd is what the self holds (money, words, kin) so its lord spends that holding in the house it occupies. The 2nd and 8th are one axis (my resources, others' resources), which is why the 2nd lord in the 8th brings inheritance and insurance.

House	Derived meaning
1 ●	Wealth by own effort; speaks freely; family-centred identity
2 ●	Steady accumulation, good speech, strong lineage (own house)
3 🇮	Money through communication, writing, siblings; effort for earnings
4 ●	Wealth from property, mother's side, education; comfortable home
5 ●	Earns through intelligence, children, speculation; learned speech
6 ○	Money through service or medicine; debts and disputes over family funds
7 ●	Wealth through spouse or partnership; pleasing speech in business
8 ○	Inheritance, insurance, sudden ups and downs in savings; guarded speech
9 ●	Wealth through fortune, father, higher learning; truthful, generous speech
10 ●	Wealth through career; speech is a professional tool
11 ●	Wealth grows through gains and networks; a strong earner
12 ○	Spending outruns saving; money abroad or in charity; quiet speech

Lord of the 3rd (courage, siblings, communication) in the... *Why these rows:* the 3rd is effort and initiative; its lord puts that effort wherever it sits. The 3rd and 9th are one axis (short journeys and long, the near sibling and the distant guru), so the 3rd lord in the 9th sends siblings or effort far away.

House	Derived meaning
1 ●	Brave, self-willed, a natural communicator; siblings shape the self
2 ●	Siblings and family close; income from communication
3 🇮	Courage, hard work, artistic hobbies, good sibling bonds (own house)
4 ●	Courage applied at home; siblings nearby; short journeys for study
5 ●	Creative communication; effort in learning; siblings' children dear
6 ○	Rivalry with siblings or competitors; courage in service; short work trips
7 ●	Partnership built on communication; spouse like a friend; business travel
8 ○	Siblings distant or in difficulty; courage tested; research writing
9 ●	Siblings fortunate or abroad; effort for dharma; long journeys
10 ●	Career in communication, sales, media, writing; a hard worker
11 ●	Gains through initiative, siblings and networks
12 ○	Sibling far away; effort spent quietly; foreign correspondence

Lord of the 4th (mother, home, education, comforts) in the... *Why these rows:* the 4th and 10th are the two ends of one axis (the private home at the bottom of the chart and the public career at the top) so the 4th lord in the 10th ties home to work, and the 4th lord anywhere carries the mother's and the home's matters there.

House	Derived meaning
1 ●	Home-loving, mother's strong influence, well educated, comfortable
2 ●	Property adds to wealth; mother's family helps; education pays
3 🚩	Changes of residence; effort for comforts; mother close to siblings
4 ●	Settled home, strong mother, sound education, vehicles (own house)
5 ●	Education leads to creativity; a wise mother; property luck
6 ○	Domestic disturbance; mother's health to watch; work away from home
7 ●	Home shared with partner; mother influences marriage; property via spouse
8 ○	Inherited property; mother's health caution; renovations and moves
9 ●	Fortunate home; higher education; a religious mother; study abroad
10 ●	Home, mother or education linked to career; family business, work from home, real estate, teaching
11 ●	Gains through property; comforts increase; mother's friends help
12 ○	Home far away; expenses on property; mother distant; spiritual learning

Lord of the 5th (children, intellect, merit) in the... *Why these rows:* the 5th is what the mind creates: children, ideas, merit; its lord creates in the house it occupies. The 5th and 11th are one axis (what I make and what I gain from it), so the 5th lord in the 11th turns creativity into income.

House	Derived meaning
1 ●	Intelligent, creative, close to children; merit shows in the personality
2 ●	Earns from intellect; children add to wealth; learned speech
3 🚩	Creative communication; studious effort; active children
4 ●	Education strong; mother's blessing; children at home
5 ●	Bright mind, blessed children, good past merit (own house)
6 ○	Children's health or studies need care; intellect in service; competitive study
7 ●	Children through partner; a creative spouse; romance becomes marriage
8 ○	Children delayed or the relationship transformed; occult intellect; research
9 ●	Dharmic intelligence; fortunate children; guru's grace
10 ●	Creative career; children successful; recognition for intellect
11 ●	Gains from intellect and speculation; prosperous children
12 ○	Children far away or late; spiritual intellect; expenses on children

Lord of the 6th (enemies, disease, service, debts) in the... *Why these rows:* the 6th is struggle and service; its lord brings competition and work to the house it sits in. The 6th and 12th are one axis (the fight and the retreat), which is why the 6th lord in the 12th, enemies in the house of loss, is a Viparita yoga.

House	Derived meaning
1 ●	Health needs attention; competitive nature; service-minded
2 ●	Debts touch family wealth; disputes over money; family health
3 🕯	Struggles with siblings; hard work; courage against rivals
4 ●	Domestic disputes; mother's health; property litigation
5 ●	Children's health; competition in studies; a sharp, combative intellect
6 🕯	Defeats enemies, excels in service, resists disease (own house)
7 ●	Friction with partner; service through partnership; spouse's health
8 🕯	Harsha Viparita: enemies undo themselves; strong longevity
9 ●	Disagreements with father or guru; service abroad; fortune by effort
10 ●	Career in service, medicine, law, the army; competition at work
11 ●	Gains through service and competition; friction with elder siblings
12 🕯	Harsha Viparita: enemies vanish; hospitals or service abroad

Lord of the 7th (spouse, partnership, business) in the... *Why these rows:* the 7th is the other person; its lord brings partnership to wherever it sits. The 7th and 1st are one axis (you and the one facing you), so the 7th lord in the 1st makes the partner a shaper of the self.

House	Derived meaning
1 ●	Partner-centred life; the spouse influences the self strongly
2 ●	Spouse brings wealth; family grows through marriage
3 🕯	Partner met through communication; travel after marriage
4 ●	Spouse from a familiar circle; domestic harmony; property via marriage
5 ●	Love marriage tendency; a creative partner; children through the partner
6 ○	Friction or health issues in marriage; partner in service; patience needed
7 ●	Strong marriage and partnerships; business acumen (own house)
8 ○	Marriage brings deep change; partner's health; in-laws' wealth
9 ●	Fortunate spouse; marriage abroad or across communities; dharmic partner
10 ●	Partner tied to career; business partnerships; status through marriage
11 ●	Gains through partner; spouse from friends' circle
12 ○	Spouse from far away; expenses on marriage; private comforts

Lord of the 8th (longevity, hidden matters, transformation) in the... *Why these rows:* the 8th is the loss of fortune (12th from the 9th), what happens to you; its lord brings change to the house it occupies. On the 2–8 axis, the 8th lord in the 2nd turns others' resources into yours.

House	Derived meaning
1 ●	Transformative personality; health caution; occult interest
2 ●	Inheritance shapes wealth; secretive speech; fluctuating savings
3 🕯	Courage tested; siblings' hidden matters; research writing
4 ●	Property through inheritance; mother's health; deep education
5 ●	Children's matters transformed; occult intellect; speculation caution
6 🕯	Sarala Viparita: hidden troubles defeated; strong longevity
7 ●	Partner's health; hidden sides of marriage; in-laws prominent
8 🕯	Long life, deep researcher, handles crises well (own house)
9 ●	Father's hidden matters; unorthodox dharma; fortune through change
10 ●	Career in insurance, research, surgery, the occult; career breaks
11 ●	Gains through inheritance, insurance, sudden windfalls
12 🕯	Sarala Viparita: hidden enemies vanish; moksha inclination

Lord of the 9th (fortune, father, guru) in the... *Why these rows:* the 9th is grace received; its lord brings luck and guidance to the house it sits in. The 9th and 10th are the two best houses of the chart, so their lords meeting, the 9th lord in the 10th, is the celebrated Dharma-Karma link.

House	Derived meaning
1 ●	Fortunate, dharmic personality; father's blessing
2 ●	Wealth through luck; a religious family; truthful speech
3 🕯	Fortune by effort; fortunate siblings; short pilgrimages
4 ●	Fortunate home; strong education; a devout mother
5 ●	Strong past merit; wise children; guru's grace
6 ○	Father's health; disputes with teachers; fortune through service
7 ●	Fortunate spouse; marriage abroad; dharma through partnership
8 ○	Father's health caution; fortune fluctuates; deep philosophy
9 ●	Strong fortune, guru, father (own house)
10 ●	Dharma-Karma link: a righteous, fortunate career; father helps
11 ●	Gains through fortune; fortunate elder siblings; wishes granted
12 ○	Fortune abroad; charitable; father distant; spiritual life

Lord of the 10th (career, status) in the... *Why these rows:* the 10th is action in the world; its lord brings work and status to the house it occupies. On the 4–10 axis, the 10th lord in the 4th brings career home; in the 9th it borrows fortune's grace.

House	Derived meaning
1 ●	Career-driven; self-employment; recognition
2 ●	Career builds wealth; family business; speech in the profession
3 🇮	Career in communication, sales, media; success by effort
4 ●	Career from home, property or education; mother's help
5 ●	Creative or advisory career; speculation; work with children
6 ○	Career in service, medicine, law; competition; job changes
7 ●	Career through partnerships; business; spouse in the work
8 ○	Career transformations; insurance, research, occult; breaks and comebacks
9 ●	Dharma-Karma link: fortunate career; teaching, law, travel
10 ●	Strong career and status (own house)
11 ●	Gains from career; ambitious; strong networks
12 ○	Career abroad or behind the scenes; hospitals; isolation

Lord of the 11th (gains, elder siblings, friends) in the... *Why these rows:* the 11th is the 6th from the 6th, the enemy of enemies, hence gains; its lord brings income and friends to wherever it sits. On the 5–11 axis the 11th lord in the 5th gains through intellect and children.

House	Derived meaning
1 ●	A gainful personality; friends help; wishes fulfilled
2 ●	Gains build wealth; family friendships
3 🇮	Gains through effort and siblings
4 ●	Gains through property and mother
5 ●	Gains through children, intellect, speculation
6 ○	Gains through service; disputes with friends; debts
7 ●	Gains through spouse and business
8 ○	Gains through inheritance or insurance; friends' losses
9 ●	Gains through fortune and father
10 ●	Gains through career; ambitious
11 ●	Strong gains, helpful elder siblings (own house)
12 ○	Gains spent; income from abroad; friends far away

Lord of the 12th (expenses, distance, release) in the... *Why these rows:* the 12th is the loss of the self: expense, sleep, distance, release; its lord spends the house it occupies on far places or on letting go. On the 6–12 axis the 12th lord in the 6th (loss of struggle) is a Viparita yoga.

House	Derived meaning
1 ●	Expenses on self; foreign residence; a spiritual bent
2 ●	Expenses on family; spending exceeds saving
3 🕯	Expenses on siblings and journeys; effort abroad
4 ●	Expenses on home; mother far away; love of sleep and comfort
5 ●	Expenses on children and education; meditative intellect
6 🕯	Vimala Viparita: losses cancel; hospital or service work abroad
7 ●	Expenses on spouse; a foreign partner
8 🕯	Vimala Viparita: losses cancel; occult depth
9 ●	Expenses on pilgrimage and father; fortune abroad
10 ●	Career abroad; behind-the-scenes work; expenses on career
11 ●	Gains balance expenses; friends abroad
12 🕯	Controlled expenses; a life abroad; moksha (own house)

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Reading one line from these tables as a prediction. "7th lord in the 6th means divorce" is not in the table, and it is not true. The table says *friction, and patience needed*. Whether that friction is a stormy first year or a lifelong struggle is decided by dignity, aspects, the karaka, the Navamsa and the dasha, never by one line.

Lords in their own house (Swakshetra)

When a lord sits in the house it owns, the shop-owner is behind his own counter and the house is stable. The twelve, in one line each:

1st lord in the 1st, a strong body and will. 2nd in the 2nd, wealth holds. 3rd in the 3rd, courage and siblings steady. 4th in the 4th, home and mother secure. 5th in the 5th, intelligence and children blessed. 6th in the 6th, enemies and disease held at bay. 7th in the 7th, marriage and business firm (Chart B's Venus). 8th in the 8th, long life, deep mind (Chart B's Saturn). 9th in the 9th, fortune protected (Chart A's Moon in Cancer). 10th in the 10th, career solid. 11th in the 11th, gains steady. 12th in the 12th, expenses controlled, a spiritual life (Chart A's Venus in Libra).

Notice that the 6th, 8th and 12th lords in their *own* houses are good, a malefic guarding its own gate keeps trouble inside it.

CONSULTATION TIP: When a lord has gone to the 6th, 8th or 12th, never say "your marriage house is destroyed" or "your children house is spoilt". Say where the matter has *gone*: "Your partner is likely to come from far away, or the marriage will involve distance." Distance, service and transformation are things a person can plan for. Destruction is not, and it is almost never what the chart says.

Two lords together: fusing two houses

When two lords sit in one house, the two houses they own are fused and poured into the house they occupy. The 9th and 10th lords together fuse fortune with career: the **Dharma-Karma Adhipati yoga**, the most reliable career signal in the classics. The 1st and 10th lords: the self-made professional. The 2nd and 11th lords: a **Dhana yoga** of wealth and gains. The 6th and 7th lords: disputes fused with marriage. The 5th and 9th lords: Lakshmi's two houses in one room.

This is where Chapter 8 meets Chapter 10. A **Raja yoga** is simply an angle lord and a trine lord connected: by conjunction, mutual aspect, or exchange (Chapter 6's Sambandha). In Chart A, the Sun (10th lord) and Jupiter (5th lord) are in mutual aspect from the 1st and 7th: the machinery beneath Meera's teaching career. Chapter 10 names and ranks these.

Dispositors: following the owners

Every planet sits in a sign, and that sign has a lord. The lord of the sign a planet sits in is that planet's **dispositor**, its landlord. The planet lives in the landlord's house and takes on the landlord's mood. Follow the chain: Sun in Scorpio, landlord Mars; Mars in Pisces, landlord Jupiter; Jupiter in Taurus, landlord Venus; Venus in Libra, its own sign. The chain stops there. Venus is the **final dispositor**: the landlord of landlords.

WHY DOES THE LANDLORD MATTER? *System grammar:* A planet in another planet's sign is a tenant: it works, but on premises it does not control, and its results depend on the condition of the owner. A strong dispositor lends strength; a weak or afflicted one quietly undermines even a well-placed tenant. Follow the rent up the chain and the planet it ends at is the one whose condition sets the ceiling for the whole chart. *Everyday:* your landlord is pleasant, but the flat's fate depends on the man *he* pays, when the building's owner sells, every tenant moves.

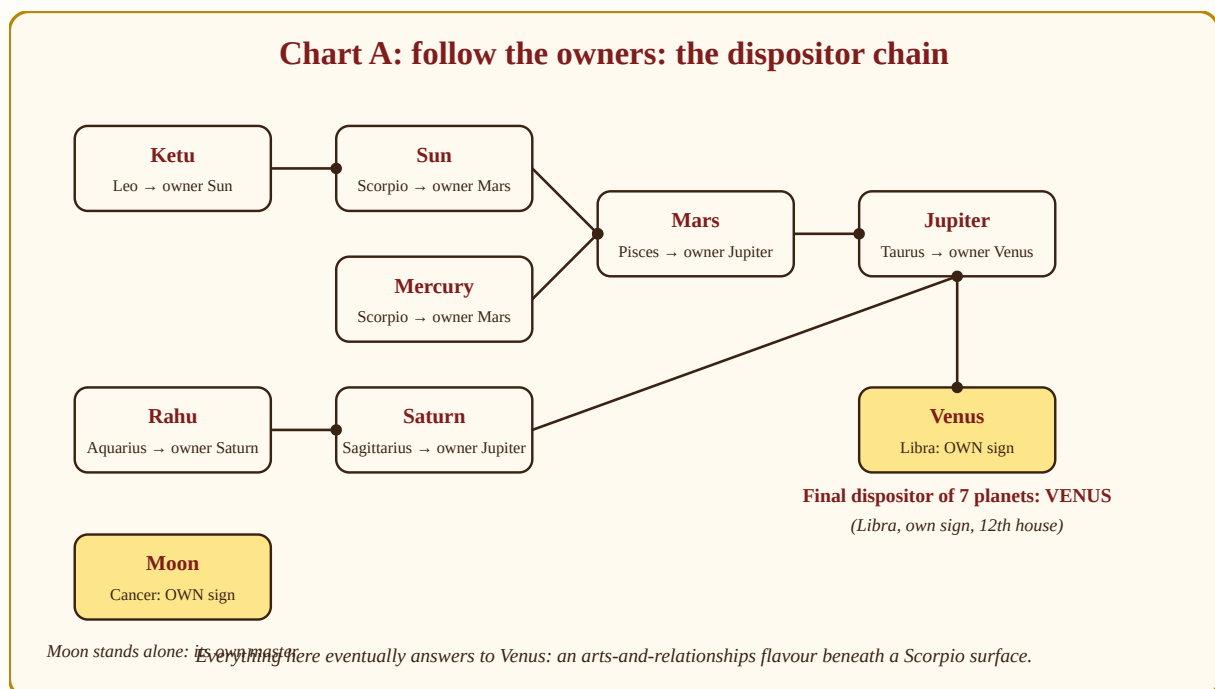


Figure 9.4: Chart A's dispositor chain. Seven planets eventually answer to Venus in Libra; the Moon, in its own sign Cancer, stands alone.

In Chart A: the Sun and Mercury (Scorpio) answer to Mars; Mars (Pisces) and Saturn (Sagittarius) answer to Jupiter; Jupiter (Taurus) answers to Venus; Rahu (Aquarius) answers to Saturn and so to Jupiter and Venus; Ketu (Leo) answers to the Sun and

so to Mars, Jupiter, Venus. Seven of nine end at Venus. The Moon sits in Cancer, its own sign, and answers to nobody.

STORY: WHO DOES YOUR LANDLORD PAY RENT TO? *The young Prince rents a room in the Commander's house. Ask the Commander, and he admits he rents his house from the Royal Priest. The Priest, it turns out, rents from the Minister of Pleasure. And the Minister of Pleasure? She owns her house outright. So when the Prince's rent goes up, it is because the Minister raised it three landlords away. Follow the rent up the chain and you find who really runs the neighbourhood. In Chart A that is Venus: the Sun and Mercury pay Mars, Mars and Saturn pay Jupiter, Jupiter pays Venus, and Venus pays nobody. The Queen Mother, in her own Cancer house, is the one tenant on the street who is also her own landlord. Rule: A planet's dispositor is the lord of the sign it occupies; follow the chain to the planet in its own sign, the final dispositor, to find the chart's hidden centre.*

What this tells you: beneath Meera's Scorpio surface (intense, private, Sun-and-Mercury sharp) the chart is ultimately run by Venus: relationships, aesthetics, harmony, comfort. Whatever happens to Venus by dasha or transit ripples through everything; the Moon's independence means her emotional life runs on its own track. A final dispositor in its own or exalted sign, as here, marks a chart with a strong central motive. When there is no single final dispositor (two planets in their own signs, or a loop) the person has two centres of gravity, and you read both.

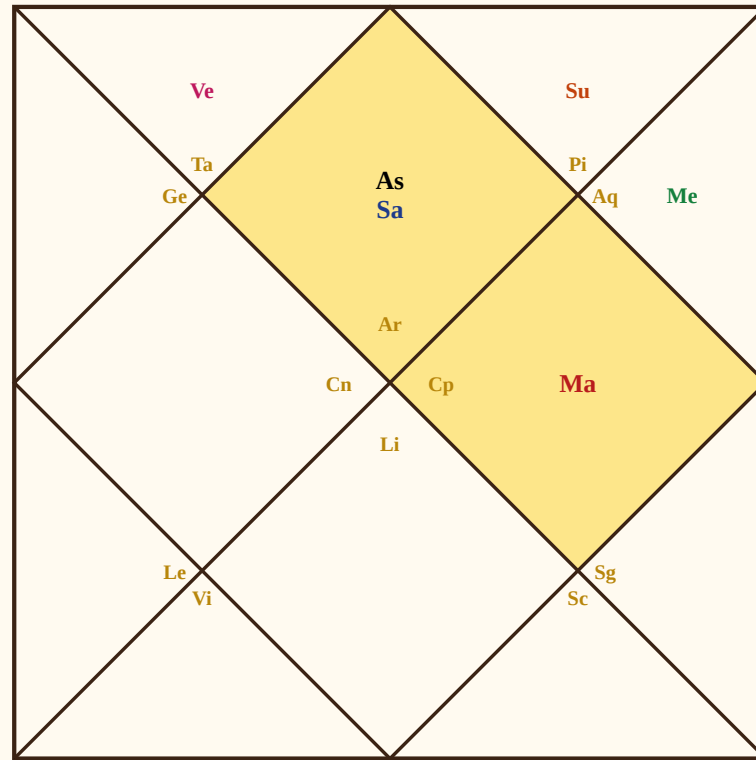
Exchange of lords: Parivartana

The most striking of the four Sambandhas from Chapter 6 is the **exchange** (*Parivartana*): the lord of house A sits in house B, and the lord of house B sits in house A. The two owners have swapped shops, and the houses fuse so tightly that the classics read each lord *as if it were in its own house*, with the flavour of the other. Three kinds are distinguished:

Kind	Houses involved	Result
Maha ("great")	Both among 1, 2, 4, 5, 7, 9, 10, 11	Both houses flourish; a strong yoga
Khala ("mischievous")	One is the 3rd (some teachers include the 11th on the trishadaya principle)	Mixed; gains after struggle, or effort that pays late
Dainya ("wretched")	One is the 6th, 8th or 12th	The good house is dragged into difficulty; both suffer, then adjust

WHY DOES AN EXCHANGE FUSE TWO HOUSES? *System grammar; Parashara lists the exchange among the ways two planets are connected. Each lord sits in the other's house, so each acts on the other's matters as host and tenant at once, and the connection runs both ways with no gap, the most complete of the four Sambandhas. Because each planet stands in the sign its partner owns, the classics read each as if it were also in its own sign: two houses, one estate. Everyday: two managers swap desks and each answers the other's phone all day; within a month nobody can tell whose department is whose.*

Maha Parivartana: 1st lord in the 10th, 10th lord in the 1st



Mars sits in Saturn's Capricorn; Saturn sits in Mars's Aries. The two houses fuse

Figure 9.5: A constructed Maha Parivartana. The 1st lord Mars sits in the 10th (Saturn's Capricorn); the 10th lord Saturn sits in the 1st (Mars's Aries). Self and career are fused.

In the constructed chart above, an Aries Lagna has Mars (1st lord) in the 10th and Saturn (10th lord) in the 1st: a Maha Parivartana between the 1st and 10th. Identity and career are one, the self-made professional who rises to authority, with Saturn's discipline in the personality and Mars's drive in the work. It even softens Saturn's debilitation in Aries, because Saturn is exchanging with its own dispositor, a Neecha Bhanga, as Appendix A.11 notes.

STORY: TWO LANDLORDS SWAP KEYS. The Queen Mother owns the Cancer house in the 4th district; the Royal Priest owns the Sagittarius house in the 9th. One day they exchange keys: she moves into his house, he moves into hers. Now every repair she orders in his house is a repair to her own interest, and every blessing he gives in her house comes home to him. The two households become one estate, neither can be judged without the other. If both houses are in good districts, the estate prospers (Maha). If one of them is the cramped house of effort in the 3rd district, the swap is mischievous, profit, but with labour (Khala). If one of them is the sick-room, the storeroom of debts or the guest-house of losses, the good landlord is dragged into a bad neighbourhood (Dainya). **Rule:** Parivartana fuses two houses; judge it Maha, Khala or Dainya by the houses involved.

Now look at Chart C, because it has a real one. Devika's Moon sits in Sagittarius, Jupiter's sign; her Jupiter sits in Cancer, the Moon's sign. For Aries Lagna, Cancer is the 4th house and Sagittarius the 9th. So the 4th lord and the 9th lord have exchanged, an angle and a trine, both good houses: a **Maha Parivartana**, and at the same time a Raja yoga by exchange (Chapter 10). Home and fortune are fused; the mother is devout and the home a place of learning; higher education and grace come through the family; and exalted Jupiter in the 4th is read as if it were in its own 9th as well. This is the quiet engine beneath her chart, and it is also why the pressured 5th house, whose lord sits with this Jupiter, ends in success. When you meet an exchange in any chart, it is often the single most important feature, and you should say so.

DID YOU KNOW? *Parivartana* is the everyday Hindi word for "change". Some South Indian teachers call the exchange the strongest of all relationships, stronger even than conjunction, because it is *mutual and complete*: each planet is read as if it had gone home.

In one breath

- Every house has a lord (the lord of its sign), and the lord carries the house's matters to wherever it sits.
- A lord in an angle, trine, 2nd or 11th makes its house flourish; in the 3rd it works hard; in 6, 8 or 12 it struggles or is transformed, unless it is in its own sign, or forms a Viparita yoga.
- Judge any house in five steps: the house, the lord, the karaka, the same house from the Moon, the divisional chart.
- The 144 "lord of N in M" combinations are derived, not memorised: combine the two houses' meanings and colour by the destination's quality (● good houses, ● the 3rd, ○ the 6th, 8th, 12th).
- The Lagna lord is the captain; its placement tells you where the person's life energy is invested.
- A lord in its own house stabilises that house, even the 6th, 8th and 12th lords.
- Two lords together fuse two houses; an angle lord and a trine lord connected is a Raja yoga (Chapter 10).
- Follow dispositors to the final dispositor to find the chart's hidden centre; an exchange of lords (*Parivartana*) is Maha, Khala or Dainya by the houses involved: Chart C has a Maha exchange of the 4th and 9th lords.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. For a Leo Lagna, name the lord of the 4th house. If it sits in the 10th house, what sign is it in, and what does the placement suggest?
2. In Chart B (Cancer Lagna), where is the 10th lord? Apply the five-step method's first two steps to Arjun's career.
3. Chart C (Aries Lagna): find the dispositor of Saturn, then of that planet, and name the final dispositor of Saturn's chain.
4. A Sagittarius Lagna has Mercury in Pisces and Jupiter in Gemini. Which houses are exchanging, and what kind of *Parivartana* is it?
5. Devika's 6th lord is Mercury, and it sits in the 5th house. Is this a Viparita Raja yoga? Why or why not?

Answers

1. For Leo, the 4th house is Scorpio and its lord is Mars. The 10th house is Taurus, so Mars sits in Taurus: Venus's sign, where Mars is neutral. The 4th lord in the 10th: home, mother, property or education linked to career: a family business, real estate, teaching, or a mother who shaped the profession. Mars adds engineering, land and the army to the possibilities. 2. The 10th house is Aries; its lord Mars sits in the 2nd house, Leo, retrograde. Step 1, the house: Aries is occupied by Ketu, and aspected by Rahu from the 4th; Jupiter from the 5th does not reach it (its aspects fall on the 9th, 11th and 1st). A career with a detached, technical, unconventional flavour. Step 2, the lord: Mars in the 2nd, in the Sun's sign (a friend), *yogakaraka* for Cancer, career feeds wealth and speech; he earns by his mind and voice, and his career strengthens in Mars's periods. 3. Saturn is in Leo; its dispositor is the Sun. The Sun is in Cancer; its dispositor is the Moon. The Moon is in Sagittarius; its dispositor is Jupiter. Jupiter is in Cancer, whose lord is the Moon. The chain ends in a Moon-Jupiter loop, which is exactly the 4th–9th *Parivartana* we met in this chapter, so there is no single final dispositor; Saturn's chain resolves to the Moon-Jupiter pair, the mind and wisdom. 4. For Sagittarius,

Pisces is the 4th house (lord Jupiter) and Gemini is the 7th house (lord Mercury). Mercury sits in Jupiter's Pisces (the 4th) and Jupiter sits in Mercury's Gemini (the 7th): an exchange between the 4th and 7th. Both are angles among the good houses, so it is a Maha Parivartana, home and marriage fused; property through the spouse, a partner who becomes family. (Note Mercury is debilitated in Pisces; the exchange with its dispositor is a Neecha Bhanga.) 5. No. Viparita Raja yoga requires the 6th, 8th or 12th lord to sit in *another* of the houses 6, 8 or 12. Mercury, the 6th lord, is in the 5th, a trine, not a dusthana. It is simply the 6th lord in the 5th: competition in studies, children's health to watch, a sharp and combative intellect, which fits the pressured 5th house we read in this chapter.

Chapter 10: Yogas: When Planets Form a Team

A cricket team is eleven players. But eleven good players do not make a good team, and a team of ordinary players who understand each other can win a World Cup. Something happens *between* them.

Planets do the same. Jupiter alone is a wise man; the Moon alone is a sensitive mind. Put Jupiter at a square angle from that Moon and you get something neither produces by itself: a mind that is protected, that recovers from every fall. The old astrologers noticed such combinations again and again and called them **yogas**. The word simply means "joining".

When I was learning this, yogas were the part of the classics that made me want to give up: every page a new name, a new condition, and no reason for any of it. This chapter is the version I wish I had been given: the principle first, then the twenty or so yogas you will actually meet, each with its reason, and finally the skill of judging whether a yoga is *alive* or just a name on paper.

What a yoga is, and the beginner's danger

A yoga is **a relationship between planets or houses that produces a result neither would produce alone**. A planet in a house is a placement; a planet in a sign is dignity; a yoga needs at least two things to *connect*. Hold that firmly and you stop asking "does this chart have Gaja Kesari?" as though it were a passport stamp, and start asking "are the Moon and Jupiter working together here, and how well?"

Now the danger. Open *Phaladeepika* or *Jataka Parijata* and you find yogas by the hundred; students memorise (and drown) or give up. You need roughly **twenty yogas** in active memory and the **principle** so firmly held that number 201 reads as "ah, a Raja yoga through the 4th and 9th lords". The principle: *connection between the right houses, by the right planets, in good condition*. Four ideas cover most of it: kendra plus trikona gives status; wealth houses connected gives wealth; difficult lords in difficult houses cancel evil; fallen planets rescued by their dispositors rise again.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: A yoga is a sentence, not a word. Ask three things: who is talking (the planets), what about (the houses they own and occupy), and are they actually in the same room (the connection). If any is missing, there is no sentence.

The glue: four kinds of relationship (Sambandha)

Chapter 6 taught you aspects and conjunctions; here is where you use them. Two planets are in **relationship** (*Sambandha*) when joined in any of these four ways, strongest first:

1. **Together in one sign** (conjunction, *Yuti*): two people in one room; the closer in degree, the tighter the bond.
2. **Mutual aspect** (*Paraspara Drishti*): two people facing each other. Any two planets in opposite signs see each other; Mars (4/8), Jupiter (5/9) and Saturn (3/10) can complete a mutual aspect from other distances too.
3. **Exchange of signs** (*Parivartana*): each sits in the other's house. Many teachers rank this the strongest bond; the two houses fuse.
4. **One-sided influence**: one planet aspects the other without being aspected back, or sits in the other's sign. Influence, not partnership. Half marks.

WHY? System grammar. Conjunction and mutual aspect are *two-way*: each planet receives the other. Exchange is stronger still because each planet lives in the other's house, so the two houses cannot be separated. A one-sided aspect shapes one planet and not the other. Everyday parallel: two colleagues who message each other daily are a team; one who only reads your messages is an audience.

Raja yogas: the royal combinations

Raja means king. A Raja yoga raises status: authority, recognition, a life somewhat larger than the family one was born into. The formation: **a lord of a kendra (1, 4, 7, 10) connected with a lord of a trikona (1, 5, 9).**

STORY: THE PILLAR-KEEPER AND THE TREASURY-KEEPER. *In the King's haveli there are two kinds of officers. The pillar-keepers hold the four corners of the building, the kendras (houses 1, 4, 7 and 10), where the doors open and the real business of the household happens. The treasury-keepers hold Lakshmi's three rooms, the trikonas (1, 5 and 9), where merit, children and fortune are stored. Most days they never meet: the pillar-keeper is busy with visitors, the treasury-keeper is counting. But when one pillar-keeper and one treasury-keeper are found in the same room, or looking at each other across the courtyard, or have swapped keys, the household rises. Effort has found its funding; fortune has found a door to walk through. The Lagna lord holds both kinds of key, since house 1 is a pillar and a treasury, so he can shake hands with either side. **Rule:** a kendra lord connected with a trikona lord makes a Raja yoga.*

WHY? System grammar, stated by Parashara in the Raja yoga chapter of Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra: kendras are the houses of power and position (Vishnu's houses), trikonas the houses of merit and fortune (Lakshmi's houses). Power without merit is a post nobody trusts; merit without power is talent nobody sees. Connected, they make status. Everyday parallel: the officer who has both the post and the public's respect; plenty have one or the other, and the one with both is the one people remember.

Let us derive it for Chart A, Meera, Scorpio Lagna. First the lordships (Chapter 9):

House	Sign	Lord	Where the lord sits	Condition
1 (kendra + trikona)	Scorpio	Mars	5th (Pisces), retrograde	● trikona, friend's sign
4 (kendra)	Aquarius	Saturn	2nd (Sagittarius)	○ combust, 7° from the Sun
5 (trikona)	Pisces	Jupiter	7th (Taurus), retrograde	● kendra, but enemy's sign
7 (kendra)	Taurus	Venus	12th (Libra)	● own sign, but a dusthana
9 (trikona)	Cancer	Moon	9th (Cancer)	● own sign, own house
10 (kendra)	Leo	Sun	1st (Scorpio)	● friend's sign, but 28°, the sign's edge

Now hunt for connections between kendra lords (Mars, Saturn, Venus, Sun) and trikona lords (Mars, Jupiter, Moon).

- **Sun (10th lord) in the 1st and Jupiter (5th lord) in the 7th** sit in opposite houses and aspect each other by the 7th aspect: a genuine **mutual aspect between a kendra lord and a trikona lord**. The 10th (career, status) joins the 5th (intelligence, students, merit), exactly the right pair for a teacher and consultant.
- **Mars (Lagna lord) in the 5th**, a trikona, in Jupiter's sign; but Jupiter's aspects from the 7th fall on the 11th, 1st and 3rd, not the 5th. Good placement, no partnership.

- **Moon (9th lord) in the 9th**, own sign: strong but alone.
- **Venus (7th lord) in the 12th** and **Saturn (4th lord) in the 2nd**: no trikona lord joins either.

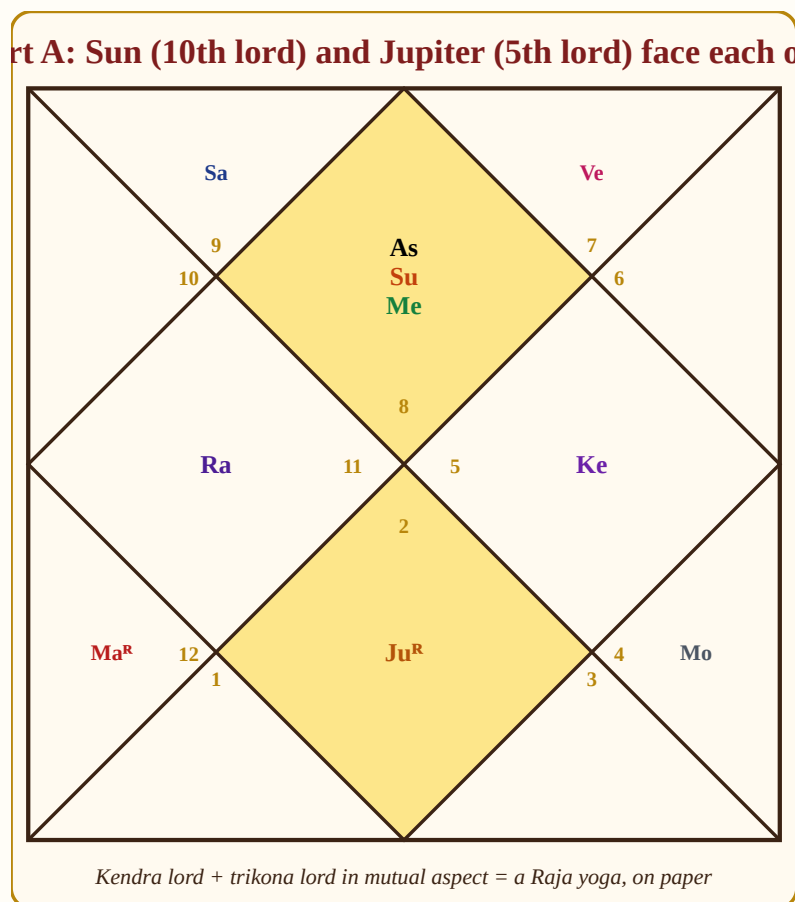


Figure 10.1: Chart A. The 10th lord Sun in the 1st and the 5th lord Jupiter in the 7th look straight at each other: a Raja yoga by mutual aspect.

So Meera has one Raja yoga on paper. Now honesty. The Sun sits at 28° Scorpio, the last two degrees of the sign, in the tail of Jyeshtha, the sensitive gandanta edge (Chapter 7). Jupiter is retrograde in Taurus, the sign of Venus, its natural enemy. A real yoga with two tired players: recognition that comes later than hoped and smaller than the effort; respect rather than fame. Say "steady rise, recognition in your forties", not "you will rule".

Chart B, Arjun, Cancer Lagna, shows another pattern. Mars owns both the 5th and the 10th: the **yogakaraka**, which carries the Raja yoga inside itself (Chapter 8). Arjun's Mars, in the 2nd, throws its 4th aspect onto Jupiter, the 9th lord, in the 5th; Jupiter does not aspect back. Half a Raja yoga on a strong yogakaraka: "a rise through your own effort and speech, slowly".

DID YOU KNOW? The most celebrated Raja yoga is **Dharma-Karmadhipati yoga**, the lords of the 9th (dharma) and 10th (karma) joined. Parashara ranks it first because it fuses grace with work. Neither Meera nor Arjun has it.

Dhana yogas: the wealth combinations

A **Dhana yoga** is any connection among the lords of the wealth houses, 2 (what you hold), 11 (what flows in), 5 (merit) and 9 (fortune), and the Lagna (the one who must earn). Three planets deserve special mention: **Jupiter**, the natural significator of wealth; **Venus**, comforts and luxury; the **Moon**, liquidity, cash that moves. When one of them is among the connected lords, the yoga is noticeably richer.

WHY? System grammar. The 2nd and 11th are the money rooms: the 2nd is what is *kept*, the 11th what *arrives* (it is the 2nd from the 10th, the earnings of the career). The 5th and 9th are the merit rooms, the reason money is allowed to come. Wealth is money rooms fed by merit rooms, received by the Lagna. Everyday parallel: salary account (11th), savings (2nd), and the goodwill that keeps the salary coming (5th, 9th). Unconnected, money passes through without staying.

In Chart A, Jupiter (2nd and 5th lord) in the 7th and Mercury (11th lord) in the 1st aspect each other: a **mutual aspect between the 2nd/5th lord and the 11th lord**, a proper Dhana yoga. Add the Moon, 9th lord, powerful in its own sign in the 9th, and money comes steadily through knowledge and communication. Meera will not be poor; nor a tycoon. Jupiter's condition sets the ceiling.

Panch Mahapurusha yogas: the five great persons

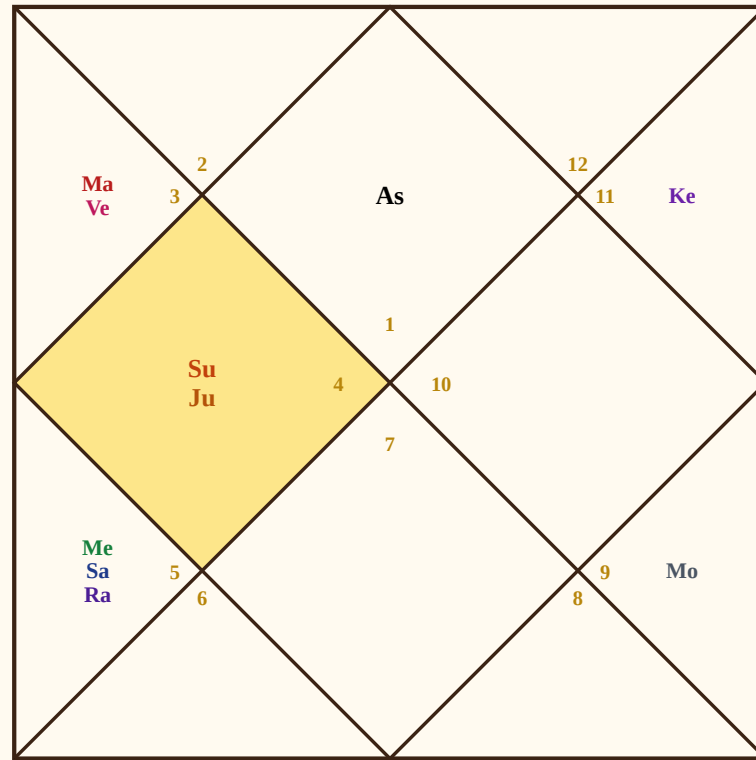
These arise when one of the five true planets, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus or Saturn, sits **in its own sign or exaltation sign, and that sign falls in a kendra from the Lagna**. Think of the five as the King's five great officers each standing at a pillar of the haveli in full regalia: the Commander, the Prince, the Priest, the Minister of Pleasure, the old Judge. A *Mahapurusha* is a "great person".

Yoga	Planet	Own signs	Exaltation	Personality it stamps
Ruchaka	Mars	Aries, Scorpio	Capricorn	Commander: courage, strength, leadership in action, a temper
Bhadra	Mercury	Gemini, Virgo	Virgo	Scholar-speaker: intellect, eloquence, trade, a youthful look
Hamsa	Jupiter	Sagittarius, Pisces	Cancer	Sage: wisdom, faith, teaching, a fine reputation
Malavya	Venus	Taurus, Libra	Pisces	Artist-aristocrat: beauty, refinement, comforts, happy marriage
Shasha	Saturn	Capricorn, Aquarius	Libra	Administrator: authority over others, land, discipline, late power

WHY? Two conditions, two reasons, both system grammar. Own or exalted sign is *capacity*: full powers. A kendra is *position*: where a planet is seen and can act (Chapter 4). A dignified planet in a dusthana is a strong person in a back room; an undignified planet in a kendra is an ordinary person in a high chair. Only the combination makes a "great person". Varahamihira's *Brihat Jataka* gives the five in this form; the Sun and Moon are left out as King and Queen Mother, above the rank of officer. Everyday parallel: the brilliant surgeon who is also head of department; skill alone or the chair alone does not make the name the whole city knows.

Chart C, Devika, is a textbook case: Jupiter at 26° Cancer, its exaltation, in the 4th house. **Hamsa yoga**. Devika's chart has real struggles in the 5th (Saturn, Rahu and Mercury together), but Hamsa in the 4th is why she comes through them with grace and is respected.

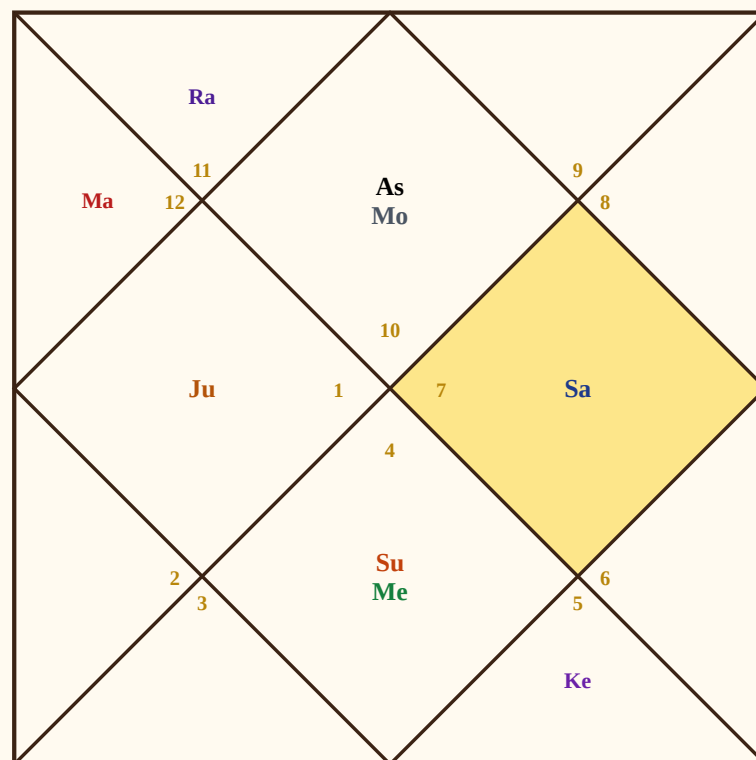
Chart C: Hamsa yoga (Jupiter exalted in Cancer, 4th house)



Jupiter in own or exalted sign in a kendra = Hamsa

Figure 10.2: Chart C, Aries Lagna. Jupiter exalted in Cancer in the 4th forms Hamsa yoga. The Sun sits with it at 5°, twenty-one degrees away, so Jupiter is not combust.

yoga: Saturn exalted in Libra in the 10th (Capricorn)



Constructed example. Saturn owns the Lagna and sits exalted in the career kendra.

Figure 10.3: Shasha yoga, constructed. Capricorn Lagna; Saturn, the Lagna lord, exalted in Libra in the 10th. Such a person rises to authority through patience: a bureaucrat, a builder, a judge.

Two honest notes. Some teachers accept the yoga when the planet is in a kendra **from the Moon**; the classics specify the Lagna, and I note the Moon version only as "supporting". And Chart A's Venus is in its own sign Libra but in the **12th**, not a kendra: no Malavya. A dignified planet in a dusthana is comfortable in private, not on stage.

Yogas from the Moon

Several yogas are counted from the Moon rather than the Lagna. Why the Moon?

WHY? Symbolic logic shared by the whole tradition: the Moon is the mind (*manas*), where life is actually *experienced*. The Lagna says what happens; the Moon says how it is received. So yogas of protection, support, loneliness and mood are measured from the Moon. Everyday parallel: two students get the same marks; one goes home to a calm house, the other to shouting. Same event, different experience.

Gaja Kesari yoga

Jupiter in a kendra from the Moon. *Gaja* is elephant, *Kesari* is lion: a person with the elephant's weight and the lion's majesty, steady, protected, respected.

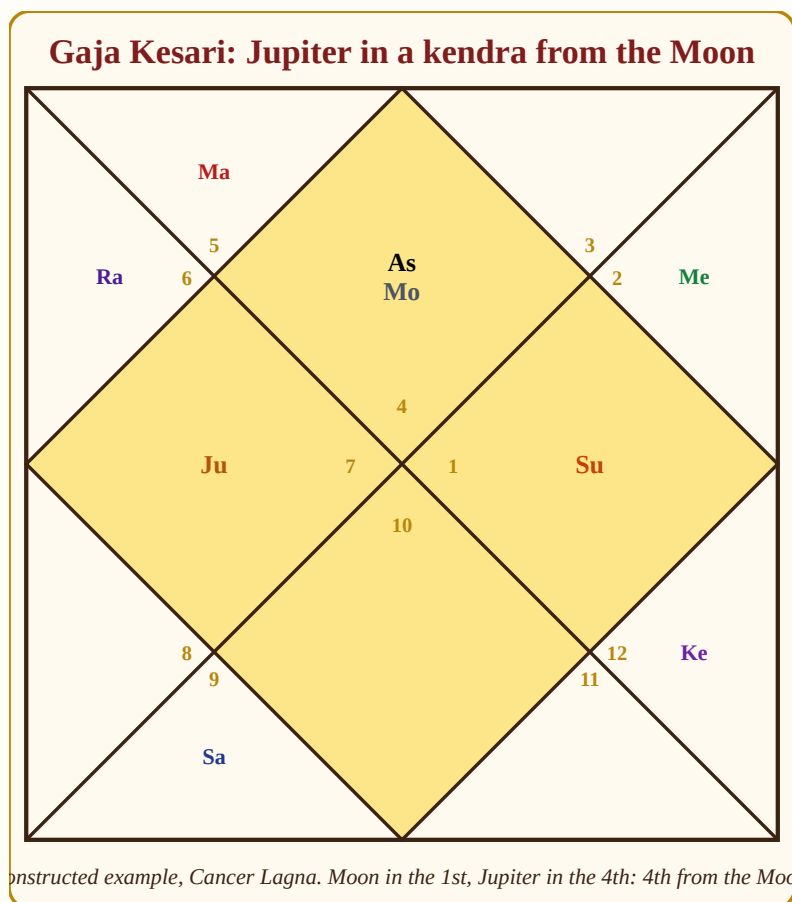


Figure 10.4: Gaja Kesari yoga. Moon in the 1st, Jupiter in the 4th, the 4th from the Moon. Here the kendras from the Moon and from the Lagna coincide, the strongest form.

WHY? Grammar plus symbol. Jupiter is the natural protector and adviser; a kendra is strength and visibility. Jupiter at a pillar *of the mind* means the mind is never without counsel, whatever the Lagna is going through, which is why the yoga gives recovery and a good name rather than wealth as such. Everyday parallel: a level-headed friend in the next seat during exams. Same paper, no panic.

Gaja Kesari is very common, roughly one chart in three, so the strengthening conditions matter: Jupiter not combust, not debilitated, not in an enemy's sign, preferably aspected by benefics; the Moon reasonably bright. A weak Jupiter here is a kind uncle with no money.

Chart A's Jupiter is the 11th from the Moon: no Gaja Kesari. Chart B's Moon is in Taurus and Jupiter in Scorpio, the 7th from it: **Gaja Kesari**, the source of Arjun's resilience through an 8th-house-heavy life. Chart C's Jupiter is the 8th from the Moon; see Shakata below.

Chandra-Mangala yoga

Moon and Mars together or in mutual 7th aspect. Mind joined with drive: earning capacity, enterprise, sometimes a sharp tongue. Chart C has it: the Moon in Sagittarius and Mars in Gemini face each other. Devika earns through communication and effort (Mars in the 3rd).

Adhi yoga

Natural benefics (Mercury, Jupiter, Venus) in the 6th, 7th and 8th from the Moon, like ministers around a queen: leadership, prosperity, protection. The full form needs all three; we accept a partial form with two. Chart C has it partially: Venus in the 7th from the Moon and Jupiter in the 8th.

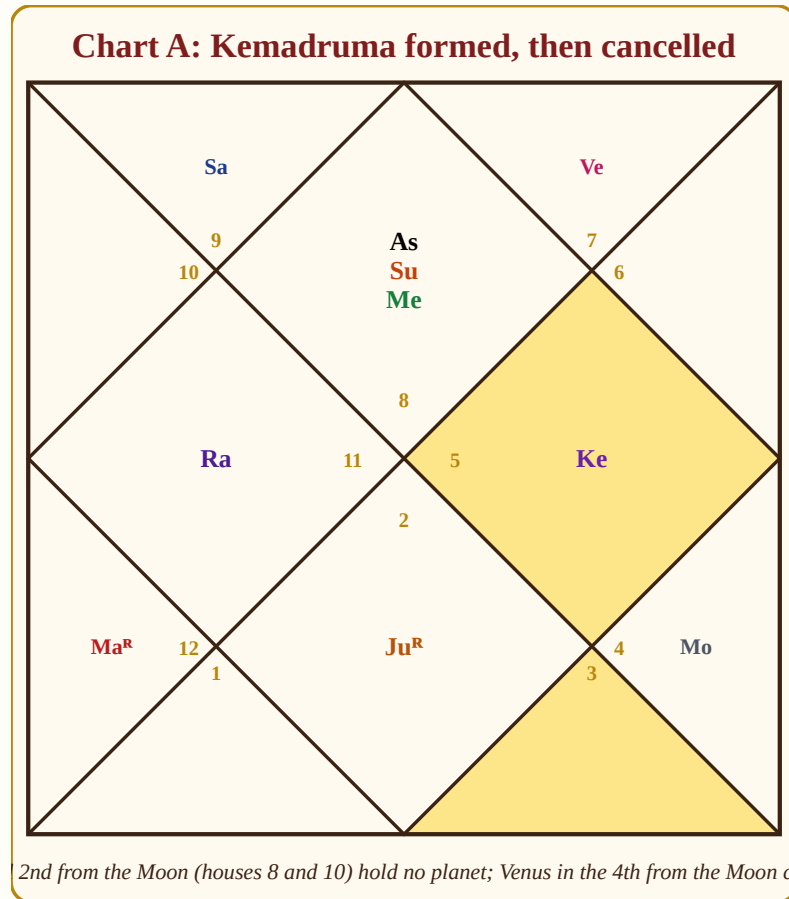
Kemadruma yoga: the lonely Moon

No planet (other than the Sun, Rahu and Ketu) in the 2nd or 12th from the Moon.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER WITH NO ATTENDANTS. *The Queen Mother, the Moon, the mind, walks through the haveli every evening. Custom says an attendant walks one step ahead of her (the 2nd house from the Moon) and one step behind (the 12th). With attendants she is at ease: someone to lean on, someone to announce her. One evening both places are empty. The King (the Sun) does not count; he is too bright, too busy, no company at all. The Smoke-headed Stranger and the Headless Sadhu (Rahu and Ketu) do not count; they are shadows, not attendants. So she walks alone through a long, bare corridor, and that is how the mind feels in Kemadruma: unsupported, lonely, struggling without help, poor in the old texts. But look up. If any courtier stands at a pillar of the corridor, a kendra from her or from the Lagna, he steps forward and the loneliness ends. Rule: Kemadruma forms when the 2nd and 12th from the Moon are empty; any planet in a kendra from the Moon or Lagna cancels it.*

WHY? Symbolic logic, and sound psychology. The mind needs company to stay steady; the houses either side of the Moon are its immediate support, people in the next room. The Sun is excluded because it outshines rather than supports (astronomically, a Moon near the Sun is dark); the nodes because they have no body. The cancellations follow the same logic: a planet at a pillar of the Moon's chart is support within reach. Everyday parallel: a big house with nobody in the next room feels empty however full of things; one relative next door changes everything.

Chart A: the Moon is in Cancer (9th house); Gemini (8th house) is empty and Leo (10th house) holds only Ketu. Kemadruma is *formed*, and cancelled three times over: Venus in Libra is the 4th from the Moon, five planets sit in kendras from the Lagna, the Moon is in its own sign. Meera *feels* alone more than she *is* alone, which is very different from "you will suffer poverty".



Charts B and C also form and cancel it. Frighten someone with the word Kemadruma without checking the cancellations and you have stopped being an astrologer.

Shakata yoga

Jupiter in the 6th, 8th or 12th from the Moon. *Shakata* is a cart: fortunes that rise, fall and rise again, because the protector is hidden from the mind's view (the dusthanas from the Moon are its blind spots). Chart C has it: Cancer is the 8th from the Sagittarius Moon. But that same Jupiter is exalted in a kendra from the Lagna, and most texts cancel *Shakata* then. Ups and downs, with a floor under the falls. The same Jupiter gives Hamsa from one reference point and *Shakata* from another; your job is to weigh, not choose.

Yogas of the mind and the good name

Budha-Aditya: Sun and Mercury together, Mercury not combust. The King and his clever young Prince in one room: intelligence, articulation, skill with words and numbers. Mercury never strays more than about 28° from the Sun (astronomy: its orbit lies inside ours), so the yoga is common; what matters is the distance. Within the combustion orb (about 14°, Appendix A.2) the Prince is scorched; beyond it, the yoga is clean. Chart A: Sun 28°, Mercury 9° Scorpio, 19° apart, in the 1st: a clean Budha-Aditya in the Lagna; Meera thinks on her feet and explains well. Chart B: Sun 18°, Mercury 2° Aquarius, 16° apart, in the 8th: the same gift applied to research.

Amala: a natural benefic alone in the 10th from the Lagna or the Moon. Spotless public action, the honest officer. None of our charts has it.

Saraswati: Jupiter, Venus and Mercury each in a kendra, trikona or the 2nd, with Jupiter strong. Wisdom, beauty and speech all in good rooms (the 2nd is included as the house of speech): learning, arts, writing. None of our charts completes it.

Lakshmi: the 9th lord strong (kendra, own or exalted sign) and the Lagna lord strong. Wealth with grace: the manager of fortune and the manager of the person both in good shape. Chart C: the 9th lord Jupiter exalted in a kendra and exchanging signs with the 4th lord, a perfect first half; but the Lagna lord Mars sits in Gemini, whose lord Mercury is Mars's enemy (Appendix A.3). Half a Lakshmi yoga: money that arrives but never sits still. Chart A: 9th lord Moon in own sign in the 9th, Lagna lord Mars retrograde in a friend's sign, a modest Lakshmi yoga.

Viparita Raja yoga: when two wrongs make a right

The 6th, 8th and 12th are the dusthanas (disease and debt, loss and death, expense and exile), and their lords carry those meanings wherever they go.

STORY: THE THIEF WHO ROBS THE THIEF. *Three shady characters lodge in the haveli's back rooms: the lords of the 6th, 8th and 12th, keepers of debt, death and loss. Each carries a bag of trouble meant for whichever room he enters. Now watch what happens when the keeper of the 12th, the room of loss, wanders into the 8th, the room of death and hidden things. He opens his bag of losses and finds nothing good there to spoil. Loss falls on loss. The two thieves rob each other, and the master of the house, who feared both, wakes to find his troubles have cancelled out. He gains what the other side lost; he survives what should have sunk him. That is Viparita Raja yoga; viparita means inverted. Rule: a dusthana lord placed in another dusthana turns its harm on the harm itself.*

WHY? *Logical derivation, the accountant's double negative. A dusthana lord means "loss of the house it sits in": in the 12th, loss of loss, which is gain; in the 6th, the defeat of enemies and debts; in the 8th, the death of obstacles. Mantreswara's Phaladeepika names the three forms with this reasoning. Everyday parallel: a fine that is cancelled. Nothing good happened, yet you are better off.*

The three names:

- **Harsha:** the 6th lord in the 6th, 8th or 12th.
- **Sarala:** the 8th lord in the 6th, 8th or 12th.
- **Vimala:** the 12th lord in the 6th, 8th or 12th.

Two conditions: the dusthana lord should not be joined with lords of good houses (they get dragged into the pit), and it should preferably be *weak*. Whether a dusthana lord in **its own** dusthana counts is debated; Appendix A.11 takes the strict view (*another* of the three), most Indian astrologers accept the own-house version with reduced force.

Chart B, Cancer Lagna. The 8th house is Aquarius. Sitting there: Saturn (7th and 8th lord, own sign), the Sun (2nd lord) and Mercury (3rd and 12th lord).

- **Mercury**, 12th lord, in the 8th: a 12th lord in another dusthana. **Vimala yoga**, textbook. Losses reverse into gains through research, analysis, insurance or occult subjects.
- **Saturn**, 8th lord, in the 8th: Sarala by the lenient reading, "strong 8th house" by the strict one. Saturn is in its own sign, but it is also **combust**, only 7° from the Sun, well inside Saturn's 15° orb (Appendix A.2). A weakened dusthana lord actually *favours* the reversal reading, so the Sarala flavour is real; but combustion also scorches what Saturn signifies for him personally (the 7th house it owns, discipline, longevity matters), so the gain comes with some cost.
- All three are *together*, and the Sun is the 2nd lord, a wealth lord dragged into the dusthana. The "not with other lords" condition is broken.

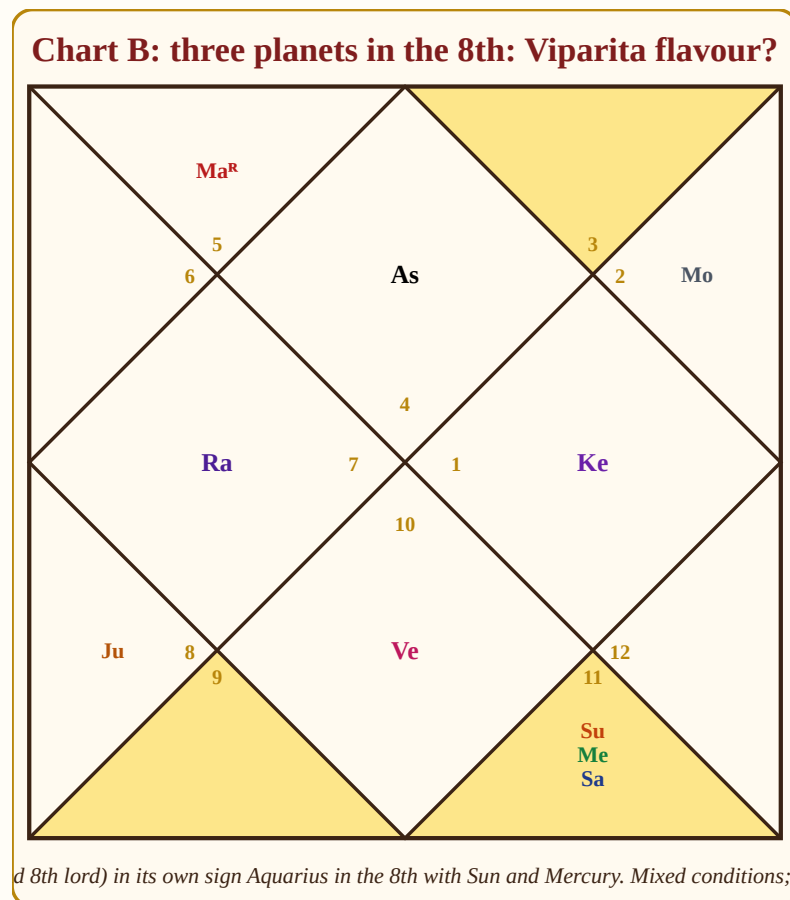


Figure 10.6: Chart B. Saturn (7th and 8th lord, own sign but combust), the Sun (2nd lord) and Mercury (12th lord) together in the 8th. Vimala forms through Mercury; Sarala is arguable; the crowding weakens both.

My reading: a partial Viparita Raja yoga with a Sarala flavour. Arjun does well where other people's difficulties are the raw material. Not a lottery, not a curse; a pattern. Chart A has the same debate in miniature: Venus, 12th lord, in the 12th in its own sign, Vimala by the lenient rule, a strong 12th house by the strict one.

CONSULTATION TIP: Never introduce Viparita Raja yoga as "you gain when others lose". It sounds like a curse or a con. Say: "Your chart is built for fields where you handle other people's crises: medicine, law, insurance, recovery, research. Where others see a problem, you see your work."

Neecha Bhanga Raja yoga: the fallen planet that rises

A debilitated planet (*neecha*) sits in the sign opposite its exaltation: Sun in Libra, Moon in Scorpio, Mars in Cancer, Mercury in Pisces, Jupiter in Capricorn, Venus in Virgo, Saturn in Aries (Appendix A.2). Left alone, it promises what it cannot deliver.

STORY: THE FALLEN MINISTER WHOSE LANDLORD IS THE KING'S FRIEND. *A minister is posted to the one district where nobody respects him: the Sun sent to Libra, the Commander sent to Cancer. He arrives humiliated, his orders ignored. But every district has a landlord, the lord of that sign, and this landlord happens to hold a pillar of the palace: he stands in a kendra, in the King's own courtyard. One word from the landlord and the district falls in line behind the fallen minister. Or the minister's own patron, the lord of the sign where he would have been honoured, stands in a kendra and sends for him. Or the minister, though weak, is himself stationed in a pillar of the Queen Mother's house, a kendra from the Moon, where nobody can ignore him. The fall is real; the rescue is real too, and it always comes through the rescuer's hand, late and in the rescuer's style. **Rule:** a debilitated planet whose dispositor or exaltation lord stands in a kendra, or which stands in a kendra from the Moon, or exchanges signs with its dispositor, has its debility cancelled.*

WHY? *System grammar. A planet in a sign is a tenant and the sign's lord is its landlord; results pass through the landlord's condition (the dispositor, Chapter 9). A powerful landlord (in a kendra) protects a weak tenant; the exaltation lord is the planet's natural patron and counts the same way; a kendra from the Moon gives the weak planet a strong seat in the mind's chart. Everyday parallel: a new employee out of his depth whose manager is well connected. He makes mistakes, nothing bad happens, and in a few years he is promoted through that manager's door.*

Appendix A.11 lists the four conditions; some texts add aspect by the dispositor or company of an exalted planet, and many accept a kendra from the Lagna as well as from the Moon.

When the cancellation is strong the tradition promotes it to *Neecha Bhanga Raja yoga*: a rise from a humble start to real status, often late, the signature of self-made people. None of our case charts has a debilitated planet (Meera's Mars is in Pisces, a friend's sign, not Cancer; students misremember this), so here is a constructed example.

Kala Sarpa yoga: popular, powerful, not in Parashara

Kala Sarpa ("the serpent of time") forms when **all seven planets lie on one side of the Rahu-Ketu axis**, hemmed between the nodes with the other half of the zodiac empty.

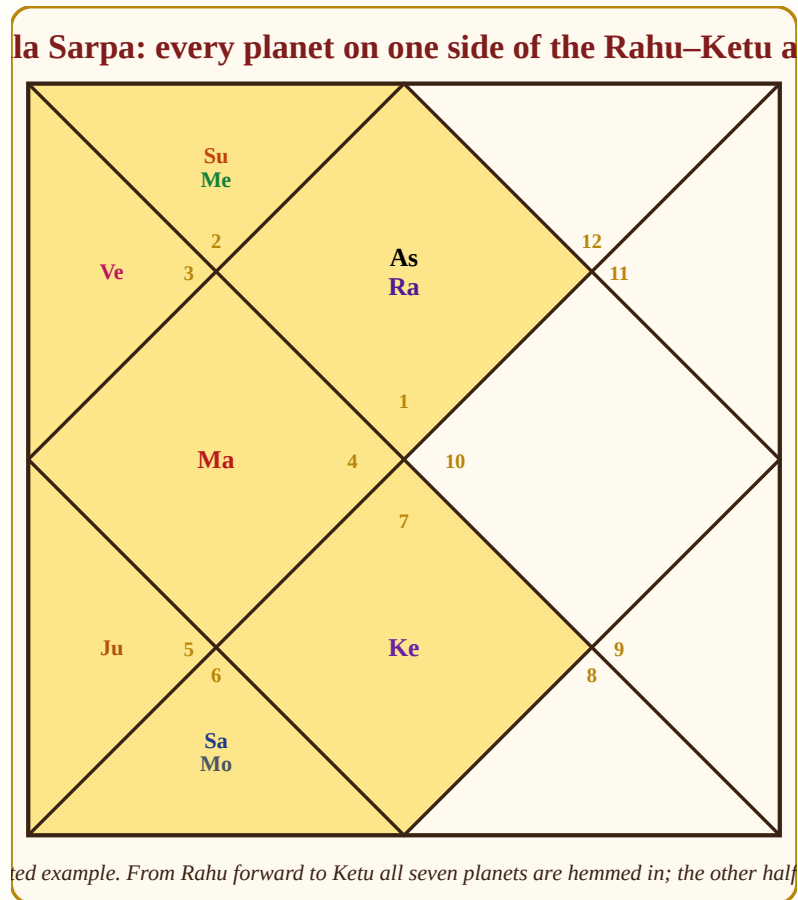


Figure 10.8: Kala Sarpa yoga. Rahu in the 1st, Ketu in the 7th, every planet between them going forward. The empty half of the chart is the tell-tale sign.

Two directions: planets **from Rahu forward to Ketu** (zodiacal order, as in the figure) give Kala Sarpa proper; planets **from Ketu forward to Rahu** give what some call **Kala Amrita**, considered gentler. Both describe a life with a strong sense of fate and sudden turns, often with a late flowering.

Now the honest part. **Kala Sarpa is not in Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra** or the other classics; it is folk teaching, and its interpretation varies by lineage. Its logic is symbolic: the nodes are the eclipse points, and a life "swallowed" between them is said to be lived under a shadow. I treat it as a *texture*, never a verdict; several accomplished people whose published charts I studied while learning had it. In Chart A, Mars, Jupiter and the Moon lie on one side of the Aquarius-Leo axis and the rest on the other: no Kala Sarpa. One planet on the far side breaks it.

Kuja dosha (Mangal dosha): a calm treatment

No idea in Indian astrology has caused more unnecessary fear than the "manglik". So we go slowly, with reasons.

Kuja is Mars; **dosha** is a blemish. The rule: **Mars in the 1st, 2nd, 4th, 7th, 8th or 12th from the Lagna** gives Kuja dosha. The count is repeated **from the Moon** and **from Venus**, so a chart may show the dosha from one, two or all three reference points.

STORY: THE COMMANDER POSTED IN THE BEDROOM WING. The Commander (Mars) is a fine officer on the parade ground: the 3rd, 6th, 10th and 11th houses, where courage, competition and work live. Now post him inside the family wing of the haveli: the master's own room (1st), the dining hall where the family talks (2nd), the mother's quarters (4th), the bride's chamber (7th), the room where the marriage's long years are kept (8th), or the bedroom itself (12th). He does not become a villain. He simply behaves like a commander where a commander is not needed: he speaks in orders, he decides in a hurry, he keeps his sword on the table. Meals turn into arguments; the bride feels commanded rather than courted. That heat in the family wing is all Kuja dosha means: a tendency to friction in married life, not a prediction of widowhood, whatever your neighbour's aunt says. And a commander who is dignified, or watched by the Priest or the old Judge, keeps his manners. **Rule:** Mars in 1, 2, 4, 7, 8 or 12 from the Lagna (also check from the Moon and Venus) gives Kuja dosha, subject to many cancellations.

WHY EXACTLY THESE SIX HOUSES? System grammar: they are the six marriage-and-home houses. The 1st is the self who marries; the 2nd, family and the words spoken at the table; the 4th, the home; the 7th, the spouse; the 8th, the marital bond's longevity (the 2nd from the 7th, the spouse's family, the house of mangalya); the 12th, bed pleasures and the private life. Heat in any of these rooms strains a shared life. The houses not on the list are where Mars is welcome (3, 6, 10, 11) or where merit lives (5, 9). We also count from the Moon (the mind that must live in the marriage) and from Venus (the marriage's own significator). Everyday parallel: the hot-tempered relative whose temper wins cricket matches and starts quarrels at the family dinner.

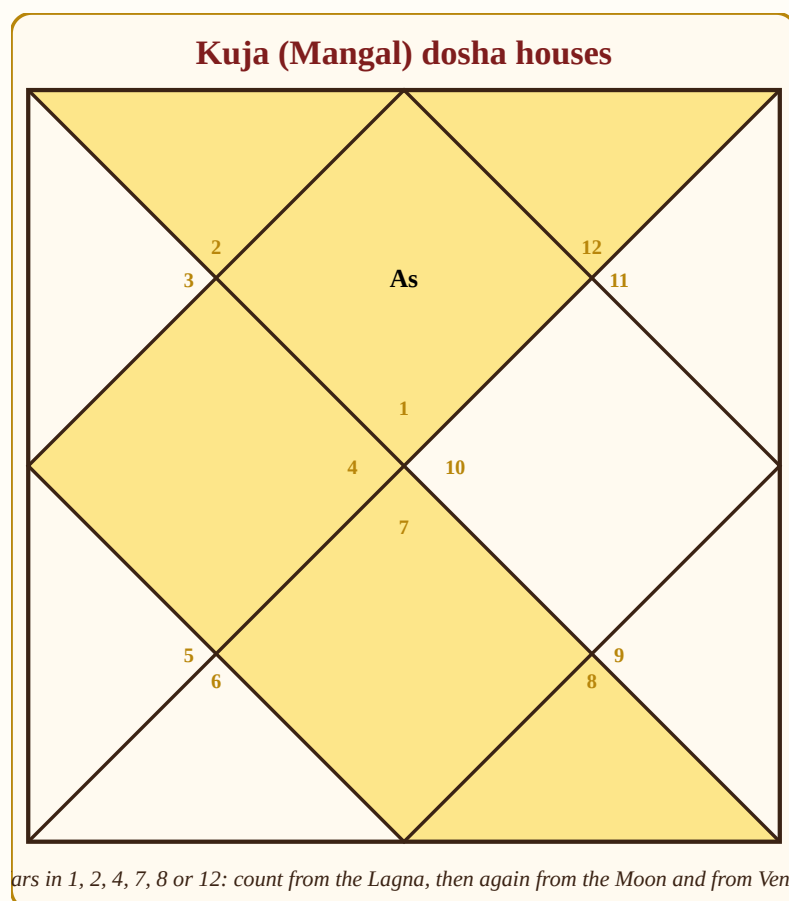


Figure 10.9: The six Kuja dosha houses. Count from the Lagna, then from the Moon, then from Venus.

Chart	Mars from the Lagna	Mars from the Moon	Mars from Venus	Verdict
A (Meera)	5th ●	9th (from Cancer) ●	6th (from Libra) ●	No dosha from any point ●
B (Arjun)	2nd ○	4th (from Taurus) ○	8th (from Capricorn) ○	Dosha from all three ○; hold that thought
C (Devika)	3rd ●	7th (from Sagittarius) ○	with Venus, 1st ○	Mixed 🗡️, a very common case

Now the **cancellations**, which the tradition lists generously precisely because it never meant the dosha as a life sentence. The mainstream list:

1. **Mars in its own sign (Aries, Scorpio) or exalted (Capricorn):** disciplined heat.
2. **Mars in Leo or Aquarius**, by several texts, plus sign-house exemptions (Gemini or Virgo in the 2nd, Cancer or Capricorn in the 7th, Sagittarius or Pisces in the 8th, and so on). Lists differ; say "by most texts".
3. **Both partners have the dosha:** the most reliable remedy; two people with the same heat understand each other.
4. **Jupiter or Saturn joined with or aspecting Mars:** wisdom or restraint cools it. (Some accept only Jupiter.)
5. **Mars combust, with Rahu, or in a dual sign:** weakened Mars, weakened dosha, by some authors.
6. **The folk view: the dosha fades after 28.** No classical text says this; recognise it when a family raises it.

WHY DO THE CANCELLATIONS MAKE SENSE? Each either *disciplines* the heat or *matches* it. A dignified Mars is heat under control. Leo and Aquarius belong to the Sun and Saturn, planets Mars respects. Jupiter's aspect adds judgement, Saturn's restraint. A combust or Rahu-afflicted Mars has less agenda of its own to spill. Two partners with the dosha both run hot, so neither is shocked. Everyday parallel: a loud person is a problem in a quiet family and no problem at all in a loud one.

Return to Arjun. Mars in Leo (exempted by several texts), retrograde, aspected by Saturn from the 8th (Saturn's 7th aspect lands on the 2nd; a combust Saturn, so a softer aspect), and his **yogakaraka**. By the bare rule, manglik three times; by the cancellations, substantially reduced. I would tell him: "Your Mars is a strong, useful planet, but it sits in the house of family and speech. Words spoken in anger at home are your one real risk. Marry someone with some fire of her own, and learn to leave the room for ten minutes."

CONSULTATION TIP: When a family arrives frightened by the word "manglik", do three things in order. First, check the dosha from all three points and every cancellation *out loud*, so they see you working, not pronouncing. Second, translate the result into behaviour, never fate: "a tendency to sharp words early in marriage", not "danger to the spouse". Third, hand them something to *do*: a match with a similarly Martian partner, a Tuesday discipline, a family rule of not deciding things when angry. Fear leaves the room the moment people have work. Never tell a young person their Mars will harm someone they love.

Daridra yogas and other dark names, in one paragraph

The texts also name combinations of poverty (*Daridra yoga*) and misfortune (*duryogas*): the 11th lord in a dusthana with malefics, the Lagna lord in the 12th with the 12th lord in the 1st, and so on. Every one is the *same principle in reverse*: wealth lords in loss houses. Derive them when you meet them, apply the same cancellations, and remember that a poverty yoga in a chart with two Raja yogas is a season of tight money, not a life of want.

Yoga bhanga: a yoga is only as strong as its planets

Every yoga above was stated as a *formation*. But a formation is a team on paper; whether it wins depends on the players and on when they take the field. Before you speak about any yoga, run four checks, which together are what the tradition means by *yoga bhanga*, the weakening of a yoga.

- 1. Dignity.** A Raja yoga between an exalted Sun and Jupiter in its own sign is a king-maker; the same yoga between a Sun at the sign's edge and a retrograde Jupiter in an enemy's sign (Chart A) is a respectable career. Chapter 12 gives the full method.
- 2. Combustion.** A planet within the Sun's orb (Appendix A.2) is a player with a fever. A Dhana yoga through a combust Venus is money that arrives and evaporates.
- 3. Dusthana placement.** Planets in the 6th, 8th or 12th work underground, late, through struggle. Not cancelled; muffled.
- 4. Dasha activation.** The one beginners miss, and the answer to the commonest complaint in every astrology WhatsApp group: "my chart has three Raja yogas and I am still a clerk."

STORY: THE TEAM THAT NEVER TOOK THE FIELD. *The King has a brilliant pair in his court, the pillar-keeper Sun and the treasury-keeper Jupiter, who get on famously. But the haveli runs on a railway timetable (Chapter 13): each courtier is given the keys of the house for a fixed stretch of years, one after another, and only the key-holder's plans are carried out. For twenty years the keys are with the Minister of Pleasure, Venus. Sun and Jupiter sit in the courtyard, friends still, waiting. Their plans are real; they are simply not on the timetable yet. The clerk with three Raja yogas is not cursed. He is early. Rule:* a yoga sleeps until the Mahadasha or Antardasha of one of its planets arrives.

WHY? *System grammar: the chart is the promise, the dasha the delivery schedule, and in Parashara's scheme results are given by the planet whose period is running. A yoga is carried by its planets, so it is delivered only when one of them holds the keys. Everyday parallel: an appointment letter with a joining date months away. The job is yours; you are not yet being paid.*

Meera's Sun and Jupiter Raja yoga does little during her Venus Mahadasha; it wakes in the Sun Mahadasha (2027–2033, ages about 38 to 44), exactly when I would tell her to expect recognition.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Formation tells you *what*; dignity tells you *how much*; dasha tells you *when*. A yoga described without all three is a rumour.

A chart nearly always holds good and difficult yogas together. Weigh them like a judge, not a shopkeeper, then speak about tendencies, seasons and work to be done.

In one breath

- A yoga is a *connection* between planets or houses that produces more than the parts; a placement alone is not a yoga.
- Four glues: conjunction, mutual aspect, exchange of signs, and (weakest) one-sided influence. Exchange is strongest because both planets live in each other's houses.
- Raja yoga = kendra lord (power) connected with trikona lord (merit); Dhana yoga = lords of 2, 5, 9, 11 and Lagna connected (money rooms fed by merit rooms); Dharma-Karmadhipati (9th + 10th) is the finest Raja yoga.
- Panch Mahapurusha = Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus or Saturn in own or exalted sign (capacity) in a kendra (position) from the Lagna. Chart C has Hamsa.

- From the Moon, because the mind is where life is experienced: Gaja Kesari, Chandra-Mangala, Adhi, Shakata; Kemadruma is formed in most charts and cancelled in most. Always check.
- Viparita Raja yoga: a dusthana lord in a dusthana is loss of loss, which is gain. Neecha Bhanga: a debilitated planet rescued by a powerful landlord or patron rises late.
- Kuja dosha: Mars in the six marriage-and-home houses (1, 2, 4, 7, 8, 12) from Lagna, Moon and Venus; a tendency to friction with many cancellations, never a sentence. Kala Sarpa is a popular teaching, not Parashari.
- A yoga is only as strong as its planets (dignity, combustion, dusthana) and sleeps until its planets' dasha arrives: promise first, delivery later.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. For Chart B (Cancer Lagna), list the kendra lords and trikona lords with their house positions. Which single planet is both, and what is it called?
2. Chart C has Hamsa and Shakata from the *same* Jupiter. Explain in two sentences how both can be true and how you would weigh them.
3. A client's Moon is in Aries with no planet in Pisces or Taurus, but Saturn sits in Cancer and Jupiter in Libra. Does she have Kemadruma?
4. Arjun's family asks whether he is "manglik". Write the three sentences you would actually say.

Answers

1. Kendra lords: Moon (1st), Venus (4th), Saturn (7th), Mars (10th); trikona lords: Moon (1st), Mars (5th), Jupiter (9th). Mars owns the 5th and the 10th: the **yogakaraka** for Cancer Lagna. 2. Hamsa is counted from the Lagna (Jupiter exalted in a kendra); Shakata from the Moon (Cancer is the 8th from the Sagittarius Moon). An exalted Jupiter in a kendra from the Lagna is powerful and most texts cancel Shakata then. Read "ups and downs, with a strong floor under the falls". 3. Formed (Pisces and Taurus, the 12th and 2nd from the Moon, are empty) but cancelled: Saturn in Cancer is the 4th from the Aries Moon and Jupiter in Libra the 7th. Say "a mind that likes its own company", not "loneliness". 4. Something like: "Mars sits in his 2nd house, so by the traditional rule the blemish is present, and I have checked it from the Moon and Venus too. But his Mars is the best planet in his chart, aspected by Saturn and placed in Leo, which the texts count as softening it. In practice this means a tendency to sharp words at home early on, which a well-matched partner handles easily."

Chapter 11: Divisional Charts (Vargas): Zooming In

Open a map of Mumbai. At one glance you see the whole city: the sea, the railway lines, the airport, the rough shape of things. That is your birth chart (D1). Now suppose you want to find a particular flat in Bandra. The city map will not do; you zoom into the Bandra sheet, where every lane is drawn. That zoomed sheet is a **divisional chart** (*Varga*, "a division"). The Navamsa (D9) is the marriage district. The Dasamsa (D10) is the office district. The Saptamsa (D7) is the children's district.

Divisional charts were where I nearly gave up, because the arithmetic looked frightening and the software printed sixteen charts without saying which one to look at. This chapter fixes both problems. You will compute a Navamsa by hand, the whole of Meera's, so that the charts stop being magic, and you will learn which six to use and how to read them without losing the city for the lanes.

Why one chart is not enough

The Rasi chart (D1) puts each planet in one of twelve signs. Twelve boxes for nine planets is a coarse grid. Two people born a day apart may have every planet in the same sign, yet one marries happily and the other struggles. Something finer must be at work.

The finer thing is *where inside the sign* a planet sits. A planet at 2° of Taurus and one at 28° of Taurus are both "in Taurus", but they behave differently.

STORY: THE KING'S MAP ROOM. *On the wall of the King's map room hangs one great map of the kingdom, cut into twelve districts: the Rasi chart. When a courtier is reported "in Taurus", the King knows roughly where he is. But the young Prince, Mercury, keeps sixteen smaller sheets in a drawer, one for each purpose: the marriage-district sheet, the office-district sheet, the children's-district sheet. On each sheet every district of the big map is cut into lanes, nine lanes on the marriage sheet, ten on the office sheet, seven on the children's sheet, and each lane is given a district name of its own. So the same courtier "in Taurus" may, on the marriage sheet, be standing in a lane called Pisces, and on the office sheet in a lane called Capricorn. The big map says which street; the sheet says which house on the street. **Rule:** a *varga* re-maps each sign by degree into slices, and each slice carries a sign of its own.*

Cut each sign into 9 slices and you get the Navamsa; into 10, the Dasamsa; into 7, the Saptamsa. The planet's *degree* decides its slice; the slice's sign becomes the planet's sign in that chart.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: D1 is the body; the *vargas* are the organs. You can say a great deal about a person from the body alone. You can say nothing sensible about the liver without first knowing whose liver it is.

The sixteen charts, and the six you actually use

Parashara lists sixteen divisional charts, the **Shodasavarga**. Appendix A.10 gives the main ones with their uses; here is the full list with my honest advice on each.

Chart	Division	Primary use	Beginner's verdict
D1 Rasi	30°	Everything; the body of the horoscope	● Use always
D2 Hora	15°	Wealth	● Use, as a tint
D3 Drekkana	10°	Siblings, courage, nature of death	◼ Later
D4 Chaturthamsa	7°30'	Property, fixed assets, fortune	◼ Later
D7 Saptamsa	4°17'	Children, progeny	● Use for children questions
D9 Navamsa	3°20'	Marriage, dharma, inner strength of planets	● Use always ; the most important varga
D10 Dasamsa	3°	Career, public life	● Use for career questions
D12 Dwadasamsa	2°30'	Parents, lineage	◼ Later
D16 Shodasamsa	1°52'30"	Vehicles, comforts	◼ Later
D20 Vimsamsa	1°30'	Spiritual life, worship	◼ Later
D24 Chaturvimsamsa	1°15'	Education, learning	◼ Later
D27 Bhamsa	1°6'40"	Strengths and weaknesses	◼ Later
D30 Trimsamsa	1°	Misfortunes, character, disease	◼ Later
D40 Khavedamsa	0°45'	Auspicious and inauspicious effects (maternal line)	○ Rarely
D45 Akshavedamsa	0°40'	General indications (paternal line)	○ Rarely
D60 Shashtiamsa	0°30'	Past-life karma; used to separate twins	◼ Know about it ; use with care

Six for the beginner: **D1, D9, D10, D7, D2 and D60**. The first five are the ones a real question actually requires (life, marriage, career, children, money); the sixth you need to *know about* because Parashara himself rates it highly and because it is the only tool that separates twins. Leave the rest until the six feel like old friends. A student who reads sixteen charts badly is worse off than one who reads two charts well.

WHY DOES EACH VARGA GOVERN WHAT IT GOVERNS? Mostly the system's own number grammar, with Parashara's assignments in *Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra* as the classical statement. The **D10** is the career chart because 10 is the number of the 10th house, karma and public life. The **D7** is the children's chart because 7 is the classical number of the progeny division: the 5th house shows children, but the tradition splits each sign into seven for the *lineage*, counting from the 7th sign for even signs because children come through the partner. The **D9** is the marriage chart because 9 is the number of dharma (the 9th house) and marriage is the great dharma of the householder in this tradition; D9 is also the *strength* chart because 3°20' is the finest division Parashara uses to judge a planet's inner condition, one nakshatra pada, and it is the division he chose for Vargottama. The **D2** is the wealth chart because two halves (the Sun's and the Moon's) sort planets into those that earn by effort and those that accumulate. Everyday parallel: a school keeps one register for attendance and separate registers for marks, fees and sports; each is the same class of children sorted for a different purpose.

DID YOU KNOW? Parashara gives each of the sixteen Vargas a weight when judging a planet's overall strength: D1 counts 3½ points, D9 counts 3, D60 counts 4, most others 1 or ½ (the *Vimsopaka* scheme, 20 points in all). The Shashtiamsa outranks even the Rasi chart, which tells you how seriously the tradition took birth-time accuracy: a D60 changes every minute.

How a varga is built: the idea of slices

Every divisional chart follows the same recipe:

1. Take the planet's **degree within its sign** (0° to 30°).
2. Divide by the slice width to find **which slice** it falls in (slice 1, 2, 3...).
3. Find the **starting sign** for that D1 sign (each varga has its own rule).
4. Count forward from the starting sign by (slice number minus 1). That is the planet's varga sign.

Only step 3 changes from one varga to another. Learn the recipe once and every varga is the same job.

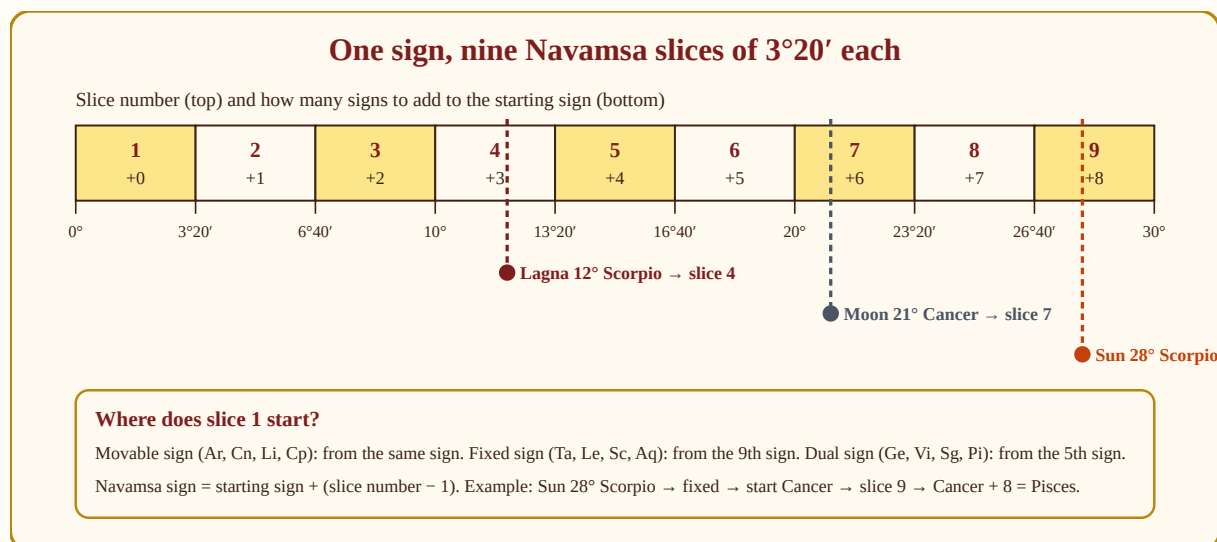


Figure 11.1: One sign cut into nine Navamsa slices. Read the slice from the degree; then apply the starting-sign rule shown in the box. Meera's Lagna (12°), Moon (21°) and Sun (28°) are marked.

The Navamsa, computed by hand

Nava is nine, *amsa* is portion: nine portions of 3°20' each. The slice boundaries are 0°, 3°20', 6°40', 10°, 13°20', 16°40', 20°, 23°20', 26°40' and 30°. A quick way to find the slice: divide the degree by 3½ (3.333...), drop the fraction, add one. So 28° ÷ 3.333 = 8.4, slice 9; 21° ÷ 3.333 = 6.3, slice 7; 12° ÷ 3.333 = 3.6, slice 4.

The starting-sign rule (Appendix A.10):

- **Movable sign** (Aries, Cancer, Libra, Capricorn): start counting **from the sign itself**.
- **Fixed sign** (Taurus, Leo, Scorpio, Aquarius): start **from the 9th sign** from it.
- **Dual sign** (Gemini, Virgo, Sagittarius, Pisces): start **from the 5th sign** from it.

STORY: THE THREE BROTHERS OF EACH ELEMENT. Every element has three sign-brothers: fire has Aries, Leo and Sagittarius; earth has Taurus, Virgo and Capricorn; and so on. The eldest brother is the movable sign, the middle one the fixed sign, the youngest the dual sign. When the King's surveyors come to number the nine lanes of a district, custom says the numbering always begins at the eldest brother's door. So in a movable district the surveyors start at the district's own gate. In a fixed district they walk to the eldest brother, who lives nine districts on, and start there. In a dual district the eldest brother is five districts on, and they start there. That is the whole rule, and it is why the nine lanes of Aries, Leo and Sagittarius all read Aries, Taurus, Gemini... in the same order: they were all numbered from the same door. **Rule:** movable signs count from themselves; fixed from the 9th; dual from the 5th.

WHY 1ST, 9TH AND 5TH? Logical derivation from the zodiac's own structure, and you can check it yourself. The three signs of one element stand 120° apart: Aries at 1, Leo at 5, Sagittarius at 9. From Leo (fixed), the 9th sign is Aries; from Sagittarius (dual), the 5th sign is Aries. So "from itself / from the 9th / from the 5th" is one rule wearing three faces: start every Navamsa count at the movable sign of the planet's own element. The consequence is that the 108 Navamsas run through the twelve signs in unbroken order, Aries to Pisces nine times, all the way round the zodiac, which is exactly the sequence of the nakshatra padas (Chapter 7: each pada is one Navamsa sign, since 3°20' is one pada). Everyday parallel: three brothers who all give the family home as their address. Whichever brother you visit, the postal route begins at the same gate.

Now Meera. Three planets slowly, then the rest in a table.

Sun, 28° Scorpio. Scorpio is fixed, so we start from the 9th sign from Scorpio. Count: Scorpio 1, Sagittarius 2, Capricorn 3, Aquarius 4, Pisces 5, Aries 6, Taurus 7, Gemini 8, **Cancer 9**. Start at Cancer. The Sun is at 28°, in slice 9 (26°40'–30°). Count 9 signs from Cancer, Cancer itself being the first: Cancer, Leo, Virgo, Libra, Scorpio, Sagittarius, Capricorn, Aquarius, **Pisces**. Sun in Pisces in the Navamsa. (Shortcut: Cancer + 8 = Pisces.)

Moon, 21° Cancer. Cancer is movable, so start from Cancer itself. 21° is in slice 7 (20°–23°20'). Cancer + 6: Cancer, Leo, Virgo, Libra, Scorpio, Sagittarius, **Capricorn**. Moon in Capricorn.

Lagna, 12° Scorpio. Fixed; start from Cancer. 12° is in slice 4 (10°–13°20'). Cancer + 3 = **Libra**. So the **Navamsa Lagna is Libra**. Notice how close this is to the edge: at 13°20' the Lagna would jump to Scorpio Navamsa. The Lagna moves roughly one degree every four minutes, so a birth time off by about five minutes would change Meera's Navamsa Lagna. Keep that in mind whenever someone is unsure of the birth time.

The whole chart:

Planet	D1 position	Sign type	Start counting from	Slice	Navamsa sign
Lagna	12° Scorpio	fixed	Cancer (9th)	4	Libra
Sun	28° Scorpio	fixed	Cancer	9	Pisces
Mercury	9° Scorpio	fixed	Cancer	3	Virgo
Venus	22° Libra	movable	Libra (itself)	7	Aries
Mars	4° Pisces	dual	Cancer (5th)	2	Leo
Jupiter	8° Taurus	fixed	Capricorn (9th)	3	Pisces
Saturn	5° Sagittarius	dual	Aries (5th)	2	Taurus
Rahu	16° Aquarius	fixed	Libra (9th)	5	Aquarius
Ketu	16° Leo	fixed	Aries (9th)	5	Leo
Moon	21° Cancer	movable	Cancer	7	Capricorn

Check a few yourself with a pencil. Venus: $22^\circ \div 3.333 = 6.6$, slice 7; Libra + 6 = Aries. Jupiter: 8° , slice 3; Taurus is fixed, 9th from Taurus is Capricorn; Capricorn + 2 = Pisces. Rahu: 16° , slice 5; 9th from Aquarius is Libra; Libra + 4 = Aquarius, the same sign it started in. Notice Rahu and Ketu, always opposite in D1, stay opposite in D9 (Aquarius and Leo), because both sit at the same degree of fixed signs.

Now place the planets in houses from the Navamsa Lagna, Libra. Libra is the 1st; Scorpio the 2nd; Sagittarius the 3rd; Capricorn the 4th (Moon); Aquarius the 5th (Rahu); Pisces the 6th (Sun, Jupiter); Aries the 7th (Venus); Taurus the 8th (Saturn); Gemini the 9th; Cancer the 10th; Leo the 11th (Mars, Ketu); Virgo the 12th (Mercury).

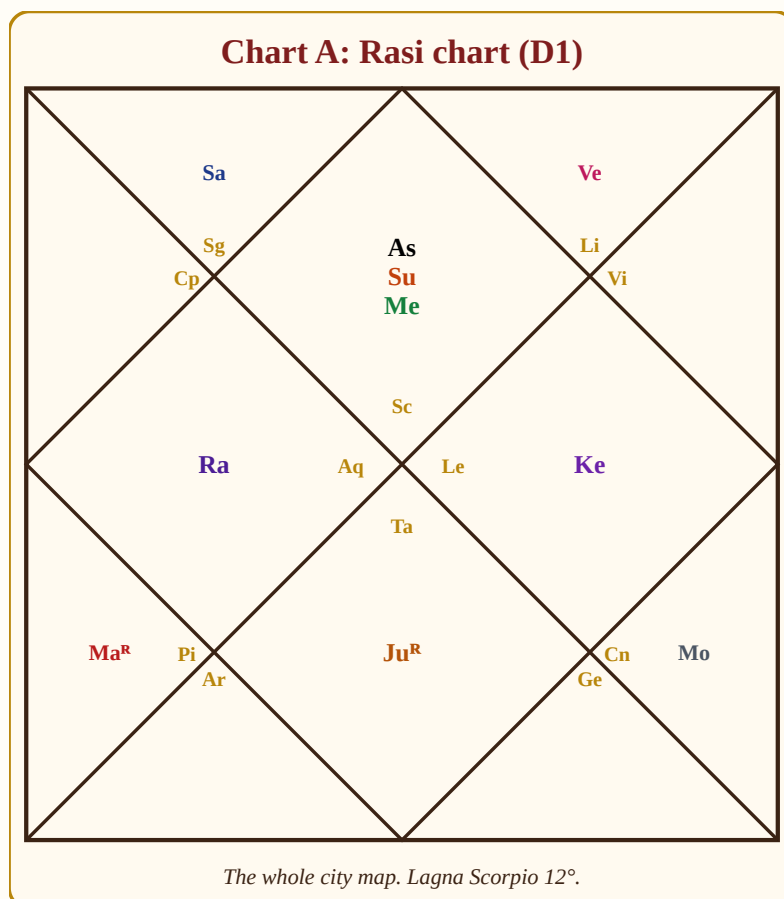


Figure 11.2: Chart A, the Rasi chart (D1). The whole city.

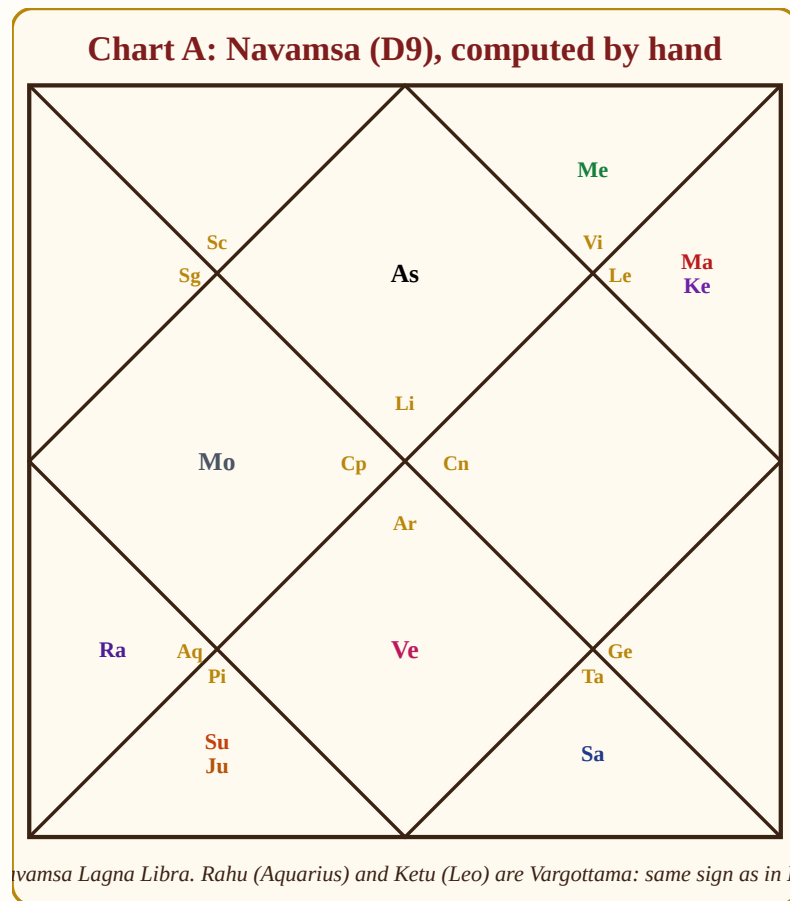


Figure 11.3: Chart A, the Navamsa (D9) we just computed. Navamsa Lagna Libra; Sun and Jupiter in Pisces; Venus in Aries; Rahu and Ketu Vargottama.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Expecting a varga to obey the astronomy of D1. In D1, Mercury is never more than a sign from the Sun. In D9, Meera's Sun is in Pisces and Mercury in Virgo, opposite each other. That is normal: the vargas are mathematical re-mappings, not sky pictures. Only Rahu and Ketu keep their opposition, and only when they sit at the same degree.

Vargottama: the planet that stays home

When a planet occupies the **same sign in D1 and in D9**, it is **Vargottama** ("best of the divisions"). It happens for planets in the first Navamsa of a movable sign, the fifth of a fixed sign, or the ninth of a dual sign.

WHY IS VARGOTTAMA STRONG? System grammar: the planet agrees with itself at two scales. Its costume on the city map and its costume on the district sheet are the same, so the outer behaviour and the inner nature pull in one direction, with no energy lost to contradiction. Parashara treats a Vargottama planet as close to being in its own sign. Everyday parallel: a person who is the same at the office and at home. You may or may not like them, but you always know where you stand, and they never trip over their own two versions.

In Chart A, **Rahu (Aquarius) and Ketu (Leo) are Vargottama**, both at 16°, the fifth slice of fixed signs. Meera's Rahu in the 4th (home, mother, foreign lands, unconventional education) and Ketu in the 10th (a detached, service-minded approach to career) are therefore *strong* themes, not background noise. Software marks Vargottama planets; look for the label.

A Vargottama **Lagna** is a special blessing: the person is exactly what they appear to be. Meera's Lagna is Scorpio in D1 and Libra in D9, so not Vargottama; but jump ahead to the Dasamsa and you will find her Lagna returns to Scorpio there. Some teachers extend the word Vargottama to any varga; strictly it belongs to D9.

How to read the Navamsa

The Navamsa answers two questions: *how strong is each planet really*, and *what is the marriage like*. Read it in four steps, always with the D1 open beside it.

Step 1: The dignity of each D1 planet in D9. A planet may look grand in D1 and be a beggar in D9, or the reverse. The classic warning is the "**hollow**" planet: **exalted in D1, debilitated in D9**, a promise the person cannot keep. The reverse, weak in D1 and strong in D9, is the quiet planet that delivers more than anyone expected.

Meera's planets, D1 against D9 (friendships from Appendix A.3):

Planet	D1 sign and dignity	D9 sign and dignity	Reading
Sun	Scorpio, friend's (Mars) ●	Pisces, friend's (Jupiter) ●	Steady inside and out
Moon	Cancer, own ●	Capricorn, neutral (Saturn) ◐	Warm outside, disciplined within
Mars	Pisces, friend's ●	Leo, friend's ●	Consistent
Mercury	Scorpio, neutral ◐	Virgo, own and exaltation ●	Hidden depth of intellect
Jupiter	Taurus, enemy's, retrograde ○	Pisces, own ●	Tired outside, at home within
Venus	Libra, own ●	Aries, neutral ◐	Comfortable, a little impatient inside
Saturn	Sagittarius, neutral, combust ○	Taurus, friend's ●	Weak outside, steadier within

The Jupiter line matters most. In Chapter 10 I called Jupiter a "tired player" in the Sun and Jupiter Raja yoga. The Navamsa says the tiredness is on the surface; underneath, Jupiter is at home.

STORY: THE PRIEST IN BORROWED ROBES. *On the big map the Royal Priest, Jupiter, is lodged in Taurus, the district of the Minister of Pleasure, his old rival, and he is walking backwards besides. Visitors see a tired, out-of-place priest and lower their expectations. But open the marriage-district sheet and there he is in Pisces, his own house, in his own robes, entirely himself. Which is the real Priest? Both. The Taurus lodging is what the world sees first; the Pisces home is what the family lives with. So I now describe Meera's Raja yoga as "slow to show but solid within", a better prediction than the D1 alone gave. The opposite case is the courtier grand on the big map and shabby on the sheet: the **hollow planet**, exalted in D1 and debilitated in D9. **Rule:** a planet's D9 dignity shows its inner strength; D1 grand and D9 fallen is hollow, D1 weak and D9 strong is quietly reliable.*

No planet of Meera's is debilitated in either chart. Nothing hollow here.

Step 2: The D9 Lagna and its lord. The Navamsa Lagna describes the inner person, the one the spouse meets at home. Libra: balance, fairness, an eye for beauty, a need for partnership. Its lord Venus sits in the **7th house of the Navamsa**, in Aries. The

inner self is oriented towards the other person. For someone who spends her working life across a table from people, that fits.

Step 3: The 7th house of the Navamsa, the spouse. Aries, a Mars sign, with Venus in it. The partner is energetic, independent, direct, possibly in a Martian or technical field; Venus there makes the relationship itself attractive and central. The 7th lord of the D9, Mars, sits in the D9 11th with Ketu: the marriage brings gains and a wide circle, with a detached, philosophical streak in the partner. Read this together with the D1 7th (Jupiter in Taurus: a learned, steady, somewhat conservative partner) and a fuller picture appears than either chart gives alone.

Step 4: Venus and Jupiter in D9. For any chart, Venus in D9 shows the *quality of love and comfort in marriage*; Jupiter in a woman's chart shows the husband, Venus in a man's chart the wife (Appendix A.2). Meera's Venus in Aries D9 is neutral: passionate, a little impatient, sincere. Her **Jupiter in Pisces, its own sign, in the D9 6th house:** the husband is a person of good character and learning (own sign), but the 6th placement says the marriage carries duty, service, health concerns or hard work; the couple builds rather than inherits. That is an honest, useful sentence; note it does not say "trouble".

CONSULTATION TIP: Never predict from the Navamsa alone. I did this once, early on, with a friend's chart: I saw a difficult D9 7th house and said so, while her D1 7th held an exalted Jupiter, and I frightened her for nothing. The order is always: D1 first, then D9 to confirm, deepen or soften. When they agree, speak with confidence. When they disagree, say "a rough start that settles" or "a smooth start that needs work". That disagreement is the reading.

The Dasamsa (D10): career under the microscope

Dasa is ten: ten slices of 3° each. Slice = degree ÷ 3, drop the fraction, add one. The starting rule: **odd signs (Aries, Gemini, Leo, Libra, Sagittarius, Aquarius) count from the sign itself; even signs (Taurus, Cancer, Virgo, Scorpio, Capricorn, Pisces) count from the 9th sign from it.**

WHY ODD FROM ITSELF, EVEN FROM THE 9TH? System grammar. Odd signs are the "male", outgoing signs; even signs the "female", receptive ones (Appendix A.1), and most vargas treat them as a pair: the odd sign counts from its own door, the even sign from a partner door. For the D10 that partner is the 9th, the house of dharma, because the career (10th) is meant to rest on right conduct (9th). Everyday parallel: an odd-numbered house on a street is entered from the front; the even-numbered house opposite is entered from the lane behind.

Sun, 28° Scorpio. $28 \div 3 = 9.33$, slice 10. Scorpio is even, so start from the 9th from Scorpio: Cancer. Cancer + 9 = **Aries**. Sun in Aries in the Dasamsa, its exaltation sign.

The whole chart:

Planet	D1 position	Odd/even	Start from	Slice	Dasamsa sign
Lagna	12° Scorpio	even	Cancer	5	Scorpio
Sun	28° Scorpio	even	Cancer	10	Aries
Mercury	9° Scorpio	even	Cancer	4	Libra
Venus	22° Libra	odd	Libra	8	Taurus
Mars	4° Pisces	even	Scorpio	2	Sagittarius
Jupiter	8° Taurus	even	Capricorn	3	Pisces
Saturn	5° Sagittarius	odd	Sagittarius	2	Capricorn
Rahu	16° Aquarius	odd	Aquarius	6	Cancer
Ketu	16° Leo	odd	Leo	6	Capricorn
Moon	21° Cancer	even	Pisces	8	Libra

Houses from the Dasamsa Lagna, Scorpio: Sagittarius 2nd (Mars); Capricorn 3rd (Saturn, Ketu); Pisces 5th (Jupiter); Aries 6th (Sun); Taurus 7th (Venus); Cancer 9th (Rahu); Libra 12th (Mercury, Moon).

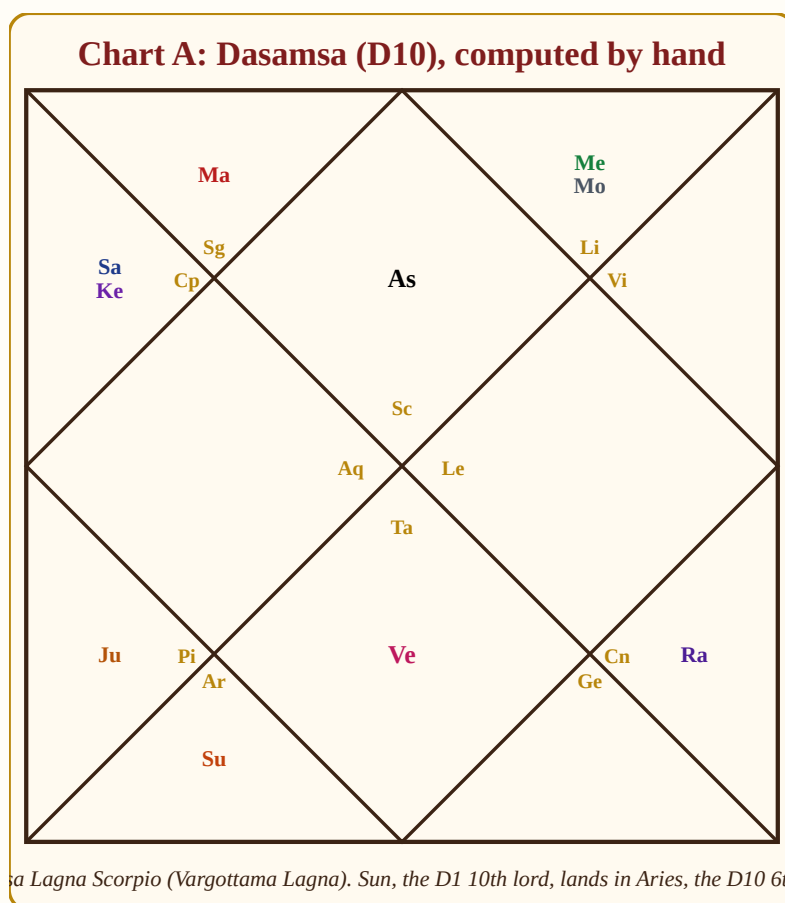


Figure 11.4: Chart A, the Dasamsa (D10). The Lagna returns to Scorpio; the Sun, D1's 10th lord, lands exalted in Aries in the D10 6th house; Venus sits in its own sign in the D10 7th.

How to read a Dasamsa: three things, then the kendras.

1. **The D1 10th lord's position in D10.** Meera's 10th lord is the Sun. In D10 it is **exalted in Aries** (a career with authority and initiative) but in the **6th house** of the D10: service, institutions, competition, the helping professions. Put together: a leader *within* an institution or a service field, not an entrepreneur. Teaching in a college, consulting within a practice, fits exactly.
2. **The D10 Lagna and its lord.** Scorpio again: her working self and her inner self are the same person, a strong sign of integrity in work. Its lord Mars sits in the **D10 2nd house in Sagittarius**: livelihood through speech, teaching, knowledge (Sagittarius is Jupiter's sign of wisdom). This is the single clearest line in her career picture.
3. **The D10 10th house and its lord.** Leo, empty; its lord the Sun is in the 6th as above, the same message twice.

Then the **planets in D10 kendras**: only Venus, in the 7th, in its own sign Taurus. Career through partnerships, one-to-one work, counsel: a consultant, again. Jupiter in the D10 5th in its own sign Pisces: students, advice, wisdom as work. Mercury and the Moon in the D10 12th: part of the work happens behind the scenes, in writing, in solitude, or connected with distant places. The D1 said "teacher and consultant"; the D10 says "teacher and consultant, inside an institution, through personal counsel and writing, with real authority". That is what zooming in buys you.

The Saptamsa (D7): children

Sapta is seven: seven slices of $4^{\circ}17'$ each ($30 \div 7 = 4.2857^{\circ}$). Slice = degree $\div$ 4.2857, drop the fraction, add one. Starting rule: **odd signs count from the sign itself; even signs from the 7th sign from it** (the partner's sign, because children come through the partner).

One example, the planet that matters most for children: Jupiter, Meera's 5th lord and the natural significator of progeny. **Jupiter, 8° Taurus.** $8 \div 4.2857 = 1.87$, slice 2. Taurus is even, so start from the 7th from Taurus: Scorpio. Scorpio + 1 = **Sagittarius**. Jupiter in its own sign in the Saptamsa: a healthy signal for children, and a good place to begin the D7 reading in Chapter 21. (For practice: the Moon, 21° Cancer, is in slice 5; Cancer is even, start from Capricorn; Capricorn + 4 = Taurus.) In the D7 you read the D7 Lagna, its 5th house and lord, and Jupiter, exactly as you would read the 5th house of D1.

The Hora (D2): wealth in two halves

The simplest varga. Each sign is cut in two: the first 15° and the last 15° . In **odd signs** the first half belongs to the **Sun** and the second to the **Moon**; in **even signs** it is reversed, the first half the Moon's, the second the Sun's. Every planet therefore falls into either the Sun's hora or the Moon's hora; there are no other signs in this chart.

Meera: Sun 28° Scorpio (even, second half), Sun's hora. Moon 21° Cancer (even, second half), Sun's hora. Saturn 5° Sagittarius (odd, first half), Sun's hora. Mercury 9° Scorpio, Mars 4° Pisces and Jupiter 8° Taurus (even, first half), Moon's hora. Venus 22° Libra (odd, second half), Moon's hora. Four of the seven planets in the Moon's hora, three in the Sun's. The traditional reading: planets in the Moon's hora bring wealth that accumulates steadily and gently; planets in the Sun's hora bring wealth through effort, authority and struggle. The logic is symbolic: the Sun is the King who earns by command, the Moon the Queen Mother who receives and keeps. Meera's mix leans gentle. Chapter 18 uses this as a tint on the money reading: a tint, never a verdict.

The Dwadasamsa (D12) and the Shashtiamsa (D60), briefly

D12: twelve slices of $2^{\circ}30'$, counted **from the sign itself** for every sign. Sun 28° Scorpio: $28 \div 2.5 = 11.2$, slice 12; Scorpio + 11 = Libra. Moon 21° Cancer: slice 9; Cancer + 8 = Pisces. The D12 is read for parents and lineage (12 is the number of the 12th, the house of the past and of what came before you): the Sun for the father, the Moon for the mother, plus the D12 9th and 4th houses.

D60: sixty slices of 0°30' each. The rule, sketched: double the degree (with its minutes) to get a number from 0 to 59, take the remainder after dividing by 12, and count that many signs forward from the planet's own sign. Sun 28° Scorpio: 56, remainder 8, Scorpio + 8 = Cancer. Each of the sixty slices also carries a name and a deity (benefic or malefic), and it is those names that the classical texts read. Parashara weights the D60 heavily; the tradition reads it for past-life karma and for the residue that D1 cannot explain. Because half a degree of Lagna passes in about two minutes, the D60 is the chart that separates **twins**, and also the chart most ruined by an inaccurate birth time.

STORY: THE TWINS AND THE OLD JUDGE'S LEDGER. *Two babies are born four minutes apart. On the great map they are identical: same Lagna, same districts for every courtier. Even the marriage and office sheets agree. The family comes to the old Judge of Labour, Saturn, who keeps the finest ledger in the kingdom, sixty lines to every district, one for each half-degree. Only in his book do the twins part: the elder's Lagna falls on a line ruled by a kindly deity, the younger's on the next line, ruled by a harsh one. "Here," says the Judge, "is the debt each brought with him." But the Judge is strict about one thing: if the family cannot tell him the birth minute, he closes the ledger. **Rule:** the D60 separates twins and reads past-life residue, but only with a reliable, rectified birth time.*

Karakamsa: a pointer to Jaimini

One paragraph, so you recognise the word. In the Jaimini system (Chapter 15), the planet with the **highest degree** in any sign is the **Atmakaraka**, the soul's significator. The sign that planet occupies **in the Navamsa** is the **Karakamsa**, and Jaimini reads the soul's direction from it the way Parashara reads the person from the Lagna. Meera's highest-degree planet is the Sun at 28°; its Navamsa sign, as we computed, is Pisces. Her Karakamsa is Pisces, Jupiter's sign of dharma, healing and teaching. Chapter 15 will show what to do with that. For now, simply notice that the Navamsa you have just built by hand is the doorway to a whole second system.

In one breath

- A divisional chart (varga) cuts each sign into slices and gives each slice its own sign; the planet's degree decides its slice. D1 is the city map, the vargas are the district sheets.
- Sixteen vargas exist; a beginner uses six: D1, D9, D10, D7, D2, and knows about D60. Each governs the house whose number it carries: 10 for career, 7 for progeny, 9 for dharma and marriage.
- Every varga follows one recipe: find the slice from the degree, find the starting sign by that varga's rule, count forward.
- Navamsa (D9): nine slices of 3°20'; movable signs count from themselves, fixed from the 9th, dual from the 5th, which is one rule: start at the movable sign of the same element. Meera's Navamsa Lagna is Libra; her Sun is in Pisces, her Moon in Capricorn.
- Vargottama = same sign in D1 and D9; the planet agrees with itself at two scales. Meera's Rahu and Ketu are Vargottama.
- Read D9 in four steps: dignity of planets (beware the hollow planet), the D9 Lagna and lord, the D9 7th house, Venus and Jupiter. Always with D1 open.
- Dasamsa (D10): ten slices of 3°; odd signs from themselves, even from the 9th. Read the D1 10th lord's place in D10, the D10 Lagna and lord, planets in D10 kendras.
- D7 (children): odd from itself, even from the 7th. D2 (wealth): Sun's and Moon's halves. D12 (parents): from the sign itself. D60: past-life karma and twins; needs an exact birth time.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. Compute the Navamsa sign of Arjun's Venus (Chart B), 24° Capricorn. Then his Moon, 6° Taurus.
2. Devika's Jupiter (Chart C) is at 26° Cancer. Find its Navamsa sign. Is it Vargottama? What does that add to the Hamsa yoga of Chapter 10?
3. Compute the Dasamsa sign of Arjun's Mars, 21° Leo (his yogakarak and 10th lord).
4. Devika's Saturn is at 18° Leo. Which hora does it fall in? Which Saptamsa sign?
5. A friend's Jupiter is exalted in Cancer in D1 but falls in Capricorn in D9. In one sentence, what do you tell yourself before you say anything?

Answers

1. Venus 24° Capricorn: $24 \div 3.333 = 7.2$, slice 8. Capricorn is movable, count from itself: Capricorn + 7 = **Leo**. Moon 6° Taurus: slice 2 (3°20'–6°40'). Taurus is fixed, start from the 9th from Taurus = Capricorn; Capricorn + 1 = **Aquarius**. 2. 26° Cancer: $26 \div 3.333 = 7.8$, slice 8. Cancer is movable, count from itself: Cancer + 7 = **Aquarius**. Not Vargottama (that would need Cancer in both). Jupiter in Aquarius, Saturn's sign, is neutral for Jupiter, so the Hamsa yoga is real on the surface but its inner strength is ordinary: respected wisdom, expressed through unconventional or humanitarian channels rather than through traditional authority. 3. Mars 21° Leo: $21 \div 3 = 7.0$ exactly; drop the fraction, add one: slice 8 (21° is the start of the 8th slice, 21°–24°). Leo is odd, count from itself: Leo + 7 = **Pisces**. Mars in Pisces in D10, a friend's sign: career energy directed to service, healing or institutional fields. 4. Saturn 18° Leo: Leo is odd; 18° is in the second half, so **Moon's hora**. Saptamsa: $18 \div 4.2857 = 4.2$, slice 5; Leo is odd, count from itself: Leo + 4 = **Sagittarius**. 5. "This is a hollow Jupiter, the promise louder than the delivery, so I will look for what supports it (dasha, aspects, D1 house) before I speak, and I will phrase Jupiter's gifts as things that need effort to come true."

Chapter 12: How Strong Is That Planet? Shadbala, Ashtakavarga and Avasthas

A friend once showed me her chart with Jupiter in the 2nd house and asked why, with "Jupiter in the house of wealth", she was always short of money. I looked. Jupiter was in Capricorn, its sign of debilitation, eight degrees from the Sun, in the last degrees of the sign, aspected by Saturn. It was Jupiter in name only: a minister with a title and no budget. The house was right; the planet was too weak to fill it.

This is the lesson of the chapter. Every promise a chart makes is made by a *planet*, and a planet keeps its promises only in proportion to its strength. The tradition measures strength in several ways, from a two-minute glance to a page of arithmetic. I will give you the glance first (it is what I actually use), and then the arithmetic, explained so that you can read what your software prints without fear.

Why strength matters

Two rules, and they are not symmetrical:

- **A weak benefic promises and cannot deliver.** Jupiter in the 5th house *promises* children, wisdom, students; a weak Jupiter gives the longing and the delay.
- **A strong malefic delivers pain, but also results.** A strong Saturn in the 10th gives a hard, slow career with real authority at the end. A weak Saturn in the 10th gives the delays without the authority.

So strength is not the same as goodness. A strong planet is a planet that *does things*. Whether the things are pleasant is the business of Chapters 8 and 10; whether they happen at all is the business of this chapter.

WHY? System grammar. In Parashara's scheme a planet gives the results of the houses it owns and occupies *in proportion to its strength*; nature (benefic or malefic) decides the flavour, strength decides the quantity. A weak benefic is a kind relative with no money; a strong malefic is a strict one who actually pays the school fees. Everyday parallel: a generous uncle who is broke versus a stern uncle who is rich. You know which one funds the wedding.

STORY: HOW STRONG IS THE SOLDIER? The Commander, Mars, inspects a new recruit and asks seven quick questions before he trusts him with a post. Is he in his own regiment's uniform, or a borrowed one that fits badly? (Dignity.) Has he a fever from standing too long in the sun? (Combustion.) Is he marching backwards, which in this army means he is doubling his effort, though he looks odd? (Retrogression.) Has he been posted at a pillar of the fort or in the back rooms? (House.) Who is watching him, the Priest and the Minister of Arts, or the old Judge and the Stranger? (Aspects.) Does he carry the same colours on the district sheet as on the great map? (Vargottama.) And is he standing at the gate where his own kind fight best? (Directional strength.) Seven questions, two minutes, and the Commander knows what the man can carry. **Rule:** judge a planet by dignity, combustion, retrogression, house, aspects, Vargottama and directional strength, in that order.

The consultant's hierarchy: seven checks in two minutes

Here is the glance, in the order I run it. Each item is something you already know from earlier chapters; the skill is running them together.

1. **Dignity:** the planet's relationship to the sign it occupies (Appendix A.2 and A.3): exalted ●●, in its moolatrikona ●, in its own sign ●, in a friend's sign ●, in a neutral's sign ●, in an enemy's sign ○, debilitated ○○. Check Neecha Bhanga (Chapter 10) before you write off a debilitated planet.
2. **Combustion:** within the Sun's orb (Appendix A.2: Moon 12°, Mars 17°, Mercury 14°, Jupiter 11°, Venus 10°, Saturn 15°) ○. A combust planet still *exists* but its own agenda is burnt; it serves the Sun's agenda.
3. **Retrogression:** a retrograde planet is counted *strong* in the strength calculations (it is closest to Earth and brightest), but its results are often delayed, internalised or unconventional ●. Teachers disagree on whether retrogression is a blessing; I treat it as intensity with a twist.
4. **House position:** kendra (1, 4, 7, 10) and trikona (5, 9) ●; upachaya (3, 6, 10, 11) ● for malefics, improving with age; dusthana (6, 8, 12) ○ for the planet's own agenda.
5. **Aspects received:** from Jupiter, Venus, a waxing Moon, an unafflicted Mercury ●; from Saturn, Mars, Rahu, Ketu, the Sun ○ (Chapter 6).
6. **Vargottama:** same sign in D1 and D9 (Chapter 11) ●.
7. **Directional strength** (*Dig Bala*, Appendix A.2): Jupiter and Mercury in the 1st, Moon and Venus in the 4th, Saturn in the 7th, Sun and Mars in the 10th ●; the opposite house gives none ○.

WHY IS COMBUSTION CHECKED BY DEGREE, NOT BY SIGN? Astronomy. Combustion is a planet lost in the Sun's glare, and glare does not stop at a sign boundary; it is a matter of angular distance in the sky. A planet at 28° Scorpio and one at 5° Sagittarius are seven degrees apart whatever their signs say. That is also why each planet has its own orb: the brighter the planet, the closer it can stand to the Sun and still be seen (Venus 10°, Saturn 15°). Everyday parallel: a new employee seated beside a loud manager. It does not matter whether their desks are in the same room or across a doorway; if he is within earshot, nobody hears him.

STORY: EACH OFFICER'S BEST GATE. The haveli has four gates and each officer fights best at his own. At dawn the east gate, the 1st house, belongs to the Royal Priest and the young Prince: wisdom and wit are sharpest in the morning, so Jupiter and Mercury take the front door. The inner courtyard at midnight, the 4th, is the Queen Mother's and the Minister of Pleasure's: comfort, feeling and beauty rule the night, so the Moon and Venus are strongest there. The western gate at dusk, the 7th, is where the old Judge stands: Saturn, patient and unhurried, guards the door that others tire of. And the roof at noon, the 10th, belongs to the King and his Commander: the Sun and Mars blaze where everyone can see them. Post an officer at the gate opposite his own and he fights at half strength. **Rule:** Dig Bala: Jupiter and Mercury in the 1st; Moon and Venus in the 4th; Saturn in the 7th; Sun and Mars in the 10th.

Now run the glance on Chart A.

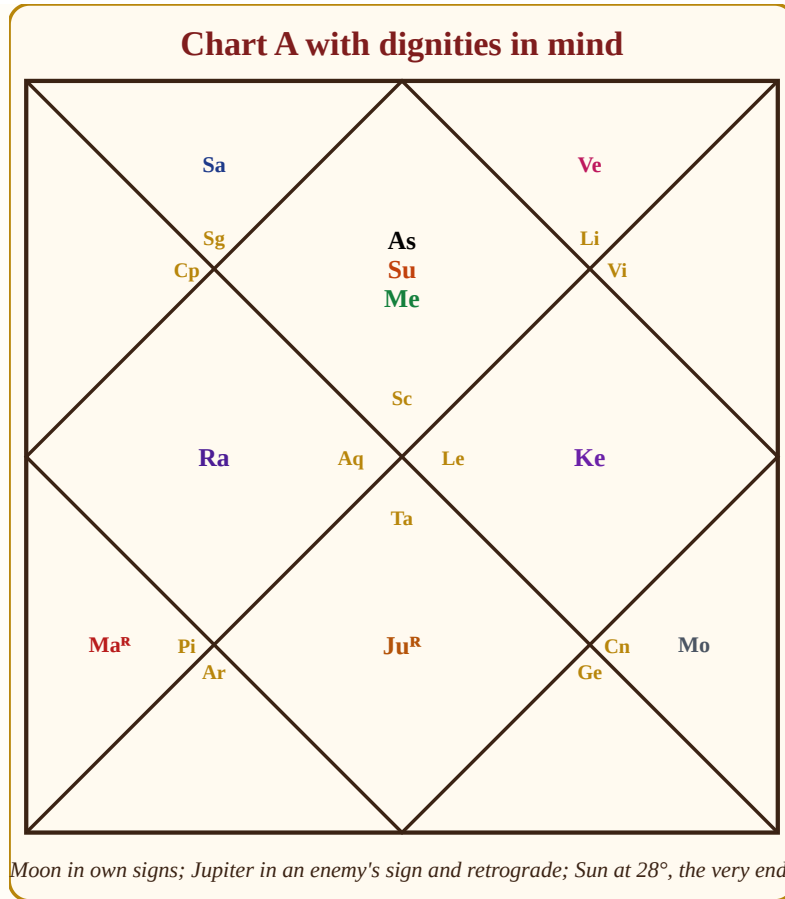


Figure 12.1: Chart A. Venus (Libra) and the Moon (Cancer) sit in their own signs; Jupiter is retrograde in Taurus, an enemy's sign; the Sun is at 28° Scorpio, the sign's last degrees; Saturn at 5° Sagittarius is only 7° from the Sun.

Planet	Dignity	Combust?	Retro?	House	Aspects received	Dig Bala	Quick verdict
Sun	Scorpio, friend's sign ● (but 28°, sign's edge ◀)	no	no	1st ●	Jupiter ●	middling ▶	Strong but unsettled ●
Moon	Cancer, own ●	no (127° from Sun)	no	9th ●	none	middling ▶	Strong ●
Mars	Pisces, friend's ●	no	yes ▶	5th ●	none	middling ▶	Adequate ▶
Mercury	Scorpio, neutral ▶	no (19° from Sun)	no	1st ●	Jupiter ●	full ●	Strong ●
Jupiter	Taurus, enemy's ○	no	yes ▶	7th kendra ●	Sun ○, Mercury ●	none (opposite its 1st) ○	Weak outside, strong in D9 ▶
Venus	Libra, own ●	no (36° from Sun)	no	12th ○	Mars ○ (its 8th aspect)	middling ▶	Dignified but private ▶
Saturn	Sagittarius, neutral ▶	yes, 7° from Sun ○	no	2nd ▶	none	middling ▶	Weak ○

Three things this table taught me that the chart alone did not. First, **Saturn is combust**. I missed this for a whole year in my own early notes on this chart, because Saturn and the Sun are in different signs; the orb does not care about sign boundaries. Saturn is Meera's 3rd and 4th lord: courage and the home both run on a burnt engine, and her Sade Sati years (Chapter 14)

would have felt heavier than the textbook says. Second, **Mercury has full directional strength** in the 1st, which is why her Budha-Aditya yoga speaks so clearly. Third, **Jupiter has zero Dig Bala** in the 7th, which adds to its D1 weakness; and yet the Navamsa (Chapter 11) puts it in its own sign. That is a planet to describe as "underrated": it will do more than it appears able to, mostly in the Jupiter periods.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Checking combustion by sign instead of by degree. Meera's Sun is at 28° Scorpio and her Saturn at 5° Sagittarius: different signs, seven degrees apart, well inside Saturn's 15° orb. Always subtract the longitudes.

Shadbala: the six strengths, explained conceptually

Shad is six, *bala* is strength. **Shadbala** is Parashara's full arithmetic of planetary strength, computed for the seven planets (not Rahu and Ketu) and expressed in **rupas**; one rupa equals 60 *shashtiamsas*, the small units in which the tables are written. Nobody computes it by hand any more; every serious program prints it. What you must know is what the six numbers *mean*, so that you can read the printout intelligently.

Strength	Sanskrit	What it measures	Where it comes from
Positional	Sthana Bala	How comfortably the planet is placed	Exaltation distance, its dignity in seven vargas, odd/even sign, the <i>drekkana</i> (which third of the sign), kendra/panapara/apoklima position
Directional	Dig Bala	Whether it is at its best gate	Distance from the house of its full strength (see the story above)
Temporal	Kala Bala	Whether the <i>time</i> of birth favours it	Day or night birth (Moon, Mars, Saturn love the night; Sun, Jupiter, Venus the day; Mercury both), bright or dark fortnight (<i>paksha</i>), and the lords of the year, month, weekday and hour of birth
Motional	Chesta Bala	How vigorously it is moving	Retrograde and slow planets score high; planets racing ahead near the Sun score low (the Sun and Moon have their own rules)
Natural	Naisargika Bala	Its built-in brightness	Fixed for ever: Sun > Moon > Venus > Jupiter > Mercury > Mars > Saturn (60, 51.4, 42.9, 34.3, 25.7, 17.1, 8.6 shashtiamsas)
Aspectual	Drik Bala	Who is looking at it	Benefic aspects add, malefic aspects subtract, using the partial aspects of Appendix A.4

WHY THESE SIX, AND NOT SOME OTHER LIST? Each answers one plain question about a person's capacity, and the six together cover everything that can make a planet effective. *Where do you stand?* (positional: the sign and house are the planet's posting). *Is this the hour you are naturally strong?* (directional: the gate where your kind fights best). *Does the season suit you?* (temporal: a night planet born at night, a bright-fortnight planet born in the bright fortnight, the day and hour ruled by a friend). *How hard are you moving?* (motional: astronomy again, a retrograde planet is at its closest to Earth and its brightest, so it counts as vigorous). *How bright are you by nature?* (natural: the fixed order of apparent brightness, Sun first, Saturn last). *Who supports you?* (aspectual: the friends and enemies looking at you). Parashara lays these out in the Shadbala chapter of *Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra* as separate quantities to be added, which is why they are additive rather than multiplied. Everyday parallel: judging a candidate for a job by posting, shift, season, energy, natural talent and references. Leave any one out and you have missed something real.

The six are added, and the total is compared with a **minimum** that each planet needs to be considered strong enough to deliver:

Planet	Required minimum (rupas)	In shashtiamsas
Sun	6.5	390
Moon	6.0	360
Mars	5.0	300
Mercury	7.0	420
Jupiter	6.5	390
Venus	5.5	330
Saturn	5.0	300

Notice that Mercury needs the most and Mars and Saturn the least: the gentle planets must be strong to do good; the harsh ones do their work even when tired. A planet above its minimum is "strong" ; between about 80 and 100 per cent of it, "adequate" ; below that, "weak" .

DID YOU KNOW? The word *rupa* means "form" or "coin", the same root as *rupee*. When Parashara says a planet has "seven rupas", he is literally counting its wealth. The *shashtiamsa*, one-sixtieth, is the same unit the D60 chart is named after: the tradition liked sixties as much as the Babylonians did.

How to read a Shadbala table from software

Open Jagannatha Hora or any serious program and you will see a table like this (the values below are for a *sample chart*, invented for teaching; they are not Meera's):

Planet	Sthana	Dig	Kala	Chesta	Naisargika	Drik	Total (rupas)	Required	Ratio	Verdict
Sun	2.40	0.90	1.60	0.70	1.00	0.20	6.80	6.5	1.05	
Moon	2.60	0.80	2.10	0.90	0.86	-0.16	7.10	6.0	1.18	
Mars	1.80	0.60	1.30	1.10	0.29	0.31	5.40	5.0	1.08	
Mercury	2.20	1.00	1.40	1.00	0.43	0.17	6.20	7.0	0.89	
Jupiter	2.90	0.30	1.50	1.70	0.57	0.93	7.90	6.5	1.22	
Venus	2.50	1.10	1.60	0.80	0.71	0.19	6.90	5.5	1.25	
Saturn	1.50	1.20	1.00	0.90	0.14	-0.14	4.60	5.0	0.92	

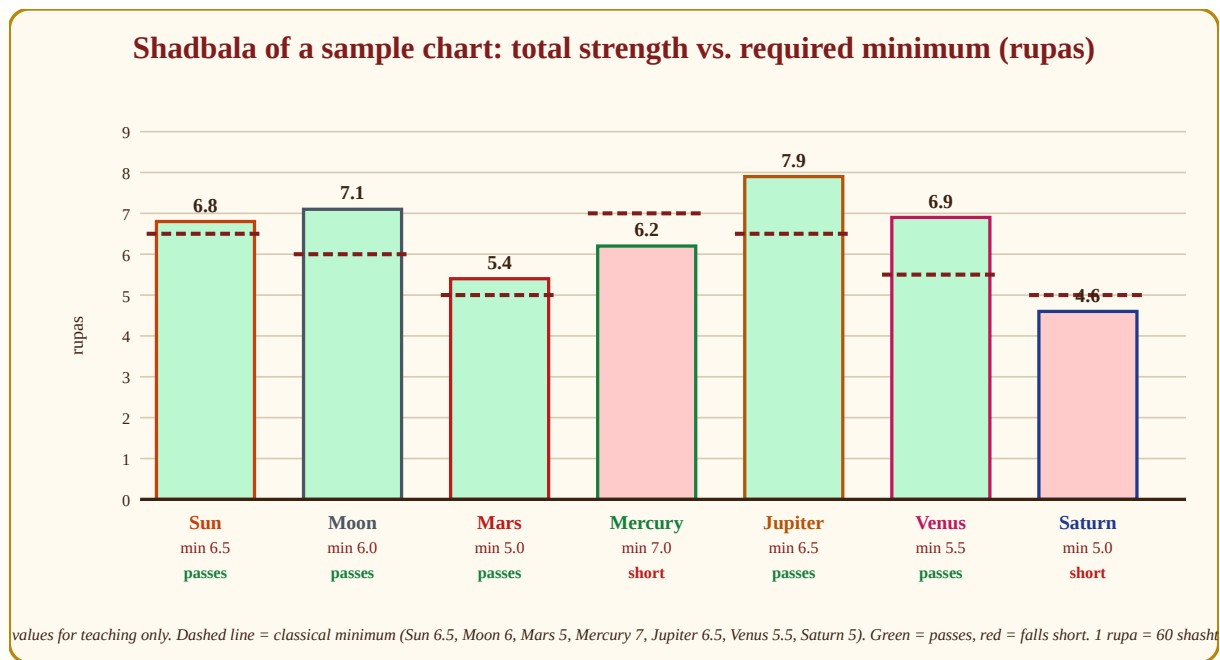


Figure 12.2: The same sample table as bars. Green bars clear the dashed minimum; red bars fall short. Software draws this for you; your job is to read the ratio column.

How I read such a table, in order:

- The ratio column first.** Anything above 1.0 is strong; 0.8–1.0 adequate; below 0.8 weak. In the sample, Jupiter and Venus lead; Mercury and Saturn fall short.
- Then the rank order.** The strongest planet's dasha (Chapter 13) tends to be the best of the life; the weakest planet's dasha the most testing. Chapter 13 will show you why this matters more than any single yoga.
- Then the weak component.** A low Sthana with a high total means a planet in a poor sign that is rescued by time and aspects; a low Drik means enemies are watching it. Look at *why* it is weak before you speak.
- Do not over-trust decimals.** Two programs can differ by half a rupa depending on options (which vargas, which ayanamsa, day-length method). Shadbala tells you *strong*, *adequate*, *weak*, not "6.83 versus 6.79".

CONSULTATION TIP: Never read a Shadbala number aloud to a client. "Your Saturn has 4.6 rupas" means nothing to anyone and sounds like a verdict. Translate: "Saturn is the planet in your chart that has to work hardest for its results, so Saturn's periods ask for patience." The number is for you; the sentence is for them.

Ashtakavarga: votes from eight neighbours

Shadbala measures a planet. **Ashtakavarga** ("the eight-fold division") measures *signs*: it tells you how much support each sign in a chart has, which turns out to be the best tool the tradition has for judging transits and for deciding which houses can bear weight.

STORY: VOTES FROM EIGHT NEIGHBOURS. A new well is to be dug in one of the twelve districts, and the King asks each of eight voters, the seven planets and the Lagna, to say which districts they favour. Each voter has a fixed list: the King himself, standing in his own district, approves of certain districts counted from where he stands (the 1st, 2nd, 4th, 7th, 8th, 9th, 10th and 11th from himself) and disapproves of the rest. Every voter has a different list and votes from a different standing place. When the votes are counted, each district has between 0 and 8 dots (bindus) from each voter, and a total; the district that all eight favoured is where the well is dug first. A district with many dots can bear a heavy visitor; a district with few dots cracks under him. **Rule:** each of the seven planets and the Lagna gives or withholds a dot for every sign; the totals show which signs (houses) can carry weight.

WHY COUNT FROM ALL SEVEN PLANETS AND THE LAGNA? System grammar: a sign's condition depends on everyone in the chart, not on one planet, and the Lagna is the ninth "planet" because it is the person. Each contributor votes from its own position, so the same sign is judged from eight standpoints at once, which is why Ashtakavarga captures things that no single placement shows. Rahu and Ketu do not vote because they have no body and no fixed benefic places in the classical tables. Everyday parallel: a WhatsApp family group deciding where to hold the wedding. Every relative votes from where they live; the venue that suits most of them is the one that works.

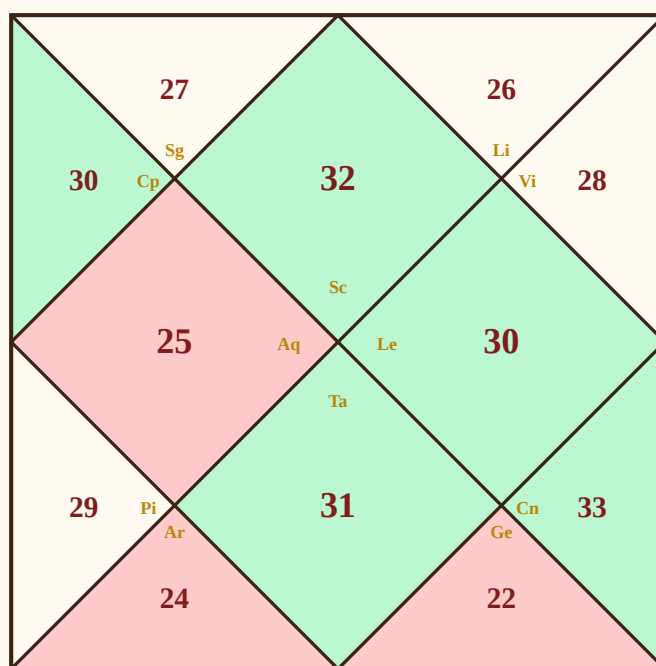
Here is the machinery in plain terms. For each of the seven planets, Parashara gives a table of "benefic places": counted from each of the eight contributors (the seven planets and the Lagna), certain houses are favourable to that planet. Each favourable house earns one **bindu** (dot); each unfavourable house earns a **rekha** (line, that is, zero). Add the dots that a given planet receives in a given sign from all eight contributors and you get a number from 0 to 8: that is the planet's **Bhinnashtakavarga** (individual Ashtakavarga) score for that sign. Add all seven planets' scores for a sign and you get the sign's **Sarvashtakavarga** (SAV, total Ashtakavarga) score.

Three numbers to memorise:

- The seven Bhinnashtakavarga tables give fixed totals across the zodiac: Sun 48, Moon 49, Mars 39, Mercury 54, Jupiter 56, Venus 52, Saturn 39, and $48 + 49 + 39 + 54 + 56 + 52 + 39 = 337$. The SAV of every chart ever cast adds up to 337.
- $337 \div 12 \approx 28$: the average SAV score of a sign.
- A sign with **28 or more** ● is well supported; **30 and above** is strong; **25 or fewer** ○ is lean; in between ◐ is ordinary.

WHY 337 AND WHY 28? Pure arithmetic. Each planet's table has a fixed number of favourable places in total (the Sun's tables contain 48 "yes" entries, Jupiter's 56, and so on), and those totals do not change from chart to chart; only *which* signs receive them changes. So every chart distributes the same 337 dots over twelve signs, and $337 \div 12$ is 28.08. A sign above 28 has taken more than its share; a sign below has given some away. Everyday parallel: a class of 337 marks shared among 12 students. Whoever has 33 has done well; whoever has 22 has been shortchanged, whatever the reason.

Sarvashtakavarga (SAV) of Chart A: sample bindus per house



30 or more: a strong house; transits here give results 25 or fewer: a lean house; go gently

Total of all twelve houses = 337 (always). Average ≈ 28 per house. Sample values for teaching; your software will print the real ones.

Figure 12.3: A sample Sarvashtakavarga laid on Chart A's houses (Scorpio Lagna). Green houses have 30 or more bindus, red houses 25 or fewer. The twelve numbers always total 337. Values invented for teaching; your software prints the real ones.

How to use it:

For transits (Chapter 14). When Saturn or Jupiter enters a sign, look at that sign's SAV. A Saturn transit through a 32-bindu sign is a hard-working season that pays; through a 22-bindu sign it is a season of loss with little return. Finer still, look at Saturn's own Bhinnashtakavarga in that sign: 4 or more of its 8 possible dots ● and the transit behaves; 3 or fewer ○ and it bites. This single rule explains why two people with the same Sade Sati have completely different experiences of it.

For judging houses. A house whose sign carries 30+ bindus can absorb a malefic and still give results; a house with 22 bindus struggles even with a benefic in it. In the sample figure, the 9th (33) and 1st (32) are Meera's strongest rooms, the 8th (22) her weakest, which agrees with a chart whose fortune (Moon in own sign in the 9th) and self (Sun, Mercury in the 1st) are its pillars.

Kakshas, in one line. Each sign is further split into eight *kakshas* (compartments) of $3^\circ 45'$, each ruled by one of the eight contributors in a fixed order (Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Sun, Venus, Mercury, Moon, Lagna); a transiting planet gives its best results in the days it crosses a kaksha whose ruler gave it a dot. That is fine-tuning for later; know the word.

Bhinnashtakavarga, in one paragraph. Each planet's individual table is read for that planet's own affairs: the Sun's table for father, authority and health; the Moon's for mind and mother; Jupiter's for children and fortune. A planet sitting in a sign where its own Bhinnashtakavarga gives 5 or more dots is comfortable and productive; with 3 or fewer it struggles regardless of its Shadbala. The Moon's and Saturn's tables are the two I check most, for Sade Sati and for the mind.

Avasthas: the states of a planet

Beyond strength, the tradition describes a planet's **state** (*avastha*): its age, its wakefulness, its mood. Three sets are in common use.

Baladi avasthas: the planet's age by degree

Each sign is cut into five bands of 6°, and the band tells you the planet's "age": infant, child, youth, old, dead. In **odd signs** the ages run forward from 0°; in **even signs** they run backward, so a planet at 2° of an even sign is *old*, not young.

Degrees	Odd sign (Ar, Ge, Le, Li, Sg, Aq)	Even sign (Ta, Cn, Vi, Sc, Cp, Pi)
0°–6°	Bala, infant ● (partial results, growing)	Mrita, dead ○
6°–12°	Kumara, child ◐ (half results)	Vriddha, old ○
12°–18°	Yuva, youth ● (full results)	Yuva, youth ●
18°–24°	Vriddha, old ○ (little)	Kumara, child ◐
24°–30°	Mrita, dead ○ (almost nothing of its own)	Bala, infant ●

The traditional proportions: Bala gives about a quarter of its results, Kumara half, Yuva full, Vriddha very little, Mrita almost none; a Mrita planet borrows its results from its dispositor and its dasha.

STORY: THE OLD JUDGE AND THE INFANT. *In the odd-numbered districts of the kingdom the gate is at the near end: a courtier who has just entered (0°) is a newcomer, an infant in that district, and by the time he reaches the far wall (30°) he has spent his whole life there and has nothing left to give. In the even-numbered districts the gate is at the far end, so the same degrees read backwards: a courtier at 4° of an even district is standing by the exit, worn out, while one at 28° has just walked in fresh. The old Judge, Saturn, keeps this register; he does not care how grand the courtier looks, only how much life he has left in that district. **Rule:** Baladi avastha runs Bala, Kumara, Yuva, Vriddha, Mrita by 6° bands in odd signs and in reverse in even signs; Yuva gives full results, Mrita almost none.*

WHY DO THE AGES REVERSE IN EVEN SIGNS? *The mirror logic of odd and even that runs through the whole system (Appendix A.1): odd signs are male and outward-facing, even signs female and inward-facing, and the tradition consistently treats an even sign as the odd sign read backwards. You met the same mirror in the Hora (the Sun's half comes first in odd signs and second in even ones) and in the Dasamsa and Saptamsa starting points. The middle band, 12°–18°, is Yuva in both, which is the point of the design: the centre of any sign is where a planet is most fully itself. Everyday parallel: two rows of houses on a street, one numbered from the north end and one from the south; number 3 on one side faces number 27 on the other, but the middle of the street is the middle on both sides.*

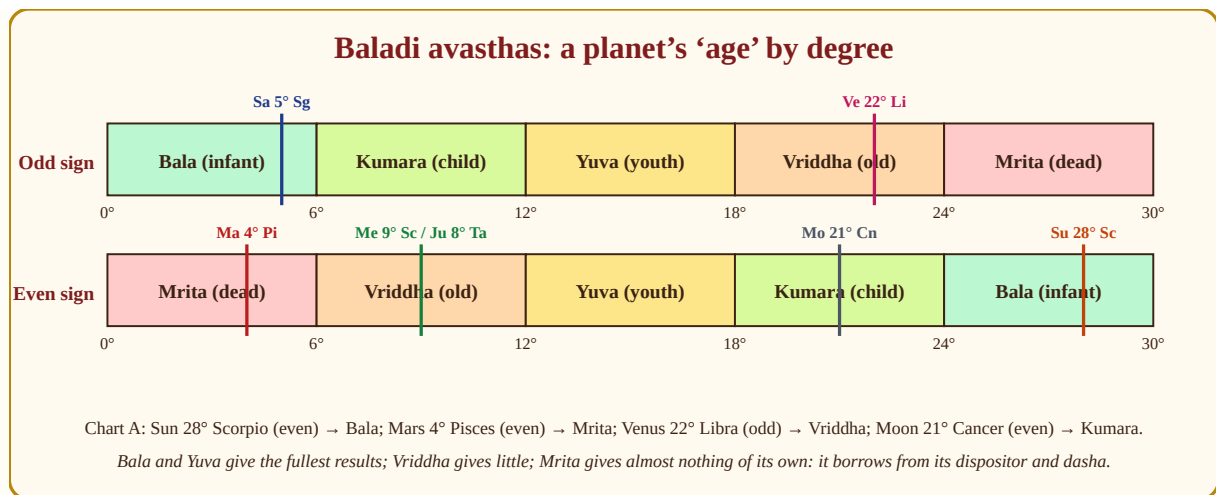


Figure 12.4: The five age bands. Odd signs read left to right, even signs right to left. Meera's planets are marked: the Sun at 28° of even Scorpio is an infant; Mars at 4° of even Pisces is "dead".

Chart A, honestly:

Planet	Position	Sign type	Avastha	Comment
Sun	28° Scorpio	even	Bala (infant) ●	Fresh, growing; its results mature slowly, which fits a Sun Mahadasha that arrives only at 38
Mercury	9° Scorpio	even	Vriddha (old) ○	Experienced but tiring; its dig bala and Jupiter's aspect carry it
Venus	22° Libra	odd	Vriddha (old) ○	Own sign, but low vigour: comfort more than passion
Mars	4° Pisces	even	Mrita (dead) ○	The Lagna lord in Mrita avastha is a real weakness: Meera's health and initiative depend on Jupiter (its dispositor) and on the dasha
Jupiter	8° Taurus	even	Vriddha (old) ○	Adds to the "tired outside" picture
Saturn	5° Sagittarius	odd	Bala (infant) ●	Young, but combust: a young planet with a fever
Moon	21° Cancer	even	Kumara (child) ◐	Half results; own sign makes up for it

Two comments the table demands. The **Sun as an infant**: some students think this contradicts "Sun in the Lagna, strong". It does not. The Sun's *dignity and house* are good; its *avastha* says the results unfold like a child growing, slowly, then fully. Meera's authority is real and late. The **Lagna lord Mars in Mrita avastha** is the most sobering line in her chart, and I would rather you saw it than not: it points to stamina that runs low, a need to guard health, and a tendency to start things that others must finish. The rescue is Jupiter (Mars sits in Jupiter's sign and Jupiter is strong in D9) and the Mars dasha, which for her comes only at 54. Notice that the avasthas are usually applied to the seven planets; most teachers leave Rahu and Ketu out.

Jagradadi avasthas: awake, dreaming, asleep

State	Condition	Result
Jagrat , awake ●	In own or exaltation sign	Full, conscious results
Swapna , dreaming ◐	In a friend's or neutral's sign	Partial, intermittent results
Sushupti , asleep ○	In an enemy's sign or debilitated	Results barely felt

The logic is symbolic and simple: a planet at home is awake to its duties; among friends it dozes; among enemies it withdraws. Chart A: Venus and the Moon are **awake** (own signs). The Sun, Mars, Saturn and Mercury are **dreaming** (friends' and neutrals' signs). Jupiter is **asleep** in Taurus, until you open the Navamsa, where it is at home. Two planets awake, one asleep, four dreaming: a chart that works through its Moon and Venus and grows into the rest.

Deeptadi avasthas: the nine moods

A finer set, nine states named for the planet's mood. Texts differ slightly on the exact list and on where debilitation belongs (some make it *Kopa*, some add a tenth state, *Bheeta*, "frightened"); this is the mainstream table.

State	Meaning	Condition	Colour
Deepta	Radiant	Exalted	●
Swastha	At ease	Own sign	●
Mudita	Delighted	Friend's sign	●
Shanta	Peaceful	In a benefic's sign or varga	●
Deena	Humble	Neutral's sign	◐
Dukhita	Sorrowful	Enemy's sign	○
Vikala	Crippled	Combust	○
Khala	Wicked	In a malefic's sign or varga	○
Kopa	Angry	Debilitated, or defeated in a planetary war	○

The value of this set is the *language* it gives you. "Your Saturn is Vikala, crippled by closeness to the Sun" is a sentence I can turn into advice. "Your Moon is Swastha" is a sentence I can turn into reassurance.

Ishta and Kashta phala, and Bhava Bala, briefly

Two advanced measures you will meet in software. **Ishta phala** (desired results) and **Kashta phala** (painful results) combine a planet's exaltation strength with its Chesta Bala to say how much *pleasant* and how much *unpleasant* result it will give in its periods; a planet may be strong and still have high Kashta. Read them as a tint, not a verdict. **Bhava Bala** applies the whole apparatus to *houses*: the house lord's Shadbala plus points for the house's own directional strength and the aspects it receives, giving each of the twelve houses a score. A high-scoring house delivers its matters even with an empty room; a low-scoring house needs a strong planet inside it. Both are worth glancing at once you are comfortable with Shadbala; neither should be your first instrument.

The two-minute strength scorecard

Finally, a tool of my own, a **teaching aid**, **not a classical method**, that turns the seven-check glance into a number you can write beside each planet in your notebook. It exists so that you form the habit of *checking everything* before you speak; once the habit is set, you will stop needing the points.

Check	Points
Dignity	exalted +4 ● · own or moolatrikona +3 ● · friend's sign +1 ● · neutral 0 ● · enemy's -1 ○ · debilitated -3 ○ (add +2 back if Neecha Bhanga applies)
Combustion	combust -2 ○
Retrogression	retrograde +1 ● (strength with a twist)
House	1st +2 · other kendra +1 · 5th or 9th +1 ● · 6th, 8th or 12th -1 ○ · others 0
Aspects received	each benefic aspect +1 ●, each malefic aspect -1 ○ (cap at ±2)
Vargottama	+1 ●
Dig Bala	at its best house +1 ● · at the opposite house -1 ○ · else 0
Baladi avastha	Mrita -1 ○ · others 0
Navamsa dignity	own or exalted in D9 +1 ● · debilitated in D9 -1 ○

Reading the total: 4 or more = strong ● (its promises will be kept in its periods); 1 to 3 = middling ● (delivers with effort and support); 0 or less = weak ○ (needs remedy, patience, or a rescuer).

Chart A, scored (aspects from Chapter 6; D9 from Chapter 11; Mercury counted as a benefic since it sits with only the mild Sun):

Planet	Dignity	Comb.	Retro	House	Aspects	Varg.	Dig	Avastha	D9	Total	Verdict
Sun	+1	0	0	+2	Jupiter +1	0	0	0	0	4	● strong
Moon	+3	0	0	+1	0	0	0	0	0	4	● strong
Mars	+1	0	+1	+1	0	0	0	-1	0	2	● middling
Mercury	0	0	0	+2	Jupiter +1	0	+1	0	+1	5	● strong
Jupiter	-1	0	+1	+1	Sun -1, Mercury +1	0	-1	0	+1	1	● middling
Venus	+3	0	0	-1	Mars -1	0	0	0	0	1	● middling
Saturn	0	-2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	-2	○ weak

Read the last column as a summary of the whole chapter: Meera's chart runs on **Mercury, the Sun and the Moon**, intellect, self and mind, with Mars, Jupiter and Venus as middling supporters and Saturn as the weak link. That is exactly the person described in Chapters 5 to 11: a communicator with a strong mind and a steady faith, whose comforts are private, whose partner and wisdom mature slowly, and whose home life and stamina need care. When her Mercury and Sun periods come, the chart

delivers; when Saturn's sub-periods come, she should expect to work for less. That one sentence is what the whole apparatus is for, and it took two minutes.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Strength decides *whether*; nature decides *what*; dasha decides *when*. Before you say anything about a planet, know all three. If you know only one, say nothing yet.

In one breath

- Strength decides whether a planet can keep its promises: a weak benefic promises and fails; a strong malefic hurts but delivers.
- The two-minute glance: dignity, combustion, retrogression, house, aspects, Vargottama, Dig Bala. Check combustion by degree, not by sign: glare does not stop at a sign boundary, and Meera's Saturn is combust across one.
- Shadbala adds six strengths (positional, directional, temporal, motional, natural, aspectual), each answering one question about capacity, in rupas of 60 shashtiamsas; minimums are Sun 6.5, Moon 6, Mars 5, Mercury 7, Jupiter 6.5, Venus 5.5, Saturn 5. Read the ratio, then the rank order, then the weak component.
- Ashtakavarga scores signs with bindus from the seven planets and the Lagna, everyone voting on every sign; the total is always 337, the average 28; 28+ is supported, 25 or less is lean. Use it for transits and for judging houses.
- Baladi avasthas give a planet's age by 6° bands, reversed in even signs by the odd/even mirror; Yuva gives full results, Mrita almost none. Meera's Sun is an infant, her Lagna lord Mars is Mrita.
- Jagradadi (awake/dreaming/asleep) and Deeptadi (nine moods) give you language for a planet's condition.
- The scorecard is a teaching aid: 4+ strong, 1–3 middling, 0 or less weak. Meera runs on Mercury, Sun and Moon; Saturn is her weak link.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. Arjun's Saturn (Chart B) is at 25° Aquarius with the Sun at 18° Aquarius. Is Saturn combust? Which Baladi avastha is it in? Which Jagradadi state?
2. Devika's Jupiter (Chart C) is at 26° Cancer. Give its dignity, Baladi avastha and Dig Bala, and score it on the two-minute scorecard (its D9 sign is Aquarius; it receives no aspects from other planets; the Sun sits with it, so count the conjunction as a malefic aspect of –1).
3. A software printout shows Venus with Shadbala 4.9 rupas. Is Venus strong, adequate or weak? What is the first thing you look at next?
4. A sign in a friend's chart has 21 Sarvashtakavarga bindus and Saturn is about to transit it. In one sentence, what do you tell her?

Answers

1. Yes: $25^\circ - 18^\circ = 7^\circ$, inside Saturn's 15° orb, so combust (Vikala). Aquarius is an odd sign, so 25° falls in the 24° – 30° band: ****Mrita**** (dead). Aquarius is Saturn's own sign, so ****Jagrat**** (awake): an awake but exhausted and scorched Saturn, the 7th and 8th lord that will give its results late and through effort. 2. Cancer is Jupiter's exaltation: **Deepta**, +4. Cancer is even, so 26° is in the 24° – 30° band: ****Bala**** (infant), full potential unfolding slowly. Jupiter's Dig Bala house is the 1st; the 4th is neither best

nor opposite: 0. Scorecard: dignity +4, not combust 0 (the Sun is 21° away), not retrograde 0, house 4th kendra +1, aspects (Sun conjunct) -1, not Vargottama 0, Dig 0, avastha Bala 0, D9 Aquarius neutral 0 = **4, strong 🟢**: a Hamsa yoga that will deliver, with the caution that its results grow with age. 3. Venus needs 5.5 rupas; $4.9 \div 5.5 = 0.89$, **adequate, leaning weak** 🟡 . Look next at *which* component is low (a poor Sthana means a poor sign; a negative Drik means malefic aspects) and at its dignity in D9, before deciding whether Venus's periods will deliver comfort or only the wish for it. 4. Something like: "Saturn is about to spend two and a half years in the weakest room of your chart, so this is a season to consolidate, not to expand: keep expenses tight, finish old work, and do not start new loans until it moves on."

Chapter 13: Vimshottari Dasha: The Timetable of Life

Everything you have learned so far describes the *chart*: the planets, their houses, their strength, their teams. The chart is a promise. It says "there is a marriage here", "there is a career in teaching here", "there is a difficult stretch for the mother here". What it does not say, by itself, is *when*. A promise without a date is a comfort at best and a torment at worst; ask anyone who has been told "you will get a good job" and waited eleven years.

The **dasha** (the word means "period" or "condition") is the delivery date. The tradition has many dasha systems (Chapter 15 surveys them), but one stands above all others in India, the one every astrologer learns first and trusts most: the **Vimshottari dasha**, the 120-year cycle. This chapter teaches it completely: how to find it, how to compute it by hand for our three charts, and how to *read* it, which is the part software cannot do for you.

The railway timetable

STORY: THE NINE TRAINS. *Life, in this system, is a railway line 120 years long, and nine trains run on it, always in the same order and always for the same number of years each: the Headless Sadhu's train for 7 years, the Minister of Pleasure's for 20, the King's for 6, the Queen Mother's for 10, the Commander's for 7, the Smoke-headed Stranger's for 18, the Royal Priest's for 16, the old Judge's for 19, the young Prince's for 17. Nobody can change the order; nobody can lengthen a train. What differs from person to person is only this: which train you are already sitting in when you are born, and how far along its route it has come. A child born aboard the Priest's train near the end of its run will change to the Judge's train within a year or two; a child born as the Minister of Pleasure's train pulls out has twenty years of her hospitality ahead. Whoever drives the current train holds the keys to the haveli for those years, and only his plans are carried out. **Rule:** Vimshottari runs Ketu 7, Venus 20, Sun 6, Moon 10, Mars 7, Rahu 18, Jupiter 16, Saturn 19, Mercury 17, always in this order, 120 years in all.*

Here is the timetable as a table, with the functional nature each period takes for Meera's Scorpio Lagna (Chapter 8, Appendix A.6):

Order	Lord	Years	For Scorpio Lagna (Chart A)
1	Ketu	7	☾ by placement (10th house, Leo)
2	Venus	20	♀ 7th and 12th lord, functional malefic, but in own sign
3	Sun	6	☼ 10th lord
4	Moon	10	☾ 9th lord
5	Mars	7	♂ Lagna lord (also 6th lord)
6	Rahu	18	☊ by placement (4th house, Aquarius)
7	Jupiter	16	♃ 2nd and 5th lord
8	Saturn	19	♄ 3rd and 4th lord
9	Mercury	17	☿ 8th and 11th lord

WHY 120 YEARS? Tradition, stated plainly: Parashara calls 120 years *Purna Ayu*, the full human lifespan granted in this age, and builds the cycle to that length so that no planet's period ever needs to repeat within one life. The layer here is classical statement, not astronomy; the individual years (Venus 20, Saturn 19 and so on) are given by Parashara without derivation, and the tradition's own account ties them to the nine nakshatra lords of Chapter 7, whose order the dasha follows exactly. Everyday parallel: a school timetable that runs the whole year without repeating a period. Nobody sits through every class; the point is that the sequence is long enough that you never do.

DID YOU KNOW? The nine dasha lords are the nine nakshatra lords of Chapter 7, and the dasha order is the order of the nakshatras counted from Ashwini (Ketu's star). Learn one list and you have learned both.

Finding the first train: the Moon's nakshatra

Which dasha are you born into? The one ruled by the **lord of the Moon's nakshatra at birth**. And how far along is it? In proportion to how far the Moon has already travelled through that nakshatra.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER'S STREET DECIDES THE FIRST TRAIN. When the child is born, the court looks not at the King but at the Queen Mother, the Moon, and asks: on which of the twenty-seven streets of the kingdom is she standing? Every street has an owner, one of the nine lords, and the owner of that street is the driver of the first train. Then they ask a second question: how far along the street has she walked? If she has walked two-thirds of it, the child gets only the last third of that train's journey; the rest was spent before he was born. So the first dasha is nearly always a fraction of its full length, and the balance is what remains. **Rule:** the first Mahadasha is the lord of the Moon's nakshatra; its balance is $(\text{degrees still to travel in the nakshatra} \div 13^\circ 20') \times \text{the lord's years}$.

WHY START FROM THE MOON'S NAKSHATRA? Symbolic logic with an astronomical root. The Moon is the mind, and Vimshottari is a nakshatra dasha: the nakshatras are the Moon's own 27 stations, the 27 nights it takes to go round the sky (astronomy: 27.3 days). So the Moon's street at birth is the natural starting address of a system built on the Moon's path, and the mind's state at birth sets where the timetable begins. The Lagna-based and Sun-based dashas exist (Chapter 15), but the tradition made the Moon-based one the backbone because life is lived in the mind. Everyday parallel: when you board a long-distance train, which coach you are in depends on where you were standing on the platform when it arrived.

Balance of the first dasha: how far the Moon has still to walk in its nakshatra

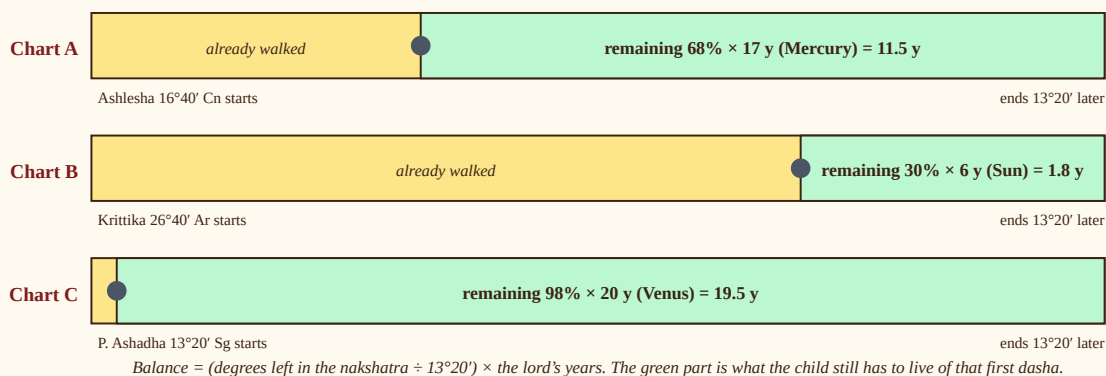


Figure 13.1: The balance of the first dasha for our three charts. The yellow part of each nakshatra has already been walked before birth; the green part is what remains, scaled to the lord's years.

Now the arithmetic, slowly, for all three charts. Each nakshatra spans 13°20', which is 13.333°; keep that number handy.

Chart A, Meera. Moon 21° Cancer. Ashlesha spans 16°40' to 30°00' Cancer (Appendix A.7); its lord is **Mercury, 17 years**. The Moon has 30° – 21° = **9°** still to travel in Ashlesha. Balance = $9 \div 13.333 \times 17 = 0.675 \times 17 = \mathbf{11.475 \text{ years}}$. Convert: 11 years; $0.475 \times 12 = 5.7$ months, so 5 months; $0.7 \times 30 = 21$ days. **Mercury balance 11 years 5 months 21 days**. Born 12 December 1988, her Mercury dasha ends around **3 June 2000**.

Chart B, Arjun. Moon 6° Taurus. Kritika spans 26°40' Aries to 10°00' Taurus; lord **Sun, 6 years**. Remaining: $10^\circ - 6^\circ = 4^\circ$. Balance = $4 \div 13.333 \times 6 = 0.3 \times 6 = \mathbf{1.8 \text{ years}}$ = 1 year; $0.8 \times 12 = 9.6$ months, so 9 months; $0.6 \times 30 = 18$ days. **Sun balance 1 year 9 months 18 days**. Born 3 March 1995, his Sun dasha ends around **19 December 1996**.

Chart C, Devika. Moon 14° Sagittarius. Purva Ashadha spans 13°20' to 26°40' Sagittarius; lord **Venus, 20 years**. Remaining: $26^\circ 40' - 14^\circ = 12^\circ 40' = 12.667^\circ$. Balance = $12.667 \div 13.333 \times 20 = 0.95 \times 20 = \mathbf{19.0 \text{ years}}$ exactly. Born 22 July 1979, her Venus dasha ends **22 July 1998**.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Using the degrees *already travelled* instead of the degrees *remaining*. The child gets what is left of the train, not what has passed. Meera has walked 4°20' of Ashlesha and has 9° to go; it is the 9° that counts.

Building the full Mahadasha timeline: Chart A

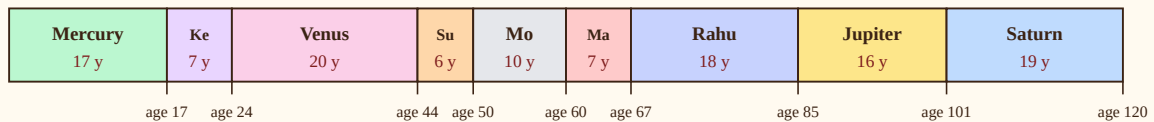
Once the first period's end is fixed, the rest is addition, because every later period runs its full length.

Mahadasha	Years	Runs from	To	Meera's age
Mercury (balance)	11.475	12 Dec 1988	≈ Jun 2000	0 to 11½
Ketu	7	Jun 2000	Jun 2007	11½ to 18½
Venus	20	Jun 2007	Jun 2027	18½ to 38½
Sun	6	Jun 2027	Jun 2033	38½ to 44½
Moon	10	Jun 2033	Jun 2043	44½ to 54½
Mars	7	Jun 2043	Jun 2050	54½ to 61½
Rahu	18	Jun 2050	Jun 2068	61½ to 79½
Jupiter	16	Jun 2068	Jun 2084	79½ to 95½
Saturn	19	Jun 2084	Jun 2103	95½ to 114½

A note on dates: I have used years of 365.25 days. Some programs use 360-day years or a slightly different balance formula, and will show these boundaries a few weeks earlier, late May rather than early June. Do not argue with anyone over three weeks; the dasha is a season, not a train that arrives at 10:42.

Chart A: Vimshottari order starting from Mercury

Birth (balance of Mercury dasha runs first)



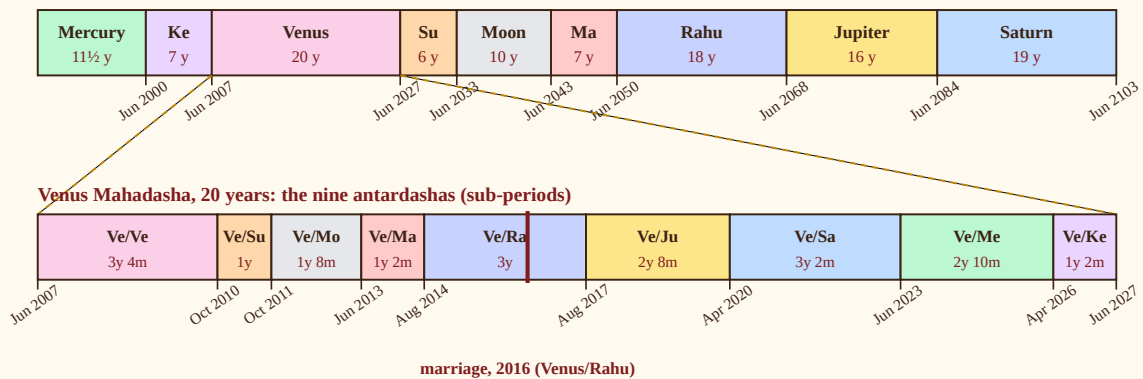
Order never changes: Ketu → Venus → Sun → Moon → Mars → Rahu → Jupiter → Saturn → Mercury → (Ketu again)

Meera's Moon is in Ashlesha (Mercury's star), so Mercury runs first: but only its 11½-year balance.

Figure 13.2: The nine Mahadashas in order, starting from Mercury. The bar shows full lengths; remember that Meera's Mercury period was already 5½ years gone at birth, so subtract 5½ from every age tick.

Chart A (Meera, b. 12 Dec 1988): Mahadashas with dates, and the Venus period zoomed

Birth 12 Dec 1988



Dates use 365.25-day years from the exact balance (11.475 y). Your software may differ by a few weeks depending on its year length.

Antardasha length = (Mahadasha years × sub-lord years) ÷ 120. Venus/Rahu = 20 × 18 ÷ 120 = 3 years.

Figure 13.3: The same timeline with real dates, and the Venus Mahadasha (2007–2027) opened up into its nine sub-periods. The maroon marker is her 2016 marriage, in Venus/Rahu.

Antardashas: the sub-periods

Each Mahadasha is itself divided into nine **Antardashas** (sub-periods), one for each lord, in the *same order*, beginning with the Mahadasha lord itself. The length is a simple proportion (Appendix A.8):

Antardasha of B inside Mahadasha A = (years of A × years of B) ÷ 120.

WHY MULTIPLY? Logical derivation: proportional share. The 120-year cycle is divided among the nine lords in fixed shares (Venus 20/120, Rahu 18/120 and so on). A Mahadasha is a small copy of the whole cycle, so inside Venus's 20 years each lord gets the *same fraction* of those 20 years that it gets of the 120: Rahu gets 18/120 of 20 years, which is $20 \times 18 \div 120 = 3$ years. Because the shares are the same, the nine sub-periods always add back up to the Mahadasha. Everyday parallel: a family that splits every month's income in the same proportions splits a small month and a large month the same way; the shares scale, the ratios do not.

So inside Venus's 20-year Mahadasha, the Rahu sub-period is 3 years; the Sun sub-period is $20 \times 6 \div 120 = 1$ year. Here is Meera's Venus Mahadasha in full, starting early June 2007, with each sub-lord's position counted from Venus (the 6/8/12 rule, explained below):

Antardasha	Length	From	To	Sub-lord's house from Venus (Libra)
Venus / Venus	$20 \times 20 \div 120 = 3\text{y } 4\text{m}$	Jun 2007	Oct 2010	(itself)
Venus / Sun	$20 \times 6 \div 120 = 1\text{y } 0\text{m}$	Oct 2010	Oct 2011	2nd (Scorpio) ●
Venus / Moon	$20 \times 10 \div 120 = 1\text{y } 8\text{m}$	Oct 2011	Jun 2013	10th (Cancer) ●
Venus / Mars	$20 \times 7 \div 120 = 1\text{y } 2\text{m}$	Jun 2013	Aug 2014	6th (Pisces) ○
Venus / Rahu	$20 \times 18 \div 120 = 3\text{y } 0\text{m}$	Aug 2014	Aug 2017	5th (Aquarius) ●
Venus / Jupiter	$20 \times 16 \div 120 = 2\text{y } 8\text{m}$	Aug 2017	Apr 2020	8th (Taurus) ○
Venus / Saturn	$20 \times 19 \div 120 = 3\text{y } 2\text{m}$	Apr 2020	Jun 2023	3rd (Sagittarius) ●
Venus / Mercury	$20 \times 17 \div 120 = 2\text{y } 10\text{m}$	Jun 2023	Apr 2026	2nd (Scorpio) ●
Venus / Ketu	$20 \times 7 \div 120 = 1\text{y } 2\text{m}$	Apr 2026	Jun 2027	11th (Leo) ●

Check the sum: $40 + 12 + 20 + 14 + 36 + 32 + 38 + 34 + 14 = 240$ months = 20 years. The table in Appendix A.8 gives the commonest sub-period lengths ready-made (Venus/Venus 3-4-0, Venus/Sun 1-0-0, and so on); use it at the desk, but be able to derive any of them in ten seconds.

Pratyantar dashas, the sub-sub-periods, divide each Antardasha by the same rule again: Pratyantar of C inside Antardasha A/B = $(\text{length of A/B} \times \text{years of C}) \div 120$. Venus/Rahu/Jupiter, for instance, is $3 \text{ years} \times 16 \div 120 = 0.4$ years, about 4 months 24 days. Pratyantars are useful for narrowing an event to a season once the Antardasha has told you the year; below that level (the *sookshma* and *prana* dashas) the birth time is rarely accurate enough to trust.

How to interpret a dasha: the five questions

Software prints the dates. Everything from here on is judgement, and it comes down to five questions asked of the period lord.

STORY: THE KEY-HOLDER OPENS HIS OWN ROOMS. When a courtier's train is running, he holds the keys of the haveli. But a key-holder does not wander everywhere. He goes first to the rooms he owns, the houses whose signs are his, and throws them open: if the Minister of Pleasure owns the bride's chamber and the storeroom of expenses, those two rooms come alive in his years. Then he goes to the room where he happens to be sitting on the day the keys were handed over, the house he occupies, and that room is busy too. He behaves according to his standing (dignity) and his mood (aspects), he treats the household as his own party treats it (functional nature), and he looks at the Queen Mother's rooms as well, because the mind is where the years are actually lived. **Rule:** a dasha lord activates the houses it owns and the house it occupies, coloured by its functional nature, dignity, aspects, and its house from the Moon.

WHY DOES A DASHA LORD ACTIVATE THE HOUSES IT OWNS AND OCCUPIES? System grammar, and it is the same grammar as Chapter 9. A planet is the lord of its houses: their affairs are its department, and it carries their files wherever it goes. When its period runs, it is the employee on duty, so its department's files are the ones on the desk. The house it occupies is where it was standing when the duty began, so that room is opened too. Everyday parallel: when the accounts officer is on duty, accounts move; when the admissions officer is on duty, admissions move; and whichever office they are physically sitting in that week gets busy as well.

Question 1: Is the dasha lord a functional benefic or malefic for this Lagna? (Chapter 8, Appendix A.6.) A functional benefic's years *lift*: doors open in its houses. A functional malefic's years *test*: the same houses are pressured, and the person works harder for less. This is the single most reliable rule in the whole of dasha interpretation, and the one most often skipped, because people jump to "Jupiter is good, Saturn is bad".

Question 2: Which houses does it own and occupy? Those are the rooms that come alive. Write them down before anything else.

Question 3: What is its dignity and who aspects it? (Chapter 12.) A strong lord delivers its houses' promises; a weak one delivers the wish for them. A dasha lord aspected by Jupiter gives its results with grace; one aspected by Saturn gives them late.

Question 4 (for Antardashas): where does the sub-lord sit from the Mahadasha lord? The famous **6/8/12 rule**: a sub-period lord placed in the 6th, 8th or 12th house *from the Mahadasha lord* gives friction, obstacles or expense, even when both planets are individually fine, because the two key-holders are at odds. A sub-lord in the 2nd, 5th, 9th, 10th or 11th from the Mahadasha lord cooperates. (The 1st, 3rd, 4th and 7th are mixed, leaning good.)

STORY: THE SUB-MINISTER WHO SITS IN THE WRONG ROOM. During the Minister of Pleasure's twenty years, each of the other courtiers takes a turn as her deputy. Most are placed in rooms where she can call them easily, the 2nd, 5th, 9th, 10th, 11th from her seat, and the household runs smoothly. But two deputies are lodged in rooms she never visits: the Commander in the 6th, the room of disputes, and the Royal Priest in the 8th, the room of hidden things. However able these men are, their years as deputy are awkward: messages are lost, plans are misread, expenses rise. It is not that either courtier is bad; it is that the deputy is sitting where the Minister cannot see him. **Rule:** an Antardasha lord in the 6th, 8th or 12th from the Mahadasha lord gives friction; in the 2nd, 5th, 9th, 10th or 11th it cooperates.

WHY 6, 8 AND 12? System grammar applied relatively. The 6th, 8th and 12th are the dusthanas, the difficult rooms, from any point you count from (Chapter 4). Counting from the Mahadasha lord treats him as a temporary Lagna: the sub-lord in his 6th is his enemy, in his 8th his obstacle, in his 12th his expense. So the sub-period is spent on the boss's disputes, hidden problems and losses rather than on the sub-lord's own gifts. Everyday parallel: a good employee seconded to a department whose head cannot stand him. The work is competent; the year is miserable for both.

Question 5: Which house does the dasha lord occupy counted from the Moon? The Moon is the mind; the dasha lord's house from the Moon tells you how the period *feels*, whatever it does. A dasha lord in the 4th from the Moon feels like home

and comfort; in the 8th from the Moon it feels like upheaval even when the results are good.

Three classical "flavours" complete the toolkit. **The dasha of a planet in a dusthana** (6, 8, 12) brings the affairs of that house forward: service, debts, illness, transformation, foreign residence, expense, though a dignified planet there makes them chosen rather than suffered. **The dasha of an exalted planet** is a rise in whatever that planet signifies, often the best years of the life. **The dasha of the Lagna lord** turns the years towards the self: health, identity, personal projects, for good or ill depending on its strength.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Before you read any dasha, say aloud: "This planet owns houses ____ and , *sits in house* , is a functional ____ for this Lagna, and is ____ in strength." If you cannot finish the sentence, you are not ready to predict.

Two refinements: the nakshatra layer, and the nodes

The nakshatra-lord layer. A modern refinement, taught heavily in the Krishnamurti (KP) school and now widespread, holds that a dasha lord also gives the results of the *planet that rules its nakshatra*, its "star lord", and of the houses that planet owns and occupies. I label this as a KP-influenced modern method, not Parashara; but I use it, because it often explains why a period produced something the house lordships alone did not predict. Meera's Venus is at 22° Libra, in **Vishakha, Jupiter's star**. So her Venus dasha also speaks with Jupiter's voice, and Jupiter sits in her **7th house** and owns the 2nd (family) and 5th. A marriage in the Venus period is written twice over.

Rahu and Ketu. The nodes own no signs, so Question 2 seems to have no answer for them. The tradition's solution: **Rahu and Ketu give the results of the lord of the sign they occupy, and of any planet conjunct them**; failing both, they give the results of the house they sit in, in their own manner: Rahu amplifying, obsessing, bringing the foreign and the sudden; Ketu detaching, dissolving, bringing the past and the spiritual.

STORY: THE STRANGER SPEAKS WITH HIS HOST'S VOICE. *The Smoke-headed Stranger owns no district in the kingdom; when his eighteen-year train runs, whose plans does he carry out? The court has an old answer. The Stranger is a guest, and a guest speaks with his host's voice: whichever courtier owns the district where Rahu is lodged becomes his host, and Rahu's years bring that host's affairs to the front, hugely, hungrily, with a foreign accent. If another courtier is lodged in the same room as the Stranger, that courtier's affairs come too, amplified. The Headless Sadhu does the same in reverse: he empties his host's rooms rather than filling them, and leaves the family wiser and lighter. Rule: Rahu and Ketu give the results of their sign lord and of any planet they sit with, in their own style.*

WHY DO THE NODES BORROW THEIR DISPOSITOR'S RESULTS? *Astronomy first: Rahu and Ketu are not bodies but the two points where the Moon's orbit crosses the Sun's path (Appendix A.2). They own no sign because they have no light of their own to rule with. The system's grammar then follows: a planet with no department must work in someone else's, so the nodes take on the agenda of the sign lord whose house they occupy and of whoever shares the room. Everyday parallel: a guest who stays a month in a household ends up eating its food, keeping its hours and taking its side in arguments; he has no kitchen of his own.*

The junctions, and the maraka periods

Dasha sandhi, the junction where one Mahadasha ends and the next begins, is sensitive. The old key-holder is packing and the new one has not yet learned the house. The last Antardasha of a Mahadasha and the first of the next tend to be unsettled:

changes of job, residence, health, mood, often without a clear cause. Meera's Venus to Sun junction falls in mid-2027; I would tell her to expect a year of transition around it and not to make irreversible decisions in the six months either side.

Maraka periods. Chapter 4 named the 2nd and 7th houses *maraka* (killer) houses, and Appendix A.6 lists the marakas for each Lagna; for Scorpio, Venus and Mercury. The dasha of a maraka lord, especially in old age or when the Lagna lord is weak, is when health and longevity are tested. For Meera, the whole Venus Mahadasha is a maraka period on paper.

CONSULTATION TIP: Never say the word "maraka" to a client, and never predict death. Ever. The classical texts use maraka periods to estimate longevity in a person already old or ill; in a healthy young person the same period simply asks for attention to health. Look: Meera's maraka Venus period brought her a marriage. What you may say is: "This is a period to take your health seriously, regular check-ups, no neglect." What you may never say is "this period is dangerous for your life". The first sentence helps; the second can do real harm to an anxious person, and it is very often wrong.

Chart A read: the Venus Mahadasha, 2007–2027

Let us run the five questions on Meera's Venus period and see whether the method predicts her life.

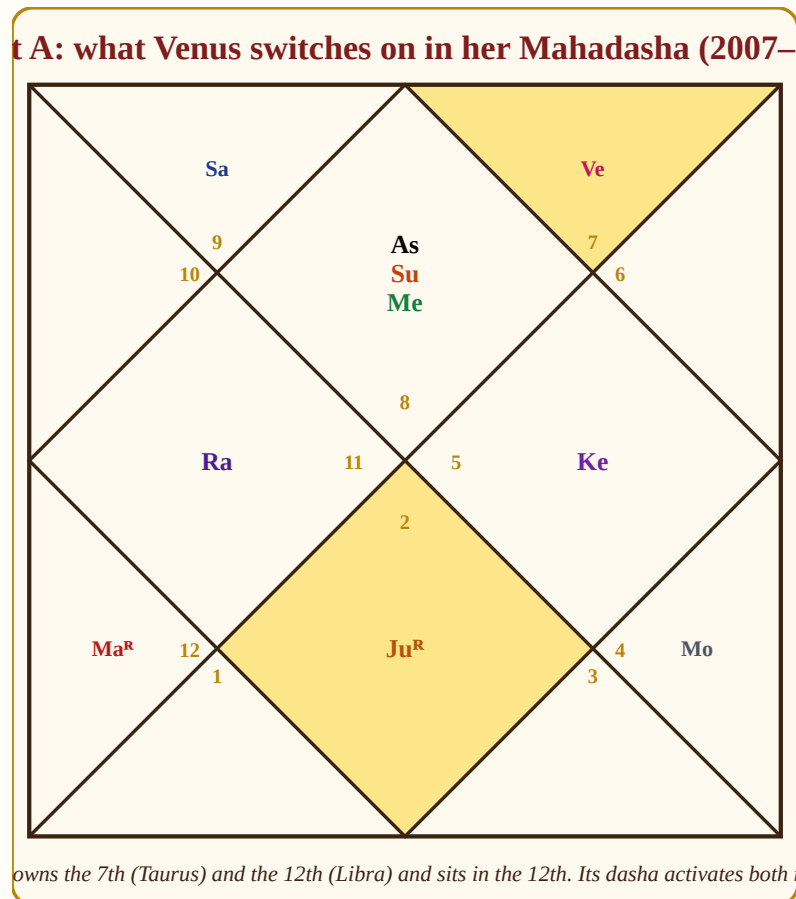


Figure 13.4: The rooms Venus opens in Meera's chart: the 7th (Taurus, marriage) and the 12th (Libra, where Venus sits: expenses, foreign lands, solitude, bed comforts).

1. **Functional nature.** For Scorpio Lagna, Venus is a functional malefic (7th and 12th lord) and a maraka. So: a *testing* period, not a *lifting* one; the person works for what she gets.
2. **Houses.** Venus owns the 7th (marriage, partnership, the public) and the 12th (expenses, foreign places, isolation, sleep), and sits in the 12th. The three themes of the period: **marriage and partnership; foreign connections and travel;**

expenditure and time spent away or alone.

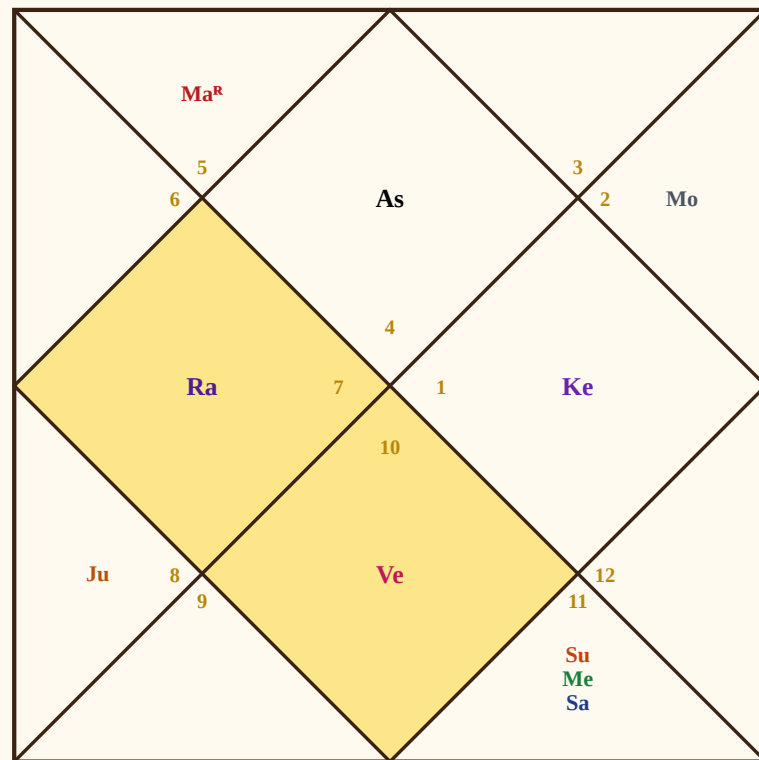
3. **Dignity and aspects.** Venus is in its own sign, strong, so the themes come as *chosen* events rather than losses. It is aspected by Mars from the 5th (the 8th aspect): some heat and haste in relationships, arguments about money. Venus in Vishakha, Jupiter's star, adds Jupiter's 7th-house voice.
4. **Antardashas.** From the table above: Venus/Mars (Jun 2013 to Aug 2014) and Venus/Jupiter (Aug 2017 to Apr 2020) are the two friction sub-periods (6th and 8th from Venus). Venus/Rahu (Aug 2014 to Aug 2017) has Rahu in the 5th from Venus, cooperative, and Rahu sits in the **4th house** (home, settling down) in Saturn's sign; Saturn sits in the 2nd, the house of family.
5. **From the Moon.** Venus in Libra is the 4th from her Cancer Moon: the period *feels* like home-building and comfort, whatever else it does.

Now the facts from the Case Study Kit: Meera married in **2016**, inside **Venus/Rahu**. Does the method explain it? The Mahadasha lord is the 7th lord, in a star whose lord sits in the 7th house. The Antardasha lord Rahu is cooperative (5th from Venus), sits in the 4th house of home and domestic settling, and speaks with the voice of its host Saturn, lord of the 4th, who sits in the 2nd house of family. A marriage that brought a new home and new family in the middle of the Venus period is exactly what this arrangement describes. I would not have said "2016" from the chart alone; no honest astrologer would. I would have said "marriage most likely between 2014 and 2017, quite possibly to someone met through travel or from another region (Rahu, 12th lord Venus)". That is what dasha prediction looks like when it is done properly: a window, with reasons.

The rest of the period reads the same way. Venus/Jupiter (2017 to 2020): Jupiter is 8th from Venus, friction, yet Jupiter is her 2nd and 5th lord in the 7th; I would expect a child or a major decision about children, with some strain and expense. Venus/Saturn (2020 to 2023): Saturn is combust and her 3rd/4th lord; a heavy stretch for the home and mother, overlapping her Ashtama Shani transit (Chapter 14). Venus/Mercury (2023 to 2026): Mercury is the 11th lord with full directional strength in the Lagna, the best earning window of the period, through writing and speaking (Chapter 18 agrees). Venus/Ketu (2026 to 2027): a quiet closing, then the junction.

Chart B and Chart C in brief

Chart B: Rahu Mahadasha (Dec 2013 to Dec 2031)



Rahu in the 4th in Libra; its dispositor Venus sits in the 7th. Rahu speaks with Venus's voice

Figure 13.5: Arjun's Rahu Mahadasha (Dec 2013 to Dec 2031). Rahu in the 4th in Libra speaks with the voice of Venus, its sign lord, who sits in the 7th.

Arjun (Chart B): Rahu Mahadasha, about December 2013 to December 2031 (age 18.8 to 36.8). Rahu in the 4th house, Libra, in Swati, its own star. Its host is Venus, lord of the 4th and 11th, sitting in the 7th. So Rahu's eighteen years bring the 4th house forward in Rahu's style: changes of home and city, property matters, education that takes an unconventional or foreign route, the mother's affairs in the foreground, and, through Venus in the 7th, partnerships and gains through other people. The sub-periods: Rahu/Jupiter (Aug 2016 to Jan 2019) with Jupiter 2nd from Rahu ●, study and mentors; Rahu/Saturn (Jan 2019 to Dec 2021) with Saturn 5th from Rahu ● but combust and the 7th and 8th lord, heavy structured work and a test of a relationship; Rahu/Venus (Jul 2025 to Jul 2028) with Venus 4th from Rahu ● and sitting in the 7th, the natural marriage window of the period, though Arjun's 7th lord Saturn is combust in the 8th, so I would say "marriage likely 2025 to 2028, after a delay or a broken first arrangement"; Rahu/Moon (Jun 2029 to Dec 2030) with the Moon 8th from Rahu ○, the one sub-period of the eighteen years I would flag for emotional upheaval.

Devika (Chart C): Rahu Mahadasha, July 2021 to July 2039 (age 42 to 60). Rahu at 3° Leo in the 5th house, in Magha, Ketu's star, and in the first degrees of a fire sign, the gandanta edge (Chapter 7). Rahu sits with Saturn (10th and 11th lord) and Mercury (3rd and 6th lord), so it speaks with three voices: its host the Sun (5th lord, in the 4th with exalted Jupiter), and its two room-mates. The 5th house, children, students, creativity, speculation, is the stage of these eighteen years, and the earlier struggles of that house (Chapter 10) come up for resolution in Rahu's amplified style: children's careers abroad, a late creative venture, students in large numbers, sudden gains and losses through speculation that she should treat with care. The best stretch is Rahu/Jupiter (Apr 2024 to Aug 2026): Jupiter is 12th from Rahu ○ by the 6/8/12 rule, which warns of expense, but it is her exalted 9th lord, exchanging signs with the Moon. The day this clicked for me was when I saw a planet of that quality override the 6/8/12 friction in a friend's chart: expense, yes, and worth it. Rahu/Saturn (Aug 2026 to Jul 2029) is the working stretch: career responsibility late in life.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Reading a Mahadasha as twenty years of one flavour. Nobody lives twenty flat years. The Mahadasha sets the theme; the Antardasha sets the chapter; the transits (Chapter 14) set the weather. Meera's Venus period contains a marriage, a heavy home stretch and her best earning years: all "Venus", all different.

In one breath

- The chart is the promise; the dasha is the delivery date. Vimshottari is the backbone dasha of Indian astrology.
- Order and years never change: Ketu 7, Venus 20, Sun 6, Moon 10, Mars 7, Rahu 18, Jupiter 16, Saturn 19, Mercury 17; 120 years, *Purna Ayu*, the full lifespan of the tradition.
- The first Mahadasha is the lord of the Moon's nakshatra, because Vimshottari is a nakshatra dasha built on the Moon's path; its balance = (degrees remaining ÷ 13°20') × the lord's years. Meera: Mercury, 11 y 5 m 21 d; Arjun: Sun, 1 y 9 m 18 d; Devika: Venus, 19 y.
- Antardasha = (A × B) ÷ 120 years, a proportional share, in dasha order starting with the Mahadasha lord; Pratyantar divides again the same way.
- Five questions for any period lord: functional nature for this Lagna; houses owned and occupied (its department's files); dignity and aspects; the sub-lord's house from the Mahadasha lord (6/8/12 = the boss's difficult rooms); its house from the Moon.
- Rahu and Ketu, having no sign of their own, give the results of their sign lord and any conjunct planet. The nakshatra-lord layer (KP-influenced) adds the star lord's houses.
- Junctions (dasha sandhi) are unsettled; maraka periods ask for attention to health. Never predict death.
- Meera's 2016 marriage falls in Venus/Rahu: 7th lord Mahadasha, in Jupiter's star (Jupiter in the 7th), with a cooperative Antardasha lord in the 4th house of home.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. A friend's Moon is at 5° Aries. Which nakshatra, which lord, and what is the balance of the first dasha? Then list the first four Mahadashas with their lengths.
2. Compute the length of the Saturn/Mercury Antardasha and the Jupiter/Venus Antardasha, in years, months and days.
3. Arjun's Jupiter Mahadasha begins around December 2031. Answer the five questions for it in one line each (Jupiter is at 22° Scorpio in the 5th; his Moon is in Taurus).
4. In Meera's Venus Mahadasha, why does Venus/Mars count as a friction sub-period even though Mars is her Lagna lord and a functional benefic?
5. A frightened acquaintance says, "My astrologer told me my maraka dasha starts next year." Write the two sentences you would say.

Answers

1. 5° Aries is in Ashwini (0° to 13°20' Aries), lord Ketu, 7 years. Remaining = 13°20' – 5° = 8°20' = 8.333°; balance = 8.333 ÷ 13.333 × 7 = 0.625 × 7 = **4.375 years = 4 y 4 m 15 d**. Then Venus 20, Sun 6, Moon 10: so Ketu (balance 4.375), Venus (20), Sun (6), Moon (10). 2. Saturn/Mercury = 19 × 17 ÷ 120 = 2.692 years = 2 y 8 m 9 d (Appendix A.8 agrees: 2-8-9). Jupiter/Venus

= $16 \times 20 \div 120 = 2.667$ years = **2 y 8 m 0 d**. 3. (1) Jupiter is a functional benefic for Cancer Lagna (9th lord; also 6th lord): a lifting period. (2) It owns the 6th and 9th and sits in the 5th: fortune, higher learning, children, and service or health matters come forward. (3) In Scorpio, a friend's sign, in a trikona, forming Gaja Kesari with the Moon (7th from it): strong. (4) For its Antardashas, count each sub-lord from Scorpio: Saturn, Sun and Mercury in Aquarius are 4th ♠, Venus in Capricorn 3rd ♠, Rahu in Libra 12th ♢, Ketu in Aries 6th ♢, Mars in Leo 10th ♣, Moon in Taurus 7th ♠. (5) Jupiter is in the 7th from his Taurus Moon: the period feels like partnership and public life. 4. Because the 6/8/12 rule counts the sub-lord's position *from the Mahadasha lord*, not from the Lagna. Mars in Pisces is the 6th from Venus in Libra. Mars's good functional nature softens the outcome but does not remove the friction between the two key-holders: expect effort and some conflict in that year even as Mars's own matters (health, initiative) are active. 5. Something like: "A maraka period is one where the tradition asks us to look after health, not one that predicts harm; in fact the same period in a friend's chart brought her marriage. Let us look at what this planet actually owns in your chart, and I will tell you what to attend to and what to look forward to."

Chapter 14: Transits (Gochar): The Weather Report

In the last chapter you learnt the *dasha*, the long planetary periods that tell you which *season* of life a person is in. Now I want to give you the second half of timing, the half people actually feel week to week: the **transits** (*Gochar*, literally "the movement of the cows", the planets grazing their way around the sky).

Here is the picture that made it click for me. The *dasha* is the season. The transit is the weather. If the *dasha* says it is monsoon, a cloudy transit gives you a downpour; the same cloudy transit in a dry season gives you a passing shower and nothing more. Neither works alone. A farmer who reads only the season plants too early; a farmer who reads only the sky never plans beyond tomorrow. You need both, and you need to know which one to trust when they disagree: the season, always the season.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: *Dasha* promises; transit delivers. A transit can never give what the *dasha* (and the natal chart behind it) has not promised. It can only decide *when* and *how loudly*.

Two frames: from the Moon and from the Lagna

A transit means simply this: where the planets are *today*, laid over the birth chart. The question is, counted from where?

The classical texts (*Brihat Samhita*, *Phaladeepika*, the transit chapters of every almanac) count from the **natal Moon**. When your nani says "Shani is in my eighth", she means the eighth from her Moon sign (*rashi*), and every panchanga printed in India follows her.

WHY? This is the system's own grammar plus a little astronomy. The Moon is the mind (*manas*) in Jyotish, and the mind is where weather is *felt* first: a delay, a windfall, a quarrel all register as mood before they register as fact. Astronomically the Moon is also the fastest body and the one that actually changes phase in front of us, so the old astronomers used it as the reference point for everything that changes. Everyday parallel: two people get the same rainy day; the one who feels it is the one who has to walk to the bus stand. Gochar from the Moon asks how the weather will feel to *this* mind.

Modern practice adds a second frame: count from the **Lagna** as well. The Lagna frame tells you which *area of life* the transiting planet is touching in the chart's own house structure: career if it is your 10th, marriage if your 7th. I use both, every time, and I want you to as well. When the two frames agree, speak with confidence. When they disagree, the Moon frame tells you how it will *feel* and the Lagna frame tells you *where* it will happen.

Chart A (Meera, our Scorpio Lagna with the Moon in Cancer) is a clean example. Saturn in Pisces (2025 to about 2027) is in her **5th house from the Lagna** and the **9th from her Moon**. Two different numbers, two different stories, both true. We will finish that reading at the end of the chapter.

Which transits matter: the speed table

Before any rule, one piece of common sense. A planet's transit matters in proportion to how long it stays. From Appendix A.2:

Planet	Time in one sign	What its transit can do
Moon	about 2¼ days	Sets the mood of the day; used for muhurta (Chapter 16), not for life events
Sun	about 1 month	Times the <i>month</i> within a good year
Mercury, Venus	about 1 month (with loops)	Month-level colour: talk, contracts, purchases, romance
Mars	about 45 days	Six-week bursts of energy, quarrels, surgery, property moves
Jupiter	about 1 year	The yearly blessing, the most-watched benefic transit
Rahu / Ketu	about 18 months, moving backwards	Karmic churn, sudden turns, obsessions
Saturn	about 2½ years	The heavyweight: Sade Sati, Dhaiya, delays, maturity

WHY? Pure astronomy. Saturn is the farthest of the visible planets, so it has the longest road around the Sun: about 29.5 years for one circuit. Twelve signs into 29.5 years gives about 2.5 years per sign. Jupiter's orbit is about 12 years, so one sign a year. Mars takes about two years, hence 45 days a sign; the Moon circles us in 27.3 days, hence 2¼ days a sign. Everyday parallel: a clock. The second hand tells you almost nothing about what time it is; the hour hand tells you everything. Saturn is the hour hand of a life.

So Saturn, Jupiter and the nodes shape the year; the Sun and Mars pick the month; the Moon picks the day. A beginner who worries about "Mercury in my 8th this week" has the telescope turned the wrong way round.

The classical good houses from the Moon

Appendix A.9 gives the list every almanac prints. Here it is again, with the one thing the almanacs leave out: the **reason**.

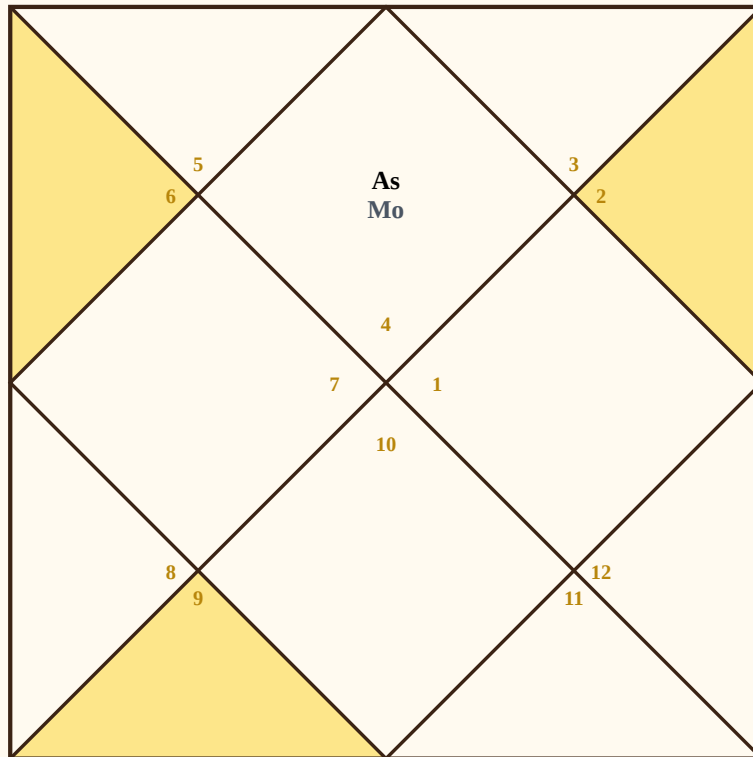
Transiting planet	● Good houses from the natal Moon	○ Worst houses (classical)	Why this pattern
Sun	● 3, 6, 10, 11	○ 1, 4, 7, 8, 12	A mild malefic: it burns what it sits on, so it is welcome only in the growing (upachaya) houses where heat means work and victory
Moon	● 1, 3, 6, 7, 10, 11	○ 4, 8, 12	Fast and gentle; happy over itself, in the upachayas, and in the 7th (public, partnerships)
Mars	● 3, 6, 11	○ 1, 4, 7, 8, 12	A malefic: good only where fighting is useful, courage (3), enemies and debts (6), gains (11)
Mercury	● 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 11	○ 1, 5, 7, 12	The clever secretary: good where paperwork, speech and calculation help (money, home, work, gains), even the 8th (research, insurance)
Jupiter	● 2, 5, 7, 9, 11	○ 6, 8, 12 (transit Shakata)	The priest blesses the houses of wealth (2), children and wisdom (5), spouse (7), fortune (9), gains (11), and from any of these it aspects the others
Venus	● 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 8, 9, 11, 12	○ 6, 7, 10	A benefic that enjoys itself almost anywhere; even the 12th (bed comforts) and 8th (inheritance, pleasure) suit it. Avoid only 6, 7, 10
Saturn	● 3, 6, 11	○ 12, 1, 2 (Sade Sati); 4, 8 (Dhaiya)	The great malefic: welcome only in the upachayas, where hard labour and patience are exactly what those houses ask for
Rahu / Ketu	● 3, 6, 11 (common practice)	○ 1, 4, 7, 8, 12	Shadows behave like Saturn (Rahu) and Mars (Ketu); the texts are thin here, so this is convention

WHY ARE MALEFICS GOOD IN 3, 6, 11? A derivation from the system's grammar. The 3rd (effort), 6th (enemies, debts, service) and 11th (gains) are three of the four upachaya houses, the houses that *improve with pressure* (Chapter 4). A malefic is a planet that applies pressure. Pressure on your effort, on your rivals and on your income is pressure in the right places; the same pressure on your body (1st), your peace (4th) or your marriage (7th) hurts. Everyday parallel: a strict coach is a blessing on the practice ground and a disaster at the dinner table.

WHY IS JUPITER GOOD IN 2, 5, 7, 9, 11? Grammar again, and it is geometry. Those are the houses where the things Jupiter gives actually live: wealth, children, spouse, fortune, gains. And because Jupiter aspects the 5th, 7th and 9th from itself (Appendix A.4), from any house on that list its glance lands on other houses on the list, or on the Moon itself: from the 5th it sees the 9th, 11th and 1st; from the 9th it sees the 1st, 3rd and 5th. Wherever the priest sits in his good rooms, he is also blessing two or three more of them. Everyday parallel: a good teacher seated in the staff room can still see the library, the exam hall and the playground through the windows.

STORY: WHERE EACH COURTIER MAY VISIT THE QUEEN MOTHER. The Queen Mother (the Moon) keeps a haveli of twelve rooms, and every courtier on his rounds must be received somewhere. The Commander (red Mars) and the old Judge (navy Saturn) are welcome only in the working rooms: the 3rd where the servants drill, the 6th where accounts and quarrels are settled, the 11th where the harvest is counted. Put either in her bedchamber (the 1st) or the family hall (the 4th) and the whole house falls silent. Guru-ji (gold Jupiter) is welcome wherever a blessing is needed: the treasury (2nd), the children's rooms (5th), the marriage pavilion (7th), the prayer room (9th), the harvest room (11th), and from any one of them his gaze reaches the others. Shukracharya (pink Venus) is welcome almost everywhere except the sickroom (6th), the guest-of-honour's seat (7th) and the office (10th), where he only distracts. The clever Prince (green Mercury) is useful wherever there is paperwork. **Rule:** malefics transit well only in 3, 6, 11 from the Moon; Jupiter in 2, 5, 7, 9, 11; each courtier is welcome where his nature is useful.

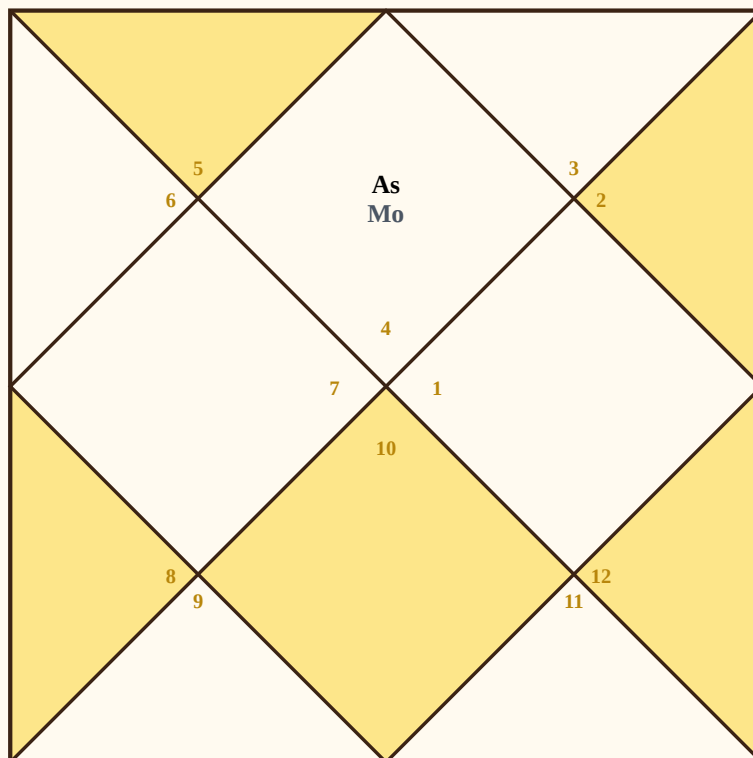
Saturn's good transit houses from the natal Moon



1 here = the natal Moon's sign. Saturn gives results in 3, 6, 11 - the growing (upachaya)

Figure 14.1: Put the natal Moon in the 1st house and count. Saturn transiting the 3rd, 6th or 11th (highlighted) gives results; elsewhere it tests. These are the upachaya houses: the reason, not a coincidence.

Jupiter's good transit houses from the natal Moon



= natal Moon. Jupiter blesses 2, 5, 7, 9, 11 - the houses of wealth, children, spouse, fortune

Figure 14.2: The same frame for Jupiter: 2, 5, 7, 9 and 11 from the Moon. From each of these positions, Jupiter's trinal aspects land on other houses in the same list.

Vedha, the obstruction (one paragraph, for completeness)

The classics add a refinement called **Vedha** (obstruction): a good transit is spoiled if another planet sits in a particular "obstructing" house at the same time. Saturn's good 3rd is obstructed by a planet in the 12th, its 6th by one in the 9th, its 11th by one in the 5th, and each planet has its own table (the Sun and Saturn, and the Moon and Mercury, do not obstruct each other). I mention it so you recognise the word in *Phaladeepika* or an old almanac. Most modern practitioners rarely apply it; learn the main list first. Vedha is a garnish for later.

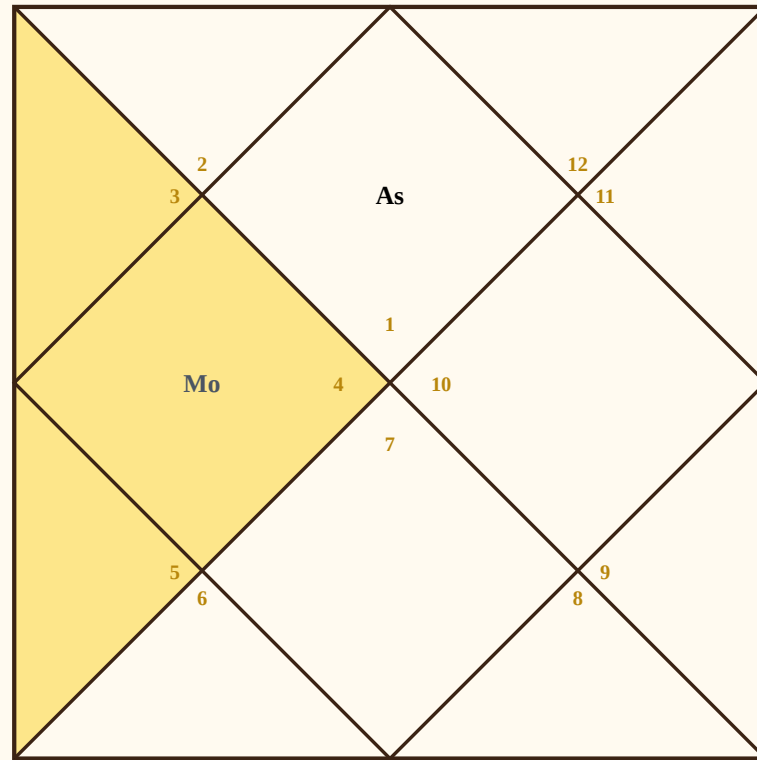
Sade Sati: the seven-and-a-half years, honestly

No transit frightens people like this one, and no transit is more misunderstood. When I first met the word, in a WhatsApp forward, it came with a skull emoji. Let me give you the whole thing, calmly.

Definition. *Sade Sati* means "seven and a half". It is the period when Saturn transits the **12th, 1st and 2nd signs from the natal Moon**: three signs at about 2½ years each, roughly 7½ years in all (Appendix A.9). Because Saturn takes about 29½ years to circle the zodiac, an ordinary life meets Sade Sati two or three times: once in childhood or youth, once in the middle years, once in old age.

WHY 7½ YEARS, AND WHY THESE THREE SIGNS? The number is astronomy: three signs $\times$ 2½ years per sign = 7½. The choice of signs is the system's grammar. Counted from the Moon (the mind), the 12th is the mind's store-room, where things are spent, lost and slept off; the 1st is the self; the 2nd is the family purse and the mouth (speech, food). Saturn walking through those three rooms in a row audits, in turn, what you waste, who you are, and what you keep. Everyday parallel: an income-tax scrutiny that starts with your expenses, then interviews you, then goes through the family accounts.

Sade Sati: Saturn's 7½-year walk over the natal Moon



Saturn walks through the 12th, 1st and 2nd from the natal Moon: about 7½ years

Figure 14.3: The natal Moon sits in the 4th house of this teaching chart. Saturn's walk through the sign before the Moon (12th from it), the Moon's own sign, and the sign after (2nd from it) is the Sade Sati: three highlighted houses, about 2½ years each.

Why the Moon? Because the Moon is the mind and Saturn is weight. When the slowest planet sits on or beside the mind, everything feels heavier: the same workload, the same family, the same body. The events differ from person to person; the weight is common to all.

The three phases

Phase	Saturn's position	What it typically brings
• First (rising)	12th from the Moon	Expenses rise; sleep suffers; distance from home or family (transfers, travel, a child leaving); a sense of something ending before the new has begun. Saturn from here aspects the 2nd (family, money) and 6th (health, debts) from the Moon.
○ Second (peak)	Over the Moon itself	The heaviest: health, identity, heavy responsibility, a change of role. Old patterns of thinking are dismantled. Saturn here aspects the 3rd, 7th and 10th from the Moon: courage, marriage and career all feel the pressure at once.
• Third (setting)	2nd from the Moon	Family and money matters, speech and reputation; often the phase where the lessons of the first two are cashed in: a settlement, a new financial discipline, a quieter home. Saturn aspects the 4th, 8th and 11th from the Moon.

STORY: THE JUDGE'S SEVEN-AND-A-HALF-YEAR AUDIT. Once every twenty-nine and a half years the old Judge of Labour (Shani-ji) arrives to audit the Queen Mother's household, and he does it room by room, never hurrying. He begins in the **store-room** (the 12th): he counts the sacks, finds what has been wasted, and the household sleeps badly while the lamps burn late; some servants are sent to distant estates. Then he enters **her own chamber** (the 1st) and sits down: now the Queen Mother herself must answer for her health, her habits and her duties, and the whole court feels her weight. This is the peak. Finally he moves to the **family dining hall** (the 2nd): the accounts are read aloud, debts are settled, careless speech is corrected, and the deposit is refunded to whoever kept honest books. Then he bows and leaves for the next house. Nothing in it is personal; he audits every household in turn, three of the twelve at any moment. **Rule:** Sade Sati is Saturn in the 12th, 1st and 2nd from the natal Moon (expenses, then self, then family), about 7½ years; a quarter of the world is in it right now.

Why one person's Sade Sati is a promotion and another's is a hospital

The word is the same; the experience is not. Four things decide it, and you already know how to check all four.

1. The Moon's strength (Chapter 12). A bright, well-placed Moon (waxing, in its own or a friend's sign, aspected by Jupiter) carries weight the way a strong back carries a sack of rice. A dark Moon in the 8th with Ketu bends under it. Meera's Moon, in its own sign Cancer in the 9th, a trikona, with no malefic sitting on it (Jupiter in her 7th does not aspect the 9th, so the Moon stands on its own dignity), is a good back.

2. Saturn's functional nature for the Lagna (Chapter 8, Appendix A.6). Almost nobody mentions this. For **Libra** and **Taurus** Lagnas Saturn is the *yogakaraka*; for Capricorn and Aquarius it is the Lagna lord; for Gemini and Virgo a friend. These people routinely report Sade Sati as the years they were promoted, bought a house, or finally became serious: hard, but *productive* hard. A Libra Lagna's Sade Sati is very often a promotion. For Aries, Cancer, Leo, Scorpio, Sagittarius and Pisces Lagnas, Saturn owns difficult houses and the same transit demands more and gives less.

3. The house from the Lagna. Sade Sati falling across the 10th and 11th houses is a career season; across the 6th, 7th and 8th it tests health and marriage.

4. The running dasha. The famous rule: **the Sade Sati during which Saturn is also a dasha lord (Mahadasha or Antardasha) is the heavy one.** When season and weather are both Saturn's, the downpour is real. In a Jupiter or Venus Mahadasha the same transit often passes as extra work and a couple of medical bills, remembered later as "the time I grew up".

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Announcing Sade Sati from the Moon sign alone. Three signs out of twelve are in Sade Sati at every moment: that is **a quarter of all the people on Earth**, right now. Add the two Dhainya signs (4th and 8th from the Moon) and it is five in twelve. If Sade Sati alone ruined lives, half the world would be in ruins every day. It is a season to be *read*, not a verdict to be *pronounced*.

Saturn's current cycle (approximate; check an ephemeris)

Sidereal Saturn's recent and coming signs, rounded to the season:

Sign	Approximate period
Capricorn	Jan 2020 – Jan 2023 (with a brief peep into Aquarius, Apr–Jul 2022)
Aquarius	Jan 2023 – Mar 2025
Pisces	Mar 2025 – mid-2027 (Saturn steps back into Pisces for a few months around late 2027–early 2028)
Aries	roughly 2027/28 – 2030
Taurus	roughly 2030 – 2032
Gemini	roughly 2032 – 2034/35

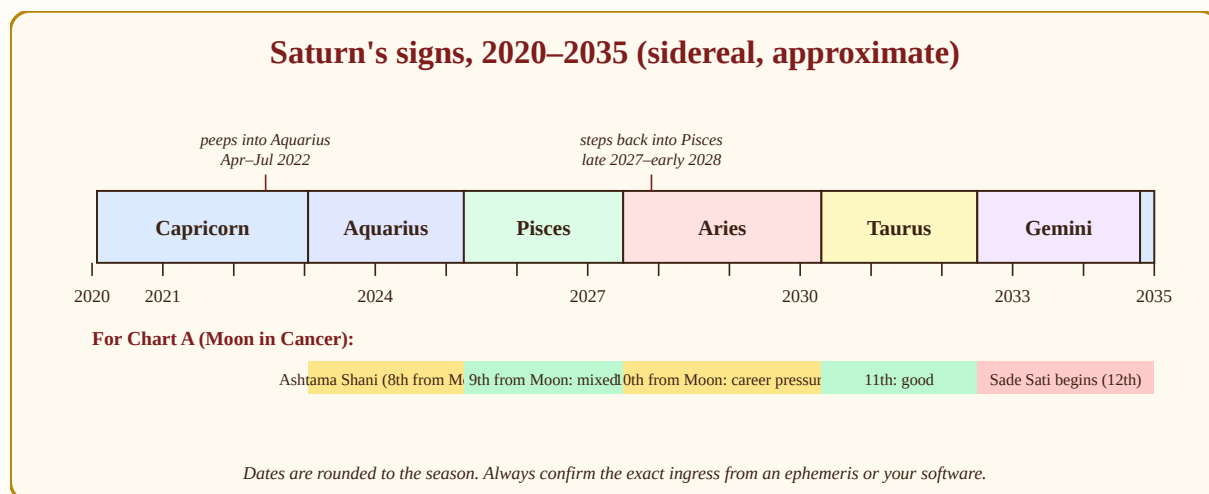


Figure 14.4: Saturn's road from 2020 to 2035, dates rounded to the season. The lower strip reads the same road from Chart A's Cancer Moon: Ashtama Shani in Aquarius, a mixed 9th in Pisces, a demanding 10th in Aries, a rewarding 11th in Taurus, and the next Sade Sati beginning when Saturn enters Gemini.

So, with Saturn in **Pisces** from 2025 to about 2027:

- **Pisces Moon:** second phase (the peak); Saturn is on the Moon.
- **Aquarius Moon:** third phase (setting); Saturn is in the 2nd from the Moon.
- **Aries Moon:** first phase (rising); Saturn is in the 12th from the Moon.

When Saturn moves into Aries (around 2027/28), Aquarius Moons are released, Aries Moons enter the peak, and Taurus Moons begin the first phase. Do not memorise these; learn to count them, and confirm the ingress dates in your software, because Saturn's retrograde loops make it enter and leave a sign more than once at the edges.

CONSULTATION TIP: When someone asks "Is my Sade Sati running?", never answer with a single yes. Say something like: "Yes, you are in the second phase, and it lasts until about such-and-such. Saturn is a strict teacher, not a monster. In these years he removes what is not yours and asks you to work for what is. About a quarter of everyone you know is in Sade Sati right now: your colleague, your neighbour, some cricketer scoring runs on television. Your Moon is strong, your Lagna is friendly to Saturn (if it is), and the current dasha is Venus's, not Saturn's, so this is a season of discipline, not disaster. Here is what I would do with it." Then give practical, low-cost advice: sleep, debt reduction, care of the elderly, honest work, Saturday charity if they wish. You have told the truth and lowered the fear. That is the whole job.

Dhaiya, Kantaka and Ashtama Shani

Two more Saturn transits carry names. **Dhaiya** ("two-and-a-half") is Saturn in the **4th** or the **8th** from the natal Moon, about 2½ years each (Appendix A.9). Saturn in the 4th, called **Kantaka Shani** (the thorn) or *Ardhashtama*, presses on home, mother, vehicles and peace of mind: the season people move house or nurse a parent. Saturn in the 8th, **Ashtama Shani**, brings chronic health matters, hidden expenses, in-laws, and the feeling of a tunnel. Meera had Ashtama Shani from 2023 to early 2025, Saturn in Aquarius being the 8th from her Cancer Moon; Chapter 24 shows what it looked like. Both frames again: for a Libra Lagna the same 8th-from-Moon Saturn may sit in a career house, and the tunnel has a promotion at the end.

WHY THE 4TH AND THE 8TH? The system's grammar. From the Moon, the 4th is home and inner peace (the mind's resting place), and the 8th is transformation, hidden matters and the mind's blind spot; the 4th and 8th are also the two *chaturasra* (square) houses, which the tradition treats as places where a planet's pressure has nowhere to escape. Saturn's weight in the resting room unsettles; Saturn's weight in the hidden room drags things into the open slowly. Everyday parallel: a strict auditor in your bedroom (4th) versus one going through the locked trunk in the attic (8th). Neither is comfortable; the second takes longer.

Jupiter: the yearly blessing

If Saturn is the examiner, Jupiter is the scholarship committee. It spends about a year in each sign, and its arrival in a new sign is the most-awaited event in the Indian astrological calendar (Tamil Nadu's *Guru Peyarchi* festivals are exactly this).

From the Moon, Jupiter gives its fruit in the **2nd, 5th, 7th, 9th and 11th**, as the table above shows: money and family in the 2nd, children and study in the 5th, marriage and partnerships in the 7th, fortune, father and pilgrimage in the 9th, gains and elder siblings in the 11th. In the 1st, 3rd, 4th, 6th, 8th, 10th and 12th it is quieter, and in the 6th, 8th and 12th from the Moon it forms a transit *Shakata* condition (Appendix A.11): ups and downs, expenses, distance.

From the Lagna, Jupiter over a house, or its aspect on it, is the standard timer for that house's events: over or aspecting the **Lagna**, a new chapter, better health, recognition; the **7th** or natal Venus, the classical marriage trigger in a marriage-promising *dasha*; the **5th** or its lord, conception, children, the year the student finally passes; the **10th** or its lord, promotion or a change of role; the **2nd** or **11th**, money you can see in the bank.

Since Jupiter aspects the 5th, 7th and 9th from where it sits, it touches about four houses at any time and will bless something in most charts every year. That is why Jupiter's transit alone predicts too much. It needs a partner.

The double transit: the modern working rule

Here is the technique most modern practitioners use, taught widely by the late K.N. Rao's school and now common everywhere. I label it clearly as **a modern rule, not from Parashara**, but it is the rule that made transits finally work for me on real charts.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB (DOUBLE TRANSIT): A major event (marriage, a child, a new job, a house) tends to happen when **both Jupiter and Saturn, by transit, touch the relevant house or its lord** (by occupation or by their aspects), *while the dasha also promises it*. Jupiter alone brings the wish; Saturn alone brings the work; the two together bring the wedding.

"Touch" means: sitting in the house, aspecting it (Jupiter 5/7/9, Saturn 3/7/10), or sitting on or aspecting the house lord. Because Saturn stays 2½ years and Jupiter one, the two overlap on any given house for a few months to a year. Combine that with the

dasha, and you can often narrow a marriage or a job to a window of months. We will do exactly this for Meera below.

WHY DOES THE DOUBLE TRANSIT WORK? A derivation from speed, so partly astronomy and partly grammar. Saturn, the slow planet, is the one that *permits*: nothing lasting is built without its structure, and its 2½-year stay marks out the season in which a matter is allowed to become real. Jupiter, the yearly planet, is the one that *delivers*: it brings the opportunity, the growth, the invitation. Permission without delivery is a long engagement; delivery without permission is a plan that never gets signed. Everyday parallel: a bank loan needs the manager's sanction (Saturn) *and* the cheque being cut (Jupiter); either alone buys no house.

STORY: TWO SIGNATURES ON THE DEED. In this kingdom no land deed is valid with one signature. Guru-ji (gold Jupiter) must bless it: he walks briskly, visits every district within twelve years, and would happily bless everything he sees. The old Judge (navy Saturn) must stamp it: he takes twenty-nine and a half years for the same round and stamps only what has been earned. Guru-ji's blessing alone gives the wish and the wedding invitations; the Judge's stamp alone gives the paperwork and the wait. Only when both stand in the same room, or both look into it from where they stand, is the marriage registered, the child born, the post confirmed. **Rule:** a major event tends to come when Jupiter and Saturn by transit both touch the relevant house or its lord, in a dasha that promises it.

Rahu and Ketu: the churning

The nodes move backwards, about 18 months to a sign, and their transit over a **natal planet** is where they bite. Rahu over the natal Moon brings restlessness, odd fears and a hunger for something new; over the natal Sun, upheaval around father, boss or government; over natal Venus, an unconventional or foreign relationship; over the 10th house, a sudden career turn, often toward technology or foreign firms. Ketu over the Moon detaches: grief, meditation, or simply losing interest. Ketu over Venus cools a relationship; over Mars it can bring cuts, surgery, or a burst of spiritual discipline. Because eclipses happen only near the nodes (Chapter 1), an eclipse within a degree or two of a natal planet is worth a note in your notebook, read with the dasha, never alone.

The Sun, Mars and Venus: picking the month

Once the year is chosen by Saturn and Jupiter, the fast planets pick the month.

- **The Sun** crosses a sign a month; when it crosses the house the slow planets have prepared (the 10th for a job, the 7th for marriage) that month brings the *event* into the open. The Sun over the Lagna (your solar return, Chapter 15) starts a new personal year.
- **Mars** gives 45 days of heat to whatever it crosses: quarrels over the 7th or Venus, property paperwork over the 4th, injury risk over the Lagna, courage over the 3rd. Mars over natal Saturn (or Saturn over natal Mars) is the classical "friction" transit.
- **Venus** over the 7th, the Lagna or the natal Moon brings romance, purchases and invitations; **Mercury** over the 3rd, 10th or 11th is the month for contracts and interviews.

DID YOU KNOW? The Tamil word *Peyarchi* and the Sanskrit *Sankranti* both mean a planet's entry into a new sign. *Makar Sankranti*, the harvest festival in January, is simply the Sun's entry into sidereal Capricorn. Every *Sankranti* of the Sun (twelve a year) was once a festival day; most Indian festivals are transit events dressed in ritual.

Retrograde transits and the triple pass

Every outer planet retrogrades (Chapter 3), so Saturn, Jupiter and Mars usually cross a sensitive degree **three times**: forward, backward, forward again. The pattern I have learnt to expect: the first pass raises the matter (an offer, a symptom, a proposal), the retrograde pass reworks it (renegotiation, second opinion, cold feet), and the final direct pass settles it. When someone says "the deal was on, then off, then on again", look for a retrograde loop of Jupiter or Saturn over the relevant house lord. This is also why an ingress is never one date: the table above has loops at both ends.

Transits over natal planets

A transit over a house is general; a transit over a **natal planet** is personal. When Saturn or Jupiter sits within a few degrees of a natal planet, that planet's significations are pressed or blessed for months. Tendencies only; weigh the natal planet's strength and its role for the Lagna. (The nodes were covered above.)

Transit	Over natal Sun	Over natal Moon	Over natal Mars	Over natal Mercury	Over natal Venus	Over natal Jupiter	Over natal Saturn
Saturn	○ Father's health; friction with bosses; ego lessons	○ Sade Sati peak; heaviness; responsibility	○ Frustration, blocked energy; watch accidents	♣ Delayed contracts; careful speech; grind in studies	♣ Relationship tested for realism; disciplined spending	♣ Faith tested; an elder needs help	♣ The "Saturn return" (about 29–30, 58–59): maturity, a new structure
Jupiter	● Recognition, honour; health improves	● Mental peace; new beginnings; often marriage or a child	● Courage rewarded; property; leadership	● Studies, publishing, a good contract	● Marriage, love, artistic success	● The "Jupiter return" (about 12, 24, 36...): a fresh cycle of growth	● Relief after a hard stretch; discipline rewarded

Moorti Nirnaya: grading a transit at its birth

Appendix A.9 gives a lovely old test for how a new transit will behave. At the **moment a planet enters a new sign**, look at where the **transiting Moon** is, counted from the person's **natal Moon**:

Transiting Moon from natal Moon at ingress	Moorti (form)	Quality
1, 6, 11	Gold (Swarna)	● Best
2, 5, 9	Silver (Rajata)	● Good
3, 7, 10	Copper (Tamra)	♣ Mixed
4, 8, 12	Iron (Loha)	○ Difficult

WHY THE MOON AT THE INGRESS? The system's grammar, applied to time. The moment a planet enters a sign is the *birth* of that transit, and every birth in Jyotish is judged by its Lagna. The transit has no rising sign of its own, so the tradition uses the next best thing: where the mind (the Moon) stood when the transit was born, counted from where the mind lives (the natal Moon). The first impression sets the tone. Everyday parallel: the mood in which you meet a new boss on day one colours the whole posting, however the work turns out.

STORY: THE FOUR GATES. When a courtier enters a new district of the kingdom, the Queen Mother's own position that day decides which gate he is shown through. If she stands in a friendly place (the 1st, 6th or 11th from her home) the **gold gate** opens and he is received with garlands: his whole stay will be gentle. From the 2nd, 5th or 9th, the **silver gate**: a warm welcome. From the 3rd, 7th or 10th, the **copper gate**: correct, formal, mixed. From the 4th, 8th or 12th, the **iron gate**: he enters by the servants' entrance, and the stay is hard however good his intentions. The gate cannot be changed once he is inside. **Rule:** at a planet's ingress, count the transiting Moon from the natal Moon: 1/6/11 gold, 2/5/9 silver, 3/7/10 copper, 4/8/12 iron.

Worked example. Saturn entered sidereal Pisces on about 29 March 2025, and that day was a new Moon (there was a partial solar eclipse), so the transiting Moon was with the Sun in Pisces. For Meera (natal Moon in Cancer), Pisces is the **9th from her Moon: silver form**, a good Moorti. So although Saturn's stay in the 9th from her Moon is not in the "good list", the transit began on a kind note; in practice this softens a mixed transit, the pilgrimage rather than the exile. For someone with a Sagittarius Moon, Pisces is the 4th: iron; the same Saturn wears a harder face for them. One event, twelve different receptions. This is the whole of astrology in miniature.

Ashtakavarga: the person's own weather map

Chapter 12 introduced **Ashtakavarga**, the system that scores every sign with **bindus** (dots, 0 to 8) for each planet, based on where the seven planets and the Lagna sit in *that* chart. It exists precisely for transits. The rule is simple: when Saturn (or any planet) transits a sign where *its own* Ashtakavarga gives **4 or more bindus**, the transit is bearable or good, however bad the house from the Moon looks; with **3 or fewer**, expect the difficulties to be real, however good the house. The total (*Sarvashtakavarga*) score of the sign (above about 28 is comfortable, below 25 is weak) tells you the same at the level of the whole chart.

WHY DOES A DOT-COUNT OVERRIDE THE HOUSE RULE? Grammar. The good-houses list is generic: the same for every Cancer Moon on Earth. Ashtakavarga is personal: it counts how many of *this* chart's planets are placed so as to support a transiting planet in *this* sign. A generic rule should yield to a specific measurement. Everyday parallel: the weather forecast says rain for the whole city; whether *your* street floods depends on your drains.

When the Sade Sati of two Pisces-Moon friends turns out completely different, the Ashtakavarga usually shows why: one has Saturn's bindus at 5 and 6 across the three signs, the other 2 and 3. Your software prints these tables in a second; look before you speak.

Putting it together: Chart A's weather, 2025–2027

Let us read Meera's sky for the years around this book, the way I would for a friend. Approximate positions; the *method* is the point.

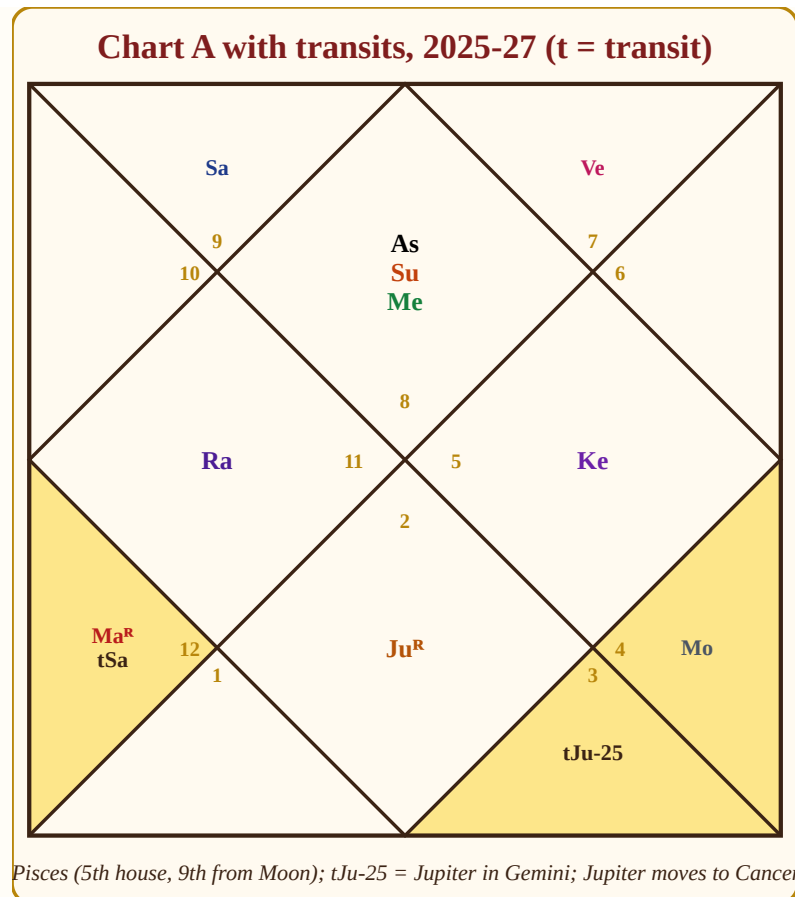


Figure 14.5: Chart A with transits marked "t". Saturn sits in Pisces, the highlighted 5th house from the Lagna, 9th from the Moon, on natal Mars. Jupiter was in Gemini (8th from the Lagna, 12th from the Moon) from about May 2025 and moves into Cancer (9th, over the natal Moon) from about June 2026. Highlighted: houses 5, 8, 9.

The season first. Meera is 37 in December 2025, in the last stretch of her Venus Mahadasha (age 18½ to 38½), which ends around mid-2027; then the six-year Sun Mahadasha begins. Venus is a functional malefic for Scorpio (Appendix A.6) but sits in its own sign in the 12th: comfortable, not powerful. The closing years of a twenty-year Mahadasha are years of *winding up*.

Saturn in Pisces (2025 to about 2027). - *From the Moon:* the 9th. Not in Saturn's good list (3, 6, 11); not Sade Sati or Dhaiya either. Mixed, and the "silver" Moorti we computed softens it. Tendencies: questions of faith and long journeys, father's or a mentor's health, a slower pace in higher studies. - *From the Lagna:* the **5th house**: children, students, creative work. Saturn, a functional malefic for Scorpio, sits here **on natal Mars** (4° Pisces), the Lagna lord: her energy and initiatives are being disciplined, the friction transit. For a teacher-consultant the 5th is the classroom: heavier loads, students who test patience, a project that takes twice as long. - *Saturn's aspects:* the 7th (Taurus, natal Jupiter, marriage), the 11th (Virgo, gains) and the 2nd (Sagittarius, natal Saturn, family). Marriage and income receive Saturn's serious look: not damage, seriousness; joint decisions, budgeting.

Jupiter in Gemini (about May 2025 to June 2026). - *From the Moon:* the **12th**, not in the good list. Expenses, a spiritual turn, travel; not a year for big new commitments. - *From the Lagna:* the 8th: research, inheritance, in-laws. Jupiter in the 8th protects in crisis but is quiet in celebration. - *Aspects:* the 12th (natal Venus, the dasha lord!), the 2nd (natal Saturn) and the 4th (natal Rahu). Jupiter's glance on the Mahadasha lord keeps the Venus period pleasant to its close and supports family finances and home.

Jupiter into Cancer (from about June 2026, roughly a year, with the usual retrograde back-and-forth at the edges). - *From the Moon:* the **1st**: Jupiter over the natal Moon, the transit form of Gaja Kesari (Appendix A.11); optimism, a decision to start something. - *From the Lagna:* the **9th**: fortune, father, higher learning, teaching, long journeys; a course launched,

recognition as a teacher, a pilgrimage or foreign trip. - *Aspects*: the **Lagna** (Scorpio, natal Sun and Mercury), the 3rd, and the **5th** (Pisces, natal Mars, and transit Saturn).

Now the double transit. From mid-2026 into 2027, Jupiter aspects the 5th from Cancer while Saturn sits *in* the 5th. Both slow planets touch the 5th (children, students, creative output) and Jupiter also touches the Lagna. If the natal chart promises a child (Chapter 21 checks her 5th house and D7), this is the window in which it is most likely to be timed; if not, it is the window for a major creative or teaching project: a book, a course, an institution. I say "window", never "will". And Saturn sits in that same house, so whatever comes, comes with labour and delay.

The month. Within that window, the Sun crossing the 5th (Pisces, mid-March to mid-April) and the 9th (Cancer, mid-July to mid-August), on Jupiter's direct passes rather than its retrograde one, are the months to watch.

And then the season changes. Around mid-2027 the Sun Mahadasha begins (the Sun is a functional benefic for Scorpio, sitting in her Lagna) and almost at the same time Saturn enters Aries: the 6th from the Lagna (an upachaya, where Saturn works well) and the 10th from the Moon (visible responsibility, career pressure). A new dasha and a new Saturn sign within months of each other is what a genuine turning point looks like on paper. Chapter 25 shows how it played out.

CONSULTATION TIP: Never read a transit to anyone without first naming the dasha. "Saturn is on your Mars" said alone is a threat. "You are finishing a twenty-year Venus period, and in its last two years Saturn is asking you to be disciplined about your energy and your students, while Jupiter next year opens the 9th: teaching, fortune, travel" is a forecast. The first sentence sells fear; the second sells nothing and helps.

In one breath

- Dasha is the season, transit is the weather; a transit can only deliver what the dasha and the natal chart promise.
- Count transits from both the natal Moon (classical: how it feels) and the Lagna (modern: where it lands).
- Slow planets shape the year (Saturn 2½ years a sign, Jupiter 1 year, Rahu and Ketu 1½ years); the Sun and Mars pick the month; the Moon picks the day. The speeds are orbital periods, nothing more.
- Malefics are good in 3, 6, 11 from the Moon (the upachayas, where pressure helps); Jupiter is good in 2, 5, 7, 9, 11, the houses it blesses and aspects.
- Sade Sati = Saturn in the 12th, 1st, 2nd from the Moon (three signs × 2½ years), in three phases; its weight depends on the Moon's strength, Saturn's role for the Lagna, the house from the Lagna, and above all whether Saturn is also the dasha lord. A quarter of humanity is in it at any moment.
- Dhainya (Kantaka, 4th; Ashtama Shani, 8th) is Saturn's 2½-year cousin in the mind's resting room and hidden room.
- Double transit (modern rule): events happen when Jupiter and Saturn together touch a house or its lord, in a promising dasha; the slow planet permits, the yearly planet delivers.
- Grade a transit by Moorti Niraya at its ingress (the transit's own "birth") and by the person's own Ashtakavarga bindus before you speak.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. Chart B (Arjun) has his Moon in Taurus. With Saturn in Pisces (2025–27), which house from his Moon is Saturn in, and is it a named transit? What happens when Saturn enters Aries?
2. Chart C (Devika) has her Moon in Sagittarius. Is she in Sade Sati or Dhaiya during Saturn's stay in Pisces? Count and name it.
3. Jupiter transits Cancer. For a person with the Moon in Pisces, which house from the Moon is that, and is it on Jupiter's good list? Which three houses from their Moon does Jupiter aspect from there?
4. A friend with a Libra Lagna and a Pisces Moon is frightened about Sade Sati. Write, in three sentences, what you would say, using both frames.
5. Saturn enters a sign while the transiting Moon is in the 4th from a person's natal Moon. What is the Moorti, and what would you check next before judging the transit?

Answers

1. Taurus to Pisces: Taurus 1, Gemini 2, ... Pisces is the ****11th**** from his Moon, one of Saturn's good houses (3, 6, 11), not a named transit. Gains, networks and elder siblings do well. When Saturn enters Aries it is the ****12th**** from Taurus: his second Sade Sati begins (first phase): expenses, travel, sleep. 2. Sagittarius to Pisces: Sg 1, Cp 2, Aq 3, Pi ****4****. Saturn is in the 4th from her Moon: ****Kantaka Shani / Dhaiya****, about 2½ years pressing on home, mother, vehicles and peace of mind. Not Sade Sati. 3. Pisces to Cancer: Pi 1, Ar 2, Ta 3, Ge 4, Cn ****5****: the 5th from the Moon, on Jupiter's good list (children, study, creativity). From the 5th, Jupiter aspects the 9th, 11th and 1st from the Moon: fortune, gains, and the Moon itself. 4. Something like: "Yes, Saturn is on your Moon, the middle phase, until about 2027, so the years feel heavy and responsibility grows. But for your Libra Lagna Saturn is the yogakaraka, the planet that gives you status, and it is now in your 6th house, where hard work on health, service and debts pays off. Expect a demanding, productive stretch, not a disaster, and let us look at what dasha is running to see how loud it will be." 5. The 4th from the natal Moon: ****iron (Loha)****, the difficult form. Next: check the planet's Ashtakavarga bindus in that sign (4 or more softens it), the house from the Lagna and the planet's functional nature there, and the running dasha. A hard Moorti in a good dasha with 5 bindus is a rough start to a fine stay.

Chapter 15: Beyond Vimshottari: Yogini, Jaimini Chara Dasha, and the Annual Chart

A friend I was studying with once asked, a little indignantly, "If Vimshottari works, why does Parashara give forty other dashas?" A fair question. Here is the answer I eventually arrived at, and it is the whole spirit of this chapter.

A good doctor does not order one test. She orders the blood test *and* the X-ray, and when both point to the same thing she speaks with confidence; when they disagree she looks harder. Parashara gives dozens of dasha systems (Vimshottari, Ashtottari, Shodashottari, Dwadashottari, Kala Chakra, Chara, Sthira, Yogini and more), not so that you use them all, but so that a practitioner has a **second opinion built into the science**. Vimshottari (Chapter 13) is the backbone; it is the one every Indian astrologer learns first and trusts most. The others are cross-checks. When Vimshottari says "a hard 2027" and Yogini says "a hard 2027", say it plainly. When they disagree, say "mixed" and go back to the transits.

WHY DO OTHER DASHAS EXIST AT ALL? The classical author's own reasoning. In *Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra*, Parashara does not present the dashas as rivals: he gives Vimshottari as the general system and then lists **conditional dashas**, each recommended for a chart that meets a particular condition (Ashtottari when Rahu stands in a kendra or trikona from the Lagna lord; Shodashottari for a day birth in the bright half or a night birth in the dark half with the Lagna in Sun's hora; and so on). The idea is that a chart may "ask for" a second clock that fits its build. Everyday parallel: a school has one main timetable, but the sports students and the music students each carry an extra schedule that applies only to them.

This chapter gives you a working taste of three more timekeepers (**Yogini dasha**, **Jaimini's Chara dasha**, and the **annual chart**, **Varshaphal**) plus a nod to two others. Nothing here replaces Vimshottari. Everything here makes you a better second-opinion doctor.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: One dasha is a prediction. Two dashas agreeing is a forecast. Two dashas and a transit agreeing is something you may say to someone's face.

Yogini dasha: the 36-year wheel

Yogini dasha is short, simple, and loved in North India, Nepal and Bengal. Where Vimshottari runs 120 years through nine planets, Yogini runs **36 years through eight "yoginis"**, goddesses, each carrying a planet and a number of years equal to her position in the sequence:

#	Yogini	Planet	Years	Flavour
1	Mangala	Moon	1	● Auspicious, gentle, short
2	Pingala	Sun	2	● Heat, authority, some struggle
3	Dhanya	Jupiter	3	● Wealth, blessing, growth
4	Bhramari	Mars	4	● Wandering, movement, restlessness
5	Bhadrika	Mercury	5	● Intellect, trade, learning
6	Ulka	Saturn	6	○ Testing, loss, labour ("the meteor")
7	Siddha	Venus	7	● Accomplishment, comfort, pleasure
8	Sankata	Rahu	8	○ Danger, crisis, upheaval ("the trouble")

$1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 5 + 6 + 7 + 8 = 36$. Then the wheel turns again. A person of 72 has seen each yogini twice.

WHY 36 YEARS? Simple arithmetic built into the design: eight yoginis whose years are their own serial numbers, 1 through 8, and $1 + 2 + \dots + 8 = 36$. There is no astronomical cycle behind it; this is the system's own grammar, a ladder where each rung is one step longer than the last, so the testing periods (Ulka 6, Sankata 8) are also the longest. Everyday parallel: a staircase whose steps get taller as you climb; the hardest steps are also the ones you spend longest on.

STORY: EIGHT SISTERS. In a village live eight sisters who take turns hosting every traveller, and each keeps him for as many years as her place in the family. Mangala, the eldest and gentlest, one year; Pingala, the fiery one, two; Dhanya, who keeps the granary, three; Bhramari, who never sits still, four; Bhadraka, the reader, five; Ulka, the stern one who works you hard, six; Siddha, in whose house everything comes right, seven; and Sankata, the youngest, in whose house the roof always seems to leak: eight. The order never changes; which sister opens the door first depends only on the street (the Moon's nakshatra) the traveller was born on. **Rule:** Yogini dasha runs 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8 years (Moon, Sun, Jupiter, Mars, Mercury, Saturn, Venus, Rahu), 36 in all; Ulka and Sankata test, Dhanya and Siddha reward.

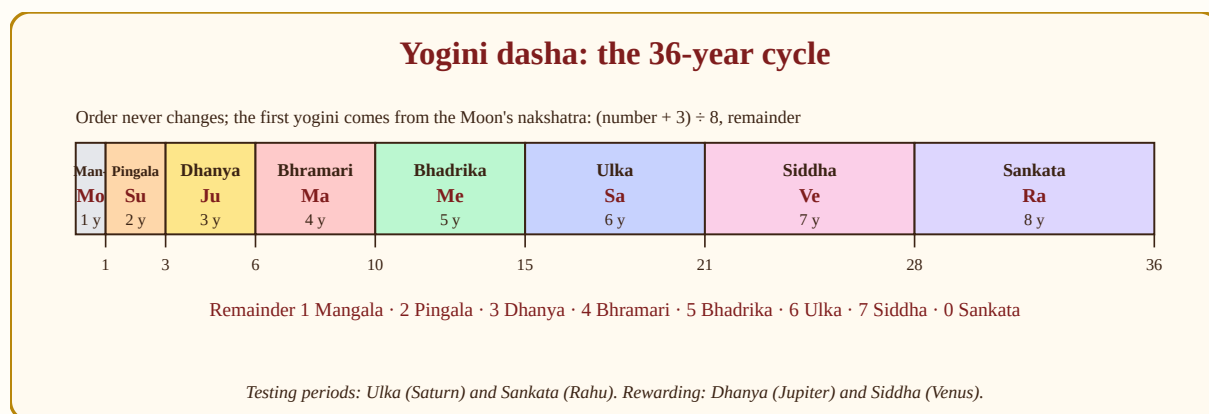


Figure 15.1: The eight yoginis in their fixed order, each bar as long as her years. The first yogini in a life is found from the Moon's nakshatra; the order never changes after that.

Finding the first yogini

Like Vimshottari, Yogini starts from the **Moon's nakshatra** (Chapter 7), but the arithmetic is different and rather charming. Take the nakshatra's number (Ashwini = 1 ... Revati = 27), **add 3, divide by 8, and keep the remainder**. Remainder 1 →

Mangala, 2 → Pingala, 3 → Dhanya, 4 → Bhramari, 5 → Bhadraka, 6 → Ulka, 7 → Siddha, and 0 (exactly divisible) → Sankata.

Let us do our three charts.

- **Chart A (Meera).** Moon in Ashlesha, nakshatra 9. $9 + 3 = 12$. $12 \div 8 = 1$, remainder **4** → **Bhramari (Mars, 4 years)** first.
- **Chart B (Arjun).** Moon in Kritika, nakshatra 3. $3 + 3 = 6$. $6 \div 8 = 0$, remainder **6** → **Ulka (Saturn, 6 years)** first.
- **Chart C (Devika).** Moon in Purva Ashadha, nakshatra 20. $20 + 3 = 23$. $23 \div 8 = 2$, remainder **7** → **Siddha (Venus, 7 years)** first.

The balance at birth

Exactly as in Vimshottari, the first period is not run in full: only the **portion of the nakshatra still to be crossed** counts. Take the degrees remaining in the nakshatra, divide by $13^{\circ}20'$, and multiply by the yogini's years.

- **Meera:** Moon at 21° Cancer; Ashlesha runs $16^{\circ}40'$ to 30° , so 9° remain out of $13^{\circ}20'$, a fraction of 0.675. Bhramari's 4 years $\times 0.675 =$ **2.7 years** of Bhramari at birth. Then Bhadraka 5 (age 2.7–7.7), Ulka 6 (7.7–13.7), Siddha 7 (13.7–20.7), Sankata 8 (20.7–28.7), Mangala 1 (28.7–29.7), Pingala 2 (29.7–31.7), Dhanya 3 (31.7–34.7), **Bhramari 4 (34.7–38.7)**, Bhadraka 5 (38.7–43.7)...
- **Arjun:** Moon at 6° Taurus; Kritika ends at 10° Taurus, so 4° remain, fraction 0.3. Ulka $6 \times 0.3 =$ **1.8 years**. (Notice this is the same 0.3 that gave his Vimshottari Sun balance of 1.8 years; the fraction is the same, only the multiplier changes.) Then Siddha 7 (1.8–8.8), Sankata 8 (8.8–16.8), Mangala 1, Pingala 2, Dhanya 3 (19.8–22.8), Bhramari 4 (22.8–26.8), Bhadraka 5 (26.8–31.8), **Ulka 6 (31.8–37.8)**.
- **Devika:** Moon at 14° Sagittarius; Purva Ashadha ends at $26^{\circ}40'$, so $12^{\circ}40'$ remain, fraction 0.95. Siddha $7 \times 0.95 =$ **6.65 years**. Then Sankata 8 (6.65–14.65), Mangala, Pingala, Dhanya, Bhramari (20.65–24.65), Bhadraka (24.65–29.65), Ulka (29.65–35.65), Siddha (35.65–42.65), **Sankata 8 (42.65–50.65)**.

Sub-periods exist (each yogini's period is divided among the eight in proportion to their years, starting with herself), but for a cross-check the main periods are enough.

Reading it simply

Yogini interpretation is deliberately plain. **Sankata (Rahu) and Ulka (Saturn) are the testing periods**; the eight-year Sankata especially is watched the way Vimshottari's Rahu is watched. **Siddha (Venus) and Dhanya (Jupiter) are rewarding**. Bhadraka (Mercury) is good for study and trade, Bhramari (Mars) for movement and change of place, Pingala (Sun) for authority with some heat, Mangala (Moon) is brief and pleasant. Then refine: how is that planet placed in the birth chart, and what does it own for this Lagna (Chapter 8)?

Now look at the cross-checks, because this is why we bother:

- **Meera at 35–39 (2023–2027) is in Bhramari, Mars.** Mars is her *Lagna lord* (Scorpio), a functional benefic, sitting in the 5th. Vimshottari has her in the last years of Venus. Yogini adds: movement, a change of place or role, self-driven effort; a Lagna-lord period is a period of identity. Fits a teacher launching something of her own.
- **Arjun at 31.8 (about December 2026) enters Ulka, Saturn, for six years.** Vimshottari has him in the Rahu Mahadasha (age 18.8–36.8), with Jupiter to follow. Two testing indicators overlapping in his early thirties: I would tell him these are years to build slowly and avoid debt, not years to gamble.
- **Devika at 42.65 (about March 2022) entered Sankata, Rahu, for eight years, until about 2030.** Her Vimshottari Rahu Mahadasha runs from age 42 to 60. **Both systems hand the same planet the same decade.** When that happens, stop

hedging: Rahu's themes (foreign matters, technology, obsession, sudden rise and sudden reversal) will run her forties, and the quality depends entirely on how her Rahu sits (5th house, Leo, with Saturn and Mercury; Chapter 24 takes this up).

When is Yogini used? In the North and in Nepal as a routine second dasha; anywhere as a quick cross-check when Vimshottari is ambiguous; and in *muhurta*-style questions ("is this a good year to start?"), where its bluntness (good year, bad year) is a virtue. Some traditions say it is especially reliable for women's charts and for charts of night births; I report that as tradition, not as something I can prove.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Running Yogini and Vimshottari and then choosing whichever gives the nicer answer.

That is not cross-checking; that is shopping. Decide *before* you look which system is your backbone (Vimshottari), and let the other only raise or lower your confidence.

Jaimini's Chara dasha: periods that belong to signs

Everything so far in this book has been Parashari. **Jaimini**, the sage whose *Upadesha Sutras* form the other great school, does timing differently, and I want you to taste it, because a whole generation of modern Indian astrologers (K.N. Rao's school above all) uses it beside Vimshottari every day. Only a taste. Jaimini deserves a book of its own, and I will name the books.

The central shift: in **Chara dasha**, the periods belong to **signs, not planets**. You live through "a Scorpio period", then "a Sagittarius period", and so on. Each sign's period lasts as many years as the distance from that sign to its own lord: a sign whose lord sits close has a short period; a sign whose lord sits far away has a long one; a sign whose lord sits in the sign itself gets the maximum, **12 years**.

WHY SIGNS AND NOT PLANETS? Jaimini's own grammar. In his system the sign is the primary unit: aspects are sign-to-sign (below), significators are chosen by degree *within* the sign, and a sign's "life" is measured by how far it must reach to find its owner. A sign whose lord has wandered far has a long story to tell before it is at peace, so it gets a long period. Parashara's dashas are about *who* is ruling; Jaimini's are about *where* the action is. Everyday parallel: Vimshottari is a rota of people on duty; Chara dasha is a rota of rooms being renovated, each for as long as it takes to fetch the owner's keys.

The direction of counting. This is where variants live. The mainstream simplification (as taught by K.N. Rao and most modern teachers): count **forward** from Aries, Taurus, Gemini, Libra, Scorpio and Sagittarius; count **backward** from Cancer, Leo, Virgo, Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces. Count from the sign to the sign holding its lord, and **subtract one**; if the lord is in the sign itself, take 12. Other schools (following different readings of the Sutras) reverse some of these and add adjustments for exalted or debilitated lords. Say so if you meet them, and follow one teacher consistently.

Two quick computations on Chart A:

- **Scorpio** (her Lagna, so her first Chara period). Scorpio counts forward. Its lord Mars is in Pisces: Scorpio 1, Sagittarius 2, Capricorn 3, Aquarius 4, Pisces 5 → $5 - 1 = 4$ **years**. (Jaimini gives Scorpio a second lord, Ketu; when the two lords are in different signs, schools differ on which to use; the mainstream takes the stronger. I have used Mars here for simplicity.)
- **Sagittarius** (the next sign forward). Its lord Jupiter is in Taurus: Sagittarius 1, Capricorn 2, Aquarius 3, Pisces 4, Aries 5, Taurus 6 → $6 - 1 = 5$ **years**.

So Meera's life in Chara dasha opens with four years of Scorpio, then five of Sagittarius, and so on around the zodiac (the direction of the *sequence* also depends on the Lagna's type: forward for the signs in the first list, backward for the others). The

period of a sign brings the affairs of the **house that sign occupies**, and of the planets in it and aspecting it (by Jaimini's own sign-based aspects, below), to the front. Her Sagittarius period, the 2nd house with natal Saturn, was the childhood of family finances and a serious, disciplined home.

The Chara karakas: the soul and its ministers

Jaimini's second gift is the **Chara karakas** ("movable significators"): instead of fixed rules ("the Sun is always father"), he ranks the planets **by degree within their sign**, highest first, and gives each a role:

Rank by degree	Karaka	Role
1st (highest degree)	Atmakaraka (AK)	The soul; the king of the chart; what this life is about
2nd	Amatyakaraka (AmK)	The minister; career, livelihood
3rd	Bhratrikaraka (BK)	Siblings, guru
4th	Matrikaraka (MK)	Mother, home, education
5th	Putrakaraka (PK)	Children, students, intelligence
6th	Gnatikaraka (GK)	Relatives, rivals, disease
7th (lowest degree)	Darakaraka (DK)	Spouse, partners

WHY THE HIGHEST DEGREE? Jaimini's symbolic logic, stated in the Sutras: the planet that has travelled furthest into its sign has the most *experience* of that sign; it is the eldest, the most seasoned, and so it carries the soul's own business (*atma*). The planet that has barely entered its sign is the youngest and is given the most outward matter, the partner. Everyday parallel: in a joint family, the one who has lived longest in the house speaks for it; the newest arrival, the bride or groom who married in, is the "other" who joined it.

STORY: SENIORITY, NOT BIRTH. In Parashara's court the offices are hereditary: the King (Sun) is always the father, the Queen Mother (Moon) always the mother. Jaimini runs his court differently. On the day of the birth he lines up the seven courtiers by how far each has walked into his own district (the degrees) and gives the offices by **seniority**. The one who has walked furthest becomes the soul's own minister, the Atmakaraka, whoever he happens to be; the next becomes minister of livelihood; and so on down to the one who has barely stepped through the district gate, who becomes the Darakaraka and stands for the spouse. In Meera's court the King has walked 28 steps and is Atmakaraka; the Commander, only 4, is Darakaraka. **Rule:** rank the planets by degree within their signs, highest first: AK, AmK, BK, MK, PK, GK, DK.

This is the **seven-karaka scheme** (the seven planets, Sun to Saturn). An **eight-karaka variant** includes Rahu, reckoned by its degrees *counted backwards* (30° minus its degree), and adds a Pitrikaraka (father). K.N. Rao's school uses seven; Sanjay Rath's school uses eight. Both work in their own hands; pick one.

For **Chart A**, the degrees are Sun 28°, Venus 22°, Moon 21°, Mercury 9°, Jupiter 8°, Saturn 5°, Mars 4°. So: **Atmakaraka = Sun** (in the Lagna: a soul whose purpose is visibility, authority, teaching), Amatyakaraka = Venus (career through arts, counsel, harmony; consulting fits), Bhratrikaraka = Moon, Matrikaraka = Mercury, Putrakaraka = Jupiter, Gnatikaraka = Saturn, **Darakaraka = Mars** (spouse-significator, in the 5th in Pisces: a warm, idealistic partner; we return to this in Chapter 19). In the eight-karaka variant Rahu's reckoned degree is 30 – 16 = 14°, which slots it fourth, between Moon and Mercury, and shifts the lower karakas down one.

Karakamsa is the sign the Atmakaraka occupies in the **Navamsa (D9)** (Chapter 11). Meera's Sun at 28° Scorpio: Scorpio is a fixed sign, so its navamsas count from the 9th sign from it, Cancer; 28° falls in the 9th navamsa (each is 3°20'), and the ninth sign from Cancer is **Pisces**. Karakamsa = Pisces, Jupiter's sign of dharma and healing, and, in her D1, the sign holding her Darakaraka Mars. Jaimini reads the soul's path from the Karakamsa the way Parashara reads it from the Lagna. A Pisces Karakamsa is the teacher, the counsellor, the one who serves through wisdom. It agrees with everything else we know of her.

Arudha Lagna: how the world sees you

Jaimini's third idea is one I reach for often, because people ask about it without knowing the word: "*Why does everyone think I'm rich when I'm not?*" That is an Arudha question.

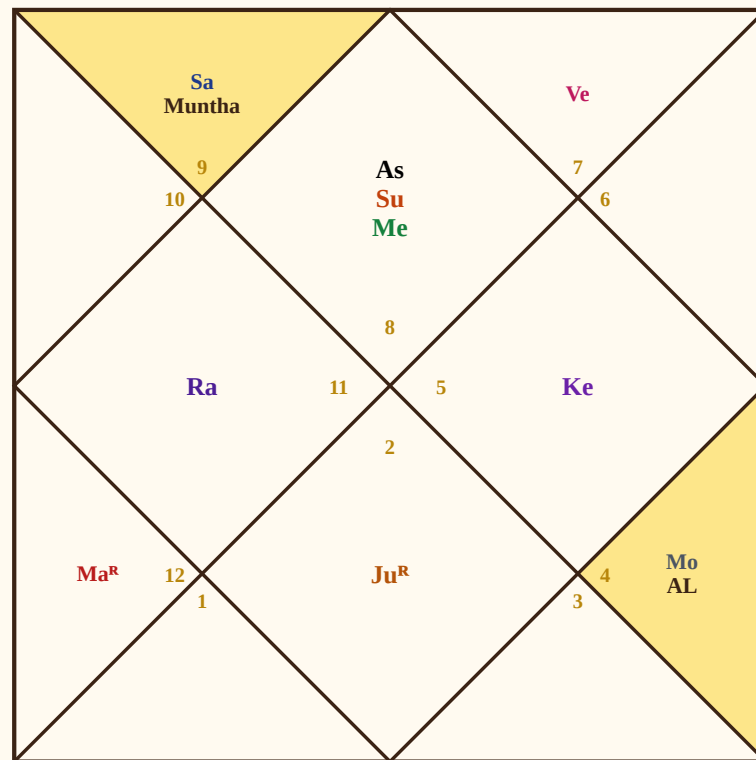
The **Arudha Lagna (AL)** is the *image*, the reflection of the self in the world. To find it: **count from the Lagna to its lord, then count the same distance again from the lord**. Two exceptions: if that landing point is the Lagna itself or the 7th from it, **move ten signs further** (the image cannot coincide with the self or stand exactly opposite it).

WHY COUNT THE DISTANCE TWICE? Symbolic logic, and it is the logic of a mirror. In a mirror the image appears as far *behind* the glass as the object stands *in front* of it. The Lagna is the object, its lord is the glass, and the Arudha is the image: the same distance again, on the far side. The two exceptions follow: an image cannot sit on the object itself (1st) or directly facing it (7th), so the tradition moves it to the 10th from there, the most public house, where images are displayed. Everyday parallel: your reputation in the family WhatsApp group is real, but it is a reflection, and it is always a little displaced from who you are at home.

STORY: THE REFLECTION IN THE PALACE TANK. The Lagna is the palace door; the lord of the Lagna is the steward, who has wandered off to some other room. Stand at the door, walk to the steward, then walk *the same distance again* in the same direction: where you arrive there is a tank of still water, and in it the palace's reflection, the Arudha, the house as the world sees it. Two rules of the tank: it cannot lie on the doorstep itself, nor exactly opposite the door across the courtyard, for then the reflection would be the thing itself; if the walk lands there, move ten rooms on. **Rule:** AL = count Lagna → lord, then the same count again from the lord; if it lands in the 1st or 7th, take the 10th from there.

Chart A. Lagna Scorpio; lord Mars in Pisces. Scorpio to Pisces is the **5th**. The 5th from Pisces: Pisces 1, Aries 2, Taurus 3, Gemini 4, **Cancer 5**. Arudha Lagna = **Cancer**, the 9th house, where her **Moon** sits.

Chart A: Arudha Lagna and Muntha (age 37)



is in Cancer (9th) with the Moon; Muntha for age 37 sits in Sagittarius (2nd) with natal

Figure 15.2: Chart A. The Arudha Lagna (AL) falls in Cancer, the 9th house, on the natal Moon; the Muntha for her 37th year sits in Sagittarius, the 2nd house, with natal Saturn.

Think about what that says. Her *self* is Scorpio, Sun and Mercury in the Lagna: intense, sharp, private. Her *image* is Cancer with the Moon in the 9th: the world sees a nurturing, motherly, wise teacher. Both are true; one is how she is, the other is how she is seen. When the AL falls on the Moon like this, the public image and the private mind are unusually close; people find her exactly as warm as she looks. Planets in and aspecting the AL, and the 2nd and 11th from it, describe reputation and the wealth others see; the 12th from it describes what drains the image.

Upapada (UL). The same method applied to the **12th house** gives the Upapada, Jaimini's marriage-and-spouse point, read with the 7th house in Chapter 19. For Meera, the 12th is Libra with its lord Venus sitting in Libra itself: the count lands back on Libra, the 1st from the house, so the exception applies and we move ten signs on, to **Cancer** again. Her Upapada joins her Arudha Lagna and her Moon in the 9th: the marriage and the public image share one room, and the spouse is bound up with faith, teaching and family. Hold that thought until Chapter 19.

Jaimini aspects: signs look at signs

Jaimini's aspects (*Rashi Drishti*) are between **signs, not planets**, and they are permanent: every **fixed sign aspects the three movable signs except the one next to it**; every **movable sign aspects the three fixed signs except the one next to it**; and the **dual signs aspect each other**. So Scorpio (fixed) aspects Aries, Cancer and Capricorn but not Libra, its neighbour; Cancer (movable) aspects Scorpio, Aquarius and Taurus but not Leo. A planet in a sign aspects whatever those aspected signs hold. Use these only *inside* Jaimini work (Chara dasa, karakas, Arudhas) and Parashari aspects (Chapter 6) everywhere else. Mixing them is the commonest way beginners make a mess of Jaimini.

DID YOU KNOW? Jaimini's *Upadesha Sutras* are written in a code: the letters of the Sanskrit alphabet stand for numbers (the *Katapayadi* system), so a single word can hide a rule about which house or how many years. This is one reason schools read the same sutra differently, and why you should learn Jaimini from one careful teacher. The modern teachers to read are **K.N. Rao** (Chara dasha in practice, with hundreds of case studies), **Sanjay Rath** (the Sri Jagannath Center tradition, eight karakas), and **Iranganti Rangacharya** (the scholarly translation of the Sutras). Read all three; follow one.

Two more Parashari dashas, briefly

Ashtottari dasha runs **108 years** through eight lords (Rahu is included, Ketu is not: Sun 6, Moon 15, Mars 8, Mercury 17, Saturn 10, Jupiter 19, Rahu 12, Venus 21). Parashara prescribes it conditionally: the traditional rule is that it applies when **Rahu is in a kendra or trikona from the Lagna lord** (some texts add: and not in the Lagna itself; others add conditions about day and night birth in bright or dark fortnights). Its starting nakshatra rule also differs from Vimshottari's. Where the condition is met, many South Indian and Bengali astrologers run Ashtottari as their second dasha in place of Yogini.

Why mention it? Because it is the most common "other dasha" printed on an old family horoscope, and you should recognise the lords and the 108 total rather than think the family astrologer made an error.

Kala Chakra dasha, Parashara's own favourite ("the best of dashas", he says), is a nakshatra-pada-based system with sign periods that jump about the zodiac; it is powerful, intricate, and not for a first book. Know the name.

The annual chart: Tajaka Varshaphal

Now a change of flavour. **Varshaphal** ("the fruit of the year") comes from the **Tajaka** tradition, which entered India from Persian and Arabic astrology in the medieval centuries and was written up in Sanskrit by Neelakantha (*Tajaka Neelakanthi*, 16th century). It is the Indian form of what the West calls the **solar return**. North Indian astrologers use it heavily for the annual "birthday reading"; the South uses it less. Everything in this section is Tajaka, not Parashari, so treat the labels carefully.

The idea: the Sun comes home

Every year, within a day of your birthday, the Sun returns to the **exact degree and minute** it held at your birth. Cast a fresh chart for that instant, at the place where you now live: that is the **annual chart**. Its rising sign is the **Varsha Lagna** (year-Lagna). The year's chart is read *against* the natal chart: the natal chart is the contract, the annual chart is this year's instalment.

WHY IS THE SOLAR RETURN THE "BIRTHDAY CHART"? Astronomy first: a year is one circuit of the Sun through the zodiac, so the Sun standing again at its natal degree is the only exact astronomical definition of "your birthday" (the calendar date drifts by a day because our years are not whole numbers of days). Then grammar: the Sun is the soul and the self, so its return is the self's fresh start, and a chart cast for a fresh start is read like a birth chart for that year. Everyday parallel: the company's financial year begins on a fixed date and gets a fresh balance sheet, but it is still the same company with the same founding deed.

STORY: THE KING'S HOMECOMING. Every year the King (the Sun) rides the full circuit of the twelve districts and returns to the exact milestone where he stood when the child was born. The court holds a fresh assembly at that minute: the annual chart. Whoever stands at the door that day (the Varsha Lagna), whichever courtier holds the strongest seat and can see the door (the Varshesha), and the room where the brass marker now stands (the Muntha) decide the year's business. The old contract, the natal chart, is not torn up; the assembly only decides this year's instalment of it. **Rule:** the Varshaphal is cast for the Sun's return to its natal degree; it refines the year, it never replaces the natal chart or the dasha.

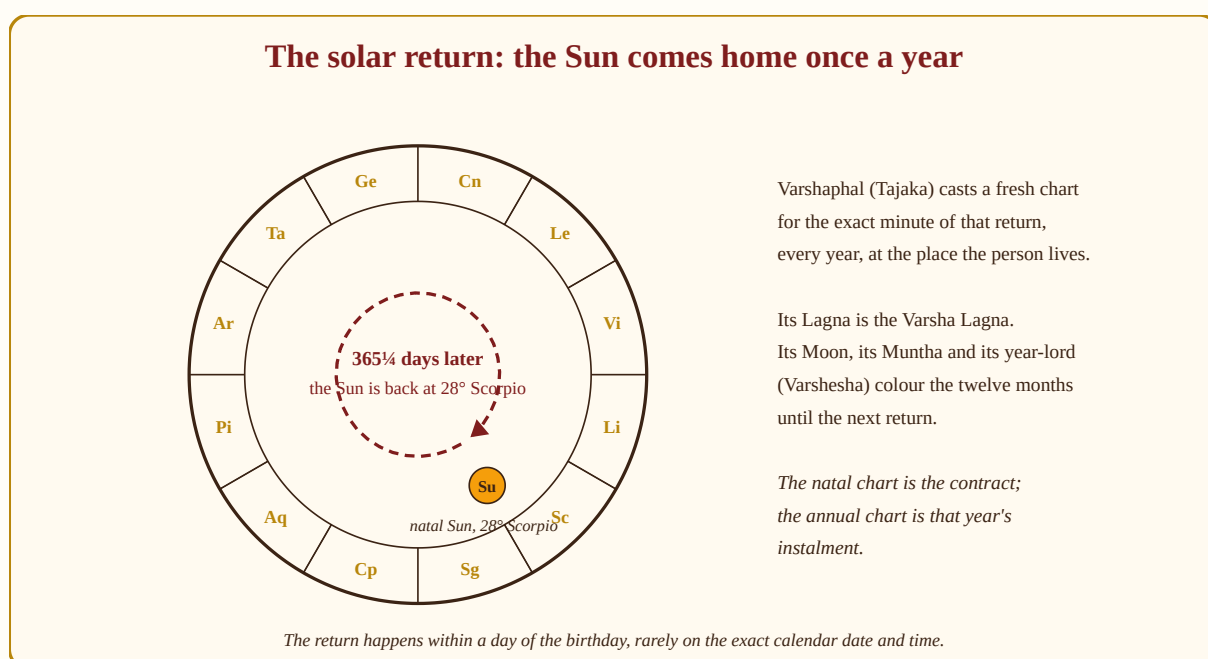


Figure 15.3: Once a year the Sun arrives back at its natal degree (here 28° Scorpio, Chart A's Sun). The moment of that return is the birth of the annual chart. It falls within about a day of the calendar birthday and at a different clock time every year.

Muntha: the progressed point

Tajaka's most-quoted device is the **Muntha**. At birth the Muntha sits in the Lagna. It then **advances exactly one sign for every completed year of age**. So at age 1 it is in the 2nd sign from the natal Lagna, at age 12 it is back in the Lagna, and so on: take the age, divide by 12, and count the remainder forward from the Lagna.

WHY ONE SIGN A YEAR? Tajaka's grammar. The Muntha is the natal Lagna *progressed* at the pace of the year itself: one solar return, one step. Twelve steps bring it home, so the Muntha completes a circuit every twelve years, the same rhythm as Jupiter and the same twelve-year "return" people notice at 12, 24, 36. It ties the fixed birth chart to the moving year without inventing a new planet. Everyday parallel: a class photo where the same child is moved one seat along each year; by the twelfth year she is back in her first seat, but every seat in between coloured a year.

STORY: THE YEAR'S BRASS MARKER. On the day of the birth the steward places a small brass marker in the front room, the Lagna. Every birthday he moves it one room on. At the first birthday it stands in the treasury (the 2nd), at the seventh in the marriage pavilion (the 7th), at the twelfth it is home again, and round it goes for as long as the person lives. Whatever room the marker stands in that year, and whichever courtier happens to be sitting there, colours the year's business. **Rule:** Muntha = natal Lagna advanced by $(\text{age} \div 12, \text{remainder})$ signs; its house, its lord and its company set the tone of the year.

Chart A, age 37 (the year beginning December 2025). $37 \div 12 = 3$, remainder **1** → one sign forward from Scorpio → **Sagittarius**, her natal **2nd house**, where natal Saturn sits (Figure 15.2). The Muntha's house in the natal chart, its house in the annual chart, its lord's condition in both, and the planets with it and aspecting it colour the whole year. A 2nd-house Muntha turns the year toward money, family, speech and food; with Saturn on it, the tone is disciplined and slow: savings rather than windfalls, a family responsibility, careful words. Muntha in the ● 1st, 2nd, 3rd, 5th, 9th, 10th or 11th from the annual Lagna is classically welcome; in the ○ 4th, 6th, 7th, 8th or 12th it is not; and a Muntha with malefics or its lord weak makes a difficult year even in a good dasha.

Varshesha: the lord of the year

Tajaka names one planet **Varshesha**, lord of the year, and its strength decides the year's basic tone. It is chosen from **five candidates**: the lord of the **Muntha's sign**, the lord of the **natal Lagna**, the lord of the **Varsha Lagna**, the **Tri-rashi lord** (a special lord assigned to each Varsha Lagna sign by day and night birth, from a fixed table), and the **Dina-ratri lord** (the Sun for a day birth, the Moon for a night birth). Whichever of the five is **strongest and aspects the Varsha Lagna** becomes Varshesha, with the Varsha Lagna lord favoured in ties. The strength is measured by Tajaka's own five-fold scheme (*Panchavargiya bala*), not by Shadbala (Chapter 12). Software does it in a moment; what you should understand is the principle: *the year is ruled by whichever of the year's natural candidates can both stand strongly and see the year's Lagna*.

Tajaka yogas and Tajaka aspects: a flag

Tajaka has **sixteen yogas**, most of them about how two planets are moving toward or away from each other. The two you will meet everywhere are **Ithasala** (an *applying* aspect: the faster planet is moving *into* exact aspect with the slower; the matter is coming together, the answer is "yes, it happens") and **Ishrafa** (a *separating* aspect: the exact aspect is already past; the matter has slipped away, "it was possible, it is going"). The others (Kamboola, Ikkabala, Induvara, Radda, Duphali-kuttha and the rest) refine these two. You will meet Ithasala again in the next chapter, because Prashna borrows it.

And here is the flag: **Tajaka aspects are not Parashari aspects**. Tajaka uses Western-style geometric aspects (trines at 120° and sextiles at 60° as friendly, squares at 90° and oppositions at 180° as hostile, conjunctions as strong), measured in degrees with orbs, and it cares whether the aspect is applying or separating. If you run an annual chart in software and see "Saturn squares the Varsha Lagna lord", you are reading Tajaka, not Parashara. Do not carry the square back into your natal reading.

Mudda dasha is the annual chart's own dasha: the 360 days of the year divided among the nine planets in Vimshottari proportions, starting from the Moon's nakshatra at the solar return. It gives you the months.

When the annual chart is actually used

In practice the annual chart is for two occasions. The **birthday reading**: someone wants to know about *this* year, and the Varsha Lagna, Muntha, Varshesha and Mudda dasha give a twelve-month map with monthly detail that the Vimshottari Antardasha alone cannot. And the **annual review** of a chart you already know, where the Varshaphal tells you which of the dasha's promises this year picks up. I never cast it before reading the natal chart, and I never let it override the dasha. If the Vimshottari says "a quiet year" and the Varshaphal is dramatic, the drama will be small.

CONSULTATION TIP: Frame the year the way a good coach frames a season. "This year your Muntha sits in the house of money with Saturn: it is a saving year, not a spending year, and the discipline will feel heavy in the middle months. Your year-lord is Jupiter and it is strong, so the base of the year is protected. Here are the two months I would use for anything important, and the one month I would keep quiet." A year has twelve months; give the person the *shape*, not a list of good and bad dates they will only fret over.

Keeping the systems in their boxes

You now have four timekeepers (Vimshottari, Yogini, Chara, Varshaphal) and each has its own aspects, lords and logic. The traditions are precise *because* they are separate: Parashari aspects with Parashari dashas; Jaimini's sign aspects with Chara dasha and the karakas; Tajaka's geometric aspects with the annual chart. When you write a case, label each paragraph with the system it uses (Chapter 24 shows the format). It is the difference between a reading that can be defended and one that cannot.

In one breath

- Other dashas are second opinions, not replacements; Vimshottari remains the backbone. Parashara gives the others as conditional systems for particular charts.
- Yogini dasha: 36 years ($1 + 2 + \dots + 8$), eight yoginis: Mangala 1 (Moon), Pingala 2 (Sun), Dhanya 3 (Jupiter), Bhramari 4 (Mars), Bhadraka 5 (Mercury), Ulka 6 (Saturn), Siddha 7 (Venus), Sankata 8 (Rahu); first yogini = remainder of (nakshatra number + 3) $\div$ 8; balance in proportion to the Moon's remaining arc.
- Chart A starts with Bhramari (Mars), Chart B with Ulka (Saturn), Chart C with Siddha (Venus); Devika's Sankata and her Vimshottari Rahu Mahadasha coincide in her forties.
- Jaimini's Chara dasha gives periods to signs (the sign is Jaimini's unit); length = count from the sign to its lord minus one (forward from Aries, Taurus, Gemini, Libra, Scorpio, Sagittarius; backward from the rest, the mainstream simplification), 12 years maximum.
- Chara karakas rank planets by degree, highest first, because the planet furthest into its sign is the most experienced: Atmakaraka (soul) down to Darakaraka (spouse); Karakamsa is the AK's Navamsa sign. Meera's AK is the Sun; her Karakamsa is Pisces.
- Arudha Lagna: Lagna $\rightarrow$ lord $\rightarrow$ same distance again, the mirror's image as far behind the glass as the object is in front (with the 1st/7th exception); Meera's AL and Upapada both fall in Cancer on her Moon.
- Varshaphal is Tajaka: a chart for the Sun's yearly return to its natal degree; Muntha advances one sign a year (Meera at 37: Sagittarius, the 2nd); Varshesha from five candidates; Ithasala/Ishrafah; Western-style aspects. Never mix with Parashari.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. A Moon in Rohini (nakshatra 4). Which yogini comes first, and for how many years in full?
2. A Moon in Revati (27) at 25° Pisces. Find the first yogini and its balance at birth.
3. Chart B's Lagna is Cancer; its lord the Moon is in Taurus. Compute Arjun's Arudha Lagna. Does the exception apply?
4. Chart C's Lagna is Aries; lord Mars is in Gemini. Find Devika's Arudha Lagna and comment on where it falls.
5. Compute Arjun's Muntha for age 31 (the year from March 2026) and name the natal house it occupies. Which planets does it join?

Answers

1. $4 + 3 = 7$; $7 \div 8$ leaves remainder 7 $\rightarrow$ **Siddha (Venus)**, a 7-year yogini. 2. $27 + 3 = 30$; $30 \div 8 = 3$, remainder 6 $\rightarrow$ **Ulka (Saturn, 6 years)**. Revati runs $16^{\circ}40' - 30^{\circ}$; at 25° there are 5° left of $13^{\circ}20'$ $\rightarrow$ fraction 0.375 $\rightarrow$ $6 \times 0.375 = 2.25$ years of Ulka at birth, then Siddha 7, Sankata 8... 3. Cancer to Taurus: Cancer 1, Leo 2, ... Taurus is the **11th**. The 11th from Taurus: Taurus 1, Gemini 2, Cancer 3, Leo 4, Virgo 5, Libra 6, Scorpio 7, Sagittarius 8, Capricorn 9, Aquarius 10, **Pisces 11**. AL = **Pisces**, his 9th house. Pisces is neither the Lagna nor the 7th (Capricorn), so no exception. He is seen as more philosophical and gentle than his 8th-house planets might suggest. 4. Aries to Gemini is the **3rd**; the 3rd from Gemini is **Leo**. AL = **Leo**, her 5th house, where Saturn, Rahu and Mercury sit. Leo is not the 1st or 7th, so no exception. The world sees her through the 5th house (children, students, creativity, intelligence) and the Saturn and Rahu there mean the image was built through struggle in exactly those matters. 5. $31 \div 12 = 2$, remainder 7 $\rightarrow$ seven signs forward from Cancer: Leo 1, Virgo 2, Libra 3, Scorpio 4, Sagittarius 5, Capricorn 6, **Aquarius 7**. Muntha in Aquarius, his natal **8th house**, joining natal Sun, Mercury and Saturn. A year of the 8th: research, insurance, inheritance, in-laws, hidden matters; and, with the Yogini Ulka beginning in December 2026, a year to be careful and thorough rather than bold.

Chapter 16: The Panchanga and Muhurta: Choosing the Right Moment

My nani could not read a birth chart. She could read a **panchanga**, the Hindu almanac, the way you read a bus timetable, and with it she ran a household of fourteen people: when to sow, when to start the children's schooling, which day the new bride should enter the house, which afternoon not to set out for the market. Before Jyotish predicted anything, it *scheduled* things. This chapter is about that older, humbler, and in some ways more useful skill.

The birth chart tells you what a person carries. The panchanga tells you what the *day* carries. And **Muhurta** (electional astrology, the choosing of a good moment) is where the two meet: given what this person carries, which day and hour should they choose to begin? The first thing anyone asks you, once they know you read charts, is for a date. Let us make sure you can give one honestly.

The five limbs of a day

Panchanga means "five limbs" (*pancha* = five, *anga* = limb). Every day has five qualities, all of them computed from the positions of just two bodies, the **Sun and the Moon**, plus the weekday (Appendix A.14):

Limb	What it is	How many
Tithi	The lunar day: the Sun-Moon angle in 12° steps	30 per lunar month
Vara	The weekday and its planetary lord	7
Nakshatra	The Moon's lunar mansion (Chapter 7)	27
Yoga	The <i>sum</i> of Sun and Moon longitudes in 13°20' steps	27
Karana	Half a tithi	11 kinds, 60 per month

Notice that four of the five are about the Moon. The panchanga is a lunar instrument: Jyotish timekeeping trusts the Moon for *quality* and the Sun for *quantity*. The Sun fixes the year and the seasons; the Moon fixes the mood of the day.

Tithi: the lunar day

Stand in the middle of the sky and watch the Moon race ahead of the Sun. It gains about 12° on the Sun every day. A **tithi** is exactly that: each **12° of separation** between Moon and Sun is one lunar day. $360^\circ \div 12^\circ = 30$ tithis in a lunar month of about 29½ solar days, so a tithi lasts, on average, a little under a day, and in practice anywhere between about 20 and 27 hours, which is why a printed panchanga always gives the time a tithi *ends*.

WHY IS THE TITHI AN ANGLE AND NOT A DATE? Astronomy. The Moon's phase is its angle from the Sun: at 0° we see no lit face (new Moon), at 90° a half, at 180° the full disc. So the tithi is not an arbitrary count; it is the phase of the Moon cut into thirty equal slices, which is why a panchanga can tell you the exact minute a tithi ends while a calendar date cannot. Everyday parallel: the level of water in a tank is the real measure of how much is left; the day of the month is only a rough guess at it.

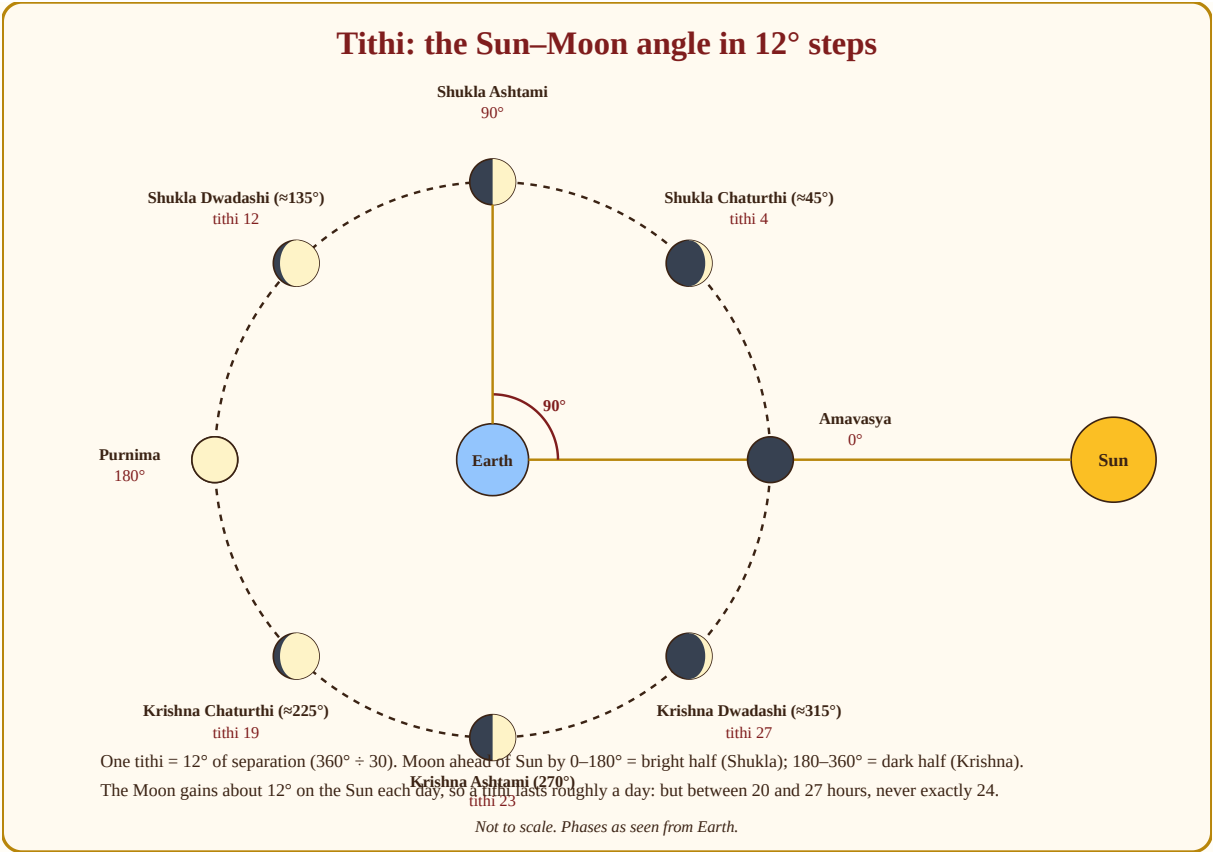


Figure 16.1: The Moon's phases are simply its angle from the Sun, seen from Earth. Every 12° is one tithi. From new Moon (0°) to full Moon (180°) is the bright half (Shukla paksha); from full back to new is the dark half (Krishna paksha).

The first fifteen tithis, from new Moon to full, are the **bright fortnight** (*Shukla paksha*) and end at **Purnima** (full Moon, 180°). The next fifteen, from full back to new, are the **dark fortnight** (*Krishna paksha*) and end at **Amavasya** (new Moon, 0°/360°). Within each fortnight the tithis have the same names:

#	Tithi	#	Tithi	#	Tithi
1	Pratipada	6	Shashthi	11	Ekadashi
2	Dwitiya	7	Saptami	12	Dwadashi
3	Tritiya	8	Ashtami	13	Trayodashi
4	Chaturthi	9	Navami	14	Chaturdashi
5	Panchami	10	Dashami	15	Purnima (bright) / Amavasya (dark)

So "Shukla Panchami" is the fifth day of the bright half, "Krishna Ashtami" the eighth of the dark half. Most festivals are tithis: Krishna Janmashtami is Krishna Ashtami of Bhadrapada, Diwali is Kartika Amavasya, Ganesh Chaturthi is Bhadrapada Shukla Chaturthi.

The five families of tithis. For muhurta the thirty tithis are grouped into five families, repeating every five days:

Family	Tithis	Meaning	Best weekday (Siddha pairing)
● Nanda (joy)	1, 6, 11	Pleasure, celebration, arts, beginnings of enjoyment	Friday
● Bhadra (good)	2, 7, 12	Steady, auspicious for most work; trade, learning	Wednesday
● Jaya (victory)	3, 8, 13	Contests, litigation, medicine, anything to be won	Tuesday
○ Rikta (empty)	4, 9, 14	Avoid for beginnings ; suited only to destructive or harsh acts	Saturday
● Purna (full)	5, 10, 15	Completion, fullness; marriage, house-warming, big undertakings	Thursday

WHY ARE THE RIKTA TITHIS "EMPTY"? The tradition's symbolic logic, with a little geometry behind it. Each family of five tithis is one quarter-turn of the Moon's light: five tithis are 60°. Within each quarter, the fourth step (tithis 4, 9, 14) is the moment *just before* the phase visibly turns: just before the first-quarter half-Moon, just before full, just before the last sliver vanishes. The light has not yet arrived, or is about to go; the tradition calls the day "empty" and refuses to begin anything in it, while the fifth step (5, 10, 15) is "full" because the turn has completed. Everyday parallel: you do not open the shop in the last minute before the power cut ends; you wait for the lights to actually come on.

STORY: FIVE KINDS OF DAYS IN A VILLAGE. Watch a village through a fortnight and you see five kinds of days come round in turn. **Nanda** days (1, 6, 11) are for joy: a wedding song, a new sari, the fair. **Bhadra** days (2, 7, 12) are steady market days when the shop is opened and the ledger balanced. **Jaya** days (3, 8, 13) are for the wrestling pit and the panchayat, anything to be won. **Rikta** days (4, 9, 14) are the empty days: the well is cleaned, the old wall pulled down, nothing new begun; the elders sit in the shade. **Purna** days (5, 10, 15) are the full days: the harvest is in, the granary sealed, the house-warming held. Each kind of day has a weekday it loves: joy on Venus's Friday, the market on Mercury's Wednesday, the contest on Mars's Tuesday, the emptying on Saturn's Saturday, the fullness on Jupiter's Thursday. **Rule:** Nanda 1/6/11, Bhadra 2/7/12, Jaya 3/8/13, Rikta 4/9/14 (avoid for beginnings), Purna 5/10/15; Siddha when on its own weekday.

When a tithi falls on its paired weekday, the panchanga calls it a **Siddha tithi**, "accomplished", a small bonus. Whether or not the geometry convinces you, memorise the five families; they are the first thing a panchanga-reader checks.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Treating Amavasya as "unlucky". Amavasya is the day for ancestors (*pitru* rites) and for inner work; it is not evil, it is simply not for *starting*. Likewise Ashtami and Chaturdashi are avoided for beginnings by many families but are the great days of Durga and Shiva. "Avoid for muhurta" never means "bad day".

Vara: the weekday and its hours

Each weekday belongs to a planet: Sunday to the Sun, Monday to the Moon, Tuesday to Mars, Wednesday to Mercury, Thursday to Jupiter, Friday to Venus, Saturday to Saturn. The day's lord colours the day: Tuesday for courage, surgery and disputes; Wednesday for trade, writing, travel; Thursday for learning, ceremonies, finance; Friday for pleasure, arts and marriage; Saturday for labour and long-term, slow work; Sunday for authority and government; Monday for the public, the home, women's matters.

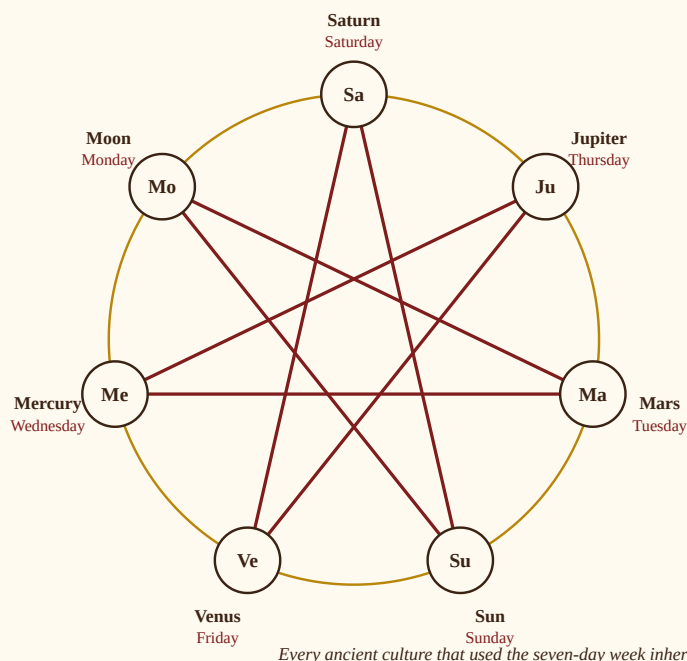
Under the day lies a finer clock. From sunrise the day is divided into **24 horas** (an hour each, roughly; "hora" is the ancestor of our word *hour*), and each hora is ruled by a planet in a fixed cycle that begins with the day's lord. Sunday's first hora is the Sun's; then Venus, Mercury, Moon, Saturn, Jupiter, Mars; then the Sun again: the planets in decreasing order of speed,

repeating. The hora of Jupiter or Venus in the morning is a favourite for signing papers; Mercury's hora for trade and study; Saturn's and Mars's horas are left for hard or harsh work.

WHY ARE THE WEEKDAYS IN THIS ORDER? Astronomy, read through the horas. Arrange the seven planets by speed, slowest first (Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Sun, Venus, Mercury, Moon: this is their order of distance from us, and the ancients could see it in how fast each moved against the stars) and give each hour to the next planet in turn. Twenty-four hours is three complete rounds of seven plus three steps. So if Sunday's first hour is the Sun's, the twenty-fifth hour, Monday's first, falls three planets on: the Moon's. Three more steps: Mars, Tuesday. Then Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn. The weekday order is the speed order read every third planet. Everyday parallel: a shift rotation where seven guards take one-hour turns in a fixed order; whoever happens to be on duty at dawn gives the day its name.

STORY: SEVEN GUARDS CHANGING SHIFT. Seven guards keep the palace gate in hour-long shifts, always in the same order of seniority, slowest first: the old Judge (Saturn), Guru-ji (Jupiter), the Commander (Mars), the King (Sun), Shukracharya (Venus), the Prince (Mercury), the Queen Mother (Moon), and then the Judge again. On Sunday the King takes the first shift at sunrise. Twenty-four shifts later (three full rounds and three more guards) it is the Queen Mother who stands at the gate as Monday dawns: Monday is hers. Three more past her: the Commander, Tuesday. Then the Prince, Guru-ji, Shukracharya, the Judge. Whoever holds the gate at dawn owns the day. **Rule:** hora order is Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Sun, Venus, Mercury, Moon, repeating from the day lord; every 25th hora gives the next weekday.

Why the weekdays run Sun–Mon–Tue...: the seven-pointed star



Around the circle: the planets in order of speed, slowest first: Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Sun, Venus, Mercury, Moon (the Chaldean order).

Each hour (hora) of the day is ruled by the next planet in this circle. Sunday's first hora is the Sun's. 24 hours later, three steps on, the 25th hora: Monday's first: belongs to the Moon.

Follow the star from point to point, skipping two each time, and you read the week:
Sun → Moon → Mars → Mercury → Jupiter → Venus → Saturn → Sun again.

Figure 16.2: The seven planets in decreasing order of speed around the circle. Skip two, land on the third, and the star spells out the week: Sun, Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn. This diagram is at least two thousand years old and appears from Babylon to Kerala.

Nakshatra: the Moon's star for the day

You know the 27 nakshatras from Chapter 7 as birth stars. In the panchanga they are the **Moon's star of the day**, and the muhurta texts sort them into seven temperaments, a classification you will use constantly:

Class	Nakshatras	Suits
● Dhruva / Sthira (fixed)	Rohini, Uttara Phalguni, Uttara Ashadha, Uttara Bhadrapada	Foundations: laying a house's first stone, planting, coronations, anything meant to last
● Chara (movable)	Swati, Punarvasu, Shravana, Dhanishta, Shatabhisha	Travel, vehicles, anything meant to <i>move</i>
○ Ugra / Krura (fierce)	Bharani, Magha, Purva Phalguni, Purva Ashadha, Purva Bhadrapada	Destructive or forceful acts: demolition, weapons, confronting an enemy; not for beginnings
● Mishra (mixed)	Krittika, Vishakha	Routine work; fire rituals; mixed results
● Kshipra / Laghu (quick, light)	Ashwini, Pushya, Hasta, Abhijit	Quick works: trade, shops, learning, medicine, ornaments, travel
● Mridu (soft)	Mrigashira, Chitra, Anuradha, Revati	Arts, music, friendship, new clothes, love, gentle beginnings
○ Tikshna / Daruna (sharp)	Mula, Ardra, Jyeshtha, Ashlesha	Separation, harsh acts, exorcism, surgery of the cutting kind; avoid for auspicious starts

WHY ARE THE FIXED STARS FOR FOUNDATIONS AND THE MOVABLE ONES FOR TRAVEL? The tradition's symbolic logic, read from each star's deity and symbol (Appendix A.7). The four "fixed" stars are the three *Uttaras* (the "latter", completing halves of their pairs, whose symbols are the back legs of a bed or cot, the part that bears the weight) plus Rohini, the Moon's beloved, whose symbol is the ox-cart and whose deity Brahma creates what lasts. The "movable" stars belong to the gods of wind and motion: Swati to Vayu (wind), Punarvasu to Aditi with its symbol of a bow (the arrow flies), Shravana to Vishnu who strides across the worlds, Dhanishta to the travelling Vasus, Shatabhisha to Varuna of the oceans. The "sharp" stars belong to Rudra, Nirriti, Indra's thunderbolt and the serpents. The classification is not arbitrary; it is the myths, tidied into a table. Everyday parallel: you would not lay a foundation stone at the bus stand, or start a bus journey from inside a temple.

STORY: THE STREETS OF THE CAPITAL. The twenty-seven streets of the capital each have a temperament, and a wise builder chooses his street. On the **fixed** streets (Rohini, the three *Uttaras*) stand the temples and the banks: lay a foundation there. The **movable** streets (Swati, Punarvasu, Shravana, Dhanishta, Shatabhisha) lead to the bus stand and the river ghat: start a journey there. The **fierce** streets (Bharani, Magha, the three *Purvas*) hold the armoury and the demolition yard: go there only to break or to fight. The **quick** streets (Ashwini, Pushya, Hasta, Abhijit) are the bazaar: open a shop, learn a trade. The **soft** streets (Mrigashira, Chitra, Anuradha, Revati) are where the musicians and tailors live: begin a friendship, buy clothes. The **sharp** streets (Mula, Ardra, Jyeshtha, Ashlesha) hold the surgeon and the exorcist: necessary, but not where you begin anything you want to grow. Krittika and Vishakha are the **mixed** lanes of everyday errands. **Rule:** fixed for foundations, movable for travel, quick for trade, soft for arts, fierce and sharp only for harsh acts.

Abhijit is the 28th "nakshatra" used only in muhurta (the last quarter of Uttara Ashadha and the first 4° of Shravana, Appendix A.7) and it is universally auspicious. Meera's birth star Ashlesha is a *sharp* nakshatra; that tells you about her (Chapter 7) but for muhurta it simply means "not a day to start a business".

Yoga: the sum of Sun and Moon

The fourth limb is the least intuitive. Take the longitudes of Sun and Moon, **add** them, and divide by 13°20': the result, 1 to 27, is the day's **yoga** (*Nitya yoga*). It has no obvious astronomical meaning; it is a numerical harmony, but the tradition attaches a

quality to each, and a panchanga reader checks it for muhurta. You do not need all 27; you need the ones to avoid and the best ones:

Quality	Yogas (with their numbers)
○ Inauspicious: avoid for beginnings	Vishkumbha (1), Atiganda (6), Shula (9), Ganda (10), Vyaghata (13), Vajra (15), Vyatipata (17) , Parigha (19), Vaidhriti (27)
● Good: preferred	Priti (2), Ayushman (3), Saubhagya (4), Shobhana (5), Sukarma (7), Dhriti (8), Vriddhi (11), Dhruva (12), Harshana (14), Siddhi (16), Variyan (18), Shiva (20), Siddha (21), Sadhya (22), Shubha (23), Shukla (24), Brahma (25), Indra (26)

Vyatipata and Vaidhriti are the two everyone avoids; no Hindu family fixes a wedding on them. (A small warning about names: you will also see "Amrita yoga", "Siddha yoga" and "Marana yoga" on panchanga pages; those are a *different* set, made from the weekday and the nakshatra together, not from the Sun-Moon sum. Same word, different limb.)

Karana: half a tithi

The fifth limb is the **karana**, simply **half a tithi** (6° of Sun-Moon separation), so there are 60 in a lunar month. There are only **eleven kinds: seven movable** ones that repeat in a fixed cycle eight times each (Bava, Balava, Kaulava, Taitila, Gara, Vanija, **Vishti**) and **four fixed** ones that appear once a month at the dark end and the bright start: Shakuni, Chatuspada, Naga (the last three half-tithis of the month) and Kimstughna (the first half of Shukla Pratipada). The one to know is **Vishti, also called Bhadra**, the karana avoided for all auspicious beginnings; every panchanga marks Bhadra's start and end times, and grandmothers wait for it to pass. Naga and Shakuni are also avoided; Bava, Balava and Kaulava are liked for beginnings.

Reading a printed panchanga page

Let me construct a day so you can see all five limbs on one page. I am choosing it to be a good one, because we will use it later for Meera's launch. Imagine a Thursday in early June, sunrise 5:28, sunset 19:12, Jaipur; the year is left out on purpose so that the reasoning, not the calendar, is the lesson.

Panchanga entry	Value on our sample Thursday
Samvat / Saka / Masa	Vikram Samvat (year), Saka (year), Jyeshtha month (Amanta), Shukla paksha
Ayana / Ritu	Uttarayana (Sun moving north) / Grishma (summer)
Sunrise / Sunset	05:28 / 19:12
Tithi	● Shukla Panchami (Purna) until 14:10, then Shashthi (Nanda)
Vara	● Thursday (Guruvara), Jupiter's day
Nakshatra	● Pushya (quick) until 20:35, then ○ Ashlesha (sharp)
Yoga	● Dhruva until 16:45, then ○ Vyaghata
Karana	● Bava until 14:10, then ● Balava
Moon's sign	Cancer (all day)
Sun's sign / nakshatra	Taurus, Rohini
Rahu Kaal	○ 14:03 – 15:46
Yamaganda	○ 05:28 – 07:11
Gulika Kaal	○ 08:54 – 10:37
Abhijit muhurta	● 11:53 – 12:47
Brahma muhurta	● 03:52 – 04:40
Disha Shool	○ South (do not set out southward)
Special note	Guru-Pushya yoga (Pushya on a Thursday), a celebrated day for trade, gold and new ventures

Read it the way my nani did. Thursday: Jupiter's day, good for ceremonies and finance. Shukla Panchami: a Purna tithi, on Thursday, a Siddha pairing. Pushya: a *quick* nakshatra, ideal for trade, and on Jupiter's day it makes the famous *Guru-Pushya*. Dhruva yoga: fixed, good. Bava karana: good. The Moon is in Cancer, its own sign, waxing. Everything on the page agrees until about 14:00, when three things change within the hour: the tithi becomes Shashthi (Nanda, still fine), Rahu Kaal begins, and by 16:45 the yoga turns to Vyaghata. The lesson: **good days have good windows**, and the panchanga tells you where the window closes.

Rahu Kaal, Yamaganda and Gulika: the eight parts of the day

The three "avoid" slots that every Indian knows are computed the same way: divide the time from **sunrise to sunset into eight equal parts**, and each weekday assigns one part to each of the three (Appendix A.14 gives Rahu Kaal for a 6-to-6 day; for a real day, use the real sunrise and sunset, as the table above does; our 13h44m June day gives parts of 103 minutes).

Weekday	○ Rahu Kaal (part of 8)	○ Yamaganda (part)	○ Gulika Kaal (part)
Sunday	8th (≈ 4:30–6 pm)	5th (≈ 12–1:30)	7th (≈ 3–4:30)
Monday	2nd (≈ 7:30–9)	4th (≈ 10:30–12)	6th (≈ 1:30–3)
Tuesday	7th (≈ 3–4:30)	3rd (≈ 9–10:30)	5th (≈ 12–1:30)
Wednesday	5th (≈ 12–1:30)	2nd (≈ 7:30–9)	4th (≈ 10:30–12)
Thursday	6th (≈ 1:30–3)	1st (≈ 6–7:30)	3rd (≈ 9–10:30)
Friday	4th (≈ 10:30–12)	7th (≈ 3–4:30)	2nd (≈ 7:30–9)
Saturday	3rd (≈ 9–10:30)	6th (≈ 1:30–3)	1st (≈ 6–7:30)

WHY IS RAHU KAAL WHERE IT IS EACH DAY? This one is tradition, not astronomy, and you should know that. The eight parts of the day are given, in the old scheme, to the seven weekday lords in turn plus one part to Rahu, and the sequence is arranged so that Rahu's part shifts through the week in the pattern Monday 2nd, Saturday 3rd, Friday 4th, Wednesday 5th, Thursday 6th, Tuesday 7th, Sunday 8th (a memory rhyme in many families runs "Mother Saw Father Wearing The Turban on Sunday", the first letters giving Mon, Sat, Fri, Wed, Thu, Tue, Sun). Yamaganda and Gulika are the parts assigned to Yama's servant and to Saturn's son Mandi by a similar table. No text I know derives these from the sky; they are a scheduling convention the whole country agreed on, which is itself their value. Everyday parallel: the school bell timetable is arbitrary, but because everyone follows it, it works.

STORY: THE EIGHT WATCHES OF THE DAY. The daylight is cut into eight watches, and three unwelcome figures each take one watch a day, moving to a different watch as the week turns. The Smoke-headed Stranger (Rahu) takes his, Rahu Kaal, and during it nothing new is signed, though routine work goes on (South India keeps this watch more strictly than the North). Yama's runner takes Yamaganda, and no one sets out on a road. And Gulika, the old Judge's slow son (also called Mandi), takes his: whatever is begun in his watch is said to repeat itself, so begin nothing there you do not want twice; some cleverly use it for the first payment into a savings scheme. The rest of the day belongs to the household.

Rule: divide sunrise-to-sunset by eight; each weekday has its own Rahu Kaal, Yamaganda and Gulika watches; nothing in the tradition is merely "bad", everything has a use.

Abhijit muhurta is the good slot hidden in every day: divide the day into **15 muhurtas** (about 48 minutes each on a 12-hour day) and the **8th, straddling local noon**, is Abhijit, universally acceptable when nothing better is available, except on Wednesdays by some texts. **Brahma muhurta** is the 96 minutes to 48 minutes before sunrise: the pre-dawn hour for study, prayer and meditation, when the mind is quietest. And **Chaughadiya** (*chogadiya*) is the popular Gujarati-Rajasthani system that divides day and night into eight slots each, cycling through seven names (Amrit, Shubh, Labh, Char good; Udveg, Rog, Kaal avoid) beginning from the day lord's slot; it is a shopkeeper's quick rule, coarser than the five limbs but practical.

Muhurta: choosing the moment

Now the craft. Electional astrology (*Muhurta Shastra*) has whole treatises (*Muhurta Chintamani*, *Muhurta Martanda*, *Kalaprakashika*) but the working principles fit in four lines. I call them the four gates, and a moment must pass all four.

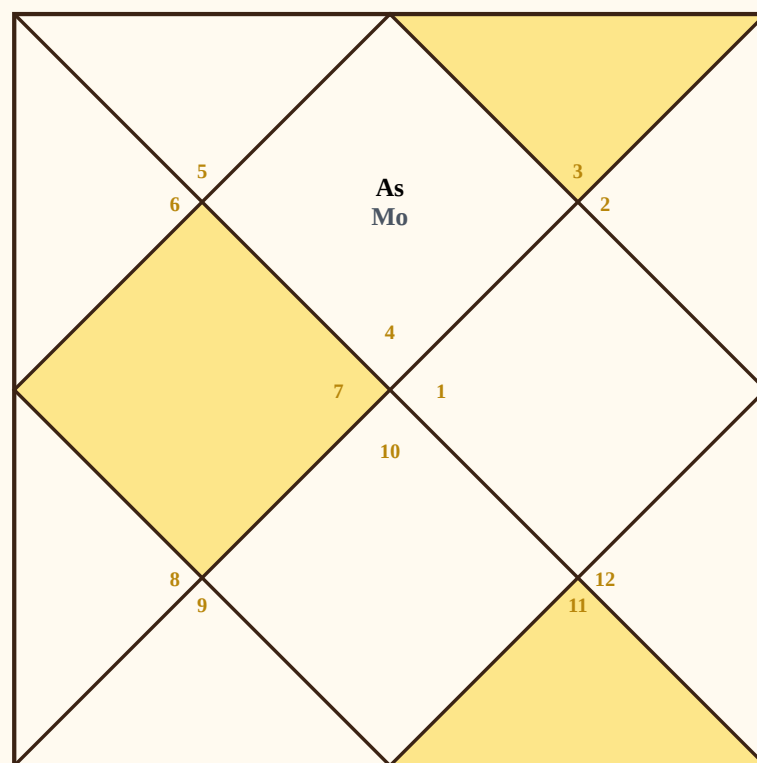
Gate 1: Panchanga shuddhi (a clean day). All five limbs acceptable for the purpose: a tithi that is not Rikta (and not Amavasya for auspicious work), a weekday that suits the matter, a nakshatra of the right temperament, a yoga not in the avoid list, and no Vishti/Bhadra karana. Plus no eclipse that day, and outside Rahu Kaal.

Gate 2: Lagna shuddhi (a clean chart of the moment). The rising sign at the chosen minute should be a **fixed sign** for things meant to last (marriage, house, institution), a **movable sign** for travel and things meant to move, a **dual sign** acceptable for trade and mixed purposes; the Lagna should be **aspected or occupied by a benefic**; **benefics in kendras (1, 4, 7, 10)**; **malefics in 3, 6, 11** (the upachayas, Chapter 14's rule again); and the **8th house empty**. The muhurta texts are unanimous that a planet in the 8th of the muhurta chart brings obstruction to the undertaking. Also check that the muhurta's Lagna is not the 6th, 8th or 12th sign from the person's natal Lagna.

Gate 3: Chandra bala and Tara bala (the Moon is kind to this person). This gate makes the muhurta *personal*. **Chandra bala:** the transiting Moon's sign, counted from the person's **natal Moon**, should be good (the 1st, 3rd, 6th, 7th, 10th or 11th, Appendix A.9) and **never the 4th, 8th or 12th**. The 8th from the natal Moon is **Chandrashtama**: about 2¼ days every month when the person is low in energy, prone to error and ill luck; nothing important is begun then. **Tara bala:** count from the person's birth nakshatra to the day's nakshatra and divide by nine; the remainder names the *tara*: 1 Janma (birth, mixed), 2 Sampat (wealth, good), 3 Vipat (danger, avoid), 4 Kshema (well-being, good), 5 Pratyari (obstacle, avoid), 6 Sadhaka (achievement, good), 7 Vadha (destruction, avoid), 8 Mitra (friend, good), 9 or 0 Ati-mitra (great friend, best). Avoid 3, 5 and 7.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER'S LOW DAYS. *The Queen Mother (the Moon) walks through the twelve rooms of her haveli every month, two and a quarter days in each. In most rooms she is herself. But when she passes through the three rooms that stand 4th, 8th and 12th from the room where she was born, she is not: the 4th unsettles her, the 12th drains her, and the 8th, the room of hidden things, leaves her tired, forgetful and unlucky for two days. No one in the household asks her to sign anything then. Every person's Moon has her own three low rooms, which is why the same calendar day is good for one person and bad for another. Rule: avoid beginnings when the transiting Moon is in the 4th, 8th (Chandrashtama) or 12th from your natal Moon.*

Chandra bala: the houses to avoid from your natal Moon



l Moon sign. Do not start important work when the transiting Moon is in 4, 8 (Chandrashtama) or 12th from your natal Moon.

Figure 16.3: Put the natal Moon in the 1st house. When the day's Moon is in the 4th, 8th or 12th from it (highlighted), the day is not this person's. The 8th is Chandrashtama, the worst of the three.

Gate 4: The specific rules of the purpose. Marriage has its nakshatras, house-warming its months, travel its directions. The next section gives the standard ones.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Panchanga for everyone, Lagna for the deed, Moon for the person. A "good day" from a calendar is Gate 1 only. A real muhurta passes all four, which is why two families with the same panchanga can be given different dates.

The standard muhurtas

Marriage (Vivaha). The classical nakshatras: **Rohini, Mrigashira, Magha, Uttara Phalguni, Hasta, Swati, Anuradha, Mula, Uttara Ashadha, Uttara Bhadrapada, Revati:** eleven stars, a mixture of fixed, soft and quick temperaments (Magha and Mula are included by tradition despite their fierce and sharp classes; texts differ on both). Tithis: Bhadra and Purna families preferred, Rikta avoided. Weekdays: Monday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday. Months: regional lists differ, but Magha, Phalgun, Vaishakha and Jyeshtha are widely accepted, Margashirsha in many regions; the four monsoon months of *Chaturmas* are avoided, as is *Kharmas* (the Sun in Sagittarius or Pisces) in the North, and an intercalary month (*Adhik maas*) everywhere. The Lagna: fixed sign preferred, the 7th house of the muhurta chart clean, Venus and Jupiter well placed, and the rule every family astrologer knows: **no marriage when Venus or Jupiter is combust** (*Shukra asta*, *Guru asta*: too close to the Sun, Appendix A.2).

WHY DOES COMBUSTION OF VENUS OR JUPITER STOP WEDDINGS? Astronomy plus grammar. A planet within a few degrees of the Sun is invisible: it rises and sets with the Sun and cannot be seen in the sky at all, which is what the word *asta*, "set", means. Venus is the karaka of marriage and of the wife; Jupiter is the karaka of the husband and of dharma, the vow itself. When the two planets that stand for the two people and the promise between them cannot be seen, the tradition will not hold the ceremony that depends on them. Everyday parallel: you do not hold the wedding when both the bride's family and the priest are out of town.

House-warming (Griha Pravesh). Fixed nakshatras (Rohini, the three Uttaras), plus Pushya, Hasta, Chitra, Anuradha, Revati and Mrigashira; a fixed Lagna; Uttarayana (mid-January to mid-July) preferred; Tuesdays avoided; the 4th house of the muhurta chart (home) clean and its lord strong.

Starting a business or shop. Quick, movable and soft nakshatras (Ashwini, Pushya, Hasta, Abhijit; Swati, Punarvasu, Shravana, Dhanishta, Shatabhisha; Mrigashira, Chitra, Anuradha, Revati) plus the fixed ones for institutions meant to last generations. Wednesday (Mercury, trade), Thursday (Jupiter, finance) and Friday (Venus, prosperity) are the days. In the muhurta chart, the Lagna lord strong, **Mercury** (trade) and **Jupiter** (wealth) well placed, and the **2nd** and **11th** houses (money and gains) with benefics or their lords strong. Guru-Pushya and Ravi-Pushya (Pushya on a Sunday) are the celebrated days.

Travel (Yatra). Movable nakshatras; Chandra bala from the natal Moon; outside Rahu Kaal and Yamaganda; and the **Disha Shool** rule, the direction that is "spiked" each day, in which one does not set out: **East on Monday and Saturday; North on Tuesday and Wednesday; West on Sunday and Friday; South on Thursday.** Village wisdom offers a remedy if travel cannot wait (eat a particular food before leaving: curd for the east, jaggery for the north, and so on) and I pass it on as custom, not as science.

Beginnings of study (Vidyarambha), naming (Namakarana), first solid food (Annaprashana), tonsure (Chudakarana): each has a short list; the *Muhurta Chintamani* gives them, and any good panchanga prints them for the year.

A worked example: a launch date for Meera

Meera wants to start her own teaching-and-consulting practice, a small institute. Let me walk the four gates with her chart (Chart A: Lagna Scorpio, Moon 21° Cancer in Ashlesha).

Her constraints first, before any calendar. Her natal Moon is in **Cancer**, so Chandra bala forbids days with the Moon in **Libra** (4th), **Aquarius** (8th, her Chandrashtama) and **Gemini** (12th). Her birth star is **Ashlesha (9)**, so I compute Tara bala for any candidate star. Her natal Lagna is **Scorpio**, so the muhurta's Lagna must not be **Aries** (6th), **Gemini** (8th) or **Libra** (12th). The purpose is a lasting institution with a trade element, so a fixed or dual Lagna, a quick or fixed nakshatra, Mercury and Jupiter well placed, the 2nd and 11th clean.

Gate 1, the day. The sample Thursday above: Shukla Panchami (Purna, Siddha on Thursday), Pushya (quick: trade and learning), Dhruva yoga, Bava karana, Guru-Pushya. Clean until about 14:00.

Gate 3, the Moon for her. The Moon is in Cancer, the **1st from her natal Moon**, which is on the acceptable list (1, 3, 6, 7, 10, 11). Tara bala: from Ashlesha (9) to Pushya (8), counting forward, is 27; $27 \div 9$ leaves remainder 0 → **Ati-mitra**, the best tara. The day is hers.

Gate 2, the moment. In early June at Jaipur, Taurus rises at dawn, Gemini until about 8, Cancer until about 10, Leo until about 12:30, and **Virgo from about 12:30 to 15:00**. Leo is fixed and tempting, but with Leo rising the Moon in Cancer falls in the muhurta's **12th house**: I reject it. Virgo is a dual sign (acceptable for trade), is the **11th from her natal Scorpio** (not 6, 8 or 12), and puts the **Moon in the 11th** (gains) of the muhurta chart. I choose **13:05**: after Abhijit ends at 12:47, and a clear hour before Rahu Kaal begins at 14:03 and the tithi changes at 14:10.

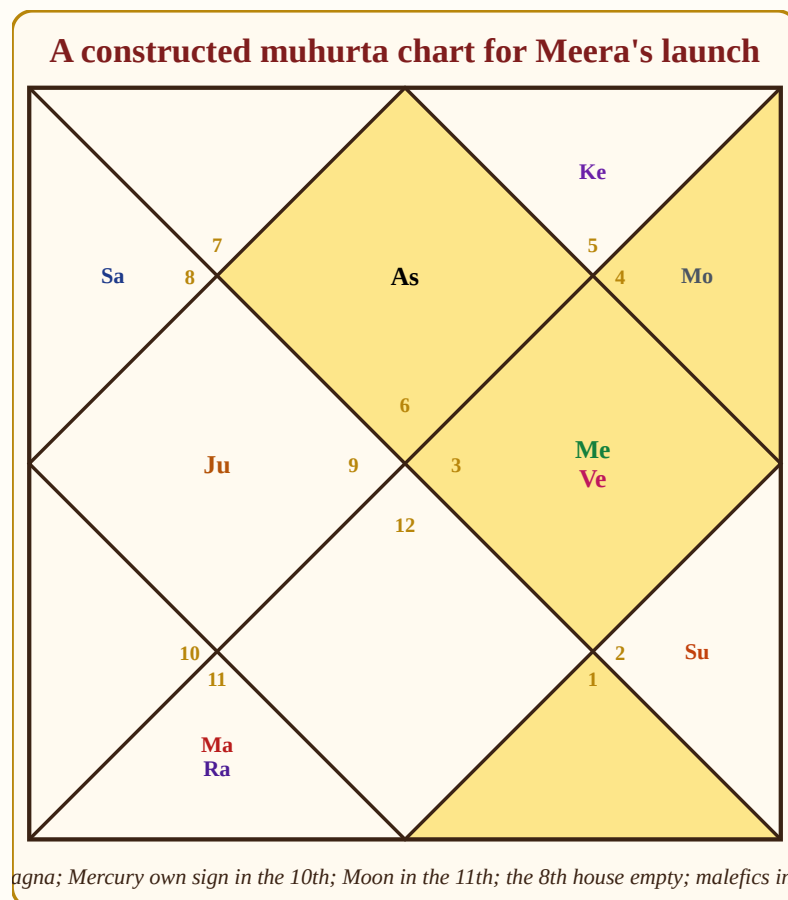


Figure 16.4: The muhurta chart at 13:05 on the sample Thursday (planets illustrative; the year is left generic). Virgo rises with its lord Mercury in the 10th in its own sign Gemini; Venus joins it; the Moon is in the 11th; Jupiter sits in the 4th in Sagittarius;

Mars, Rahu and Saturn are in the upachayas 6 and 3; Ketu is tucked in the 12th; the 8th house (Aries) is empty. Highlighted: houses 1, 8, 10, 11.

Now the checklist on Figure 16.4. Lagna Virgo; its lord **Mercury in the 10th in Gemini, own sign**: the trade planet strong in the career house, a Bhadra-type placement. **Benefics in kendras**: Mercury and Venus in the 10th, Jupiter in the 4th in its own sign. **Malefics in 3, 6, 11**: Saturn in the 3rd, Mars and Rahu in the 6th. **The 8th house empty. Moon in the 11th**. The 2nd house (Libra) is empty but its lord Venus is strong in the 10th; the 11th holds the Moon. Ketu in the 12th is tolerable. All four gates pass. If the slow planets of the actual year put something in the 8th, I would move to the next Guru-Pushya or to a Hasta-on-Wednesday with the same method. The method is the point, not the date.

What I would tell her. "Thursday, between one and two in the afternoon, after the midday Abhijit and before Rahu Kaal at two. Light the lamp and sign the first paper at five past one. The day is Guru-Pushya, the Moon is your own, and the chart of the moment puts your trade planet at the top." Then the sentence that should follow every muhurta anyone gives: the next section.

The honest limit of muhurta

A muhurta is a **good start, not a guarantee**. It cannot override a weak natal promise. If Meera's natal chart did not support an independent practice (a weak 10th lord, an afflicted Mercury, a dasha of loss) the finest Guru-Pushya afternoon would only give her a pleasant opening ceremony. The classical image is of a seed and a season: muhurta chooses the season; the seed is the natal chart; the farming is the person's effort. All three are needed, and the astrologer controls only the first.

There is a second limit, more practical: **perfection does not exist**. Every day has a flaw somewhere among the five limbs, the Lagna and the Moon. The skill is in weighting: the person's Moon and the 8th house first, the tithi and nakshatra next, the yoga and karana last. Someone who waits for a flawless day will wait forever.

CONSULTATION TIP: When someone says "just give me the date", do three things. First, ask what the date is *for*; the same day can be right for a shop and wrong for a wedding. Second, offer two or three windows, not one, and say which is best and why in one sentence each; a person who understands the reason will not panic if the caterer is unavailable. Third, say clearly, and kindly: "This is a good moment to begin. What you do after the beginning is yours." Never say that a wrong date will bring ruin. You will only add fear to a family that is already anxious, and it is not true.

DID YOU KNOW? Indian astronomy measured its longitudes from **Ujjain**, the ancient *Ujjayini*, where Varahamihira worked and the Mahakal temple stands. The *Surya Siddhanta* places its prime meridian through Ujjain the way modern maps use Greenwich, and the Tropic of Cancer passes very near the city. India's official civil calendar, the **Saka calendar** (adopted in 1957 on the recommendation of the Calendar Reform Committee chaired by the physicist Meghnad Saha), counts years from the Saka era of 78 CE and begins its year on 22 March. And panchangas differ by region partly because the lunar months are counted two ways: **Amanta** (the month ends at the new Moon: Maharashtra, Gujarat, Karnataka, Andhra, Tamil Nadu, Kerala) and **Purnimanta** (the month ends at the full Moon: most of North India). The same dark fortnight is "Shravana Krishna" in Mumbai and "Bhadrapada Krishna" in Varanasi. When two families argue over a wedding month, this is often the whole quarrel.

In one breath

- The panchanga's five limbs (tithi, vara, nakshatra, yoga, karana) are all computed from the Sun, the Moon and the weekday.
- Tithi = the Sun-Moon angle in 12° steps, because the Moon's phase is that angle; five families (Nanda, Bhadra, Jaya, Rikta, Purna) with weekday pairings; avoid Rikta tithis (the step just before the light turns), Amavasya and Vishti/Bhadra

karana for beginnings.

- Weekday order comes from the horas: the planets in speed order read every third, the seven-pointed star.
- Nakshatras have temperaments read from their deities and symbols: fixed for foundations, movable for travel, quick for trade, soft for arts, fierce and sharp for harsh acts.
- Avoid the yogas Vyatipata and Vaidhriti above all; Rahu Kaal, Yamaganda and Gulika are eighths of the daylight assigned by tradition, not astronomy; Abhijit is the noon muhurta.
- Muhurta's four gates: a clean panchanga; a clean Lagna (fixed for permanence, benefics in kendras, malefics in 3/6/11, 8th empty); Chandra bala and Tara bala from the person's natal Moon (never the 4th, 8th or 12th; avoid Vipat, Pratyari, Vadha taras); the purpose's own rules.
- No marriage when Venus or Jupiter is combust (the two marriage karakas cannot be seen); Disha Shool gives the direction not to travel each day.
- A muhurta is a good start, not a guarantee; it cannot override the natal chart or replace effort.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. The Sun is at 10° Leo and the Moon at 22° Scorpio. Compute the tithi (name and paksha), the tithi family, and the yoga number.
2. Which day of the week is Purna-family Dashami "Siddha" on? Which family is Chaturdashi, and what does that mean for a house-warming?
3. Arjun (Chart B) has his Moon in Taurus, birth star Kritika. On a day when the Moon is in Sagittarius in Mula, is the day good for him to sign a lease? Check Chandra bala and Tara bala.
4. A friend wants to travel north-east on a Tuesday for a job interview. What does Disha Shool say, and what would you check next?
5. Sunrise is 6:40 and sunset 17:40 on a winter Saturday. Compute Rahu Kaal and Abhijit for that day.

Answers

1. Sun 10° Leo = 130°; Moon 22° Scorpio = 232°. Moon – Sun = 102° → $102 \div 12 = 8.5$ → the **9th tithi, Shukla Navami** (the Moon is less than 180° ahead, so the bright half). Navami is a **Rikta** tithi: avoid for beginnings. Yoga: $130 + 232 = 362 \rightarrow 2^\circ \rightarrow 2 \div 13^\circ 20'$ is less than 1 → yoga **1, Vishkumbha** (inauspicious). 2. Purna tithis are Siddha on **Thursday**. Chaturdashi (14) is **Rikta**, "empty": not for a house-warming; wait for Purnima or a Bhadra/Purna day. 3. Taurus to Sagittarius: Taurus 1, Gemini 2, Cancer 3, Leo 4, Virgo 5, Libra 6, Scorpio 7, **Sagittarius 8**: the Moon is in his **Chandrashtama**. Tara: Kritika (3) to Mula (19) is 17; $17 \div 9$ leaves remainder 8 → **Mitra**, good. But Chandrashtama overrides a good tara, and Mula is a *sharp* nakshatra besides. Not this day. 4. Tuesday's Disha Shool is **North**, the spiked direction, and north-east shares that sting for the cautious. If the interview cannot move, the custom offers a small remedy (eating jaggery before leaving) and the honest advice is to leave outside Rahu Kaal (3–4:30 pm on Tuesday) and Yamaganda (9–10:30 am), with the Moon in a good house from his natal Moon. Do not frighten him; an interview is not a pilgrimage. 5. Day length 11 hours = 660 minutes; one-eighth = 82.5 minutes. Saturday's Rahu Kaal is the **3rd part**: $6:40 + 2 \times 82.5 \text{ min} = \textbf{9:25 to 10:47}$. Abhijit: $660 \div 15 = 44$ minutes per muhurta; local midday is 12:10; the 8th muhurta runs **11:48 to 12:32**.

Chapter 17: Prashna: When There Is No Birth Time

A woman I read for, a friend's aunt in her sixties, had a question about her son's marriage and, when I asked for her son's birth details, produced a torn school certificate with a date and nothing else. "The midwife said evening," she offered. "Or it may have been morning." Half the people in India over a certain age have a birth time like this, and a chart without a birth time is a photograph without focus (Chapter 1).

So I did what astrologers have done for two thousand years when the birth chart is missing: I cast a chart for **that moment**, the minute she asked, at my table, and read her question from it. That is **Prashna** (the Sanskrit simply means "question"), the horary branch of Jyotish. It is the oldest branch after the calendar, it needs no birth data, and it is one of the most satisfying things you will learn, because the sky answers a question *while the person is still sitting in front of you*.

What Prashna is, and when to use it

The principle is this: **the moment a sincere question is asked is itself a birth**, the birth of the question. Cast the chart for that instant, at the place where the question is received (the astrologer's place, by tradition), with the same tools you already know: Lagna, houses, planets, aspects. Then read the chart *as the question*, not as a person.

WHY SHOULD THE MOMENT OF ASKING CARRY THE ANSWER? The system's grammar, and it is the same logic as the birth chart. Jyotish holds that anything which *begins* has a chart: a person at birth, a shop at its opening, a question at the moment it is truly asked. The chart of a beginning describes how that beginning unfolds, because the sky at that instant is the seed's pattern. A question is a beginning too: the moment a worry stops circling and becomes a spoken question, something has started, and the astrologer reads its chart the way she would read a newborn's. Everyday parallel: the first email in a thread sets the tone of the whole thread; read it carefully and you can usually guess how the exchange will go.

STORY: THE MESSENGER AT THE GATE. A messenger runs up to the palace gate with a sealed question and knocks. The court does not ask when the messenger was born. It notes which district's banner flies over the gate at that exact minute (the Prashna Lagna, the messenger himself), sees which courtiers are sitting in which rooms, and reads the answer from how the court happens to be arranged the moment the knock is heard. A knock a minute earlier or later, or at a different gate, would meet a different arrangement, which is why the moment must be the true one: when the question is really asked, where it is really received. **Rule:** cast the Prashna chart for the minute the sincere question is spoken, at the astrologer's place; the Lagna is the querent.

When do I use it?

- **No birth time, or an unreliable one.** The commonest case in India.
- **Lost objects and missing persons.** Prashna's most famous use, and its most testable.
- **Yes/no questions with a deadline.** "Will the deal close this month?" "Will my visa come?" "Will I get the job I interviewed for?"
- **As a cross-check** on a birth chart whose reading is unclear: a second, independent witness.
- **For a matter about which the birth chart is silent:** a specific event too small for a Mahadasha to show.

And when do I *not* use it? When the question is idle ("what about my career, generally?"), when the same question has been asked already and the person is shopping for a nicer answer, or when the question is about someone who has not consented. More on that under ethics.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: One question, sincerely asked, one chart. Prashna answers the question that was *asked*, not the one you wish had been asked; and it answers a burning question far more clearly than a casual one.

The mindset: sincerity is the birth time

In a natal chart, the birth time is given by the clock. In Prashna, the "birth" is the moment the question becomes real for the asker, when they stop turning it over and actually ask. The old texts insist on this: the querent should come with the question in mind, having bathed or at least composed themselves, and the astrologer should cast the chart at the moment the question is spoken, not when the appointment was booked. In practice I note the time the person *finishes* stating the question, and I do not let them ask a second question on the same chart. If they have two questions, the second gets its own chart, cast when it is asked. This is not fussiness; it is what makes the method work.

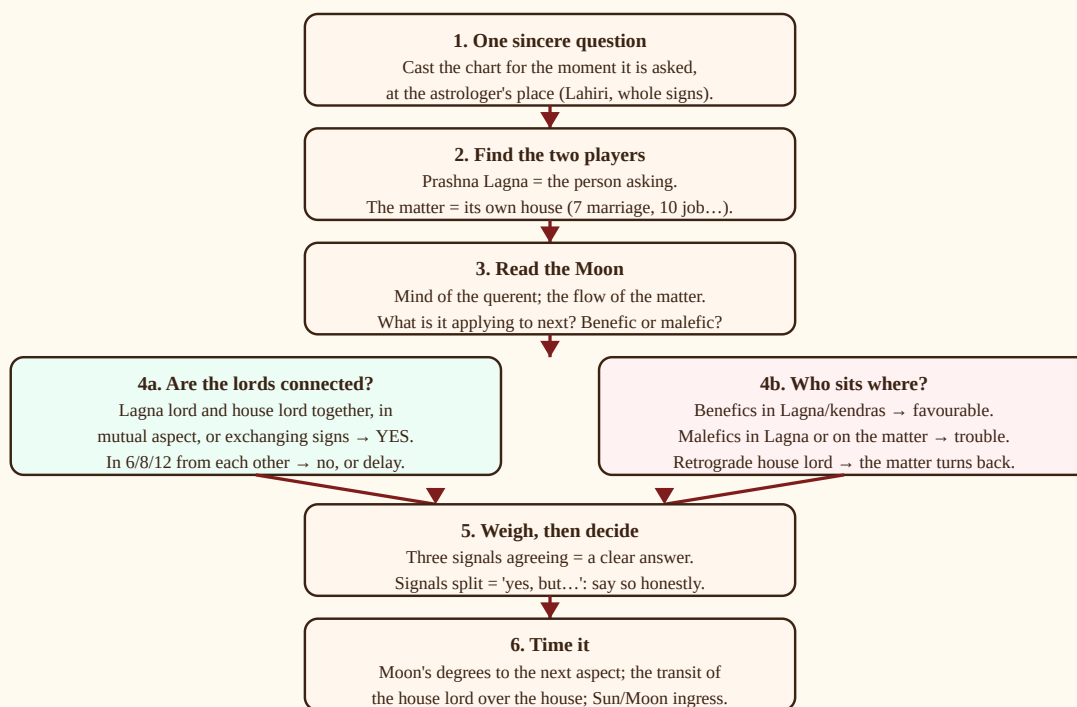
COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Casting the Prashna chart for the time the appointment was *booked*, or for the time you *finished* the reading. The chart belongs to the moment the question is spoken. If someone messages on Monday and comes on Thursday, the Thursday minute when they ask is the birth of the question, unless they asked the whole question in Monday's message, in which case Monday's minute is, and you should have noted it.

The roots

Prashna has its own classical library. **Shatpanchasika** ("fifty-six verses"), by Prithuyashas, the son of Varahamihira, 6th century, is the short, foundational text; most of the rules below descend from it. **Prashna Marga** ("the path of questions"), composed in Kerala in the 17th century by a Namboodiri astrologer, is the encyclopaedia of the subject and the backbone of the Kerala tradition, which remains the most vigorous Prashna school in India. **Krishneeya** (*Krishneeyam*), a medieval text attributed to a Krishna, is much quoted in the south for lost-object and illness questions. And the Tajaka school gave Prashna its applying-and-separating aspects through Neelakantha's **Prashna Tantra**. You do not need to read them yet; you need to know they exist, so that when a Kerala astrologer speaks of *Ashtamangala Prashna* or a Delhi astrologer of "KP horary" you know which river each stream comes from.

The method in six steps

The Prashna method in six steps



*Ethics first: no questions about another person's private life, no death questions,
and never the same question again because you disliked the first answer.*

Figure 17.1: The method on one page. Cast for the moment; identify the querent (Lagna) and the matter (its house); read the Moon; test the connection between the two lords and the company they keep; weigh; then time it.

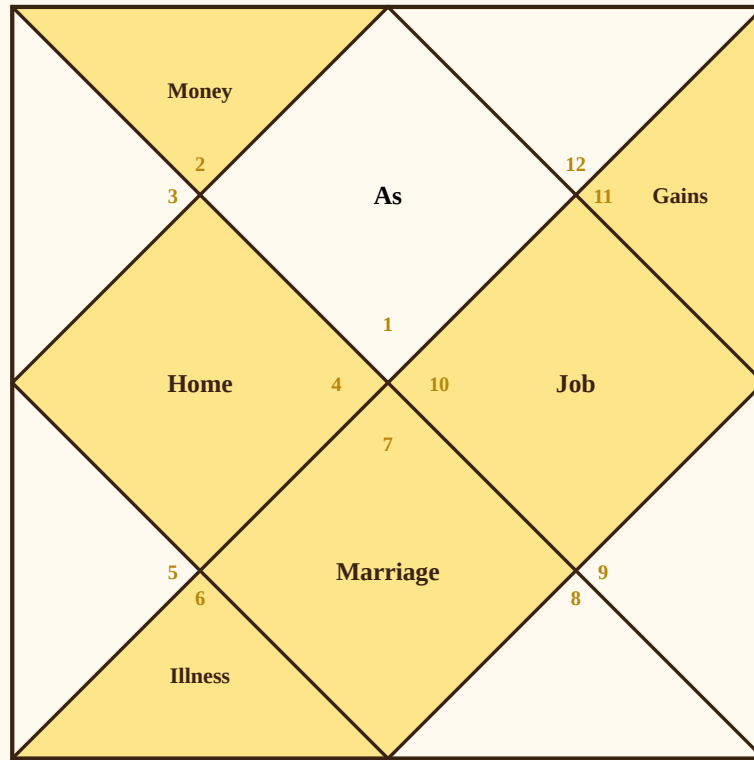
Step 1: Cast the chart for the moment

Same settings as always: Lahiri ayanamsa, sidereal zodiac, whole-sign houses. Time: the minute the question is asked. Place: where *you* are. (Some modern practitioners use the querent's location for phone consultations; the classical rule is the astrologer's place, and I keep to it: the question is "born" where it is received.)

Step 2: Identify the two players

The **Prashna Lagna is the person asking** (the querent), always, whatever the question. The **matter asked about lives in its own house**, and you know the houses from Chapter 4:

Which house holds the question?



The Lagna is always the person asking; the matter asked about lives in its own house

Figure 17.2: The querent is always the 1st house. Money lives in the 2nd (and gains in the 11th), home and lost household objects in the 4th, illness and enemies in the 6th, marriage and the "other party" in the 7th, job and career in the 10th.

Question	House (and its lord)	Also look at
Marriage: "will it happen?"	7th	Venus; the Moon applying to the 7th lord
Job, promotion, career	10th	The 6th (service), the 11th (gains); Sun, Saturn
Money, recovery of lent money	2nd, 11th	Jupiter; the 2nd for recovery of what was lost
Illness, enemies, court cases	6th (and the 8th for chronic or dangerous)	Lagna lord vs 6th lord; the Moon's condition
A lost object at home	4th	Its lord; the 7th lord as "the thief"; the 2nd for recovery
A missing sibling / a letter / a short journey	3rd	Mercury
A long journey, a visa, a foreign move	9th (long), 12th (foreign, settlement), 3rd (short)	The Lagna lord's movement
Children	5th	Jupiter
Property, vehicle, mother	4th	Venus, Moon
A partner, an opponent, the other party in any dealing	7th	Its lord's relation to the Lagna lord

The **other party** deserves a word. In every question with two sides (a marriage, a lawsuit, a negotiation, a job interview) the querent is the 1st and the other side is the **7th**. So in a job question the 10th is the job and the 7th is the employer; in a court case the 7th is the opponent; in a lost-object question the 7th lord is, by long tradition, the thief.

Step 3: Read the Moon

The Moon in Prashna does two jobs. It is the **mind of the querent**: its sign, house and condition show what state they are in, and whether the question is sincere and urgent (a Moon in the 6th, 8th or 12th, or in a sharp nakshatra like Ashlesha or Mula, often marks anxiety, confusion, or a question already half-answered). And it is the **flow of the matter**: the Moon is the fastest body, so what it is *about to do* (the next planet it will conjoin or aspect by degree) shows what comes next. Moon applying to a benefic, or to the lord of the house asked about: the matter is coming together. Moon applying to a malefic, or separating from the house lord with nothing ahead: the matter is slipping.

WHY THE MOON, FOR BOTH JOBS? Grammar and astronomy together. In the natal chart the Moon is already the mind (*manas*), so in a chart of a question it is the mind of the one asking. And astronomically the Moon is the only body that visibly moves within the hour a consultation lasts, about half a degree in that time; it is the chart's second hand, the one thing in the picture that is *going somewhere*. So the tradition reads the direction of its motion as the direction of the matter. Everyday parallel: in a still photograph of a railway platform, the one blurred figure is the person who is actually leaving; watch where they are heading.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER CARRIES THE MESSAGE. In the Prashna court the Queen Mother (the Moon) is the one who carries the messenger's sealed question from room to room, and she is the quickest walker in the palace. Watch where she is heading. If her next stop is Guru-ji's room or the room of the matter's own lord, the question is about to be answered kindly; if she is walking toward the Commander or the old Judge with nothing gentle between, the answer is delayed or harsh; if she has just left the matter's lord and is walking away, the chance has passed. Her own mood (the district she stands in, the street she walks) is the querent's state of mind. **Rule:** the Moon is the querent's mind and the flow of the matter; what it applies to next is what comes next.

Step 4: Test the connection, and the company

The connection. The heart of the judgement is the relationship between the **Lagna lord** (the querent) and the **lord of the house asked about** (the matter):

Signal	Reading
● The two lords together in one sign, in mutual aspect, or exchanging signs (Parivartana, Chapter 10)	Yes. The person and the matter are in contact
● One aspects the other, but not both	<i>Yes, with effort;</i> whichever is aspecting is doing the reaching
○ The two lords in 6, 8 or 12 from each other , no aspect	No, or a long delay. They cannot see each other
● The matter's natural karaka (Venus for marriage, Jupiter for children and money, Sun and Saturn for a job) joins the connection	The yes grows firmer

WHY DOES "CONNECTED" MEAN YES, AND 6/8/12 MEAN NO? Pure grammar of the houses. A question is a meeting between two parties: the querent (Lagna lord) and the matter (house lord). Conjunction, mutual aspect and exchange are the three ways two planets *meet* in Parashari astrology (Chapter 6 and Chapter 10), so when the lords meet, the parties meet. The 6th, 8th and 12th positions are the dusthanas (Chapter 4): from any house, its 6th is its enemy, its 8th its loss and its 12th its dissolution, and none of the three carries a Parashari aspect back to the starting house. Two lords in that relation have no door between their rooms. Everyday parallel: two colleagues on the same floor, or who at least can see each other across the office, will sort a matter out; two in different buildings with no phone line will not, however willing.

STORY: TWO COURTIERs WHO MUST MEET. Every question is a meeting between two courtiers: the lord of the door (the querent) and the lord of the room the question is about. If they sit in the same room, or can see each other across the courtyard (mutual aspect), or have swapped rooms for the day (exchange), the business is done: yes. If one can see the other but not the reverse, the one who is looking will have to do the walking: yes, with effort. But the palace has wings with no windows between them: rooms 6, 8 and 12 from each other. Two courtiers in those wings can shout all day and never be heard: no, or not until one of them moves. **Rule:** Lagna lord and house lord together, in mutual aspect or in exchange → yes; in 6/8/12 from each other → no or delay.

The company.

Signal	Reading
● Benefics in the Lagna or in the kendras (1, 4, 7, 10)	Favourable; the querent is supported
○ Malefics in the Lagna	Trouble for the querent, or a troubled state of mind
○ A malefic <i>in the house asked about</i>	Obstruction in the matter itself
● A retrograde house lord	The matter turns back, is reconsidered, or returns: excellent for a lost object, worrying for a marriage
● A combust house lord	The matter is hidden, or overpowered by an authority

Step 5: Weigh and decide

Three signals agreeing (connection, Moon, company) give a clear answer, and you may say it plainly. Signals split give "yes, but" or "no, unless", and the honest reading says which "but". Never force a split chart into a single word; the person deserves the shape of the answer, not a coin toss.

Step 6: Time it

Three tools, in order of my trust. First, **the Moon's degrees to its next exact aspect or conjunction** with the relevant planet: the classical conversion counts each degree as a day in a movable sign, a week in a dual sign, a month in a fixed sign; coarse, but often right in kind. Second, **the transit of the house lord** or of the Moon over the house asked about, or of the Sun over the Lagna or the house; the Sun's ingress into a new sign is a reliable "the matter becomes public" marker. Third, the number of signs between the two lords, read as days, weeks or months by the querent's evident urgency. Timing is the weakest part of Prashna; say "within about" and never "on".

Ithasala and Ishrafa: the Tajaka borrowing

Chapter 15 introduced the two Tajaka yogas that Prashna borrowed wholesale. **Ithasala**: the faster planet is *applying*, moving toward exact aspect (in Tajaka's geometric sense: conjunction, sextile, square, trine, opposition) with the slower, and has not yet reached it: the matter is *coming*. **Ishrafa**: the exact aspect is *past* and the faster planet is separating: the matter *was* possible and is now leaving. In a Prashna chart, look for Ithasala between the Moon and the house lord, or between the Lagna lord and the house lord; it is the sharpest yes/no tool the tradition has. Keep it labelled as Tajaka, and keep its geometric aspects out of your Parashari natal work.

The Arudha of Prashna: the sign the person touches

The South Indian schools add a beautiful device. Before the reading, the querent is asked to **touch or point to a part of a zodiac diagram** (a *rashi chakra* drawn on a board, or a set of twelve marked positions), or in Kerala to place a gold coin on it; the sign chosen is the **Arudha** (sometimes *Arudha Lagna*, a different thing from Jaimini's Arudha in Chapter 15, so mind the name). The Arudha is read beside the Prashna Lagna as a second ascendant: the Prashna Lagna is what the sky says, the Arudha is what the querent's own hand says, and their agreement or disagreement is itself a signal (Arudha in the 6th, 8th or 12th from the Prashna Lagna is unfavourable). Kerala's *Ashtamangala Prashna* elaborates this with cowrie shells, a lamp, and 108 counted shells: a full ritual I mention so that you recognise it, not so that you attempt it from a book.

Special topics

Lost objects. The most-asked Prashna in any village. The **4th house** is the object if it is a household thing; its lord's position tells you where. The **Moon in a fixed sign** → the object is still where it was put, not moved; in a movable sign → it has travelled; in a dual sign → it is between places, perhaps in a bag or vehicle. The **sign of the 4th lord** gives the **direction** (fire signs east, earth south, air west, water north, Appendix A.1) and, by its nature, the kind of place (water signs near water or damp; earth signs low, in the ground or under things; air signs high, on shelves; fire signs near the kitchen or heat). The **7th lord** stands for a thief if theft is suspected: if the 7th lord is in the Lagna or aspects it, the taker is known to the querent; in the 4th, a household member; retrograde, the object will be returned. The **2nd house** and its lord show recovery: a benefic there or the 2nd lord applying to the Lagna lord → it comes back. **Ketu** in the 4th or with the 4th lord is a classical sign the object is gone.

WHY THE 4TH FOR THE OBJECT AND THE 7TH LORD FOR THE THIEF? House grammar. The 4th is home, the room where household things live, so a lost household object is a 4th-house matter and its lord "is" the object; where the lord has gone, the object has gone. The 7th is always the *other*: the partner, the opponent, the person on the far side of any dealing (it is the house directly opposite the self). In a theft the other party is the taker, so the 7th lord stands for the thief; if that lord sits in the querent's own 1st house, the thief is someone close. The 2nd is what you hold, so it shows recovery. Everyday parallel: when a thing goes missing in a joint family, you first search the room it lives in (4th), then wonder about the one person who was *not* you (7th), and finally check whether it has come back into your hand (2nd).

STORY: THE JUDGE WALKS BACKWARDS. When a courtier walks backwards through his district (a retrograde planet) he goes over ground he has already covered, and that is exactly what a lost object needs. If the lord of the 4th room, or the 7th lord who stands for the taker, is walking backwards, the thing comes back, or the taker returns it. In a marriage question the same backward walk is less welcome: the proposal is reconsidered, the engagement retraced. **Rule:** a retrograde house lord means the matter turns back: good for recovery, cautionary for commitments.

Illness. The **6th** is disease, the **8th** danger and chronicity, the **Lagna** the patient's body. Compare the **Lagna lord and the 6th lord**: Lagna lord stronger, or in a kendra with benefics → recovery; 6th lord in the Lagna or stronger → the illness has the

upper hand. The Moon afflicted in the 6th or 8th → long convalescence. Prashna on illness is for *the course of the matter*, never for diagnosis; send the person to a doctor first and always.

Travel and settlement abroad. The **3rd** for short journeys, the **9th** for long ones, the **12th** for foreign residence. The Lagna lord in a movable sign or in the 3rd, 9th or 12th → the journey happens; in a fixed sign in the 4th → the person stays home. The 12th lord connected to the Lagna lord → settlement abroad. Saturn in the 9th → delays with papers.

Marriage. The **7th** and its lord, **Venus**, and the **Moon applying to the 7th lord**. Lagna lord and 7th lord in mutual aspect or together → yes; Venus in a kendra → soon; Venus combust or in the 6th/8th/12th → not yet. A malefic in the 7th → friction in the match or a broken engagement; Saturn there → delay but not denial.

Litigation. The querent is the **Lagna**, the opponent the **7th**. Whichever lord is stronger, better placed, and better aspected wins; the **6th** is the case itself and the **10th** the judge. Lagna lord in the 6th → the querent is the aggressor and struggles; 7th lord in the 12th → the opponent loses. Retrograde 6th lord → adjournments.

"Will I get the job?" The **10th lord**, the **Lagna lord**, and the **Moon**: any two of the three connected → yes. The **7th** is the employer; the **11th** is the offer letter and the salary. **Saturn** well placed → a job of service or a long-term post; the **Sun** strong → government or authority. We will do this one in full below.

KP: the modern horary many Indian astrologers use

You will meet astrologers who ask a person to "give a number between 1 and 249" before answering. That is **Krishnamurti Paddhati (KP)**, the system devised by K.S. Krishnamurti (1908–1972) of Tamil Nadu, and it is worth a page because it is probably the most widely used Prashna method in India today.

KP keeps the sidereal zodiac, the 27 nakshatras and the Vimshottari lords (so far, familiar) but changes three things. First, **the sub-lord**: each nakshatra is divided into nine unequal subs in Vimshottari proportions (Ketu's sub 7 parts, Venus's 20, the Sun's 6, and so on out of 120), and KP's central claim is that **the sub-lord of a house cusp decides whether that house gives its result**, and the star-lord decides *how*. Second, **Placidus houses**: KP uses the unequal Western house cusps, so a house can begin in the middle of a sign, and the cusp's sign-lord, star-lord and sub-lord are each read. Third, **the ruling planets**: at the moment of judgement, the lords of the weekday, the Moon's sign and star, and the Lagna's sign and star are taken as the planets "ruling" the question, and used for timing. The **1–249 number** is the KP horary shortcut: the zodiac's 249 subs are numbered, the querent chooses one, and the Lagna is set to the start of that sub, so the querent's own choice, not the clock, fixes the ascendant, and the rest of the chart is cast for the time of judgement. KP also uses its own ayanamsa, a few minutes of arc from Lahiri, and it sets aside yogas and most Parashari aspects in favour of significators by star and sub.

WHY SUBDIVIDE THE NAKSHATRA AT ALL? Krishnamurti's own stated reasoning, and it is a logical extension of the Vimshottari grammar. The sign (30°) gives a broad reading; the nakshatra (13°20') gives a finer one, and it already carries a Vimshottari lord. He argued that if the nakshatra could be divided in the same Vimshottari proportions once more, each sub of a degree or two would carry a third lord, and that lord would decide the *outcome* where sign and star only describe the *field*. Finer division, finer answer; and a horary number that picks one of 249 subs pins the ascendant to a couple of degrees, sharper than any clock. Everyday parallel: a PIN code narrows a letter to a city; the street name to a lane; the house number to a door. KP wants the house number.

Its relationship to Parashari: same planets, same stars, same dasha; different houses, a different unit of judgement (the sub), and a deliberately mechanical yes/no style that many find refreshingly clear. I do not teach it in this book (it is a system, not a technique, and deserves its own) but I want you to recognise it, respect its results when they are good, and never mix Placidus

cusps or sub-lords into a whole-sign Parashari chart. Mixing systems is the beginner's disease in every branch of astrology, and Prashna is where the temptation is strongest.

DID YOU KNOW? Horary astrology was once the *main* work of court astrologers from Baghdad to Ujjain. The Arabic and Persian masters of the 9th to 12th centuries, whose methods entered India as Tajaka, treated the natal chart as a luxury and the question chart as the daily tool, because most people simply did not know when they were born. The 17th-century English astrologer William Lilly built a career, and a famous book, on exactly the lost-object and "will I marry" questions that Indian village astrologers were answering at the same time, with much the same rules. The method is older than the birth chart's popularity and it has not changed much because it did not need to.

Ethics: the three refusals

Prashna is powerful and intimate, and it needs rules the natal chart does not.

No question about another person's private matters without their consent. "Is my husband having an affair?" "Will my brother's business fail?" The sky may show something, but the person concerned did not ask and did not agree. The exception is a parent asking about a minor child, or a family asking about someone missing or unwell who cannot ask. Otherwise, gently decline: "I can read *your* question (what should you do about this?) but not his private life."

No death questions. Not "when will he die", not "will she survive the operation", not from anyone, for any fee. The tradition forbids it, it is nearly always wrong in the specifics, and even when it is right it does harm. Illness questions are answered as *course and care*, never as life and death.

Do not repeat the question. A chart answers once. If the person dislikes the answer and asks again next week, the second chart is not a second opinion; it is noise, and the classical texts say it lies. If the *situation* genuinely changes, a new question may be asked; a change of mood is not a change of situation.

And one more, mine rather than the texts': **do not create urgency.** Prashna's timing tools are the weakest part of the method, and a nervous person will hear "within about three weeks" as a countdown. Say "around" and mean it.

A full worked Prashna

Let me construct one from beginning to end. The chart is constructed for teaching, with positions plausible for the date.

The question. A young man, aged around thirty, asks: "*Will I get the job I interviewed for last week?*" Asked at **10:15 am, 3 October 2026, Delhi**, at my table. He states it clearly and stops. I note the time.

The chart. At 10:15 on an early-October morning in Delhi, about four hours after sunrise, **Libra** is rising; I take the Lagna at about 20° Libra. The Sun, in early October, is at about 16° sidereal Virgo. Placing the rest plausibly for the date:

Planet	Sign, degree	House from Libra	Signal for the question
Sun	Virgo 16°	12th	• The authority is out of sight
Mercury	Libra 3°	1st	• Benefic in the Lagna
Venus	Libra 14°	1st	• Lagna lord strong in own sign
Mars	Scorpio 10°	2nd	• Heat in the money house
Jupiter	Cancer 20°	10th	• Exalted benefic in the matter's house
Saturn (retrograde)	Pisces 6°	6th	• Service house; process repeats
Rahu	Aquarius 2°	5th	• Not touching Lagna or 10th
Ketu	Leo 2°	11th	• In the offer house, but quiet
Moon	Aries 8° (Ashwini)	7th	• 10th lord applying to Lagna lord

The Moon at 8° Aries is 202° ahead of the Sun: the second tithi after the full Moon, Krishna Dwitiya, still bright and strong. Mercury, at 17° from the Sun, is outside its 14° combustion orb; Venus is at 28°. (For any real question you will let the software place the planets; the *reasoning* below is what you are learning.)

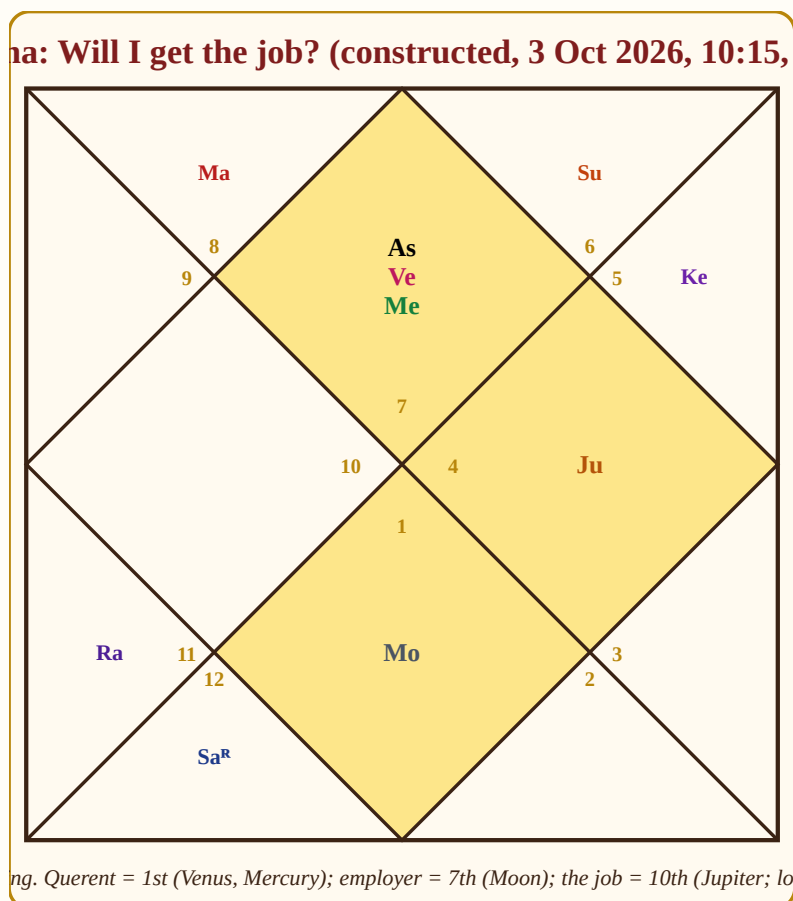


Figure 17.3: The Prashna chart. Libra rises with Venus (its own lord) and Mercury in the 1st: the querent. The Moon, lord of the 10th (the job), sits in the 7th (the employer). Jupiter is exalted in the 10th. The Sun, the authority, is in the 12th. Saturn is retrograde in the 6th, the house of service.

Step 2, the players. Querent = Lagna, Libra; Lagna lord **Venus**, in the Lagna itself, in its own sign, with Mercury: a composed, articulate, well-presented querent who is in a strong position. The matter = the **10th house, Cancer**, whose lord is the **Moon**.

The employer = the **7th house, Aries**, lord Mars. The offer and salary = the 11th (Leo) and 2nd (Scorpio).

Step 3, the Moon. The Moon, both the querent's mind and the 10th lord, the job itself, sits in the **7th house**, the employer's house, in Aries, a movable sign: the job is in the employer's hands right now and the matter is moving quickly. The Moon is bright (two days past full), in Ashwini, a quick nakshatra. It is at 8° Aries, and Venus is at 14° Libra, exactly opposite: the Moon is **applying**, six degrees from an exact aspect with the Lagna lord, a textbook Ithasala between the 10th lord and the Lagna lord. The matter is coming toward the querent, and fast (six degrees in a movable sign → about six days for the first signal).

Step 4, the connection and the company. Lagna lord Venus in Libra; 10th lord Moon in Aries: they are in **mutual 7th-house aspect**, a full aspect each way. The querent and the job see each other. That alone is a yes. The company: **Jupiter, exalted in Cancer, in the 10th**: a great benefic, in its exaltation sign, sitting in the house asked about. (For a Libra Lagna Jupiter owns the 3rd and 6th and is not this Lagna's functional friend, Appendix A.6; but in a Prashna the natural benefic's strength in the *matter's* house is the louder signal, and the 6th lord, *service*, sitting in the 10th, *career*, is almost a literal sentence: "employment in the career house".) Benefics in the Lagna: Venus and Mercury. Benefics in kendras: Venus, Mercury (1st), Moon (7th), Jupiter (10th). No malefic in the Lagna or the 10th. Saturn, Libra's yogakaraka and the karaka of service, is **retrograde in the 6th, the house of service**: the job is real, but the process doubles back on itself, a second round or a repeated document. Mars in the 2nd, own sign: a firm, slightly heated salary conversation. The **Sun in the 12th**: the final authority, the person who signs, is behind a closed door, away, or in another office; the approval is not in the interviewer's hands.

Step 5, the decision. Three signals agree: the mutual aspect of the lords, the applying Moon, and the exalted benefic in the 10th with a clean Lagna. **Yes**: he gets the job. The "but": Saturn retrograde in the 6th and the Sun in the 12th say the confirmation comes in two stages and the formal letter waits on an authority who is not yet visible.

Step 6, the timing. The Moon reaches exact aspect with Venus in about six degrees: the first signal (a call, a second-round invitation, an informal "you are selected") within about a week. The **Sun enters Libra, the Prashna Lagna, around 17 October**: the authority walks into the querent's house; the formal offer should follow in the second half of October. Saturn's retrograde in the 6th warns of one repetition (a document to resend, a medical, a reference re-checked) before the letter. I would say: *"Yes. Expect the first good news within a week, the formal letter after the middle of October, and one round of paperwork you thought was finished. Negotiate the salary firmly but not hotly; Mars is in your money house."*

What I would not say: "Yes, on the 19th." Prashna does not know the date. It knows the shape.

CONSULTATION TIP: Give a Prashna answer in three sentences (the answer, the shape, the action) and stop. "Yes; in two stages, with the letter after mid-October; meanwhile keep your references warm." Someone who asks a Prashna came for a decision, not a lecture, and a short clear answer is what earns the trust to be asked the next, harder question. If the chart says no, say it as *"not this one"*, name what the chart shows blocking it, and turn at once to what the querent can do: the 11th house, the next opening, the timing of the next attempt. Prashna is a lamp, not a gavel.

In one breath

- Prashna casts a chart for the moment a sincere question is asked, at the astrologer's place, and reads the question from it; it needs no birth time. A beginning is a birth, and a question is a beginning.
- One question, sincerely asked, one chart; never the same question twice.
- The Lagna is the querent; the matter lives in its own house (7th marriage, 10th job, 2nd/11th money, 6th illness, 4th lost household objects); the 7th is always the other party, which is why its lord is the thief.
- The Moon is the querent's mind and the flow of the matter, because it is the mind in every chart and the only body visibly moving during the hour; what it applies to next is what comes next.

- Lagna lord and house lord together, in mutual aspect, or exchanging → yes (the parties meet); in 6/8/12 from each other → no or delay (no door between the rooms); benefics in Lagna and kendras favour, malefics in the Lagna or the matter obstruct.
- Time by the Moon's degrees to its next aspect, by the house lord's or the Sun's transit, and always say "around".
- Ithasala (applying) and Ishrafa (separating) are Tajaka borrowings; the Arudha of Prashna is the South's touched-sign method; KP is the modern sub-lord horary with its 1–249 number, finer division for a finer answer. Recognise all three, mix none into Parashari.
- Ethics: no third-party private questions without consent, no death questions, no repeats, no manufactured urgency.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. A question about marriage is asked with Capricorn rising. Saturn is in Capricorn; the Moon (7th lord) is in Virgo. Is the connection a yes, a no, or a delay? What else would you check?
2. A lost-objects question: Taurus rising, the 4th lord Sun is in Sagittarius, the Moon is in Leo. Where would you look, and has the object moved?
3. In a job question with Aries rising, Mars is in the 8th and the 10th lord Saturn is in Aries. Read the connection and the company.
4. Someone asks whether her neighbour's daughter will marry this year. What do you do?
5. In the worked example above, suppose the Moon had been at 8° Aries but Venus at 2° Libra. What changes in the reading?

Answers

1. Lagna lord Saturn is in the Lagna; the 7th lord Moon is in Virgo, the **9th** from Capricorn, not 6, 8 or 12. Saturn aspects the 3rd, 7th and 10th from itself (Pisces, Cancer, Libra), so it does not aspect Virgo; the Moon's 7th aspect falls on Pisces, not on Saturn. No direct connection, but no 6/8/12 separation either: a **"yes, with effort and delay"**; Saturn in the Lagna also says the querent is patient and the matter slow. Check Venus (marriage karaka) and what the Moon applies to next; if the Moon is heading toward a benefic aspect with Venus or Saturn, the yes strengthens. 2. The 4th lord Sun is in **Sagittarius**, a **fire** sign → **east**; a fire sign suggests a warm place: near the kitchen, a heater, or where sunlight falls. Sagittarius is a dual sign and the Sun is in the 8th from Taurus: hidden, tucked away. The **Moon is in Leo**, a fixed sign → the object has **not moved**; it is where it was put, probably under or behind something in the eastern part of the home. Check the 7th lord Mars: if it is with the Sun or in the Lagna, someone took it; if not, it was merely misplaced. 3. Lagna lord Mars in the **8th** (Scorpio): the querent is anxious, feels kept in the dark, and is in a weak position. The 10th lord Saturn in **Aries**, the Lagna, is in the **6th** from Mars (a 6/8 relationship) and neither aspects the other (Mars glances at Aquarius, Taurus and Gemini; Saturn at Gemini, Libra and Capricorn). By the rule, **no, or a long delay**. The company confirms it: Saturn is debilitated in Aries (Appendix A.2), a weak malefic sitting on the querent; the job knocks at his door in a poor form, with heavy conditions, while his own position is unstable. Reading: **"not this one, or not on these terms"**. Check the Moon's next aspect before answering; only a Moon applying to Saturn or Mars would soften this to a delayed yes. 4. **Decline the question as asked.** The neighbour's daughter has not consented, and her marriage is her private matter. Offer what can honestly be read: the asker's own question ("how should I respond to this family's proposal for my son?") cast as **her** Prashna, or, if the daughter herself wishes, her own question in her own words. 5. With Venus at 2° Libra and the Moon at 8° Aries, the Moon is **six degrees past** the exact opposition: an **Ishrafa**, separating. The mutual aspect by sign still stands (a whole-sign yes), but the Tajaka refinement says the moment of closest contact has **just passed**: the position may already have been decided, possibly for someone else, or the offer has been

made to another and may fall to the querent only if that person declines. The reading softens from "yes, fast" to "yes if the first choice falls through; otherwise not this one", and honesty requires saying so.

Chapter 18: Career and Wealth, "What Work Suits Me, and Will I Have Money?"

Of the people who ask me to look at their charts, most ask about work or money before anything else. Not marriage, not health, work. "Should I take the transfer?" "Will my business run?" "My son has finished engineering and wants to become a chef; will he starve?" And underneath every one of these questions is the same two-part worry: *what am I meant to be doing, and will it feed my family?*

This chapter gives you a method for both halves. Seventeen chapters have built the grammar; now we use it the way a client needs it. You get a checklist to run in the same order every time, two worked charts, and the exact words I use at the table, because how you say it matters as much as what you find.

One promise before we begin. I have promised myself never to tell a young person "you will not succeed": not because I am soft, but because the chart cannot say it. A chart shows *which road is downhill for you*. It never says you cannot climb.

The career triad: three questions, not one

Beginners look at the 10th house and stop. That is like judging a restaurant by its signboard. The 10th tells you *what you do*; it says nothing about whether you are paid well for it, or whether you do it as an employee or your own boss. For those you need two more sets of houses.

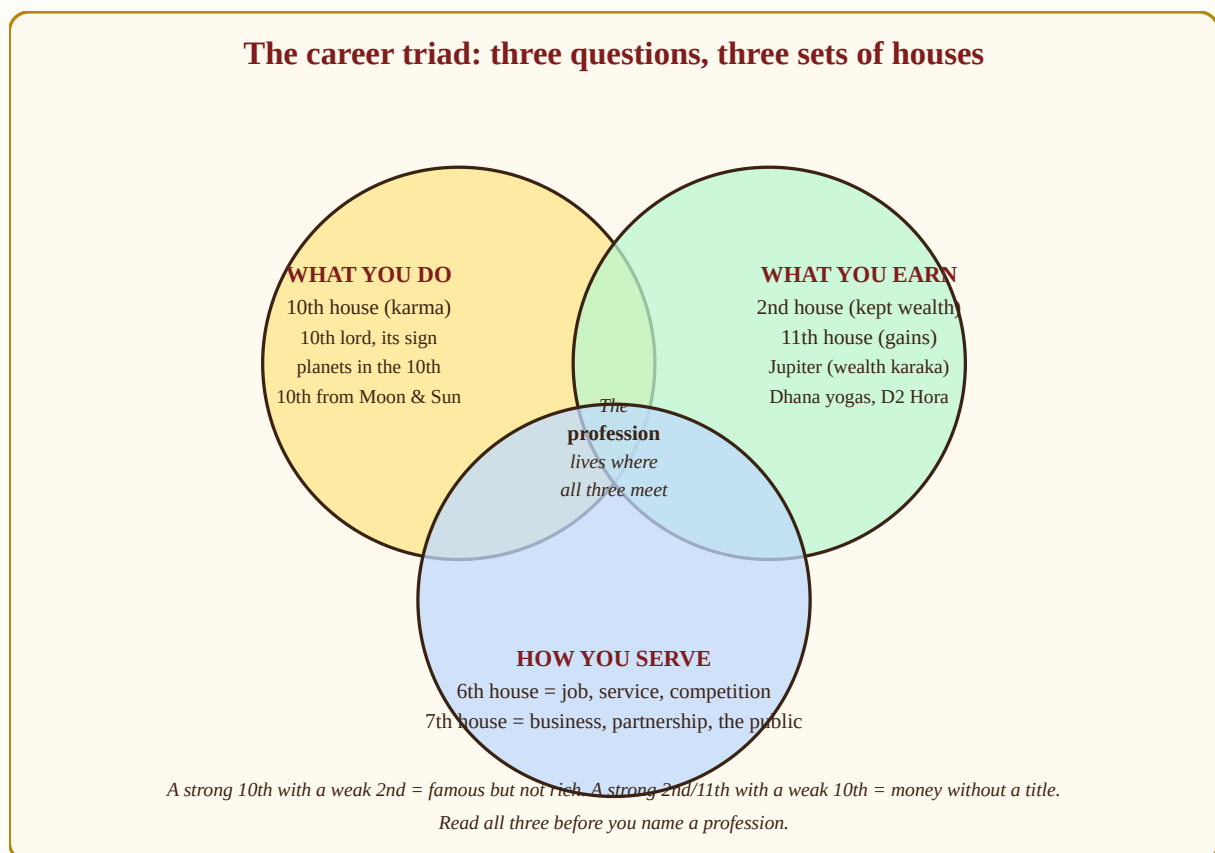


Figure 18.1: The career triad. The profession a person actually lives is found where all three circles overlap.

What you do: the 10th house (Karma bhava). The 10th is the top of the chart, the midday Sun, the most visible point. Whatever sits here is seen by the world. Its lord, the sign on it, its occupants and the planets that aspect it describe the *shape* of your work: leadership or service, hands or head, public or private.

WHY? (Astronomy, then logic.) The 10th house is the meridian, the point directly overhead where the Sun stands at noon. Nothing in the sky is more visible than what is there. So the 10th became the house of what the world sees you doing: your public action, your karma in the plain sense of "work". Everyday parallel: a shop sign facing the main road. Whatever is painted on it is what the whole town believes you do.

What you earn: the 2nd and the 11th. The 2nd house (Dhana) is what you *keep*: savings, family wealth, the food on the table, and, remember from Chapter 4, speech, which is why so many people earn through their voice. The 11th (Labha) is what *comes in*: gains, income streams, the networks that send work your way. A chart can have a magnificent 10th and a hollow 2nd (the famous man who dies in a rented room is a real type) or a modest 10th and a fat 11th: the quiet trader who owns four buildings.

WHY? (Logic from the system's grammar.) The 2nd is the house next to the self: what you hold close, in hand and mouth, so food, speech and stored wealth. The 11th is the 2nd from the 10th, that is, the "holdings" produced by your work: earnings. It is also the 6th from the 6th, enemies of your enemies, so it is gains that overcome obstacles. Parallel: the 11th is the salary credited on the first; the 2nd is what is still in the account on the thirtieth.

How you serve: the 6th and the 7th. This pair is the least taught and the most useful. The 6th house is service, competition, daily routine, the boss above you: in plain words, *a job*. The 7th house is partnership, the public, other people's money coming to you across a counter: in plain words, *business*. Also recall the Bhavat Bhavam idea (Appendix A.5): the 10th from the 10th is the 7th, so the 7th is a second career house in its own right. That is the classical reason the 7th shows business.

WHY? (Logic.) The 6th is the 12th from the 7th: the loss of the "other party" as an equal, which is what an employee agrees to. You surrender independence for a fixed reward, under someone's roster. The 7th is the other person you meet as an equal: the customer across the counter, the partner who signs beside you. Parallel: the same cook can be a salaried employee in a canteen (6th) or run her own tiffin service for the same customers (7th).

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: 10th = the title on your visiting card. 2nd and 11th = the balance in your passbook. 6th and 7th = whether the card says "Manager" or "Proprietor". Read all three before you open your mouth.

STORY: THREE ROOMS OF THE HAVELI. Walk through the old family haveli with me. The 10th house is the *workshop* on the roof terrace, open to the sky, where the world can see what you make, the King likes to inspect it at noon. The 2nd and 11th are the *treasury*: the 2nd is the locked iron chest where the family gold is kept, the 11th the front counter where the day's takings come in. And the 6th and 7th are the *servants' hall* and the *shop front*: in the 6th you work for the household under the old Judge's roster; in the 7th you open your own door onto the market and deal with strangers. A friend once asked me why his brilliant workshop had never filled the chest. His treasury doors, I showed him, opened outward, the 12th was stronger than the 2nd. **Rule:** 10th = what you do; 2nd and 11th = what you earn and keep; 6th and 7th = job or business. Judge career from all three rooms.

Job or business? Reading the 6th against the 7th

This is the question I am asked most by people in their late twenties, and the chart answers it fairly reliably.

The chart leans toward service (a job) when: the 6th house or its lord is strong, occupied, or connected to the 10th; Saturn (the servant of the court, discipline, hierarchy) or Mercury (the clerk, the secretary) influence the 10th or its lord; the 10th lord sits in the 6th; or the 10th falls in a fixed sign with Saturn's aspect. Give such people structure and they build empires *for* someone.

The chart leans toward business when: the 7th and 10th are connected; Mercury (trade), Venus (goods, pleasures, luxury) or Jupiter (counsel, finance) sit in or rule the 7th or 10th; planets in the 10th are in their own signs (a planet in its own house does not like to take orders); the 10th lord is in the 7th or the 11th; or Mars in strength gives the appetite for risk. These people chafe under a boss by thirty.

Special flavours in the 10th:

- **Sun or Mars in the 10th**, Sun has directional strength here (Appendix A.2); this is the classic signature of authority, government, administration, uniformed service, and any work where one gives orders.
- **Rahu in the 10th**, foreign connection, technology, the unconventional, a career that did not exist a generation ago. Rahu here is ambitious and often climbs high by an unusual door.
- **Ketu in the 10th**, the headless ascetic in the career house. Either frequent changes and a detachment from ambition, or a career that is itself research or spiritual work: astrology, healing, mathematics, coding. Ketu here does not mean "no career"; it means the person cannot fake enthusiasm for work that has no meaning for them.

STORY: SALARIED IN THE JUDGE'S OFFICE, OR YOUR OWN SHOP IN THE MARKET. *Two cousins left the village together. One took a post in Shani-ji's office, the old Judge of Labour keeps strict hours, pays on the first of the month, and promotes slowly but surely; the young Prince Mercury sits at the next desk keeping the ledgers. That is the 6th house: service, routine, a roof over your head that someone else owns. The other cousin rented a stall in the 7th-house market, where Shukracharya sells silks, Mercury brokers deals and Guru-ji advises for a fee. No salary, no roster, but every planet sitting in its own sign refuses to take orders, and every strong 7th wants its own signboard. The first cousin thought the second reckless; the second thought the first asleep. Both were reading their charts correctly. Rule: 6th strong, Saturn/Mercury on the 10th → service. 7th–10th linked, Mercury/Venus/Jupiter or own-sign planets there → business.*

Many charts are mixed, a job first, a business after forty, or employment that behaves like a practice (doctors, lawyers, consultants). Say so: "Your chart supports both; the first half looks structured, and after your Rahu period begins you will want your own name on the door."

Naming the profession: the four sources

Now the harder question: not job or business, but *which field*. Classical texts give a beautiful rule for this, and it is a good example of why our tradition tells us to read from three reference points.

Judge the 10th house from the Lagna, from the Moon and from the Sun. Whichever of the three is strongest: most occupied, best-dignified lord, describes the profession. (Chapter 9 reminded you always to check a house from the Moon as well as from the Lagna; here the Sun joins in, because the Sun is the natural karaka of the 10th and of one's standing in the world.)

WHY? (Classical statement, with a logic behind it.) Parashara and Varahamihira both direct the astrologer to judge livelihood from the 10th counted from the Lagna, the Moon and the Sun. The reason: the Lagna is the body and its circumstances, the Moon is the mind and what it enjoys, the Sun is the soul and its standing. Work lives in all three. Parallel: before a wedding, families ask three different relatives about the same boy, because each sees a different side of him.

From these three 10th houses, gather four pieces of evidence:

1. **The sign of the 10th lord.** Where does the ruler of your career house sit? A 10th lord in a fire sign works with energy, leadership and heat; in water, with emotions, people and liquids; in air, with ideas, trade and communication; in earth, with material, money and land.
2. **Planets in the 10th.** An occupant of the 10th is louder than its lord.
3. **The planet in the 10th from the Moon and from the Sun.** These are often the "what I really enjoy" and "what gives me respect" layers.
4. **The Dasamsa (D10).** Chapter 11 introduced this divisional chart of career; the sign on the D10 Lagna and the planets in its 10th house confirm or refine what D1 says. If D1 and D10 agree, speak with confidence. If they disagree, the person often has a public role and a private skill that differ.

If the 10th is empty from all three points, judge by its lord, and by the planet whose dasha is running, people change lanes with their dashas.

The planet-to-profession table

STORY: WHAT EACH COURTIER DOES WHEN HE LEAVES THE COURT. *Imagine the court dissolved for a year and every courtier sent to earn his own bread. The King opens a government office or a hospital and gives orders. The Queen Mother runs a guest-house and feeds the town. The Commander joins the police, or builds houses, or operates. The young Prince opens a shop, an accountancy, a newspaper, a coaching class. Guru-ji teaches, judges, banks and blesses. Shukracharya opens a boutique, a jewellery house, a cinema. Shani-ji goes to the mines and the fields, the iron foundry and the old-age home, and is the last to leave every evening. The Smoke-headed Stranger sells foreign machines, flies aeroplanes and speculates. The Headless Sadhu sits under a tree doing mathematics and reading horoscopes. Nobody had to tell them where to go; their characters chose. Rule: a planet's profession is its court character taken to the market. Derive the table; never memorise it.*

Here is the table I keep in my head. Every row follows from the planet's character in Chapter 3. The dot shows the planet's natural nature at work (● benefic, ○ malefic, ◐ mixed or conditional); a malefic does not mean a bad career (the navy Saturn builds the longest ones); it means the work is harder and slower.

WHY? (Derivation from the karakatwas in Appendix A.2, with tradition for the modern fields.) Each row is the planet's significations taken to the market: the Sun signifies authority and government, so government and administration; the Moon signifies the public and fluids, so hospitality and nursing; Mars signifies blood and land, so surgery and real estate; Saturn signifies labour and old age, so mines and elderly care. Aviation for Rahu and coding for Ketu are the tradition's extensions, not the classics. Parallel: you can guess a person's trade from what they talk about at a wedding dinner.

Planet	Nature	Fields it points to
Sun	● mild malefic	Government, administration, medicine, politics, leadership, father's line of work
Moon	● benefic when bright	Dealing with the public, hospitality, nursing, liquids, women's goods, psychology, food
Mars	○ malefic	Engineering, army and police, surgery, sports, real estate and construction, mechanical trades
Mercury	● takes its company's nature	Commerce, accounting, writing, teaching, IT and communication, law, brokering
Jupiter	● great benefic	Teaching, law, finance, priesthood, counselling, banking, publishing
Venus	● benefic	Arts, fashion, beauty, entertainment, luxury goods, hospitality, jewellery, design
Saturn	○ great malefic	Labour, mining, oil, iron and heavy industry, real estate, agriculture, the judiciary, elderly care, long-term institutions
Rahu	○ shadow malefic	Technology, foreign trade, aviation, pharmaceuticals, photography and film, speculation, politics
Ketu	○ shadow malefic	Research, mathematics, astrology, coding, diagnostic medicine, spiritual work

The sign-to-field table

The sign of the 10th house (and of the 10th lord) tints the planet's field:

Sign of the 10th / 10th lord	Field and style
Aries	Initiative, engineering, defence, sport, surgery, starting things
Taurus	Finance, food, agriculture, luxury goods, music, steady wealth
Gemini	Communication, writing, sales, teaching, media, dual careers
Cancer	Public service, hospitality, nursing, real estate, the sea, the home
Leo	Government, administration, management, performance, politics
Virgo	Accounting, analysis, medicine, editing, IT, service professions
Libra	Law, diplomacy, arts, fashion, trade, partnerships
Scorpio	Research, surgery, insurance, occult sciences, investigation, chemicals
Sagittarius	Teaching, law, religion, philosophy, publishing, foreign relations
Capricorn	Administration, industry, engineering, mining, construction, long climbs
Aquarius	Technology, science, social work, large organisations, networks
Pisces	Healing, hospitals, spirituality, arts, charity, liquids, foreign shores

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Reading the table as a menu of exactly one dish. The 10th lord Mercury in Leo does not mean "accountant in the government". It means the person communicates and manages information, in a setting where authority and visibility matter, that could be a management consultant, a school principal, a political speech-writer or the head of an IT department. Give the client the *shape*, and let them recognise the specific chair.

The Amatyakaraka: a second opinion from Jaimini

Chapter 15 introduced the Jaimini karakas, the planets ranked by their degree within their signs. The one with the second-highest degree is the **Amatyakaraka** (AmK), the "minister" of the soul, the planet that shows how you make your living, the skill you carry into the world. When the Parashari 10th house is confusing, I look at the AmK. If it agrees with the 10th, speak firmly. If it adds a new flavour, mention it: "Your career house shows teaching; your minister-planet is Venus, so the teaching may be in an artistic or people-centred field."

Timing career events

A profession is a road; the dashas tell you when you walk fast, when you rest, and where the bridge is. Chapters 13 and 14 gave you the tools; here is how I apply them to career.

Periods that raise the career:

- The **Mahadasha or Antardasha of the 10th lord**, especially if that lord is well placed.
- The dasha of **any planet sitting in the 10th** (from Lagna or Moon).
- The dasha of a **yogakaraka** or a planet forming a Raja yoga with the 10th lord (Chapter 10).
- **Rahu's dasha**, when Rahu is well placed (especially in the 3rd, 6th, 10th or 11th): sudden rises, foreign postings, big titles that arrive faster than expected, and the person must be warned to build foundations under them.

Transits that release the timing:

- The **double transit** (Chapter 14): when Jupiter and Saturn, by position or aspect, both touch the 10th house or its lord in the same season, career events happen. Promotions, new jobs, launches. This is my single most reliable timing tool for work.
- **Saturn's transit over the 10th from the Moon**: I call it "Saturn on the job". For about two and a half years the person feels the weight of responsibility, works harder for less praise, and usually comes out promoted or in a completely new line. Do not call it a bad period. Call it the apprenticeship.
- **Jupiter transiting the 10th, 2nd or 11th** from the Moon (its good houses in Appendix A.9 include 2 and 11): recognition, income, new offers.

WHY? (Astronomy and logic.) Saturn spends about two and a half years in a sign, so its stay over the 10th from the Moon is a long season, not a mood. The 10th from the Moon is work as the mind experiences it. Saturn is the Judge of Labour: load, deadlines, accountability. Put the slowest planet of duty on the house where the mind feels its work, and you get two and a half years of "why is everything so heavy". Parallel: the audit year in an office, when every file is checked and the good staff come out promoted.

Job changes. The 12th house from any house is its ending. The 12th from the 10th is the 9th, so a strong activation of the 9th (its lord's dasha, or Saturn/Jupiter on the 9th) often coincides with leaving a job, sometimes for a better one, sometimes for study or travel. Transits of Saturn or Rahu over the 8th house (sudden endings, the hidden) also mark disruptions at work. And a job change during the 6th lord's period is usually a lateral move within service; during the 7th lord's period, a move toward independence.

Business start. Look for the dasha of the 7th lord or of a planet in the 7th, a Jupiter transit over the 7th or 10th, and Mars strong by transit (courage to sign the lease). I also want the 2nd and 11th supported by the running dasha, a business launched in the 12th lord's dasha with nothing else behind it tends to eat capital.

Foreign career. The 12th house (foreign lands), the 9th (long journeys), Rahu (the foreigner at the gate), and movable signs on the Lagna, 10th or 12th. When the 10th lord sits in the 12th or the 9th, or with Rahu, or the 12th lord is strong in its own sign, the career has a foreign chapter. Time it with the dasha of the 12th or 9th lord and with Rahu's periods.

DID YOU KNOW? The classical rule of judging the 10th from the Lagna, Moon *and* Sun is stated in Parashara and repeated in *Brihat Jataka*. Varahamihira goes further in his chapter on livelihood (*Karmajiva*): he says to take the lord of the sign occupied by the 10th lord, and read the profession from *that* planet's Navamsa sign, a rule some modern teachers still use as a tie-breaker.

Wealth: will I have money, and will it stay?

Career says what you do; wealth is a separate question with its own houses. People with modest work and quiet money are common; people with big titles and no savings are more common still.

The Dhana yogas (Chapter 10 reminder). Wealth combinations form when the lords of the 2nd, 5th, 9th and 11th, and the Lagna lord, connect with each other by conjunction, mutual aspect or exchange. The 2nd lord with the 11th lord in the 2nd, the 5th lord with the 9th lord, the Lagna lord with the 2nd lord: these are the money knots. Count how many such links a chart has; three or more and the person will not want for money in the dashas of those planets.

The 2nd and 11th lords. Where they sit and how strong they are (Chapter 12) decide the *size* of the passbook. The 2nd lord in a kendra or trikona, in its own or exalted sign, means savings accumulate. The 11th lord well placed means income keeps arriving. Either of them in the 6th, 8th or 12th means the money comes with friction, debts, losses, expenses abroad, unless a Viparita yoga rescues it.

Jupiter, the karaka of wealth. Whatever the houses say, check Jupiter's dignity. Jupiter exalted, in its own sign or in a kendra gives a fundamental "wealth floor", such people are rarely destitute even in bad periods. Jupiter debilitated, combust or in the 6th/8th/12th from the Lagna means money must be earned with more effort, and saved with discipline.

WHY? (Derivation, then symbolism.) Appendix A.5 makes Jupiter the natural karaka of the 2nd, 5th, 9th and 11th, the very houses that form Dhana yogas: holdings, merit, fortune and gains. Why those four? Because 2 and 11 are money in hand and money arriving, while 5 and 9 are the trikonas of merit and grace, the luck you did not work for. Jupiter is the priest who receives offerings and distributes them, the planet of expansion. Parallel: a family that has a salary (11), savings (2) and, now and then, an unexpected windfall (5, 9) is wealthy in every sense.

The Hora chart (D2) in one paragraph. Chapter 11 mentioned it. In the D2 every planet falls either in the Sun's hora or the Moon's hora (the two halves of a sign). The traditional reading: more planets in the Moon's hora, wealth accumulated steadily with less struggle; more in the Sun's hora, wealth won through effort and authority. Use it only as a tint, never as a verdict.

The 5th and the 8th. The 5th is speculation, a strong 5th lord linked to the 2nd or 11th makes an investor; afflicted by Rahu, a gambler, and I say so gently. The 8th is inheritance, insurance, windfalls and the spouse's money; benefics there mean unearned money arrives at some point.

"Money comes but doesn't stay." You will hear this more than any other sentence. Look for a 12th stronger than the 2nd, Rahu or malefics in the 2nd (Saturn blocks, Mars spends, Ketu does not care), or the 2nd lord in the 12th. The remedy is rarely a gemstone; it is a budgeting habit begun in the right dasha.

Here are the wealth signals side by side, colour-coded:

Signal	Reading
● Lords of 2, 5, 9, 11 and Lagna connected (Dhana yoga)	Money knots; wealth in those planets' periods
● 2nd/11th lord in kendra, trikona, own or exalted sign	Savings accumulate; income keeps arriving
● Jupiter exalted, own sign or in a kendra	A wealth floor; rarely destitute
● More planets in the Moon's hora (D2)	Steadier accumulation (a tint, not a verdict)
● Strong 5th lord linked to 2nd/11th	Good investor; with Rahu, a gambler
● Benefics in the 8th or strong 8th lord	Unearned money at some point: inheritance, claims
○ 2nd/11th lord in 6, 8 or 12 (no Viparita rescue)	Money with friction: debts, losses, expenses abroad
○ 12th stronger than 2nd; 2nd lord in 12th; Rahu or malefics in 2nd	"Comes but doesn't stay"
○ 6th lord in Lagna or 2nd	Lives on credit

The Indu Lagna (advanced pointer). Some texts compute a "wealth ascendant" from fixed values (kalas) of the 9th lords from the Lagna and the Moon, counted from the Moon; planets there and its lord's dasha are read for prosperity. Recognise the name; leave it until the basics are second nature.

CONSULTATION TIP: Never say "you will be poor" or "you will be rich". Say what the chart actually shows: "Your chart earns through your own effort rather than inheritance; the periods that fill the passbook are your Jupiter and Mercury dashas; and you should build the habit of saving before your Rahu period, when the money will come faster than the sense to keep it."

Worked example: Chart A (Meera)

Meera's chart is our teaching workhorse; you know it by now. Scorpio rising, Sun and Mercury in the Lagna, Moon in Cancer in the 9th, Jupiter retrograde in the 7th, Venus in Libra in the 12th, Mars retrograde in Pisces in the 5th, Saturn in the 2nd, Rahu in the 4th, Ketu in the 10th.

Chart A (Meera): the career and money houses

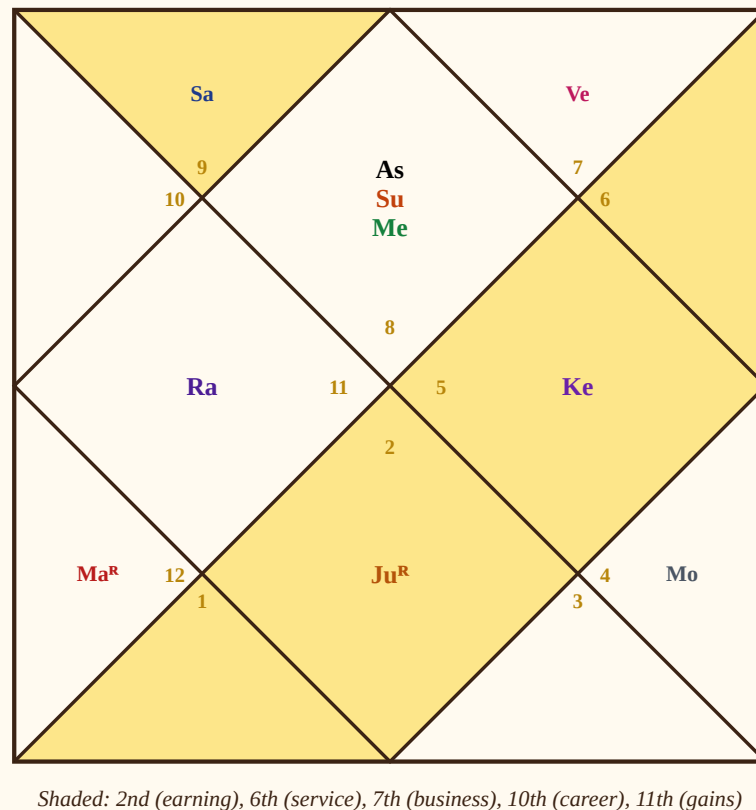


Figure 18.2: Chart A with the career triad shaded. Ketu sits alone in the 10th; the 10th lord Sun and the 11th lord Mercury share the Lagna.

Step 1: the 10th house from three points. From the Lagna, the 10th is Leo, holding Ketu. From the Moon (Cancer), the 10th is Aries, empty, ruled by Mars. From the Sun (Scorpio), the 10th is again Leo with Ketu. Two of three point to Leo and its lord the Sun, so the Sun's placement decides.

Step 2: the 10th lord. ● The Sun is in the Lagna, in Scorpio, with Mercury, a Budha–Aditya yoga (Chapter 10) sitting in the most personal house of the chart. A 10th lord in the 1st means *the career is the person*: she is known for what she does, and she does it in her own name. The Sun gives authority and teaching; Mercury gives speech, writing, explanation. The combination is the classic teacher–consultant–communicator signature. Scorpio tints it toward depth: research, investigation, the subjects most people avoid.

Step 3: occupants of the 10th. ◀ Ketu in Leo. Here is the flavour that makes Meera's teaching unusual: Ketu brings research, mathematics, astrology, the unconventional. A teacher, yes, but of something with a hidden or philosophical layer, and one who is not chasing titles. She may change institutions more than once, and she will resist any role that is merely a designation.

Step 4: the D10. Chapter 11 drew Meera's Dasamsa; recall that it supported the communication signature.

Step 5: job or business? The 6th (Aries) is empty; its lord Mars sits retrograde in the 5th, in Jupiter's sign. The 7th holds Jupiter retrograde. Jupiter in the 7th, the 10th lord in the 1st with Mercury: this is a practice, not a payroll. She may begin in an institution (Saturn in the 2nd gives early caution), but the chart wants a consultancy, a school of her own, a counselling desk.

Step 6: wealth. ● The 2nd lord is Jupiter, retrograde in the 7th: money comes through partnerships, through advice given to others, through the spouse's circle, and retrograde Jupiter often means the earning method is unconventional or comes later than the person expects. The 11th lord Mercury is in the Lagna: gains are self-generated; she earns from her own name and voice. Note the Dhana link: the 11th lord (Mercury) joins the 10th lord (Sun) in the 1st, connecting career, gains and self in one house.

Step 7: timing. Meera runs Venus Mahadasha from mid-2007 to mid-2027 (Chapter 13). Venus is the 12th lord in the 12th, and the 7th lord: the period favours partnerships, foreign contacts, comfort, and a career that grows through relationships, consistent with the teaching/consulting she does. The Venus/Mercury sub-period (mid-2023 to early 2026) activates the 11th lord in the Lagna, a good window for independent income. From mid-2027 the Sun Mahadasha begins: the 10th lord's own period, six years of visibility, authority, recognition for her work. That is the period I would tell her to prepare for now.

Worked example: Chart B (Arjun)

[illegible]

Step 1: the 10th from three points. From the Lagna, the 10th is Aries with Ketu; lord Mars. From the Moon (Taurus), the 10th is Aquarius, and there sit Sun, Mercury and Saturn, with Saturn in its own sign. From the Sun (Aquarius), the 10th is Scorpio with Jupiter. The 10th from the Moon is by far the strongest of the three: three planets, one of them at home. This is a chart where reading only from the Lagna would badly mislead you.

Step 2: the 10th lord. ● Mars, for a Cancer Lagna, is the yogakaraka (Appendix A.6): lord of the 5th and 10th, a kendra and a trikona in one planet. He sits retrograde in the 2nd, in Leo, the Sun's sign. Career and intelligence fuse with wealth, speech and family. Retrograde Mars works in bursts, reviews, returns; he may leave a line and come back to it.

Step 3: occupants. Ketu in the 10th from the Lagna (detachment from conventional ambition; frequent changes or research-type work). Sun–Mercury–Saturn in the 10th from the Moon, in the 8th from the Lagna: Aquarius is the sign of large systems and science, the 8th is the house of hidden things, insurance, research, the occult and other people's money. Saturn there in its own sign gives structure and patience (it is combust, close to the Sun, so the structure is felt more than displayed); Mercury gives analysis and data; the Sun gives a position of some authority within that world. Jupiter in the 10th from the Sun (Scorpio): advisory depth, finance, investigation.

Step 4: the picture. Put it together: research, insurance and actuarial work, data analysis, forensic accounting, deep technical or scientific work, or the occult sciences, structured (Saturn), analytical (Mercury), hidden from the public eye (8th), with an unconventional detachment (Ketu in the 10th). He will not enjoy a sales floor. He will thrive where depth is rewarded.

Step 5: job or business? The 6th house (Sagittarius) is empty; its lord Jupiter is in the 5th, service without struggle; institutions treat him kindly. The 7th holds Venus in Capricorn, and its lord Saturn sits in its own sign Aquarius, though combust, partnership works too, but Venus is a functional malefic for Cancer, so business partnerships need clear contracts. Saturn strong in the 10th from Moon suggests a long institutional climb: I would say "service first, possibly a specialised consultancy after forty."

Step 6: wealth. ● The 2nd holds the yogakaraka Mars, a real Dhana signature; money through his own ability and through family. The 11th holds the Moon in Taurus, near its exaltation point (Appendix A.2 puts the Moon's deepest exaltation at Taurus 3°; his Moon is at 6°): steady gains, public goodwill, income that grows. The 2nd lord Sun is in the 8th with Saturn, savings tied to long-term instruments, insurance, provident funds; money that is *locked* rather than lost. Rahu in the 4th: property through loans or unconventional means, possibly abroad.

Step 7: timing. Arjun's Rahu Mahadasha runs from about December 2013 to December 2031 (Chapter 13). Rahu in the 4th, in Libra, disposed by Venus in the 7th: sudden changes of home and city, property matters, foreign connections, and an unconventional route through his career. The Rahu/Saturn sub-period (roughly January 2019 to November 2021) activated the Saturn cluster in the 10th from the Moon, a period of heavy, structured work and institutional responsibility. Rahu/Venus (mid-2025 to mid-2028) touches the 7th: partnerships and possibly a move toward independent practice. The Jupiter Mahadasha from late 2031, Jupiter in the 5th trikona, lord of the 6th and 9th, would be the period of advisory standing and fortune.

What I would say: "Your talent is for deep, structured, analytical work, research, risk, data, the hidden machinery of things. You will do best inside solid institutions for a long stretch, with sudden changes of place during this Rahu period. Do not measure yourself against louder colleagues; your chart rewards depth, and the rewards arrive later and last longer."

The ten-point career checklist

Run this in order, every time.

1. **10th house from Lagna**, sign, occupants, aspects.
2. **10th from Moon and 10th from Sun**, which of the three 10ths is strongest?
3. **10th lord**, its sign, house, dignity (Chapter 12), and who it sits with.
4. **Planets in the 10th**, apply the planet table; note Sun/Mars (authority), Rahu (foreign/tech), Ketu (research/detachment).
5. **6th versus 7th**, job or business? ● Saturn/Mercury toward service; Mercury/Venus/Jupiter and own-sign planets in 7th/10th toward business (neither is "better").
6. **D10 Dasamsa**, does it confirm?

7. **Amatyakaraka**, second opinion on the skill.
8. **2nd and 11th lords, Jupiter's dignity, Dhana yogas** ●, will the work pay, and will it stay? Check ○ the 12th, the 6th (debts), Rahu or malefics in the 2nd.
9. **Timing**, 10th lord's dasha, dashas of planets in the 10th, Rahu dasha, the double transit on the 10th/10th lord, Saturn over the 10th from Moon.
10. **Foreign or change indicators**, 12th and 9th, Rahu, movable signs, 8th-house transits.

Write the answers down before you speak. A written checklist separates a reader from a guesser.

CONSULTATION TIP: The phrasing that works: "Your chart favours *-type work*. *Here is what to develop:* . The periods that will reward it are ____." Three sentences: the shape, the skill, the timing. Never the single job title, never a verdict. And when a nervous twenty-two-year-old asks "Will I be successful?", the only honest and ethical answer is: "Your chart shows where success is easier for you. Let me show you the road." A chart *cannot* say a young person will never succeed. Anyone who tells a client that is not reading a kundali; they are reading their own bad mood.

FROM LAL KITAB: In the Lal Kitab tradition, the 10th house is Saturn's permanent house (*pakka ghar*), and Saturn's condition in the chart is read as the "roof" of one's livelihood; a "sleeping" 10th house is said to be woken by the planets in the 2nd and 6th, and remedies for career are often directed at Saturn (serving labourers, feeding crows, keeping the workplace clean and orderly). This is a different system from the Parashari method in this chapter and must not be mixed with it. (Source: *Lal Kitab*, Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, 1939–1952 Urdu editions; Hindi translations vary.)

In one breath

- Career is a triad: the 10th (what you do), the 2nd and 11th (what you earn and keep), the 6th and 7th (job or business).
- Judge the 10th from the Lagna, the Moon *and* the Sun; the strongest of the three describes the profession. Confirm with the D10 and the Amatyakaraka.
- Name the field from the 10th lord's sign, the planets in the 10th, and the planet and sign tables, as a shape, not a single job title.
- Sun/Mars in the 10th lean to authority; Rahu to foreign, technology and the unconventional; Ketu to research, detachment or frequent change.
- Wealth is a separate reading: Dhana yogas, the 2nd and 11th lords, Jupiter's dignity, the 5th (speculation), the 8th (inheritance), the 12th (outflow), the 6th (debts).
- Time career events with the 10th lord's dasha, planets in the 10th, Rahu's dasha, the double transit on the 10th, and Saturn over the 10th from the Moon.
- Meera (Chart A): 10th lord Sun with Mercury in the Lagna and Ketu in the 10th, teaching, consulting, communication with a research flavour; earning through partnerships and her own name; Sun Mahadasha from 2027 is her period of authority.
- Arjun (Chart B): the 10th from the Moon carries Sun, Mercury and Saturn in Aquarius, research, insurance, data and structured deep work; a long institutional climb through the Rahu period.
- Never tell a young client they will not succeed. Give them the shape, the skill to develop, and the timing.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. For Chart C (Devika, Aries Lagna: Sun 5° and Jupiter 26° in Cancer in the 4th; Moon in Sagittarius in the 9th; Mars 27° and Venus in Gemini in the 3rd; Mercury, Saturn and Rahu in Leo in the 5th; Ketu in Aquarius in the 11th), find the 10th house from the Lagna, from the Moon and from the Sun. Which is strongest?
2. Devika's 10th lord is Saturn. Where does it sit, and with whom? Using the planet and sign tables, describe the *shape* of her career in two sentences.
3. Is Chart C a job chart or a business chart? Give two reasons from the 6th and 7th houses.
4. Chart B's 2nd lord is the Sun in the 8th with Saturn. Rewrite this in the client's language, without the words "8th house" or "Saturn".
5. A client with Rahu in the 10th asks whether to accept a posting abroad in a technology firm. Which dasha would you check first, and which transit? Write your one-sentence answer.

Answers

1. From the Lagna (Aries): 10th = Capricorn, empty, lord Saturn. From the Moon (Sagittarius): 10th = Virgo, empty, lord Mercury. From the Sun (Cancer): 10th = Aries, the Lagna itself, empty, lord Mars. All three 10ths are empty, so judge by lords. Saturn (10th lord from Lagna) sits in the 5th in Leo with Mercury (10th lord from Moon) and Rahu, two of the three 10th lords are together, which makes that Leo cluster the strongest career signal. 2. Saturn sits in Leo in the 5th with Mercury and Rahu. Shape: structured, disciplined work involving information, analysis or teaching (Saturn + Mercury), in a field with visibility or administration (Leo), with a technological or unconventional edge (Rahu), and connected to children, education or creativity (5th house). A senior educator, an administrator in an institution for the young, a long-serving analyst in a large organisation, that kind of shape. 3. Job leaning: the 6th (Virgo) is ruled by Mercury, which sits with Saturn, service and hierarchy; Saturn itself is the 10th lord, pointing to institutions. The 7th lord Venus in the 3rd with Mars gives some commercial drive, but the dominant note is a long institutional career. 4. "Your savings tend to go into long-term, locked forms, insurance, provident fund, property that is not quickly sold, rather than sitting as cash. Money is safe with you but not liquid; plan for that." 5. Check whether the running Mahadasha or Antardasha is Rahu's, or the 12th or 9th lord's; then check whether Jupiter and Saturn are both touching the 10th house or its lord by transit this year. Answer: "If the period and the double transit agree, the posting is on your road, go; if only one agrees, go with your eyes open and a return plan."

Chapter 19: Marriage and Relationships, "When, With Whom, and Will It Last?"

A friend's mother once handed me two horoscopes folded inside a wedding card that had already been printed. "Didi, just tell me the points are above eighteen." The points were fourteen. The 7th houses of both charts were beautiful. I told her the truth about both facts, and I told her what I will tell you in this chapter: the points are a sieve, the chart is the river, and a wise astrologer reads the river.

Marriage carries the most emotion into the room, so the method must be the most disciplined: houses and karakas, the partner, the timing, the eight-fold matching with its arithmetic, and the phrases that keep hope and honesty in one sentence.

The houses and karakas of marriage

STORY: THE GUEST WING. *In the old haveli the family lived on the east side and the 7th house was the guest wing on the west, the rooms where the person who marries into the family will live. Before the wedding the elders would walk through it. Whose portrait hangs there? If Guru-ji's, the guest will be learned and generous; if the Commander's, quick-tempered and brave; if the old Judge's, older, quiet, late to arrive. Who holds the key, the wing's lord, and where is he? A lord standing in his own rooms keeps the wing in order; a lord away in the 12th (the store-room by the back gate) means the guest comes from far, or arrives late. And is the wing swept? Two malefics camped there make the guest's stay stormy. The elders never described the guest's face, only the rooms. **Rule:** the 7th house sign, its occupants and its lord's placement describe the partner and the partnership; read them before any koota.*

The 7th house and its lord. The 7th (Kalatra bhava) is the house opposite the self, the other person who completes the pair. Its sign, its occupants, the planets aspecting it and, above all, the placement and strength of its lord tell you the *quality* of partnership a person is built for. Chapter 9's five-step method applies here in full: the house, the lord, the karaka, the same house from the Moon, and the varga (here the Navamsa).

WHY? (Astronomy, then logic.) When the Lagna rises in the east, the 7th house is setting in the west: the sky's exact opposite of the self. The tradition read every opposition as "the other": the person who faces you, completes you and sometimes opposes you. That is why the 7th holds spouse, business partner and the public at once. Parallel: the person across the dining table is the one you must negotiate with every day.

Venus and Jupiter, the karakas. The classical rule is gendered: Venus is the karaka of the wife in a man's chart and of love and marriage in general; Jupiter is the karaka of the husband in a woman's chart (Appendix A.2). Modern astrologers apply this flexibly: most of us read Venus for the *relationship itself* in every chart, and Jupiter for the *husband* where a woman asks about one, without insisting the two never cross. I do the same. Check the karaka's dignity, its house, and whether it is combust or afflicted; a weak karaka weakens even a good 7th.

WHY? (Symbolic logic, and a classical statement.) Venus is desire and the pleasure of union (kama); Jupiter is dharma, the vow and the protector. Marriage needs both, which is why both are karakas. Parashara's gendered rule, Jupiter for the husband in a woman's chart, came from a society in which the husband was the wife's dharma-protector and the wife the husband's source of comfort and prosperity. The society has changed; the two forces have not. Parallel: every wedding still has both the mehendi night (Venus) and the vows before the fire (Jupiter).

The Darakaraka (Jaimini). Chapter 15 introduced the seven Jaimini karakas ranked by degree. The planet with the **lowest degree** is the **Darakaraka (DK)**, the spouse-significator; it describes the partner and the karma of partnership. In Chart A the degrees are Sun 28°, Venus 22°, Moon 21°, Mercury 9°, Jupiter 8°, Saturn 5°, Mars 4° (Rahu is excluded in the seven-karaka scheme): so Meera's DK is **Mars**. (Chart B: Mercury at 2°; Chart C: Mercury at 1°.)

The supporting houses.

House	Question it answers
2nd	Family life after marriage; the household that forms
4th	Domestic happiness, the home the couple keeps
5th	Romance, courtship, the children of the union
8th	Marital longevity, in-laws, the spouse's family and money
12th	Bed pleasures, private life, foreign partners

WHY? (Logic.) The 8th is the 2nd from the 7th: the partner's holdings, the partner's family, and the "savings" of the marriage itself, which is its endurance. It is also the general house of longevity. So the 8th shows in-laws, the spouse's money and how long the bond lasts. Parallel: the in-laws' house is the room next door to the guest wing; what happens there decides how long the guest stays.

The Navamsa (D9). Chapter 11 called it the most important varga, and marriage is where it earns the title. Look at the D9 Lagna, the 7th house of the D9 and its lord, and where Venus falls in the D9. A 7th house that looks troubled in D1 but is clean in D9 usually settles down after a rough start; the reverse pattern is the one that needs care.

WHY? (Classical assignment, with a logic.) Parashara assigns the Navamsa to the spouse, and the ninth division is the division of dharma: nine is the number of the 9th house. Marriage is the householder's dharma, so the varga of dharma tests its inner strength. Chapter 11 showed how a planet's D9 sign reveals what the D1 sign only promises. Parallel: the D1 is the wedding album; the D9 is how the couple speak to each other in the kitchen ten years later.

The Upapada Lagna (UL). Also from Jaimini (Chapter 15): the Arudha of the 12th house. Count from the 12th house sign to its lord, then the same distance again; if the result lands in the 12th sign itself or in the 7th from it, take the 10th from that instead. Let us compute it for Chart A. The 12th house is Libra; its lord Venus sits in Libra itself. The distance is zero, so the Arudha would fall on Libra, the same sign, and the exception applies: count to the 10th from Libra, which is **Cancer**. Meera's UL is Cancer, her 9th house, where her own Moon sits in its own sign: a marriage that brings fortune, faith and a nurturing home. The **2nd from the UL** (Leo) shows marital longevity; there we find Ketu. A malefic here asks for care, but Ketu is the gentlest of the three, and Leo's lord the Sun is strong in her Lagna, so I read it as "phases of emotional distance that the marriage survives", not a breaking sign.

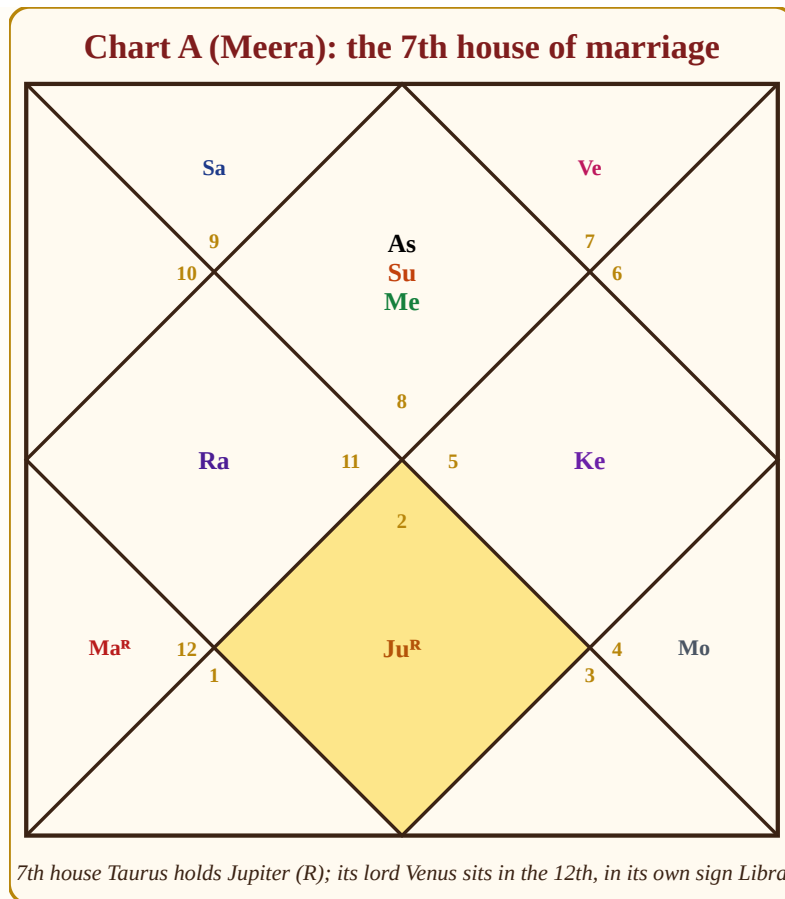


Figure 19.1: Chart A. The 7th house Taurus holds Jupiter (R); its lord Venus sits in the 12th in its own sign Libra.

Describing the partner

Clients want a portrait. Give them a sketch, temperament, background, direction, never a photograph.

From the sign of the 7th house (adjusted by the D9 7th):

7th sign	Partner's temperament
Aries	Energetic, direct, independent, quick-tempered
Taurus	Steady, sensual, loyal, fond of comfort and food
Gemini	Talkative, witty, restless, youthful
Cancer	Nurturing, emotional, home-loving, moody
Leo	Proud, generous, wants admiration, leads
Virgo	Practical, analytical, particular, dutiful
Libra	Charming, fair-minded, social, indecisive
Scorpio	Intense, private, loyal, jealous when hurt
Sagittarius	Idealistic, frank, learned, loves freedom
Capricorn	Serious, ambitious, reserved, matures late
Aquarius	Unconventional, principled, detached, friendly
Pisces	Gentle, dreamy, compassionate, impractical

From the planets in or ruling the 7th (and the DK):

Planet	For the 7th	Partner's type
Sun	☌	Dignified, dominant, from government or administration
Moon	● when bright	Caring, emotional, homely, changeable
Mars	○ heat	Energetic, argumentative, athletic, technical
Mercury	☌	Talkative, youthful, clever, commercial
Jupiter	●	Learned, religious, generous, sometimes older
Venus	●	Beautiful, artistic, comfort-loving
Saturn	○ delay	Older, serious, hard-working; marriage delayed
Rahu	○ unconventional	Foreign, from another community, unconventional
Ketu	☌ detached	Spiritual, detached, quiet

Direction of the partner. Tradition reads the direction of the spouse's home from the 7th sign's element (Appendix A.1): fire signs east, earth south, air west, water north. Meera's 7th is Taurus, earth, south of her birthplace. Treat this as folklore that clients enjoy, not a prediction to bet on.

Meera's partner. Taurus 7th with Jupiter: steady, generous, learned, possibly a teacher or adviser, fond of comforts, perhaps a few years older. The 7th lord Venus in the 12th in its own sign: met through travel, a foreign connection or a distant city; a partner who values privacy. The DK Mars in Pisces: energetic but gentle, idealistic. In the D9 (below), Venus sits in the D9 7th in Aries, ruled by Mars in Leo, an independent, spirited partner with a strong will under the gentle exterior.

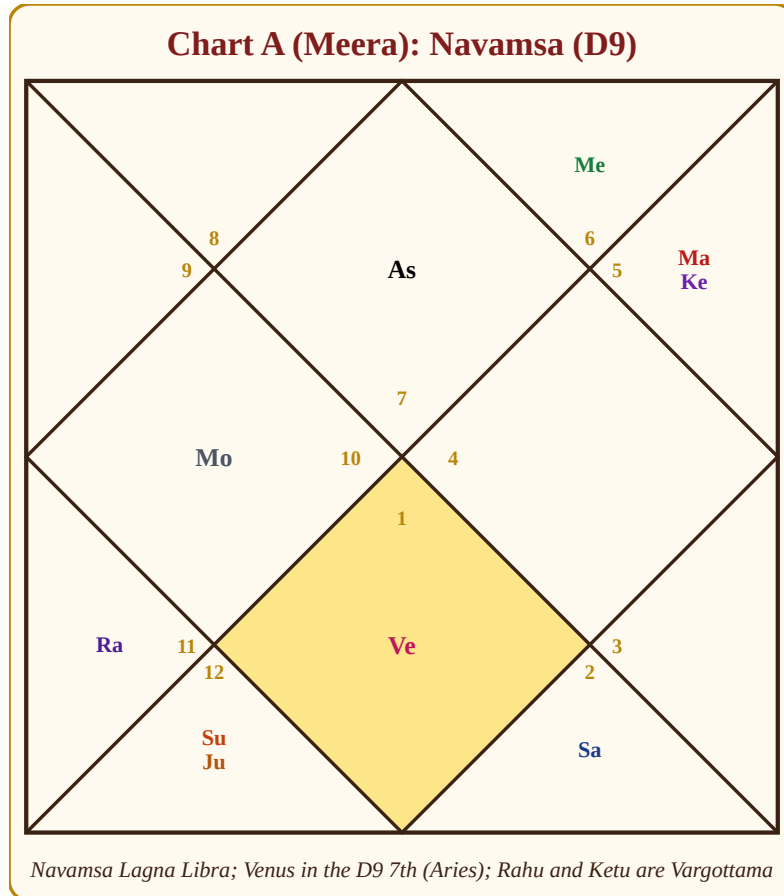


Figure 19.2: Meera's Navamsa (computed with the A.10 rule, as in Chapter 11). Navamsa Lagna Libra; Venus in the D9 7th house (Aries); Rahu and Ketu Vargottama.

Love or arranged? One partner or several?

Love marriage indicators: a connection between the 5th (romance) and the 7th (marriage), their lords together, exchanged, or in mutual aspect; Venus with Mars (attraction that acts); Rahu in the 7th or 5th (a partner outside the expected circle); the Moon with Venus (the heart chooses). None of these forbids a family-arranged match; they say the person's heart will be involved either way.

Multiple relationships: Venus or the 7th lord in dual signs (Gemini, Virgo, Sagittarius, Pisces); a 7th house afflicted by two or more malefics; Rahu, Mars or Saturn in the 7th; the 7th lord in the 6th or 12th with Venus afflicted. Phrase this with great care. "Your chart shows more than one significant relationship in life" is honest. "You will have affairs" is slander dressed as astrology.

Delays: Saturn's influence on the 7th, on Venus or on the 7th lord (by placement or aspect) is the single commonest delay factor; the 7th lord in the 6th, 8th or 12th; Venus combust; no planet at all aspecting the 7th. Delay is not denial.

Indicator	Weight	Reads as
5th–7th lords linked; Moon with Venus	●	The heart chooses (love marriage likely)
Venus with Mars; Rahu in 5th or 7th	●	Attraction that acts; partner outside the circle
Venus or 7th lord in a dual sign	●	More than one significant relationship possible
Two or more malefics on the 7th; Rahu/Mars/Saturn in 7th	○	Storms; multiplicity; phrase with care
Saturn on 7th, Venus or 7th lord	○ delay	Marries later; a good marriage still
7th lord in 6, 8 or 12; Venus combust; no aspect on 7th	○ delay	Later, or from a distance
Benefic in 7th; 7th lord in own/exalted sign or kendra	●	Steady partnership; the "guest wing" in order

CONSULTATION TIP: When a parent asks "why is my daughter still unmarried at thirty", they are asking whether it is their fault. Answer the chart, not the guilt: "Her 7th lord sits in a house of delay; it also sits in its own sign, which means the marriage, when it comes, is a good one. The periods that open the door are ____." Then stop talking.

Timing the marriage

STORY: TWO SIGNATURES ON THE MARRIAGE FILE. *In our court a marriage is not fixed by a wish; it is fixed by a file, and the file needs two signatures. Guru-ji, the Royal Priest, signs first; he is generous and goes round the twelve districts once a year, blessing three at a time with his glance, so his signature is easy to get. Shani-ji, the old Judge, signs last. He spends two and a half years in each district, reads every page, and signs only when he has himself touched the house of marriage or its lord. Families who ran to the pandit the moment Guru-ji smiled at their district came back a year later asking why nothing happened: the Judge had not yet reached the file. And the railway timetable, the dasha, must have a marriage train running at all. Three things, one season. **Rule:** marriage is timed when Jupiter and Saturn both touch the 7th house or its lord by transit, inside a dasha of a marriage-giving planet.*

The **dasha layer** first. Marriage tends to arrive in the Mahadasha or Antardasha of: the 7th lord; Venus (or Jupiter for a woman, by the classical rule); a planet sitting in the 7th; the lord of the 7th from the Moon; the D9 Lagna lord; the UL lord; or a planet in the 7th of the D9. Two of these in the same window is strong; three is nearly certain.

The **transit layer**, the double transit from Chapter 14, fixes the season. Marriage happens when Jupiter transits, or aspects, the 7th house, the Lagna or the 7th lord, *while* Saturn also touches the 7th or its lord by position or aspect.

WHY? (Astronomy.) Jupiter and Saturn are the two slowest planets we can see: about a year and about two and a half years per sign. Every faster planet crosses the 7th within weeks, so it cannot mark a season. Only when the two slow hands of the clock both point at the same house do we get a window long enough for a real event to fall into. Parallel: a wedding needs both the pandit's free date and the hall's free date; either alone books nothing.

Worked on Chart A (a constructed example: we are checking that the reasoning holds, not that history did). Meera's Venus Mahadasha runs mid-2007 to mid-2027. Venus is her 7th lord, the D9 Lagna lord, and the marriage karaka: the whole

dasha is a marriage-friendly era. Within it, the Venus/Rahu sub-period runs roughly August 2014 to July 2017. Rahu sits in her 4th (home) and is disposed by Saturn in her 2nd (family), a sub-period that changes the home and the family.

Now the transits. Jupiter was in sidereal Leo from about July 2015 to August 2016, her 10th house. From Leo, Jupiter's 5th, 7th and 9th aspects fall on Sagittarius (her 2nd), Aquarius (her 4th) and Aries (her 6th): family and home are touched, but *not* the 7th. Then Jupiter moved to Virgo (August 2016 to September 2017); from Virgo its aspects fall on Capricorn (3rd), Pisces (5th) and **Taurus: the 7th**. Meanwhile Saturn was in Scorpio from November 2014 to January 2017, sitting on her Lagna; from Scorpio, Saturn's 3rd, 7th and 10th aspects fall on Capricorn (3rd), **Taurus (7th)** and Leo (10th). So from August 2016 until January 2017, Jupiter aspected the 7th and Saturn aspected the 7th, inside the Venus/Rahu sub-period of the 7th lord's Mahadasha. A marriage in late 2016 fits every layer. That is how the double transit is meant to be used: not "Jupiter is somewhere good, so marriage", but two slow planets and one dasha agreeing on one house.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Timing marriage from Jupiter alone. Jupiter aspects three houses at once and returns every year; by itself it would "predict" marriage in a third of all years. Without Saturn's agreement and a supporting dasha, it is a hope, not a timing.

Kuja dosha: the counselling frame

STORY: THE COMMANDER BILLETED IN THE BEDROOM WING. *After a campaign the Commander needs quarters. If the King bills him in the barracks (the 3rd, 6th, 10th, 11th) everyone sleeps well. But suppose he is billeted in the family's private rooms: the front hall (1st), the dining room (2nd), the inner courtyard (4th), the guest wing (7th), the in-laws' rooms (8th) or the bedroom by the back gate (12th). He does nothing wrong; he is simply loud. He argues at dinner, drills in the courtyard at dawn, and the new bride wonders what she has married into. That is the whole of Mangal dosha, a hot temperament in the rooms where a marriage is lived. The elders learned to soften it: if the Commander was in his own district or a friend's, or Guru-ji sat with him, or the other family also had a Commander in their private rooms, the two would understand each other. **Rule:** Mars in 1, 2, 4, 7, 8 or 12 (from Lagna, Moon or Venus) is heat in the marriage rooms; check cancellations; counsel temperament, never curse.*

Chapter 10 covered the Mars dosha (Mangal or Kuja dosha): Mars in the 1st, 2nd, 4th, 7th, 8th or 12th from the Lagna, and by the fuller tradition, also from the Moon and from Venus, with its long list of cancellations (Mars in its own or a friend's sign, in Leo or Aquarius, with Jupiter, the partner having the same dosha, and more). Meera has no Kuja dosha from the Lagna, the Moon or Venus. Arjun (Chart B) has Mars in the 2nd from the Lagna, the 4th from his Moon and the 8th from his Venus, but Mars is retrograde in Leo, a friend's sign, and is his yogakaraka, so most teachers would call the dosha 🍌 mild.

WHY? (Logic.) Why count Mars from three points? The Lagna is the body, the Moon the mind, Venus the desire. A quarrel in a marriage can start in any of the three: tiredness, mood or jealousy. Mars is heat; the tradition checked whether heat sat in the marriage rooms of the body, the mind or the heart. Parallel: a kitchen fire can start at the stove, the gas cylinder or the wiring, so an inspector checks all three.

The counselling frame matters more than the rule. Mars in the marriage houses describes *heat*: a sharp tongue in the family (2nd), a restless home (4th), a partner who argues (7th). Tell the couple this as a temperament to manage, "one of you speaks first and thinks second; agree now who cools the kitchen", and never as a curse on the other's life. The frightening folk version of Mangal dosha has broken more engagements than Mars ever did.

Ashtakoota: the eight-fold matching, done properly

STORY: EIGHT GATEKEEPERS AT THE WEDDING GATE. At the wedding gate of the old kingdom stood eight gatekeepers, each allowed exactly one question, each holding a different number of coins to give if the answer pleased. The first, a thin old man with one coin, asked about temperament: Varna. The second, with two, asked whether the two would pull each other: Vashya. The third, with three, counted the stars between the bride's street and the groom's: Tara. The fourth, with four, asked which animals they were: Yoni. The fifth, with five, asked whether the lords of their two Queen Mothers were friends: Graha Maitri. The sixth, with six, asked whether they were of the gods, of men or of the wild: Gana. The seventh, with seven, measured the distance between their two Moons: Bhakoot. The eighth, tallest, with eight coins, felt their pulses: Nadi. Thirty-six coins in all; eighteen opened the gate. But the wise families knew the gatekeepers had never seen the couple, only their two Moons. Inside, the elders still walked the guest wing. **Rule:** Ashtakoota compares the two Moons in eight ways, 36 points; 18 is the gate; the 7th houses, Navamsa and dashas decide the marriage.

Appendix A.12 gives the eight kootas and their points out of 36. Here is how each is actually computed, and then the full match between Chart A (Meera as bride) and Chart B (Arjun as groom).

WHY? (Tradition, from the muhurta texts such as *Muhurta Chintamani*.) Why these eight, and why do the points rise from one to eight? The list is the tradition's ranking of what breaks a marriage, from least to most: ego and temperament (Varna, 1), attraction (Vashya, 2), shared fortune (Tara, 3), instinct (Yoni, 4), mental rapport (Graha Maitri, 5), temperament class (Gana, 6), family and finances (Bhakoot, 7) and health with progeny (Nadi, 8). Everything is judged from the two Moons because the Moon is the mind, and marriage was held to be the meeting of two minds. Parallel: it is the elders' pre-wedding checklist, with the items they feared most placed at the bottom and weighted heaviest.

1. Varna (1 point): temperament, ego. From the Moon sign's element: water signs Brahmin, fire Kshatriya, air Vaishya, earth Shudra. These caste words are traditional labels for four *temperaments* (reflective, commanding, transactional, grounded), say so plainly to clients, because the words upset people and mean nothing about birth. Full point if the groom's varna is equal to or "higher" than the bride's; otherwise zero.

2. Vashya (2 points): mutual pull. Signs fall in five groups: quadruped (Aries, Taurus, the second half of Sagittarius, the first half of Capricorn), human (Gemini, Virgo, Libra, the first half of Sagittarius, Aquarius), water (Cancer, the second half of Capricorn, Pisces), wild (Leo) and insect (Scorpio). Same group 2; friendly groups 1; where one group is the other's prey or enemy (the wild Leo against quadrupeds or humans, human against water in some tables) 0 or ½. Tables differ slightly between authors; use one and say which.

3. Tara (3 points): health and fortune together. Count from the bride's nakshatra to the groom's (inclusive), divide by nine, take the remainder; then count from the groom's to the bride's and do the same. Remainders 3, 5 and 7 (Vipat, Pratyari, Vadha) are unfavourable. Both counts good: 3 points; one good: 1½; both bad: 0.

4. Yoni (4 points): instinctive compatibility. Each nakshatra is an animal; the 27 map to 14 animals, mostly in male–female pairs:

Animal	Nakshatras	Enemy animal
Horse	Ashwini, Shatabhisha	Buffalo
Elephant	Bharani, Revati	Lion
Sheep (goat)	Pushya, Krittika	Monkey
Serpent	Rohini, Mrigashira	Mongoose
Dog	Mula, Ardra	Deer
Cat	Ashlesha, Punarvasu	Rat
Rat	Magha, Purva Phalguni	Cat
Cow	Uttara Phalguni, Uttara Bhadrapada	Tiger
Buffalo	Swati, Hasta	Horse
Tiger	Vishakha, Chitra	Cow
Deer	Jyeshtha, Anuradha	Dog
Monkey	Purva Ashadha, Shravana	Sheep
Lion	Purva Bhadrapada, Dhanishta	Elephant
Mongoose	Uttara Ashadha	Serpent

Same animal 4; friendly 3; neutral 2; unfriendly 1; enemies 0.

5. Graha Maitri (5 points): mental rapport. Take the lords of the two Moon signs and look them up in the friendship table (Appendix A.3). Same lord or mutual friends 5; one friend, one neutral 4; both neutral 3; one friend, one enemy 1; one neutral, one enemy ½; mutual enemies 0.

6. Gana (6 points): temperament class. Deva, Manushya or Rakshasa from Appendix A.7. Same gana 6; Deva–Manushya 6 (some tables 5); Deva–Rakshasa 0 (some give 1); Manushya–Rakshasa 0.

7. Bhakoot (7 points): family welfare and finances. Count the distance between the two Moon signs both ways. Pairs of 2/12, 5/9 and 6/8 are Bhakoot dosha, 0 points; every other pairing (1/1, 3/11, 4/10, 7/7) scores 7. Exceptions exist when both Moon-sign lords are the same planet or friends.

WHY? (Logic for two pairs, tradition for the third.) When the Moons are 6/8 apart, each mind sits in the other's house of enemies or of death; when 2/12, one mind's gain is the other's loss. Those are dusthana relationships between two minds, so the tradition marked them. The 5/9 pair is a trine and looks friendly; the muhurta texts still call it a dosha, giving progeny as the reason (9 is the 5th from the 5th). Many modern astrologers soften that one, and I say so. Parallel: two colleagues whose desks face each other's blind spots quarrel without meaning to.

8. Nadi (8 points): health and progeny. The nakshatras fall into three nadis (pulses):

Nadi	Nakshatras
Adi	Ashwini, Ardra, Punarvasu, Uttara Phalguni, Hasta, Jyeshtha, Mula, Shatabhisha, Purva Bhadrapada
Madhya	Bharani, Mrigashira, Pushya, Purva Phalguni, Chitra, Anuradha, Purva Ashadha, Dhanishta, Uttara Bhadrapada
Antya	Krittika, Rohini, Ashlesha, Magha, Swati, Vishakha, Uttara Ashadha, Shravana, Revati

Different nadis 8; the same nadi 0, the **Nadi dosha**, the heaviest single penalty in the system. Classical exceptions cancel it: the same Moon sign with different nakshatras; the same nakshatra with different Moon signs (some texts require different padas); and, in several texts, when the two Moon-sign lords are the same planet or great friends.

WHY? (Tradition.) Nadi means pulse. The old understanding, borrowed from the physicians, was that two people of the same nadi shared one constitution, and children of such a union would inherit a doubled weakness. That is why Nadi carries eight points, the most of any koota: the tradition ranked the health of children above every other worry. Modern medicine tests this differently, but the intention is the same one genetic counselling serves today. Parallel: families who would not marry within the same gotra were guarding the same thing by another rule.

The worked match: Meera (Chart A) with Arjun (Chart B)

Bride: Moon in Cancer 21°, Ashlesha. Groom: Moon in Taurus 6°, Krittika.

- **Varna.** ○ Cancer is water: Brahmin. Taurus is earth, Shudra. The groom's varna is lower than the bride's: **0**.
- **Vashya.** ♣ Cancer is a water sign (Jalachara); Taurus is a quadruped (Chatushpada). Friendly groups in the common table: **1**.
- **Tara.** ♣ From Krittika (3) to Ashlesha (9): 7 nakshatras; $7 \div 9$ leaves 7, Vadha, unfavourable. From Ashlesha (9) to Krittika (3): 22; $22 \div 9$ leaves 4, Kshema, favourable. One good, one bad: **1½**.
- **Yoni.** ♣ Ashlesha is the cat; Krittika is the sheep. Not enemies, not friends, so neutral: **2**.
- **Graha Maitri.** ○ Cancer's lord is the Moon; Taurus's lord is Venus. From Appendix A.3, the Moon is neutral toward Venus, but Venus counts the Moon as an enemy. One neutral, one enemy: **½**.
- **Gana.** ● Ashlesha is Rakshasa; Krittika is Rakshasa. Same gana: **6**.
- **Bhakoot.** ● Cancer to Taurus is 11; Taurus to Cancer is 3. The 3/11 pair is not a dosha: **7**.
- **Nadi.** ○ Ashlesha is Antya; Krittika is Antya. Same nadi, **0**, Nadi dosha. Check the exceptions: different Moon signs, different nakshatras, and the lords (Moon and Venus) are not friends. No exception applies; the dosha stands.

Total: 0 + 1 + 1½ + 2 + ½ + 6 + 7 + 0 = 18 out of 36.

Ashtakoota scorecard: Meera (Chart A) × Arjun (Chart B)

Bride: Moon Cancer 21°, Ashlesha · Groom: Moon Taurus 6°, Krittika

Koota	Max	How it was judged	Score
Varna	1	Cancer = water = Brahmin · Taurus = earth = Shudra (groom lower)	

○ 0 Vashya 2 Jalachara (water) × Chatushpada (quadruped): friendly groups ● 1 Tara 3 Krittika → Ashlesha 7 (Vadha) · Ashlesha → Krittika 22 → 4 (Kshema) ● 1.5 Yoni 4 Cat (Ashlesha) × Sheep (Krittika): neutral, not enemies ● 2 Graha Maitri 5 Moon neutral to Venus · Venus enemy to Moon ● 0.5 Gana 6 Rakshasa × Rakshasa: same gana ● 6 Bhakoot 7 Cancer–Taurus = 3/11: no dosha ● 7 Nadi 8 Antya × Antya: same nadi: NADI DOSHA
○ 0 TOTAL 18 / 36 18 = the bottom edge of ‘acceptable’. Two red flags (Nadi, Varna) and one strong pillar (Bhakoot + Gana = 13 of 13). ● 6–8 good · ● partial · ○ dosha. Now read the actual charts: the 7th houses, Venus and Jupiter, the Navamsa, the dashas. The points are only the first sieve.

Figure 19.3: The scorecard. Two red rows (Varna, Nadi) and one very strong pillar (Gana and Bhakoot together give 13 of 13).

Eighteen sits exactly on the lower edge of "acceptable" in Appendix A.12. A family astrologer working from the points alone would frown. Now watch what the *charts* say. Meera's 7th holds Jupiter with its lord in its own sign; Arjun's 7th holds Venus, the marriage karaka, and his 7th lord Saturn sits in its own sign Aquarius, two solid marriage houses, though Saturn in his 8th, combust beside the Sun, delays his. Their Lagnas, Scorpio and Cancer, are both water signs in a 5/9 trine, natural emotional understanding. Meera's 7th lord Venus and Arjun's 7th lord Saturn are natural friends. She runs a Venus Mahadasha; he runs Rahu, disposed by Venus, their timings pull the same way. The Nadi dosha is real and I would say so; I would also say that a Nadi match is traditionally about health and progeny, so we look at both 5th houses and Jupiters (Chapter 21) before we worry. **A low score with strong 7th houses is not a "no".** A high score with two afflicted 7th houses is not a "yes".

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Points first, then the two 7th houses, then the two Navamsas, then the two dashas. If three of these four are good, bless the match. If only the points are good, look again.

The modern consultant's compatibility method

Beyond the kootas, I compare the two charts in six lines:

1. **Lagnas**, are the rising signs in a friendly relationship (trine, sextile, same element) or in a 6/8 or 2/12 position?
2. **Moon signs**, emotional fit; the same test.
3. **Venus and Mars**, his Venus to her Mars and hers to his: attraction and its endurance.
4. **Saturn**, where does each person's Saturn fall in the other's chart? Saturn on the other's Moon or 7th is heavy; Saturn on the other's 10th or 11th steadies them.
5. **The two 7th lords**, are they friends? Do they fall in good houses of each other's chart?
6. **Dashas**, are both people in periods that favour partnership, or is one in a Saturn/Ketu withdrawal while the other is in a Venus bloom?

Strain, separation, remarriage, and how to speak of them

The indicators of marital strain, all ○: the lords of the 6th, 8th or 12th in the 7th; Saturn, Mars and Rahu together influencing the 7th; the 7th lord in the 6th, 8th or 12th with malefic aspect; the D9 7th house or its lord afflicted; the 2nd from the UL heavily afflicted; Venus debilitated and combust. Against them, the ● sustainers: Jupiter's aspect on the 7th or its lord, a clean D9 7th, a strong UL lord. Two red marks is a chart that must work at marriage. Four is a chart where separation is a real possibility.

Remarriage is read from the 2nd house (the second partner, by the classical convention of counting the 8th from the 7th, which is the 2nd) and from planets in dual signs in the 7th or ruling it. Where the 7th is afflicted and the 2nd is strong, I say "the chart has room for a second, happier chapter", and only when I am asked.

Childlessness is not a marriage question but is asked as one; Chapter 21 covers the 5th house and Jupiter. Note here only that a Nadi dosha or a weak 5th is a reason to *plan*, not to refuse a match.

CONSULTATION TIP: The ethics of this section are absolute. You never say "this marriage will break", "your husband will leave" or "she will be unfaithful". You say: "This chart shows strain in partnership during ____ period; here is what strengthens it." You never reveal one partner's chart to the other without consent. You never use a chart to end a marriage a client has not already decided to end. And when someone in a bad marriage asks whether the stars permit them to leave, remember that they are asking you for permission to be safe, the stars never forbid safety.

LGBTQ+ and live-in relationships. The classical texts do not address same-sex partnership or unmarried cohabitation; they were written for a society that did not name them. The honest consultant reads the 7th house, the 5th, Venus and the DK for *partnership in general*, its quality, timing and endurance, exactly as for any client, and does not moralise. The chart describes how a person loves and commits; it does not rule on whom they may love.

DID YOU KNOW? The 36-point Ashtakoota is North Indian. South India uses a ten-fold matching (*Dasha Porutham*) with Rajju (longevity) and Vedha (obstruction) tests, so two families from two regions can score the same pair quite differently: one more reason to read the whole chart.

FROM LAL KITAB: In the Lal Kitab tradition Venus is read in its permanent house, the 7th, and a "sleeping" or afflicted Venus there is said to trouble the spouse's comfort; the commonly taught remedies for marital friction involve the couple keeping a small silver piece, feeding cows, and the husband respecting women of the household as a discipline. This belongs to Lal Kitab's own system and is not to be blended with the Parashari reading above. (*Source: Lal Kitab, Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, 1939–1952 Urdu editions; Hindi translations vary.*)

The marriage checklist

1. 7th house: sign, occupants, aspects, from the Lagna and from the Moon.
2. 7th lord: house, dignity, company.
3. Venus (and Jupiter for a woman): dignity, combustion, affliction.
4. Darakaraka: which planet, where.
5. D9: Lagna, 7th house, 7th lord, Venus.
6. UL and the 2nd from it.
7. ○ Delay and multiplicity factors; ● love-marriage links (5th–7th); ● benefics on the 7th.
8. ○ Kuja dosha from Lagna, Moon and Venus, ● with cancellations.
9. Timing: dasha lords of marriage; the double transit on the 7th.
10. If matching: Ashtakoota total, then the six-line modern comparison.

In one breath

- Marriage is read from the 7th house and its lord, Venus (and Jupiter in a woman's chart, applied flexibly), the Darakaraka, the D9 7th and the Upapada.
- Meera's DK is Mars (lowest degree, 4°); her UL is Cancer (Venus in its own sign forces the "10th from" exception); Ketu in the 2nd from UL is read as phases of distance, not breaking.
- Describe the partner as a sketch from the 7th sign, its planets and the D9, temperament, background, direction, never a photograph.
- Delay comes chiefly from Saturn on the 7th, Venus or the 7th lord, and from the 7th lord in 6/8/12. Delay is not denial.
- Time marriage with the dashas of the 7th lord, Venus, planets in the 7th, the 7th-from-Moon lord, the D9 Lagna lord or the UL lord, and confirm with Jupiter and Saturn both touching the 7th. Meera's late-2016 window passes every layer.
- Ashtakoota: Meera × Arjun scores 18/36, Nadi dosha and Varna fail, Gana and Bhakoot are perfect. Strong 7th houses, friendly Lagnas and aligned dashas outweigh the thin points.
- Strain is spoken of as strain, in periods, with what strengthens it. Never predict a breaking. Never moralise about whom a client loves.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. Chart C (Devika, Aries Lagna: Sun 5° and Jupiter 26° Cancer; Moon 14° Sagittarius; Mars 27° and Venus 15° Gemini; Mercury 1°, Saturn 18°, Rahu 3° Leo; Ketu 3° Aquarius). Find her 7th house, its lord and where that lord sits. In one sentence, what does it say about partnership?
2. Compute Devika's Darakaraka and her Upapada Lagna (12th house Pisces; lord Jupiter in Cancer).
3. Devika's Moon is in Purva Ashadha; Arjun's is in Kritika. Compute Gana, Yoni and Nadi for that pair.
4. A client's 7th lord is Saturn in the 12th, and Venus is combust. What do you say, in two sentences, when the mother asks "why no marriage at thirty-one"?
5. Chart B: Arjun's 7th house Capricorn holds Venus; its lord Saturn sits in the 8th in its own sign, combust. Which dasha lords would you list as marriage-timing candidates for him? (Use his Rahu Mahadasha of December 2013 to December 2031 and its sub-periods.)

Answers

1. The 7th is Libra, lord Venus, sitting in Gemini in the 3rd with Mars. A charming, communicative partner met through siblings, neighbours or short travel; Venus with Mars gives attraction and some argument; Gemini adds wit and restlessness. 2. Degrees: Mars 27°, Jupiter 26°, Saturn 18°, Venus 15°, Moon 14°, Sun 5°, Mercury 1°, lowest is Mercury, so DK = Mercury (a clever, youthful, commercial partner). UL: 12th house Pisces, lord Jupiter in Cancer, which is 5 signs from Pisces; 5 more from Cancer gives Scorpio. Scorpio is neither Pisces nor its 7th (Virgo), so no exception: UL = Scorpio, her 8th house. 3. Gana: Purva Ashadha is Manushya, Kritika is Rakshasa, Manushya–Rakshasa = 0. Yoni: Purva Ashadha is the monkey, Kritika the sheep; these are enemy animals = 0. Nadi: Purva Ashadha is Madhya, Kritika is Antya, different = 8. (A pair that fails temperament and instinct but passes the health test; you would read both 7th houses next.) 4. "Her 7th lord sits in a house of delay and her marriage planet is weakened by the Sun, so her chart marries later than her friends; that is a timing, not a fault. The periods that open the door are Saturn's and Venus's sub-periods, and the season when Jupiter and Saturn both touch her 7th; let me find those dates for you." 5. Saturn (the 7th lord); Venus (the marriage karaka, sitting in the 7th); Mars (the 7th from his Moon in Taurus is Scorpio, whose lord is Mars, also his yogakaraka); and any planet in his D9 7th. Within the Rahu Mahadasha the candidates are Rahu/Saturn (January 2019 to November 2021), Rahu/Venus (mid-2025 to mid-2028) and Rahu/Mars (late 2030 to 2031). With the 7th lord in the 8th (a delay factor), Rahu/Venus is the more likely window; confirm with the double transit on Capricorn or Saturn.

Chapter 20: Health and Longevity, Reading the Body Without Frightening the Patient

Before a single rule, the ethics. I put this first because in health matters a careless astrologer can do real harm; I have watched one careless sentence frighten a person for months.

An astrologer is not a doctor. You do not diagnose. You do not name a disease from a chart, however sure you feel. You do not predict death, not the year, not the decade, not "after sixty be careful". You never, under any circumstance, advise a client to stop, delay or replace a treatment their doctor has prescribed. Parashara himself warns against announcing the span of life, and every honest teacher since has repeated the warning.

WHY? (Ethics, and logic.) The ethical reason is plain: a frightened person delays treatment, and you are not qualified to treat. The logical reason is deeper: a chart shows tendency, not pathology. The same Saturn on the same Moon sits in thousands of charts, and those thousands have thousands of different bodies. A tendency is a direction, not a diagnosis. Parallel: a weather forecast tells you to carry an umbrella; it does not tell you that you are already wet.

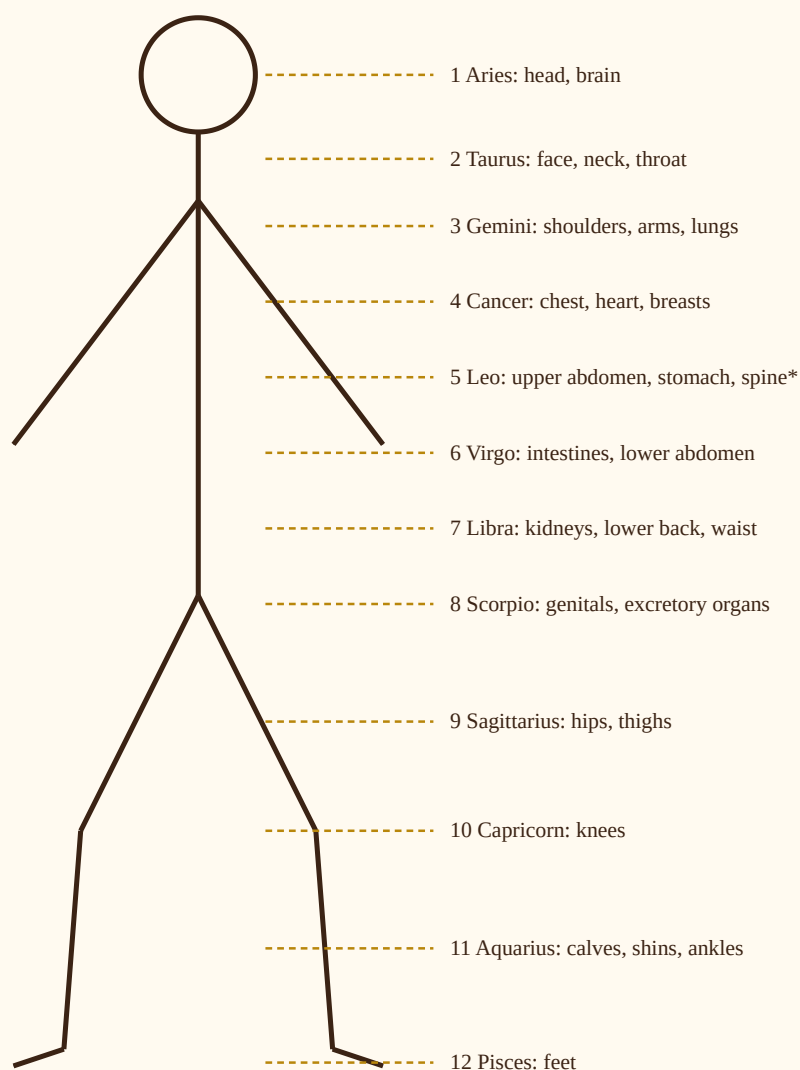
What, then, is the astrologer's job in health? To notice where the chart carries a *sensitivity*, and to say so in a way that sends the person to a doctor sooner rather than later. The sentence I use, word for word, is: **"Your chart shows a sensitivity in this area: please keep up regular check-ups."** That sentence does more good than any gemstone. It has sent people for tests that found things early. It has never frightened anyone.

With that fixed, let us learn the anatomy.

The anatomy map: signs, houses, planets

The tradition lays the zodiac on the body of the Cosmic Man (*Kala Purusha*), head to feet, Aries to Pisces. The houses follow the same order from the Lagna. And each planet governs a *system* rather than a place. The three maps are read together.

The Cosmic Man (Kala Purusha): signs on the body



Head to feet, Aries to Pisces: the zodiac laid on the body of the Kala Purusha (BPHS). *Spine: traditional addition.
Houses follow the same order from the Lagna (1st = head ... 12th = feet). Both maps are read together.

Figure 20.1: The Kala Purusha. Aries head, Taurus face and throat, Gemini arms and lungs, Cancer chest, Leo stomach, Virgo intestines, Libra kidneys and lower back, Scorpio genitals and excretion, Sagittarius hips and thighs, Capricorn knees, Aquarius calves and ankles, Pisces feet.

STORY: THE COSMIC MAN ASLEEP ACROSS TWELVE ROOMS. Picture a giant lying asleep across the whole haveli: the Kala Purusha, the Man of Time. His head rests in the first room (Aries, the Commander's district), his face and throat in the second, his arms stretch through the third, his chest fills the fourth, his stomach the fifth, and so on down to his feet, which stick out of the twelfth room by the back gate. Now the courtiers walk through the rooms at night. Wherever the old Judge sits down, that part of the giant grows stiff and cold. Wherever the Commander stamps, it heats and bleeds. Wherever the Smoke-headed Stranger stands, it aches in a way no physician can name. And wherever Guru-ji lays his hand, the limb rests easy. Every birth chart is one night in that house; the astrologer only notes which rooms had which visitors. **Rule:** sign and house name the body part (head to feet, Aries to Pisces, 1st to 12th); the planet names the kind of trouble.

Signs → **body parts** come from Appendix A.1. **Houses** → **body parts** come from A.5: 1st head, 2nd face and mouth, 3rd arms and ears, 4th chest, 5th stomach and upper belly, 6th intestines, 7th lower belly and pelvis, 8th genitals and excretion, 9th thighs and hips, 10th knees, 11th calves and shins, 12th feet. When a planet sits in a house, both the sign and the house speak: Saturn in the 2nd house in Sagittarius touches the face, teeth, throat and speech (2nd) *and* the hips and thighs (Sagittarius).

WHY? (Classical statement with an astronomical logic.) Parashara describes the zodiac as the body of the Kala Purusha, head to feet, Aries to Pisces. Why head first? Because the Lagna, the 1st house, is the sign rising at birth, and a child is born head first: the first house is the head, and the rest of the body follows the order of rising. The houses copy the same order from your own Lagna. Parallel: a tailor measures from the collar down, always in the same order, so that every measurement has a fixed place.

Planets → **systems:**

Planet	Effect on the body	Body systems and tendencies
Sun	☀ vitality, but heat	Heart, bones, eyes (right eye), vitality, fevers, spine
Moon	🌑 when bright; 🌑 when dark	Fluids, mind and mood, breasts, stomach, left eye, sleep
Mars	♂ acute, sharp	Blood, muscles, accidents, cuts and surgery, fevers, inflammation
Mercury	☿ by company	Nerves, skin, speech, lungs and breathing, the intellect
Jupiter	♃ protector (excess: fat, sugar)	Liver, fat, sugar, ears, growths, the pancreas by extension
Venus	♀ (excess: indulgence)	Reproductive organs, kidneys, hormones, eyes, the throat
Saturn	♄ chronic, slow	Chronic conditions, bones, teeth, joints, nerves, low mood, cold
Rahu	☊ mysterious	Undiagnosed or mysterious illness, poisons, addictions, phobias, infections that puzzle
Ketu	☋ sudden	Infections, wounds, viral fevers, cuts, surgery, sudden sharp pain

The tridosha link (as tradition teaches it). The Ayurveda–Jyotish crossover assigns the fiery planets Sun and Mars to *pitta* (heat, inflammation, acidity); the Moon and Venus to *kapha* (fluids, weight, congestion); Saturn, Rahu and Mercury to *vata* (nerves, dryness, joints, anxiety). Jupiter is usually given to *kapha* as well. I label this a tradition rather than a rule: it is useful for the *flavour* of a complaint, "heat-type" versus "cold-type", and it gives a client a language their Ayurvedic doctor will recognise. It is not a prescription.

DID YOU KNOW? The word *Kala Purusha* means "the Man of Time". The image of the zodiac as a cosmic body appears in the Puranas as well as in Parashara, and the same idea, the sky as a body, the body as a sky, runs through Indian temple architecture, where the plan of a shrine is also laid on the figure of a man (the *Vastu Purusha*).

The health houses and their lords

STORY: CLINIC, OPERATING THEATRE AND HOSPITAL WARD. *Three rooms of the haveli were given to the physicians. The 6th room, near the servants' hall, was the clinic: fevers, cuts, stomach upsets, you walked in, were treated, and walked out; the Commander was its patron, and a strong clinic meant a household that fought off illness. The 8th room, deep inside and rarely opened, was the operating theatre and the family's long-term ledger: chronic complaints, surgeries, and the record of how long each member lived; the old Judge kept its key, and a well-placed Judge there meant a long ledger, not a short one. The 12th room, by the back gate, was the hospital ward: the bed where one lay when one could not rise, with the door to the outside world half open. The front room, the 1st, was the constitution, how sturdy the house itself was built. **Rule:** 1st = constitution; 6th = acute, treatable; 8th = chronic, surgery, longevity; 12th = hospitalisation. Their lords carry the same meanings wherever they sit.*

Four houses do most of the work.

The 1st house: constitution. The Lagna, its sign, its occupants and above all its lord describe the body's basic strength. A strong Lagna lord (Chapter 12: own sign, exaltation, kendra, unafflicted) is the immune system of the chart. Such people fall ill and bounce back. A weak Lagna lord means the body needs more care for the same life.

The 6th house: acute illness. The 6th (Ripu bhava) is disease that comes and goes: infections, fevers, injuries, the treatable. It is also *fighting* disease, a strong 6th lord gives a good fighter. The sign on the 6th and the placement of its lord show *where* the acute troubles tend to land.

The 8th house: chronic illness, surgery, longevity. The 8th is the deep house: conditions that stay, operations, and the span of life itself. Malefics in the 8th are not automatically bad for health, Saturn in the 8th is a classical long-life indicator, but the 8th lord's condition tells you whether chronic matters will be mild or heavy.

WHY? (Logic.) The 6th is an upachaya, a house of effort and fights, so what it brings can be fought off: acute, treatable. The 8th is the 12th from the 9th, the loss of grace, and the house of transformation and longevity; things there work slowly and stay. That is why the 6th is the cold and the 8th is the slipped disc. Parallel: a quarrel at the office (6th) is settled by Friday; a court case (8th) runs for years.

The 12th house: hospitalisation, confinement. The 12th is the bed: hospital stays, long rests, isolation. Malefics in the 12th or its lord afflicted point to periods of enforced rest.

WHY? (Logic.) The 12th is the 12th from the 1st: the loss of the body's freedom. It is also the house of the bed, sleep and confinement. A hospital is exactly that, a bed you cannot leave. Parallel: the difference between resting at home and being admitted is the locked ward door.

Two more actors matter more than any house. **The Lagna lord's strength is vitality.** And **the Moon's strength is mental health**, which brings us to a section I ask you to read slowly.

Mental health: the Moon, read with care

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER'S HEALTH. *The whole court takes its mood from the Queen Mother. When Rani Ma is bright, the waxing Moon, in her own district or a friend's, with Guru-ji calling on her, the kitchens sing and even bad news is borne. When the old Judge sits beside her, the palace grows quiet and heavy; when the Smoke-headed Stranger stands at her door, she cannot sleep for fears no one can name; when she is sent to the clinic, the theatre or the ward (the 6th, 8th or 12th) and the malefics follow her there, the court itself sickens. The young Prince, her son, carries her worries into his ledgers and his speech falters. The physician's wisdom was this: the Queen Mother is never dismissed as "just moody". She is attended at once, and by a real physician. **Rule:** the Moon is the mind; Saturn, Rahu, dusthana placement and affliction on Mercury are strain markers, and strain on the mind is referred to a professional, never remedied away.*

The Moon is the mind. Its sign, its brightness (waxing or waning), its company and its house tell you how a person's mind weathers life. The indicators the tradition watches for mental strain are: the Moon with Saturn (heaviness, low mood, pessimism); the Moon with Rahu (anxiety, obsessive thinking, fears without names); the Moon in the 6th, 8th or 12th *and* afflicted by malefics (the mind under siege); Mercury afflicted (the thinking faculty disturbed; speech and nerves); a weak or afflicted 4th house (inner peace) and 5th house (the capacity for joy, the intellect). A waning Moon close to the Sun (the dark Moon) adds sensitivity.

WHY? (Classical definition, with an astronomical logic.) Parashara names the Moon the karaka of the mind (manas). The astronomy explains the choice: the Moon is the fastest body, changing sign every two and a quarter days and changing shape every night, exactly as moods do. The planet that never stays the same was made the ruler of the faculty that never stays the same. Parallel: your mood on a Monday depends on the news, the weather and who spoke to you; so does the Moon's face.

Indicator	Reads as
○ Moon with Saturn	Heaviness, low mood, pessimism
○ Moon with Rahu	Anxiety, obsessive thinking, unnamed fears
○ Moon in 6, 8 or 12 <i>and</i> afflicted	The mind under siege
● Mercury afflicted	Thinking and speech disturbed; nerves
● Weak 4th or 5th house	Inner peace and joy harder to reach
● Dark Moon (close to the Sun)	Sensitivity
● Jupiter aspecting the Moon; Moon in own/friendly sign, bright	Resilience; the mind rights itself

These are *tendencies toward strain*, not diagnoses of illness, and none of them is rare, most charts have at least one. What matters is how many stack up, whether Jupiter aspects the Moon (the great protector of the mind), and what dasha is running. The consultant's duty here is not astrological at all. If a client tells you they cannot sleep, cannot stop crying, cannot feel anything, or are thinking of ending their life, your job is to encourage professional help immediately, a doctor, a counsellor, a helpline, and to follow up. You may add that the chart shows this as a *period* that eases, because that is usually true and always kind. You may never say "it is just your Saturn, do a remedy and it will pass". Mental illness is treatable; an astrologer who delays treatment has done harm.

CONSULTATION TIP: For any mental-health indicator, my three sentences are: "Your chart shows a sensitive mind; that is also the mind of poets and healers. In this period it is under more pressure than usual, and the pressure eases from _____. Please speak to a doctor or counsellor now; the remedy I give you is *in addition* to that, never instead of it."

The "which body part" method

When a client asks "where should I be careful", run this sequence:

1. **The 6th lord**, the sign and house it occupies name the first sensitive area (sign → A.1; house → A.5).
2. **Planets afflicted**, any planet debilitated, combust, or hemmed by malefics: its system (table above) is sensitive, and the sign and house it occupies say where.
3. **Signs occupied by malefics**, Saturn, Mars, Rahu, Ketu each sit on a body part; read the sign.
4. **The Lagna and 8th lords**, their signs add constitutional weak points.
5. **The D30 Trimsamsa**, the divisional chart of misfortune and disease (Appendix A.10). Malefic-ruled portions of the D30 sharpen the picture. The **D6 Shashthamsa** is used by some for disease specifically. Both are advanced; look at them only after D1 is clear.

Accidents are read from Mars–Ketu–Rahu combinations (especially in the Lagna, 4th, 8th or in movable signs, which are about motion and travel), from the 8th house and its lord, and from Mars–Saturn contacts (sudden force meeting rigid structure, falls, fractures). A client with these does not need to be frightened; they need to be told to wear a helmet and not to drive tired during the indicated periods.

Chronic versus acute. Saturn, the 8th house and fixed signs point to conditions that stay and need management; Mars, Ketu, the 6th house and movable signs to conditions that arrive sharply and leave. This is the difference between "keep up your check-ups" and "be careful in these months".

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Sign says *where*, house says *where again*, planet says *what kind*. If the three do not point to the same part of the body, you have a general sensitivity, not a specific one, say less, not more.

Timing illness and recovery

Illness has its seasons, and this is where the astrologer is genuinely useful, not for naming the illness, but for naming the months in which a check-up is wise.

Periods of vulnerability (○): the Mahadasha or Antardasha of the 6th, 8th or 12th lord; malefic antardashas whose lords sit in the 6th, 8th or 12th *from the Mahadasha lord*; Saturn or Rahu transiting the Lagna, the Lagna lord or the Moon; the second phase of Sade Sati (Saturn on the natal Moon, Appendix A.9); Ashtama Shani (Saturn in the 8th from the Moon); the maraka lords' periods (below).

Recovery (●): Jupiter's transit over the Lagna, the Moon or the Lagna lord, or its aspect on them; the dasha of the Lagna lord or of a strong benefic; the end of the malefic transit. Always give the client the date recovery indicators arrive. Hope with a date on it is medicine.

The maraka concept (Chapter 8 reminder). The lords of the 2nd and 7th, and planets in those houses, are called marakas, "killers", in the classical texts. I use the word in study and *never* with the person in front of me. For the consulting table, maraka periods are simply "periods to take health seriously": more rest, timely check-ups, no bravado.

Balarishta: infancy. Classical texts describe combinations for danger in early childhood: the Moon in the 6th, 8th or 12th afflicted by malefics, especially in a night birth; malefics in the Lagna and 7th together; the Lagna lord combust or debilitated with no benefic aspect. They also give the cancellations, which are many: a strong Jupiter aspecting the Moon or Lagna, benefics in kendras, the Lagna lord strong, the Moon waxing. Modern medicine has made the old danger far smaller than the old texts assumed. The ethics for new parents are simple: never say the word. If the chart shows a weak Moon in an infant, say "keep the child's vaccinations and check-ups on schedule and watch the digestion", and nothing more.

Protective factors (●). Learn these as well as the dangers: Jupiter aspecting the Lagna or the Moon; a strong Lagna lord; benefics in kendras; and a well-placed Saturn, which is the *Ayushkaraka*, the planet of longevity, Saturn strong in the 8th, or in its own sign, is one of the classical marks of a long life.

WHY? (Astronomy, then derivation.) Saturn is the slowest planet we can see, taking about twenty-nine and a half years to go round: it is time itself in the sky. Appendix A.5 makes it the karaka of the 8th, the house of longevity, and A.2 lists longevity first among its significations. The planet of time keeps the ledger of years. Parallel: the oldest servant in a joint family has watched every generation arrive and can tell you who lived long and why.

Longevity: the three spans, and why the beginner leaves them alone

The classical branch of life-span calculation (*Ayurdaya*) sorts lives into three categories: **Alpayu** (short, 0–32 years), **Madhyayu** (medium, 32–64), **Purnayu** (full, 64–100, with some authors extending to 120). Some texts draw the boundaries at 36 and 72.

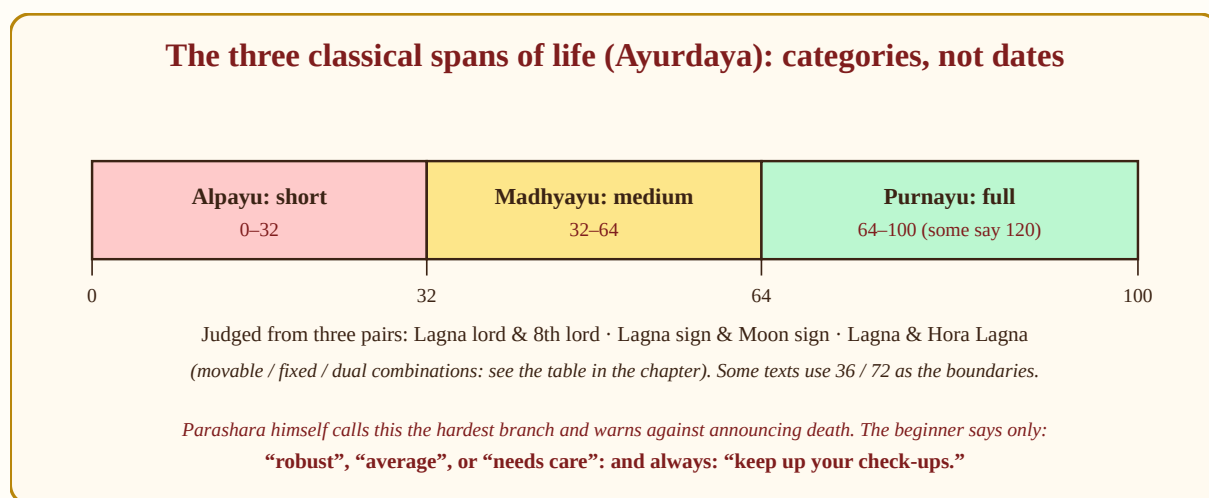


Figure 20.2: The three classical spans. A category, never a date, and even the category is judged only by experienced hands.

The category is judged from three pairs of signs, using whether each sign is movable, fixed or dual (Appendix A.1): the signs occupied by the **Lagna lord and the 8th lord**; the **Lagna sign and the Moon sign**; and the **Lagna and the Hora Lagna** (a special ascendant your software computes). For each pair:

Pair	Category
Movable + movable	● Full
Fixed + fixed	○ Short
Dual + dual	◐ Medium
Movable + fixed	◐ Medium
Movable + dual	○ Short
Fixed + dual	● Full

Where the three pairs agree, the texts take that category; where two agree, the majority; where all three differ, further rules apply (and the authors themselves disagree on them). Then come corrections for Saturn's placement, benefics in kendras, the Lagna lord's strength, and much else.

WHY? (Tradition, and I name it as such.) The pairing of movable, fixed and dual signs into full, short and medium comes from *Jataka Parijata* and *Phaladeepika*; the texts state it without a derivation, and the results are not intuitive (two fixed signs giving a short life, for instance). I have not found a reasoning that satisfies me, so I teach it as a received table and use it only to understand the classics. Parallel: an old family recipe kept exactly as grandmother wrote it, even where nobody remembers why a step is there.

STORY: THE OLD JUDGE WHO KEEPS THE KEYS. The family feared Shani-ji most of all, and he was the one who kept them alive longest. He is the *Ayushkaraka*, the keeper of the ledger of years. The households that treated him well, gave him his own quiet room in the 8th, or let him sit in his own districts of Capricorn and Aquarius, found their old people living to see great-grandchildren, slowly, stiffly, but surely. The households that panicked when he entered, and threw him out with stones and threats, lost the one servant who counted the years faithfully. Guru-ji's blessing on the front door and on the Queen Mother added the second protection. **Rule:** a well-placed Saturn is a long-life mark, not a death mark; Jupiter on the Lagna or Moon, a strong Lagna lord and benefics in kendras are the other protectors.

I want to be honest with you about this branch. The classical authors say plainly that Ayurdaya is the hardest part of Jyotish; Parashara gives several methods, admits they conflict, and warns against telling anyone their span. I have never managed to use these tables without embarrassment, and I have watched experts stumble on them too. Learn the table so you understand the tradition; then, at the table, judge only "**robust**", "**average**" or "**needs care**", and say what supports each. A reader who tells a client "medium life" has broken the first rule of this chapter and understood nothing of the second.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Mistaking Saturn in the 8th, or the Lagna lord in the 8th, for a death sentence. Saturn in the 8th is a *long-life* mark in the classics. The 8th is the house of longevity itself; planets there are read for the *quality* of the long years, not for their end.

Worked example: Chart A (Meera)

Scorpio Lagna. Lagna lord Mars retrograde in the 5th in Pisces, Jupiter's sign. Sun 28° and Mercury 9° in the Lagna. Saturn in the 2nd in Sagittarius. Rahu in the 4th (Aquarius), Ketu in the 10th (Leo). Moon in Cancer in the 9th. Venus in the 12th in Libra, own sign. Jupiter retrograde in the 7th in Taurus.

Constitution. ● The Lagna is strong: the Sun (vitality) and Mercury sit there, and the Lagna lord Mars sits in a trikona in a friend's sign. Good basic vitality. One refinement from Chapter 12: the Sun at 28° of Scorpio, an even sign, is in the infant (*Bala*) avastha, so its vitality is real but less mature than its house suggests; she tires faster than she looks.

Where the sensitivities lie. ♠ Saturn in the 2nd, Sagittarius: face, teeth, throat and speech (2nd house) and hips and thighs (Sagittarius). Dental care and the voice, and stiffness in the hips later in life. The 6th house is Aries, lord Mars, Aries and Mars together say heat, inflammation, blood, fevers: acute troubles tend to be inflammatory. The 8th house is Gemini, lord Mercury in the Lagna: nerves, breathing, skin, chronic tendencies are nervous rather than structural, and Mercury in the strong Lagna handles them well. Ketu in the 10th in Leo: the 10th is the knees (A.5), joints with age; Leo adds the stomach and spine. Rahu in the 4th in Aquarius: the 4th is the chest and heart; Aquarius the calves and circulation. This is her most important single indicator, and the 4th is also the house of mother and home, so anxiety about family expresses through the chest.

The mind. ● The Moon in Cancer, its own sign, in the 9th, with no malefic in or beside it. (Jupiter in the 7th aspects the 11th, 1st and 3rd, so the Moon does not receive its glance, note it honestly.) Even so, a dignified, unafflicted Moon in the house of faith gives good mental resilience, a mind that steadies itself through belief and learning.

Timing. Her Ashtama Shani (Saturn in Aquarius, 8th from her Cancer Moon) ran 2023–2025, exactly over natal Rahu in the 4th, the period to have taken the heart and blood pressure seriously. Her Venus Mahadasha (12th lord) is generally comfortable; Venus/Saturn (2020–2023) was the sub-period of the 2nd-house Saturn, teeth, throat, hips. The Sun Mahadasha from 2027 is the Lagna planet's own period: vitality rises, with the Sun's heat asking for care of eyes and blood pressure.

What I would say: "Your constitution is good and your mind is your strength. Two areas to keep an eye on: the heart and blood pressure, please make a yearly check a habit, especially when you are anxious about family, and teeth, throat and hips, which need ordinary care. Nothing here worries me; everything here rewards attention."

Worked example: Chart C (Devika)

Aries Lagna. Lagna lord Mars in the 3rd in Gemini at 27°. Sun 5° and Jupiter 26° (exalted) in the 4th in Cancer. Moon in the 9th in Sagittarius. Mercury 1°, Saturn 18° and Rahu 3° in the 5th in Leo. Venus in the 3rd. Ketu in the 11th in Aquarius.

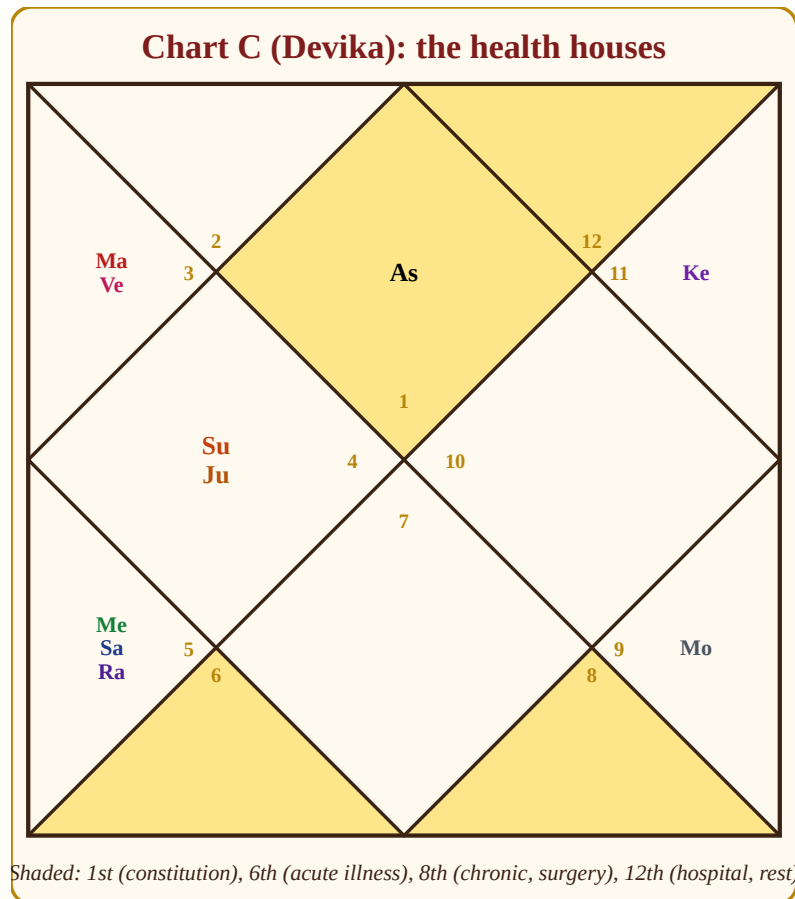


Figure 20.3: Chart C with the four health houses shaded. The Lagna and 12th are empty; the 6th (Virgo) and 8th (Scorpio) are empty; the story is in the 5th and 4th.

Constitution. ● Mars, the Lagna lord, also rules the 8th (Scorpio), the same planet governs vitality and longevity, which the classics read as robust. Mars in Gemini at 27°: shoulders, arms and lungs (Gemini and the 3rd house both). She may have respiratory sensitivity, colds that settle in the chest, or shoulder strain, but Mars there is not afflicted, and the constitution is sound.

The 5th-house cluster. ○ Saturn, Rahu and Mercury in Leo in the 5th. The 5th house is the stomach and upper belly; Leo is the upper abdomen, stomach and, by tradition, the spine. Saturn (chronic, cold, constriction) with Rahu (the mysterious, anxiety) on Mercury (nerves): stress-related digestive trouble, acidity, irregular digestion that flares under worry, and a tendency toward back stiffness. Mercury is also her 6th lord (Virgo), sitting with the two malefics, which confirms that her acute complaints route through digestion and nerves.

Protection. ● Exalted Jupiter in the 4th with the Sun protects the chest and heart: a strong shield over the 4th house. Note, honestly, what Jupiter does *not* do: from Cancer, its 5th, 7th and 9th aspects fall on Scorpio (the 8th), Capricorn (the 10th) and Pisces (the 12th). It does not aspect the 5th, so the digestive cluster is not softened by Jupiter's glance. Its protection to the 8th and 12th, however, is the classical kind that makes chronic matters milder and hospital stays shorter.

The mind. ● The Moon in Sagittarius in the 9th, unafflicted: buoyant, philosophical, resilient. The worry lives in the 5th cluster (Mercury with Saturn and Rahu, an anxious, over-thinking intellect), not in the Moon. She thinks herself into a stomach-ache; she does not sink.

Timing. Her Rahu Mahadasha runs from July 2021 to July 2039, Rahu sitting in the 5th cluster. This is the eighteen-year period in which digestion, blood sugar (Leo and the 5th; Jupiter as karaka of sugar is strong, which helps) and stress management need routine attention. Within it, Rahu/Jupiter (roughly 2024–2026) is softened by the exalted Jupiter; Rahu/Saturn (roughly 2026–2029) and Rahu/Mercury (roughly 2029–2032) are the sub-periods that bring the whole cluster into play.

What I would say: "You are physically robust, your chart's vitality and longevity planet are one and the same. Your weak point is digestion under stress: acidity, a nervous stomach, back stiffness when you worry. Through this long Rahu period, make the annual blood-sugar and digestive check a habit and treat stress as a health matter, not a character flaw. Your chest and heart are well protected."

The ten-point health checklist

1. Lagna, Lagna lord, strength, dignity, affliction: the constitution.
2. Moon, sign, brightness, company, house: the mind.
3. 6th house and lord, acute tendencies; where (sign and house).
4. 8th house and lord, chronic tendencies; surgery; longevity quality.
5. 12th house and lord, hospitalisation, rest.
6. Afflicted planets, debilitated, combust, hemmed: which system, which part.
7. ○ Malefics by sign and house, body parts under pressure; Mars–Ketu–Rahu and Mars–Saturn for accidents.
8. ● Protection, Jupiter's aspects, benefics in kendras, Saturn well placed.
9. ○ Timing, dashas of 6th/8th/12th lords, maraka periods, Saturn/Rahu on Lagna or Moon, Sade Sati phase 2, Ashtama Shani; and the recovery dates.
10. Phrasing, sensitivity, check-ups, doctor first. Never a diagnosis, never a date.

CONSULTATION TIP: Three model sentences to carry with you. (1) "Your chart shows a sensitivity in the ____ area, please keep up regular check-ups there." (2) "The months from ____ to ____ are a period to take your health seriously: rest more, test on time, no heroics." (3) "Whatever remedy I suggest is in addition to your doctor's treatment, never instead of it."

FROM LAL KITAB: The Lal Kitab tradition reads health largely through the planet in the 6th house (Ketu's permanent house) and through Mercury and Ketu together, with remedies such as feeding dogs, keeping the house free of cobwebs and not accepting free medicine, as commonly taught in that tradition. It is a separate system and is not blended with the Parashari method above. (*Source: Lal Kitab, Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, 1939–1952 Urdu editions; Hindi translations vary.*)

In one breath

- Ethics first: no diagnosis, no death date, never interfere with treatment. The sentence is "a sensitivity here, please keep up regular check-ups".
- Three maps: signs on the body (Kala Purusha), houses on the body (A.5), planets on systems. Read a placement through all three.
- The 1st is constitution, the 6th acute illness, the 8th chronic and surgery, the 12th the hospital bed. The Lagna lord is vitality; the Moon is the mind.
- Mental-health indicators (Moon with Saturn or Rahu, in 6/8/12 afflicted, Mercury afflicted, weak 4th/5th) are tendencies toward strain; the consultant's duty is to encourage professional help.
- Time vulnerability by the 6th/8th/12th lords' periods, maraka periods, Saturn/Rahu on Lagna or Moon, Sade Sati and Ashtama Shani; time recovery by Jupiter and the Lagna lord.
- Longevity has three classical categories judged from movable/fixed/dual pairs; the classics call it the hardest branch. The beginner says only robust, average or needs care.
- Meera: strong constitution, heart and blood pressure to watch (Rahu in the 4th), teeth and hips (Saturn in the 2nd), excellent mental resilience.

- Devika: robust (Lagna and 8th lord the same), stress-driven digestion (Saturn, Rahu, Mercury in the 5th), heart well shielded by exalted Jupiter; the Rahu period is the one for routine checks.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. Chart B (Arjun, Cancer Lagna: Sun 18°, Mercury 2°, Saturn 25° in Aquarius in the 8th; Moon 6° Taurus in the 11th; Mars 21° (R) Leo in the 2nd; Jupiter 22° Scorpio in the 5th; Venus 24° Capricorn in the 7th; Rahu Libra in the 4th; Ketu Aries in the 10th). Name his Lagna lord and where it sits, and judge his constitution in one sentence.
2. Which body areas does Arjun's 8th-house cluster point to? Use both the sign and the house.
3. Arjun's Moon in Taurus: is it afflicted? What does Rahu in the 4th add to the mental-health reading?
4. Using the longevity table, classify the Lagna lord–8th lord pair and the Lagna–Moon pair for Chart A (Lagna lord Mars in Pisces; 8th lord Mercury in Scorpio; Lagna Scorpio; Moon Cancer). Then write the sentence you would actually say to Meera.
5. A client says, "My astrologer told me I have a maraka period from March and I should not travel." What do you tell them?

Answers

1. Lagna lord Moon in Taurus in the 11th, near its exaltation degree, in a benefic Venus sign, unafflicted: a good constitution with strong recuperative power, and a mind that steadies under pressure. 2. Aquarius: calves, shins, ankles, and by extension circulation. The 8th house: genitals and excretory organs. With Saturn (chronic), Sun (heart, bones) and Mercury (nerves) there: chronic tendencies in circulation and the lower legs, and in the excretory or reproductive system, "keep up check-ups" material, not alarm. 3. The Moon is unafflicted (Venus's sign, no malefic conjunct; Jupiter in Scorpio opposes it from the 5th, which is a benefic 7th aspect, protective). Rahu in the 4th adds unease about home, mother and belonging, anxiety with a domestic root, but the strong Moon carries it. 4. Mars in Pisces (dual) with Mercury in Scorpio (fixed): fixed + dual = full. Lagna Scorpio (fixed) with Moon Cancer (movable): movable + fixed = medium. The pairs disagree (the third, the Hora Lagna, would be needed), which is exactly why the beginner does not use the table at the desk. The sentence: "Your constitution is robust; keep an eye on the heart and blood pressure, and you have every reason to plan a long life." 5. The word "maraka" should never have reached them. Explain that the 2nd and 7th lords' periods are read as times to take health seriously, rest, check-ups, no bravado, and that nothing in that concept forbids travel. Ask what the doctor says, and encourage them to follow that.

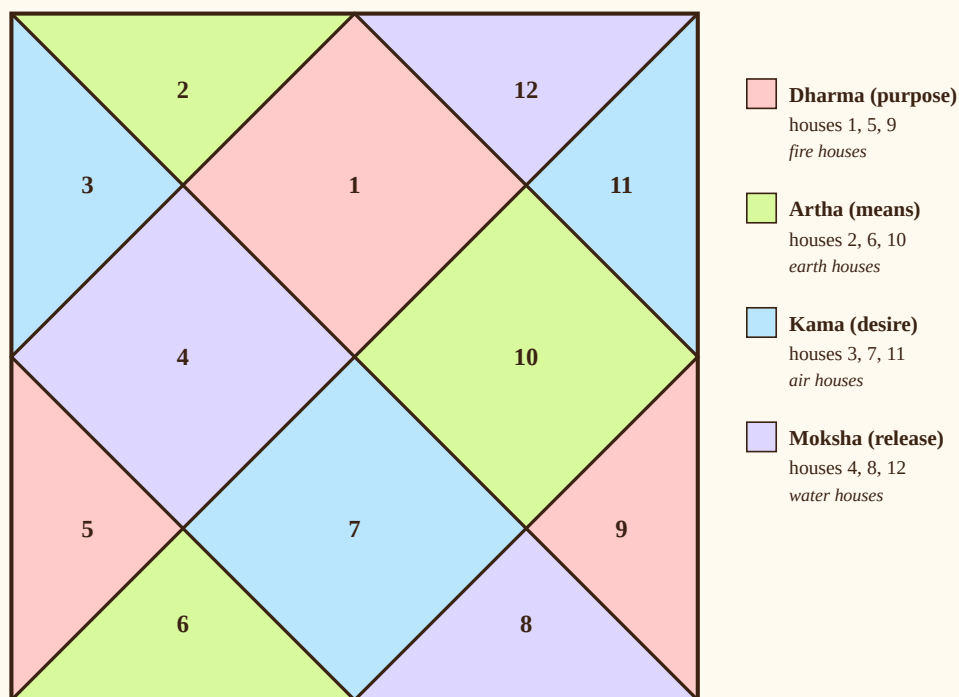
Chapter 21: Children, Education, Property, Travel and the Spiritual Path

After career, money, marriage and health, the client's list is not finished. "Will we have children?" "Which stream should my daughter take?" "Should I buy the flat now?" "Will I settle abroad?" And, more often than you might expect, quietly at the end: "Didi, is there something spiritual in my chart?"

Five questions, five short methods. Each one uses the same five-step reading you learned in Chapter 9, the house, its lord, the karaka, the same house from the Moon, and the divisional chart, and each ends with a mini checklist you can run at the table. We will work every method on a case-study chart, and we will spend a moment on the ethics that each question carries, because every one of them can be answered cruelly.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Every life question has three witnesses, the house, its lord, and its karaka planet. One witness is a rumour. Two is a lead. Three agreeing is a reading. Never speak on one.

The four aims of life: four triangles in the diamond



Each aim is a triangle of three houses, four signs apart: the same pattern as the elements in the natural zodiac.

The spiritual questions of this chapter live in the Moksha triangle (4, 8, 12), with the 9th (dharma) as the door.

Ketu, Jupiter and Saturn are its three karakas: release, guidance, renunciation.

Figure 21.1: The four aims of life as four triangles. The questions in this chapter touch all four, children and education (5th, 9th, 4th), property (4th), travel (3rd, 9th, 12th) and moksha (4th, 8th, 12th).

1. Children: the 5th house and Jupiter

STORY: THE NURSERY AND THE FAMILY PRIEST. *The 5th room of the haveli was the nursery, painted yellow, and Guru-ji, the family priest, was the one who blessed every birth in it. When he was strong, in his own district or exalted in Cancer, the Queen Mother's home, the cradles filled easily. When he was weak, far away in Capricorn under the old Judge's roof, or scorched standing too near the King, the family waited and prayed. And the nursery had visitors. If the old Judge sat in it, the children came late; if the Smoke-headed Stranger stood at its door, they came by an unexpected road, a clinic, an adoption, a surprise. The 9th room, the nursery's own nursery, five doors on, was where the grandmother kept the second cradle. Rule: 5th house and lord, Jupiter's dignity, the 9th as the 5th-from-5th; malefics there mean effort and a different road, never "no children".*

The houses. The 5th house (Putra bhava) is children, from the Lagna and again from the Moon. Bhavat Bhavam (Appendix A.5) gives a second signal: the 5th from the 5th is the 9th. A chart with a troubled 5th but a strong 9th usually has children after effort. Read the 5th lord's house, dignity and company as you would any lord.

WHY? (Logic, then symbolism.) The 5th is the 9th from the 9th: the fortune of your fortune, the fruit of merit, which is why the texts call it Poorva Punya, past good deeds. Children were understood as the return on a family's merit. On the Kala Purusha the 5th is the belly and the womb. Parallel: a grandmother saying "children are the interest on good karma" is quoting this house without knowing it.

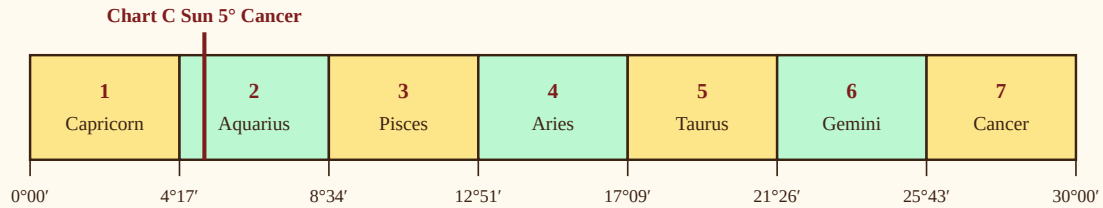
The karaka. Jupiter is the Putrakaraka, the significator of children. Its dignity is the first thing I check when a couple asks: exalted or in its own sign, and I relax; debilitated in Capricorn, combust or in the 6th, 8th or 12th, and I prepare to speak of effort.

WHY? (Derivation, with astronomy behind the symbol.) Appendix A.5 makes Jupiter the natural karaka of the 5th. Jupiter is expansion and blessing: the largest planet in the sky, the priest who blesses births and naming ceremonies. The planet of growth rules the house of the family growing. Parallel: the family priest is the first outsider called when a child is born, and his blessing is what the nursery waits for.

The Saptamsa (D7). The divisional chart of progeny divides each sign into seven parts of $4^{\circ}17'$ each. For an odd sign the seven parts are counted from the sign itself; for an even sign, from its 7th sign. The slice number is the whole part of $(\text{degree} \div 4.2857)$ plus one. Take Chart C's 5th lord, the Sun at 5° Cancer. Cancer is even, so we start from Capricorn. $5 \div 4.2857 = 1.17$, whole part 1, plus 1 = the 2nd slice: Capricorn, then **Aquarius**. Devika's 5th lord falls in Aquarius in the D7, Saturn's sign, which speaks of delay before fulfilment.

WHY? (Classical assignment; tradition.) Parashara assigns each divisional chart to a life area, and the seventh division to progeny. The number seven is not derived from the 5th house; it is the tradition's choice, and I say so plainly. What the D7 does is what every varga does: it looks inside a sign to see which portion of it a planet occupies. Parallel: the village office keeps a separate births register apart from the land records; same people, different ledger.

Saptamsa (D7) ruler for Cancer: seven slices of 4°17'



Cancer is an even sign, so counting starts from its 7th sign, Capricorn. $5^\circ \div 4^\circ 17' = 1.17 \rightarrow$ the 2nd slice $\rightarrow$ Aquarius.

For an odd sign (Aries, Gemini, Leo...) counting starts from the sign itself.

Rule of thumb: slice number = whole part of $(\text{degree} \div 4.2857) + 1$.

Figure 21.2: The D7 ruler for Cancer. Seven slices of 4°17', counted from the 7th sign because Cancer is even. The Sun at 5° lands in the second slice, Aquarius.

Timing. Children arrive in the dasha of the 5th lord, of Jupiter, of planets in the 5th, or of the lord of the 5th from the Moon, supported by Jupiter's transit over the 5th, the 9th or the Lagna, or its aspect on the 5th.

Delays and difficulty: "effort needed". Saturn, Rahu, Ketu or Mars in the 5th or on its lord; the 5th lord in the 6th, 8th or 12th; Jupiter debilitated or combust; the 5th from the Moon similarly troubled. Two of these and I say "effort"; three or four and I say "medical support is likely to be part of the story, and it succeeds in most charts". Advanced students compute the Beeja sphuta (a point combining Sun, Venus and Jupiter, read for the husband) and the Kshetra sphuta (Moon, Mars, Jupiter, for the wife); the sign and Navamsa of each is judged for fertility. Know the names; leave them for later.

Signal	Reads as
● Jupiter exalted, own sign or kendra; 5th lord in kendra/trikona; benefic in 5th	Children come easily; strong protection
● One of: Saturn, Rahu, Ketu or Mars on the 5th or its lord; 5th lord in 6, 8 or 12	Effort, patience, possibly a delay
● 5th lord with Rahu or Saturn; Ketu in 5th; 5th from Moon strong while 5th from Lagna is troubled	A different door: medical help, adoption
○ Two or more of the above <i>and</i> Jupiter debilitated or combust	Medical support likely part of the story: and it succeeds in most charts

Putra dosha and Pitru dosha. The tradition speaks of a "children's affliction" (Putra dosha, Rahu or Ketu with the 5th lord, malefics in the 5th) and an "ancestral affliction" (Pitru dosha, Sun with Rahu or Ketu, the 9th afflicted), and prescribes remedies for both. I present them to clients as *traditional beliefs with traditional remedies*, described in Chapter 23, and I never let them become a verdict on a couple who are already suffering.

Number and sex of children. The classical texts do contain rules for counting children (from the Navamsa of the 5th lord, from planets aspecting the 5th) and for predicting sons or daughters (odd signs male, even female, and so on). I tell you plainly: the counting rules are unreliable, and the sex rules are both unreliable *and* unethical to use. If a client asks you to predict or select the sex of a child, refuse, kindly and completely. It is against the law in India and against everything this science is for.

Adoption. The 5th lord with Rahu or Saturn, Ketu in the 5th, or the 5th from the Moon strongly placed while the 5th from the Lagna is troubled, these charts often find children by a different door. Say it as a possibility and as a blessing.

Children's welfare from the parent's chart. The 5th house and Jupiter also describe the children's health and fortune from the parent's side; a strong 5th means the parent's chart supports the children. The child's own chart, of course, is the real authority.

Worked example: Chart C (Devika). Aries Lagna. The 5th is Leo with Mercury 1°, Saturn 18° and Rahu 3°. The 5th lord, the Sun, sits in the 4th in Cancer with exalted Jupiter at 26°. The 5th from her Moon (Sagittarius) is Aries, empty, its lord Mars in the 3rd.

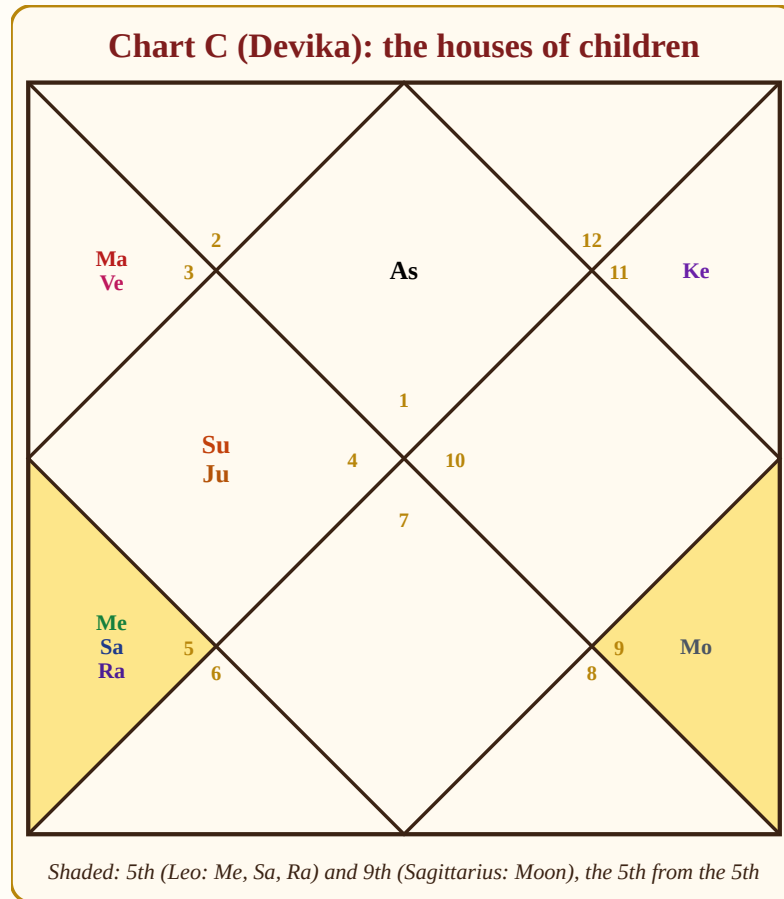


Figure 21.3: Chart C. Saturn and Rahu on the 5th house with Mercury; the 5th lord Sun protected by exalted Jupiter in the 4th; the Moon in the 9th, the 5th from the 5th.

○ Two heavy malefics on the 5th is the "effort" signature; anxiety about children is written in. ● But look at the protections: the 5th lord sits with the exalted Putrakaraka, the strongest Jupiter possible, in a kendra. The 9th, the 5th from the 5th, holds the Moon in a benefic sign. Delay, then blessing. **Timing:** her Venus Mahadasha ran to age nineteen, the Sun Mahadasha (5th lord!) from nineteen to twenty-five, plausible but young, and the Moon Mahadasha from twenty-five to thirty-five (July 2004 to July 2014), the Moon sitting in the 9th. Within it, Moon/Jupiter ran from about June 2007 to October 2008, and Jupiter transited sidereal Sagittarius, her 9th house, from about late 2007 to late 2008, from where its 9th aspect falls on Leo, the 5th, and its 5th aspect on Aries, the Lagna. Sub-period of the Putrakaraka, Jupiter on the 9th, Jupiter aspecting the 5th and the Lagna: a child around age twenty-eight to twenty-nine. It is a constructed case, but notice how every layer had to agree before I named a window.

Children mini checklist: 1. 5th house from Lagna and Moon; the 9th as the 5th-from-5th. 2. 5th lord, house, dignity, company. 3. Jupiter's dignity. 4. D7: the 5th lord's and Jupiter's D7 signs. 5. ○ Delay factors (Saturn, Rahu, Ketu, Mars; lord in 6/8/12); ● adoption hints; ● Jupiter's protection. 6. Timing: 5th lord, Jupiter, planets in the 5th; Jupiter's transit. 7. Ethics: "effort", never "never"; refuse sex prediction.

CONSULTATION TIP: To a couple trying for a child: "Your chart asks for effort and patience here, and it also carries a strong protection, the planet of children is at its best in your chart. The periods that favour you are _____. Please take the doctor's help without hesitation; the chart and the clinic work together."

2. Education: the 4th, 5th and 9th

STORY: THE SCHOOL-ROOM AND THE LAND DEED. *The 4th room of the haveli did double duty. In the morning it was the school-room, where the Queen Mother sat the children down and the young Prince taught them letters; in the afternoon the same room held the iron box with the land deeds, because the 4th is home, mother, schooling and property all at once, the things that hold you up from below. The tutors who visited decided the subjects: the Commander taught drill and engineering, Guru-ji law and scripture, Shukracharya music and drawing, the old Judge history and patience (his pupils were slow and finished everything), the Headless Sadhu mathematics, and the Smoke-headed Stranger foreign tongues and strange machines. Upstairs, the 5th room was where the clever child read alone, and the 9th was the college in the next town. Rule: 4th = schooling and foundations; 5th = intelligence; 9th = higher learning; the planet dominating them and Mercury names the subject. The 4th also holds the land deed.*

The houses. The 4th is schooling and foundations; the 5th is intelligence and higher study; the 9th is higher learning, philosophy and the university; the 2nd is early speech and the first learning. **The planets:** Mercury is grasp and memory, Jupiter wisdom and the teacher, Saturn perseverance (the slow scholar who finishes), Ketu mathematics, research and intuition. The divisional chart is the **D24 Chaturvimsamsa** (Appendix A.10), advanced, but worth glancing at for the D24 Lagna lord.

WHY? (Astronomy, then logic.) The 4th is the bottom of the chart, the midnight point, the foundation everything else stands on. What holds a life up from below? The mother's lap, the house, the land, and the schooling that shaped the mind before it could choose. That is why one house carries education and property together: both are what you sit on. Parallel: the floor of a house is both where the child learns to walk and the deed that says the house is yours.

WHY? (Logic and symbolism.) The 9th is dharma, the guru and the father: the trine of grace. Higher learning is what a guru gives, not what a school-room drills, so the 9th took the university and the philosophy while the 4th kept the classroom. Parallel: the 4th is the tuition teacher at home; the 9th is the professor who changes how you think.

"Which subject?" Find the planet that most strongly influences the 4th, the 5th, the 9th and Mercury, by placement, lordship or aspect, and read the table:

Planet	On the 4th/5th/Mercury	Subjects
Sun	☿	Medicine, administration, political science
Moon	☾ when bright	Psychology, hospitality, nursing, home sciences
Mars	♂ restless	Engineering, surgery, defence studies, sports
Mercury	☿ grasp	Commerce, mathematics, languages, computer science
Jupiter	♃ wisdom	Law, philosophy, finance, teaching, religion
Venus	♀	Arts, design, media, fashion, music
Saturn	♄ slow but finishes	History, geology, law, labour studies, archaeology
Rahu	☊ breaks, foreign	Technology, foreign languages, aviation, unconventional fields
Ketu	☋ intuitive	Mathematics, astrology, research, coding

Breaks in education (☊): the 4th lord in the 6th, 8th or 12th; Rahu or Ketu in the 4th; Saturn on the 4th or on Mercury. These do not mean "no degree"; they mean gaps, changes of stream, or a return to study later. **Foreign education:** the 12th or 9th, or Rahu, connected with the 4th or 5th.

Worked example: Chart B (Arjun). Cancer Lagna. The 4th is Libra with Rahu; its lord Venus sits in the 7th in Capricorn. The 5th is Scorpio with Jupiter at 22°; its lord Mars is retrograde in the 2nd. Mercury at 2° Aquarius sits in the 8th with the Sun and Saturn.

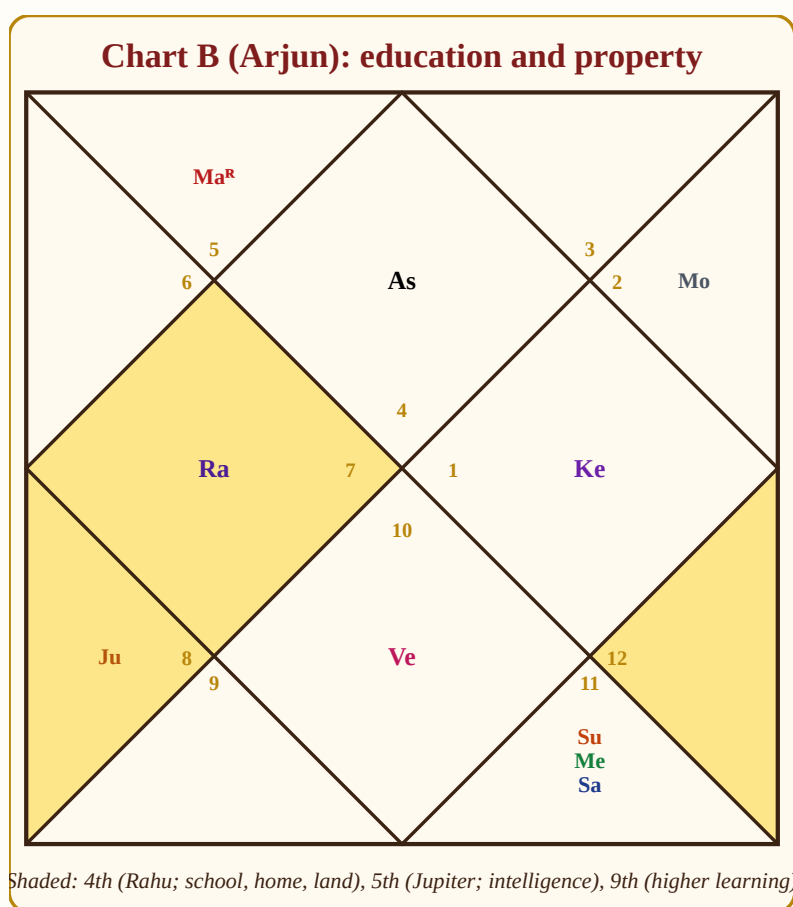


Figure 21.4: Chart B. Rahu in the 4th (unconventional or foreign schooling), Jupiter in the 5th (a deep intellect), Mercury in the 8th with Saturn (a slow-ripening, research-type mind).

A deep, research-type mind: Jupiter in Scorpio in the 5th, Mercury in the 8th (the house of the hidden) in Aquarius (science, systems). Saturn on Mercury makes him a late bloomer in examinations, the boy who is quiet in class and brilliant at twenty-six. Rahu in the 4th: unconventional schooling, or a foreign or technology-flavoured education. **Timing:** the Moon Mahadasha (age 1.8 to 11.8) covered his school years with the Lagna lord strong in the 11th, a happy school life. The Mars Mahadasha (11.8 to 18.8) is the 5th and 10th lord, the yogakaraka: good board results, a strong entry into higher study. The Rahu Mahadasha from 18.8, Rahu in the 4th, points to higher education abroad or in a new-technology field, with a change of institution along the way. Subjects: Saturn–Mercury–Sun in Aquarius and Jupiter in Scorpio favour data, actuarial or research science, and the systems side of technology.

Education mini checklist: 1. 4th (school), 5th (intellect), 9th (higher learning), 2nd (early learning). 2. Mercury and Jupiter, dignity; Saturn's touch for perseverance or delay. 3. Dominant planet on 4th/5th/9th/Mercury → subject table. 4. ○ Break indicators; ● foreign-study indicators; ● strong Mercury/Jupiter. 5. Dashes over school and college years. 6. D24 Lagna lord for confirmation.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Telling a parent "your child is not academic" because Saturn sits on Mercury. Saturn on Mercury is the *slow* scholar, not the poor one, many of the finest researchers I know carry it. Say "late bloomer; do not judge by the tenth-standard marks".

3. Property and vehicles: the 4th house

The houses and karakas. The 4th house and its lord govern land, home and vehicles. Mars is the karaka of land; Saturn of old property and long leases; Venus of vehicles and comforts; the Moon of the home itself. The **D4 Chaturthamsa** is the divisional chart of fixed assets; the **D16 Shodasamsa** covers vehicles and comforts (Appendix A.10).

Buying timing: the dasha of the 4th lord or of a planet in the 4th; Mars or Saturn transiting the 4th (the effort and the paperwork); Jupiter transiting or aspecting the 4th (the blessing). **Inheritance:** the 8th house and its lord. **Disputes over property:** links between the 4th, 6th and 8th, and Mars–Saturn contacts touching the 4th.

Worked example: Chart B (Arjun). Rahu in the 4th in Libra: property acquired through unconventional means: a loan-heavy purchase, a flat abroad, a joint venture. The 4th lord Venus in the 7th: property through the spouse or a partnership, a home bought jointly, or in the partner's city. Mars, the land karaka, retrograde in the 2nd in Leo: family land, ancestral property that returns to him after a delay. Vehicles from Venus in Capricorn in the 7th: sober, practical vehicles bought late and kept long; a partner who influences the choice. **Timing:** the Rahu Mahadasha (2013–2031) is itself the 4th-house planet's period, property matters run through it, with the Rahu/Venus sub-period (mid-2025 to mid-2028), the 4th lord's, the most likely purchase window.

Property mini checklist: 1. 4th house, sign, occupants; 4th lord, house, dignity. 2. Mars (land), Saturn (old property), Venus (vehicles), Moon (home). 3. D4 for property, D16 for vehicles. 4. Timing: 4th lord's dasha, Mars/Saturn/Jupiter on the 4th. 5. ● Inheritance (8th); ○ disputes (4th–6th–8th, Mars–Saturn); ● Jupiter or 4th lord strong on the 4th.

4. Travel and foreign settlement

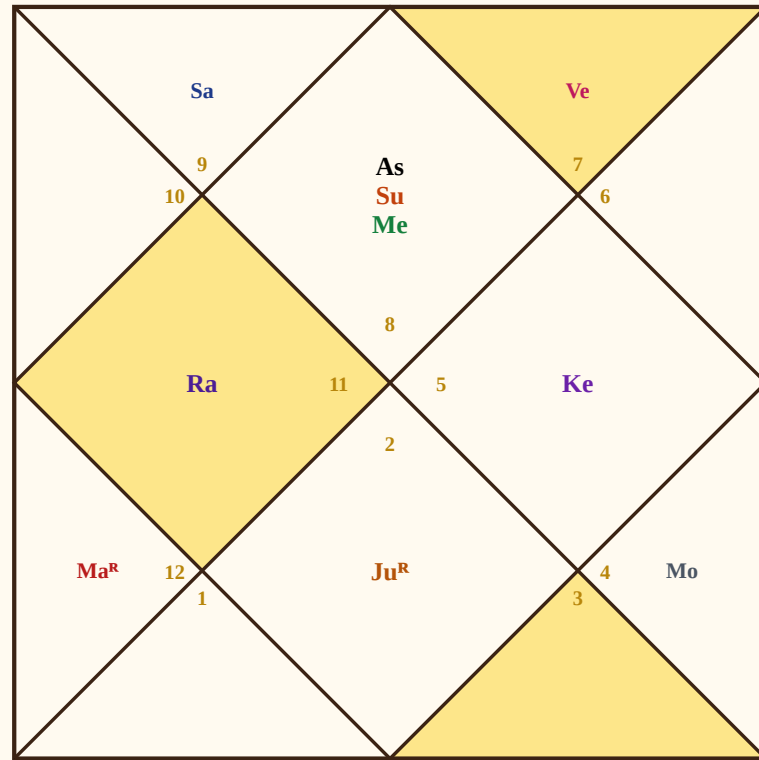
STORY: THE ROAD OUT OF THE KINGDOM. *Three roads left the haveli. The 3rd-house road went to the neighbouring villages: the Prince rode it weekly with letters. The 9th-house road went to the far temple towns, where Guru-ji made his pilgrimages and the young went to the great university. The 12th-house road went out through the back gate, past the hospital ward, to the border and beyond, the road out of the kingdom altogether. At that gate stood the Smoke-headed Stranger, who knew every foreign tongue and whispered of lands where the family name meant nothing and anything was possible. When the keeper of the 4th room, the home, was found standing at the 12th gate, or talking with the Stranger, the elders knew: this child will not stay. The Judge and the Priest, arriving at that gate in the same season, stamped the passport. Rule: 3rd short, 9th long, 12th foreign; Rahu and movable signs add distance; 4th lord in 12th or with Rahu = leaving the homeland; double transit on 12th/9th times it.*

The houses. The 3rd is short journeys; the 9th long journeys and pilgrimage; the 12th foreign lands and settlement away from home; the 7th travel for work or with a partner. **The planets:** Rahu is the foreigner and the foreign shore; the Moon is movement itself. **Signs:** movable signs on the Lagna, 9th or 12th add restlessness and distance. **Leaving the homeland:** the 4th lord in the 12th, or with Rahu, or the 4th afflicted while the 12th is strong. **Timing:** the double transit of Jupiter and Saturn on the 12th or 9th, inside the dasha of the 12th or 9th lord or of Rahu.

WHY? (Logic.) The 12th is the 12th from the 1st: the loss of the self's own place. The tradition read that loss three ways: sleep and the bed (loss of waking), isolation and hospital (loss of company), and foreign lands (loss of the homeland). Rahu, the stranger at the gate, naturally keeps company there. Parallel: the first year of a migrant is exactly a 12th-house year, the old address gone and the new one not yet home.

Worked example: Chart A (Meera). Venus, the 12th lord, sits in the 12th in its own sign Libra, a movable sign: comfortable foreign connections, money spent abroad, ease in distant places, the traveller who is at home in a hotel. Rahu in the 4th: distance from the homeland and from the mother's house; a life lived partly away. The 9th lord Moon in the 9th in its own sign: long journeys, pilgrimage, higher learning in far places, and good fortune from them. Her Venus Mahadasha (2007–2027) is the foreign period of her life; the Venus/Rahu sub-period (2014–2017) and Venus/Ketu (2026–2027) are its most mobile stretches.

Chart A (Meera): travel and the moksha houses



aded: 4th (homeland; Rahu), 8th (Gemini, empty), 12th (foreign lands; Venus in own sign)

Figure 21.5: Chart A. The 4th (Rahu, distance from home), the 8th (empty) and the 12th (Venus in its own sign, comfortable foreign connections) form her moksha triangle.

Travel mini checklist: 1. 3rd, 9th, 12th, 7th, occupants and lords. 2. Rahu and the Moon; movable signs on Lagna, 9th, 12th. 3. 4th lord in 12th / with Rahu → leaving the homeland. 4. Dasha of 12th/9th lord or Rahu; double transit on 12th/9th.

5. Spirituality and moksha

STORY: THE QUIET WING. The west side of the haveli, the 4th, 8th and 12th rooms, was the quiet wing: the inner courtyard where the mother lit the evening lamp, the locked room where the family kept what it did not speak of, and the back room by the gate where the old ones sat with their beads. Three courtiers had leave to walk there. The Headless Sadhu, who had no face left to lose, sat in the courtyard and taught letting-go. Guru-ji came through the 9th-house door with the scriptures and showed the way. And the old Judge, who had served all his life, was the one who finally set down his keys, renunciation is his. Most of the family never left the haveli for the forest; they did their sadhana in the quiet wing between the kitchen and the shop. When the Stranger sat with Guru-ji, the elders did not panic: the Priest simply preached a stranger sermon. **Rule:** moksha lives in 4–8–12 with the 9th as the door; Ketu, Jupiter and Saturn are its karakas; householder spirituality is the norm; Jupiter–Rahu questions; it does not destroy.

The houses and karakas. The moksha triangle is the 4th, 8th and 12th (Appendix A.5); the 9th (dharma) is the door to it. Ketu is the moksha-karaka; Jupiter is the guru; Saturn is renunciation. Read the 12th lord and any planets in the 12th for the shape of a person's inner life. From Jaimini (Chapter 15), the Atmakaraka, the planet of highest degree, and its Navamsa sign, the Karakamsa, are read for the soul's direction; Ketu or Jupiter in or aspecting the Karakamsa is the classical mark of a spiritual bent.

WHY? (Logic from the natural zodiac.) The 4th, 8th and 12th are the water houses: in the natural chart they hold Cancer, Scorpio and Pisces (Appendix A.1). Water dissolves. The 4th is inner peace, the 8th transformation, the 12th release; together they are the slow dissolving of the separate self that the word moksha names. Parallel: a river (4th) enters the rapids (8th) and disappears into the sea (12th).

WHY? (Myth, and astronomy behind it.) In the story, the demon Svarbhanu was cut in two and the headless body became Ketu. No head means no face, no name, no wanting: the ego is gone. Astronomically Ketu is not a body at all but the point where the Moon's path crosses the Sun's, where eclipses swallow the Sun, the king, the self. The point that swallows the self is the karaka of release from it. Parallel: the moment you stop wanting the last laddoo on the plate is a small Ketu moment.

Pravrajya (renunciation) yogas. The classics list combinations for the renunciate's life: four or more planets in one sign (the strongest planet's nature shows the order of renunciation); Saturn alone aspecting the Lagna lord with no other aspect; the Moon in a Saturn drekkana aspected by Saturn or Mars. Present these as classical, and remember that in a modern chart "four planets in a sign" is more often a specialist than a sannyasi.

Sannyasa versus householder spirituality. Most spiritual charts belong to householders. The 12th and Ketu show detachment; the 9th and Jupiter show faith and practice; the 4th shows inner peace found at home. A chart can be deeply spiritual with a family, a job and a mortgage. Say so, many clients arrive half-afraid the chart will tell them to leave.

The Guru–Chandala myth. Jupiter with Rahu is called Guru–Chandala yoga in popular teaching and read as "anti-guru": disrespect for teachers, unorthodox beliefs. The balanced view: Rahu magnifies whatever it touches; Jupiter with Rahu gives unconventional, questioning, sometimes brilliant spiritual and intellectual life, the reformer, the scientist of religion. It goes wrong only when Jupiter is otherwise weak.

Worked example: Chart A (Meera). Ketu in the 10th in Leo: the career itself becomes the spiritual practice, teaching, astrology, research as a discipline of the self. The Moon in Cancer in the 9th: devotion, faith, a mind that rests in worship. Mars, the Lagna lord, in Pisces in the 5th, Jupiter's sign, the house of mantra: mantra and upasana (personal practice) suit her. The 12th lord Venus in the 12th: comfortable in solitude and retreat; a spiritual life with beauty in it, music, ritual, a well-kept altar.

Worked example: Chart B (Arjun). Three planets in the 8th, Sun, Mercury and a combust Saturn in Aquarius: the occult, depth psychology, research into hidden things; a mind that goes down rather than up. Ketu in the 10th: detachment from the ordinary ambitions of career. Jupiter in Scorpio in the 5th: interest in mantra, tantra, the transformative practices; the 5th is the house of mantra and Scorpio the sign of hidden power. His path is the researcher's, through the 8th house.

DID YOU KNOW? Teachers of the tradition often observe that the charts of astrologers themselves show a strong 8th or 12th house and a prominent Ketu, Ketu being the karaka of Jyotish, the "headless" planet that sees without eyes. It is offered as a charming tradition, not a rule; I know excellent astrologers with neither.

Spirituality mini checklist: 1. 4th, 8th, 12th, occupants and lords; the 9th as the door. 2. Ketu (moksha), Jupiter (guru), Saturn (renunciation), placement and dignity. 3. Atmakaraka and Karakamsa; Ketu/Jupiter there. 4. 12th lord, where, and how comfortable. 5. Pravrajya yogas, noted as classical. 6. Householder or renunciate? ● Almost always householder; say so. ● Pravrajya yogas present, a specialist more often than a sannyasi.

CONSULTATION TIP: When a client asks about spirituality, they are usually asking whether their inner life is *allowed*. The answer is always yes. "Your chart shows a real inner pull, expressed through ____ (the career, worship, study, solitude). It does not ask you to leave anything; it asks you to bring depth to what you already do."

FROM LAL KITAB: In the Lal Kitab tradition, Ketu is read in the 6th house as its permanent house and is linked to children (especially sons) and to dogs; the commonly taught remedy for troubles with progeny or with Ketu is to feed and care for dogs and to keep the household free of harshness toward the young. This belongs to Lal Kitab's separate system and is not blended with the Parashari reading above. (*Source: Lal Kitab, Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, 1939–1952 Urdu editions; Hindi translations vary.*)

In one breath

- Children: the 5th (from Lagna and Moon) and the 9th (5th from 5th), the 5th lord, Jupiter's dignity, the D7; malefics on the 5th mean effort, not never; refuse sex prediction. Devika: two malefics on the 5th, but the 5th lord with exalted Jupiter and the Moon in the 9th, delay, then blessing, plausibly in Moon/Jupiter around 2007–2008.
- Education: the 4th, 5th, 9th and Mercury; the dominant planet names the subject; Saturn on Mercury is the late bloomer. Arjun: research mind, unconventional or foreign higher study in the Rahu period.
- Property: the 4th and its lord, Mars (land), Saturn (old property), Venus (vehicles), D4 and D16; time by the 4th lord's dasha and transits on the 4th. Arjun: property through partnership and loans; family land through retrograde Mars.
- Travel: the 3rd, 9th, 12th and 7th, Rahu, the Moon, movable signs; the double transit on the 12th or 9th. Meera: Venus in its own 12th, Moon in its own 9th, the comfortable traveller; Venus Mahadasha is her foreign era.
- Spirituality: the moksha triangle 4–8–12 with the 9th as the door; Ketu, Jupiter, Saturn; Atmakaraka and Karakamsa; Pravrajya yogas as classical curiosities; householder spirituality is the norm; Jupiter–Rahu is not "anti-guru". Meera's career is her practice; Arjun's path runs through the 8th house.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. Compute the D7 sign of Chart C's Jupiter (26° Cancer) and of Chart A's 5th lord Jupiter (8° Taurus). Show the working.
2. Chart A (Meera): the 5th is Pisces with retrograde Mars; the 5th lord Jupiter is retrograde in the 7th. Judge her children question in three sentences, using the 5th from the Moon as well.
3. Chart C (Devika): which planet dominates her 4th, 5th and 9th, and which subject table row would you read? Explain in two sentences.
4. A client with the 4th lord in the 12th and Rahu in the 9th asks whether they will settle abroad. What do you check next, and how do you phrase the answer?
5. Chart B: which of Arjun's planets is the Atmakaraka (highest degree, seven-karaka scheme), and what does its placement suggest about his spiritual direction?

Answers

1. Jupiter 26° Cancer: even sign, count from Capricorn; $26 \div 4.2857 = 6.07$, whole part 6, plus 1 = 7th slice → Capricorn, Aquarius, Pisces, Aries, Taurus, Gemini, **Cancer**. Jupiter is in Cancer in D7 too (Vargottama in the D7 and exalted there as well: a strong progeny signature). Jupiter 8° Taurus: even sign, count from Scorpio; $8 \div 4.2857 = 1.87$, whole part 1, plus 1 = 2nd slice → Scorpio, **Sagittarius**. Meera's 5th lord falls in its own sign in the D7. 2. The 5th holds Mars, her Lagna lord, retrograde in Jupiter's sign, energy on the 5th but a friendly one, not a heavy malefic. The 5th lord Jupiter is in a kendra (7th), retrograde, aspected by nothing hostile, and falls in its own sign Sagittarius in the D7. The 5th from her Moon (Cancer) is Scorpio, her Lagna, holding Sun and Mercury, strong. Children are supported; the retrograde planets suggest some waiting or a change of plan, not denial. 3. Saturn: it sits in the 5th with Mercury and Rahu, and from Leo its 3rd, 7th and 10th aspects fall on Libra (7th), Aquarius (11th) and Taurus (2nd), so it dominates the 5th by occupation; Mercury (3rd and 6th lord) beside it adds the intellect. Read the Saturn–Mercury rows: history, law, geology, labour studies, or structured analytical fields, with Rahu adding technology. Jupiter exalted in the 4th (the house of schooling) with the Sun adds law, finance, medicine or teaching as a second stream. 4. Check the 12th lord's dignity and dasha, Rahu's dasha, whether the Lagna or 12th is a movable sign, and whether Jupiter and Saturn will both touch the 12th or 9th in the coming years. Phrase: "Your chart carries a strong pull away from the homeland, the house of home connects to the house of foreign lands, and the foreign planet sits in the house of long journeys. The periods that open it are ____; whether you stay is your choice, but the road is clearly there." 5. Degrees: Saturn 25°, Venus 24°, Jupiter 22°, Mars 21°, Sun 18°, Moon 6°, Mercury 2°. Saturn is the Atmakaraka. Saturn in the 8th in its own sign Aquarius, combust beside the Sun: a soul learning through discipline, patience and the hidden, the path of the researcher and the servant rather than the devotee; renunciation of the ordinary rather than of the world.

Chapter 22: Lal Kitab, the Red Book, Clearly Labelled

FROM LAL KITAB: This whole chapter is about one book and one tradition, so (here and only here) Lal Kitab material appears in ordinary prose rather than boxed. Read every paragraph of this chapter as if it sat inside this box. The source is *Lal Kitab* by Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, written in Urdu in undivided Punjab and published in five volumes in 1939, 1940, 1941, 1942 and 1952. The Hindi translations (and the many later commentators who built courses on them) differ from one another, sometimes seriously. Wherever I am not certain that a point is in the original text, I write "as commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition". Verify against the edition you actually own. (*Source: Lal Kitab, Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, 1939–1952 Urdu editions; Hindi translations vary.*)

A friend's younger brother sent me a screenshot from an app. "Didi, my Saturn is sleeping, my Mercury is in its pakka ghar, and I have been told to float a coconut in the river for forty-three days. But my Lagna is Scorpio and my Saturn is in Sagittarius. Is that good or bad?"

Half of what he said was Parashari (Scorpio Lagna, Saturn in Sagittarius); the other half was Lal Kitab (sleeping planets, pakka ghar, the coconut). Nobody had told him they were two different languages. He was trying to read Urdu with a Sanskrit dictionary.

This chapter gives you the second dictionary, and, more importantly, teaches you to notice which language a sentence is written in. Everything in the rest of this book is Parashari. Everything in this chapter is Lal Kitab. Keep the two shelves separate and both become useful; mix them and both become noise.

Where the Red Book came from

Pt. Roop Chand Joshi was a Punjabi from the Jalandhar district who, by the accounts that have come down to us, worked as a government accountant. Between 1939 and 1952 he published five volumes in Urdu (the working language of educated Punjab then) under the name *Lal Kitab*, "the Red Book", for its red binding. The 1952 volume is the longest and the one most Hindi translations rest on.

Three things explain the book's whole character. First, it was written **for households, not pandits**: aphorism and rhymed saying (*farmaan*), not treatise and proof; it says what to do far more than why. Second, it is **remedy-centred**: in Parashari texts remedies are a chapter at the end; in Lal Kitab they are the point, and chart-reading exists to choose the remedy. Third, the original **mixes astrology with palmistry** (*samudrik shastra*): a chart may be built from the hand when the birth time is unknown, and the first volume's title pairs the two subjects. Modern courses drop the palmistry.

The book became enormously popular in Punjab, Haryana and Delhi and travelled with Punjabi families wherever they went; if your clients come from the north-west, you will meet it.

DID YOU KNOW? Lal Kitab is one of very few Indian astrological texts written in a modern vernacular within living memory, with a known author and known dates. That closeness cuts both ways: the text is accessible, but there is no long chain of learned commentary to stabilise its meaning, so the "tradition" around it is largely a creation of the last fifty years.

Why students get confused

Its words travel without a passport.

Open ten online "planet profile" videos and you will hear, in one breath: "Saturn is exalted in Libra" (Parashari), "Saturn's pakka ghar is the eighth and tenth" (Lal Kitab), and "if the house opposite Saturn is empty, Saturn is sleeping" (Lal Kitab). Each is defensible in its own system; together, unlabelled, they describe a Saturn no text ever described.

The three Lal Kitab ideas that leak most often are **pakka ghar** (a planet's permanent *house*; Parashari homes are *signs*), **sleeping planets and houses** (*soya grah* / *soya ghar*, with no Parashari counterpart), and **the 43-day remedies** (the coconut in the river, the feeding of dogs). None of these is in Parashara, Varahamihira or Mantreswara.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Saying "Venus in the 12th is bad because the 12th is Rahu's house." The 12th is Rahu's *pakka ghar*, a Lal Kitab statement. In Parashari, the 12th has no owner until you know the Lagna; in Chart A the 12th is Libra, Venus's own sign, and Venus there is dignified. Same placement, two systems: say which one you are speaking in.

The Lal Kitab chart: houses that never move

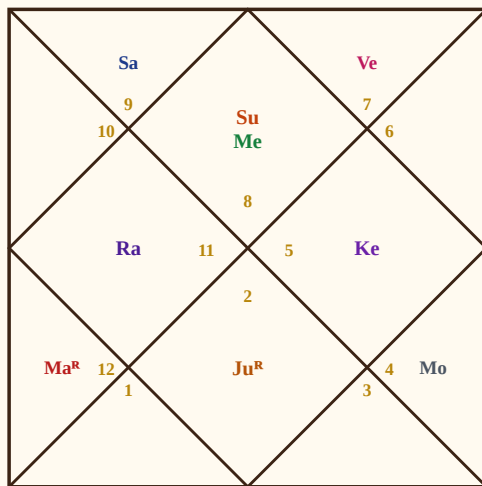
In Parashari we cast the rising sign (Lagna), put it in the 1st house, and let the other eleven follow; the sign colours everything in its house. The signs move; the houses are the frame.

Lal Kitab throws the signs away. **House 1 is always treated as Aries, house 2 as Taurus, and so on around to house 12 as Pisces, for every person ever born.** There is no separate reading of signs at all. A planet is placed in the Lal Kitab chart by the house it occupies in the ordinary Parashari chart, and from then on only the house number matters.

WHY? *Practical reason, from the book's own purpose (tradition).* Lal Kitab was written for households without an almanac or a pandit. Finding the rising sign needs the birth time, the latitude and tables of rising times; counting which house a planet sits in needs none of that once someone has drawn the basic chart. And because every remedy in the book is prescribed by house ("Saturn in the 2nd: do this"), the house is the natural unit; a sign would add a layer the remedy never uses. Everyday parallel: a railway porter does not need to know a passenger's home town, only the coach number.

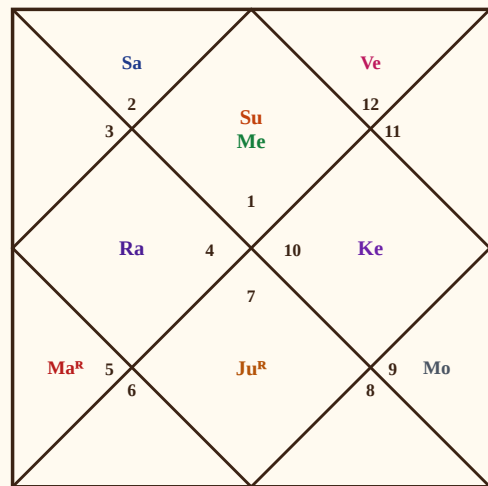
Same birth, two frames: Parashari (signs move) vs Lal Kitab (houses fixed)

Parashari North chart: Lagna Scorpio (sign 8 in house 1)



Gold numbers = SIGNS. The 1st house is Scorpio, so Mars colours the body; Venus sits in Libra, its own sign.

Lal Kitab chart: house 1 is always 'Aries'



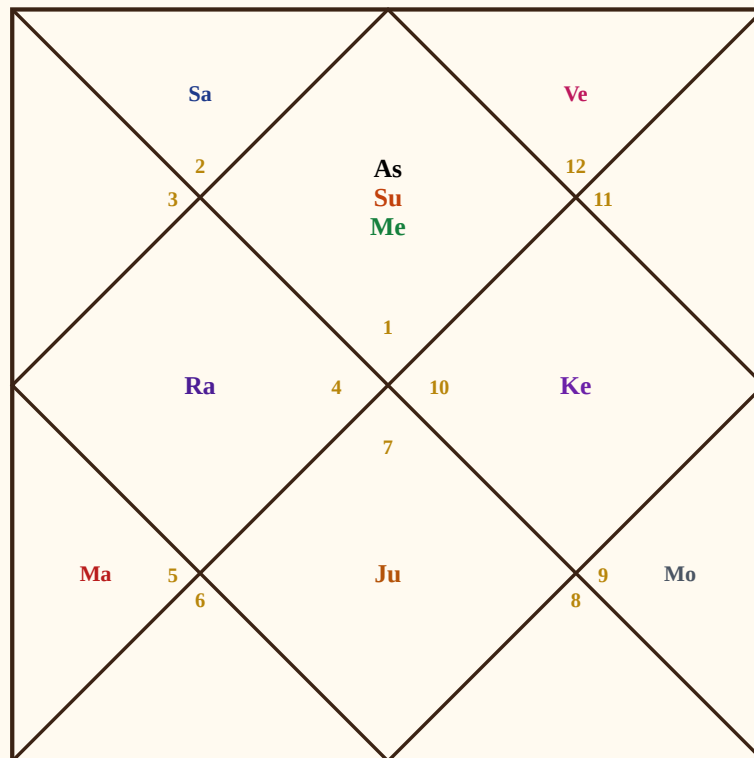
Numbers = HOUSES only. No sign is read. House 1 = Sun's pakka ghar; Venus in 12 = Rahu's pakka ghar.

Planets keep their Parashari house numbers; only the meaning of the frame changes.

Figure 22.1: The same birth in two frames. Left, the Parashari chart: gold numbers are signs and Scorpio (8) sits in the 1st house. Right, the Lal Kitab chart: numbers are houses only, and house 1 is "Aries" for everyone. The planets keep their house numbers; only what the frame means has changed.

Convert Chart A: Sun and Mercury in the 1st; Saturn 2nd; Rahu 4th; Mars 5th; Jupiter 7th; Moon 9th; Ketu 10th; Venus 12th. Her Lal Kitab chart is exactly those house numbers in the fixed frame.

Chart A in the Lal Kitab frame (houses fixed)



House 1 is always 'Aries'; planets keep their Parashari house numbers

Figure 22.2: Chart A in the Lal Kitab frame, generated with the book's chart tool. Read the numbers as houses, never as signs.

What changes in the reading? In Parashari, Scorpio in the 1st gives Meera's body Mars's colour (intense, private, resilient) and the Sun and Mercury are read *in Scorpio*. In Lal Kitab there is no Scorpio. House 1 is the Sun's permanent house (next section); a Sun there is "at home", read as a strong father, authority, health and self-respect.

Venus in the 12th is the sharpest contrast. In Parashari, Venus sits in Libra, its own sign, as 12th lord in the 12th, dignified, forming Vimala yoga (Chapter 10). In Lal Kitab the 12th is Rahu's permanent house, and yet, as commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition, Venus in the 12th is regarded as fortunate: a comfortable later life. Two roads, one hill, this time. Often they diverge, and then you must choose whose map you are reading.

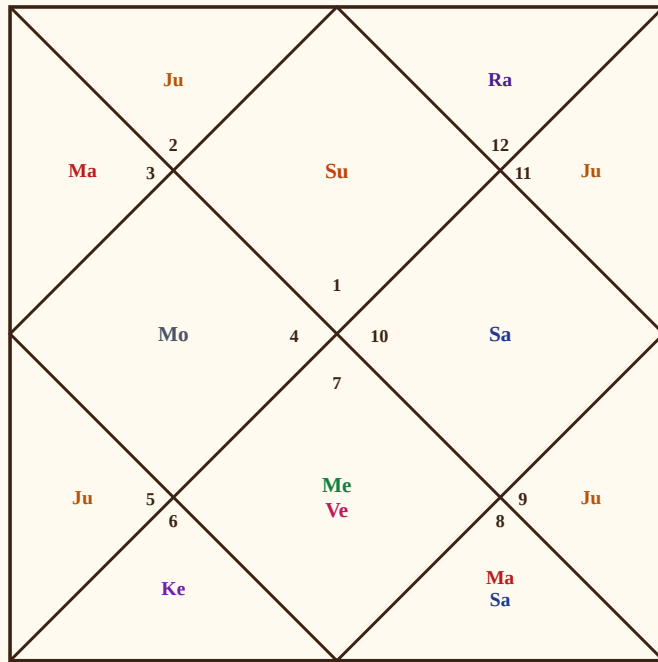
ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: If a sentence mentions a *sign* (Scorpio, Libra, exaltation, own sign) it is Parashari. If it mentions only a house number and a planet, ask which system before you agree with it.

Pakka ghar: every planet's permanent home

In Parashari a planet's home is a sign. In Lal Kitab it is a *house*, its **pakka ghar** ("permanent house"). The list, exactly as Appendix A.15 gives it:

Planet	Pakka ghar (permanent house)
Sun	1
Moon	4
Mars	3 and 8
Mercury	7 (some teachers and editions give 6 and 8)
Jupiter	2, 5, 9, 11 (some editions add 12)
Venus	7
Saturn	8 and 10
Rahu	12
Ketu	6

Pakka ghar: the permanent houses of the planets (Lal Kitab)



Planet → permanent house(s)

Su	Sun	1
Mo	Moon	4
Ma	Mars	3 and 8
Me	Mercury	7 (some: 6 and 8)
Ju	Jupiter	2, 5, 9, 11 (some add 12)
Ve	Venus	7
Sa	Saturn	8 and 10
Ra	Rahu	12
Ke	Ketu	6

A planet in its pakka ghar is 'at home' and gives its results with confidence.

This is a list drawn as a chart, not one person's kundali. Editions differ on Mercury and Jupiter.

Figure 22.3: The pakka ghar drawn as a chart. This is a list, not a real kundali; Jupiter appears four times. Where editions differ (Mercury, Jupiter), the legend says so.

STORY: THE HAVELI WITH TWELVE FIXED ROOMS. In Parashari the court travels: the King holds durbar wherever the Lagna pitches his tent, and the twelve districts (signs) turn around him. Lal Kitab builds a haveli instead: one old house with twelve rooms that never move, and every courtier has a permanent room. The King (Sun) sleeps in room 1, by the front door. The Queen Mother (Moon) keeps room 4, the heart of the house. Guru-ji (Jupiter) has the run of rooms 2, 5, 9 and 11: treasury, nursery, prayer room and granary. Shukracharya (Venus) and the young Prince (Mercury) share room 7, the guest hall. The Commander (Mars) guards rooms 3 and 8, the door and the vault. Old Shani-ji (Saturn) keeps rooms 8 and 10, the vault and the workshop. The Smoke-headed Stranger (Rahu) sleeps in room 12, the outhouse; the Headless Sadhu (Ketu) in room 6, with the dogs. In his own room a courtier speaks with authority; in another's room he is a guest, treated as that host treats him. **Rule:** Pakka ghar is the planet's permanent room, strong there; elsewhere, read host and guest.

In Chart A, Saturn in the 2nd is a guest in one of Jupiter's rooms; Rahu in the 4th in the Moon's; Ketu in the 10th in Saturn's; Venus in the 12th in Rahu's. As commonly taught, a planet in its own pakka ghar needs no remedy for itself.

DID YOU KNOW? Put the pakka ghar list beside Parashara's natural house significators (Appendix A.5) and you get a small shock. Parashari gives the Sun as karaka of the 1st, the Moon of the 4th, Jupiter of the 2nd, 5th, 9th and 11th, Venus of the 7th, and Saturn of the 8th and (with others) the 10th. Lal Kitab's pakka ghar: Sun 1, Moon 4, Jupiter 2/5/9/11, Venus 7, Saturn 8/10. Nearly identical. Whatever else the Red Book is, its author knew the Parashari scheme and built his fixed chart on it. The differences (Mars in 3 and 8, Mercury in 7, Ketu in 6, Rahu in 12) are where Lal Kitab is most itself.

WHY? *Logical derivation: the two lists share one root.* Both descend from the natural zodiac (the Kala Purusha chart, Chapter 4): Aries in the 1st, Cancer in the 4th, Libra in the 7th, and so on around. Parashari reads that chart to say which planet naturally "means" each house: the Sun the 1st, the Moon the 4th, Venus the 7th. Lal Kitab then freezes the natural chart as the only chart, so the natural significators become permanent rooms. Same tree, two branches. Parallel: two cousins who learned to cook from the same grandmother make the same dal; one adds tomatoes, the other does not.

The planets as a family, with their objects

Every planet stands for people, colours, foods, metals and animals, and these are what the remedies use. The table is as commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition; the original scatters these correspondences across its volumes.

Planet	Family member	Objects, foods, metals, colours, animals (as commonly taught)
Sun	Father; the king of the house	Wheat, jaggery, copper; the monkey
Moon	Mother	Milk, rice, silver, water; white
Mars	Brother	Red lentils (masoor), copper, neem; red; the sweet <i>rewri</i>
Mercury	Daughter, sister	Green things, moong, ivory; the goat and the parrot
Jupiter	Guru, grandfather; the father in some readings	Saffron, gold, turmeric, gram (chana); yellow; the peepal tree
Venus	Wife; the woman of the house	Curd, ghee, perfume, silk; the cow
Saturn	Servant, uncle, labourer	Iron, mustard oil, leather, black; the crow; the buffalo
Rahu	In-laws; the outsider who has joined the family	The elephant, blue and smoky colours, coconut, barley; silver in some readings; lead
Ketu	Son, nephew; the dog at the gate	Blanket, sesame, multicoloured cloth; the dog

STORY: THE ELEPHANT AND THE DOG. *Parashari seats the planets in a court; Lal Kitab seats them at a family dinner. The father breaks the wheat roti (Sun); the mother pours the milk (Moon); the brother argues over the red lentils (Mars); the daughter brings green moong (Mercury); the grandfather says grace with a turmeric mark on his forehead (Jupiter); the wife sets out curd and ghee (Venus); the old servant refills the mustard-oil lamp (Saturn). At the gate stand two who are not quite family: the in-laws' elephant, huge, smoke-blue and impossible to ignore (Rahu), and the loyal dog who guards the door and wants a blanket in winter (Ketu). Feed each what it eats and the dinner goes well. **RULE:** In Lal Kitab every planet is a family member with its own foods, metals, colours and animals, and its remedy feeds that member.*

So when a Lal Kitab astrologer says "your Mercury is troubled", he is also thinking "something about your sister or daughter"; when he says "your Rahu is bad", he is thinking about in-laws.

WHY? *Symbolic logic of the tradition (sympathetic correspondence).* Each planet governs a family of substances: Saturn iron, oil, black, labourers; the Moon milk, silver, white, mothers. In the tradition's logic, to give away a planet's substance is to release some of that planet's pressure (you loosen your grip on what it grips), while to keep or wear the substance is to invite the planet in. This is not astronomy; it is the same symbolic grammar that makes daan work in Parashari (Chapter 23). Parallel: in a joint family, when one uncle's demands grow heavy, the peace-making move is to offer him first exactly the things he cares about, and let them go.

Mangal Nek and Mangal Bad: the two faces of Mars

Lal Kitab gives one planet two names: **Mangal Nek**, the good Mars (courage, a brother who stands by you) and **Mangal Bad**, the bad Mars (quarrels, blood, a brother turned enemy). In Parashari we judge Mars by sign, house, lordship and aspects and call it a functional benefic or malefic *for a given Lagna* (Chapter 8). Lal Kitab has no such machinery; it judges Mars by its company and its room.

STORY: THE COMMANDER'S COMPANY. *Senapati Mangal is a fine officer when he rides alone: he guards the brothers, protects the land, fights only when he must. But watch whom he drinks with. Seated beside old Shani-ji the Judge he turns sullen and cruel; beside the Smoke-headed Stranger he schemes; beside the Headless Sadhu he stops caring who gets hurt. And put him in room 4 (the Queen Mother's room) or room 8, the vault, and he is a soldier in the wrong place, breaking the crockery. That, as commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition, is Mangal Bad; the same man riding alone in the open is Mangal Nek. Rule: Mars with Saturn, Rahu or Ketu, or in the 4th or 8th, is read as Mangal Bad; Mars alone elsewhere is Mangal Nek (as commonly taught; verify your edition).*

Mars's condition (as commonly taught)	Verdict
Alone, not in the 4th or 8th	● Mangal Nek
With the Sun or Moon (pairings differ by commentator)	■ Mixed; check your edition
With Saturn, Rahu or Ketu	○ Mangal Bad
In the 4th or 8th house	○ Mangal Bad

In Chart A, Mars sits in the 5th with no Saturn, Rahu or Ketu beside it: ● Mangal Nek. Parashari agrees in spirit by a different road: Mars is Meera's Lagna lord, a functional benefic for Scorpio, in the trikona 5th. When the systems disagree, I trust Parashari and use Lal Kitab for its remedy.

Friends and enemies, Lal Kitab style

Parashari friendship (Appendix A.3) has seven planets and leaves the nodes out. Lal Kitab treats Rahu and Ketu as full planets with friends and enemies of their own. As commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition (the seven-planet core matches Parashara closely; the nodes are added):

Planet	● Friends	○ Enemies	● Neutral
Sun	● Moon, Mars, Jupiter	○ Venus, Saturn, Rahu, Ketu	● Mercury
Moon	● Sun, Mercury	○ Rahu, Ketu	● Mars, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn
Mars	● Sun, Moon, Jupiter	○ Mercury, Ketu	● Venus, Saturn, Rahu
Mercury	● Sun, Venus, Rahu	○ Moon	● Mars, Jupiter, Saturn, Ketu
Jupiter	● Sun, Moon, Mars	○ Mercury, Venus, Rahu	● Saturn, Ketu
Venus	● Mercury, Saturn, Ketu	○ Sun, Moon, Rahu	● Mars, Jupiter
Saturn	● Mercury, Venus, Rahu	○ Sun, Moon, Mars	● Jupiter, Ketu
Rahu	● Mercury, Saturn, Ketu	○ Sun, Mars, Venus	● Moon, Jupiter
Ketu	● Venus, Rahu	○ Moon, Mars	● Sun, Mercury, Jupiter, Saturn

Two cautions: commentators differ on several cells (Ketu especially), and Lal Kitab uses this table mainly for the *guest–host* relationship and *companions in one house*, not for Parashari's five-fold friendship.

How houses look at each other (drishti)

In Parashari the aspect belongs to the planet (Chapter 6): every planet sees its 7th, Mars adds the 4th and 8th, Jupiter the 5th and 9th, Saturn the 3rd and 10th. In Lal Kitab the aspect belongs to the **house**: houses look at one another in fixed pairs, and whatever sits in a house joins its gaze. The mainstream idea, as commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition, is that opposite houses see each other (1 and 7, 2 and 8, 3 and 9, 4 and 10, 5 and 11, 6 and 12) with special pairings on top that commentators list differently (some give the 2nd looking at the 6th, or the 3rd at the 11th). I will not print a precise table; I have seen three that contradict one another. Take the opposite-house principle as safe and anything beyond it from your edition.

Sleeping houses, sleeping planets, and the blind and the righteous

A **sleeping house** (*soya hua ghar*) is, as commonly taught, a house with no planet in it: dormant, not bad, giving results only when something *wakes* it. A **sleeping planet** (*soya hua grah*) is, as commonly taught, a planet whose partner house is empty, so it has nothing to act upon. Appendix A.15 puts it carefully: the precise rules differ between editions.

STORY: THE UNLIT ROOMS. *Walk through the haveli at night. Rooms with someone in them have a lamp burning. Rooms with nobody in them are dark (not cursed, just unlit) and the tradition calls them asleep (soya ghar). Now notice a courtier in a lit room staring across the courtyard at a dark one: the room he "looks at" is empty, so he has nobody to talk to, and he dozes off: a sleeping planet (soya grah). A traveller (a transit) walks into the dark room and lights the lamp; the watcher wakes and begins to speak. In Parashari there is no such thing: an empty room is read through whoever owns it, and the Queen Mother in her own district is wide awake whether or not anyone sits opposite. **RULE:** In Lal Kitab an empty house, and a planet facing one, are dormant until a transit or related planet wakes them; rules vary by edition.*

In Chart A, houses 3, 6, 8 and 11 are empty and would be called asleep; her Moon in the 9th looks at the empty 3rd and, in this reading, sleeps until something enters it. In Parashari the same Moon, in its own sign in the 9th, is emphatically awake.

Two more terms. An **andha** (blind) planet is, as commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition, one placed where it cannot "see" its own matters and so acts weakly; a **dharmi** (righteous) planet does no harm by its placement even if a natural malefic, and must not be "punished" with a remedy. The words are genuine Lal Kitab vocabulary; the placements behind them vary by edition.

Rin: debts the family pays together

Parashari karma is personal: the chart shows *your* ripened karma (*prarabdha*), and the remedy is yours. Lal Kitab adds a **family level**: certain placements are **rin**, a debt (the Hindi/Urdu word for a loan) carried by the family line and repaid by the *whole family together*, each blood relative contributing an equal share, in one collective act.

The list below is as commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition. The *concept* is unquestionably in the text; the placement rules vary by edition. Verify against your edition.

Debt (rin)	Read from (as commonly taught; varies by edition)	Whose debt
Self debt (<i>swayam rin</i>)	Venus in the 5th	One's own past conduct
Ancestral debt (<i>pitru rin</i>)	Jupiter afflicted in the 2nd, 5th, 9th or 12th; or Venus, Mercury or Rahu in the 2nd, 5th, 9th or 12th; rules differ most here	Forefathers
Mother's debt (<i>matru rin</i>)	Ketu in the 4th	Mother's line
Sibling debt	Mercury or Ketu in the 1st or 8th	Brothers
Spouse debt (<i>stri rin</i>)	Sun, Moon or Rahu in the 2nd or 7th	Partner's line
Daughter's / sister's debt	Moon in the 3rd or 6th	Women of the family
Divine / natural debt (<i>kudarti rin</i>)	Moon or Mars in the 6th	Owed to nature or the divine
Anti-social debt (<i>apni</i> or <i>ajaat rin</i>)	Various; the most variable of all	Owed to society

Run Chart A through the table and the edition problem appears at once: Mercury in the 1st flags a sibling debt; Venus in the 12th is an ancestral debt by the broader *pitru rin* rule and nothing by the narrower Jupiter-only version. When editions disagree, say so, rather than sending a family of twelve to the river on one photocopy.

STORY: THE FAMILY LEDGER. *In every old Punjabi house there was a ledger (bahi) of the family's debts: not one person's, the family's. Grandfather borrowed for a wedding; the loan passed down; nobody remembers the wedding, but the entry remains. Lal Kitab reads certain placements as entries in that ledger. Guru-ji sitting troubled in the treasury, the nursery, the prayer room or the outhouse: an unpaid debt to the ancestors. The Headless Sadhu in the Queen Mother's room: a debt to the mother's line. The young Prince at the front door: a debt to the brothers. Nobody argues about whose fault it is. Every blood relative puts an equal coin on the table, and the entry is struck out in one act. **Rule:** Rin is a family debt read from specific placements (lists vary by edition) and paid collectively, in equal shares by all blood relatives.*

WHY? *The tradition's stated view of karma (Lal Kitab's own framing). The book treats the household, not the individual, as the unit that earns and owes. Wealth, land and reputation pass down a family line, so in its logic unpaid obligations pass down too, and a debt the ancestors incurred is settled fastest by the whole line acting together, each with an equal share, so that no one carries it alone or is blamed. Parashari does not share this frame; its karma is personal (Chapter 1). Parallel: when a village family repays a loan taken for a grandparent's hospital bills, nobody asks which grandchild "caused" the illness.*

The remedy, as commonly taught, is collective: equal contributions pooled for a temple offering (ancestral debt), or a specified material collected from each blood relative and given together (mother's debt). The *shape* is the constant; the material varies.

CONSULTATION TIP: When a client asks "Do we have pitru rin?", never answer with a yes that frightens a whole family. Say: "In the Lal Kitab tradition your chart *may* show an ancestral debt; editions differ on the rule. If your family would like to do the collective remedy, it is gentle and costs little. If not, the Parashari remedy for the same planet is available to you alone." Give them the choice, and the size of the choice.

Varshphal: the thirty-five-year wheel

Parashari times life with dashas (Vimshottari's 120-year cycle, Chapter 13) and refines the year with the Tajaka annual chart (Chapter 15). Lal Kitab's annual method, also called **varshphal**, is built on a **35-year cycle**: each year of life, counted from birth, is ruled by a planet from a fixed table, and after thirty-five years the table repeats. The year-lord's condition in the birth chart (its room, whether it is in its pakka ghar, whether asleep, its companions) flavours the year, and a badly placed year-lord gets that planet's upay.

I am deliberately **not** printing the table: several versions circulate and disagree, and a wrong table is worse than none. Take it from your edition. Used properly: suppose a client's 42nd year is ruled, in her edition, by Saturn, and her Saturn sits in the 2nd (a guest in Jupiter's room) facing an empty 8th. The tradition reads a Saturn year slow to wake, touching Jupiter's matters (wealth, elders), and prescribes Saturn's upay. In Parashari you would look at her Vimshottari period and Saturn's transit; lay the two side by side, never one in place of the other.

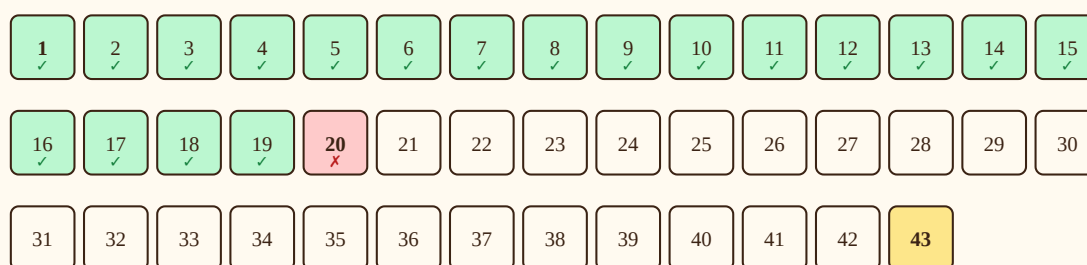
WHY? *Given in the text; no basis stated.* I looked for an astronomical reason for thirty-five (Saturn's 29½-year round? the 36-year Yogini cycle?) and found none that the book itself gives. The honest answer is that it is the author's table, to be used as given, and its authority is the tradition's, not the sky's. Say so to a client. Parallel: a school timetable of subjects by period is not derived from the sun; it works because everyone in the school follows the same one.

Upay: the remedies

Now the heart of the book. Remember the **principles** above all; they are what make Lal Kitab remedies safe to recommend, and they are given exactly as Appendix A.15 has them:

1. **Simple household items, low cost.** Wheat, milk, a coconut, a blanket. Never a stone that costs a month's salary.
2. **Forty or forty-three consecutive days**, depending on the upay. The count is the discipline.
3. **If a day is missed, begin again from day one.** No making up, no doubling.
4. **Never harm any being.**
5. **Never for revenge or selfish gain against another.** An upay to defeat a rival is not an upay; the tradition treats it as backfiring.
6. **Not a substitute for conduct.** A man who floats coconuts and cheats his brother has done nothing.
7. **Done in the daytime**, as commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition.
8. **House-and-planet specific.** There is no "Saturn remedy"; there is "Saturn in the 2nd remedy".

The 43-day upay: consecutive, daytime, restart if broken



Day 1: begin in daylight, with a clear intention (sankalpa)

Day 20 missed? The count is broken: as commonly taught, begin again from Day 1 (do not 'make up' the day)

Day 43 complete → stop; observe conduct rules afterwards. Some upay run 40 days instead: follow the text you use.

Colours: green = done, red = missed, gold = completion. The strip is an aid to memory, not a ritual object.

Figure 22.4: The 43-day upay as a calendar strip. Green days are done; the red day is missed, and the count returns to day 1. I give this strip to anyone starting an upay; the discipline is the remedy.

WHY? *Tradition, and I name it as such.* Forty-odd days is the classic length of a disciplined vow across India: the forty-day mandala vow of Kerala and Tamil Nadu, the forty-day chilla of Sufi practice in the Punjab where the book was written, the forty days of rest after a birth. The text gives no astronomical reason for 40 or 43, and I will not invent one; the number is a cultural unit of "long enough to become a habit, short enough to finish". Parallel: a trainer's six-week programme. Nobody claims six weeks is written in the stars, but almost nobody changes in one.

STORY: THE FAST THAT STARTS AGAIN. A grandmother keeps a forty-three-day upay for her grandson's Saturn. Every morning, before the sun is high, she puts grain out for the crows. On the twentieth morning she is unwell and forgets. That evening she does not double the next day's grain; she quietly turns the calendar back to day one. "Shani-ji does not count grain," she says. "He counts whether you kept your word." The remedy was never the grain. It was forty-three unbroken mornings of remembering someone smaller than herself. **Rule:** An upay runs 40 or 43 consecutive days in daylight; a missed day restarts the count; the discipline, not the object, is the remedy.

The classic upay families by planet

These are the remedies you will meet most often, by planet for orientation, but remember principle 8: in the book itself the remedy depends on the house too. Every line is as commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition.

Planet	Classic upay families (as commonly taught)
Sun	Offer water to the rising Sun; respect and serve the father; feed monkeys; give jaggery or wheat
Moon	Keep silver on the person or in the house; offer water or milk; serve the mother; keep a vessel of water or a little rice at the bedside
Mars (Bad)	Distribute <i>rewri</i> or sweets; plant or water a neem tree; keep a red handkerchief; feed one's brothers
Mercury	Feed cows green fodder; give away green things (moong, cloth); care for sisters and daughters; avoid caged birds; some editions warn against certain green objects in the house; check yours
Jupiter	Saffron or turmeric <i>tilak</i> ; give gram dal or turmeric; respect teachers and elders; water a peepal tree; keep gold
Venus	Give curd, ghee or perfume; feed cows; honour the wife; keep the home clean; give white or silk cloth
Saturn	Mustard oil (give it, or keep some in an iron vessel); feed crows; give iron, but (as commonly taught) do not <i>buy</i> iron on a Saturday; help servants, labourers and the elderly; avoid alcohol
Rahu	Float a coconut (or barley) in running water; keep silver, or a small silver elephant; feed birds; avoid blue and smoky colours; clear the house of rubbish and broken electricals
Ketu	Feed dogs, or keep a dog; give blankets to the poor; wear gold in the ear (a custom many Punjabi families keep for sons); give sesame; care for one's son and nephews

Notice that these are almost all **acts of care directed at the planet's family member**: the dinner-table story again.

The kayde: the don'ts

Alongside the upay come rules of conduct (*kayde*). As commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition: take nothing free, and accept no gifts from certain relatives (in-laws, for Rahu); no gambling or speculation; honour the in-laws; keep the house clean, lit and repaired; do not lie or break a promise made during a remedy; do not harm animals, especially the planets' animals. Any grandmother would say the same. That is the point.

How I actually use Lal Kitab

Let me be plain about my position; you should form your own.

Parashari is my predictive engine: Lagna, functional benefics and malefics, divisional charts, Vimshottari and transits. I have not found the fixed chart to predict *events* as well, and I do not think it was built to.

Lal Kitab is my remedy toolbox and second lens. When Parashari says "Saturn is the difficult planet, and Saturn's period is coming", I often reach for a Lal Kitab upay (crows, mustard oil, service to labourers) because it is cheap, harmless, disciplining and easy to explain. When a family carries something bigger than one chart, rin gives me a language Parashari lacks.

When a client says "a Lal Kitab astrologer told me..."

Translate before you react. The little dictionary I keep in my head:

The client says...	It means in Lal Kitab	Parashari counterpart to check
"My Saturn is in its pakka ghar"	Saturn in the 8th or 10th	Saturn's sign dignity and lordship for that Lagna
"My Moon is sleeping"	The Moon's partner house is empty (edition-dependent)	Moon's sign, strength, aspects; an empty house means little in Parashari
"I have Mangal Bad"	Mars with Saturn/Rahu/Ketu, or in the 4th/8th	Mars's functional nature; Kuja dosha (Chapter 10) if marriage is the question
"We have pitru rin"	A family debt read from Jupiter/Venus/Mercury/Rahu in 2, 5, 9 or 12	Pitru dosha (Sun, 9th house, Rahu–Ketu with Sun): a <i>different</i> concept with a different remedy

Usually the other astrologer was not wrong; he was speaking Lal Kitab.

Parashari and Lal Kitab, side by side

Aspect	Parashari (BPHS)	Lal Kitab
The chart	Lagna sets the 1st house; signs move	Houses fixed; house 1 = Aries for everyone
Signs	Central: dignity, exaltation, lordship	Not read separately
Aspects	Belong to the planet	Belong to the house; vary by commentator
Timing	Vimshottari and other dashas; transits; Tajaka varshaphal	35-year varshphal; transits that wake sleeping houses
Karma	Personal (prarabdha)	Personal plus family (rin)
Remedies	Mantra, daan, gemstone, fasting, worship (Chapter 23)	Household-item upay, 40/43 days, conduct rules; no gemstones as a rule
Philosophy	A map of tendencies; dharma and knowledge	Practical, family-centred: do the upay, mend your conduct

Strengths and limits

Feature of Lal Kitab	Verdict
Accessible: a farming family can perform its remedies without a priest	● Strength
Remedies cheap, harmless, aimed at care and discipline; no gemstone bills	● Strength
Family-karma view (rin): much of what enters a consulting room is family pattern	● Strength
Fixed houses throw away sign dignity: Venus in Libra and Venus in Virgo become the same	○ Limit
Edition variance: two sincere practitioners can read one placement in opposite ways	○ Limit
Over-commercialisation: 43-day "kits" and courses that borrow the vocabulary unlabelled	○ Limit (not the book's fault)
As a predictive engine for timed events	● Weaker than Parashari; use as a second lens

CONSULTATION TIP: A remedy is a prescription, not a sale. Before suggesting any upay, from either system, ask yourself three questions: Does it harm anyone? Does it cost more than the client can comfortably spare? Would I do it myself in their place? If any answer is wrong, do not prescribe it. Then say to the client, in these words: "This is one of several things you can do. It supports your effort; it does not replace it. You may choose not to do it."

In one breath

- Lal Kitab is a separate system: five Urdu volumes by Pt. Roop Chand Joshi (1939–1952), remedy-centred, written for households, originally mixed with palmistry; Hindi editions and commentators vary.
- Its chart keeps the houses fixed (house 1 is always "Aries") and reads no signs; planets are placed by their Parashari house number.
- Each planet has a permanent house (pakka ghar): Sun 1, Moon 4, Mars 3 & 8, Mercury 7, Jupiter 2/5/9/11, Venus 7, Saturn 8 & 10, Rahu 12, Ketu 6 (with edition variants); the list closely mirrors Parashari's house significators.
- Planets are read as a family with objects and animals; Mars has two faces (Nek and Bad); Rahu and Ketu are full planets with friends and enemies; aspects belong to houses, not planets.
- Empty houses and their planets may be "asleep" until woken; "andha" and "dharmi" are genuine terms whose exact rules vary.
- Rin (karmic debt) is a family-level idea with a collective remedy; the placement lists are commonly taught but edition-dependent.
- Varshphal follows a 35-year cycle from a fixed table; take the table from your edition, never from memory.
- Upay use cheap household items for 40 or 43 consecutive days, restart if broken, harm no being, are never for selfish gain, and never replace conduct.
- Use Lal Kitab as a remedy toolbox and a second lens; keep Parashari as the predictive engine; always say which system you are speaking in.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. Convert Chart B (Arjun; Parashari houses: Sun, Mercury, Saturn in 8; Moon in 11; Mars in 2; Jupiter in 5; Venus in 7; Rahu in 4; Ketu in 10) into the Lal Kitab frame. Which planets sit in their own pakka ghar? Which are guests, and in whose house?
2. In Chart A, which houses are empty and therefore "asleep" in the Lal Kitab reading? Give one Parashari reason why an empty house is not a problem in itself.
3. Is Chart B's Mars Mangal Nek or Mangal Bad by the commonly taught conditions? What does Parashari say about the same Mars for a Cancer Lagna?
4. A client says: "A Lal Kitab astrologer told me my Venus is in Rahu's house, so my marriage will suffer." Write three sentences translating this for a Parashari reading of Chart A, without dismissing the other astrologer.
5. Write the eight upay principles from memory. Then design a 43-day Saturn upay for a client of modest means and check it against all eight.

Answers

1. In their own pakka ghar: Saturn (8th), Jupiter (5th), Venus (7th); and Mercury if your edition gives Mercury the 6th and 8th. Guests: Sun and Mercury in the 8th (Saturn's and Mars's room); Moon in the 11th and Mars in the 2nd (Jupiter's rooms); Rahu in the 4th (the Moon's); Ketu in the 10th (Saturn's). 2. Houses 3, 6, 8 and 11: "asleep" as commonly taught. In Parashari an empty house is read through its lord and its aspects; Meera's empty 11th is read through Mercury, strong in the 1st. 3. Mars in the 2nd, alone: ● Mangal Nek. Parashari: Mars owns the 5th and 10th for Cancer and is the yogakaraka (Appendix A.6), in a friend's sign: ● functional benefic. The systems agree. 4. Something like: "The astrologer is speaking Lal Kitab, where the 12th is Rahu's permanent house for everyone, and in that tradition, as commonly taught, Venus in the 12th is actually read as fortunate, so the conclusion is stronger than the system supports. In the Parashari chart your Venus is in Libra, its own sign, as 12th lord in the 12th, which forms Vimala yoga, a dignified, protective placement. Marriage is judged from the 7th house and its lord, Jupiter in your 7th, and from the Navamsa, not from the 12th alone." 5. Household items and low cost; 40 or 43 consecutive days; restart if broken; harm no being; never for selfish ends; not a substitute for conduct; daytime; house-and-planet specific. Sample (as commonly taught): each morning for 43 days put out food for crows and on Saturdays give a little mustard oil to a labourer, while keeping a promise to speak respectfully to helpers. Check all eight, and confirm the rule for Saturn in *that* client's house against your edition.

Chapter 23: Remedies (Upaya), Helping Without Harming

A woman I read for arrived wearing three rings: a yellow sapphire, a blue sapphire and a hessonite. She had spent close to two lakh rupees over four years on the advice of three astrologers, and nothing in her life had moved. "Anushka, which stone is wrong?"

All of them. Her chart had Taurus rising. Jupiter, lord of the 8th and 11th, is a functional malefic for Taurus; the yellow sapphire was *strengthening* the wrong planet. The blue sapphire was for Saturn, her yogakaraka and already well placed: a stone for a planet that was not broken. The hessonite was for Rahu, which nobody should be strengthening. Three rings, three sales, no prescription.

I took nothing off her that day. I explained each ring and gave her one thing to do for forty days that cost nothing. She came back a year later without the rings. That is what this chapter is about: remedies as **prescription, not sale**.

What a remedy is, and what it is not

A remedy (*upaya*) works, first, on the **mind and conduct of the client**. A person who feeds crows every Saturday for forty days has practised humility, regularity and attention to the neglected: precisely what a troubled Saturn asks for. The planet's signification and the remedy's action are aligned, and the alignment does its work in the doer.

A remedy works, second, as an **act of intention** (*sankalpa*): a deliberate, repeated offering aligned with a planet's nature softens or supports that planet's results. Take this as faith, as psychology, or both; I have never seen it help someone who did it resentfully.

A remedy is **not** a substitute for effort, medicine, law or common sense; not a bargain with fate; not a guarantee; and never a way to harm a third party.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: A remedy is a prescription, not a sale. If you would be embarrassed to explain to a doctor why you prescribed it, do not prescribe it.

The classical basis

Parashara devotes chapters of *Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra* to remedies: propitiation of the planets (*graha shanti*), worship of the nine planets (*Navagraha*), and remedies for afflictions such as birth in Gandanta or on an eclipse day. The Vedic tradition behind him gives us two words. **Shanti** (peace, pacification) is the ritual and mental quieting of a disturbing influence. **Daan** (giving) is the release of something of value into the world as an act of dharma. Around these grew the *Navagraha* worship you still see in every South Indian temple.

Later texts and the Puranas add the mantras, fasts and gemstones. Gemstones are the youngest of the family, widespread only in the last few centuries; the modern gem trade has shaped "Vedic remedies" more than any rishi did. Stones are not the heart of astrology; they are its edge.

DID YOU KNOW? The nine-planet shrine (*Navagraha sannidhi*) in almost every Tamil temple arranges the planets so that no two face each other: the Sun in the centre, the others around it, each looking a different way. Devotees walk around it nine times. The arrangement is a lesson in itself: the planets are honoured together, as a court, not bargained with one at a time.

The four families of remedy

In Parashari practice I sort remedies into four families, and I teach students to reach for them in this order:

1. **Conduct, worship and fasting** (*vrata, puja, seva*): what you do and how you live. Free, safe, always appropriate.
2. **Mantra** (*japa*): repeated sacred sound for a planet or its deity. Free, safe, needs discipline.
3. **Donation** (*daan*): giving away the items of a planet. Low cost, safe, and it *pacifies*.
4. **Gemstone** (*ratna*): wearing a planet's stone. Costly, and it *strengthens*; therefore the most restricted.

WHY? *Logic of signification, then practice.* Every planet's meaning is partly a behaviour: Saturn is discipline and service, the Sun is self-respect and punctuality, the Moon is care. A behaviour can be changed today, costs nothing, cannot harm, and is the one remedy that works whether or not the sky cooperates. Mantra and daan take a week to arrange; a stone takes a month and a month's salary. That is why conduct comes first. Parallel: a good doctor says "walk every day" before "take this tablet", because the walk helps everything else and has no side effects.

The pair that organises everything is **strengthen versus pacify**. A weak functional benefic needs strengthening: mantra, conduct, perhaps a stone. A troublesome functional malefic needs pacifying: daan, seva, fasting, mantra, and *never* a stone.

WHY? *Logical derivation from the system's grammar (Chapter 8).* A planet's natural nature says what it is like; its functional nature says what job it holds for this Lagna, that is, which houses it owns. Remedies act on results, and results come from the job. Saturn owning the 9th and 10th for a Taurus Lagna brings fortune and career, so pacifying him would be pacifying your own good luck. Judge by the job, not the personality. Parallel: the strict aunt who keeps the family accounts. You do not want her softer; you want her well.

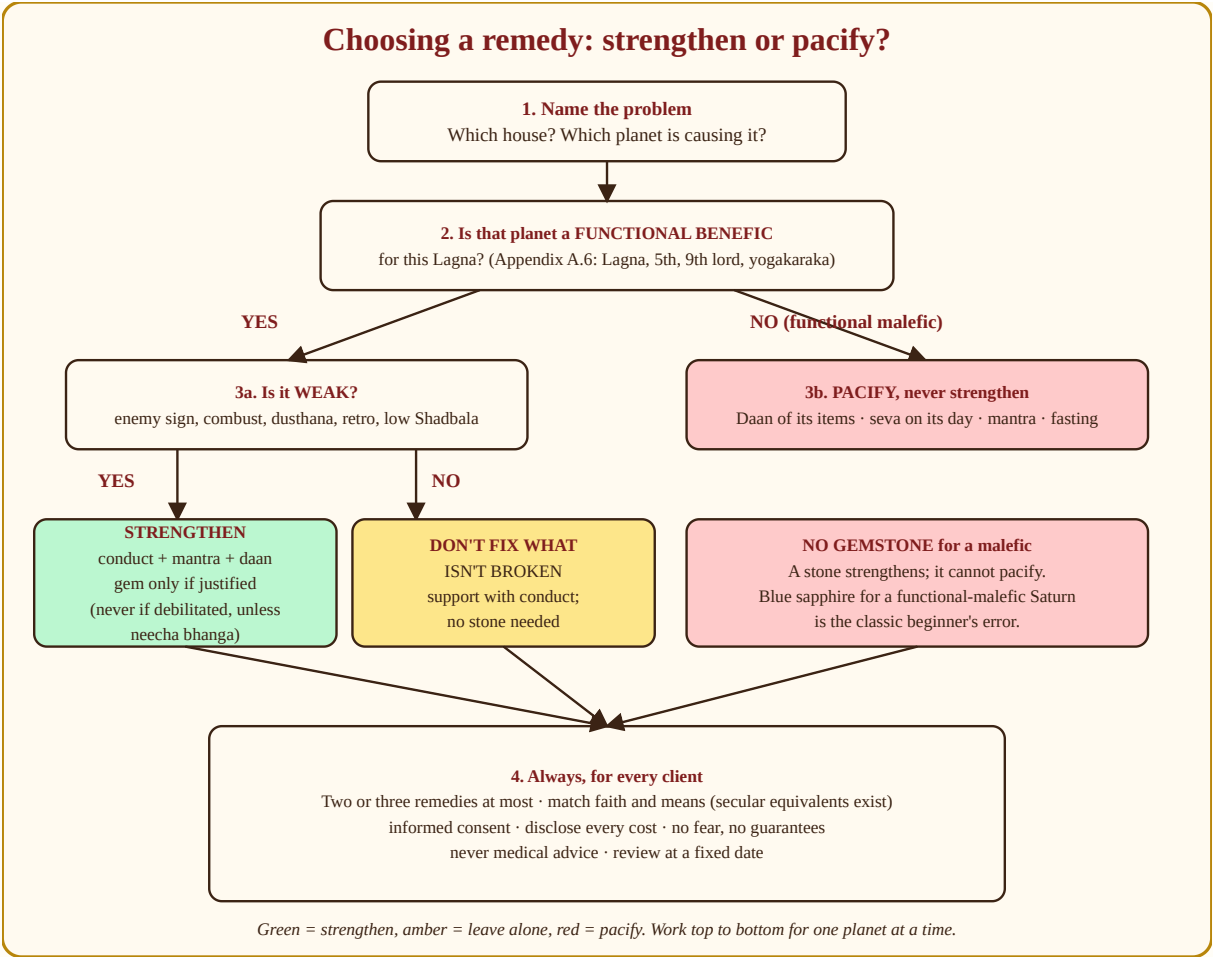


Figure 23.1: The remedial decision tree I keep on my desk. Work down it for one planet at a time. Most consultations end in the middle branch (leave it alone) or the right branch (pacify).

Mantra (japa)

The planetary **seed mantras** (*beeja mantras*) are the working tools. They are given exactly as Appendix A.13 has them, with the classical counts.

Planet	Beeja mantra	Classical japa count
Sun	Om Hraam Hreem Hraum Sah Suryaya Namah	7,000
Moon	Om Shraam Shreem Shraum Sah Chandraya Namah	11,000
Mars	Om Kraam Kreem Kraum Sah Bhaumaya Namah	10,000
Mercury	Om Braam Breem Braum Sah Budhaya Namah	9,000 (some 17,000)
Jupiter	Om Graam Greem Graum Sah Gurave Namah	19,000
Venus	Om Draam Dreem Draum Sah Shukraya Namah	16,000
Saturn	Om Praam Preem Praum Sah Shanaye Namah	23,000
Rahu	Om Bhraam Bhreem Bhraum Sah Rahave Namah	18,000
Ketu	Om Sraam Sreem Sraum Sah Ketave Namah	17,000

The counts are classical totals for a complete undertaking (*anushtana*); the tradition multiplies them by four in Kali Yuga (Saturn's 23,000 becomes 92,000) and a priest is usually hired to complete such a number. For a client doing it herself I prescribe a **daily** practice: one *mala* of 108 a day for forty days or for a troubling sub-period. Regularity matters more than arithmetic.

WHY? *Tradition for the totals; a zodiac count for the 108.* The totals (7,000 for the Sun, 23,000 for Saturn) are handed down in the ritual manuals and roughly scale with how heavy the tradition considers each planet; no text derives them, and I will not pretend one does. The 108 of a mala has a cleaner root: 27 nakshatras of 4 padas each make $27 \times 4 = 108$ steps around the sky, so one round of the beads walks the whole zodiac. Parallel: a cricket over is six balls because the rules say so (the totals); the 108 is more like the 360 degrees of a circle, built into the measuring system itself.

Beside them stands the **Navagraha Stotra** attributed to Vyasa: nine verses, one per planet, chanted in every Navagraha shrine. Know at least the opening of each:

- **Sun:** *Japakusuma-sankasham kashyapeyam mahadyutim...* ("Red as the hibiscus, son of Kashyapa, of great radiance...")
- **Moon:** *Dadhi-shankha-tusharabham kshirodarnava-sambhavam...*
- **Mars:** *Dharani-garbha-sambhutam vidyut-kanti-samaprabham...*
- **Mercury:** *Priyangu-kalika-shyamam rupena-pratimam budham...*
- **Jupiter:** *Devanam cha rishinam cha gurum kanchana-sannibham...*
- **Venus:** *Hima-kunda-mrinalabham daityanam paramam gurum...*
- **Saturn:** *Nilanjana-samabhasam ravi-putram yamagrajam...*
- **Rahu:** *Ardha-kayam maha-viryam chandraditya-vimardanam...*
- **Ketu:** *Palasha-pushpa-sankasham taraka-graha-mastakam...*

The older **Vedic Navagraha mantras** (Rig Vedic verses used by priests in the fire ritual, *homa*) are a different set; the Sun's begins *Aa krishnena rajasa vartamano...*, and the rest are best learned from a priest. Do not confuse them with the Vyasa stotra.

The tradition also matches planets to **deities**; a client who already has a devotion is best served by it:

Planet(s)	Traditional devotional remedy
Saturn, Mars	Hanuman Chalisa; Hanuman worship on Saturday and Tuesday
Jupiter, Mercury	Vishnu Sahasranama; Vishnu or Dakshinamurti worship
Venus, Rahu	Durga and Lakshmi worship; Durga Saptashati for Rahu
Ketu	Ganesha worship and mantra
Moon, and health generally	Shiva; the Mahamrityunjaya mantra
Sun	Aditya Hridayam; Surya Namaskar at dawn

How to prescribe a mantra

Say **which planet, which mantra, which count, which day to begin, how long**, and **what for**: the *sankalpa*, spoken at the start: "I undertake this for forty days for steadiness in my work." The classic frame: begin on the planet's weekday, in the morning after bathing, facing east, one mala of 108 a day, for forty days. Pronunciation matters less than sincerity.

Daan: giving away

The donation table, exactly as Appendix A.13, with the traditional recipients added:

Planet	Items (daan)	Traditional recipient	Day
Sun	Wheat, jaggery, copper, red cloth	Father-figures, temple priests, the poor	Sunday
Moon	Rice, milk, white cloth, silver	Mother-figures, women, the elderly	Monday
Mars	Red lentils (masoor), red cloth, copper	Young men, soldiers, brother-figures	Tuesday
Mercury	Green moong, green cloth, books	Students, young girls	Wednesday
Jupiter	Chana dal, turmeric, yellow cloth, books	Teachers, priests, scholars	Thursday
Venus	Curd, ghee, rice, white cloth, perfume	Young women, wife-figures	Friday
Saturn	Black sesame, mustard oil, iron, black cloth	Labourers, servants, the disabled and destitute	Saturday
Rahu	Coconut, blue cloth, mustard, blanket	The marginalised, sweepers, lepers (traditionally)	Saturday (some: Wednesday)
Ketu	Blanket, sesame, multi-coloured cloth; feeding dogs	Ascetics, the homeless; dogs	Tuesday / Thursday

STORY: DON'T GIVE AWAY YOUR JUPITER. A family whose Guru-ji was frail (a weak Jupiter, lord of their Lagna) was told to "do Jupiter's daan". Every Thursday for a year they carried turmeric, gram and yellow cloth out of the house and gave them away. The Priest grew thinner. Daan is a farewell gift: it says to a planet, "I release what you grip; I ask nothing more of you." That is exactly what you say to the drunken Judge you want out of the hall. It is the opposite of what you say to the Priest whose blessing you need. For him you bring gifts in: his mantra, his Thursday, respect for teachers, and, if he is truly weak, his yellow stone. **Rule:** Donate the items of a functional malefic to pacify it; never donate the items of a functional benefic you need.

I have met people faithfully donating the very planet they needed to keep. Check the functional nature (Appendix A.6) before you write a single daan on the card.

WHY? Symbolic logic of the tradition, the mirror of the gem rule. If wearing a planet's substance invites it in, giving the substance away sends it out. The whole remedial grammar rests on one idea: substances carry a planet's quality, and the direction of movement (into the body, out of the house) decides whether you gain it or release it. So daan suits the planet you want quieter, and ratna the planet you want louder; the same item cannot do both. Parallel: you return the borrowed pressure-cooker that keeps hissing at you; you do not give away the one gift you actually cook with.

Timing: the planet's weekday, in daylight, with the recipient's dignity preserved: a gift handed over with respect, never thrown from a car window. The quality of the giving is the remedy.

WHY? *Astronomical, through the hora order (Chapter 16).* The weekday lords come from the planetary hours. List the seven planets from slowest to fastest as seen from Earth (Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Sun, Venus, Mercury, Moon), give each hour of the day to the next planet in that order, and the planet ruling the first hour after sunrise names the day. Twenty-four hours is three full rounds of seven plus three, so the day after Saturn's day begins with the Sun, then the Moon, then Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus: the week. "Saturn's day" is literally the day whose first hour he rules, so that is when his substances are offered. Parallel: a shop rota where each worker opens in turn; the day is named after whoever holds the morning key.

Gemstones (ratna)

STORY: THE LOUDSPEAKER AND THE MUZZLE. *A gemstone is a loudspeaker. Hang it on a courtier and everything he says is heard in every room of the haveli. Now picture the wedding at which Shani-ji, the old Judge of Labour, has had too much to drink and is lecturing the guests on their failings. The frightened host runs to the jeweller: "Give me a blue sapphire, for Saturn!" The jeweller, smiling, hands him a loudspeaker. The lecture is now audible in the street. What the host needed was a muzzle: a quiet word, a plate of food, a task for the old man's hands (daan, seva, mantra). No jeweller sells a muzzle. **Rule:** A stone strengthens; it never pacifies. Prescribe it only for a weak functional benefic, never for a functional malefic.*

A gemstone strengthens. It does not pacify, calm, block or "balance". Therefore a stone is prescribed **only** for a **functional benefic** that **needs strength** (the Lagna lord, the 5th or 9th lord, the yogakaraka) and **never** for a functional malefic. Not for the 6th, 8th or 12th lord; not for the 3rd or 11th lord; not for Rahu or Ketu except in the narrowest, rarest circumstances, which a beginner should not attempt.

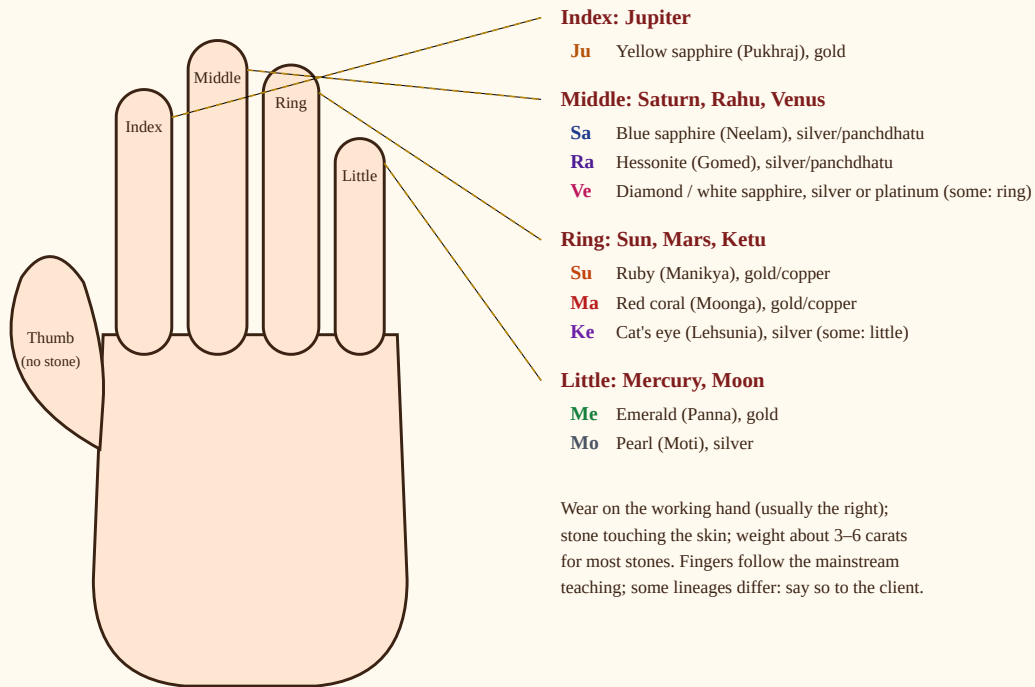
WHY? *The classical view (symbolic), named as such.* The gem texts (the Garuda Purana and the later ratna-shastra tradition) treat a ratna as a planet's own colour and light in solid form: a ruby carries the Sun's red-gold ray, a blue sapphire Saturn's dark blue. Worn against the skin, it pours that ray into the body all day. More of a planet's ray is simply more of that planet; no stone carries "less Saturn". Parallel: a loudspeaker amplifies whoever is holding it and does not check whether the speech is kind.

Two refinements. A **debilitated** planet gets no stone unless its debility is cancelled (Neecha Bhanga, Chapter 10). And a functional benefic **already strong** (exalted, in its own sign, in a kendra with dig bala) needs no stone either. Don't fix what isn't broken.

May this planet receive a gemstone?	Verdict
Lagna lord, 5th or 9th lord, or yogakaraka that is weak (enemy sign, combust, dusthana, retrograde, low strength)	● Yes; the only case
Lagna lord, 5th or 9th lord, but already strong (exalted, own sign, kendra)	● Not needed; don't fix what isn't broken
Kendra lord (4th, 7th, 10th) that is a natural benefic	● Rarely; only with a clear reason and a trial
Debilitated planet without Neecha Bhanga	○ No
Lord of the 3rd, 6th, 8th, 11th or 12th (functional malefic for that Lagna)	○ Never
Rahu or Ketu	○ Never, for a beginner

Planet	Stone (Hindi)	Metal	Finger	Approx. weight
Sun	Ruby (Manikya)	Gold or copper	Ring	3–6 carats
Moon	Pearl (Moti)	Silver	Little	3–6 carats
Mars	Red coral (Moonga)	Gold or copper	Ring	5–9 carats (coral is light)
Mercury	Emerald (Panna)	Gold	Little	3–6 carats
Jupiter	Yellow sapphire (Pukhraj)	Gold	Index	3–6 carats
Venus	Diamond (Heera) or white sapphire	Silver or platinum	Middle (some: ring)	Diamond ½–1 carat; white sapphire 3–6
Saturn	Blue sapphire (Neelam)	Silver, panchdhatu or iron	Middle	3–6 carats; 3-day trial
Rahu	Hessonite (Gomed)	Silver or panchdhatu	Middle	3–6 carats
Ketu	Cat's eye (Lehsunia)	Silver or panchdhatu	Ring or little	3–6 carats

Which finger for which stone (common practice)



Wear on the working hand (usually the right); stone touching the skin; weight about 3–6 carats for most stones. Fingers follow the mainstream teaching; some lineages differ: say so to the client.

A stone is prescribed only for a weak functional benefic (Appendix A.13). The finger is the easy part.

Figure 23.2: Fingers and stones by common practice. Index for Jupiter; middle for Saturn, Rahu and Venus; ring for Sun, Mars and Ketu; little for Mercury and Moon. Lineages differ on Venus and Ketu; say so.

Metals and fingers follow the mainstream teaching; weights are the working range. The stone must **touch the skin** (open-backed setting), on the **working hand**, first worn on the planet's **weekday**, after washing in milk and water and 108 repetitions of its mantra. That is the whole ritual.

The trial period

Blue sapphire is famous for a **three-day trial**: kept under the pillow or worn loosely for three nights, and returned if the days bring bad dreams, accidents, illness or a sharp turn of luck. I extend the idea to *every* stone: wear it a week, watch, stop if anything feels wrong.

Never wear enemies together

STORY: TWO PARTIES, ONE HAND. *The court has two parties (Chapter 3). The Royal Party (the King, the Queen Mother, the Commander and Guru-ji the Priest) wears ruby, pearl, coral and yellow sapphire. The People's Party (the young Prince, Shukracharya the Minister of Pleasure and old Shani-ji the Judge, with the Smoke-headed Stranger and the Headless Sadhu at their table) wears emerald, diamond, blue sapphire, hessonite and cat's eye. Seat both parties on one small hand and they quarrel all day: the King's ruby shouting at the Judge's sapphire on the next finger, the Queen Mother's pearl flinching from the Stranger's hessonite. My client with three rings had seated the Priest beside the Judge.*

Rule: *Never wear the stones of enemy planets together; keep the Royal Party's stones and the People's Party's stones apart.*

Pair	Wear together?
Ruby + pearl, ruby + coral, ruby + yellow sapphire (Royal Party)	● Yes
Emerald + diamond, emerald + blue sapphire, diamond + blue sapphire (People's Party)	● Yes
Coral + yellow sapphire, pearl + yellow sapphire	● Yes
Yellow sapphire + emerald; pearl + emerald	🔥 Traditions differ; avoid unless a teacher you trust allows it
Ruby + blue sapphire, ruby + diamond, ruby + hessonite	○ No
Pearl + hessonite, pearl + cat's eye, pearl + blue sapphire	○ No
Coral + emerald, coral + blue sapphire, coral + hessonite	○ No
Yellow sapphire + diamond, yellow sapphire + blue sapphire	○ No

Substitute stones (upa-ratna)

The precious stones are expensive; the tradition allows cheaper substitutes, and I prescribe them freely:

Precious	Substitute (upa-ratna)
Ruby	Garnet, red spinel
Pearl	Moonstone
Red coral	Carnelian
Emerald	Peridot, green tourmaline
Yellow sapphire	Citrine, yellow topaz
Diamond	White sapphire, white zircon
Blue sapphire	Amethyst, iolite, lapis lazuli
Hessonite	Orange zircon
Cat's eye	Tiger's eye

Quality and certification

Glass does nothing but lighten the purse. Insist on a **natural, untreated** stone with a certificate from a recognised gemmological laboratory, a dealer who accepts returns, and a price range told to the client *before* they shop. Never sell stones yourself; never take commission.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Prescribing a stone as the *first* remedy, because it is the one the client expects and the one that pays. Reverse the order. Conduct first, mantra second, daan third; a stone only when the analysis says a functional benefic is weak and the client's means allow. When I read for someone, fewer than one in ten leaves with a stone recommendation.

CONSULTATION TIP: On stone-selling. The temptation is real. A beginner earns five hundred rupees for a reading and could earn five thousand on a sapphire. The industry built on that arithmetic has done more damage to astrology's name than any sceptic. If you sell stones, your prescriptions are no longer trusted: not by the client and, soon, not by you. Read charts; let jewellers sell jewels.

Fasting (vrata)

The weekday fasts are the oldest household remedies: **Monday** for the Moon and Shiva, **Tuesday** for Mars and Hanuman, **Thursday** for Jupiter, **Friday** for Venus and the goddess, **Saturday** for Saturn; and **Ekadashi**, the eleventh lunar day, for Vishnu. A fast is usually one meal a day, or fruit and milk, until sunset.

Health first. No fasting for diabetics, pregnant or nursing women, the frail, children, or anyone whose medication needs food; say so aloud. For them a fast becomes a *restriction* (no salt, grain, meat or alcohol) on the planet's day. The point is a small act of self-command, not hunger.

Seva and conduct: the remedies that always work

If I had to keep only one family of remedies, it would be this one.

STORY: THE JUDGE'S SATURDAY. *Shani-ji, the old Judge of Labour, cannot be bribed and cannot be flattered: a stone does not impress him and a sweet does not soften him. He was a servant before he became a judge, and he remembers. What he watches is how you treat his people: the labourer, the sweeper, the old man nobody visits. Bring him nothing; instead, on his day, give your hour to someone who works with his hands. Then he nods, and the sentence he was about to pass becomes a lesson instead. Every planet has such a door, and it is always a person. Rule: Each planet is honoured by caring for the people it signifies, on its weekday; Saturn by seva to the poor, the old and those who labour.*

Each planet's signification tells you exactly what conduct pacifies or honours it:

Planet	Conduct remedy (seva)
Sun	Respect the father and authority; punctuality; face the dawn; keep your word in public
Moon	Care for the mother and for women who are mothers; keep regular sleep; give water; tend the emotional life
Mars	Control anger; protect younger siblings; physical discipline; donate blood
Mercury	Honest speech; teach someone what you know; care for a sister or a young student
Jupiter	Respect teachers and elders; study something daily; give knowledge freely
Venus	Honour the spouse and women generally; cleanliness and beauty in the home; the arts
Saturn	Serve the poor, the elderly, labourers and servants; punctuality and thrift; humility
Rahu	Discipline and routine; avoid intoxicants, gambling and shortcuts; help outsiders and migrants
Ketu	Feed dogs; meditate; serve ascetics and the dying; practise detachment from a specific craving

Every line is something a wise grandmother would prescribe without a chart; the chart tells you *which* grandmother's advice this person needs most.

Yantras and rudraksha

A **yantra** is a geometric diagram of a planet or deity, engraved on copper or drawn on paper, kept on the altar; the nine planetary yantras are number-squares. It is a focus for daily attention; its power is what you bring to it.

Rudraksha beads (seeds of the *Elaeocarpus* tree, sacred to Shiva) are classified by their natural faces (*mukhi*), matched by tradition to planets: **1 Sun, 2 Moon, 3 Mars, 4 Mercury, 5 Jupiter, 6 Venus, 7 Saturn, 8 Rahu, 9 Ketu**. The five-faced bead is the universal, safe, cheap one I most often suggest. Fakes are common; buy from a temple or trusted source.

Colours and directions

The Vastu-lite version: honour a planet with its colour (saffron for the Sun, white for the Moon and Venus, red for Mars, green for Mercury, yellow for Jupiter, dark blue or black for Saturn, smoky blue for Rahu, multicolour for Ketu) and avoid a malefic's colour on its day. One common scheme of directions: Sun east, Venus south-east, Mars south, Rahu south-west, Saturn west, Moon north-west, Mercury north, Jupiter north-east. Facing the planet's direction for its mantra is harmless; rearranging a client's house is a separate profession.

The remedial logic: how to choose

STORY: THE VAIDYA'S SLIP OF PAPER. *The old family vaidya in my mother's town never sold medicine. He listened, pressed the wrist, named the trouble, and wrote three lines on a slip of paper: one thing to stop, one thing to take, one thing to do. Then he named the day to return. He would not write a fourth line ("a patient with seven instructions follows none") and he would not write a tonic for a man who was already strong: "why fatten a healthy bull?" When a patient begged for the expensive syrup, he asked what it was for. That slip is what a remedy prescription should look like: the trouble named, tonic or sedative decided, two or three lines, a review date, no sale. **Rule:** Name the planet and house; decide strengthen or pacify; prescribe at most three things; write it down; review.*

Here is the procedure, in the order I follow it:

1. **Identify the problem house and planet** from the analysis, not from the client's fear. The chart says where the pressure is; the dasha says when.
2. **Decide: strengthen or pacify.** Functional benefic and weak → strengthen. Functional malefic troubling the house → pacify. Functional benefic and already strong → leave it alone.
3. **Prefer conduct + mantra + daan.** Gems only when justified by step 2 and by means.
4. **Match the client's faith and means.** A Muslim, Christian, Sikh or non-religious client gets remedies in their own language: charity for daan, a prayer of their tradition or a silent discipline for a mantra, service for puja, the planet's weekday as the day. "On Saturdays, for forty days, give something to a labourer and speak to no one harshly" is a Saturn remedy in any religion.
5. **Never more than two or three remedies at once.** A client with seven instructions does none.

The remedy prescription card

I write every prescription on a card the client takes home:

- **Name / chart reference · Date**
- **Concern:** (in the client's words)
- **Chart reading:** house(s) ____ · planet ____ · period ____ (from-to)
- **Aim:** ● strengthen ____ / ○ pacify ____ / ● leave alone
- **Remedy 1 (conduct):** ____ (daily / on ____ days)
- **Remedy 2 (mantra or prayer): ; count ;** begin ____; for ____ days
- **Remedy 3 (daan or charity):** item ; *to whom* ; on ____
- **Gemstone:** not indicated / indicated: , ____ *carats*, ____ *metal*, ____ *finger*; *reason* ; estimated cost ____
- **Review date:** ____
- Footer, printed on every card: "These support your effort; they do not replace it. Nothing here is medical advice. You may stop any of them at any time."

The card forces you to justify every line, stops the client mis-remembering, and is your record.

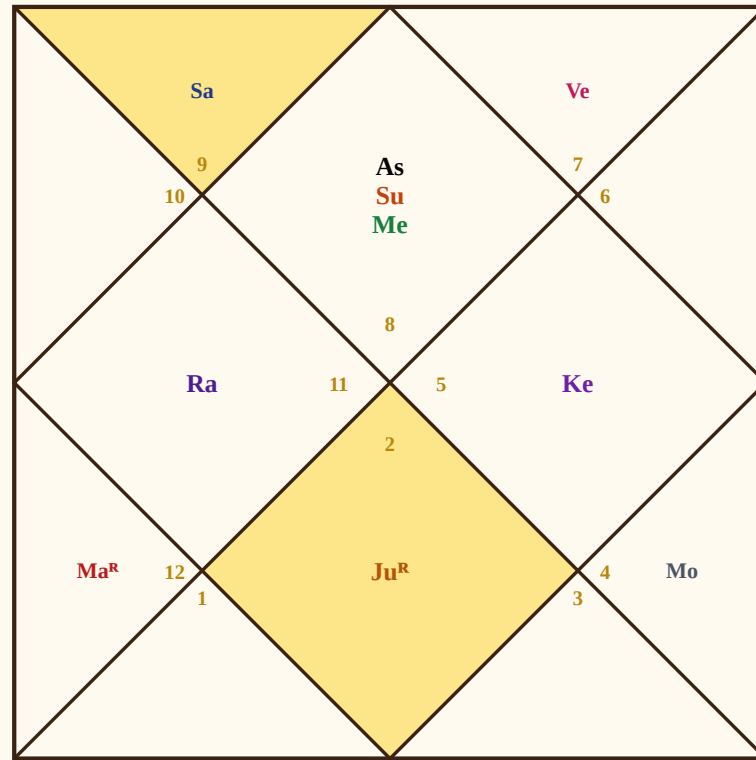
FROM LAL KITAB: Lal Kitab's remedies (upay) follow their own principles and sit beside the Parashari families rather than inside them: simple household items at low cost; performed for 40 or 43 consecutive days, restarting if a day is missed; never harming any being; never for selfish gain against another; not a substitute for right conduct; done in the daytime as commonly taught; and specific to both planet and house. As a rule the tradition uses no gemstones. I draw on these upay when I want a cheap, harmless, disciplining act for a pacification (feeding crows, floating a coconut, giving a blanket) and I always tell the client which system it comes from. Chapter 22 gives the full picture. (*Source: Lal Kitab, Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, 1939–1952 Urdu editions; Hindi translations vary.*)

Worked remedies for the three charts

For each chart: the functional nature of the planet (Appendix A.6), the decision, the remedy.

Chart A: Meera (Scorpio Lagna)

Chart A (Meera): Jupiter in the 7th, Saturn in the 2nd



The two placements most often asked about for remedies

Figure 23.3: Chart A. Jupiter (retrograde) in the 7th and Saturn in the 2nd are the two placements clients most often ask remedies for.

Venus, the running Mahadasha lord (2007–2027). Venus owns the 7th and 12th for Scorpio and is a functional malefic (A.6), sitting as 12th lord in the 12th in its own sign Libra: Vimala yoga. Decision: **do not strengthen, and do not fuss.** Venus is dignified and its period brought her marriage (2016) and a steady career; a diamond would be a sale. If Venus sub-periods bring expense or restlessness, a Friday daan of curd or white cloth is enough.

Jupiter, 2nd and 5th lord, retrograde in the 7th in Taurus. A functional benefic carrying wealth, children and learning. Weak? Taurus is an enemy's sign for Jupiter and it is retrograde; but it is not combust, sits in a kendra and aspects the Lagna. Weak-ish, not broken. Yellow sapphire? *In principle yes; in practice* begin with Thursday conduct, the Jupiter beeja mantra, no daan of Jupiter's items, and hold the stone in reserve for a Jupiter sub-period that shows strain.

Saturn in the 2nd in Sagittarius. Saturn owns the 3rd and 4th for Scorpio, a functional malefic (A.6) in the house of speech, family and savings. Decision: **pacify, never a blue sapphire.** Speech discipline (the 2nd is the mouth): a specific promise about harsh words at home; Saturday seva to the elderly; the Hanuman Chalisa; a modest daan of black sesame or mustard oil. Two or three of these, not all.

Rahu in the 4th, Ketu in the 10th. Mother and home; career. Decision: pacify by conduct: care for her mother, order in the home, a coconut daan in Rahu sub-periods; feeding dogs, a Ganesha practice and unpaid teaching for Ketu. No hessonite, no cat's eye.

Chart B: Arjun (Cancer Lagna)

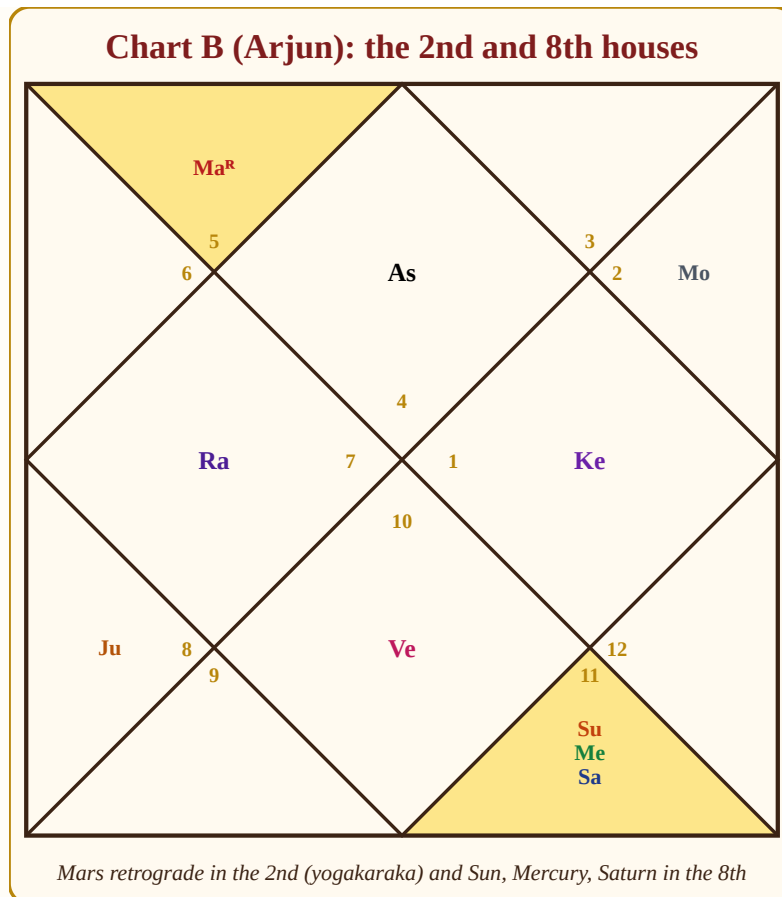


Figure 23.4: Chart B, generated with the book's tool. Mars retrograde in the 2nd is the *yogakaraka*; the Sun, Mercury and Saturn crowd the 8th.

Mars, retrograde in the 2nd in Leo. Mars owns the 5th and 10th for Cancer, the *yogakaraka* (A.6), a functional benefic of the first rank. In a friend's sign, retrograde, in a wealth house: less than it could be, and Mars sub-periods recur through life. Decision: **strengthen; a red coral is justified**: five to seven carats, gold or copper, ring finger, first worn on a Tuesday. Add control of anger and speech, Tuesday Hanuman worship, no daan of red lentils.

Saturn in the 8th in Aquarius. Saturn owns the 7th and 8th for Cancer, neutral to malefic (A.6), and sits in its own sign in the 8th, combust (7° from the Sun) and beside Mercury. As 7th lord it also carries his marriage. Decision: **pacify; not a blue sapphire**. A beginner sees "combust" and reaches for a stone to strengthen; but Saturn is not a planet this Lagna wants louder. Saturday seva, the Hanuman Chalisa, a daan of mustard oil in Saturn sub-periods, and, since the 8th is research and insurance, the advice to put Saturn's patience to work.

Rahu in the 4th in Libra. Decision: pacify. A coconut floated in running water on a Saturday, discipline at home, care for the mother, no intoxicants, especially through the Rahu Mahadasha (age 18.8–36.8, roughly 2014–2032).

Moon, Lagna lord, in the 11th in Taurus. The Moon is a functional benefic and Arjun's Lagna lord, sitting in Taurus, its exaltation sign, 6° past the deepest point and within its Moolatrikona range (A.2). Not weak. Decision: **a pearl is possible, not necessary**. It harms nothing, but "don't fix what isn't broken" says spend the money elsewhere. Monday conduct is enough.

Chart C: Devika (Aries Lagna)

Mars, Lagna lord, in the 3rd in Gemini. Mars is a functional benefic (A.6) in the sign of Mercury, its natural enemy, in the 3rd, a house of effort where Mars is comfortable but not dignified. Decision: **strengthen; a red coral is justified** for the Lagna lord, particularly through Mars sub-periods. Add Tuesday conduct: protecting siblings, physical discipline, controlled anger.

Jupiter, 9th and 12th lord, exalted in the 4th in Cancer with the Sun. A functional benefic, exalted, in a kendra. Weak? Not remotely. Yellow sapphire? **No, don't fix what isn't broken;** a stone on an exalted kendra Jupiter is a sale. Thursday conduct honours it at no cost; the stone can be reconsidered in her Jupiter Mahadasha (age 60–76).

Saturn and Rahu (with Mercury) in the 5th in Leo. The 5th is children, intellect and mantra. Saturn owns the 10th and 11th for Aries, a functional malefic (A.6); Rahu is a shadow malefic; and the pair sits on her children's house. Decision: **pacify, with 5th-house remedies; no stones for Saturn or Rahu, ever, here.** Ganesha worship (the remover of obstacles, matched to Ketu and to the 5th's mantra nature), Saturday seva to children who lack teachers, a coconut daan for Rahu, the Hanuman Chalisa. Her Rahu Mahadasha (age 42–60, about 2021–2039) is exactly the time; put Ganesha first and keep the rest simple.

Chart · planet	Functional nature	Decision
A · Venus (12th lord in 12th, MD 2007–2027)	○ malefic, but dignified	♣ Leave alone; Friday daan if sub-periods pinch; no diamond
A · Jupiter (2nd/5th lord, retro in 7th)	● benefic, somewhat weak	● Strengthen: mantra, Thursday conduct; yellow sapphire held in reserve
A · Saturn (3rd/4th lord in 2nd)	○ malefic	○ Pacify: speech discipline, Saturday seva, Hanuman Chalisa; no stone
A · Rahu (4th), Ketu (10th)	○ shadow malefics	○ Pacify by conduct: mother, home, dogs, service
B · Mars (yogakarak, retro in 2nd)	● benefic, first rank	● Strengthen: red coral justified
B · Saturn (7th/8th lord, combust in 8th)	♣ neutral to malefic	○ Pacify: Saturday seva, Hanuman Chalisa; no blue sapphire
B · Rahu (4th)	○ shadow malefic	○ Pacify: coconut, discipline, care of mother
B · Moon (Lagna lord, exalted sign, 11th)	● benefic, strong	♣ Pearl possible, not necessary
C · Mars (Lagna lord in 3rd, enemy sign)	● benefic, weakish	● Strengthen: red coral justified
C · Jupiter (9th lord, exalted in 4th)	● benefic, very strong	♣ Leave alone; no yellow sapphire
C · Saturn + Rahu (5th)	○ malefics	○ Pacify: Ganesha, Saturday seva, coconut; no stones

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Across three charts we prescribed two stones (coral for B and C), held one in reserve (yellow sapphire for A), and refused four (diamond and blue sapphire for A, blue sapphire for B, yellow sapphire and any Saturn/Rahu stone for C). That ratio (more refusals than prescriptions) is what an honest remedial practice looks like.

Ethics: what you owe the person across the table

- **Informed consent.** Explain why each remedy is chosen, what it costs, and that they may decline.
- **No fear.** A remedy offered as escape from a threat you have just planted is extortion, however gentle the voice.
- **No guarantees.** Never say a remedy *will* bring the job, the child, the marriage. It supports; the effort is theirs.
- **Disclose costs; take no commission.** Never route a client to a dealer who pays you.
- **Never medical advice.** A client with symptoms goes to a doctor first, and you say so in those words.
- **Nothing that harms.** No remedy against another person, no injury to an animal, no fasting diabetic.

CONSULTATION TIP: The exact words, for a Saturn prescription: "Looking at your chart, the pressure right now is on your fourth house (home and mother) through Saturn's period, which runs until March 2028. I am going to suggest three things, all of them free. Feeding crows or giving a little oil to a labourer on Saturdays for forty days; the Hanuman Chalisa on Saturday mornings if you are comfortable with it, or ten quiet minutes if you are not; and a promise to yourself about how you speak at home. These support your effort; they do not replace it, and none of them is medical advice. You may stop any of them whenever you wish. I am not recommending a stone; nothing in your chart calls for one. Let us review in six months."

In one breath

- A remedy works on the client's mind and conduct in alignment with the planet's meaning; it is a prescription, not a sale, and never a guarantee.
- Four families in Parashari practice: conduct/worship/fasting, mantra, daan, gemstone; reach for them in that order.
- The organising question is **strengthen or pacify**: strengthen a weak functional benefic; pacify a troublesome functional malefic.
- Mantras: the nine beeja mantras with their classical counts (×4 in Kali Yuga); the Vyasa Navagraha stotra; deity practices matched to planets; prescribe planet, count, day, duration and sankalpa.
- Daan pacifies: donate a malefic's items to its traditional recipients on its day; never give away the items of a benefic you need.
- Gemstones strengthen: only for a weak functional benefic, never for a malefic, never for a debilitated planet without neecha bhanga, never for a planet already strong; respect enemy pairs, use substitutes, insist on certification, and never sell.
- Fasting with health caveats; seva matched to the planet; rudraksha 1–9 mukhi for Sun through Ketu; colours and directions as a light touch.
- Choose by the five-step logic, give at most two or three remedies, adapt to the client's faith and means, and write it on a card with a review date.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. A Taurus-Lagna client asks for a yellow sapphire "for luck". Using Appendix A.6, decide and explain in two sentences.
2. For Chart B, design a complete prescription card for the Saturn-in-the-8th concern, using the template above.
3. Which of these pairs may be worn together, and which not: ruby and pearl; pearl and hessonite; emerald and blue sapphire; coral and emerald? Give the reason from natural friendship.
4. A client is a practising Christian and wants help with a difficult Saturn period. Write a three-line secular/faith-matched prescription.
5. For Chart C, a jeweller has told Devika to buy a yellow sapphire and a blue sapphire. Write what you would say to her.

Answers

1. For Taurus Lagna, Jupiter owns the 8th and 11th and is a functional malefic (A.6); a stone strengthens, so a yellow sapphire would strengthen a malefic. Decline it, and if Jupiter is troubling her, pacify with Thursday daan of Jupiter's items and respect for teachers. 2. Sample. Concern: anxiety about health and sudden events. Reading: 8th house; Saturn, 7th/8th lord, own sign, combust, with Sun and Mercury; Rahu MD to about 2032. Aim: ○ pacify Saturn. Remedy 1: weekly Saturday seva to an elderly neighbour or a labourer. Remedy 2: Hanuman Chalisa (or ten quiet minutes) on Saturday mornings for 40 days. Remedy 3: a small monthly Saturday daan of mustard oil. Gemstone: not indicated (a stone would strengthen a functional malefic). Review: six months. Footer. 3. Ruby and pearl: yes (Sun and Moon are friends). Pearl and hessonite: no (Moon and Rahu are hostile). Emerald and blue sapphire: yes (Mercury and Saturn are friends). Coral and emerald: no (Mars and Mercury are enemies). 4. Something like: "For the next forty Saturdays, give something (money, food or an hour's help) to someone who works with their hands or to an elderly person; keep a fixed Saturday-morning time for prayer or quiet in your own tradition; and choose one habit of discipline (punctuality, a budget) to keep through the period." Saturn's meaning; no ritual the client does not own. 5. "Your Jupiter is exalted in a strong house; it does not need help, and a yellow sapphire would be money for something already working. Saturn owns your 10th and 11th and sits with Rahu in your 5th; it is a planet to calm, not to strengthen, so a blue sapphire is the one stone you must not wear. The 5th house asks for Ganesha worship, Saturday service and a coconut daan for Rahu: a few rupees at most. The coral for Mars, your Lagna lord, is the only stone I would consider."

Chapter 24: The Consultation, From Birth Details to a Client Who Comes Back

Everything before this page was about reading the sky. This chapter is about the other half of the job, the half that no classical text teaches and that decides whether you will still be practising in ten years: the hour a frightened, hopeful, sceptical human being spends in the chair across from you.

I remember my first paid sitting. I knew the chart cold and still made a mess of the hour: I answered the question before I had checked the birth time, said one true thing too bluntly, and watched a woman I read for leave paler than she had arrived. I also remember the first sitting that went right, a year later, and what had changed was not the astrology. It was the preparation, the order, the language, and the ethics. Those four things can be learned, and this chapter is everything I wish someone had handed me before that first hour.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: A consultation is judged by what the client can *do* on Monday morning. If they leave with a plan, you did your job. If they leave with a fear, you did the client harm and yourself no favour.

The mindset: a counsellor with a map

Get one idea straight before anything else. You are not an oracle. You are a counsellor who happens to have a very good map.

A map shows the terrain: here the road climbs, here it is flat, here there is a river and a bridge at mile thirty-two. It does not tell the traveller whether to walk. Chapter 1 called the chart a map of tendencies and timings, and every chapter since has shown you how to read the terrain. Now you will hand that reading to someone who has to walk the road, and the way you hand it over matters as much as its accuracy.

Two consequences follow. First, **the client's dignity comes before your cleverness**. You will be tempted to show how much you see, the difficult marriage, the father's illness, the money that went missing in 2019. Resist. Say only what helps, in the order that helps. Second, **the client keeps the decisions**. You may say the wind favours a move abroad in 2027. You may never say "go". The moment you decide for people, you have taken a responsibility no chart entitles you to and no fee can pay for.

Think of the family doctor of the old kind, the one who knew your grandmother's knees. He had test results in his hand and he told you the truth, but he told it in a way that made you want to get better. That is the posture.

Before the session

The consultation begins two days before the client arrives, when their birth details land in your inbox. Most beginners skip this stage and try to read cold, in the room, with the client watching. Do not. A surgeon does not open the patient and then look for the textbook.

The intake form

Ask for these in writing, before you accept the appointment. A one-page form, on paper or online, is fine.

Field	Why you need it
Full name (and the name they use)	Records, and so you address them correctly
Date of birth	Obvious, but ask them to write the year in full; "89" has cost me an hour
Time of birth, and its source	Hospital record, birth certificate, a parent's memory, "around dawn", each deserves a different level of trust
Place of birth (town, not just state)	Latitude and longitude fix the Lagna
Their question or questions, in their own words	So you prepare the right houses, and so you can quote them back
Have they consulted an astrologer before? What were they told?	Half your session may be undoing fear someone else planted
The events list: marriage date; children's birth years; father's and mother's major events (illness, retirement, passing, if they are willing); job changes with years; surgeries or serious illness; moves to another city or country	This is your rectification material and your confirmation material
Anything they do not want discussed	Consent, in advance

Tell them on the form why you want the events: "so that I can check the birth time against your life before I say anything about your future." Clients respect this. It tells them you are serious.

CONSULTATION TIP: If the time comes from family memory, ask one more question: "Was it before or after breakfast? Was it dark?" Indian families remember meals and daylight better than clocks. Those two answers often narrow a vague "morning" to a two-hour window, which is exactly one Lagna. It worked on my own grandmother's memory of my birth.

Birth-time rectification, the basics

The Lagna changes roughly every two hours (Chapter 5, the eastern horizon sweeps through one sign in about that time, faster for some signs, slower for others). The Moon moves about one degree every two hours, which shifts the dasha balance by weeks, not years. So a birth time that is off by twenty minutes rarely breaks a chart; one that is off by two hours breaks everything.

Rectification is the craft of testing candidate times against a known life. Here is the routine I use; it took me an hour at first and takes about twenty minutes now.

1. **Draw the candidate Lagnas.** If the family says "about eight in the evening", cast the chart at 19:30, 20:15 and 21:00 and see which Lagnas appear. Often two candidates survive; sometimes three.
2. **Test each candidate against 3–4 dated events.** Take the marriage, the first job, a parent's major event, a surgery. For each candidate Lagna, ask: which dasha and antardasha was running (Chapter 13), and which houses were Saturn and Jupiter touching (Chapter 14)? The right Lagna makes the events fall on the right houses. The wrong one makes you argue with yourself.
3. **Use the Navamsa Lagna and the D10 as tie-breakers.** The D9 Lagna changes every 13–15 minutes and the D10 Lagna every 12 or so (Chapter 11). If two Rasi candidates both fit, ask which Navamsa Lagna fits the marriage and which Dasamsa Lagna fits the career.

4. **Apply the personality test, lightly.** Chapter 5 gave each Lagna a body type and temperament. A Cancer Lagna and a Leo Lagna sit differently in a chair, speak differently, and remember differently. This is the weakest evidence and I use it last, but it has tipped a coin for me many times.
5. **Choose, record, and say so.** Write down the time you settled on, the events that supported it, and the one that did not quite fit. Tell the client: "I have used 20:15; it fits your first job and your difficult 2022 best. If a prediction feels wrong later, this is the first thing we will revisit."

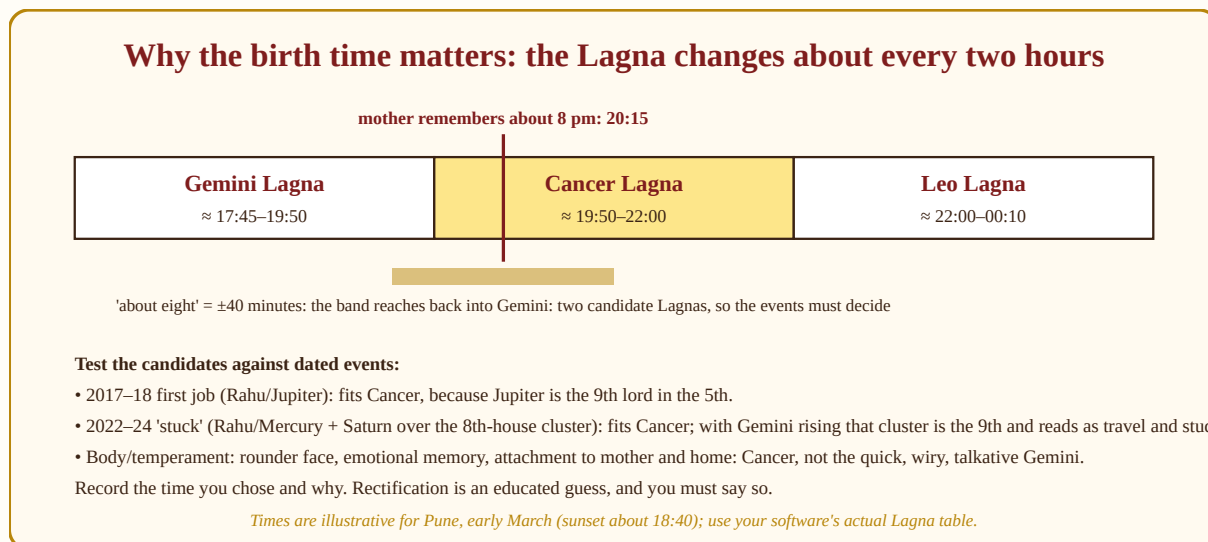


Figure 24.1: Arjun's evening. "About eight o'clock, from his mother's memory": 20:15, sits early in the Cancer window, so a ±40-minute uncertainty reaches back into Gemini. The dated events decide between the two. Times shown are illustrative.

WHY? The reason is astronomical. The Lagna is the degree rising in the east, and the whole zodiac rises once a day, so a new sign comes up roughly every two hours and the exact degree moves every four minutes. A birth time that is off by two hours moves every planet into a different house and changes every lord; nothing you say afterwards can be right. Checking the time against dated events is the only test that uses the client's own life as the measuring stick. Everyday parallel: a doctor confirms the patient's name and date of birth before reading out the report, however sure she is that she has the right file.

Be honest with yourself and the client: rectification is an approximation. Anyone who tells you they have fixed a birth time to the second from a few life events is performing, not practising.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Rectifying the time *until the chart says what the client wants to hear*. If a candidate Lagna "explains" the marriage only after you have also changed the house system, the ayanamsa and your interpretation of the 7th lord, you have not rectified anything. You have decorated a guess.

The 60–90 minute preparation routine

Once the time is settled, I sit with the chart alone for an hour, sometimes ninety minutes, with Appendix A open and a blank page. I fill the page in the same order every time, because order is what saved me the first time a client cried and I could not think. The list below is the same one you will find printed in Appendix C; photocopy it and tick it off for every chart until it is in your bones.

1. **Lagna:** sign, degree and lord; the lord's sign, house and dignity.

2. **Moon:** sign, nakshatra and pada, waxing or waning, and strength (own, exalted or debilitated; alone or supported).
3. **Sun:** sign, house and dignity; then check combustion for every planet within orb of it.
4. **Functional benefics and malefics for this Lagna** (Chapter 8, Appendix A.6); mark the yogakaraka and the marakas.
5. **Planets in kendras (1, 4, 7, 10), trikonas (5, 9) and dusthanas (6, 8, 12).**
6. **Exalted, debilitated, combust and retrograde planets;** any Neecha Bhanga.
7. **Yogas present,** and whether the planets forming them are strong enough to deliver.
8. **The seven key houses (1, 2, 4, 5, 7, 10, 11),** read by the five-step method (the house, its lord, the karaka, the same house from the Moon, the divisional chart).
9. **Navamsa (D9) and Dasamsa (D10) quick read:** varga Lagnas, Vargottama planets, and the D9/D10 dignity of the Lagna lord, the 7th lord and the 10th lord.
10. **Current Mahadasha and Antardasha with dates,** and the next two sub-periods.
11. **Saturn and Jupiter transit positions** counted from the Lagna and from the Moon; Sade Sati or Dhainya status; where the double transit falls.
12. **The client's stated questions,** each mapped to its houses, lord, karaka and the periods that activate them.
13. **Remedies shortlist:** conduct first, then daan and mantra; a gemstone only if a functional benefic needs strength.
14. **Three past events or traits you will ask the client to confirm** before you predict anything.

Fourteen items looks like a lot. After twenty charts it takes forty minutes; after a hundred, you will find that items 1 to 7 assemble themselves while you make tea, and the real work is in 8, 11 and 12.

CONSULTATION TIP: Item 14 is the one beginners skip and the one I would keep if I had to throw away the other thirteen. Choose three things the chart says about the *past*, a job change in a particular year, a difficult period with the mother, a move, and hold them ready. If two of the three land, your time is good and your client is listening. If none land, stop and revisit the time before you predict a single thing.

The order of a session

Sessions have a shape, and the shape is not negotiable. Clients arrive wanting their question answered in the first minute; if you oblige, you skip the confirmation, and you skip the general picture that makes the specific answer make sense. Here is the order I settled on after my first fifty sittings, with rough timings for a seventy-five-minute sitting.

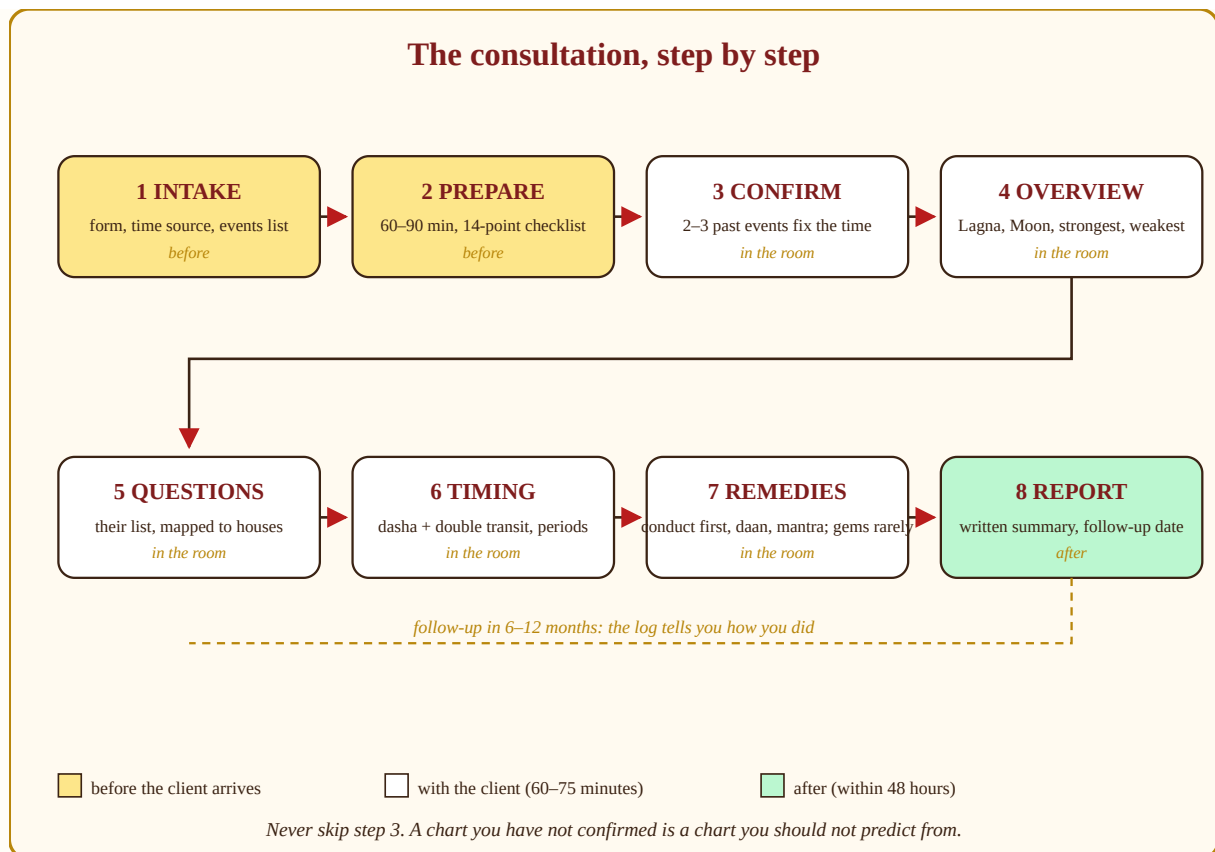


Figure 24.2: The eight steps. Two happen before the client arrives, five in the room, one after. The dashed line is the follow-up: the log you keep tells you, a year later, how well you read.

STORY: A PETITIONER COMES TO COURT. A farmer arrives at the haveli with a question about his land. The Queen Mother (Moon) receives him first and asks about his journey, was the road as he remembers it? That is the confirmation. Then the King (Sun) speaks for a minute, not more: "You are an honest man with a stubborn streak; your land is good, your well is shallow." That is the overview. The young Prince (Mercury) takes the petitions one at a time, in the order the farmer wrote them. The old Judge of Labour (Saturn) opens the railway timetable and says which season the water will come. The Royal Priest (Jupiter) gives him a blessing and a task for Thursdays. And the Secretary writes it all down and hands the farmer the page before he leaves. Nobody at that court answers the question before the journey has been checked.

Rule: Open, confirm, overview, questions, timing, remedies, written record, in that order, every time.

WHY? The reason for the order is logical. Every specific answer depends on a frame: the Lagna and its lord tell you whose career or marriage you are timing, and the dasha tells you which years count, so the frame has to be laid before any detail can mean anything. Past before future, because the past is the only thing you can check. Everyday parallel: a school report card begins with the child's name, class and attendance before it lists the marks; a mark without the class it was scored in tells a parent nothing.

1. Opening (5 minutes). Set expectations and confidentiality in plain words. "Everything you tell me stays here. I will tell you what your chart suggests, as tendencies and time windows, not as certainties. You will make your own decisions; my job is to make sure you make them with your eyes open. Please stop me if anything is unclear or if I say something that is not true of your life, that helps me, it does not offend me." Then repeat their questions back to them from the intake form, and ask if anything has changed.

- 2. Confirm the time (5–10 minutes).** Offer your three past observations from item 14. Do this as questions, not as boasts. "Your chart suggests a change of work or study around 2017 or 2018, does that ring true?" If it does, note it. If it does not, ask what did happen that year, and listen. Two out of three is enough to proceed. Fewer, and you say: "I want to check something about the time before I go further," and you do it, in front of them, without embarrassment. Clients respect a craftsman who checks his measurements.
- 3. The general picture (5 minutes).** Four sentences: the Lagna and what it says about temperament; the Moon and what it says about the mind; the strongest planet and what it carries; the weakest planet and what it asks for. This is where the client starts to trust you, because you are describing them, not predicting them. Do not go past five minutes, the temptation to show off here is enormous.
- 4. Their questions (25–30 minutes).** Take them in the order the client gave, not the order you find interesting. For each: name the houses involved, say what the chart suggests as a tendency, say what supports it and what tests it, and give a window. Then stop and ask, "Does that make sense? Is that your experience so far?" Move on only when they nod.
- 5. Timing (10 minutes).** Pull the threads together: the current Mahadasha and Antardasha and what they favour, the next two sub-periods, and where Saturn and Jupiter are and will be. Give windows, never dates, unless the client explicitly asks and you hedge.
- 6. Remedies (5–10 minutes).** Conduct first, then daan and mantra, then, rarely, a gemstone, and only with the reasoning aloud (Chapter 23). Say what each remedy is *for*, and say plainly that a remedy supports effort; it does not replace it.
- 7. Close and written summary (5 minutes).** Repeat the three most important things you said. Tell them when a follow-up would be useful and why. Promise the written summary within 48 hours and deliver it. The summary is what they will actually remember; the session is what they will feel.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: General before specific, past before future, strengths before tests, plan before goodbye. If you remember nothing else about the order, remember these four pairs.

Language: the ten rules of astrological speech

A reading is words. The same true observation can be delivered as a blessing or a curse, and the client will live for years with whichever version you chose. These ten rules are how I learned to guard my mouth.

1. **Tendency, not certainty.** The chart shows a slope, not a fall. "Your chart leans towards..." is always true; "you will..." is never fully true.

WHY? Two reasons, one classical and one practical. The classical one: the tradition itself divides karma into *prarabdha*, the portion ripe for this life, which the chart shows, and *kriyamana*, what the person does now, which the chart cannot show; a prediction stated as certainty denies the second half of the system's own teaching. The practical one is ethical: a hedged tendency cannot harm. If it comes true, the client was prepared; if it does not, no life was rearranged around it. Everyday parallel: the weather forecast says "70 per cent chance of rain", and you carry an umbrella; nobody cancels the wedding.

2. **Period, not date,** unless asked, and then hedged. "The second half of 2027 is the strongest window I see" is honest. "Your marriage is on 14 November" is a lottery ticket with your name on it.

3. **Never death.** Not the client's, not a parent's, not a spouse's. Not with a date, not with a year, not with a wink. Chapter 20 taught you longevity; this chapter tells you to keep it to yourself and speak of health and care instead.
4. **Never "you will divorce". Never "your child will fail".** Say what the tendency asks for, patience, communication, a different kind of schooling, not the worst outcome.
5. **Malefics are tests; benefics are support.** Saturn in the 7th is not "trouble in marriage"; it is "marriage will ask you for patience and will reward it slowly". Same chart, different life.
6. **Use the verbs of the trade:** *your chart suggests, favours, leans towards, asks you to be careful about, supports.* Retire *will, must, cannot, never.*
7. **Give agency.** Every difficult observation ends with what the client can do. "This period is heavy for finances; it is also the best period in years for learning a new skill, that is where to put the energy."
8. **One difficult truth per session, wrapped in a plan.** People can carry one hard thing home. Two, and they drop both. If the chart has five hard things, choose the one that matters for the next two years and hold the rest for the follow-up.

WHY? This one is psychological, and the tradition agrees with it in spirit: Varahamihira asks the astrologer to be of steady mind and to speak so that the listener is not thrown. People can carry one hard thing home and act on it; a second cancels the first, and a third turns both into fear. Everyday parallel: a good teacher returns an essay with one thing to fix, not fifteen, because the student with fifteen corrections fixes none.

9. **Never blame a spouse, a mother-in-law, a business partner from the chart.** You are reading one person's map; the others are not in the room to answer.
10. **Do not diagnose, and do not promise.** "Your chart asks you to take care of digestion" is astrology. "You have an ulcer" is malpractice. "This coral will fix your career" is a lie; "this coral may support your Mars while you do the work" is the truth.

STORY: THE TWO HERALDS. *The old Judge (Saturn) issues one decree for a village: "The granary must be filled before the rains, or there will be hunger." Two heralds ride out with it. The first stands in the square and shouts, "Hunger is coming! You will starve!" The village panics, hoards, and quarrels; half the fields go unsown. The second herald reads the same decree and says, "The Judge asks you to fill the granary before the rains. Those who fill it will eat well through the winter." The village plants. Same Saturn, same decree, two futures, and only the herald differed.*

Rule: *A malefic is a test. Say what the test asks for, never what failure would look like.*

Twelve phrases to retire

Here are sentences I have heard beginners say, and said myself in my first year, with what I say now instead.

○ Don't say	● Say instead
"You will never have money."	"Money in your chart comes slowly and through discipline; the 2nd house asks you to save before you spend. Your 11th house improves steadily after 35."
"Your marriage will break."	"Your 7th house asks for patience and honest conversation, especially in Saturn's sub-periods. Couples with this placement do well when they learn to argue kindly."
"Your father will die in this period."	"This is a period to give your father extra care and attention, and to make sure his check-ups are regular."
"Your child is weak in studies."	"Your child's chart favours learning by doing rather than by rote. The 4th house suggests a practical or creative stream will suit better."
"Saturn is bad for you."	"Saturn is your teacher in this chart. He is slow, but everything he gives, he lets you keep."
"You have Kaal Sarp dosha, you must do a puja."	"Rahu and Ketu hold your planets in a tight band, which often gives a life of strong direction and some sense of being fated. It is not a curse, and no puja is compulsory."
"You will get the job in March."	"March to May is the strongest window I see for career movement. Apply hard then; if it comes in June, you were still on time."
"Your mother-in-law is the problem."	"Your 4th house is under some pressure right now. Home will feel crowded; it usually eases when Jupiter moves next year."
"Wear a blue sapphire, everything will be fine."	"I would not recommend a blue sapphire here: Saturn is not a friend to your Lagna. Let us look at conduct and daan first."
"You have a very bad chart."	"Your chart has three real strengths and two real tests. Let us name all five."
"Don't start anything this year."	"This year favours preparation over launch. Use it to build; launch in the window after."
"Astrology says you should leave him."	"That decision is yours alone. What I can tell you is what the chart suggests about timing and about your own needs, and you can weigh that with everything else you know."

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Softening the language so much that you say nothing. "Things may or may not improve at some point" is not hedging; it is cowardice. Give a real tendency and a real window, then hedge that. The client should leave knowing what you actually think.

Handling difficult moments

Every session has one. Here is what I have learned to do.

A client begins to cry. Stop talking. Offer water and a tissue; do not fill the silence. When they are ready, say, "Take your time. We have the hour." Do not use the tears as a cue to soften a prediction you have already made, and do not use them to add a remedy. When they resume, ask what touched them, it is often something you did not expect, and it tells you which house matters most today.

A client wants to know when they, or someone, will die. Refuse, warmly and completely. "I do not read longevity for clients, and I would not trust any astrologer who does. What I can do is tell you which periods ask for extra care of health, and that is more useful." If they push, and a bereaved or anxious client will push, hold the line and change the subject to care.

A parent asks about an unborn child's gender. Refuse, flatly, every time, and say why: it is illegal in India under the pre-natal diagnostic laws, and the tradition itself never sanctioned it. "I will happily read the pregnancy for health and timing. I will not touch gender." No exceptions, no hints, no "the chart leans towards".

A couple asks whether to end a pregnancy, or to separate. Refuse to decide for them, and say so with respect. "This is a decision for the two of you, perhaps with a doctor or counsellor. I can tell you what each chart suggests about the coming years, and you may use that as one input among many." Then give them the tendencies honestly and get out of the way.

"Another astrologer said..." Never contradict a colleague to score a point, and never agree to be polite. Say, "I can only tell you what I see. Here is my reading of that placement, and here is why." If the other reading planted fear, a curse, a "dosha", a costly puja, gently take the fear apart with the chart itself, in front of them.

A client who wants a stone. Ask what they want it for. Then check the rule (Chapter 23): a stone strengthens; it is only for a functional benefic that needs strength. If the chart justifies it, say so and name the alternative remedies too. If it does not, refuse and explain, and do not, ever, sell the stone yourself.

WHY? The reason for refusing to sell stones, or to take a cut, is ethical and very plain: the moment your income rises when the client is frightened, your reading will drift towards frightening them, without your noticing. The incentive corrupts the judgement before it corrupts the person. Everyday parallel: you would not trust a mechanic who is paid a commission by the spare-parts shop to tell you honestly whether the part needs changing.

A sceptic. Welcome them. Skip nothing, especially the confirmation step. Say, "Tell me when I am wrong." A sceptic who hears two accurate observations about their past becomes your most careful listener; a sceptic who is flattered stays a sceptic.

A client in crisis. Occasionally someone in the chair is not there for astrology. They have not slept in a week, they speak of not wanting to go on, they are shaking. Your reading stops. You say, "I am going to put the chart aside for a moment, because you matter more than it does." You stay with them, you make sure they are not alone tonight, and you give them the number of a mental-health helpline or a doctor. In India, national and state helplines exist and every practitioner should keep two numbers written on the inside cover of their notebook. Astrology waits. If they insist on the reading, keep it short, keep it kind, and say plainly that a counsellor will help more than any transit.

CONSULTATION TIP: Keep a small card in your drawer with three names on it: a general physician, a counsellor or psychiatrist, and a lawyer who does family and property work. When a client's problem belongs to one of them, hand over the card. Referring out is not a failure of astrology; it is the mark of someone who knows what astrology is for.

The ethics code

STORY: THE STRANGER'S SHOP. *The Smoke-headed Stranger (Rahu) opens a gem shop outside the court gate. He makes a quiet arrangement with a junior secretary: for every frightened petitioner sent across the road with the words "only a blue stone can save you," a silver coin. Within a season the secretary has stopped reading the maps at all; he reads faces, finds the fear, and names the stone. The Royal Priest (Jupiter) notices that the petitioners come back poorer and no happier, and has the secretary's desk moved into the courtyard, where everyone can hear what he says. The shop closes within a month. The Priest's only comment: "A counsellor who profits from a fear will always find one."*

Rule: No fear-selling, no gem commissions, and say your readings where they could be overheard.

Every profession that touches people's fears eventually writes itself a code. Ours has not been written down in any classic, so here is the one I wrote for myself in my first year and still keep on the wall. Adopt it, adapt it, print it and hang it where clients can read it. It is reproduced word for word in Appendix C.

1. **Confidentiality.** What is said in the room, and the chart itself, stays in the room: no sharing, no teaching examples with identifying details, no screenshots.
2. **Consent for third parties.** Read another adult's chart only with that person's consent; for a minor, only when a parent or guardian asks in the child's interest.
3. **No fear-selling.** Never frighten a client into a remedy, a return visit or a purchase. A prediction that leaves a person more afraid and less capable was badly delivered.
4. **Fees disclosed upfront,** in writing where possible, before the session begins; no surprise charges for "special" remedies.
5. **No gem commissions.** Recommend a stone only when the chart justifies it; never sell it yourself or take a cut from a seller.
6. **Stay inside your competence.** No medical diagnosis, no legal opinion, no investment advice. Astrology describes tendencies and timing; qualified professionals decide the rest.
7. **Refuse sex-determination** of an unborn child in every form, and refuse any remedy intended to harm another person.
8. **Keep records:** birth data as given, the time you used and why, what you said, what you predicted and by when.
9. **Admit errors.** When a prediction fails, say so, log it and learn from it; never rewrite history to protect your reputation.
10. **Keep learning.** Read the classics, sit with a teacher, meet peers. An astrologer who stopped learning ten years ago is practising ten-year-old mistakes.
11. **Do not read for a person who is intoxicated,** or for a minor without a guardian present; postpone a reading for someone in acute crisis until they are safe.
12. **Refer out.** When the matter belongs to a doctor, a lawyer, a counsellor or a financial planner, say so plainly and help the client get there.

DID YOU KNOW? Varahamihira, in the sixth century, listed the qualities of a good astrologer in *Brihat Samhita*: clean in habit, well versed in the texts, of steady mind, and, this is the part I love, "not given to boasting". The ethics of our trade are older than most of its techniques.

Fees and practice

Nobody teaches this either, and I got it wrong before I got it right, so let us be practical.

Setting a fee

Charge for time, not for miracles. A **time-based** fee, so much for a seventy-five-minute session, so much for a written report, is honest and easy to explain. Many practitioners use **tiers**: a shorter single-question session, a full reading, a couple's matching, an annual review. Keep a **sliding scale for hardship**, quietly; the student, the widow, the man who has just lost his job pay what they can or nothing, and you do not announce it. Publish your fees, and never, this is the ethics code again, let a fee depend on a remedy.

A fee is also a boundary. Clients who pay arrive on time, bring their birth details, and listen. The free reading for the neighbour's cousin is where most of my early mistakes happened, because neither of us took it seriously.

Free readings as practice

In your first months, read for free, but say so, and ask for something in return: written birth details, a completed events list, and honest feedback afterwards. "I am learning. This reading is free. In exchange, I would like you to tell me, in six months, what came true and what did not." That sentence taught me more in six months than the shelf of classics I had failed with.

Recording and the written report

Ask permission to record audio; many clients like to have it, and it protects both of you. Whether or not you record, send a **written summary within 48 hours**. Mine follows a fixed template (one page, two at most), and the discipline of writing it has caught more of my own errors than any client ever has.

The written report: one page, seven sections

KUNDALI READING: SUMMARY FOR _____

Date of reading ____ Birth data used: __/__/__, __:__(source: _____), place _____
Rectified? yes / no Ayanamsa: Lahiri Confidential: prepared only for the person named above

1. The picture in five lines

Lagna and lord · Moon sign and nakshatra · strongest planet · weakest planet · one-line temperament

2. Your questions, one by one

Question → houses involved → what the chart suggests (tendency) → what favours you → what to be careful about

3. Timing

Current Mahadasha / Antardasha and dates · the next two sub-periods · Saturn & Jupiter transits · Sade Sati status · windows, not dates

4. Strengths to lean on

Two or three placements that carry you, in plain words

5. Tests to prepare for

One difficult truth, wrapped in a plan, never a threat

6. Remedies (in order of importance)

Conduct → daan → mantra/fast → gemstone only if justified, with the reason and the alternative

7. What to watch and when to return

Three things you predicted, with the window, so we can check together · follow-up date · "I don't know" items

Astrology describes tendencies and timings; it is not medical, legal or financial advice. Decisions remain yours.

Two pages at most. If it cannot fit, it was not understood.

Figure 24.3: The report template. Section 7, "what to watch and when to return", is the one that turns a reading into a relationship. It is also your prediction log in the client's hands.

WHY? The written report exists because memory rewrites predictions. Six months later the client remembers "she said I would get the job in March" when you said "March to May favours applications", and you remember being more right than you were. A page written within 48 hours is the only record neither of you can edit. Everyday parallel: the prescription is written down because nobody, patient or doctor, remembers the dose correctly a week later.

Follow-ups and the prediction log

Offer a follow-up at six to twelve months, timed to the next dasha change or a major transit. Before the follow-up, open your notebook, the one Chapter 1 asked you to keep, and read what you predicted. Then ask the client what happened. Write both down, side by side. After a hundred such pairs you will know, with humbling precision, which of your techniques work and which are habits you copied from a book. I found two of my own habits that way, and dropped them. This is called calibration, and it is the only road from a good student to a trustworthy astrologer.

Social media

Do: teach, explain a placement, share a composite story with all details changed, show your working. Don't: post a client's chart, predict for public figures (you do not have their consent or their correct time), forecast disasters, or sell stones from your feed. If you make monthly or yearly forecasts, say plainly that a sign-based forecast is weather for a whole country and not a reading for one person.

When to say "I don't know"

Often, and out loud. "I don't know" followed by "here is what I would need to find out" is the most trust-building sentence in the consulting room. The client who hears you say it once believes everything else you say twice as much.

Continuing education

Read the classics, slowly, a verse a day of *Brihat Jataka* or *Phaladeepika* with a good commentary is enough (Appendix C has the list). Find a teacher whose charts you can watch being read; there is no substitute for sitting beside someone while they think aloud. I found mine late, and wish I had looked sooner. Join or form a peer group of three or four students who meet monthly and read one chart each, blind, then compare. Your errors will be different from theirs, and that is the point.

The law, hedged and general

In India, practising astrology is legal; the Supreme Court has treated it as a matter of belief and it is taught in some universities. What is not legal is fraud, and what is regulated is medicine: claiming to cure disease, selling "medicines", or making medical diagnoses can bring you under the drugs-and-remedies advertising laws and consumer-protection law. Sex-determination is a criminal offence. Consumer-protection rules also mean that a fee paid for a promised result, "your visa will come in three months, guaranteed", can be disputed. So: disclose fees, promise nothing, keep records, stay out of medicine and law, and you will never have a problem. I am not a lawyer, and this paragraph is not legal advice; a one-hour conversation with one before you open a practice is money well spent.

If you never take a consultation

Most readers of this book will never charge a rupee for a reading, and that is exactly who I wrote it for. Everything in this chapter still applies; only the chair is different.

Start with your own chart and run the fourteen-point list on it as if you were a stranger. Do the confirmation step honestly: pick three past events, find their dasha and transits, and see whether your birth time holds. Then read the general picture aloud, the three pillars and the strongest and weakest planet, and notice how much of it you already knew about yourself and how much you had never put into words. That noticing is the whole reward.

Then read for the people you love, with the same rules you would use for a paying client, and one more. The rules: ask before you read an adult's chart; speak in tendencies and windows; one hard thing at a time; never death, never blame. The extra rule: you are not their astrologer, you are their daughter, brother, wife or friend, and that relationship comes first. If the chart shows your mother a heavy Saturn period, the reading is "I want to sit with you more this year", not a forecast. If it shows your husband's Rahu sub-period, the reading is patience, not an accusation dressed as a transit.

Used this way, the method does something no consultation can: it lets you understand your own nature without paying anyone to tell you, and it lets you see what is happening with the people around you while it is happening, so that you can be kinder in time rather than wise afterwards. Keep the notebook for these readings too. Some of my best lessons came from being wrong about my own family.

The first 100 charts: a six-month plan

Reading a chart in a book and reading one across a table are different skills. This is the plan I followed, tidied up with hindsight, to build the second one without hurting anyone.

Weeks 1–4: friends and family, free, with consent. Ten to fifteen charts. Use the full fourteen-point preparation on every one, even when you know the person. Practise the opening script aloud. Ask for the events list and do the confirmation step even though you know the answers, you are training the habit, not testing the astrology. Log every prediction with a window.

Weeks 5–12: low-fee readings with feedback forms. Twenty to thirty charts, for a nominal fee that makes both sides take it seriously. Send the written report every time. Include a one-page feedback form: what was accurate about the past, what was useful, what was unclear, what you said that frightened them. Read the forms. The third one will sting; that is the one to keep.

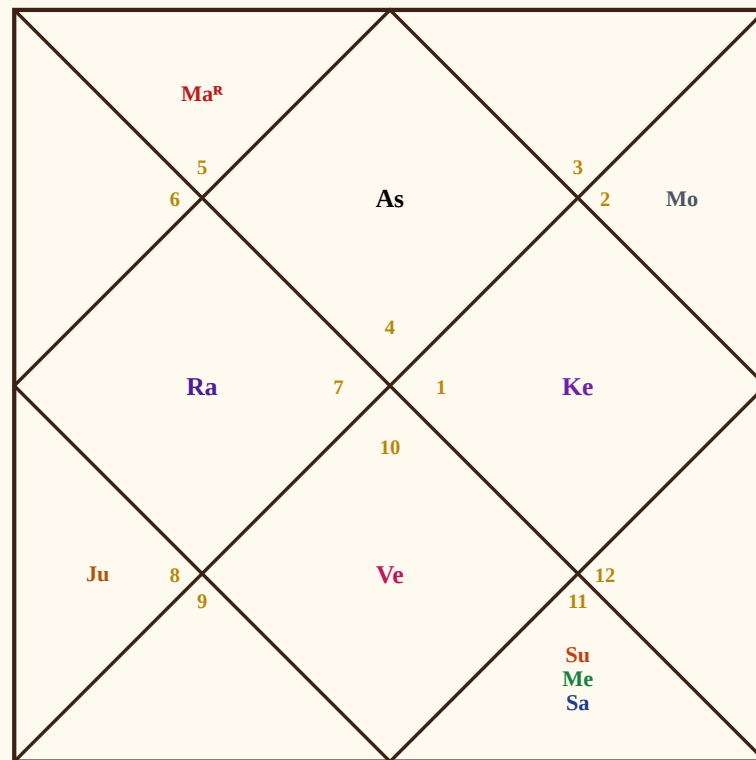
Months 4–6: specialise. Choose one area, career, marriage and matching, children and education, health windows, or annual reviews, and take forty to fifty charts in that area. Depth in one field teaches you more about the whole system than breadth ever will, because you see the same houses behave under a hundred different Lagnas. Keep the notebook. At chart 100, read the notebook from the beginning. You will meet a stranger on page one; I did.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: A hundred charts with a log beats a thousand without one. The log is the teacher; the charts are only the lessons.

A sample session: Arjun

Here is a condensed transcript of a seventy-five-minute session, reconstructed and simplified for teaching. The client is Arjun, Chart B, Cancer Lagna, born 3 March 1995 at about 20:15 in Pune, just after sunset. He is about to turn thirty-one. His intake form asked two things: "Should I move into a research career abroad or stay in my current job?" and "When will I marry?" Under "previous consultations" he wrote: "One, in 2021. Was told I have Kaal Sarp dosha and should do a puja costing 21,000 rupees. Did not do it. Have been worried since." The session takes place in February 2026: Rahu Mahadasha, Venus Antardasha; Saturn in Pisces; Jupiter in Gemini, about to enter Cancer in the middle of the year.

Chart B (Arjun): the chart on the desk



Cancer Lagna; Sun, Mercury and Saturn in the 8th; Moon in the 11th

Figure 24.4: The chart on the desk. Three planets in the 8th (Aquarius), the Moon exalted in the 11th (Taurus), Jupiter in the 5th (Scorpio), Venus in the 7th (Capricorn), Mars retrograde in the 2nd (Leo), Rahu in the 4th, Ketu in the 10th.

Anushka: Arjun, welcome. Before we start: everything we discuss stays in this room. I will describe what your chart suggests, as tendencies and time windows, and I will tell you where I am unsure. You will make the decisions; I am here so that you make them with your eyes open. If I say something that is not true of your life, please tell me at once. It helps me. Your two questions are the research move and marriage, is that still right?

Arjun: Yes. And the dosha thing, Didi. I want to know if it is real.

Anushka: We will get to it, and I will show you on the chart. First I want to check the birth time against your life, because everything I say depends on it. Your form says about eight in the evening: 20:15, from your mother's memory. Twenty-five minutes earlier and you would be a Gemini rising, a different person, so I have three things to test. One: your chart suggests a change of direction, finishing studies and starting work, around 2017 or 2018. Does that fit?

Arjun: Exactly. I finished my master's in 2017 and joined the company in early 2018.

Anushka: Good. Two: it suggests that late 2021 through 2024 felt stuck, not disaster, but doors that did not open, a sense of being in a waiting room.

Arjun: (laughs) That is the reason I am here. Since about the start of 2022.

Anushka: Three, and this is a softer one: your Lagna is Cancer. People with this rising sign tend to have a rounder face, a strong emotional memory, they remember how a room felt, not what was said, and a deep tie to their mother and to home. Is that you?

Arjun: My friends say I remember every slight from school. And yes, my mother.

Anushka: Then 20:15 is good enough for us to proceed, a Gemini Lagna would not have made 2022 feel like a waiting room; the three planets in your 8th house would have been in the 9th, and Saturn's transit over them would have read as travel and study. If anything I say later feels off, the time is the first thing we revisit. Now, the general picture, in four sentences. You are a Cancer rising, protective, cautious on the outside, very feeling on the inside. Your Moon, which is the mind, is in Taurus in the 11th house, where it is exalted: a stable, stubborn, loyal mind, good with people and networks. Your strongest planet is that Moon, and after it Mars, who for a Cancer Lagna is the planet that gives success, he sits in your 2nd house, in Leo, retrograde: your drive turns inward, you rework things, you are better at deep effort than at showing off. Your weakest area is the cluster in the 8th house, Sun, Mercury and Saturn together in Aquarius, with Saturn very close to the Sun and therefore weakened. The 8th is the house of research, insurance, hidden things, sudden change, and also of feeling that life happens to you rather than through you. Does that description sit right?

Arjun: The inward part, yes. I work in a data team at an insurance firm. Nobody knows what I do, including my manager.

Anushka: Insurance and data, that is the 8th house speaking, and Mercury in it is your analytical mind working in hidden places. Let us take your first question. Research career abroad, or stay. Three houses matter: the 9th for higher learning and long journeys, the 12th for living in foreign lands, and the 10th for career itself. Your 9th house is Pisces, and its lord Jupiter sits in your 5th house, in Scorpio, a fortunate place for him, in a friend's sign. That says higher study suits you and would go well. Your 10th house holds Ketu, the planet of detachment, which is why titles and visibility do not satisfy you; you want the work itself to mean something. And your 12th lord, Mercury, sits in the 8th with the Sun: foreign lands connect to research and to hidden, technical work. So the tendency is clear: your chart favours research, and it favours doing it somewhere else. That is not the same as saying "go". It says the door is a real door.

Arjun: When?

Anushka: Timing. You have been in Rahu's major period since late 2013, Rahu is the planet of foreigners and of technology, and he runs until the end of 2031. The sub-period that made 2022 to 2024 heavy was Mercury's, and Saturn was also transiting your 8th house then, sitting on top of that cluster. Both have passed. Since mid-2025 you are in Rahu–Venus, which runs to mid-2028; Venus sits in your 7th house, so this is a period of partnerships, relationships, and gains through others. Now the transits. Saturn entered Pisces, your 9th house, in 2025 and stays until about 2027; Jupiter enters Cancer, your own Lagna, in the middle of this year and from there he aspects the 9th house where Saturn is standing. When Saturn and Jupiter both touch a house, that house tends to deliver, that is the double-transit rule. So the window for applications, admissions and a decision about abroad is roughly mid-2026 to mid-2027. The move itself, if it comes, leans towards 2027–28, when Saturn moves to Aries and aspects your 12th house. I would not promise the move; I would say this is the best two-year window your chart has shown in a decade, and you should use it.

Arjun: And if I stay?

Anushka: Then use the same window to change *how* you work, a research role inside the firm, a part-time degree. The chart favours the direction more than the geography. Now, marriage. Your 7th house is Capricorn, and its lord Saturn is in the 8th, weakened by the Sun. That is why marriage has not been quick: Saturn delays, and he is not at his best here. But Venus, the planet of marriage, sits in your 7th house itself, in a friendly sign, and you are in Venus's sub-period right now. Jupiter, entering Cancer this year, will aspect your 7th house and Saturn. So the tendency is that late 2026 through 2028 is your marriage window, with the second half of 2026 to 2027 the first serious opening. I am giving you a window, not a date. If someone asks you a question at a wedding in December, listen.

Arjun: My mother will be pleased. Now, Anushka, the dosha.

Anushka: Look at the chart. Rahu is in your 4th house, Ketu in your 10th. For the so-called Kaal Sarp pattern, all the other planets would have to sit on one side of that axis. Yours do not, your Moon in the 11th and your Mars in the 2nd sit on the other side. So the pattern is not even formed. And even where it is formed, it is not in the classical texts; it is a popular teaching, and it

describes a strongly directed life, not a curse. Nobody needs to pay twenty-one thousand rupees to be released from something they do not have. I would like you to leave that fear on this table.

Arjun: (*quiet*) Thank you.

Anushka: There is one real thing to say about Mars, since we are being honest. Mars sits in your 2nd house, and from the Moon and from Venus he is also in sensitive places, what the tradition calls Kuja or Mangal dosha. Here is the whole truth: technically it is present; practically, Mars is the best planet for your Lagna, in a friend's sign, and the tradition lists many cancellations. What it asks of you is a partner with comparable energy and a marriage where you learn to disagree without wounding. When a match is proposed, have the two charts read together, not for a verdict, but for understanding. Do not let anyone use the word dosha to frighten you or your family.

Remedies, in order. First, conduct: you have three planets in the 8th; the 8th rewards depth and honesty and punishes shortcuts, so no quick fixes, in work or in love. Second, for Rahu's period, a Saturday practice, a coconut or a blanket to someone who needs it, once a month, and a real discipline about screens after ten at night; Rahu lives in our phones now. Third, Jupiter is your 9th lord and he will carry the abroad question, respect your teachers, and on Thursdays give something yellow, chana dal or turmeric, to a temple or a person. Fourth, and only if you want it: red coral for Mars, your success-giving planet. It is justified in your chart, and it is the only stone I would consider. Not a blue sapphire, Saturn is not a friend to your Lagna, whatever anyone online says. And I am not selling the coral; buy it from whoever you trust.

To close. Three things: your chart favours research and favours abroad, with mid-2026 to mid-2027 as the decision window. Marriage leans towards late 2026 to 2028, with Venus's sub-period running now. And you have no Kaal Sarp dosha. I will send the written summary in two days. Come back in about a year, around the time Jupiter moves into Leo, and we will see what came true; I will have it written down, and so will you.

Notice what I did *not* do: predict a date, diagnose the 8th-house cluster as illness, tell him to resign, or mention that Saturn in the 8th is classically linked to longevity. Notice what I did: confirmed the time, described before predicting, answered in the client's order, gave windows, dismantled a fear with the chart, told one hard truth (Mars) wrapped in a plan, and closed with three sentences and a follow-up.

The Consultation Checklist (print this page)

The fourteen preparation points and the twelve-point code, one page, identical to the version in Appendix C. Tick the preparation list for every chart; hang the code where the client can see it.

Preparation, before the client arrives

1. **Lagna:** sign, degree and lord; the lord's sign, house and dignity.
2. **Moon:** sign, nakshatra and pada, waxing or waning, and strength (own, exalted or debilitated; alone or supported).
3. **Sun:** sign, house and dignity; then check combustion for every planet within orb of it.
4. **Functional benefics and malefics for this Lagna** (Chapter 8, Appendix A.6); mark the yogakaraka and the marakas.
5. **Planets in kendras (1, 4, 7, 10), trikonas (5, 9) and dusthanas (6, 8, 12).**
6. **Exalted, debilitated, combust and retrograde planets;** any Neecha Bhanga.
7. **Yogas present,** and whether the planets forming them are strong enough to deliver.
8. **The seven key houses (1, 2, 4, 5, 7, 10, 11),** read by the five-step method (the house, its lord, the karaka, the same house from the Moon, the divisional chart).

9. **Navamsa (D9) and Dasamsa (D10) quick read:** varga Lagnas, Vargottama planets, and the D9/D10 dignity of the Lagna lord, the 7th lord and the 10th lord.
10. **Current Mahadasha and Antardasha with dates,** and the next two sub-periods.
11. **Saturn and Jupiter transit positions** counted from the Lagna and from the Moon; Sade Sati or Dhaiya status; where the double transit falls.
12. **The client's stated questions,** each mapped to its houses, lord, karaka and the periods that activate them.
13. **Remedies shortlist:** conduct first, then daan and mantra; a gemstone only if a functional benefic needs strength.
14. **Three past events or traits you will ask the client to confirm** before you predict anything.

The code, on the wall

1. **Confidentiality.** What is said in the room, and the chart itself, stays in the room: no sharing, no teaching examples with identifying details, no screenshots.
2. **Consent for third parties.** Read another adult's chart only with that person's consent; for a minor, only when a parent or guardian asks in the child's interest.
3. **No fear-selling.** Never frighten a client into a remedy, a return visit or a purchase. A prediction that leaves a person more afraid and less capable was badly delivered.
4. **Fees disclosed upfront,** in writing where possible, before the session begins; no surprise charges for "special" remedies.
5. **No gem commissions.** Recommend a stone only when the chart justifies it; never sell it yourself or take a cut from a seller.
6. **Stay inside your competence.** No medical diagnosis, no legal opinion, no investment advice. Astrology describes tendencies and timing; qualified professionals decide the rest.
7. **Refuse sex-determination** of an unborn child in every form, and refuse any remedy intended to harm another person.
8. **Keep records:** birth data as given, the time you used and why, what you said, what you predicted and by when.
9. **Admit errors.** When a prediction fails, say so, log it and learn from it; never rewrite history to protect your reputation.
10. **Keep learning.** Read the classics, sit with a teacher, meet peers. An astrologer who stopped learning ten years ago is practising ten-year-old mistakes.
11. **Do not read for a person who is intoxicated,** or for a minor without a guardian present; postpone a reading for someone in acute crisis until they are safe.
12. **Refer out.** When the matter belongs to a doctor, a lawyer, a counsellor or a financial planner, say so plainly and help the client get there.

In one breath

- You are a counsellor with a map, not an oracle; the client's dignity and the client's decisions come first.
- The session begins with the intake form: exact time *and its source*, the questions in their words, and a dated events list for rectification and confirmation.
- Rectify by testing candidate Lagnas against three or four dated events, with the D9 and D10 Lagnas as tie-breakers; record the time you chose and say it is an approximation.
- Prepare for 60–90 minutes with the fourteen-point checklist, and always finish with three past events to confirm.
- The order never changes: open and set expectations, confirm the time, the general picture in five minutes, their questions, timing, remedies, a written summary within 48 hours.
- Speak in tendencies and windows; never death, never "you will divorce", never blame a third party, never diagnose, never promise a remedy will fix anything; one hard truth per session, wrapped in a plan.
- Adopt the twelve-point code: confidentiality, consent, no fear-selling, fees upfront, no gem commissions, stay in your competence, refuse sex-determination, keep records, admit errors, keep learning, protect the vulnerable, refer out.

- A hundred charts with a prediction log will make you an astrologer; a thousand without one will make you a performer.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. A client writes on the intake form: "Born 1990, morning, in Lucknow. Grandmother remembers it was just after the milkman came." Write the three follow-up questions you would ask before casting any chart.
2. Rewrite each of these in the language of the ten rules: (a) "Your Saturn dasha will destroy your business." (b) "You will have a son in 2027." (c) "Your husband's chart is the reason you are unhappy."
3. A client asks, "Just tell me, will my father survive this illness?" Write your reply in full, in no more than four sentences.
4. From the sample session, list the three confirmation points the astrologer used and say which house or dasha each came from.
5. Design your own one-page feedback form for the "weeks 5–12" stage of the first-100-charts plan. It should have no more than six questions.

Answers

1. Examples: "Roughly what time did the milkman come to your grandmother's house, before or after sunrise? Before or after the morning tea?" "Was it already light outside when the baby arrived?" "Is there any document, a hospital slip, a horoscope made at the time, a school certificate with a time, anywhere in the family?" (Any three questions that narrow the window to about two hours and search for a written source.) 2. (a) "Saturn's period will test your business, it favours consolidation over expansion, and it rewards the ones who keep their costs and their word. Plan for slower growth, not for failure." (b) "Your 5th house is well supported in 2027, which favours a child in that window; the chart does not reliably show a child's sex, and I do not read for it." (c) "Your own 7th house is under pressure just now, and it asks for patience and honest conversation. I can only read your map; the reasons for unhappiness in a marriage are never in one chart alone." 3. Something like: "I do not read for longevity, for anyone, and I would not trust an astrologer who did. What your chart does show is that this is a period to give your father your presence and to make sure his medical care is steady and regular. Let us look at what the coming months ask of *you*, so that you can be strong for him. And please lean on his doctors for the medical questions; that is their map, not mine." 4. (i) The 2017–18 change from study to work, Rahu–Jupiter antardasha (Jupiter 9th lord in the 5th). (ii) The stuck feeling from 2022 to 2024, Rahu–Mercury antardasha (Mercury 12th lord in the 8th) plus Saturn's transit through the 8th house (Aquarius). (iii) The Cancer Lagna personality test, rounder face, emotional memory, attachment to mother and home. 5. Your own design. Good forms include: what I said about your past that was accurate; what was not; the most useful thing you heard; anything unclear; anything that frightened you; would you recommend me and why or why not.

Chapter 25: Three Complete Readings: Meera, Arjun and Devika

We have walked through the alphabet, the grammar and the manners. Now we read three whole charts from the first line of birth data to the last line of advice, in exactly the order I use at my own desk. You have met all three people before: Meera in almost every chapter, Arjun in the consultation you just watched, Devika in the health and children chapters, so nothing here should surprise you. What is new is seeing the *whole* done in one sitting, with nothing skipped and nothing hidden.

I follow the same eleven steps for each. That is deliberate. The steps are the point; the three lives are only the material. By the third reading you should be able to predict what I am going to look at next, and by the end of the chapter you should be able to do it yourself on a fourth chart, alone.

Two housekeeping notes. First, every position, nakshatra, Navamsa placement and dasha date below was computed, not copied, and cross-checked against Appendix A; the arithmetic is shown where it teaches something. Second, transit positions for 2026–2029 are approximate, Saturn in Pisces from 2025 until about mid-2027 and then Aries (with a brief return to Pisces late in 2027); Jupiter in Gemini until mid-2026, Cancer to mid-2027, Leo to mid-2028, Virgo to mid-2029. Check an ephemeris before you quote them to a client.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: Read the chart the same way every time. Method is what protects you on the day your intuition is tired.

DID YOU KNOW? The Sun's house is a clock you can read at a glance, and it is the fastest check on a birth time. The Sun in the 1st house means a birth around sunrise (Meera, 06:40); in the 10th, around noon; in the 7th, around sunset; in the 4th, around midnight (Devika, 23:55). Arjun's Sun in the 8th (one house past the 7th) says "shortly after sunset", which is exactly his 20:15. If a client's stated time puts the Sun in the 10th house at nine in the evening, something is wrong before you have read a single planet.

Reading one: Meera (Chart A)

1. Birth data, the chart, and the planetary table

Born 12 December 1988, 06:40, Jaipur (constructed). Lagna Scorpio 12°, in Anuradha nakshatra, pada 3. The Sun rose about half an hour after her birth, so the Sun sits at the very end of the 1st house, a dawn birth, which fits a Sun-in-Lagna personality.

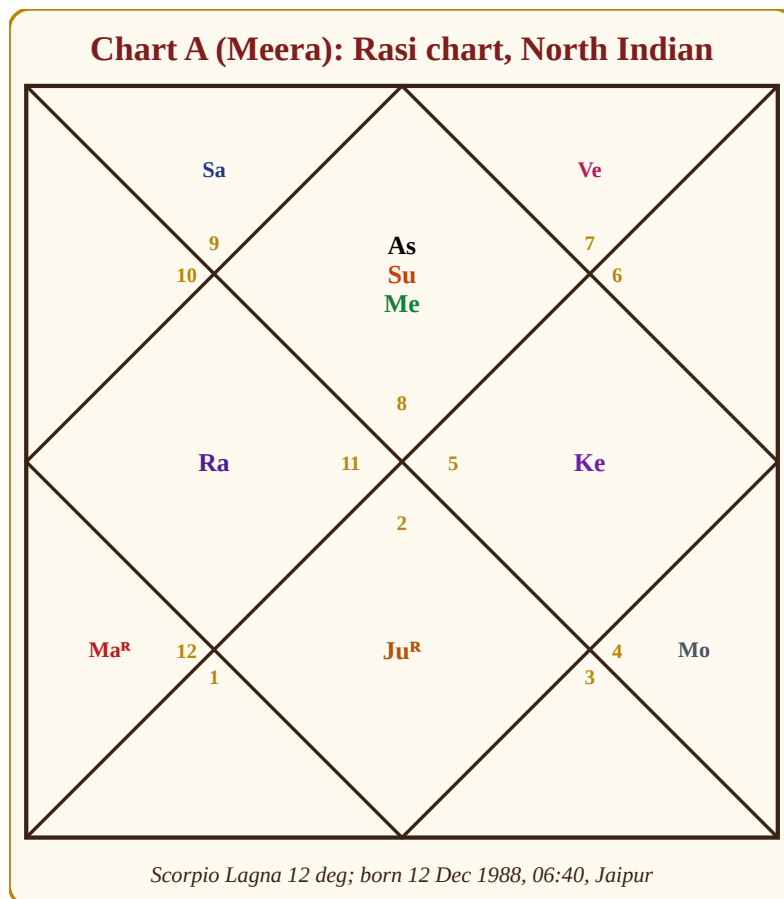


Figure 25.1: Chart A, North Indian style. Sun and Mercury in the Lagna (Scorpio), Saturn in the 2nd, Rahu in the 4th, Mars retrograde in the 5th, Jupiter retrograde in the 7th, Moon in the 9th, Ketu in the 10th, Venus in the 12th.

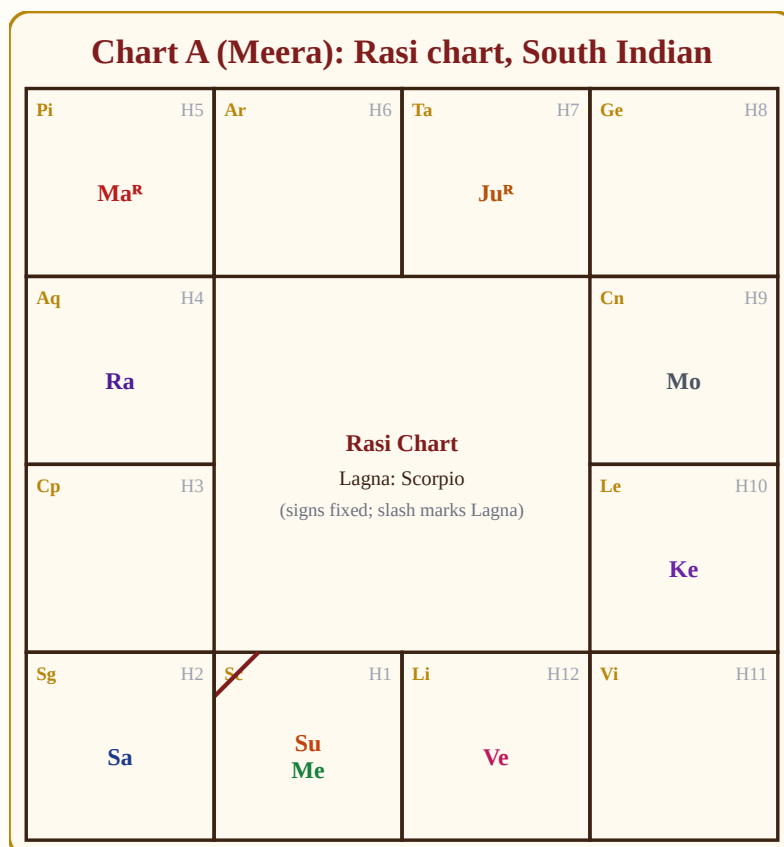


Figure 25.2: The same chart in the South Indian grid. Find the Lagna mark in Scorpio and count clockwise.

The table is the spine of the reading. Absolute longitude = (sign number – 1) × 30 + degree; nakshatra = that longitude divided by 13°20', pada by 3°20'. Dignity follows Appendix A.2 (own, exaltation, debilitation) and A.3 (friend, neutral, enemy by the sign lord). Combustion uses the A.2 orbs measured from the Sun at 28° Scorpio (238°).

Planet	Sign	Degree	House	Nakshatra, pada (lord)	Dignity (● good ● neutral ○ difficult)	Notes
Sun	Scorpio	28°	1	Jyeshtha 4 (Mercury)	● Friend's sign (Mars)	10th lord in the Lagna; last 2° of the sign, in the Jyeshtha gandanta zone
Moon	Cancer	21°	9	Ashlesha 2 (Mercury)	● Own sign	Five days past full, still bright, counted benefic by most teachers
Mars	Pisces	4°	5	Uttara Bhadrpada 1 (Saturn)	● Friend's sign (Jupiter)	Retrograde; Lagna lord in a trikona
Mercury	Scorpio	9°	1	Anuradha 2 (Saturn)	● Neutral (Mars)	19° from the Sun, not combust (orb 14°)
Jupiter	Taurus	8°	7	Krittika 4 (Sun)	○ Enemy's sign (Venus, per A.3)	Retrograde; 2nd and 5th lord in a kendra
Venus	Libra	22°	12	Vishakha 1 (Jupiter)	● Own sign	12th lord in the 12th
Saturn	Sagittarius	5°	2	Mula 2 (Ketu)	● Neutral (Jupiter)	7° from the Sun, combust (orb 15°)
Rahu	Aquarius	16°	4	Shatabhisha 3 (Rahu)	(none)	In its own nakshatra
Ketu	Leo	16°	10	Purva Phalguni 1 (Venus)	(none)	

Two things in this table are easy to miss and matter. Saturn is combust, only seven degrees from the Sun across the sign boundary. A combust 2nd lord-in-residence (Saturn sits in the 2nd but rules the 3rd and 4th) weakens what Saturn carries here: her savings discipline and her mother's house both need conscious care. And Jupiter sits in Venus's sign, which Appendix A.3 marks as an enemy for Jupiter; many teachers soften this to "neutral" because Jupiter is a great benefic, but I keep the table's word and let his kendra position and retrogression (which many say adds strength) balance it.

The dispositor chain (Chapter 9) runs Sun → Mars → Jupiter → Venus, and Venus in her own sign closes the chain; Mercury, Saturn, Rahu and Ketu also end at Venus. Only the Moon stands alone, in her own sign. So two planets hold the whole chart up: Venus in the 12th, and the Moon in the 9th. Remember that when we come to remedies.

2. First impression: the three pillars

Lagna. Scorpio rising at 12°, with the Sun and Mercury in the sign: a fixed water sign, intense, private, and (with the Sun there) dignified, visible, a natural authority in a room. The Lagna lord Mars is in the 5th in Pisces, retrograde: her drive goes into ideas, students, and reworking things until they are right. Scorpio Lagna people carry their wounds quietly and their loyalties for life.

Moon. Cancer, own sign, 9th house, Ashlesha. An emotional, retentive mind that finds its peace in learning, teaching and faith. Ashlesha adds shrewdness and a tendency to hold on. Strong, bright, alone in its sign, the second pillar of the chart.

Sun. Own-lordship of the 10th, sitting in the Lagna in a friend's sign: career and self are the same thing for Meera. She is what she does. The Sun at 28° is at the very edge of Scorpio, in the gandanta zone of Jyeshtha; I read that as a life that had to cross a threshold early (a change of home or of father's fortunes in childhood) and I would ask about it.

3. Functional benefics and malefics for Scorpio

From Appendix A.6:

● Functional benefics	○ Functional malefics	● Neutral	Yogakaraka	Marakas
Jupiter, Moon, Sun, Mars	Mercury, Venus, Saturn	(none)	Sun + Moon together	Venus, Mercury

Applied here: all four benefics are reasonably placed, Sun in the Lagna, Moon in own sign in the 9th, Mars in a friend's sign in the 5th, Jupiter in a kendra though in an uncomfortable sign. The three malefics are each in a place that limits their harm: Mercury with the benefic Sun in the Lagna (a Budha-Aditya that lends intellect), Venus in her own sign in the 12th (a malefic in a dusthana, she pays her own bills), Saturn combust in the 2nd (weakened, so his malefic bite is dulled, but so is his gift of discipline). This is a chart whose green lights are on and whose red lights are dimmed. That is a fortunate pattern, and it explains why Meera's life has been steady rather than dramatic.

4. House by house

Each house: the house and its occupants, the lord and where it sits, the karaka, the same house from the Moon, and the varga where it matters (Chapter 9). After each verdict I give the reason, so you can see the chain and not just the conclusion.

1st (Scorpio), self. Sun and Mercury here; lord Mars in the 5th; karaka Sun in the house itself; from the Moon, Cancer with the Moon. A strong, articulate, self-directed person, because the karaka of the body sits in the body's house and the Lagna lord is in a trikona. Heat and acidity are the health note, because Mars and the Sun are both fiery.

2nd (Sagittarius), wealth, speech, family. Saturn, combust; lord Jupiter retrograde in the 7th; karaka Jupiter; from the Moon, Leo with Ketu. Money slow and earned, because the planet of delay sits in the house of savings and its lord is weakened by an enemy's sign; careful speech, because the 2nd is also the mouth and Saturn restrains.

3rd (Capricorn), courage, siblings, effort. Empty; lord Saturn combust in the 2nd; karaka Mars retrograde in the 5th; from the Moon, Virgo, lord Mercury in the Lagna. Effort is mental rather than physical, because the karaka of courage sits in the house of ideas; a sibling bond that asked for patience, because a combust Saturn rules it.

4th (Aquarius), mother, home, education. Rahu; lord Saturn combust in the 2nd; karaka Moon strong in the 9th; from the Moon, Libra with Venus in own sign. Mixed: Rahu (restlessness, the foreign) in the house of home and a weakened lord say home and mother need attention; the strong karaka and the strong 4th from the Moon say both are protected. Two of the five steps are weak and three are strong, so read the majority.

5th (Pisces), intelligence, children, students. Mars retrograde, the Lagna lord; lord Jupiter in the 7th; karaka Jupiter; from the Moon, Scorpio with Sun and Mercury. A teacher's 5th, because the Lagna lord (the self) sits in the house of students and ideas and the intellect pair sits in the 5th from the mind. Children later than expected, because the karaka is in an enemy's sign and the occupant is retrograde (reworking).

6th (Aries), service, debts, illness. Empty; lord Mars in the 5th; karakas Mars and Saturn; from the Moon, Sagittarius with Saturn. Hard work that turns into teaching, because the lord of service sits in the house of students; minor chronic complaints of Saturn's kind (joints, fatigue), because Saturn sits in the 6th from the Moon.

7th (Taurus), marriage, partnerships, business. Jupiter retrograde; lord Venus own-sign in the 12th; karaka Venus; from the Moon, Capricorn, lord Saturn combust. A learned, decent spouse, because the great benefic occupies the house; a partner met away from home and a private marriage, because the 7th lord sits in the 12th (foreign lands, retreat). Marriage in 2016 in Venus–Rahu fits: the 7th lord's own sub-period, with Rahu sitting in the 4th, the house of settling. The 7th is also the 10th from the 10th, so business partnerships suit her.

8th (Gemini), transformation, inheritance, research. Empty; lord Mercury in the Lagna with the Sun; karaka Saturn; from the Moon, Aquarius with Rahu. A researcher's 8th, because the lord of hidden things sits in the house of self beside the intellect. Sudden events arrive through documents and words (Mercury), not the body.

9th (Cancer), fortune, father, guru, higher learning. The Moon in her own sign, herself the lord; karakas Jupiter and Sun; from the Moon, Pisces with Mars. The best house in the chart, because a lord in its own house in a trikona has nothing pulling against it: grace, a guide at the right time, a steady father, easy higher education.

10th (Leo), career. Ketu; lord Sun in the Lagna; karakas Sun, Mercury, Jupiter, Saturn; from the Moon, Aries, lord Mars in the 5th. Work is identity, because the career lord sits in the house of self; no attachment to titles, because Ketu, the headless sadhu of detachment, sits in the house of status; teaching and consulting, because the 10th lord sits with Mercury (speech) and the lord of the 10th from the Moon sits in the 5th (students).

11th (Virgo), gains, networks, elder siblings. Empty; lord Mercury in the Lagna; karaka Jupiter; from the Moon, Taurus with Jupiter. Income through words and knowledge, because the gains lord is Mercury in the 1st; learned friends, because Jupiter sits in the 11th from the mind.

12th (Libra), expenses, foreign lands, solitude, release. Venus in own sign, the lord in its own house; karaka Saturn; from the Moon, Gemini, empty. Comfortable spending, a love of retreat, foreign travel that feels like home, because the minister of beauty owns the house of expenses and solitude and is at home there. This is the Vimala pattern, weighed below.

5. Yogas present, honestly weighed

- **Budha-Aditya** in the Lagna: Sun and Mercury together, Mercury not combust. Strong; it gives her articulacy and a mind that organises. This is her most visible yoga.
- **Raja yoga by mutual aspect:** the Sun (10th lord, a kendra) and Jupiter (5th lord, a trikona) aspect each other across the 1st–7th axis. Real, and moderate, Jupiter is in an enemy's sign and retrograde, so the rise is steady rather than sudden.
- **Gaja Kesari:** *not* present. Jupiter in Taurus is the 11th from the Moon in Cancer, not a kendra. Beginners assume every Jupiter-in-a-kendra chart has it; check from the Moon.
- **Lakshmi yoga, modest form:** the 9th lord (Moon) strong in her own sign, the Lagna lord Mars in a friend's sign and a trikona. Present but not textbook (the 9th lord is in a trikona, not a kendra, and Mars is retrograde). It shows as grace rather than wealth.
- **Vimala (Viparita) flavour:** the 12th lord Venus in the 12th. Strictly, Vimala needs the 12th lord in the 6th, 8th or 12th; the 12th itself qualifies for many teachers, and since Venus is alone and in her own sign, I count it. Expenses turn into assets, travel that becomes work, solitude that becomes study.

WHY? The Viparita logic is a derivation from the system's own grammar. The 6th, 8th and 12th are the houses of loss; a lord of loss sitting in a house of loss spends its power on losing *the loss itself*, so the person loses expenses, loses enemies, loses hidden fear. Everyday parallel: a debt that the bank writes off is money in your hand.

- **Kemadruma, cancelled:** no planet in the 2nd (Leo has only Ketu, which does not count) or the 12th (Gemini) from the Moon, the pattern forms, but Venus in a kendra from the Moon (Libra, 4th from Cancer) and Jupiter in a kendra from the Lagna cancel it (Chapter 10). She has felt lonely at times; she has never been without support.
- **Kuja dosha:** none. Mars is in the 5th from the Lagna, the 9th from the Moon, the 6th from Venus. Her marriage was never under that particular cloud.
- **Saturn in the 2nd, combust; Rahu–Ketu on the 4th–10th axis; Mars retrograde in the 5th.** Not yogas, but patterns: money by patience, a life pulled between home and work, and a teaching mind that revises.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER'S EMPTY NEIGHBOURS. *The Queen Mother (Moon) sits in the ninth room in her own colours, strong, serene. But look either side of her: the eighth room (Gemini) is empty, and in the tenth (Leo) there is only the Headless Sadhu (Ketu), who does not count as company. That is Kemadruma, the loneliness of a queen with no attendants. Then look across the courtyard: the Minister of Pleasure (Venus) sits in the fourth room from her, in a kendra, in her own silks, and the Royal Priest (Jupiter) sits in a kendra from the front door. A queen with a minister across the hall is not alone. She is only quiet.*

Rule: *Kemadruma forms when the 2nd and 12th from the Moon are empty; a planet in a kendra from the Moon or the Lagna cancels it.*

6. Navamsa (D9) quick read

Using the A.10 rule, movable signs count from themselves, fixed from the 9th, dual from the 5th; each part is 3°20', the Navamsa positions are:

Planet	D1	D9 sign	D9 house	Comment
Lagna	Scorpio 12° (fixed → count from Cancer; 4th part)	Libra	1	
Sun	Scorpio 28°	Pisces	6	● Friend's sign
Moon	Cancer 21°	Capricorn	4	● Neutral; a kendra of the D9
Mars	Pisces 4° (dual → from Cancer; 2nd part)	Leo	11	● Friend's sign
Mercury	Scorpio 9°	Virgo	12	● Own and exalted sign
Jupiter	Taurus 8°	Pisces	6	● Own sign
Venus	Libra 22°	Aries	7	● Neutral; the D9 7th house
Saturn	Sagittarius 5°	Taurus	8	● Friend's sign
Rahu	Aquarius 16°	Aquarius	5	● Vargottama
Ketu	Leo 16°	Leo	11	● Vargottama

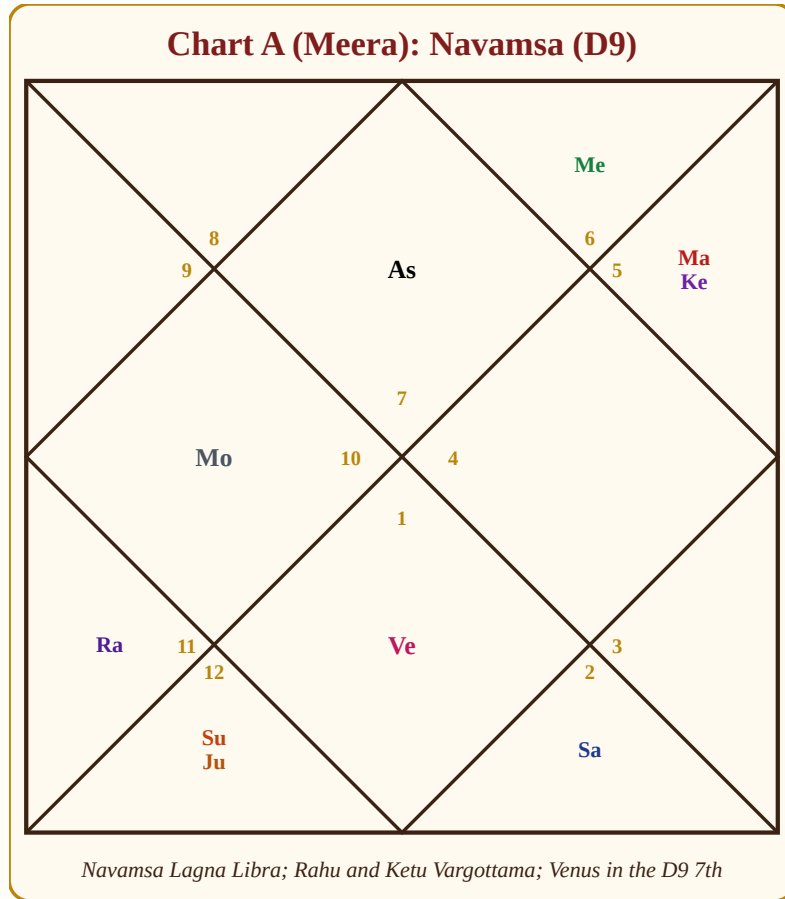


Figure 25.3: Meera's Navamsa. Jupiter comes home to Pisces and Mercury to Virgo: two planets that looked ordinary in the Rasi chart are inwardly strong.

What the D9 adds: Jupiter, awkward in Taurus in D1, sits in his own sign in D9, his promises about marriage and children are kept. Mercury, merely neutral in D1, is exalted in D9, her intellect is deeper than it shows. Venus in the D9 7th confirms marriage as a central theme. Rahu and Ketu Vargottama make the home-career pull a lifelong, not passing, theme. No planet is debilitated in either chart.

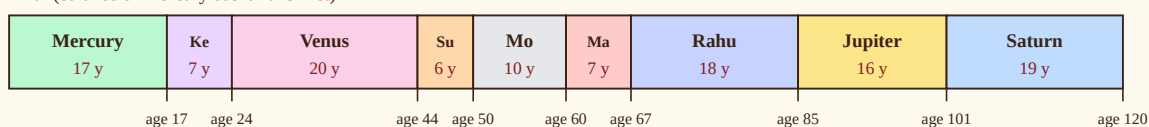
7. Dasha timeline

The Moon at 21° Cancer is in Ashlesha, Mercury's star. Balance of Mercury at birth = $(30^\circ - 21^\circ) \div 13^\circ 20' \times 17 \text{ years} = 11.475$ years. Computed from 12 December 1988:

Mahadasha	From	To	Age
Mercury (balance)	birth	Jun 2000	0–11½
Ketu	Jun 2000	Jun 2007	11½–18½
Venus	Jun 2007	Jun 2027	18½–38½
Sun	Jun 2027	Jun 2033	38½–44½
Moon	Jun 2033	Jun 2043	44½–54½
Mars	Jun 2043	Jun 2050	54½–61½
Rahu	Jun 2050	May 2068	61½–79½

Chart A (Meera): Vimshottari order from Mercury

Birth (balance of Mercury dasha runs first)



Order never changes: Ketu → Venus → Sun → Moon → Mars → Rahu → Jupiter → Saturn → Mercury → (Ketu again)

Mercury balance 11.475 y at birth: Ketu Jun 2000, Venus Jun 2007, Sun Jun 2027, Moon Jun 2033, Mars 2043, Rahu 2050

Figure 25.4: The order from Mercury. The first block runs only its 11½-year balance; every later block is full length.

Venus's sub-periods (Venus years × sub-lord years ÷ 120): Venus–Venus Jun 2007–Oct 2010; Venus–Sun to Oct 2011; Venus–Moon to Jun 2013; Venus–Mars to Aug 2014; **Venus–Rahu Aug 2014–Jul 2017**; Venus–Jupiter to Mar 2020; Venus–Saturn to May 2023; Venus–Mercury to Mar 2026; Venus–Ketu Mar 2026–May 2027.

Past confirmations. Marriage in 2016 falls in Venus–Rahu: Venus is the 7th lord and Rahu occupies the 4th, the house of home, a textbook fit. Sade Sati ran roughly 2000–2007 as Saturn crossed Gemini, Cancer and Leo, the 12th, 1st and 2nd from her Cancer Moon; that was also Ketu's Mahadasha, her school-leaving and college years, which she remembers as lonely and formative. Ashtama Shani, Saturn in Aquarius in the 8th from the Moon, 2023–2025, coincided with Venus–Saturn and Venus–Mercury: a heavy, grinding stretch at work and at home. I would put these three to her as questions, not statements.

Now (2026). Venus–Ketu, March 2026 to May 2027: the last sub-period of a twenty-year Venus era. Ketu sits in her 10th. A closing sub-period behaves like a clearing because the sub-lord is Ketu, whose whole nature is release, and because the next Mahadasha lord (the Sun) is already waiting; the tradition reads the junction of two Mahadashas (the *dasha sandhi*) as unsettled ground. This is a wind-down and a clearing, the classic year in which people leave a role they have outgrown and do not yet know what comes next. Saturn in Pisces is in her 5th house and the 9th from the Moon (a good transit position by A.9); Jupiter in Gemini until mid-2026 is in her 8th, quiet, then enters Cancer, directly over her natal Moon, for the year to mid-2027.

The next three to five years. The Sun Mahadasha begins in June 2027. The Sun is her 10th lord, a functional benefic, sitting in her Lagna: a six-year era in which career, authority and identity fuse. Sun–Sun (to Sep 2027) and Sun–Moon (to Mar 2028) open it, the two yogakarakas for Scorpio running back to back. Jupiter moves into Leo, her 10th house, in mid-2027, aspecting the 2nd and 4th, while Saturn moves to Aries, her 6th house (an upachaya where Saturn does well) from about mid-2027. The double transit does not fall neatly on the 10th house itself in this stretch, so I do not promise a dramatic promotion; I say instead that 2027–28 favours a change of *role*, from employee to authority in her own name, with the Sun's period supplying the confidence.

8. Her three questions

"Should I start my own consulting practice?" Houses: the 10th (career), the 7th (business, and the 10th from the 10th), the 3rd (enterprise), the 2nd and 11th (money in). Findings: 10th lord Sun in the Lagna, she is built to work in her own name; Jupiter in the 7th and Venus own-sign in the D10's 7th (from the Dasamsa: Venus in Taurus in the D10 7th, and the Sun exalted in Aries in the D10) favour partnership-based practice; the combust Saturn in the 2nd warns that cash flow will be the discipline she has to learn. Timing: Venus–Ketu (2026–May 2027) is the year to *prepare*, register, build the client list, leave cleanly. The Sun Mahadasha from June 2027, with Jupiter entering her 10th house that same summer, is the launch window. So: yes, the chart favours it; not yet, and not alone at the start.

"When will finances stabilise?" Houses: the 2nd (Saturn, combust; lord Jupiter retrograde in the 7th), the 11th (empty; lord Mercury in the Lagna), and Venus, who disposes the whole chart from the 12th. Findings: the chart's money is *slow and knowledge-based*, never fast. The Venus–Saturn and Venus–Mercury sub-periods (2020–2026), with Ashtama Shani in the

middle, were the hardest stretch, and she will confirm that. Sun–Moon (Sep 2027–Mar 2028) and Sun–Rahu (to Jun 2029) bring the 9th lord and then the 4th-house Rahu into play: income steadies and property or a home matter becomes possible. Tendency: stability from 2028, with 2026–27 as the year to hold savings and avoid large fixed commitments.

"My mother's health?" Houses: the 4th (Rahu; lord Saturn combust in the 2nd), the Moon as karaka (strong, own sign, 9th), the 4th from the Moon (Libra, Venus own sign). Findings: the karaka and the Moon's own 4th are both strong, a resilient constitution and a good support system around her mother. The Rahu in the 4th and the combust lord say: irregular, hard-to-pin-down complaints, and a mother who does not like doctors. Timing: Jupiter aspects her 4th house from Gemini (until mid-2026) and again from Leo (mid-2027 to mid-2028); the year in between lacks that protection, so I would ask for regular check-ups in the second half of 2026 and early 2027. I do not diagnose. I say: keep the appointments, and let the doctors do the rest.

CONSULTATION TIP: Meera's mother is not in the room. Everything about her is said to help Meera *act* ("book the check-up", "sit with her more this winter") never to describe the mother's fate.

9. Remedies

Following Chapter 23: strengthen functional benefics that need it, pacify functional malefics by conduct and giving, and prescribe a stone only where a functional benefic genuinely lacks strength.

- **Jupiter:** 2nd and 5th lord, a functional benefic, in a kendra but in an enemy's sign and retrograde: the one planet in this chart where a gemstone is defensible. A **yellow sapphire (pukhraj)** in gold on the index finger, Thursday, after a trial period; alternatives are Thursday chana dal or turmeric daan and respect for teachers. Jupiter is strong in the D9, which is why I expect the stone to work quietly rather than dramatically.
- **Sun and Moon:** already strong; no stone needed. Sunday Surya Namaskar and Monday water-offering are enough to keep the yogakarakas engaged.
- **Saturn:** a functional malefic, combust, in the 2nd: pacify by conduct. Saturday sesame or mustard-oil daan; a fixed monthly savings transfer on the first Saturday of every month (Saturn loves a system); truthful, sparing speech.
- **Venus:** a functional malefic but the dispositor of the chart, in her own sign: honour rather than fight. Friday giving of white things (curd, rice) and mindful spending.
- **Rahu in the 4th:** coconut or a blanket to someone in need on Saturdays, and a calm, uncluttered home.
- **Ketu in the 10th:** feed street dogs; work without demanding credit.
- **No blue sapphire, no emerald, no diamond:** Saturn, Mercury and Venus are all functional malefics for Scorpio, and a stone strengthens; it does not pacify.

FROM LAL KITAB: In the Lal Kitab chart, where houses are fixed, Meera's Rahu sits in the 4th house, the Moon's *pakka ghar*. The tradition considers Rahu in the Moon's house unsettling for mother, home and peace of mind, and commonly teaches keeping a small piece of solid silver on one's person and offering coconut into flowing water, along with never quarrelling with the mother, as commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition; the exact prescription varies with the edition. (Source: *Lal Kitab*, Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, 1939–1952 Urdu editions; Hindi translations vary.)

10. What I would say in the first two minutes

"Meera, you are a Scorpio rising with the Sun and Mercury sitting right in your first house, a person who is what she does, speaks precisely, and is far more private than her confidence suggests. Your Moon is in its own sign in the ninth house: your mind finds its peace in learning and in teaching others; you have almost certainly been someone's guru already without calling it

that. Your strongest planets are that Moon and the Sun, grace and authority. The planet that asks the most of you is Saturn in your second house, weakened by the Sun: money and savings will always need a system rather than a mood. The twenty-year Venus period that shaped your adult life ends next year, and the Sun's period that follows is, frankly, the one your chart has been preparing you for. Let us see whether the past agrees with me before we talk about that."

11. Lessons for the student

- A strong Lagna with the 10th lord in it makes career and identity one thing; read them together.
- Always test Gaja Kesari *from the Moon*. Jupiter in a kendra from the Lagna is not enough.
- Combustion crosses sign boundaries: Saturn at 5° Sagittarius is combust by a Sun at 28° Scorpio.
- A dispositor chain that ends in one planet tells you which planet to honour in remedies, here Venus, a functional malefic, whom we respect rather than strengthen.
- The last sub-period of a long Mahadasha (here Venus–Ketu) is a clearing, not a launch. Time the launch to the new Mahadasha.

Reading two: Arjun (Chart B)

You watched Arjun's consultation in Chapter 24. Here is the preparation that sat under it, the hour at the desk that made the seventy-five minutes in the chair look easy.

1. Birth data, the chart, and the planetary table

Born 3 March 1995, 20:15, Pune (constructed), just after sunset, which is why the Sun sits in the 8th house, below the western horizon. Lagna Cancer 19°, in Ashlesha nakshatra, pada 1.

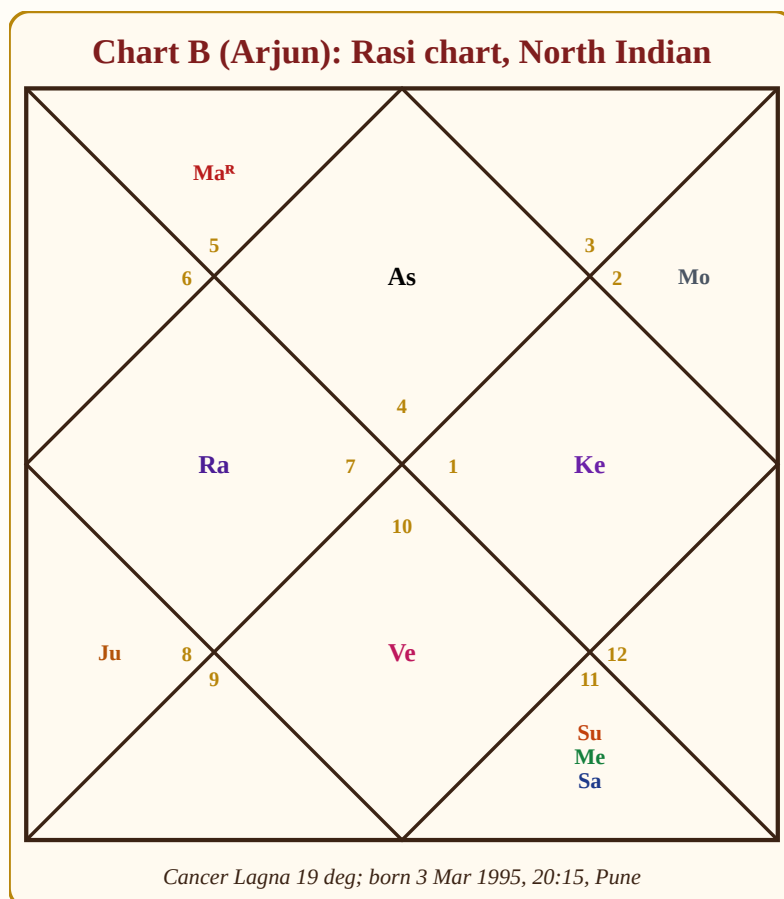


Figure 25.5: Chart B, North Indian style. Sun, Mercury and Saturn in the 8th (Aquarius); Moon in the 11th (Taurus); Mars retrograde in the 2nd (Leo); Jupiter in the 5th (Scorpio); Venus in the 7th (Capricorn); Rahu in the 4th, Ketu in the 10th.

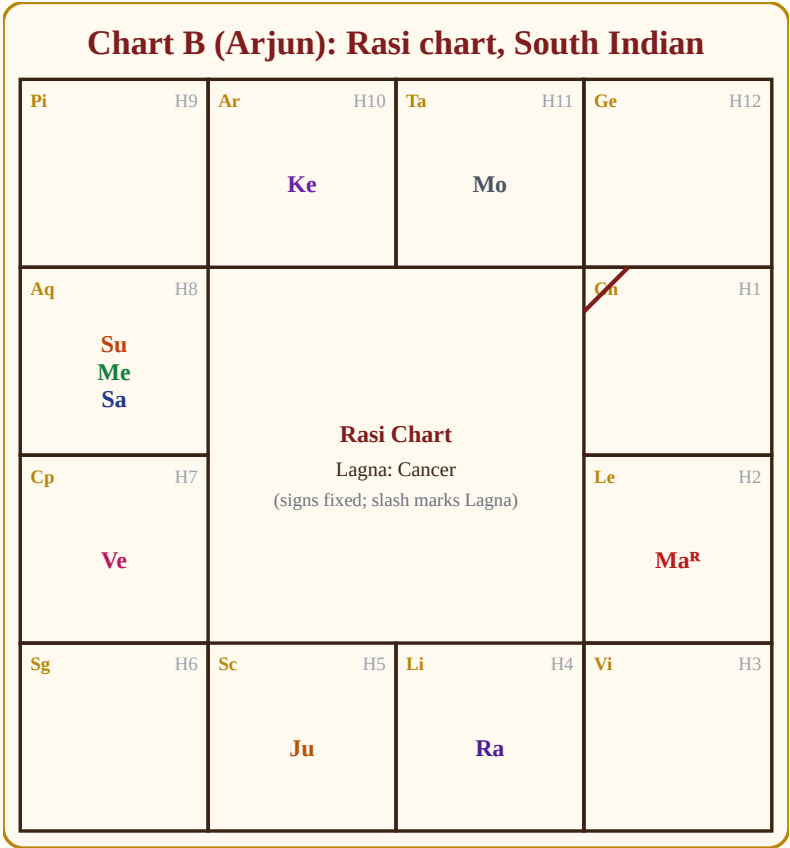


Figure 25.6: The same chart in the South Indian grid; the Lagna mark is in Cancer.

Combustion is measured from the Sun at 18° Aquarius (318°).

Planet	Sign	Degree	House	Nakshatra, pada (lord)	Dignity (● good ● neutral ○ difficult)	Notes
Sun	Aquarius	18°	8	Shatabhisha 4 (Rahu)	○ Enemy's sign (Saturn)	2nd lord in the 8th
Moon	Taurus	6°	11	Krittika 3 (Sun)	● Exalted (past the deepest point at 3°, still in the sign)	Waxing, seventh day of the bright half; Lagna lord
Mars	Leo	21°	2	Purva Phalguni 3 (Venus)	● Friend's sign (Sun)	Retrograde; yogakaraka (5th and 10th lord)
Mercury	Aquarius	2°	8	Dhanishta 3 (Mars)	● Neutral (Saturn)	16° from the Sun, not combust (orb 14°); 3rd and 12th lord
Jupiter	Scorpio	22°	5	Jyeshtha 2 (Mercury)	● Friend's sign (Mars)	6th and 9th lord
Venus	Capricorn	24°	7	Dhanishta 1 (Mars)	● Friend's sign (Saturn)	4th and 11th lord; 24° from the Sun, not combust (orb 10°)
Saturn	Aquarius	25°	8	Purva Bhadrapada 2 (Jupiter)	● Own sign, but ○ combust , 7° from the Sun (orb 15°)	7th and 8th lord
Rahu	Libra	12°	4	Swati 2 (Rahu)	(none)	In its own nakshatra
Ketu	Aries	12°	10	Ashwini 4 (Ketu)	(none)	In its own nakshatra

The one line a beginner misses: **Saturn is combust**. He sits in his own sign, which normally makes him solid, but the Sun is seven degrees away and scorches him. Saturn is also the lord of the 7th house (Capricorn), not Venus, who merely *occupies* the 7th as the marriage karaka while owning the 4th and 11th. So the marriage lord is weak, and the marriage karaka is strong. Hold that tension; it explains his whole question about marriage.

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE: Calling Venus "the 7th lord" because she sits in the 7th. A house's lord is the planet that *owns the sign* there (Capricorn belongs to Saturn) and the occupant is a separate fact. Mixing the two here would make Arjun's marriage look quick and easy when the chart says the opposite: a weak lord, a strong karaka, and therefore late but good.

WHY? Combustion is astronomy first. A planet within a few degrees of the Sun rises and sets with it and cannot be seen at all: it is lost in the glare. The tradition reads what cannot be seen as unable to act, and Parashara lists the orbs (A.2). Being in its own sign does not move a planet away from the Sun, so it does not save it. Everyday parallel: a brilliant new employee seated next to the loudest manager in the office; everything he says is drowned out, however good it is.

Now the dispositor chain. Sun and Mercury are in Saturn's sign; the Moon is in Venus's sign and Venus in Saturn's; Mars is in the Sun's sign, Jupiter in Mars's, Rahu in Venus's, Ketu in Mars's. Follow every thread and it ends at Saturn, in his own sign, combust, in the 8th house. The whole chart rests on a scorched Saturn in the room of hidden things. That is Arjun: patient, private, working in insurance data where nobody sees him, and never quite sure his effort is noticed.

STORY: THREE MINISTERS LOCKED IN THE EIGHTH ROOM. *The eighth room of the haveli is the strong-room, vaults, old papers, the family's secrets, the insurance ledgers. Three men are shut in there together: the King (Sun), the young Prince-Secretary (Mercury) and the old Judge of Labour (Saturn). It is the Judge's own room; he has the keys and knows every ledger. But the King has brought his brazier, and the Judge, sitting seven feet from it, is sweating, half-blinded, working at half his strength. The Prince, sixteen feet away, is uncomfortable but clear-headed; he reads the ledgers aloud and turns them into reports. Nobody outside the room knows how much work is done in there. The family's fortune depends on that room, and the family barely remembers it exists.*

Rule: Planets in the 8th work in hidden, technical, research-like fields; a planet within its combustion orb of the Sun loses strength even in its own sign.

2. First impression: the three pillars

Lagna. Cancer rising at 19°, empty, its lord the Moon exalted in the 11th. A protective, cautious exterior over a deeply feeling interior; identity built through friends, networks and belonging rather than through display. Ashlesha on the Lagna adds a watchful, slightly wary quality.

Moon. Taurus, exalted, 11th house, Kritika, waxing and bright. Stable, stubborn, loyal, practical; good with people once trust is earned; a mind that wants security. The strongest planet in the chart, and it is the Lagna lord, which makes it the pillar that holds the rest.

Sun. Aquarius, 8th house, in an enemy's sign, with Mercury and Saturn. The soul and the father are both in the strong-room: a father who was distant or rule-bound, a sense of self that formed through private struggle rather than applause, and a lifelong pull towards research and what lies beneath the surface.

3. Functional benefics and malefics for Cancer

● Functional benefics	○ Functional malefics	● Neutral / mixed	Yogakaraka	Marakas
Mars, Jupiter, Moon	Venus, Mercury	Sun, Saturn	Mars	Saturn, Venus

Applied here: all three benefics are well placed, Mars in a friend's sign, Jupiter in a friend's sign in a trikona, the Moon exalted. Both malefics sit where they cannot do much harm, Venus in a friend's sign in the 7th (she gives comfort and delays nothing but her own promises), Mercury in the 8th (a dusthana lord in a dusthana, which the tradition often reads as protective). The two neutrals, Sun and Saturn, are the weak ones, and both are in the 8th. Read that pattern once and the man's life makes sense: the good things come steadily through effort and people; the difficult things come through father, authority and hidden processes.

4. House by house

1st (Cancer), self. Empty; lord Moon exalted in the 11th; karaka Sun in the 8th; from the Moon, Taurus with the Moon. Identity through belonging and networks, because the Lagna lord sits in the house of friends and gains; a body that gains weight and holds water, because Cancer and an exalted Moon are both watery.

2nd (Leo), wealth, speech, family. Mars retrograde, the yogakaraka; lord Sun in the 8th; karaka Jupiter in the 5th; from the Moon, Gemini, lord Mercury in the 8th. Money through effort and technical skill, because the success-planet sits in the house of savings and its lord in the house of research; blunt speech, because Mars sits in the mouth's house; a father-son tension in the family, because the 2nd lord is the Sun (father) sitting with Saturn in the 8th.

3rd (Virgo), courage, siblings, communication. Empty; lord Mercury in the 8th; karaka Mars in the 2nd; from the Moon, Cancer, the Lagna. Courage turned into analysis rather than argument, because the lord of communication sits in the house of hidden research.

4th (Libra), mother, home, education. Rahu; lord Venus in the 7th; karakas Moon (exalted) and Mercury (8th); from the Moon, Leo with Mars. A strong mother, because the karaka is exalted; a restless relationship with home and a foreign-flavoured education, because Rahu the stranger sits in the house of home and schooling; property through a partner, because the 4th lord sits in the 7th.

5th (Scorpio), intelligence, children, past merit. Jupiter, the 9th lord; lord Mars in the 2nd; karaka Jupiter here; from the Moon, Virgo, empty. Deep, investigative intelligence, because the planet of wisdom sits in the house of intellect in Mars's probing sign; children later but well supported, because the karaka is present and strong while the lord is retrograde. Mars aspects Jupiter here by his 4th aspect from Leo: the 10th lord meets the 9th lord, a Raja yoga.

6th (Sagittarius), service, debts, disease. Empty; lord Jupiter in the 5th; karakas Mars (2nd) and Saturn (8th); from the Moon, Libra with Rahu. A salaried career, because the lord of service sits in a trikona and service becomes his merit; digestion and weight, because Jupiter governs fat and liver; anxiety about unseen rivals, because Rahu sits in the 6th from the mind.

7th (Capricorn), marriage, partnership. Venus, the karaka, lord of the 4th and 11th; lord Saturn combust in the 8th, own sign; from the Moon, Scorpio with Jupiter. Late, because the house's lord is weak and is Saturn, the planet of delay, in the 8th; good, because the karaka sits in the house itself and Jupiter sits in the 7th from the mind (a principled, educated partner); comfort and home through the partner, because the 4th–11th lord is the occupant.

8th (Aquarius), research, inheritance, sudden change. Sun, Mercury, Saturn (own, combust); lord and karaka Saturn here; from the Moon, Sagittarius, lord Jupiter in the 5th. Hidden, technical, research-like work, because three planets sit in the house that is the 12th from the 9th, where visible fortune disappears and depth begins; inheritance late and complicated, because its lord is combust. Longevity is not for the client; Saturn own-sign in the 8th is classically steady, and that is all I note.

9th (Pisces), fortune, father, higher learning, long journeys. Empty; lord Jupiter in the 5th; karakas Jupiter and Sun; from the Moon, Capricorn with Venus. Strong higher education, because the 9th lord sits in the 5th, the house of learning, in a friend's sign; a father who provided from a distance, because the karaka of father sits in the 8th; long journeys favoured, and Saturn is transiting this house in 2025–27.

10th (Aries), career. Ketu; lord Mars in the 2nd; karakas Sun, Mercury and Saturn in the 8th, Jupiter in the 5th; from the Moon, Aquarius, the cluster itself. Hidden analytical work, because every career signifier sits in the 8th and the 10th from the mind is the 8th house; detachment from titles, because Ketu sits in the house of status. In the Dasamsa (D10, Chapter 11) the Sun sits in his own sign Leo in that chart's 12th (authority exercised in institutions or abroad) and Saturn is exalted there (discipline in work rewarded, late).

11th (Taurus), gains, friends, elder siblings. Moon exalted, the Lagna lord; lord Venus in the 7th; karaka Jupiter in the 5th; from the Moon, Pisces, empty. Gains through people, because the self's lord sits at full strength in the house of friends; wishes fulfilled slowly, because the house's lord sits in Saturn's sign.

12th (Gemini), foreign lands, expenses, sleep. Empty; lord Mercury in the 8th with Sun and Saturn; karaka Saturn in the 8th; from the Moon, Aries with Ketu. Foreign residence tied to research, because the lord of foreign lands sits in the house of hidden work; sleep disturbed by thinking, because Mercury (the mind's chatter) rules the house of sleep.

WHY? Two conclusions above rest on the grammar of the houses. The 8th is the 12th house counted from the 9th: the loss of visible fortune, hence what is hidden, sudden, buried and researched; planets there work below the surface. Ketu in the 10th gives detachment from status because the 10th is the most visible house (the noon point, where the Sun has directional strength) and Ketu is the headless sadhu who has given up wanting to be seen. Everyday parallel: the back-office team that keeps the company running and never appears in the brochure, led by a man who does not care to.

5. Yogas present, honestly weighed

- **Gaja Kesari:** Jupiter in Scorpio is the 7th from the Moon in Taurus (a kendra from the Moon) and Jupiter aspects the Moon directly. Genuine and reasonably strong (Jupiter in a friend's sign). Protection, a good name among those who know him.
- **Raja yoga by aspect:** Mars, lord of the 5th and 10th, aspects Jupiter, lord of the 9th, by his 4th aspect. A kendra lord touching a trikona lord. Real; moderate, because the aspect is one-way and Mars is retrograde.
- **Budha-Aditya** in the 8th: Mercury with the Sun, not combust. Intelligence, but pointed at hidden and technical things, and sobered by Saturn's presence.
- **Viparita flavour:** the 12th lord Mercury in the 8th (Vimala type) and the 8th lord Saturn in his own 8th (Sarala type, by some teachers). Both are diluted because the 2nd lord Sun sits with them, the "not with other lords" clause. It shows as resilience through crises, not windfalls.
- **Kuja dosha:** Mars is in the 2nd from the Lagna, the 4th from the Moon and the 8th from Venus, present on all three counts. Mitigations: Mars is the yogakaraka, in a friend's sign, and retrograde (which several teachers count as softening). It asks for a partner of comparable energy and a marriage where disagreement is allowed. Never say the word "dosha" to him without the mitigations in the same breath.
- **Saturn combust in the 8th:** the dispositor of the whole chart, weakened. This is the real fault line, not a yoga, but the thing every remedy has to respect.
- **Kala Sarpa:** not formed. Rahu in Libra and Ketu in Aries; the Moon in Taurus and Mars in Leo sit on the far side of the axis from the rest. Arjun had been told otherwise, and the chart itself dismantles it.
- **The exalted Lagna lord in the 11th:** not a named yoga, but the backbone of the chart.

STORY: THE COMMANDER WHO WALKS BACKWARDS. *The Commander (Mars) is the one officer in this court whom the Lagna trusts completely, for a Cancer-born king, Mars is the yogakaraka, the single planet who can deliver a rise in status. He has been posted to the second room, the treasury and the family dining hall, in the King's own colours (Leo), which suits him. But he is walking backwards, retrograde. He does not charge; he re-checks, re-does, reworks the plan a third time, and gets there later than the others expected and more thoroughly than anyone else could. From that room he looks across at the fifth, where the Royal Priest (Jupiter) sits, and the two of them: Commander and Priest, quietly run the kingdom's real affairs.*

Rule: *A retrograde yogakaraka still gives its rise, but through repetition and depth rather than speed.*

6. Navamsa (D9) quick read

Planet	D1	D9 sign	D9 house	Comment
Lagna	Cancer 19° (movable → from Cancer; 6th part)	Sagittarius	1	
Sun	Aquarius 18° (fixed → from Libra; 6th part)	Pisces	4	● Friend's sign; a D9 kendra
Moon	Taurus 6°	Aquarius	3	● Neutral
Mars	Leo 21°	Libra	11	● Neutral
Mercury	Aquarius 2°	Libra	11	● Friend's sign
Jupiter	Scorpio 22°	Capricorn	2	○ Debilitated , the D9 Lagna lord
Venus	Capricorn 24°	Leo	9	○ Enemy's sign
Saturn	Aquarius 25°	Taurus	6	● Friend's sign
Rahu	Libra 12°	Capricorn	2	(none)
Ketu	Aries 12°	Cancer	8	(none)

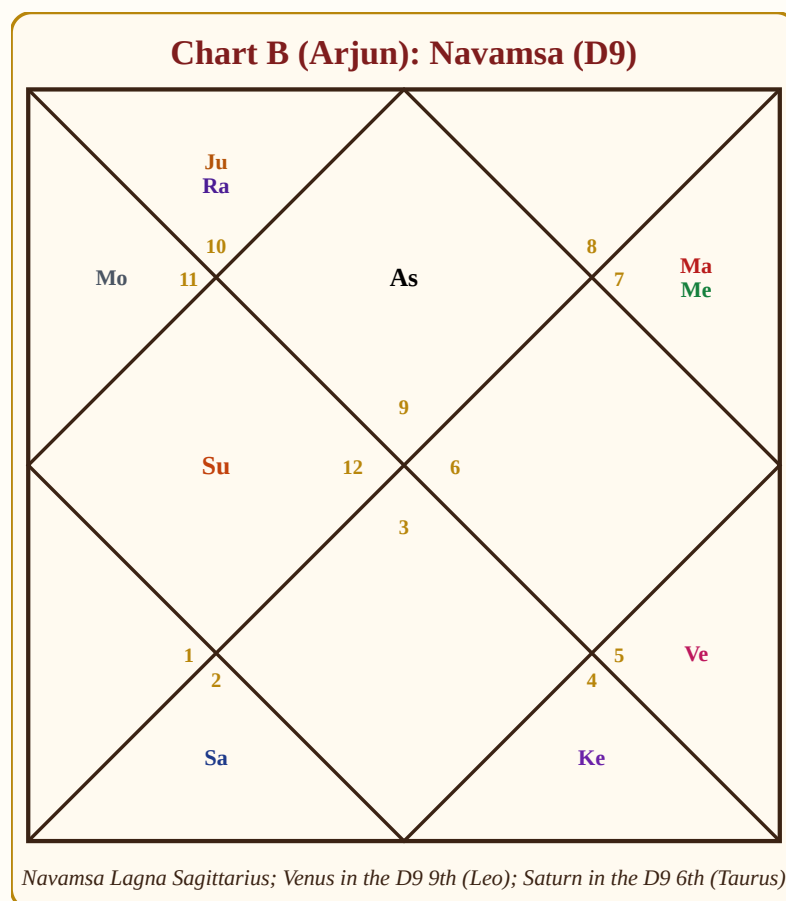


Figure 25.7: Arjun's Navamsa. Jupiter, comfortable in the Rasi chart, is debilitated here, the inner reserve of faith is thinner than the outer confidence.

No planet is Vargottama. The honest finding is Jupiter: friend's sign in D1, debilitated in D9, and he is the D9 Lagna lord. Arjun's outer optimism about study and travel rests on an inner doubt, and he will need a teacher or mentor to hold the faith for him at times. For marriage, the D9 7th house is Gemini, whose lord Mercury sits in the D9 11th with Mars in a friend's sign, a

partner met through networks or work, articulate and independent. Venus in the D9 9th in an enemy's sign suggests a partner from a different background, and a love that needs adjusting to.

7. Dasha timeline

The Moon at 6° Taurus is in Krittika, the Sun's star, which runs to 10° Taurus. Balance of the Sun at birth = (10° – 6°) ÷ 13°20' × 6 years = 1.8 years.

Mahadasha	From	To	Age
Sun (balance)	birth	Dec 1996	0–1.8
Moon	Dec 1996	Dec 2006	1.8–11.8
Mars	Dec 2006	Dec 2013	11.8–18.8
Rahu	Dec 2013	Dec 2031	18.8–36.8
Jupiter	Dec 2031	Dec 2047	36.8–52.8
Saturn	Dec 2047	Dec 2066	52.8–71.8

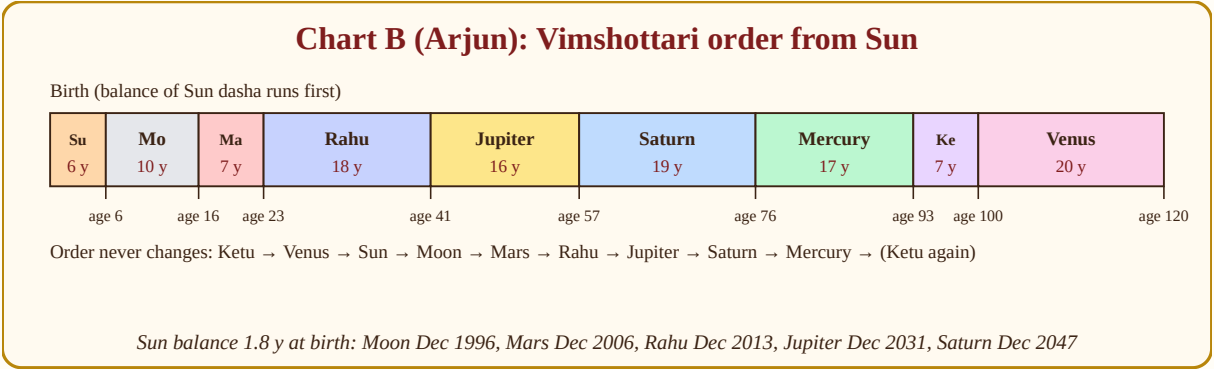


Figure 25.8: The order from the Sun. Rahu's eighteen years (the whole of his twenties and early thirties) are the current chapter.

Rahu's sub-periods, computed from December 2013 (Rahu years × sub-lord years ÷ 120): Rahu–Rahu to Aug 2016 (2y 8m 12d); **Rahu–Jupiter to Jan 2019** (2y 4m 24d); Rahu–Saturn to Nov 2021 (2y 10m 6d); **Rahu–Mercury to Jun 2024** (2y 6m 18d); Rahu–Ketu to Jul 2025 (1y 0m 18d); **Rahu–Venus Jul 2025–Jul 2028** (3y); Rahu–Sun to May 2029 (10m 24d); Rahu–Moon to Nov 2030 (1y 6m); Rahu–Mars to Dec 2031 (1y 0m 18d).

Past confirmations. The Mars Mahadasha (age 12–19) was his school success, the yogakaraka running through the exam years, with Mars–Venus (Nov 2011–Jan 2013) at the board-exam and college-entry stage. Rahu–Jupiter (Aug 2016–Jan 2019), Jupiter the 9th lord in the 5th, finished the master's and started the job in 2017–18. Rahu–Mercury (Nov 2021–Jun 2024), the 12th lord in the 8th, with Saturn transiting Aquarius over the 8th-house cluster from January 2023, produced the "stuck since 2022" feeling he came in with. Rahu–Ketu (Jun 2024–Jul 2025), Ketu being in his 10th, was the year of "what am I doing here". Three confirmations, all landed in the session.

Now (early 2026). Rahu–Venus, to July 2028: Venus in the 7th, lord of the 4th and 11th, partnerships, relationships, home and gains through others. Saturn in Pisces is in his 9th house and the 11th from the Moon, one of Saturn's three good transit positions (A.9). Jupiter is in Gemini, his 12th, until mid-2026, then enters Cancer, his Lagna, for a year.

WHY? The double-transit rule is astronomy put to work. Jupiter takes about a year per sign and Saturn about two and a half, so they are the two slow hands of the clock; every other planet passes over a house several times a year, but these two mark out stretches long enough for a life event to ripen. Jupiter's aspect opens a door (growth, permission); Saturn's makes it real (structure, paperwork, commitment). Both are needed because a door with no frame is a hole in the wall. Everyday parallel: a wedding needs the couple to choose a date *and* the hall to be free; either alone is a wish.

The next three to five years. Mid-2026 to mid-2027: Jupiter on the Lagna, aspecting the 5th, 7th and 9th houses, while Saturn stands in the 9th, the double transit falls on the 9th (higher learning, long journeys) and Jupiter alone lights the 7th. From about mid-2027 Saturn moves to Aries, his 10th house and the 12th from the Moon: the first phase of Sade Sati begins, and Saturn's 10th aspect from Aries falls on Capricorn, the 7th house. Jupiter in Leo (mid-2027 to mid-2028) crosses his natal Mars and aspects the 8th-house cluster and the 10th; Jupiter in Virgo (mid-2028 to mid-2029) aspects the 7th again. Then Rahu–Sun (Jul 2028–May 2029) asks for care with father and authority; Rahu–Moon (May 2029–Nov 2030) brings the exalted Lagna lord forward, a settling period; Rahu–Mars (to Dec 2031) is the yogakaraka's sub-period, and Jupiter's Mahadasha follows.

8. His three questions

"Research career abroad, or stay?" Houses: the 9th (higher learning, long journeys), the 12th (foreign residence), the 10th (career). Findings: the 9th lord Jupiter strong in a trikona; the 12th lord Mercury in the 8th with the Sun, foreign lands linked to research; every 10th-house karaka in the 8th; the D10 Sun in his own sign in the 12th of that chart. The chart favours research and favours doing it elsewhere. Timing: the decision window is **mid-2026 to mid-2027** (double transit on the 9th, Rahu–Venus running); the move itself leans towards **2027–28**, when Saturn from Aries aspects the 12th house and Jupiter from Leo aspects the 12th lord. I say "favours", not "go".

"When will I marry?" Houses: the 7th (Venus present; lord Saturn combust in the 8th), the D9 7th (Gemini, lord Mercury with Mars in the D9 11th), Venus as karaka in the current sub-period. Findings: a weak lord delayed it; a strong karaka and her sub-period now bring it forward. Timing: **late 2026 through 2028**, Jupiter aspecting the 7th house and the transiting 7th lord from Cancer (mid-2026 to mid-2027), then Saturn's aspect on the 7th from Aries (from about mid-2027) and Jupiter's from Virgo (mid-2028). The first serious opening is the second half of 2026 into 2027. The Kuja dosha conversation belongs here, with its mitigations, and with the advice to read both charts together when a match is proposed.

"Why have I felt stuck since 2022?" Rahu–Mercury (Nov 2021–Jun 2024): the 12th lord, a functional malefic for Cancer, in the 8th. Saturn transiting Aquarius (Jan 2023–Mar 2025), the 8th house, sitting on his natal Sun, Mercury and Saturn, and the 10th from the Moon. Then Rahu–Ketu with Ketu in the 10th. Three heavy indicators, all passed by mid-2025. Naming the period, and its end, was worth more to him than any prediction.

9. Remedies

- **Mars**, the yogakaraka, in a friend's sign, retrograde: the one stone I would consider. **Red coral (moonga)**, gold or copper, ring finger, Tuesday, after a trial period. It strengthens the planet that gives him his rise; the tradition does not hold that it worsens Kuja dosha.
- **Jupiter**, 9th lord and the planet carrying the abroad question, weak in the D9: Thursday chana dal or turmeric daan, respect for teachers, a mentor sought and kept. A yellow sapphire is defensible but I would not give two stones at once; coral first.
- **Moon**, exalted; nothing to add but Monday's water offering and a fixed sleep hour.
- **Saturn**, combust, the dispositor: pacify by conduct. Saturday sesame or mustard-oil daan; service to someone older; no shortcuts in work, ever, the 8th punishes them.
- **Sun**, in an enemy's sign with Saturn: mend the father relationship by small regular acts; Sunday Surya Namaskar.

- ○ **Rahu**, his Mahadasha lord: coconut or a blanket on Saturdays to someone in need, and a hard rule about screens after ten at night.
- **No blue sapphire** (Saturn is neutral and a maraka for Cancer), **no diamond** (Venus is a functional malefic), **no emerald** (Mercury likewise).

FROM LAL KITAB: In the Lal Kitab house-chart, Arjun's Saturn sits in the 8th house, one of Saturn's *pakka ghar* (permanent houses), so the tradition treats it as settled rather than hostile. Commonly taught remedies for Saturn in the 8th include offering a few drops of mustard oil on Saturdays, feeding a black dog or crows, keeping the home's drains and dark corners clean, and neither lending nor borrowing iron, as commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition; editions differ on the details. (*Source: Lal Kitab, Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, 1939–1952 Urdu editions; Hindi translations vary.*)

10. What I would say in the first two minutes

"Arjun, you are a Cancer rising (protective on the outside, deeply feeling inside) with your Moon, which is your mind, exalted in the eleventh house: a steady, loyal, practical mind that succeeds through people and networks, and that is the strongest thing in your chart. After the Moon comes Mars, in your second house, retrograde, for your Lagna he is the planet of success, and he works by doing things deeply and twice rather than fast. Your weak point is the three planets in the eighth house, the Sun, Mercury and Saturn together, with Saturn scorched by the Sun. The eighth is research, insurance, hidden work, and the feeling that life happens to you. That is where your career has been and where the frustration has been. Let me check three things about your past before we go further."

11. Lessons for the student

- Find the lord of a house before you read its occupant. Chart B's 7th lord is Saturn; Venus only lives there.
- Combustion in one's own sign is still combustion. A scorched dispositor weakens a whole chart quietly.
- A yoga is a claim; the D9 is the audit. Jupiter looked fine in D1 and is debilitated in D9, say both.
- When a client names a year they felt stuck, find the antardasha *and* the Saturn transit; when both agree, the birth time is confirmed.
- Dismantle a planted fear (here, Kala Sarpa) with the chart in front of the client, not with your opinion of the other astrologer.

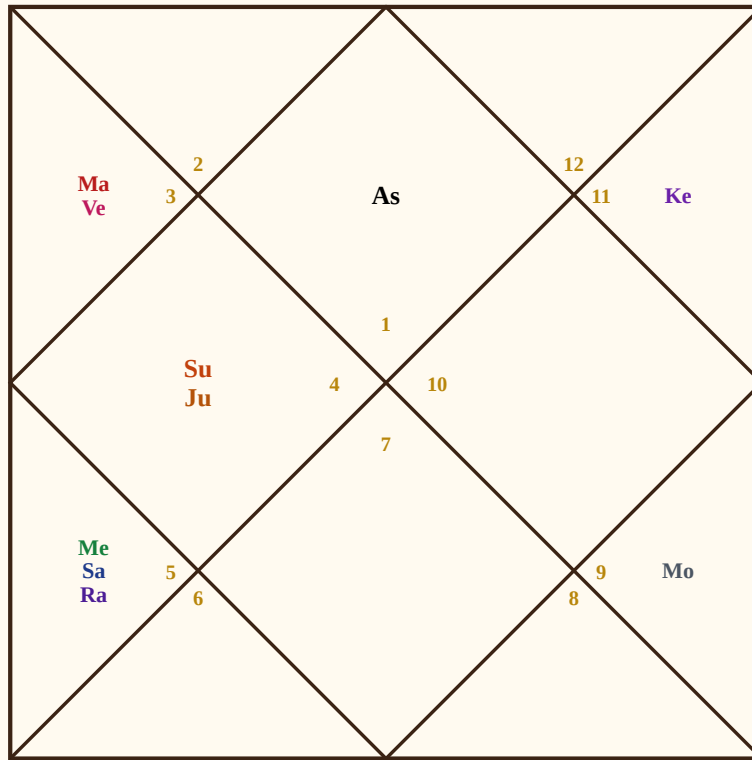
Reading three: Devika (Chart C)

Devika is the oldest of the three and the one with the most life behind her to check against. That makes her chart the best teacher of timing in this book: three Mahadashas have already run, and each left a mark she can confirm.

1. Birth data, the chart, and the planetary table

Born 22 July 1979, 23:55, Kolkata (constructed), five minutes before midnight, the Sun deep below the horizon in the 4th house. Lagna Aries 7°, in Ashwini nakshatra, pada 3.

Chart C (Devika): Rasi chart, North Indian



Aries Lagna 7 deg; born 22 Jul 1979, 23:55, Kolkata

Figure 25.9: Chart C, North Indian style. Sun and Jupiter in the 4th (Cancer); Mars and Venus in the 3rd (Gemini); Mercury, Saturn and Rahu in the 5th (Leo); Moon in the 9th (Sagittarius); Ketu in the 11th (Aquarius).

Chart C (Devika): Rasi chart, South Indian

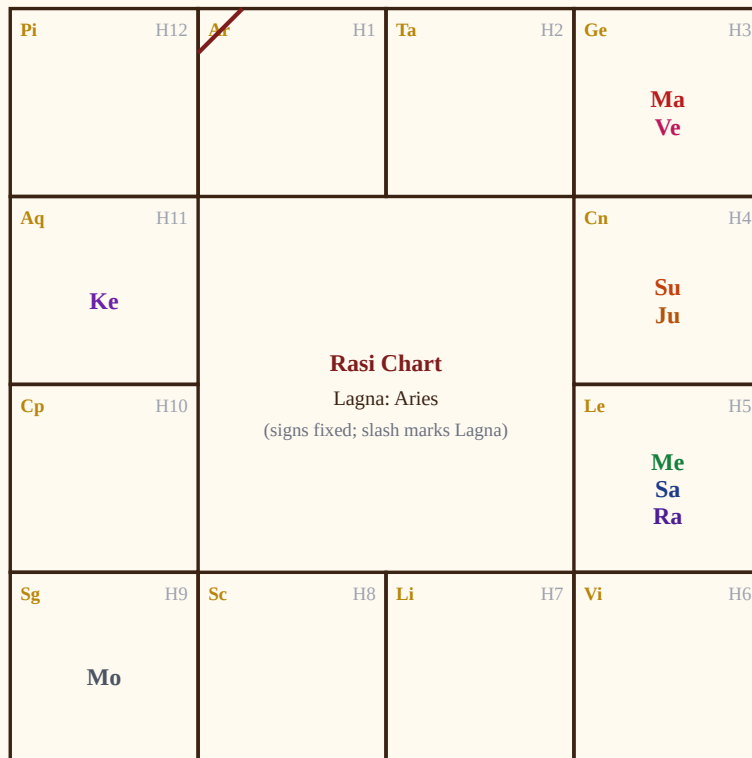


Figure 25.10: The same chart in the South Indian grid; the Lagna mark is in Aries.

Combustion is measured from the Sun at 5° Cancer (95°).

Planet	Sign	Degree	House	Nakshatra, pada (lord)	Dignity (● good ● neutral ○ difficult)	Notes
Sun	Cancer	5°	4	Pushya 1 (Saturn)	● Friend's sign (Moon)	5th lord in the 4th, with Jupiter
Moon	Sagittarius	14°	9	Purva Ashadha 1 (Venus)	● Neutral (Jupiter); ● waxing, two days from full	4th lord in the 9th
Mars	Gemini	27°	3	Punarvasu 3 (Jupiter)	○ Enemy's sign (Mercury); ○ combust , 8° from the Sun (orb 17°)	Lagna lord and 8th lord; Vargottama in D9
Mercury	Leo	1°	5	Magha 1 (Ketu)	● Friend's sign (Sun)	26° from the Sun, not combust; in the first 3°20' of Magha, a gandanta zone; 3rd and 6th lord
Jupiter	Cancer	26°	4	Ashlesha 3 (Mercury)	● Exalted	9th and 12th lord; 21° from the Sun, not combust (orb 11°)
Venus	Gemini	15°	3	Ardra 3 (Rahu)	● Friend's sign (Mercury)	2nd and 7th lord; 20° from the Sun, not combust (orb 10°)
Saturn	Leo	18°	5	Purva Phalguni 2 (Venus)	○ Enemy's sign (Sun)	10th and 11th lord
Rahu	Leo	3°	5	Magha 1 (Ketu)	(none)	Gandanta zone
Ketu	Aquarius	3°	11	Dhanishta 3 (Mars)	(none)	

Two lines to underline. **Mars, the Lagna lord, is combust** (eight degrees behind the Sun across the sign boundary) and in an enemy's sign. That is the weakest planet in the chart, and it is the planet that stands for her body and her will. And Jupiter is exalted, at 26° Cancer: past the deepest exaltation point of 5°, but still in the sign of his exaltation, and in a kendra.

The dispositor chain is the prettiest of the three charts. Sun in Cancer reports to the Moon; the Moon in Sagittarius reports to Jupiter; Jupiter in Cancer reports back to the Moon, a closed loop, an exchange of signs between the 4th lord and the 9th lord. Mars and Venus report to Mercury, Mercury and Saturn and Rahu to the Sun, Ketu to Saturn; every planet in the chart flows into the Sun and from there into that Moon–Jupiter loop. The 4th house (home, mother, property) and the 9th (fortune, father, faith) are the engine of her life.

STORY: THE EXCHANGE OF KEYS. In Devika's haveli the Queen Mother (Moon) and the Royal Priest (Jupiter) have swapped rooms. The Queen Mother has moved into the ninth room, the family temple, with the Priest's books and lamps around her; the Priest has moved into the fourth, the mother's room at the heart of the house, and he has never been so well, sitting in his exaltation, with the King (Sun) beside him as his guest. Each holds the other's keys. Whatever happens to the home happens to the family's fortune, and whatever happens to their faith happens to their home. Then look up: from the temple in the ninth room the Priest's new seat is the eighth room away, the Shakata pattern, so the Queen Mother's fortunes rise and dip like a cart on a rutted road. But the cart is pulled by an exalted Priest and a King, so it never overturns.

Rule: Two lords in each other's signs fuse their houses (Parivartana); Jupiter exalted in a kendra is Hamsa yoga; Jupiter in the 6th, 8th or 12th from the Moon is Shakata, and one chart can hold all three.

WHY? An exchange of signs fuses two houses by plain logic: each lord is living in the other's house, so whatever reaches one house's affairs reaches the other's lord, and the two cannot act without acting for each other. Parashara ranks the exchange between a kendra lord and a trikona lord (Maha) above the others because those are the houses of support and of merit. Everyday parallel: two sisters who have swapped kitchens for a year; each one's cooking now depends on the other's stove.

2. First impression: the three pillars

Lagna. Aries rising at 7°, empty, its lord Mars combust and in an enemy's sign in the 3rd. Courage, initiative and heat, but the Lagna lord's weakness shows as energy that comes in bursts and then runs out, headaches and impatience, and a will that is strongest when defending others (the 3rd house is siblings and courage).

Moon. Sagittarius, 9th house, Purva Ashadha, nearly full. An optimistic, principled, faith-oriented mind; a mother herself who mothers through teaching; the exchange with Jupiter makes the Moon far stronger than "neutral" suggests. The Moon is her second pillar.

Sun. Cancer, 4th house, with exalted Jupiter, in a friend's sign. Soul and father in the mother's room, beside the Priest: a father who was a moral presence in the home, a childhood steeped in learning and religion, and (as the 5th lord) children and intelligence flowing through home and education. This Sun–Jupiter pair is the yogakaraka combination for Aries (A.6), and it is the strongest thing in the chart.

3. Functional benefics and malefics for Aries

● Functional benefics	○ Functional malefics	● Neutral / mixed	Yogakaraka	Marakas
Sun, Mars, Jupiter	Mercury, Venus, Saturn	Moon	Sun + Jupiter together	Venus, Mercury

WHY? The marakas are derived, not decreed. The 8th house is longevity and the 3rd, being the 8th from the 8th, is its second signal; the houses that are the 12th (loss) from those two are the 7th and the 2nd. So the 2nd and 7th and their lords are where life-force is spent, which is why Parashara calls them maraka. For Aries that means Venus (2nd and 7th lord) and Mercury (6th lord, the other classical candidate). Everyday parallel: the two exits of a house are not dangerous rooms, but they are where people leave from.

Applied here: two of the three benefics (Sun and Jupiter) are together in a kendra, one of them exalted. The third, Mars, is the weak one. All three malefics are in Mercury's or the Sun's signs: Mercury and Saturn in the 5th with Rahu (the difficult corner

of the chart), Venus in the 3rd with Mars. So the pattern is: an exceptionally strong core (home, faith, children's future) with two soft spots (the body (Mars) and the 5th house (Saturn, Rahu, Mercury)) that will make her *work* for what the core promises.

4. House by house

1st (Aries), self. Empty; lord Mars combust in the 3rd; karaka Sun in the 4th with Jupiter; from the Moon, Sagittarius with the Moon. A strong spirit in a body that tires, because the karaka of vitality is excellently placed while the Lagna lord is scorched; head, heat and blood to respect, because Aries is the head and Mars is blood.

2nd (Taurus), wealth, speech, family. Empty; lord Venus in the 3rd, a friend's sign; karaka Jupiter exalted; from the Moon, Capricorn, empty. Steady money by her own effort, because the wealth lord sits in the house of effort; gentle speech, because Venus rules the mouth's house.

3rd (Gemini), siblings, courage, effort. Mars (Lagna lord) and Venus (2nd and 7th lord); lord Mercury in the 5th; karaka Mars here; from the Moon, Aquarius with Ketu. Siblings central and contested, because the self's lord sits weakened in the siblings' house; great personal effort, because the Lagna lord and the karaka of courage are both here; the property matter lives in this house, because Mars is also the karaka of land.

4th (Cancer), mother, home, property, education. Sun and exalted Jupiter; lord Moon in the 9th in exchange; karakas Moon and Mercury; from the Moon, Pisces, lord Jupiter exalted. The best house, because a great benefic exalted in a kendra and the exchange with the 9th tie home to fortune: a good mother, a home that is a temple, property that is rightfully hers, education completed well. Hamsa and Raja yoga both live here.

5th (Leo), children, intelligence, past merit. Mercury, Saturn, Rahu; lord Sun in the 4th with Jupiter; karaka Jupiter exalted; from the Moon, Aries, empty. Children delayed and worried over, then well, because the occupants (delay, foreignness, anxiety) are malefic while the lord and karaka are excellent: struggle in the process, success in the outcome. Some popular teachings call Saturn with Rahu "cursed"; Parashara does not, and I read it as a stern tutor and a foreign one in the nursery.

6th (Virgo), illness, debts, litigation, service. Empty; lord Mercury in the 5th with Saturn and Rahu; karakas Mars (3rd) and Saturn (5th); from the Moon, Taurus, empty. Digestive and anxious illness, because the lord of disease sits in Leo, the stomach's sign (A.1), with Saturn and Rahu; long, document-heavy litigation, for the same reason.

7th (Libra), marriage. Empty; lord Venus in the 3rd with Mars, a friend's sign; karaka Venus, and in a woman's chart Jupiter as husband-karaka, exalted; from the Moon, Gemini with Mars and Venus. A steady marriage to a principled, learned man, because the husband-karaka is exalted in a kendra; sharp arguments that pass quickly, because Mars sits with the 7th lord.

8th (Scorpio), transformation, inheritance, chronic matters. Empty; lord Mars combust in the 3rd; karaka Saturn in the 5th; from the Moon, Cancer with Sun and Jupiter. Inheritance real but contested, because the lord of inheritance sits in the house of siblings; sudden events touch the body, because the 8th lord is also the Lagna lord.

9th (Sagittarius), fortune, father, faith, higher learning. Moon, in exchange with Jupiter; lord Jupiter exalted in the 4th; karakas Jupiter and Sun; from the Moon, Leo with Mercury, Saturn and Rahu. Grace through home and family, because of the exchange; a father who was the family's conscience, because the Sun sits with Jupiter; higher learning good, and likely to continue in later life.

10th (Capricorn), career. Empty; lord Saturn in the 5th, an enemy's sign; karakas Sun (4th), Mercury and Saturn (5th), Jupiter (4th); from the Moon, Virgo, empty. Career through children, education or institutions, because the career lord sits in the 5th; status late and by patience, because that lord is Saturn in an uncomfortable sign.

11th (Aquarius), gains, elder siblings, friends. Ketu; lord Saturn in the 5th; karaka Jupiter exalted; from the Moon, Libra, empty. Gains that arrive unchased, because the detached sadhu sits in the house of gains while the karaka is strong.

12th (Pisces), expenses, hospitals, foreign lands, release. Empty; lord Jupiter exalted in the 4th; karaka Saturn in the 5th; from the Moon, Scorpio, empty. Expenses on home and children, because the 12th lord sits in the 4th; a genuine spiritual bent, because the house of release is ruled by an exalted great benefic; foreign links through the daughter. Saturn transits here in 2025–27.

5. Yogas present, honestly weighed

- **Hamsa Mahapurusha:** Jupiter exalted in the 4th, a kendra. Strong. Dignity, learning, a moral centre that others lean on.
- **Raja yoga by conjunction:** the 5th lord Sun and the 9th lord Jupiter together in a kendra, the two trikona lords, the yogakaraka pair for Aries, in one room. Strong. A rise through family, property and children's achievements rather than through office.
- **Maha Parivartana:** the 4th lord Moon in Jupiter's sign, the 9th lord Jupiter in the Moon's, a kendra lord and a trikona lord exchanging. Strong. Home and fortune are one account.
- **Chandra–Mangala:** the Moon in Sagittarius and Mars in Gemini are in mutual 7th aspect. Present; moderate, because Mars is combust. Earning capacity and drive, in bursts.
- **Shakata:** Jupiter is the 8th from the Moon. Present. Ups and downs in fortune, but the Hamsa and the exchange set a high floor under the dips.
- **Kemadruma, cancelled:** the 2nd from the Moon (Capricorn) and the 12th (Scorpio) are empty, but Mars and Venus sit in a kendra from the Moon, and Jupiter in a kendra from the Lagna. Solitude felt, never suffered.
- **Adhi yoga, partial:** Venus in the 7th and Jupiter in the 8th from the Moon; the 6th is empty. Some leadership in her circle, not the full result.
- **Kuja dosha, partial:** Mars is the 3rd from the Lagna (clear), the 7th from the Moon and the 1st from Venus (both count). Combust Mars weakens the dosha; her marriage has held, which is the proof.
- **Saturn, Rahu and Mercury in the 5th, Saturn in an enemy's sign:** the fault line, children and education by struggle, and the seat of the current Rahu Mahadasha.
- **Lagna lord combust in an enemy's sign:** the second fault line. The D9 answers it (below).
- Not present: Gaja Kesari (Jupiter 8th from the Moon), Budha–Aditya (Sun and Mercury in different signs), Neecha Bhanga (nothing is debilitated), Amala, Saraswati.

STORY: THE JUDGE, THE STRANGER AND THE YOUNG PRINCE IN THE NURSERY. *The fifth room is the children's room and the schoolroom. Devika's has three occupants: the old Judge of Labour (Saturn), sitting stiffly in the King's colours which do not suit him; the Smoke-headed Stranger (Rahu), who speaks of foreign universities and strange new sciences; and the young Prince (Mercury), bright, a little anxious, standing right at the threshold. It is not a warm nursery. But look at who owns it (the King (Sun), who is sitting next door with the exalted Priest) and who is its karaka: that same Priest. The child raised in this room learns discipline from the Judge, ambition from the Stranger and cleverness from the Prince, and inherits the King's and Priest's blessing from across the wall. Hard schooling; good ending.*

Rule: *Read a house's lord and karaka before you judge its occupants; malefics in a house whose lord and karaka are strong give struggle first and success after.*

6. Navamsa (D9) quick read

Planet	D1	D9 sign	D9 house	Comment
Lagna	Aries 7° (movable → from Aries; 3rd part)	Gemini	1	
Sun	Cancer 5° (movable → from Cancer; 2nd part)	Leo	3	● Own sign
Moon	Sagittarius 14° (dual → from Aries; 5th part)	Leo	3	● Friend's sign; with the Sun
Mars	Gemini 27° (dual → from Libra; 9th part)	Gemini	1	● Vargottama, in the D9 Lagna (○ still an enemy's sign)
Mercury	Leo 1° (fixed → from Aries; 1st part)	Aries	11	● Neutral
Jupiter	Cancer 26°	Aquarius	9	● Neutral; the D9 9th
Venus	Gemini 15°	Aquarius	9	● Friend's sign; with Jupiter
Saturn	Leo 18°	Virgo	4	● Friend's sign; a D9 kendra
Rahu	Leo 3°	Aries	11	(none)
Ketu	Aquarius 3°	Libra	5	(none)

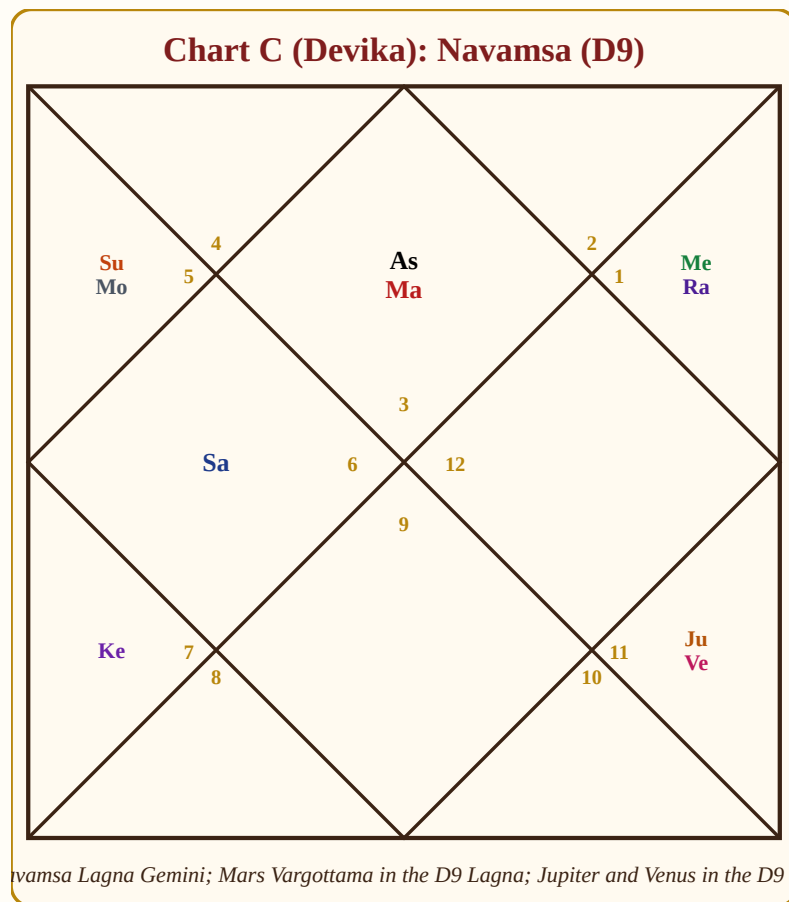


Figure 25.11: Devika's Navamsa. The combust Lagna lord Mars returns as Vargottama in the D9 Lagna, the inner stamina the Rasi chart hides.

What the D9 adds: Mars, so weak in D1, is Vargottama and rises in the D9 Lagna, her constitution recovers better than it looks, and her will outlasts her energy. The Sun in his own sign with the Moon in the D9 3rd, soul and mind in one room, in the King's colours, is inner steadiness. For marriage, the D9 7th is Sagittarius, whose lord Jupiter sits in the D9 9th with Venus: a husband of faith and learning, and a marriage held together by shared principles. Saturn, so awkward in D1, is in a friend's sign in a D9 kendra, the discipline is real underneath.

7. Dasha timeline

The Moon at 14° Sagittarius is in Purva Ashadha, Venus's star, which runs from 13°20' to 26°40'. Balance of Venus at birth = $(26^{\circ}40' - 14^{\circ}) \div 13^{\circ}20' \times 20 \text{ years} = 19.0 \text{ years}$.

Mahadasha	From	To	Age
Venus (balance)	birth	Jul 1998	0–19
Sun	Jul 1998	Jul 2004	19–25
Moon	Jul 2004	Jul 2014	25–35
Mars	Jul 2014	Jul 2021	35–42
Rahu	Jul 2021	Jul 2039	42–60
Jupiter	Jul 2039	Jul 2055	60–76

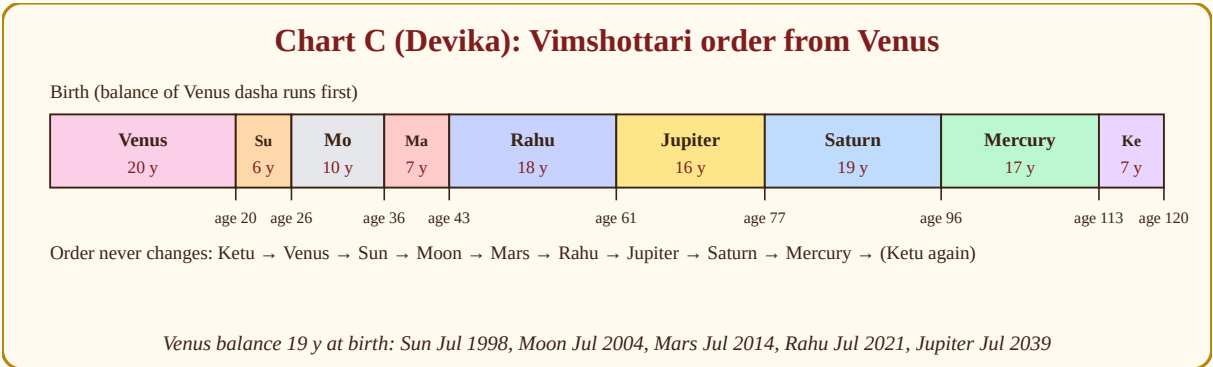


Figure 25.12: The order from Venus. A nineteen-year Venus balance gave her a long, comfortable childhood; Rahu now runs to 2039.

Rahu's sub-periods from July 2021: Rahu–Rahu to Apr 2024; **Rahu–Jupiter Apr 2024–Aug 2026; Rahu–Saturn Aug 2026–Jul 2029**; Rahu–Mercury to Jan 2032; Rahu–Ketu to Feb 2033; Rahu–Venus to Feb 2036; Rahu–Sun to Dec 2036; Rahu–Moon to Jun 2038; Rahu–Mars to Jul 2039.

Past confirmations. Marriage in the Sun–Venus sub-period (Jul 2003–Jul 2004): the 7th lord Venus running inside the Mahadasha of the 5th lord Sun, who sits with Jupiter, the husband-karaka, at 24, in the last year of the Sun's period. A daughter born in Moon–Jupiter (Jun 2007–Oct 2008), after the worry of Moon–Rahu (Dec 2005–Jun 2007) with Rahu in the 5th, delay, then the exalted karaka delivers. The Mars Mahadasha (2014–2021), the combust Lagna lord's period, overlapped almost exactly with her Sade Sati, Saturn through Scorpio, Sagittarius and Capricorn, roughly late 2014 to early 2023, and I would expect a surgery or a serious health episode in Mars–Saturn (Dec 2016–Jan 2018), and the property dispute surfacing around 2020–21 in Mars–Venus and Mars–Sun, when Saturn in Capricorn aspected her 4th house. All of these I would ask as questions.

Now (2026). Rahu–Jupiter until August: the exalted 9th lord's sub-period, the kindest stretch of the whole Rahu era, good for the daughter's admissions and for movement on property. Saturn in Pisces (2025 to about mid-2027) is her 12th house and the

4th from the Moon, a Dhaiya (A.9): home, peace of mind and expenses under pressure for two and a half years. Jupiter in Gemini until mid-2026 sits on her natal Mars and Venus and aspects the 7th, the 9th (her Moon) and the 11th.

The next three to five years. From August 2026, Rahu–Saturn (to July 2029): Saturn in the 5th with Rahu, in an enemy's sign, lord of the 10th and 11th, slow, procedural, paperwork-heavy years that reward patience and punish haste, and that ask for discipline with health. Mid-2026 to mid-2027: Jupiter in Cancer, sitting on her natal Sun and Jupiter in the 4th, a Jupiter return over her strongest house, while Saturn from Pisces aspects the 4th lord Moon in Sagittarius: the double transit falls on the 4th house and its lord. From about mid-2027, Saturn enters Aries, over her Lagna, until about 2030, aspecting the 3rd (Mars, Venus), the 7th and the 10th; Jupiter moves through Leo (mid-2027 to mid-2028), over the 5th-house trio, then Virgo.

8. Her three questions

"My daughter's higher education?" Houses: the 5th (children; Mercury, Saturn, Rahu; lord Sun in the 4th with Jupiter), the 4th and 9th (education; both superb), the 12th (foreign study; lord Jupiter exalted), and Jupiter as karaka. Findings: the daughter's education is carried by the strongest part of her mother's chart; the occupants of the 5th say the field will be analytical and disciplined (Mercury, Saturn) and possibly unconventional or abroad (Rahu), and that the path has delays and paperwork. Timing: until mid-2026, Jupiter aspects the 9th and Saturn's 10th aspect from Pisces also falls on the 9th (a double transit on higher learning, inside Rahu–Jupiter) so the 2026 admission season is favoured. From August 2026 (Rahu–Saturn) things slow: scholarships, visas and paperwork need effort but are not refused. Jupiter over the 5th house in 2027–28 supports the daughter's next step. Tendency: yes, with patience; the field and the place may surprise her.

"The property dispute?" Houses: the 4th (Sun and exalted Jupiter; lord Moon in exchange), the 3rd (siblings; Mars, the land karaka, combust with Venus), the 6th (litigation; lord Mercury in the 5th with Saturn and Rahu), the 8th (inheritance; lord Mars). Findings: her *right* is strong (the 4th house could hardly be better) but her *force* is weak (Mars combust in the house of siblings), and the case itself will be long and technical (the 6th lord with Saturn and Rahu). Tendency: settlement or mediation rather than a courtroom victory, and she keeps her rightful share. Timing: the double transit on the 4th house and its lord, **mid-2026 to mid-2027**, is the resolution window; the Rahu–Saturn sub-period beginning August 2026 says it will conclude slowly, on paper, with lawyers, not in a dramatic hearing. Advice: a good lawyer, a written offer to the siblings in this window, no ultimatums. I never say "you will win"; I say "your position is strong and this is the window to settle from strength."

"My health, and this Rahu period?" Houses: the 1st (lord Mars combust (energy, head, heat), the 6th (lord Mercury in the 5th with Saturn and Rahu) digestion, anxiety, the upper abdomen that Leo governs), the 8th (lord Mars, sudden episodes rather than chronic decline), the 12th (Saturn transiting it, and the Dhaiya). Findings: a body that tires before the will does; digestive and stress-linked complaints in Rahu's period, and a tendency to search the internet at midnight for diagnoses; protection from the exalted Jupiter in the 4th (the chest) with the Sun, and from the Vargottama Mars in the D9. Timing: 2025 to mid-2027 (Saturn in the 12th, Dhaiya from the Moon) asks for routine tests, sleep and a fixed rhythm; from mid-2027 Saturn on the Lagna asks for the disciplined management of anything chronic, joints, teeth, bones. I do not diagnose. I say: "Two check-ups a year, a walk every morning, and let the doctors do the naming."

9. Remedies

- **Jupiter**, 9th lord, exalted, one of the yogakaraka pair, and the karaka for both children and husband; the Rahu era leans on him. The one stone I would recommend: **yellow sapphire (pukhraj)**, gold, index finger, Thursday. Some teachers hesitate because Jupiter also owns her 12th; I weigh the 9th lordship and the exaltation higher.
- **Mars**, the Lagna lord, a functional benefic, but combust and in an enemy's sign. A red coral is the textbook answer and I hesitate, and the reason is the logic of what a stone does: the tradition treats a gem as a lens that lets more of a planet's light through, so it magnifies the planet *as it is*, awkwardness included (everyday parallel: a louder microphone helps a good singer and exposes a nervous one). So: a stone amplifies a planet as it is, and this Mars is awkward. Conduct first

for forty days: Tuesday masoor daan, daily exercise, Hanuman Chalisa, and a *trial* coral only after that, watched for a month.

- ● **Sun**, 5th lord with Jupiter: Sunday Surya Namaskar and the Aditya Hridaya. A ruby is defensible; one stone at a time, and the sapphire comes first.
- ○ **Saturn and Rahu in the 5th**, pacify by conduct: Saturday sesame or mustard-oil daan; service to an elderly person; for Rahu, coconut in flowing water or a blanket given, and a firm rule against shortcuts and second-hand information in the legal matter.
- ○ **Mercury**, 6th lord in the difficult 5th: Wednesday green moong daan; keep the paperwork immaculate.
- ● **Ketu in the 11th**, feed street dogs; accept gains without suspicion.
- **No blue sapphire** (Saturn is a functional malefic for Aries), **no emerald, no diamond**.

FROM LAL KITAB: In the Lal Kitab house-chart, Devika's Saturn and Rahu sit in the 5th house, one of Jupiter's *pakka ghar* (permanent houses). The tradition reads malefics in Jupiter's house as a call to strengthen Jupiter there, and commonly teaches: a saffron or turmeric tilak on the forehead, a small piece of gold kept on the body, feeding and serving cows, avoiding alcohol and meat; for Saturn in the 5th it commonly teaches donating almonds at a temple and bringing half of them home, as commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition; editions differ. (Source: *Lal Kitab*, Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, 1939–1952 Urdu editions; Hindi translations vary.)

10. What I would say in the first two minutes

"Devika-ji, you are an Aries rising (courage, initiative, heat) but the planet that rules your rising sign, Mars, is weakened by the Sun and sits in the house of siblings, so your energy comes in bursts and you spend most of it fighting for other people. Your real strength is in the fourth house: Jupiter exalted, with the Sun, in the room of home, mother and property (one of the great yogas of the tradition) and your Moon in the ninth house has exchanged places with that Jupiter, so your home and your fortune are one account. The difficult corner is the fifth house (Saturn, Rahu and Mercury together) which is children and education: hard schooling, good endings. You are in Rahu's long period; this year's sub-period is the kindest in it, and the next one, from August, will be slower. Let me check three things about your past before we talk about your daughter, the property and your health."

11. Lessons for the student

- A Lagna lord can be combust across a sign boundary; check the Sun's distance in degrees, not the sign.
- An exchange of signs between two lords (Parivartana) is easy to miss when the planets are in different houses; trace the dispositor chain and it jumps out.
- Hamsa and Shakata can sit in the same chart; report both and say which sets the floor.
- The D9 can rescue a planet the D1 condemns: Vargottama Mars here. Never pronounce on health from the Rasi alone.
- Time a property matter to the double transit on the 4th house *and its lord*; time a legal matter to the sub-period lord's nature (Saturn: slow, on paper).

The template

Three charts, one method. Here it is as a card. The shaded rows are where beginners rush.

The eleven-step reading template (photocopy this card)

1	Birth data, chart, planetary table sign · degree · house · nakshatra/pada · dignity · retro/combust
2	Three pillars Lagna + lord · Moon (sign, star, strength) · Sun
3	Functional benefics / malefics from the Lagna table (Ch 8, A.6): the traffic lights
4	House walk 1 → 12 five steps each: house · lord · karaka · same house from Moon · varga
5	Yogas present name them, then ask: are their planets strong enough to deliver?
6	Navamsa (D9) quick read D9 Lagna · Vargottama planets · D9 dignity of the 7th lord and Lagna lord
7	Dasha timeline Mahadasha/Antardasha dates · confirm 2–3 past events · current · next 3–5 years with double transit
8	The client's questions map each to its houses, karaka, lord, dasha; answer as tendency + window
9	Remedies strengthen functional benefics; pacify malefics by conduct/daan; gem only if justified
10	The first two minutes the script: warm, specific, two strengths, one caution, a plan
11	Lessons / log entry what you predicted, the window, when to check

Shaded rows are where beginners rush. Slow down there.

Figure 25.13: The eleven steps. Photocopy it and keep it under the chart until you no longer need to look.

1. **Birth data, chart, planetary table**, sign, degree, house, nakshatra and pada, dignity, retrograde and combustion. Compute; do not copy.
2. **Three pillars**, Lagna and lord, Moon (sign, star, brightness, strength), Sun.
3. **Functional benefics and malefics** for the Lagna (Chapter 8, A.6): the traffic lights.
4. **House walk 1 to 12**, the house, its lord, the karaka, the same house from the Moon, the varga (Chapter 9).
5. **Yogas**, name them, then ask whether their planets can deliver (Chapter 10).
6. **Navamsa quick read**: D9 Lagna, Vargottama planets, D9 dignity of the Lagna lord and the 7th lord (Chapter 11).
7. **Dasha timeline**: Mahadasha and Antardasha dates, two or three past confirmations, the current period, the next three to five years with the double transit (Chapters 13–14).
8. **The client's questions**, houses, lord, karaka, dasha; answer as tendency plus window.
9. **Remedies**, strengthen functional benefics, pacify functional malefics by conduct and daan, a gemstone only when justified (Chapter 23).
10. **The first two minutes**, write the script before the session.
11. **Lessons and the log entry**, what you predicted, the window, when to check.

ANUSHKA'S RULE OF THUMB: If you cannot fill step 7's "past confirmations" line with at least two dated events, you are not ready to fill step 8. Go back to the birth time.

What next

You have reached the end of the book, which is where the astrology begins.

Keep the notebook. Every chart you meet from today (a cousin's, a colleague's, your own) gets a page: the three pillars, one yoga, one prediction with a window. Read the notebook every six months. It is the only teacher that knows your particular mistakes.

Read the classics slowly. Appendix C lists them in order. A verse a day of *Brihat Jataka* or *Phaladeepika*, with a good commentary, checked against a chart you know, will teach you more than a course. Do not read Parashara straight through; read him by topic, when a chart raises the question.

Find a teacher. Not a course, a person. Someone whose charts you can watch being read, who will let you sit at the desk and say your reading first and then correct it. Offer to do their paperwork in exchange. The two people who let me sit beside their desk taught me what the shelf of classics I had failed with could not.

Do a hundred charts, the way Chapter 24 laid out: free and careful, then low-fee with feedback, then specialised. At the hundredth, open the notebook at page one and meet the beginner you were; I still wince at mine. Then start the second hundred.

The sky will keep moving whether or not you look up. The difference an astrologer makes is that someone, somewhere, walks into their Monday morning knowing which way the wind is blowing and what to do about it. That is the whole job. Go and do it kindly.

In one breath

- All three readings follow the same eleven steps: data and table, three pillars, functional nature, house walk, yogas, D9, dasha with confirmations, questions, remedies, script, lessons.
- Compute every position: nakshatra and pada from absolute longitude; combustion from the Sun's distance in degrees (Saturn is combust in Charts A and B, Mars in Chart C); D9 from the movable–fixed–dual rule.
- Meera (Scorpio): Budha-Aditya in the Lagna, Moon strong in the 9th, Venus own-sign in the 12th closing the dispositor chain; Venus's period ends 2027 and the Sun's begins, the launch window for her own practice.
- Arjun (Cancer): the chart rests on a combust Saturn in the 8th; Gaja Kesari and a Mars–Jupiter Raja yoga hold him up; Rahu–Venus now, marriage window late 2026–2028, research abroad favoured mid-2026 to 2028; no Kala Sarpa.
- Devika (Aries): Hamsa, a Sun–Jupiter Raja yoga and a Moon–Jupiter exchange make the 4th house her engine; the combust Lagna lord and the 5th-house trio are the tests; Rahu–Saturn from August 2026 is slow and procedural; the property window is mid-2026 to mid-2027.
- Gems only where a functional benefic needs strength (yellow sapphire for Meera and Devika, red coral for Arjun) and no blue sapphire for any of the three.
- Every answer is a tendency plus a window, and every remedy begins with conduct.

Practice

PRACTICE:

1. Compute the nakshatra and pada of Arjun's Venus (24° Capricorn) and Devika's Jupiter (26° Cancer) from the absolute longitude, and name each nakshatra's lord.
2. Using the A.10 rule, find the Navamsa sign of Meera's Saturn (5° Sagittarius) and Devika's Venus (15° Gemini). Show the counting.
3. In Chart B, Saturn is the 7th lord and Venus occupies the 7th. Write two sentences on marriage for Arjun that use both facts and neither the word "delay" nor the word "dosha".
4. Devika's Rahu–Saturn sub-period begins in August 2026. Compute its length from the A.8 formula and its end date, then write one hedged sentence about the property matter for that period.
5. Take a fourth chart (your own or a friend's) and fill the eleven-step template on one page. Time yourself. Under ninety minutes is the goal by the end of your first hundred charts.

Answers

1. Venus 24° Capricorn: absolute longitude $(10 - 1) \times 30 + 24 = 294^\circ$; $294 \div 13.333 = 22.05 \rightarrow$ the 23rd nakshatra, Dhanishta (Mars); $294 - 293.33 = 0.67^\circ$ into it $\rightarrow$ pada 1. Jupiter 26° Cancer: $(4 - 1) \times 30 + 26 = 116^\circ$; $116 \div 13.333 = 8.7 \rightarrow$ the 9th nakshatra, Ashlesha (Mercury); $116 - 106.67 = 9.33^\circ \rightarrow 9.33 \div 3.333 = 2.8 \rightarrow$ pada 3. 2. Saturn 5° Sagittarius: Sagittarius is dual, so count from the 5th sign from it, Aries; $5^\circ \div 3^\circ 20' = 1.5 \rightarrow$ the 2nd part $\rightarrow$ Aries + 1 = Taurus. Venus 15° Gemini: dual, count from Libra; $15 \div 3.333 = 4.5 \rightarrow$ the 5th part $\rightarrow$ Libra + 4 = Aquarius. 3. For example: "Your 7th house is ruled by Saturn, who sits weakened in your 8th, so marriage in your chart matures slowly and asks for patience with paperwork and family process. Venus herself lives in that 7th house in a friendly sign, and you are in her sub-period now, which is why the coming two years are the most supportive for it that you have had." 4. Rahu $18 \times$ Saturn $19 \div 120 = 2.85$ years = 2 years 10 months 6 days; from late August 2026 that ends about the start of July 2029. "During Saturn's sub-period the property matter tends to move slowly and on paper (mediation and documents rather than hearings) so this is a period to settle patiently from a position of strength rather than to expect a quick result." 5. Your own work. Keep the page; it is the first entry in the second half of your notebook.

Appendix A: Quick Reference Tables

Every number and rule in this book agrees with the tables here. When in doubt at a consultation, open this page. Values follow *Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra* (BPHS) and the mainstream Indian teaching tradition unless a note says otherwise.

A.1 The twelve signs (Rashis)

#	Sign	Sanskrit	Lord	Element (Tattva)	Quality	Gender	Body part (Kala Purusha)	Symbol
1	Aries	Mesha	Mars	Fire	Movable (Chara)	Male	Head	Ram
2	Taurus	Vrishabha	Venus	Earth	Fixed (Sthira)	Female	Face, neck, throat	Bull
3	Gemini	Mithuna	Mercury	Air	Dual (Dwiswabhava)	Male	Shoulders, arms, lungs	Couple
4	Cancer	Karka	Moon	Water	Movable	Female	Chest, heart, breasts	Crab
5	Leo	Simha	Sun	Fire	Fixed	Male	Upper abdomen, stomach	Lion
6	Virgo	Kanya	Mercury	Earth	Dual	Female	Intestines, lower abdomen	Maiden
7	Libra	Tula	Venus	Air	Movable	Male	Kidneys, lower back, waist	Scales
8	Scorpio	Vrishchika	Mars	Water	Fixed	Female	Genitals, excretory organs	Scorpion
9	Sagittarius	Dhanu	Jupiter	Fire	Dual	Male	Hips, thighs	Archer
10	Capricorn	Makara	Saturn	Earth	Movable	Female	Knees	Crocodile
11	Aquarius	Kumbha	Saturn	Air	Fixed	Male	Calves, shins, ankles	Water-pot
12	Pisces	Meena	Jupiter	Water	Dual	Female	Feet	Fishes

Directions: Fire signs = East, Earth = South, Air = West, Water = North. Odd signs (1,3,5,7,9,11) are male/active; even signs are female/receptive.

A.2 The nine planets (Grahas)

Planet	Sanskrit	Nature	Karakatwa (what it signifies)	Own signs	Exaltation (deepest point)	Debilitation (deepest point)	Moolatrikona
Sun	Surya	Cruel malefic (mild)	Soul, father, authority, government, health, bones, right eye, ego, king	Leo	Aries 10°	Libra 10°	Leo 0°–20°
Moon	Chandra	Benefic when waxing (bright), malefic when waning (dark)	Mind, mother, emotions, public, fluids, nourishment, left eye, queen	Cancer	Taurus 3°	Scorpio 3°	Taurus 3°–30° (some texts 4°–20°)
Mars	Mangala / Kuja	Malefic	Energy, courage, younger siblings, land, property, blood, muscles, surgery, army/police, commander	Aries, Scorpio	Capricorn 28°	Cancer 28°	Aries 0°–12°
Mercury	Budha	Benefic when alone/with benefics; malefic with malefics	Intellect, speech, communication, trade, mathematics, nerves, skin, maternal uncle, prince	Gemini, Virgo	Virgo 15°	Pisces 15°	Virgo 16°–20°
Jupiter	Guru / Brihaspati	Great benefic	Wisdom, guru, children, wealth, dharma, husband (in a woman's chart), liver, fat, minister	Sagittarius, Pisces	Cancer 5°	Capricorn 5°	Sagittarius 0°–10°
Venus	Shukra	Benefic	Love, marriage, wife (in a man's chart), beauty, luxury, arts, vehicles, reproductive system, minister	Taurus, Libra	Pisces 27°	Virgo 27°	Libra 0°–15°
Saturn	Shani	Great malefic	Longevity, discipline, sorrow, labour, servants, delay, chronic disease, old age, bones/teeth/nerves, servant	Capricorn, Aquarius	Libra 20°	Aries 20°	Aquarius 0°–20°
Rahu	Rahu (north node)	Malefic (shadow)	Obsession, foreigners, technology, illusion, sudden rise, paternal grandfather, poison, smoke	none (behaves like Saturn)	Taurus (some say Gemini)	Scorpio (some say Sagittarius)	none
Ketu	Ketu (south node)	Malefic (shadow)	Detachment, moksha, past-life skills, occult, sudden loss, maternal	none (behaves like Mars)	Scorpio (some say Sagittarius)	Taurus (some say Gemini)	none

Planet	Sanskrit	Nature	Karakatwa (what it signifies)	Own signs	Exaltation (deepest point)	Debilitation (deepest point)	Moolatrikona
			grandfather, wounds, spirituality				

Rahu and Ketu are not physical bodies; they are the two points where the Moon's orbit crosses the Sun's path (the lunar nodes). They are always exactly opposite each other and move backwards (retrograde) through the zodiac.

Directional strength (Dig Bala): Jupiter and Mercury are strongest in the 1st house; Moon and Venus in the 4th; Saturn in the 7th; Sun and Mars in the 10th.

Speed through the zodiac (approx.): Moon 2¼ days per sign (27.3 days round); Sun, Mercury, Venus about 1 month per sign (1 year round); Mars about 45 days per sign (~2 years round); Jupiter about 1 year per sign (~12 years); Saturn about 2½ years per sign (~29.5 years); Rahu/Ketu about 18 months per sign (~18.6 years), moving backwards.

Combustion (Asta), when a planet is too close to the Sun and loses strength (approximate orbs): Moon 12°, Mars 17°, Mercury 14° (12° when retrograde), Jupiter 11°, Venus 10° (8° when retrograde), Saturn 15°. Rahu and Ketu are never combust.

A.3 Natural friendship (Naisargika Maitri)

Planet	Friends	Neutral	Enemies
Sun	Moon, Mars, Jupiter	Mercury	Venus, Saturn
Moon	Sun, Mercury	Mars, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn	(none)
Mars	Sun, Moon, Jupiter	Venus, Saturn	Mercury
Mercury	Sun, Venus	Mars, Jupiter, Saturn	Moon
Jupiter	Sun, Moon, Mars	Saturn	Mercury, Venus
Venus	Mercury, Saturn	Mars, Jupiter	Sun, Moon
Saturn	Mercury, Venus	Jupiter	Sun, Moon, Mars

Rahu and Ketu are not in Parashara's table. Mainstream practice: Rahu is friendly to Venus, Saturn, Mercury; hostile to Sun, Moon, Mars. Ketu is friendly to Mars, Venus, Saturn; hostile to Moon and Sun. (Sources vary; treat as a working convention.)

Temporary friendship (Tatkalika Maitri): planets in the 2nd, 3rd, 4th, 10th, 11th, 12th from a planet are its temporary friends; those in 1st, 5th, 6th, 7th, 8th, 9th are temporary enemies. Combine natural + temporary → five-fold relationship (Panchadha Maitri): great friend, friend, neutral, enemy, great enemy.

A.4 Aspects (Drishti), Parashari

Planet	Full aspect on houses counted from itself
Sun, Moon, Mercury, Venus, Rahu, Ketu	7th only
Mars	4th, 7th, 8th
Jupiter	5th, 7th, 9th
Saturn	3rd, 7th, 10th

Partial aspects (used in Shadbala): $\frac{3}{4}$ on 5th and 9th, $\frac{1}{2}$ on 4th and 8th, $\frac{1}{4}$ on 3rd and 10th, for all planets. Rahu/Ketu aspects are not in BPHS; many practitioners give them Jupiter's 5/7/9 pattern or Saturn's. Say so if you use it.

A.5 The twelve houses (Bhavas)

House	Sanskrit name	Core meanings	Body	Natural karaka
1	Tanu (body)	Self, body, appearance, health, temperament, start of life, fame	Head	Sun
2	Dhana (wealth)	Wealth, savings, speech, food, family, face, early education, right eye	Face, mouth	Jupiter
3	Sahaja (siblings)	Younger siblings, courage, effort, short journeys, communication, hobbies, arms, hearing (right ear)	Arms, ears	Mars
4	Sukha / Bandhu (happiness)	Mother, home, land, vehicles, comforts, formal education, heart, inner peace	Chest	Moon, Mercury
5	Putra (children)	Children, intelligence, creativity, past-life merit (Poorva Punya), romance, mantra, speculation	Stomach, upper belly	Jupiter
6	Ari / Ripu (enemies)	Enemies, disease, debts, service/jobs, competition, litigation, maternal uncle, pets	Intestines	Mars, Saturn
7	Kalatra / Yuvati (spouse)	Spouse, marriage, partnerships, business, sexual life, travel, the public	Lower belly, pelvis	Venus
8	Randhra / Ayu (longevity)	Longevity, death, transformation, inheritance, insurance, hidden things, occult, chronic disease, sudden events, in-laws	Genitals, excretion	Saturn
9	Dharma / Bhagya (fortune)	Fortune, father, guru, religion, higher learning, long journeys, philosophy, grace	Thighs, hips	Jupiter, Sun
10	Karma (career)	Career, profession, status, authority, government, fame from work, father (some schools)	Knees	Sun, Mercury, Jupiter, Saturn
11	Labha (gains)	Gains, income, elder siblings, friends, networks, fulfilment of wishes	Calves, shins	Jupiter
12	Vyaya (loss)	Expenses, losses, sleep, bed pleasures, foreign lands, hospitals, isolation, liberation (moksha), left eye	Feet	Saturn

House groups

Group	Houses	Sense
Kendra (angles)	1, 4, 7, 10	Pillars of life; Vishnu's houses; planets here act strongly
Trikona (trines)	1, 5, 9	Lakshmi's houses; merit, fortune, wisdom
Dusthana / Trik (difficult)	6, 8, 12	Struggle, hidden, loss; lords here are functional malefics
Upachaya (growing)	3, 6, 10, 11	Improve with time and effort; malefics do well here
Panapara	2, 5, 8, 11	Medium strength
Apoklima	3, 6, 9, 12	Weaker positions (except 9th)
Maraka (killer)	2, 7	Their lords and occupants can end life or health in their periods
Trishadaya	3, 6, 11	Lords of these become malefic (BPHS)
Chaturasra	4, 8	Square houses
Moksha trikona	4, 8, 12	Water houses; emotion, transformation, release
Artha trikona	2, 6, 10	Earth houses; wealth, work
Kama trikona	3, 7, 11	Air houses; desire, relationship
Dharma trikona	1, 5, 9	Fire houses; purpose

Bhavat Bhavam: the n th house from the n th house is a second signal for that matter (e.g., 4th from 4th = 7th also shows mother's wellbeing; 10th from 10th = 7th also shows career).

A.6 Functional benefics and malefics by Lagna (BPHS)

Parashara's rules: lords of trikonas (1, 5, 9) are benefic; lords of 3, 6, 11 are malefic; lords of kendras (4, 7, 10) become neutral (a natural benefic owning a kendra loses its benevolence, a natural malefic owning a kendra loses its malevolence); lords of 2, 8, 12 go by their other sign; the 8th lord is generally bad unless it also owns the Lagna. The summary below is the working table most Indian teachers use. The Lagna lord is treated as benefic in practice even when it also owns a difficult house.

Lagna	Benefics	Malefics	Neutral / mixed	Yogakaraka (single planet giving rajayoga)	Marakas to watch
Aries	Sun, Mars, Jupiter	Mercury, Venus, Saturn	Moon	(Sun + Jupiter together act as yogakarakas)	Venus, Mercury
Taurus	Saturn, Sun, Mercury	Moon, Jupiter, Mars	Venus (own lagna but 6th lord)	Saturn	Jupiter, Venus, Mars
Gemini	Venus, Saturn, Mercury	Mars, Jupiter, Sun	Moon	(Venus + Saturn combination)	Moon, Jupiter
Cancer	Mars, Jupiter, Moon	Venus, Mercury	Sun, Saturn	Mars	Saturn, Venus
Leo	Mars, Jupiter, Sun	Mercury, Venus, Saturn	Moon	Mars	Saturn, Mercury
Virgo	Venus, Mercury	Mars, Jupiter, Moon	Sun, Saturn	Venus	Venus, Jupiter
Libra	Saturn, Mercury, Venus	Jupiter, Sun, Mars	Moon	Saturn (Moon + Mercury together too)	Mars, Jupiter
Scorpio	Jupiter, Moon, Sun, Mars	Mercury, Venus, Saturn	(none)	(Sun + Moon together)	Venus, Mercury
Sagittarius	Sun, Mars, Jupiter	Venus, Saturn	Mercury, Moon	(Sun + Mercury together)	Saturn, Venus
Capricorn	Venus, Mercury, Saturn	Mars, Jupiter, Moon	Sun	Venus	Mars, Moon
Aquarius	Venus, Saturn	Jupiter, Moon, Mars	Mercury, Sun	Venus	Jupiter, Sun, Mars
Pisces	Mars, Moon, Jupiter	Saturn, Venus, Sun, Mercury	(none)	(Mars + Jupiter together)	Mercury, Saturn

A.7 The 27 Nakshatras (lunar mansions)

Each nakshatra spans 13°20' and has four quarters (padas) of 3°20'. Vimshottari dasha lords repeat in the order Ketu, Venus, Sun, Moon, Mars, Rahu, Jupiter, Saturn, Mercury.

#	Nakshatra	Span	Lord (dasha yrs)	Deity	Symbol	Gana	Keyword
1	Ashwini	0°00' Ar – 13°20' Ar	Ketu (7)	Ashwini Kumaras	Horse's head	Deva	Speed, healing
2	Bharani	13°20' – 26°40' Ar	Venus (20)	Yama	Yoni (womb)	Manushya	Bearing burdens, birth/death
3	Krittika	26°40' Ar – 10°00' Ta	Sun (6)	Agni	Razor, flame	Rakshasa	Sharpness, purification
4	Rohini	10°00' – 23°20' Ta	Moon (10)	Brahma / Prajapati	Ox-cart, chariot	Manushya	Growth, beauty, fertility
5	Mrigashira	23°20' Ta – 6°40' Ge	Mars (7)	Soma	Deer's head	Deva	Searching, curiosity
6	Ardra	6°40' – 20°00' Ge	Rahu (18)	Rudra	Teardrop, gem	Manushya	Storms, effort, breakthroughs
7	Punarvasu	20°00' Ge – 3°20' Cn	Jupiter (16)	Aditi	Bow and quiver	Deva	Return of light, renewal
8	Pushya	3°20' – 16°40' Cn	Saturn (19)	Brihaspati	Cow's udder, lotus	Deva	Nourishment; most auspicious
9	Ashlesha	16°40' – 30°00' Cn	Mercury (17)	Nagas (serpents)	Coiled serpent	Rakshasa	Clinging, hypnotic, shrewd
10	Magha	0°00' – 13°20' Le	Ketu (7)	Pitris (ancestors)	Throne, palanquin	Rakshasa	Lineage, authority
11	Purva Phalguni	13°20' – 26°40' Le	Venus (20)	Bhaga	Front legs of a bed	Manushya	Pleasure, creativity, rest
12	Uttara Phalguni	26°40' Le – 10°00' Vi	Sun (6)	Aryaman	Back legs of a bed	Manushya	Contracts, friendship, patronage
13	Hasta	10°00' – 23°20' Vi	Moon (10)	Savitar	Hand	Deva	Skill, craft, humour
14	Chitra	23°20' Vi – 6°40' Li	Mars (7)	Tvashtar / Vishwakarma	Pearl, bright jewel	Rakshasa	Design, architecture, glamour
15	Swati	6°40' – 20°00' Li	Rahu (18)	Vayu	Young sprout swaying in wind	Deva	Independence, trade
16	Vishakha	20°00' Li – 3°20' Sc	Jupiter (16)	Indra–Agni	Triumphal arch, potter's wheel	Rakshasa	Goal focus, ambition
17	Anuradha	3°20' – 16°40' Sc	Saturn (19)	Mitra	Lotus, archway	Deva	Devotion, friendship in hardship
18	Jyeshtha	16°40' – 30°00' Sc	Mercury (17)	Indra	Earring, umbrella, talisman	Rakshasa	Seniority, protection

#	Nakshatra	Span	Lord (dasha yrs)	Deity	Symbol	Gana	Keyword
19	Mula	0°00' – 13°20' Sg	Ketu (7)	Nirriti	Bundle of roots, lion's tail	Rakshasa	Uprooting, research
20	Purva Ashadha	13°20' – 26°40' Sg	Venus (20)	Apas (waters)	Fan, winnowing basket, tusk	Manushya	Invincibility, purification
21	Uttara Ashadha	26°40' Sg – 10°00' Cp	Sun (6)	Vishwadevas	Elephant tusk, planks of a bed	Manushya	Final victory, leadership
22	Shravana	10°00' – 23°20' Cp	Moon (10)	Vishnu	Ear, three footprints	Deva	Listening, learning, fame
23	Dhanishta	23°20' Cp – 6°40' Aq	Mars (7)	Eight Vasus	Drum, flute	Rakshasa	Wealth, rhythm, music
24	Shatabhisha	6°40' – 20°00' Aq	Rahu (18)	Varuna	Empty circle, 100 flowers/healers	Rakshasa	Healing, secrecy, science
25	Purva Bhadrapada	20°00' Aq – 3°20' Pi	Jupiter (16)	Aja Ekapada	Sword, front legs of funeral cot	Manushya	Intensity, penance
26	Uttara Bhadrapada	3°20' – 16°40' Pi	Saturn (19)	Ahir Budhnya	Back legs of funeral cot, serpent of the deep	Manushya	Depth, wisdom, patience
27	Revati	16°40' – 30°00' Pi	Mercury (17)	Pushan	Fish, drum	Deva	Nourishing journeys, completion

Gandanta (knots): the last 3°20' of Ashlesha/Jyeshtha/Revati and the first 3°20' of Magha/Mula/Ashwini: the water-to-fire junctions. Considered sensitive; check the Moon and Lagna here. **Abhijit:** a 28th "nakshatra" (the last quarter of Uttara Ashadha plus the first sliver of Shravana, about 4 ghatīs or 0°53') used in muhurta, not in dasha.

A.8 Vimshottari Dasha

Lord	Years	Lord	Years	Lord	Years
Ketu	7	Venus	20	Sun	6
Moon	10	Mars	7	Rahu	18
Jupiter	16	Saturn	19	Mercury	17

Total = 120 years. Starting dasha = lord of the Moon's nakshatra at birth. Balance at birth = (portion of the nakshatra still to be traversed ÷ 13°20') × lord's years. Sub-period (Antardasha) of planet B inside Mahadasha A = (years of A × years of B) ÷ 120, in years; sub-periods run in dasha order beginning with the Mahadasha lord itself. Handy conversion: 1 year = 12 months; multiply the fraction of a year by 12 for months, ×30 for days.

Sub-period lengths for common lookups (years-months-days): Saturn/Saturn 3-0-3; Saturn/Mercury 2-8-9; Saturn/Ketu 1-1-9; Saturn/Venus 3-2-0; Rahu/Rahu 2-8-12; Rahu/Jupiter 2-4-24; Rahu/Saturn 2-10-6; Jupiter/Jupiter 2-1-18; Jupiter/Saturn 2-6-12; Venus/Venus 3-4-0; Venus/Sun 1-0-0; Mercury/Mercury 2-4-27.

A.9 Transits (Gochar)

Good houses from the natal Moon (classical): Sun 3, 6, 10, 11 · Moon 1, 3, 6, 7, 10, 11 · Mars 3, 6, 11 · Mercury 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 11 · Jupiter 2, 5, 7, 9, 11 · Venus 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 8, 9, 11, 12 · Saturn 3, 6, 11 · Rahu/Ketu 3, 6, 11 (by common practice).

Sade Sati: Saturn transiting the 12th, 1st and 2nd signs from the natal Moon, about 7½ years in all (three phases of about 2½ years). **Dhaiya / Kantaka / Ashtama Shani:** Saturn transiting the 4th or the 8th from the Moon, about 2½ years.

Moorti Nirnaya (quality of a transit): at the moment a planet enters a new sign, count the transiting Moon's sign from the natal Moon: 1, 6, 11 → gold (Swarna, best); 2, 5, 9 → silver (Rajata, good); 3, 7, 10 → copper (Tamra, mixed); 4, 8, 12 → iron (Loha, difficult).

A.10 Divisional charts (Vargas)

Chart	Division	Primary use
D1 Rasi	30°	Everything; the body of the horoscope
D2 Hora	15°	Wealth
D3 Drekkana	10°	Siblings, courage, nature of death
D4 Chaturthamsa	7°30'	Property, fixed assets, fortune
D7 Saptamsa	4°17'	Children, progeny
D9 Navamsa	3°20'	Marriage, dharma, inner strength of planets; the most important varga
D10 Dasamsa	3°	Career, public life
D12 Dwadasamsa	2°30'	Parents, lineage
D16 Shodasamsa	1°52'30"	Vehicles, comforts
D20 Vimsamsa	1°30'	Spiritual life, worship
D24 Chaturvimsamsa	1°15'	Education, learning
D27 Bhamsa	1°6'40"	Strengths and weaknesses
D30 Trimsamsa	1°	Misfortunes, character, disease
D60 Shashtiamsa	0°30'	Past-life karma; used to separate twins

Navamsa (D9) rule: divide each sign into 9 parts of 3°20'. For a movable sign, counting begins from the same sign; for a fixed sign, from the 9th sign from it; for a dual sign, from the 5th sign from it. A planet in the same sign in D1 and D9 is **Vargottama** (extra strong).

A.11 Named yogas (quick list)

Yoga	Formation	Result
Panch Mahapurusha: Ruchaka / Bhadra / Hamsa / Malavya / Shasha	Mars / Mercury / Jupiter / Venus / Saturn in own or exalted sign in a kendra from Lagna	Powerful personality in that planet's field
Gaja Kesari	Jupiter in a kendra from the Moon	Fame, wisdom, protection
Budha–Aditya	Sun + Mercury together (Mercury not combust)	Intelligence, articulation
Chandra–Mangala	Moon + Mars together or in mutual 7th	Earning capacity, drive
Raja yoga	Lords of a kendra and a trikona together, in mutual aspect, or exchanging signs	Rise in status
Dhana yoga	Lords of 2, 5, 9, 11 (and Lagna) connected	Wealth
Viparita Raja: Harsha / Sarala / Vimala	6th / 8th / 12th lord placed in another of 6, 8, 12 (and not with other lords)	Sudden gains from others' losses, resilience
Neecha Bhanga	Debilitated planet with its sign lord or exaltation lord in a kendra from Lagna/Moon, or the debilitated planet itself in a kendra from the Moon, or exchanging signs with its dispositor	Debility cancelled; may produce late strength
Parivartana (exchange)	Two lords sitting in each other's signs	The two houses fuse; results depend on the houses (Maha, Khala, Dainya types)
Kemadruma	No planet (except Sun, Rahu, Ketu) in the 2nd or 12th from the Moon	Loneliness, struggle; cancelled by planets in kendras from Moon/Lagna
Adhi yoga	Benefics in 6th, 7th, 8th from the Moon	Leadership, prosperity
Kala Sarpa	All seven planets hemmed between Rahu and Ketu	Fated, karmic life pattern (not in BPHS; popular teaching)
Kuja (Mangal) dosha	Mars in 1, 2, 4, 7, 8 or 12 from Lagna (also check from Moon and Venus)	Friction in marriage; many cancellations apply
Shakata	Jupiter in 6th, 8th or 12th from the Moon	Ups and downs in fortune
Amala	A benefic alone in the 10th from Lagna or Moon	Spotless reputation
Saraswati	Jupiter, Venus, Mercury in kendra/trikona/2nd, Jupiter strong	Learning, arts
Lakshmi	9th lord strong in kendra/own/exalted, Lagna lord strong	Wealth and grace

A.12 Marriage matching: Ashtakoota (36 points)

Koota	Points	Tests
Varna	1	Spiritual compatibility / ego
Vashya	2	Mutual attraction, control
Tara	3	Birth-star compatibility, health
Yoni	4	Sexual/instinctive compatibility
Graha Maitri	5	Friendship of Moon-sign lords, mental rapport
Gana	6	Temperament (Deva / Manushya / Rakshasa)
Bhakoot	7	Moon-sign distance; family welfare, finances
Nadi	8	Health, progeny (Adi / Madhya / Antya)

Below 18 = not recommended; 18–24 = acceptable; 25–32 = good; 33–36 = excellent. Always read the full charts (7th house, Venus/Jupiter, Navamsa, dasha); the points are only the first sieve.

A.13 Remedies: gemstones, mantras, days

Planet	Gemstone (Hindi)	Metal & finger (common)	Weekday	Beeja mantra	Classical japa count	Donation (daan)
Sun	Ruby (Manikya)	Gold/copper, ring finger	Sunday	Om Hraam Hreem Hraum Sah Suryaya Namah	7,000	Wheat, jaggery, copper, red cloth
Moon	Pearl (Moti)	Silver, little finger	Monday	Om Shraam Shreem Shraum Sah Chandraya Namah	11,000	Rice, milk, white cloth, silver
Mars	Red coral (Moonga)	Gold/copper, ring finger	Tuesday	Om Kraam Kreem Kraum Sah Bhaumaya Namah	10,000	Red lentils (masoor), red cloth, copper
Mercury	Emerald (Panna)	Gold, little finger	Wednesday	Om Braam Breem Braum Sah Budhaya Namah	9,000 (some 17,000)	Green moong, green cloth, books
Jupiter	Yellow sapphire (Pukhraj)	Gold, index finger	Thursday	Om Graam Greem Graum Sah Gurave Namah	19,000	Chana dal, turmeric, yellow cloth, books
Venus	Diamond (Heera) / white sapphire	Silver/platinum, middle finger (some: ring)	Friday	Om Draam Dreem Draum Sah Shukraya Namah	16,000	Curd, ghee, rice, white cloth, perfume
Saturn	Blue sapphire (Neelam)	Silver/panchdhatu/iron, middle finger	Saturday	Om Praam Preem Praum Sah Shanaye Namah	23,000	Black sesame, mustard oil, iron, black cloth
Rahu	Hessonite (Gomed)	Silver/panchdhatu, middle finger	Saturday (some: Wednesday)	Om Bhraam Bhreem Bhraum Sah Rahave Namah	18,000	Coconut, blue cloth, mustard, blanket
Ketu	Cat's eye (Lehsunia)	Silver/panchdhatu, ring or little finger	Tuesday/Thursday	Om Sraam Sreem Sraum Sah Ketave Namah	17,000	Blanket, sesame, multi-coloured cloth, feeding dogs

Gemstones are prescribed **only** for functional benefics that need strength, never to "pacify" a functional malefic (a stone strengthens; it does not pacify). Japa counts are the classical figures; the tradition multiplies by four in Kali Yuga.

A.14 Panchanga: the five limbs of the day

Limb	Meaning	Count
Tithi	Lunar day (Sun–Moon angle in 12° steps)	30 per lunar month (15 Shukla bright + 15 Krishna dark)
Vara	Weekday (planetary lord)	7
Nakshatra	Moon's lunar mansion	27
Yoga	Sun + Moon longitude in 13°20' steps	27
Karana	Half a tithi	11 kinds, 60 per month

Rahu Kaal (approximate 1½-hour slot, from sunrise): Mon 7:30–9, Tue 3–4:30 pm, Wed 12–1:30, Thu 1:30–3, Fri 10:30–12, Sat 9–10:30, Sun 4:30–6 pm (adjust to the actual day length by dividing daylight into eight equal parts).

A.15 Lal Kitab: reference facts (attributed)

(Source: *Lal Kitab*, Pt. Roop Chand Joshi, five Urdu volumes 1939, 1940, 1941, 1942 and 1952; Hindi translations vary. Use only inside "From Lal Kitab" boxes.)

- The Lal Kitab chart keeps the **houses fixed**: house 1 is always treated as Aries, house 2 as Taurus, and so on. Signs are not read separately; planets are placed by house.
- **Pakka ghar (permanent houses)**: Sun 1; Moon 4; Mars 3 and 8; Mercury 7 (teachers differ: some editions give 6 and 8); Jupiter 2, 5, 9, 11 (12 in some editions); Venus 7; Saturn 8 and 10; Rahu 12; Ketu 6.
- Rahu and Ketu are treated as full planets; Mars has two forms, **Mangal Nek** (benefic) and **Mangal Bad** (malefic).
- A house with no planet, or a planet whose result is not "awake", is called **sleeping** (*soya hua ghar / soya hua grah*); it gives results only when activated by transit or related planets. Precise rules differ between editions.
- **Rin (karmic debts)**: the tradition lists debts such as self-debt (*swayam rin*), ancestral debt (*pitru rin*), mother's debt (*matru rin*), sibling debt, spouse debt, daughter/sister debt, and divine debt, each read from particular planets in particular houses, and each with a collective family remedy. Placement rules vary by edition: verify against the edition you use.
- **Varshphal**: the annual chart follows a **35-year cycle** in which each year is ruled by a planet according to a fixed table.
- **Remedy (upay) principles**: simple household items, low cost; done for **40 or 43 consecutive days** (restart if a day is missed); never harm another being; not to be used for selfish gain against others; remedies do not replace right conduct.

Appendix B: Glossary (Sanskrit to Plain English)

Every technical word used in this book, in alphabetical order, with the plain-English meaning first and the chapter that treats it in brackets. Alternative spellings you will meet in other books and apps are given after the term. When a definition here seems to disagree with something you read elsewhere, remember that spellings and even meanings drift between schools; Appendix A holds the numbers this book uses.

Before the alphabet, the cast. Every story in this book uses the same nine characters, and the glossary is easier to read if you have them in mind.

STORY: THE COURT IN ONE PARAGRAPH. A King (Sun) rules a kingdom of twelve districts (the signs) from a haveli of twelve rooms (the houses). His Queen Mother (Moon) runs the household and its moods. His Commander (Mars) guards the borders and loses his temper. His clever young Prince and secretary (Mercury) writes the letters and counts the money. Guru-ji, the Royal Priest and Minister (Jupiter), advises, blesses and teaches. Shukracharya, the Minister of Arts and Pleasure (Venus), keeps the court beautiful and the King distracted. Old Shani-ji, once a servant and now the Judge of Labour (Saturn), moves slowly and forgets nothing. At the gate stand a Smoke-headed Stranger (Rahu), hungry for everything, and a Headless Sadhu (Ketu), hungry for nothing. Royal Party: King, Queen Mother, Commander, Priest. People's Party: Prince, Minister of Pleasure, Judge. The streets of the districts are the nakshatras; the railway timetable that says when each courtier's turn comes is the dasha. **Rule:** Planet = who; sign = how (which district); house = where (which room); nakshatra = which street; dasha = when.

Planet	Character in the stories	Natural nature	Party
Sun	The King (Raja)	○ Mild malefic	Royal
Moon	The Queen Mother (Rani Ma)	● Benefic when bright, ○ malefic when dark	Royal
Mars	The Commander (Senapati)	○ Malefic	Royal
Mercury	The young Prince / Secretary (Rajkumar)	● Takes the nature of its company	People's
Jupiter	The Royal Priest and Minister (Guru-ji)	● Great benefic	Royal
Venus	The Minister of Arts and Pleasure (Shukracharya)	● Benefic	People's
Saturn	The old Judge of Labour (Shani-ji)	○ Great malefic	People's
Rahu	The Smoke-headed Stranger at the gate	○ Shadow malefic	Sits with the People's Party
Ketu	The Headless Sadhu	○ Shadow malefic	Sits with the People's Party

Colour dots throughout the book: ● benefic, friend or good; ○ malefic, enemy or difficult; ● neutral or mixed. In the chart diagrams the planets keep fixed colours: the Sun orange, the Moon grey, Mars red, Mercury green, Jupiter gold, Venus pink, Saturn navy, Rahu and Ketu purple.

A

- **Abhijit**: A 28th "star" used only for choosing auspicious times: the last quarter of Uttara Ashadha plus the first 4° of Shravana. Not used in dashas. (Ch 16)
- **Adhi yoga**: Benefic planets in the 6th, 7th and 8th houses counted from the Moon; a combination for leadership and prosperity. (Ch 10)
- **Amala yoga**: A single benefic planet alone in the 10th house from the Lagna or the Moon; a spotless reputation. (Ch 10)
- **Amanta / Purnimanta**: Two ways of ending the lunar month: at the new moon (Amanta, used in the south and west of India) or at the full moon (Purnimanta, used in the north). The same festival can fall in differently named months. (Ch 16)
- **Amatyakaraka (AmK)**: In Jaimini's method, the planet with the second-highest degree in any sign; the "minister", read for career. (Ch 15)
- **Amavasya**: The new-moon day, when the Sun and Moon share the same degree; the last day of the dark fortnight. (Ch 16)
- **Andha graha**: "Blind planet": a Lal Kitab term for a planet placed where it cannot act on its own matters. Rules vary by edition. (Ch 22)
- **Antardasha (Bhukti)**: A sub-period inside a major planetary period; each Mahadasha is divided into nine Antardashas in fixed proportion. (Ch 13)
- **Apoklima**: The 3rd, 6th, 9th and 12th houses, traditionally the weaker "cadent" positions (the 9th excepted). (Ch 4)
- **Arudha (Arudha Lagna, AL)**: In Jaimini's method, the image or reflection of a house: count from a house to its lord, then the same distance again. Shows how the world sees you rather than what you are. (Ch 15)
- **Ashtakavarga**: A point-scoring system giving every sign a score of 0–8 for each planet, based on where the seven planets and Lagna stand; used to judge transits and strength. (Ch 12)
- **Ashtakoota**: The eight-part, 36-point compatibility test for marriage, comparing the two Moons. (Ch 19)
- **Ashtama Shani**: Saturn transiting the 8th sign from the natal Moon, about 2½ years of heaviness. (Ch 14)
- **Ashtottari dasha**: A 108-year conditional dasha system used by some schools when Rahu is in a kendra or trikona from the Lagna lord. (Ch 15)
- **Asta (combustion)**: A planet so close to the Sun (within a set number of degrees) that it is "burnt" and loses strength. Orbs are in Appendix A.2. (Ch 3, 12)
- **Atmakaraka (AK)**: In Jaimini's method, the planet with the highest degree in its sign; the "soul planet", the chart's chief significator. (Ch 15)
- **Avastha**: The "state" of a planet. Three families: **Baladi** (by degree: infant, youth, adult, old, dead), **Jagradadi** (awake, dreaming, asleep, by dignity) and **Deeptadi** (nine moods such as radiant, delighted, tormented, by placement). (Ch 12)
- **Ayanamsa**: The angular gap between the Western (tropical) zodiac and the star-based (sidereal) zodiac, about 24° today. Indian practice uses the Lahiri value. (Ch 1)
- **Ayurdaya**: Longevity assessment. Three classical bands: **Alpayu** (short, to about 32), **Madhyayu** (middle, to about 64) and **Purnayu** (full, beyond). Judged with caution and never spoken to a client as a date. (Ch 20)

B

- **Badhaka (Badhakesh)**: The "obstructing" house and its lord: the 11th for movable signs, the 9th for fixed, the 7th for dual. Used for hidden obstacles. (Ch 9)
- **Balarishta**: Combinations indicating danger to health in early childhood; read with restraint and cancellation rules. (Ch 20)
- **Beeja mantra**: The "seed" sound-formula of a planet, such as *Om Hraam Hreem Hraum Sah Suryaya Namah* for the Sun. (Ch 23)

- **Bhakoot:** The seventh test in Ashtakoota (7 points): the distance between the two Moon signs, read for family welfare and finances. (Ch 19)
- **Bhava:** A house: one of twelve areas of life counted from the Lagna. (Ch 4)
- **Bhava Chalit:** A chart in which planets are placed by house cusps (house midpoints and boundaries) rather than by whole signs, so a planet near a boundary may shift house. (Ch 5)
- **Bhava Madhya (cusp):** The midpoint or most powerful degree of a house in cusp-based systems. (Ch 5)
- **Bhavat Bhavam:** "House from house": the nth house from the nth house is a second indicator of that matter (the 4th from the 4th, the 7th, also shows the mother). (Ch 4)
- **Bindu:** A point or dot; in Ashtakavarga, one unit of the score. (Ch 12)
- **BPHS:** *Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra*, the foundational Sanskrit text attributed to the sage Parashara; the backbone of this book. (Ch 1)
- **Brihat Jataka:** Varahamihira's classic text (6th century CE, Ujjain); compact and authoritative. (Ch 1)
- **Budha-Aditya yoga:** Sun and Mercury together (Mercury not combust): intelligence and articulate speech. (Ch 10)

C

- **Chandra Bala:** The Moon's transit strength for a given person on a given day, judged by the transiting Moon's house from the natal Moon; used in choosing times. (Ch 16)
- **Chandra Lagna:** The Moon's sign treated as the 1st house; the chart read "from the Moon". (Ch 5)
- **Chandra-Mangala yoga:** Moon and Mars together or opposite: drive and earning capacity. (Ch 10)
- **Chandrashtama:** The roughly 2¼ days each month when the transiting Moon is in the 8th sign from the natal Moon; a low-energy day, avoided for beginnings. (Ch 16)
- **Chara / Sthira / Dwiswabha:** The three sign qualities: movable (Aries, Cancer, Libra, Capricorn), fixed (Taurus, Leo, Scorpio, Aquarius) and dual (Gemini, Virgo, Sagittarius, Pisces). (Ch 2)
- **Chara dasha:** Jaimini's sign-based dasha system, in which signs rather than planets rule periods. (Ch 15)
- **Cusp:** See Bhava Madhya.

D

- **Daan (dana):** Donation; giving away a planet's items to pacify it. (Ch 23)
- **Darakaraka (DK):** In Jaimini's method, the planet with the lowest degree; the spouse significator. (Ch 15)
- **Daridra yoga:** Combinations for poverty, typically the 11th lord in a dusthana or malefics afflicting the wealth houses; read with the whole chart. (Ch 10)
- **Dasamsa (D10):** The tenth divisional chart, each sign split into ten parts of 3°; read for career and public life. (Ch 11)
- **Dasha:** A planetary period: the system by which the chart's promises are timed. (Ch 13)
- **Dhaiya:** Saturn's 2½-year transit through the 4th or 8th sign from the natal Moon (see Kantaka and Ashtama Shani). (Ch 14)
- **Dhana yoga:** Wealth combinations: connections between the lords of the 2nd, 5th, 9th, 11th and the Lagna. (Ch 10, 18)
- **Dharmi graha:** "Righteous planet": a Lal Kitab term for a planet that, by placement, does no harm and should not be "punished" with a remedy. Rules vary by edition. (Ch 22)
- **Dig Bala:** Directional strength: Jupiter and Mercury strongest in the 1st, Moon and Venus in the 4th, Saturn in the 7th, Sun and Mars in the 10th. (Ch 12)
- **Disha Shool:** "Direction thorn": the direction traditionally avoided for starting a journey on each weekday. (Ch 16)
- **Dispositor:** The lord of the sign a planet sits in; the planet's "landlord". A chain of dispositors shows who ultimately controls a placement. (Ch 9)

- **Drekkana (D3):** The third divisional chart, each sign in three parts of 10°; siblings, courage, and the manner of death. (Ch 11)
- **Drishti:** Aspect: the "glance" one planet casts on a house or planet at fixed distances. (Ch 6)
- **Dusthana (Trik):** The difficult houses 6, 8 and 12: struggle, hidden matters, loss. (Ch 4)

E

- **Ecliptic:** The Sun's apparent yearly path across the sky; the zodiac belt is centred on it. (Ch 1)
- **Eclipse:** The Sun or Moon darkened when the Moon is near Rahu or Ketu at new or full moon; astrologically a sensitising event. (Ch 3)
- **Ekadashi:** The eleventh lunar day of each fortnight, a traditional fasting day for Vishnu. (Ch 23)
- **Exaltation / Debilitation degrees:** The exact degree of a planet's peak (Uccha) and trough (Neecha) within its exaltation and debilitation signs; listed in Appendix A.2. (Ch 3)

G

- **Gaja Kesari yoga:** Jupiter in a kendra (1, 4, 7, 10) from the Moon; fame, wisdom, protection. (Ch 10)
- **Gana:** The sixth Ashtakoota test (6 points): each nakshatra is Deva (godly), Manushya (human) or Rakshasa (fierce); temperaments are compared. (Ch 7, 19)
- **Gandanta:** The "knot" junctions where a water sign meets a fire sign (end of Cancer, Scorpio, Pisces; start of Leo, Sagittarius, Aries), each 3°20' either side; sensitive zones for the Moon and Lagna. (Ch 7)
- **Gandmool (Gand Mool nakshatra):** The six nakshatras owned by Mercury and Ketu (Ashwini, Ashlesha, Magha, Jyeshtha, Mula, Revati) that contain the Gandanta zones; a Moon here traditionally calls for a shanti ritual. (Ch 7)
- **Gochar (Gochara):** Transit: the current positions of the planets moving over the birth chart. (Ch 14)
- **Graha:** "That which grasps": one of the nine planets: Sun, Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn, Rahu, Ketu. (Ch 3)
- **Graha Maitri:** The fifth Ashtakoota test (5 points): friendship between the lords of the two Moon signs. Also the general word for planetary friendship. (Ch 3, 19)
- **Graha Yuddha:** Planetary war: two true planets (not Sun, Moon or nodes) within one degree of each other; the "loser" is weakened. (Ch 12)
- **Guru Chandala yoga:** Jupiter joined with Rahu (some include Ketu); tests of ethics and unconventional wisdom. (Ch 10)

H

- **Hora:** (1) A planetary hour, one of 24 in a day. (2) The second divisional chart (D2), each sign split into two halves ruled by the Sun and Moon; read for wealth. (3) "Hora Shastra": the predictive branch of Jyotisha. (Ch 11, 16)
- **Hora Lagna (HL):** A special ascendant in Jaimini's method, advancing one sign every 2½ hours from sunrise; read for wealth. (Ch 15)
- **Hora Shastra:** The branch of Jyotisha dealing with birth charts and prediction, as opposed to calendar and omen lore. (Ch 1)

I

- **Indu Lagna:** A wealth ascendant computed from the lords of the 9th houses from the Lagna and the Moon. (Ch 18)
- **Ishrafa:** In Tajaka, a separating aspect: the faster planet has already passed the slower; the matter is over. (Ch 15)
- **Ithasala:** In Tajaka, an applying aspect: the faster planet moves toward the slower; the matter will come about. (Ch 15)

J

- **Jaimini:** A parallel school of astrology attributed to the sage Jaimini, using sign aspects, karakas by degree and sign-based dashas. Appears in this book only where marked. (Ch 15)
- **Janma Patrika:** See Kundali.
- **Japa:** Repetition of a mantra, usually counted on a mala of 108 beads. (Ch 23)
- **Jataka:** A birth chart, or the branch of astrology dealing with birth charts. (Ch 1)
- **Jataka Parijata:** Vaidyanatha Dikshita's classical compendium (c. 15th century). (Ch 1)
- **Jyotisha (Jyotish):** "The science of light": Indian astrology and astronomy, one of the six limbs of the Veda. (Ch 1)

K

- **Kala Chakra dasha:** A nakshatra-based dasha system with its own sequence of signs and periods; specialised and rarely used by beginners. (Ch 15)
- **Kala Purusha:** The "cosmic man": the zodiac laid over a human body, Aries at the head to Pisces at the feet; the basis of medical astrology. (Ch 2, 20)
- **Kala Sarpa yoga:** All seven planets hemmed on one side of the Rahu–Ketu axis; a fated, karmic life pattern. Popular teaching, not in BPHS. (Ch 10)
- **Kantaka Shani:** Saturn transiting the 4th (some say also the 7th or 10th) from the Moon or Lagna; the "thorn" period. (Ch 14)
- **Karaka:** A significator: the planet that naturally stands for a matter (Venus for marriage, Jupiter for children). (Ch 3, 4)
- **Karakamsa:** In Jaimini's method, the Navamsa sign occupied by the Atmakaraka; read for the soul's direction and career. (Ch 15)
- **Karakatwa:** The list of things a planet signifies; its portfolio. (Ch 3)
- **Karana:** Half a lunar day; one of the five limbs of the Panchanga, with eleven kinds. (Ch 16)
- **Karma (Prarabdha / Sanchita / Kriyamana):** Action and its results. **Sanchita** is the whole store of past karma; **Prarabdha** the portion ripened for this life (what the chart shows); **Kriyamana** what you do now (which the chart cannot show). (Ch 1)
- **Kemadruma yoga:** No planet (other than the Sun, Rahu or Ketu) in the 2nd or 12th from the Moon; loneliness, cancelled by many conditions. (Ch 10)
- **Kendra:** The angular houses 1, 4, 7 and 10; the pillars of the chart. (Ch 4)
- **KP (Krishnamurti Paddhati):** A modern system (K. S. Krishnamurti, 20th century) using the nakshatra sub-lord of cusps and planets for precise event prediction. (Ch 17)
- **Krishna paksha:** The dark fortnight, from full moon to new moon. (Ch 16)
- **Krura / Saumya graha:** Cruel and gentle planets: the natural malefics (Sun, Mars, Saturn, Rahu, Ketu, waning Moon, afflicted Mercury) and benefics (Jupiter, Venus, waxing Moon, unafflicted Mercury). (Ch 3)
- **Kuja dosha (Mangal dosha, Manglik):** Mars in the 1st, 2nd, 4th, 7th, 8th or 12th from the Lagna (also checked from the Moon and Venus); friction in marriage, with many cancellations. (Ch 10, 19)
- **Kundali (Janma Patrika, Kundli):** The birth chart: the map of the sky at the moment and place of birth. (Ch 1)

L

- **Lagna:** The rising sign, or ascendant: the sign on the eastern horizon at birth, which becomes the 1st house. (Ch 1, 5)
- **Lahiri (Chitrapaksha) ayanamsa:** The ayanamsa value adopted by the Indian Calendar Reform Committee in 1955 and used by most Indian astrologers. (Ch 1)
- **Lakshmi yoga:** The 9th lord strong in a kendra, own or exalted sign, with a strong Lagna lord; wealth and grace. (Ch 10)
- **Lal Kitab:** "The Red Book": a distinct remedy-centred system by Pt. Roop Chand Joshi (five Urdu volumes, 1939–1952), using a fixed-house chart. Appears only in marked boxes and in Chapter 22. (Ch 22)

M

- **Mahadasha:** A major planetary period in Vimshottari (6 to 20 years long). (Ch 13)
- **Mangal Nek / Mangal Bad:** Lal Kitab's benefic and malefic forms of Mars. (Ch 22)
- **Maraka:** A "killer" house or planet: the 2nd and 7th houses and their lords, whose periods can bring health crises. Spoken of only with great care. (Ch 4, 20)
- **Moolatrikona:** A planet's "root-triangle" portion of a sign, stronger than its own sign but weaker than exaltation; degree ranges in Appendix A.2. (Ch 3)
- **Moorti Nirnaya:** Judging the quality of a transit (gold, silver, copper, iron) by where the transiting Moon stands from the natal Moon at the moment a planet enters a new sign. (Ch 14)
- **Mudda dasha:** The planetary periods within a Tajaka annual chart, dividing the year. (Ch 15)
- **Muhurta:** Electional astrology: choosing an auspicious time to begin something. (Ch 16)
- **Muntha:** In Tajaka, a point that advances one sign per year from the birth Lagna; its house in the annual chart colours the year. (Ch 15)

N

- **Nadi:** The eighth Ashtakoota test (8 points): the nakshatras' three "pulses" (Adi, Madhya, Antya); same nadi is the main objection. (Ch 19)
- **Naisargika / Tatkalika / Panchadha Maitri:** Natural friendship (fixed), temporary friendship (by position in this chart), and the five-fold combination of the two. (Ch 3)
- **Nakshatra:** One of 27 lunar mansions of 13°20' each; the Moon's nakshatra at birth starts the Vimshottari dasha. (Ch 7)
- **Navagraha:** The nine planets as a group, and their worship. (Ch 23)
- **Navamsa (D9):** The ninth divisional chart, each sign split into nine parts of 3°20'; marriage, dharma and the inner strength of planets. The most important varga. (Ch 11)
- **Neecha:** Debilitation: the sign where a planet is weakest. (Ch 3)
- **Neecha Bhanga:** Cancellation of debilitation by specific conditions (for example the sign lord in a kendra from the Moon); may give late strength. (Ch 10)
- **Nirayana:** Sidereal, star-fixed: the zodiac used in Jyotisha. (Ch 1)
- **Node:** Rahu (north) and Ketu (south): the two points where the Moon's orbit crosses the Sun's path. (Ch 3)

P

- **Pada:** One quarter of a nakshatra, 3°20'; each pada corresponds to one Navamsa sign. (Ch 7)
- **Pakka ghar:** A planet's "permanent house" in Lal Kitab. (Ch 22)
- **Paksha:** A lunar fortnight: bright (Shukla) or dark (Krishna). (Ch 16)

- **Panapara:** The 2nd, 5th, 8th and 11th houses; medium strength. (Ch 4)
- **Panch Mahapurusha yogas:** Five "great person" combinations: a planet in its own or exalted sign in a kendra: **Ruchaka** (Mars), **Bhadra** (Mercury), **Hamsa** (Jupiter), **Malavya** (Venus), **Shasha** (Saturn). (Ch 10)
- **Panchanga:** The five-limbed Hindu almanac: tithi, vara, nakshatra, yoga, karana. (Ch 16)
- **Parivartana:** Exchange: two planets each sitting in the other's sign; the two houses fuse. (Ch 9, 10)
- **Phaladeepika:** Mantreswara's classical text (c. 13th–16th century), rich in yogas and results. (Ch 1)
- **Pitru dosha:** An affliction of the ancestral line, read chiefly from the Sun, the 9th house and Rahu–Ketu with the Sun; a Parashari-tradition concept distinct from Lal Kitab's *pitru rin*. (Ch 21)
- **Pitta / Kapha / Vata:** The three Ayurvedic constitutions (fire, water-earth, air), associated with planets and signs in medical astrology. (Ch 20)
- **Prarabdha:** See Karma.
- **Prashna:** Horary astrology: answering a question from the chart of the moment it is asked. (Ch 17)
- **Prashna Marga:** A Kerala text on horary and remedial astrology (17th century). (Ch 17)
- **Pratyantar dasha:** The third level of Vimshottari sub-period, inside an Antardasha. (Ch 13)
- **Pravrajya yoga:** Combinations for renunciation, typically four or more planets in one sign or a strong Saturn influence on the 10th; the monk's chart. (Ch 10, 21)
- **Precession:** The slow backward drift of the equinox point against the stars (about 1° in 72 years), which creates the ayanamsa. (Ch 1)
- **Purnima:** The full-moon day. (Ch 16)

R

- **Rahu Kaal:** A roughly 1½-hour slot each day, ruled by Rahu, avoided for beginnings. (Ch 16)
- **Raja yoga:** Combinations for rise in status, classically the lords of a kendra and a trikona joined, in mutual aspect or exchanging signs. (Ch 10)
- **Rashi:** A sign of the zodiac: one of twelve 30° divisions. (Ch 2)
- **Ratna:** Gemstone, as a remedy. (Ch 23)
- **Rin:** "Debt": Lal Kitab's family-level karmic debts with collective remedies. (Ch 22)
- **Rudraksha:** Beads of the *Elaeocarpus* tree, sacred to Shiva, classified by faces (mukhi) and matched to planets. (Ch 23)
- **Ruling planets:** In KP, the planets ruling the moment of judgement (day lord, Moon's sign and star lords, Lagna's sign and star lords), used to time events. (Ch 17)

S

- **Sade Sati:** Saturn's roughly 7½-year transit through the 12th, 1st and 2nd signs from the natal Moon. (Ch 14)
- **Saka calendar:** India's official civil-era calendar, beginning in 78 CE; the year printed on government almanacs. (Ch 16)
- **Sambandha:** Relationship between two planets: by conjunction, mutual aspect, exchange, or one aspecting the other's sign. (Ch 6, 9)
- **Samhita:** The branch of Jyotisha dealing with omens, weather, and the fortunes of nations, as opposed to individual charts. (Ch 1)
- **Sandhi:** A junction: the last degrees of a sign or house and the first of the next, where a planet is unstable. (Ch 5)
- **Sankalpa:** The spoken intention at the start of a remedy or ritual. (Ch 23)
- **Saptamsa (D7):** The seventh divisional chart, each sign in seven parts; children. (Ch 11)
- **Saravali:** Kalyana Varma's classical text (c. 8th–10th century). (Ch 1)

- **Saraswati yoga:** Jupiter, Venus and Mercury in kendras, trikonas or the 2nd, with Jupiter strong; learning and the arts. (Ch 10)
- **Sarvashtakavarga (SAV):** The total Ashtakavarga score of each sign, all planets combined (out of 337); above 28 is comfortable, below 25 weak. (Ch 12)
- **Sayana:** Tropical, equinox-based: the zodiac used in Western astrology. (Ch 1)
- **Shadbala:** The six-fold strength calculation for planets (positional, directional, temporal, motional, natural, aspectual), expressed in units called rupas. (Ch 12)
- **Shakata yoga:** Jupiter in the 6th, 8th or 12th from the Moon; ups and downs in fortune. (Ch 10)
- **Shanti:** Pacification: a ritual or practice to quiet a disturbing planetary influence. (Ch 23)
- **Shashtiamsa (D60):** The sixtieth divisional chart, each sign in sixty parts of half a degree; past-life karma, and the chart that separates twins. (Ch 11)
- **Shodasavarga:** The set of sixteen divisional charts. (Ch 11)
- **Shukla paksha:** The bright fortnight, from new moon to full moon. (Ch 16)
- **Sidereal / Tropical:** Star-fixed zodiac (Jyotisha) versus equinox-fixed zodiac (Western). (Ch 1)
- **Soya grah / Soya ghar:** Lal Kitab's "sleeping planet" and "sleeping house": dormant until woken by a transit or related planet. (Ch 22)
- **Sripati (Shripati) system:** A house system that uses unequal houses with midpoints as cusps; the basis of Bhava Chalit charts in most Indian software. (Ch 5)
- **Stellium:** A modern word for three or more planets in one sign or house. (Ch 5)
- **Sub-lord:** In KP, the lord of the sub-division of a nakshatra (each nakshatra is split into nine unequal parts in Vimshottari proportion); the deciding factor in a KP judgement. (Ch 17)
- **Surya Lagna:** The Sun's sign treated as the 1st house; the chart read "from the Sun". (Ch 5)
- **Swakshetra:** A planet in its own sign. (Ch 3)

T

- **Tajaka (Tajika):** The Persian-influenced system of annual charts (Varshaphal), with its own aspects and year-lords. Appears in this book only where marked. (Ch 15)
- **Tara Bala:** The strength of a day's nakshatra counted from one's birth nakshatra, in nine groups; the third Ashtakoota test also uses it. (Ch 7, 16, 19)
- **Tattva:** Element: fire, earth, air, water (and space); each sign belongs to one. (Ch 2)
- **Teva:** The Punjabi/Hindi word for a birth chart, especially in Lal Kitab usage. (Ch 22)
- **Tithi:** A lunar day, defined by each 12° of separation between Moon and Sun; thirty in a lunar month. (Ch 16)
- **Trikona:** The trinal houses 1, 5 and 9; merit, fortune and wisdom. (Ch 4)
- **Trimsamsa (D30):** The thirtieth divisional chart, each sign in five unequal parts of 5°, 5°, 8°, 7°, 5°; misfortune, character and disease. (Ch 11)

U

- **Uccha:** Exaltation: the sign where a planet is strongest. (Ch 3)
- **Ujjain meridian:** The reference longitude of classical Indian astronomy (roughly 75°47' E), through Ujjain; the Indian "Greenwich". (Ch 16)
- **Upachaya:** The growing houses 3, 6, 10 and 11, which improve with time and where malefics do well. (Ch 4)
- **Upapada (UL):** In Jaimini's method, the Arudha of the 12th house; read for marriage. (Ch 15)
- **Upa-ratna:** A substitute gemstone (garnet for ruby, moonstone for pearl, and so on). (Ch 23)

- **Upay (Upaya):** Remedy. *Upay* is the Hindi/Lal Kitab form; *upaya* the Sanskrit. (Ch 22, 23)
- **Uttara Kalamrita:** Kalidasa's (not the poet's) classical text, valued for its detailed lists of significations. (Ch 1)

V

- **Vakri:** Retrograde: a planet appearing to move backwards against the stars. Rahu and Ketu are always retrograde. (Ch 3)
- **Vara:** The weekday, each ruled by a planet: Sunday–Sun, Monday–Moon, Tuesday–Mars, Wednesday–Mercury, Thursday–Jupiter, Friday–Venus, Saturday–Saturn. (Ch 16)
- **Vargottama:** A planet in the same sign in both the birth chart (D1) and the Navamsa (D9); extra strength and steadiness. (Ch 11)
- **Varna:** The first Ashtakoota test (1 point): the "class" of the Moon sign, read for spiritual compatibility and ego. (Ch 19)
- **Varshaphal / Varshphal:** The annual chart: in Tajaka, the chart of the Sun's return to its birth degree each year; in Lal Kitab, the 35-year cycle of year-lords. (Ch 15, 22)
- **Varshesha:** In Tajaka, the lord of the year, chosen from five candidates by strength. (Ch 15)
- **Vashya:** The second Ashtakoota test (2 points): mutual attraction and influence between the two Moon signs. (Ch 19)
- **Vedha:** Obstruction of a good transit by another planet in a specified position; used in transit judgement. (Ch 14)
- **Vimshottari:** The 120-year dasha system based on the Moon's nakshatra; the standard timing tool. (Ch 13)
- **Viparita Raja yoga:** "Reversed" royal combinations: the 6th, 8th or 12th lord placed in another of those houses: **Harsha** (6th lord), **Sarala** (8th lord), **Vimala** (12th lord); gains from others' losses, resilience. (Ch 10)
- **Vish yoga:** Saturn and the Moon together: emotional heaviness, discipline learned the hard way. (Ch 10)
- **Vrata:** A vow, usually a weekday fast or restriction, kept as a remedy. (Ch 23)

W

- **Whole-sign houses:** The house system in which each sign is exactly one house, beginning with the Lagna sign as the 1st; the default in Jyotisha and in this book. (Ch 5)

Y

- **Yantra:** A geometric diagram of a planet or deity, engraved or drawn, used as a focus for worship. (Ch 23)
- **Yoga:** (1) A planetary combination with a named result (Raja yoga, Gaja Kesari). (2) In the Panchanga, one of 27 divisions of the combined longitude of Sun and Moon. (Ch 10, 16)
- **Yogakaraka:** For certain Lagnas, a single planet that owns both a kendra and a trikona and therefore gives Raja yoga on its own (Mars for Cancer and Leo, Saturn for Taurus and Libra, Venus for Capricorn and Aquarius). (Ch 8)
- **Yogini dasha:** A 36-year dasha system with eight "yogini" periods, popular in the Himalayan north and Bengal. (Ch 15)
- **Yoni:** The fourth Ashtakoota test (4 points): each nakshatra has an animal symbol; instinctive compatibility. (Ch 19)
- **Yuti:** Conjunction: two or more planets in the same sign or house. (Ch 6)

Appendix C: Reading List, Cheat Sheets and the Consultation Checklist

This appendix is the desk drawer: the books to read next, one-page tables to keep under the chart, the consultation checklist and ethics code from Chapter 24 in their canonical form, a few words of Sanskrit you will meet in software and in the classics, and a blank worksheet. Nothing here is new; everything here is what you will reach for most.

C.1 Reading list, in order of difficulty

Titles and authors are given as commonly published; editions, publishers and translators vary, verify before buying. Read in roughly this order. One good book finished is worth ten skimmed.

Beginner

Book	Author	Why
<i>Hindu Predictive Astrology</i>	B.V. Raman	The clearest twentieth-century introduction; the book most Indian astrologers began with
<i>A Catechism of Astrology</i>	B.V. Raman	Question-and-answer format; settles a hundred beginner doubts in a page each
<i>Learn Hindu Astrology Easily</i>	K.N. Rao	Teaches by charts, not lists; the method of this book owes it a debt
<i>Light on Life</i>	Hart de Fouw and Robert Svoboda	The philosophy and the <i>why</i> behind the rules, written for the Western-educated reader
<i>The Essentials of Vedic Astrology</i>	Komilla Sutton	A well-organised, gentle overview with good chapter summaries
<i>The Nakshatras</i>	Dennis Harness	A readable first book on the 27 stars, one chapter each
<i>The 27 Celestial Portals</i>	Prash Trivedi	Deeper nakshatra lore, myths, symbols, padas; read after Harness

Intermediate

Book	Author / translator	Why
<i>Brihat Parashara Hora Shastra</i>	Parashara; translations by R. Santhanam or Girish Chand Sharma	The backbone text of this book. Read by topic, not cover to cover
<i>Brihat Jataka</i>	Varahamihira; translation by B. Suryanarain Rao	The sixth-century classic; compact, aphoristic, best with a commentary
<i>Phaladeepika</i>	Mantreswara	The most practical of the classics for results of placements and yogas
<i>Saravali</i>	Kalyana Varma	Exhaustive on planets in signs and houses; a reference, not a read
<i>Jataka Parijata</i>	Vaidyanatha Dikshita	Strong on strength, longevity and yogas; for the third year of study
<i>Planets and Children</i>	K.N. Rao	The 5th house, the D7 and the timing of children, by charts
<i>Predicting through Jaimini's Chara Dasha</i>	K.N. Rao	The most accessible door into Jaimini (Chapter 15)
<i>Crux of Vedic Astrology</i>	Sanjay Rath	Timing techniques and the logic of dashas, densely argued
<i>Vedic Remedies in Astrology</i>	Sanjay Rath	The classical basis of remedies; balances Chapter 23
<i>KP Readers</i> (six volumes)	K.S. Krishnamurti	Only if you want the Krishnamurti Paddhati; a different system, learn it separately
<i>Muhurta</i>	B.V. Raman	Electional astrology (Chapter 16) in one volume
<i>Prasna Marga</i> (translation)	B.V. Raman	The Kerala classic on horary and much else (Chapter 17)
<i>Varshaphal</i> (Tajaka)	B.V. Raman	The annual chart (Chapter 15)

Lal Kitab

Book	Author / translator	Why
<i>Lal Kitab</i> (five Urdu volumes, 1939, 1940, 1941, 1942, 1952)	Pt. Roop Chand Joshi	The original; in Urdu, rare, and the only true source
Hindi translations and commentaries	e.g. Pt. Krishna Ashant; Umesh Puri "Gyaneshwar"; Radha Krishna Shrimali	The versions most readers use; translations differ from one another on rules and remedies , compare two before quoting
<i>Lal Kitab</i> (English)	U.C. Mahajan	The most available English rendering; useful as a map, not as the territory

Classical astronomy and history

Work	Why
<i>Surya Siddhanta</i> (translations available)	The astronomical text behind the traditional almanac; how positions were once computed
David Pingree, writings on the history of Indian astronomy and astrology	The scholarly account of where our techniques came from and when
<i>Report of the Calendar Reform Committee</i> (Government of India, 1955)	The document that fixed the Lahiri ayanamsa and the national calendar; surprisingly readable

Software

Software	Notes
Jagannatha Hora	Free, Windows; every varga and dasha; the professional's workhorse
Parashara's Light	Paid; the standard in many Indian institutes; excellent printouts
Maitreya	Free, open source; clean and reliable
AstroSage (and similar apps)	Free, mobile; good for beginners, set the ayanamsa to Lahiri and check it

C.2 One-page cheat sheets

Signs: lords, elements, qualities

#	Sign	Lord	Element	Quality	#	Sign	Lord	Element	Quality
1	Aries	Mars	Fire	Movable	7	Libra	Venus	Air	Movable
2	Taurus	Venus	Earth	Fixed	8	Scorpio	Mars	Water	Fixed
3	Gemini	Mercury	Air	Dual	9	Sagittarius	Jupiter	Fire	Dual
4	Cancer	Moon	Water	Movable	10	Capricorn	Saturn	Earth	Movable
5	Leo	Sun	Fire	Fixed	11	Aquarius	Saturn	Air	Fixed
6	Virgo	Mercury	Earth	Dual	12	Pisces	Jupiter	Water	Dual

Planet dignities

Planet	Own	● Exalted (deepest)	○ Debilitated (deepest)	Moolatrikona
Sun	Leo	Aries 10°	Libra 10°	Leo 0°–20°
Moon	Cancer	Taurus 3°	Scorpio 3°	Taurus 3°–30°
Mars	Aries, Scorpio	Capricorn 28°	Cancer 28°	Aries 0°–12°
Mercury	Gemini, Virgo	Virgo 15°	Pisces 15°	Virgo 16°–20°
Jupiter	Sagittarius, Pisces	Cancer 5°	Capricorn 5°	Sagittarius 0°–10°
Venus	Taurus, Libra	Pisces 27°	Virgo 27°	Libra 0°–15°
Saturn	Capricorn, Aquarius	Libra 20°	Aries 20°	Aquarius 0°–20°
Rahu / Ketu	(none)	Taurus / Scorpio (some say Gemini / Sagittarius)	Scorpio / Taurus (some say Sagittarius / Gemini)	(none)

Combustion orbs from the Sun: Moon 12°, Mars 17°, Mercury 14° (12° retrograde), Jupiter 11°, Venus 10° (8° retrograde), Saturn 15°. Why: a planet this close to the Sun cannot be seen, and the tradition reads the unseen as unable to act.

Natural friendships

Planet	● Friends	● Neutral	○ Enemies
Sun	Moon, Mars, Jupiter	Mercury	Venus, Saturn
Moon	Sun, Mercury	Mars, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn	(none)
Mars	Sun, Moon, Jupiter	Venus, Saturn	Mercury
Mercury	Sun, Venus	Mars, Jupiter, Saturn	Moon
Jupiter	Sun, Moon, Mars	Saturn	Mercury, Venus
Venus	Mercury, Saturn	Mars, Jupiter	Sun, Moon
Saturn	Mercury, Venus	Jupiter	Sun, Moon, Mars

Why the pattern (Chapter 3): the Royal Party (Sun, Moon, Mars, Jupiter) and the People’s Party (Mercury, Venus, Saturn) are friends within and enemies across; the Moon alone has no enemies. Working convention for the nodes: Rahu ● Venus, Saturn, Mercury / ○ Sun, Moon, Mars; Ketu ● Mars, Venus, Saturn / ○ Moon, Sun.

Aspects (Parashari, full)

Planet	Aspects houses counted from itself	Why (Chapter 6)
Sun, Moon, Mercury, Venus, Rahu, Ketu	7th	Every planet sees what stands opposite it
Mars	4th, 7th, 8th	The commander leaps forward (4th) and strikes from behind (8th)
Jupiter	5th, 7th, 9th	The priest blesses the two trines from himself, the houses of merit
Saturn	3rd, 7th, 10th	The judge supervises effort (3rd) and work (10th)

House groups

Group	Houses	Why (Chapter 4)
Kendra (angles)	1, 4, 7, 10	The four pillars: rising, lowest, setting and highest points of the sky
Trikona (trines)	1, 5, 9	The fire houses counted from the self: purpose, merit, grace
Dusthana (difficult)	6, 8, 12	The 12th from the 7th, 9th and 1st: loss of partnership, of fortune, of self
Upachaya (growing)	3, 6, 10, 11	Houses of effort, competition, work and gain, which improve with time
Maraka (killer)	2, 7	The 12th from the two longevity houses (3rd and 8th): where life-force is spent
Trishadaya	3, 6, 11	Effort, enemies and desire: their lords charge a price for everything
Dharma / Artha / Kama / Moksha trikonas	1-5-9 / 2-6-10 / 3-7-11 / 4-8-12	The four aims of life, each on one element's houses
Panapara / Apoklima	2, 5, 8, 11 / 3, 6, 9, 12	Succedent and cadent to the kendras; medium and weaker positions

Functional benefics and malefics by Lagna (from A.6)

Why the table looks as it does (Chapter 8): trikona lords (1, 5, 9) are benefic because those houses are merit; lords of 3, 6 and 11 are malefic because effort, enmity and desire are the price of everything; kendra lords go neutral because pillars carry both good and bad; the 2nd, 8th and 12th lords take the nature of their other sign. Derive one row yourself before you trust the rest.

Lagna	● Benefics	○ Malefics	● Neutral / mixed	Yogakaraka	Marakas
Aries	Sun, Mars, Jupiter	Mercury, Venus, Saturn	Moon	(Sun + Jupiter together)	Venus, Mercury
Taurus	Saturn, Sun, Mercury	Moon, Jupiter, Mars	Venus	Saturn	Jupiter, Venus, Mars
Gemini	Venus, Saturn, Mercury	Mars, Jupiter, Sun	Moon	(Venus + Saturn)	Moon, Jupiter
Cancer	Mars, Jupiter, Moon	Venus, Mercury	Sun, Saturn	Mars	Saturn, Venus
Leo	Mars, Jupiter, Sun	Mercury, Venus, Saturn	Moon	Mars	Saturn, Mercury
Virgo	Venus, Mercury	Mars, Jupiter, Moon	Sun, Saturn	Venus	Venus, Jupiter
Libra	Saturn, Mercury, Venus	Jupiter, Sun, Mars	Moon	Saturn (Moon + Mercury too)	Mars, Jupiter
Scorpio	Jupiter, Moon, Sun, Mars	Mercury, Venus, Saturn	(none)	(Sun + Moon together)	Venus, Mercury
Sagittarius	Sun, Mars, Jupiter	Venus, Saturn	Mercury, Moon	(Sun + Mercury together)	Saturn, Venus
Capricorn	Venus, Mercury, Saturn	Mars, Jupiter, Moon	Sun	Venus	Mars, Moon
Aquarius	Venus, Saturn	Jupiter, Moon, Mars	Mercury, Sun	Venus	Jupiter, Sun, Mars
Pisces	Mars, Moon, Jupiter	Saturn, Venus, Sun, Mercury	(none)	(Mars + Jupiter together)	Mercury, Saturn

Nakshatra lords by number (the nine-lord cycle repeats three times)

#	Nakshatra	Lord	#	Nakshatra	Lord	#	Nakshatra	Lord
1	Ashwini	Ketu	10	Magha	Ketu	19	Mula	Ketu
2	Bharani	Venus	11	Purva Phalguni	Venus	20	Purva Ashadha	Venus
3	Krittika	Sun	12	Uttara Phalguni	Sun	21	Uttara Ashadha	Sun
4	Rohini	Moon	13	Hasta	Moon	22	Shravana	Moon
5	Mrigashira	Mars	14	Chitra	Mars	23	Dhanishta	Mars
6	Ardra	Rahu	15	Swati	Rahu	24	Shatabhisha	Rahu
7	Punarvasu	Jupiter	16	Vishakha	Jupiter	25	Purva Bhadrapada	Jupiter
8	Pushya	Saturn	17	Anuradha	Saturn	26	Uttara Bhadrapada	Saturn
9	Ashlesha	Mercury	18	Jyeshtha	Mercury	27	Revati	Mercury

Each nakshatra is 13°20'; each pada 3°20'. Nakshatra number = (absolute longitude ÷ 13°20') rounded down, plus 1.

Vimshottari years and the sub-period formula

Ketu 7	Venus 20	Sun 6	Moon 10	Mars 7	Rahu 18	Jupiter 16	Saturn 19	Mercury 17

Total 120. First dasha = lord of the Moon's nakshatra; balance = (degrees left in the nakshatra ÷ 13°20') × lord's years.

Antardasha of B inside Mahadasha A = (A × B) ÷ 120 years; multiply the fraction by 12 for months and by 30 for days. Sub-periods run in dasha order, starting with the Mahadasha lord itself.

The ten-minute first read (Chapter 5)

1. Lagna sign and its lord, where does the lord sit?
2. Moon sign and nakshatra.
3. Which houses are occupied; which are empty.
4. Planets in kendras (1, 4, 7, 10), the pillars.
5. Planets in trikonas (5, 9), the merit.
6. Planets in dusthanas (6, 8, 12), the tests.
7. Any planet in its own or exaltation sign; any debilitated.
8. Retrograde or combust planets.
9. Where Rahu and Ketu fall, the axis of the life.
10. One sentence about the person before you look at anything else.

The five-step house method (Chapter 9)

1. **The house**, its sign and occupants.
2. **Its lord**, where it sits, in what dignity, with whom.
3. **The karaka**, the natural signifier's condition.
4. **The same house from the Moon.**
5. **The divisional chart** for that matter (D9 marriage, D10 career, D7 children, D4 property, D24 education).

The double-transit rule (Chapter 14)

A house tends to deliver its results when **Saturn and Jupiter both**, by transit, occupy or aspect that house or its lord, and the running dasha agrees. Jupiter alone opens the door; Saturn alone builds the frame; both together, the event.

The gemstone rule (Chapter 23)

A gemstone **strengthens**; it never pacifies. Prescribe one only for a **functional benefic** for that Lagna that needs strength, never for a functional malefic, and never for a planet you wish to quieten. Conduct, daan and mantra come first; the stone, if at all, comes last and after a trial.

C.3 The Consultation Checklist

These two lists are the canonical versions; Chapter 24 reproduces them word for word.

The fourteen-point preparation list

1. **Lagna**: sign, degree and lord; the lord's sign, house and dignity.

2. **Moon:** sign, nakshatra and pada, waxing or waning, and strength (own, exalted or debilitated; alone or supported).
3. **Sun:** sign, house and dignity; then check combustion for every planet within orb of it.
4. **Functional benefics and malefics for this Lagna** (Chapter 8, Appendix A.6); mark the yogakaraka and the marakas.
5. **Planets in kendras (1, 4, 7, 10), trikonas (5, 9) and dusthanas (6, 8, 12).**
6. **Exalted, debilitated, combust and retrograde planets;** any Neecha Bhanga.
7. **Yogas present,** and whether the planets forming them are strong enough to deliver.
8. **The seven key houses (1, 2, 4, 5, 7, 10, 11),** read by the five-step method (the house, its lord, the karaka, the same house from the Moon, the divisional chart).
9. **Navamsa (D9) and Dasamsa (D10) quick read:** varga Lagnas, Vargottama planets, and the D9/D10 dignity of the Lagna lord, the 7th lord and the 10th lord.
10. **Current Mahadasha and Antardasha with dates,** and the next two sub-periods.
11. **Saturn and Jupiter transit positions** counted from the Lagna and from the Moon; Sade Sati or Dhainya status; where the double transit falls.
12. **The client's stated questions,** each mapped to its houses, lord, karaka and the periods that activate them.
13. **Remedies shortlist:** conduct first, then daan and mantra; a gemstone only if a functional benefic needs strength.
14. **Three past events or traits you will ask the client to confirm** before you predict anything.

The twelve-point ethics code

1. **Confidentiality.** What is said in the room, and the chart itself, stays in the room: no sharing, no teaching examples with identifying details, no screenshots.
2. **Consent for third parties.** Read another adult's chart only with that person's consent; for a minor, only when a parent or guardian asks in the child's interest.
3. **No fear-selling.** Never frighten a client into a remedy, a return visit or a purchase. A prediction that leaves a person more afraid and less capable was badly delivered.
4. **Fees disclosed upfront,** in writing where possible, before the session begins; no surprise charges for "special" remedies.
5. **No gem commissions.** Recommend a stone only when the chart justifies it; never sell it yourself or take a cut from a seller.
6. **Stay inside your competence.** No medical diagnosis, no legal opinion, no investment advice. Astrology describes tendencies and timing; qualified professionals decide the rest.
7. **Refuse sex-determination** of an unborn child in every form, and refuse any remedy intended to harm another person.
8. **Keep records:** birth data as given, the time you used and why, what you said, what you predicted and by when.
9. **Admit errors.** When a prediction fails, say so, log it and learn from it; never rewrite history to protect your reputation.
10. **Keep learning.** Read the classics, sit with a teacher, meet peers. An astrologer who stopped learning ten years ago is practising ten-year-old mistakes.
11. **Do not read for a person who is intoxicated,** or for a minor without a guardian present; postpone a reading for someone in acute crisis until they are safe.
12. **Refer out.** When the matter belongs to a doctor, a lawyer, a counsellor or a financial planner, say so plainly and help the client get there.

C.4 Sanskrit counting, abbreviations and Hindi names

Numbers and the houses

Number	Sanskrit	House name (Bhava)
1	eka	Tanu (body)
2	dvi	Dhana (wealth)
3	tri	Sahaja (siblings)
4	chatur	Sukha / Bandhu (happiness)
5	pancha	Putra (children)
6	shat	Ari / Ripu (enemies)
7	sapta	Kalatra / Yuvati (spouse)
8	ashta	Randhra / Ayu (longevity)
9	nava	Dharma / Bhagya (fortune)
10	dasha	Karma (career)
11	ekadasha	Labha (gains)
12	dvadasha	Vyaya (loss)

So *Panchama Bhava* is the 5th house, *Saptamesha* the 7th lord, *Dashamsa* the tenth division (D10), *Navamsa* the ninth (D9), *Dwadasamsa* the twelfth (D12).

Abbreviations used in Indian software

Planet	Code	Hindi	Sign	Code	Hindi
Sun	Su	Surya	Aries	Ar	Mesh
Moon	Mo	Chandra	Taurus	Ta	Vrish (Vrishabh)
Mars	Ma	Mangal	Gemini	Ge	Mithun
Mercury	Me	Budh	Cancer	Cn	Kark
Jupiter	Ju	Guru / Brihaspati	Leo	Le	Singh
Venus	Ve	Shukra	Virgo	Vi	Kanya
Saturn	Sa	Shani	Libra	Li	Tula
Rahu	Ra	Rahu	Scorpio	Sc	Vrishchik
Ketu	Ke	Ketu	Sagittarius	Sg	Dhanu
Lagna	As / La	Lagna	Capricorn	Cp	Makar
			Aquarius	Aq	Kumbh
			Pisces	Pi	Meen

Retrograde is marked (R) or Vakri; combust, (C) or Asta; Vargottama, (V).

C.5 Blank chart worksheet

Copy this table into your notebook for every chart. Fill the first six columns from the software; the last three are your work.

Planet	Sign	Degree	House	Nakshatra / pada	Dignity	Functional nature	Aspects received	Notes
Lagna			1		(none)	(none)		
Sun								
Moon								
Mars								
Mercury								
Jupiter								
Venus								
Saturn								
Rahu								
Ketu								

Below the table, leave five lines: **Three pillars · Yogas · D9 Lagna and Vargottama · Current Mahadasha / Antardasha (dates) · Three past events to confirm.** When those five lines are full, you are ready for the client.

Appendix D: The Story Bank: Every Memory Tale in One Place

The reader who commissioned this book said: lists fade, stories stay. Here are all the stories from the chapters, in order, each with its one-line rule, so you can revise the whole grammar of astrology in an evening by reading the tales alone. The cast never changes: the **King** (Sun), the **Queen Mother** (Moon), the **Commander** (Mars), the young **Prince** and secretary (Mercury), the **Royal Priest** (Jupiter), the **Minister of Pleasure** (Venus), the old **Judge of Labour** (Saturn), and the two strangers at the gate: smoke-headed **Rahu** and the headless sadhu **Ketu**. The twelve houses are the rooms of the palace, the signs are the districts of the kingdom, the nakshatras are its streets, and the dashas are the railway timetable.

From Chapter 1: Welcome. Why the Books Confused You, and How This One Won't

STORY: THE COURT ASSEMBLES. *Picture a kingdom. The **King** (Sun) sits on the throne, proud, warm, impossible to ignore; when he is strong the whole court has confidence, and when he is weak nobody knows who is in charge. Beside him the **Queen Mother** (Moon) runs the household and knows every servant's troubles; she is the mood of the palace, changing a little every day. The **Commander** (Mars) guards the gates and starts the fights. The clever young **Prince** (Mercury) writes the letters and counts the money. The **Royal Priest** (Jupiter) advises, blesses and teaches the children. The **Minister of Pleasure** (Venus) arranges music, weddings and comfort. The old **Judge of Labour** (Saturn), once the King's neglected son, keeps the accounts of every debt and lets nobody leave until the work is done. At the gate stand two strangers: **Rahu**, a smoke-headed traveller who wants everything he sees, and **Ketu**, a headless sadhu who wants nothing at all. Every chart you will ever read is a story about which of these nine sits in which room of the palace, and who is on speaking terms with whom. **Rule:** learn the nine characters first; the rest of astrology is watching them interact.*

From Chapter 2: The Twelve Signs (Rashis): The Costumes

STORY: FOUR KINDS OF VILLAGE. Walk the ring road of the kingdom and you pass four kinds of village, over and over. First a festival village (fire), where somebody is always drumming, a new temple is always being started, and nobody has finished the last one. Then a granary village (earth), where every sack is counted, the walls are thick, and a stranger is fed before he is questioned. Then a market town (air), where everyone is talking, bargaining, carrying news from the last village to the next. Then a river village (water), where the old women remember every flood and every kindness, and the mood of the whole place changes with the tide. Then the drum starts again. Whatever planet moves into a village takes on its habits: the Commander in the market town argues instead of fighting; the Prince in the river village writes poetry instead of accounts. **Rule:** Fire acts, earth keeps, air connects, water feels, and they repeat in that order, Aries to Pisces.

STORY: THREE KINDS OF SHOPKEEPER. In every one of those villages you meet three kinds of shopkeeper. The hawker (movable) arrives with the season, sets up a bright new stall, sells fast, and is gone to the next town before you have learned his name. The old shop (fixed) has stood on the same corner for forty years; the owner will not change the sign, the prices or his opinion, and his customers' grandchildren still come. The trader (dual) keeps one foot in each town, buying here and selling there, always able to see both sides of a bargain and sometimes unable to close it. A planet that moves in becomes that shopkeeper: Saturn in a movable sign hurries, which is not like him; Mars in a fixed sign digs in for a siege; Jupiter in a dual sign teaches by comparing. **Rule:** Movable starts, fixed holds, dual adapts, repeating in that order round the wheel.

STORY: THE TWELVE DISTRICTS OF THE KINGDOM. Picture the kingdom as a ring of twelve districts. At the summer end of the ring stand two palaces side by side: the Queen Mother's (Cancer, the Moon) and the King's (Leo, the Sun). The King does not govern the outer districts himself. He posts his ministers outward in pairs, one on the Queen Mother's side, one on his own, nearest first. The young Prince-Secretary (Mercury), who must run back and forth with messages, gets the two districts touching the palaces: Gemini and Virgo. The Minister of Arts (Venus), next in the procession, receives Taurus and Libra. The Commander (Mars), who guards the borders, takes Aries and Scorpio. The Royal Priest (Jupiter) is sent further out to teach the towns, Pisces and Sagittarius. And the old Judge of Labour (Saturn) governs the two cold districts farthest from the palaces, at the winter end of the ring: Aquarius and Capricorn. Each minister's two districts have different soil, so each has a day-side manner and a night-side manner. **Rule:** Sign lords mirror outward from Cancer and Leo in order of distance from the Sun: Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn.

From Chapter 3: The Nine Planets (Grahas): The Actors

STORY: THE STRANGER AND THE SADHU. At the gate stands a Stranger with smoke for a head (Rahu): foreign clothes, restless eyes, hungry for everything inside. The King and Queen Mother exposed him at the churning of the ocean and the Commander threw him out, so he hates all three; his friends are in the People's Party, the Minister of Arts sells him pleasures, the Judge respects his patience, the Prince enjoys his cleverness. Outside the wall sits the Headless Sadhu (Ketu), his severed other half, who wants nothing. He too hates the two lights that unmasked him, but counts the fierce Commander, the detached Judge and the flower-bringing Minister of Arts as friends. **Rule:** Rahu is friendly to Venus, Saturn and Mercury, hostile to Sun, Moon and Mars; Ketu is friendly to Mars, Venus and Saturn, hostile to Moon and Sun (a working convention; sources vary).

STORY: THE TWO PARTIES. Every court has two parties. At the King's right hand sits the **Royal Party**: the King himself (Sun), the Queen Mother (Moon), the Commander (Mars) and the Royal Priest, Guru-ji (Jupiter). They believe in throne, dharma and duty. Across the hall sits the **People's Party**: the clever young Prince-Secretary (Mercury), the Minister of Arts and Pleasure, Shukracharya (Venus), and the old Judge of Labour, Shani-ji (Saturn), who rose from the servants' quarters. They believe in trade, comfort, cleverness and the working man. Inside a party everyone is a friend or at least civil; across the aisle there is coolness, and a few open feuds that the next stories explain. **Rule:** Sun, Moon, Mars and Jupiter are friends or neutral to one another; so are Mercury, Venus and Saturn; every enmity in the table runs across the aisle.

STORY: THE KING AND THE MINISTER OF PLEASURE. The King (Sun) rises before dawn, bathes in cold water and expects the court to do the same. Shukracharya (Venus) keeps the court up till midnight with music, perfume and wine, and, worse, is the guru of the asuras, the King's sworn enemies, whom he has taught to revive their dead. The King calls him decadent; the Minister calls the King a bore. Neither has ever forgiven the other. **Rule:** Sun and Venus are mutual enemies.

STORY: THE REJECTED SON. Shani-ji (Saturn) was born dark and slow to the King and his wife's shadow, Chhaya. His brilliant father never accepted him. The Queen Mother's household (Moon) looked past the awkward boy; the hot young Commander (Mars) mocked his lame foot. Shani left, worked among the labourers, and slowly became the Judge of Labour, who keeps the ledger of everyone's work and forgets nothing. He counts all three as enemies. The King and the Commander return the feeling. The Queen Mother, who quarrels with no one, merely looks away. **Rule:** Saturn's enemies are Sun, Moon and Mars; Sun and Mars return the enmity; the Moon stays neutral.

STORY: TARA'S SON. The Moon carried away Tara, the wife of Guru-ji, and from that scandal the Prince, Budha (Mercury), was born. When Tara returned, both Guru-ji and the Moon claimed the brilliant child, and Tara named the Moon. The boy grew up quick, clever and ashamed of the story; he resents the parent who caused it and keeps his distance. But a parent's love does not depend on the child's gratitude: the Moon still counts Budha a friend. **Rule:** Mercury calls the Moon an enemy; the Moon calls Mercury a friend. Friendship in this table is not always mutual.

STORY: THE PRIEST'S TWO HEADACHES. Guru-ji (Jupiter) preaches restraint, tradition and the sacred texts. Two people at court give him indigestion. Shukracharya (Venus), the rival guru who teaches the other side and laughs at restraint; and the Prince (Mercury), who is too clever by half and questions every sermon with a footnote. Guru-ji calls both enemies. Neither is much bothered, one is busy with a concert, the other with his accounts, so they hold nothing against the old priest and count him neutral. **Rule:** Jupiter regards Mercury and Venus as enemies; Mercury and Venus regard Jupiter as neutral.

STORY: THE COMMANDER AND THE SECRETARY. The Commander (Mars) wants his orders obeyed now. The Prince-Secretary (Mercury) wants them in writing, in triplicate, with three questions attached. Mars calls him an enemy and a coward. Mercury shrugs and files the complaint, he has no strong feelings about the loud man in armour. **Rule:** Mars counts Mercury an enemy; Mercury counts Mars neutral.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER HAS NO ENEMIES. Rani Ma (Moon) has fed everyone at this court. She is the King's closest friend, she loves the difficult Prince, and to the Commander, the Priest, the Minister of Arts and the Judge she is simply the one who asks whether they have eaten. Nobody is her enemy, and she is nobody's. Notice, too, that the King tolerates the Prince, the clever boy is always at his elbow, and so is neutral to him, though the Prince counts the King a friend and patron. **Rule:** The Moon's friends are Sun and Mercury, all others neutral, none enemies; the Sun is neutral to Mercury.

STORY: EVERY COURTIER'S FAVOURITE GUEST HOUSE. Each courtier has one district where the host's ways suit him perfectly, and one where he is quietly humiliated. The King (Sun) is honoured in Aries, the Commander's frontier fort, where a king is needed to lead the charge; he is humiliated in Libra, the Minister of Arts' salon, where every decision is put to a vote. The Queen Mother (Moon) rests in Taurus, the Minister's well-stocked kitchen; she is miserable in Scorpio, the Commander's night barracks. The Commander (Mars) is honoured in Capricorn, the Judge's fortress of five-year plans, and humiliated in Cancer, the Queen Mother's nursery. The Prince (Mercury) shines in Virgo, his own accounts office, and drowns in Pisces, the Priest's ashram by the sea. Guru-ji (Jupiter) is honoured in Cancer, the Queen Mother's house of compassion, and humiliated in Capricorn, the Judge's audit office. Shukracharya (Venus) is honoured in Pisces, the Priest's house of boundless kindness, and humiliated in Virgo, the Prince's office where love is itemised. And the Judge (Saturn) is honoured in Libra, the Minister's hall of scales where justice is weighed, and humiliated in Aries, the Commander's barracks, where the slow old man is told to run. **Rule:** Exaltation and debilitation are always opposite signs at the same degree, 10, 3, 28, 15, 5, 27, 20 for Sun, Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn.

STORY: BLINDED BY THE KING. A courtier who stands too close to the throne is blinded by the King's glare. He can still speak, but he can only echo the King's words; his own business is forgotten. Each courtier can stand a different distance before he is dazzled: the Commander is blinded from 17° away, the Judge from 15°, the Prince from 14° (12° when he is walking backward), the Queen Mother from 12°, Guru-ji from 11°, and the Minister of Arts, who is used to bright lights, only from 10° (8° when retrograde). The Stranger and the Sadhu are smoke and shadow; no glare touches them. **Rule:** Within its orb of the Sun a planet is combust, it serves the Sun's agenda (ego, father, authority) rather than its own.

STORY: THE MINISTER WHO WALKS BACKWARD. Once in a while a minister is seen walking backward through the great hall, slowly, lost in thought. The junior courtiers giggle: he has gone the wrong way. The old ones know better. At that moment he is nearer to you than he ever is otherwise, and brighter, you can see every line on his face. He is not reversing his duties; he is turning them over inside himself. When he finally speaks, it is after long reflection, and it lands harder. **Rule:** A retrograde planet is intensified and internalised, results come later, from within, often on a second attempt. Never read it as "reversed".

STORY: WHO STANDS AT WHICH GATE. The palace has four gates, and the day decides who stands at each. At dawn the East gate (the 1st house) opens, and there stand Guru-ji and the Prince, the Priest and the Secretary, because counsel is given while the mind is fresh. At noon the King and the Commander are on the rooftop above the South gate (the 10th house), in full blaze, giving orders the whole city can see. At sunset the tired old Judge closes the West gate (the 7th house): the labourer's day is done and the accounts are settled. At midnight the Queen Mother and the Minister of Arts keep the North gate (the 4th house), the inner rooms of rest, food and comfort. Stand a courtier at the wrong gate, the Judge at dawn, the King at midnight, and he has no strength of direction at all. **Rule:** Dig bala: Jupiter and Mercury in the 1st; Sun and Mars in the 10th; Saturn in the 7th; Moon and Venus in the 4th. The opposite house gives zero.

From Chapter 4: The Twelve Houses (Bhavas): The Rooms

STORY: THE HAVELI OF TWELVE ROOMS. Walk through the old family haveli once and you will never forget the houses. You enter at the **front door and veranda** (1st), the face the family shows the street. Just inside is the **kitchen with the family purse** (2nd), where grain and money are kept and everyone eats and talks. Beyond it the **courtyard** (3rd), where brothers wrestle and letters are written. Off the courtyard, the **mother's inner room** (4th), the heart of the house. Next the **children's study** (5th). Down a passage, the **store-room** (6th), where the servants work, the debts are recorded and the sick are nursed. Straight ahead, the **bridal room** (7th), whose second door opens on the world. Behind it the dark **back stairs** (8th). Up those stairs the **prayer room** (9th) where the grandfather sits, and above it the **office on the roof** (10th) that the whole street can see. Down again to the **guest hall** (11th) where friends gather, and finally across the lane to the **guest-house** (12th), where one goes to sleep, to hide, or to leave. **Rule:** House n is the nth room of the haveli, picture the room and its meanings follow.

STORY: STORE-ROOM, BACK STAIRS AND GUEST-HOUSE. Why are 6, 8 and 12 the difficult rooms? Because they are the three rooms of the haveli where the family does not receive guests. The **store-room** (6th) is where the servants labour, the account of debts is kept, and a sick child is nursed away from the others, work, debt, illness, service. The **back stairs** (8th) are dark, steep and used at night: this is where the locked chest of inheritance sits, where the secrets are whispered, where someone once fell. The **guest-house across the lane** (12th) is where you go when you leave the family, to sleep, to travel, to a hospital bed, or, if you are a sadhu, to freedom. Nothing is wrong with these rooms; they simply are not where the family's daily happiness lives. A gentle planet placed there is out of sight; a tough planet placed there gets useful work done. **Rule:** 6, 8 and 12 are dusthanas, struggle, hidden things, loss; their lords are functional troublemakers, and malefics there do useful work.

STORY: THE TWO DOORS OUT OF THE LIFE-ROOMS. The 8th room, the back stairs, is where the family's life-span is kept, the old texts call the 8th Ayu, longevity. Count eight rooms on from the back stairs and you reach the 3rd, the courtyard: the 8th from the 8th, its twin, and so also a life-room. Now, in this haveli, every room's exit door is the room just before it, the 12th from it. The exit from the courtyard (3rd) is the kitchen (2nd); the exit from the back stairs (8th) is the bridal room (7th). Those two exits are where life-span leaks out, and so the 2nd and 7th are called maraka, the killers. In practice their lords' periods far more often bring illness or the end of a phase than the end of a life. **Rule:** Marakas are 2 and 7 because they are the 12th houses from the two longevity houses, 3 and 8.

STORY: THE FOUR WINGS OF THE HAVELI. Seen from the roof, the haveli has four wings, and each wing serves one of the four aims of a Hindu life. The **prayer wing** (dharma: 1, 5, 9) runs from the front veranda through the children's study to the grandfather's prayer room, who you are, what you create, what you believe. The **working wing** (artha: 2, 6, 10) holds the kitchen-purse, the store-room and the roof office, money, labour, career. The **meeting wing** (kama: 3, 7, 11) holds the courtyard, the bridal room and the guest hall, siblings, spouse, friends: every room where you meet another person. The **inner wing** (moksha: 4, 8, 12) holds the mother's room, the back stairs and the guest-house across the lane, roots, transformation, and leaving. Count where a client's planets sleep, and you know which wing the life is lived in. **Rule:** Dharma 1-5-9 (fire), artha 2-6-10 (earth), kama 3-7-11 (air), moksha 4-8-12 (water).

From Chapter 5: Reading Your First Chart: Layout, Lagna, and the Twelve Ascendants

STORY: THE CAPTAIN AT THE DOOR. Every haveli has a captain, the person who actually runs the household, keys at the waist. When you visit, the first thing to learn is where in the house the captain spends the day. If she is always at the front door (1st), the household is about itself. If she lives in the kitchen (2nd), it is about food, money and talk. If she is forever in the mother's room (4th), home comes first; in the roof office (10th), work comes first; in the guest-house across the lane (12th), she is half gone already, abroad, in retreat, or in the hospital wing. The Lagna lord is that captain, and its house is where the self goes to find itself. **Rule:** Read the Lagna lord's house as the room where the person's identity is invested.

STORY: TWELVE HOSTS AT THE FRONT DOOR. Knock on twelve havelis and twelve hosts answer. **Aries** flings the door open before you have finished knocking. **Taurus** will not discuss anything until you have eaten. **Gemini** asks you three questions on the doorstep and answers two of them himself. **Cancer** asks after your mother, and means it. **Leo** receives you from his chair and you feel oddly honoured. **Virgo** notices your shoes and quietly moves the doormat. **Libra** asks whether you would prefer tea or coffee, and then asks again. **Scorpio** watches you through the half-open door for a moment before it swings wide. **Sagittarius** tells you about his last pilgrimage before you have sat down. **Capricorn** checks the clock, then gives you exactly the time he promised. **Aquarius** is already telling you about the neighbourhood committee. **Pisces** has made up a bed for you before you said you were staying. **Rule:** The Lagna is the host's manner at the door, the body, the temperament, the first impression; the Lagna lord tells you where in the house that host actually lives.

STORY: WALKING THE HAVELI ONCE. Before I say a word to a client I walk through their haveli once, always by the same route. I stop at the **front door** and ask who owns it and where the captain is (Lagna and its lord). I pay my respects to the **Queen Mother** in her room (the Moon, its sign and star), because she decides how everything I say will be received. I check the **four pillars** that hold the roof (planets in the kendras). I look into the **store-room, the back stairs and the guest-house** (the dusthanas) to see who has been sent there. I note which courtier is being **honoured** and which **humiliated** (exalted and debilitated planets). I read the **railway timetable** pinned to the wall (the current dasha and the next). Then, and only then, I turn to the host and ask **one question** to make sure I am in the right house. **Rule:** Lagna and lord; Moon and nakshatra; kendras; dusthanas; dignities; dasha; one confirming question, in that order, every time.

From Chapter 6: Aspects (Drishti) and Conjunctions (Yuti): How Planets Talk

STORY: THREE COURTIER'S AND THEIR HABITS. Every courtier in the haveli stares straight across the hall at whoever sits opposite: that is the 7th aspect, and even the King and the Queen Mother do it. But three courtiers have habits. The Commander, red Mars, never trusts a hall. He stands at his post and keeps glancing to his flanks (the room four steps ahead and the room eight steps ahead) because that is where an ambush comes from. The Royal Priest, golden Jupiter, walks the hall with his hand raised, and he blesses the two rooms where the lamps of merit burn, the 5th and the 9th. The old Judge of Labour, navy Saturn, blesses nobody; he inspects. He walks to the 3rd room to see whether the servants are working and to the 10th to see whether the work is finished. **Rule:** Every planet aspects the 7th; Mars adds the 4th and 8th, Jupiter the 5th and 9th, Saturn the 3rd and 10th, always counted from where the planet sits.

STORY: THE KING'S THREE COMPANIONS. Watch who sits beside the King. When the clever young Prince, green Mercury, sits at his elbow with the ledgers, the court gets a ruler who can explain his decrees: that is Budha-Aditya, authority that speaks. But the Prince must not sit too close to the throne; if the King's glare falls full on him he goes silent: that is combustion. When the Minister of Pleasure, pink Venus, sits beside the King, the court turns glamorous (festivals, arts, fine buildings) yet the King demands discipline and the Minister wants indulgence, so Venus is often burnt, and the person's comforts and love life end up serving the father's or the career's wishes. And when the old Judge, navy Saturn, sits beside the King, the hall goes cold. In the Puranas Saturn is the Sun's own son, whom the Sun refused to recognise; father and son sit together and do not speak. That is friction with father or authority, and recognition that comes late, after long duty. **Rule:** Sun + Mercury ● speaks; Sun + Venus ♀ shines but may burn; Sun + Saturn ○ tests the bond with father and bosses.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER'S VISITORS. The Queen Mother, the grey Moon, is the mind of the kingdom: she feels whatever enters her room. When the Commander marches in, the two of them end up running the treasury together, her care for the household and his drive to win make money, and quarrels; that is Chandra-Mangala, earning capacity with a temper. When the old Judge visits, he sits in silence and reminds her of every duty undone and every year gone; the room fills with melancholy (the tradition calls it Vish yoga, poison) but it also breeds endurance, for she learns to bear anything. When the Smoke-headed Stranger slips in, she cannot see clearly; the room fills with rumours, fascination, fear of things that are not there: Grahan yoga, the eclipsed mind, brilliant at imagining and poor at resting. **Rule:** Moon + Mars ♀ earns and argues; Moon + Saturn ○ sorrows and endures; Moon + Rahu ○ imagines and worries.

STORY: THE COMMANDER'S COMPANY. The Commander, red Mars, is heat and speed. Put the cold old Judge in his room and you have a chariot with one foot on the accelerator and one on the brake: it lurches, it stalls, sometimes it crashes (hard labour, frustration, the accident born of impatience) but a chariot that learns to drive this way can climb any mountain; that is the endurance of engineers and miners. Put the Minister of Pleasure in his room and the Commander falls in love: fast, hot, sometimes reckless: passion in romance, in art, in sport. Put the young Prince in his room and the two argue all night: the sharp tongue, the debate, the surgeon's or coder's precise aggression. **Rule:** Mars + Saturn ○ brakes and accelerates at once; Mars + Venus ♀ is passion; Mars + Mercury ♀ is the sharp, technical tongue.

STORY: THE PRIEST'S COMPANY. The Royal Priest, golden Jupiter, is wisdom and faith. Seat the Minister of Pleasure beside him and you have two ministers who both want the budget, the Priest for temples and schools, the Minister for gardens and music. Both are generous, so wealth flows, but they never quite agree; that is the old enmity between Jupiter and Venus. Seat the Smoke-headed Stranger beside him and the court whispers Guru Chandal, the holy man keeping company with the outsider. But watch what actually happens: the Priest learns things the scriptures never taught, and the Stranger learns restraint. If the Priest is strong (own sign, exalted, in a trine) you get the reformer, the scholar who reads foreign books, the professor who breaks his field open. Only when the Priest is weak does faith go astray. Seat the old Judge beside him and you have dharma and karma at one table: slow, institutional, lasting: the priest-administrator.

Rule: Jupiter + Venus ♀ is wealth with disagreement; Jupiter + Rahu ♀ is the unconventional guru, not a curse; Jupiter + Saturn ♀ is slow, durable success.

STORY: THE JUDGE'S COMPANY. The old Judge of Labour, navy Saturn, began life as a servant and rose by discipline. Two people are comfortable in his cold room. The Smoke-headed Stranger also came from outside; together they carry the heaviest files in the kingdom: the popular name is Shrapit, "cursed", but what I see is two outsiders doing the long, unglamorous, karmic work nobody else will: foreign labour, large engineering, delays that end in permanence. The Minister of Pleasure surprises everyone by liking the Judge: she brings him flowers, he gives her a schedule. Love that comes late and lasts, art with discipline, loyalty above romance. **Rule:** Saturn + Rahu ♂ is heavy, delayed karma; Saturn + Venus ♀ is mature, durable love.

STORY: THE PRINCE, THE MINISTER AND THE STRANGER. The young Prince, green Mercury, and the Minister of Pleasure, pink Venus, are the People's Party's charming pair: he writes the verse, she sets it to music; he sells, she decorates the shop. Poetry, commerce, pleasant speech, a natural friendship. But when the Minister of Pleasure is found with the Smoke-headed Stranger, the court's desires grow larger than life: foreign lovers, glamour, the screen, the intoxication of wanting. Rahu magnifies whatever he touches, and what he touches here is desire. **Rule:** Mercury + Venus ♀ is charm and art; Venus + Rahu ♀ is magnified, unusual desire.

STORY: THE HEADLESS SADHU EMPTIES THE ROOM. Purple Ketu has no head, no ego, no appetite for applause. Whichever room he sits in, he quietly removes the furniture. With the King: no craving for position, detachment from the father. With the Queen Mother: an intuitive, unworldly mind, separation from mother or motherland. With the Commander: sudden action and sudden withdrawal, cuts and wounds, the surgeon's knife. With the Priest: philosophy that gives away wealth and expectation. With the Minister of Pleasure: refined taste and detachment in love. With the Judge: renunciation, the researcher in his cell. The emptied room feels like loss for years, and then, often, like freedom. **Rule:** Ketu with any planet ♂ subtracts that planet's worldly appetite and ♀ sharpens its spiritual or technical skill, read both.

From Chapter 7: The 27 Nakshatras: The Street Addresses of the Sky

STORY: NINE RELAY RUNNERS, THREE LAPS. Picture the zodiac as a running track of twenty-seven lanes-lengths, and nine runners from the court passing a baton. The Headless Sadhu, Ketu, always starts, he has nothing to carry, so he runs light. He hands to the Minister of Pleasure, Venus, who runs the longest leg (twenty years of dasha; she likes to linger). She hands to the King, who runs a short, proud six. The King hands to the Queen Mother, she to the Commander, he to the Smoke-headed Stranger (who runs a long, strange eighteen) then the Royal Priest, the old Judge (nineteen; he is slow), and last the young Prince, who sprints seventeen and hands back to the Sadhu. Nine runners, one lap. Then the same nine run the lap again, and again: three laps make twenty-seven. The Sadhu's three starting lines are Ashwini, Magha and Mula, the first streets of the three fire districts. **Rule:** Nakshatra lords run Ketu, Venus, Sun, Moon, Mars, Rahu, Jupiter, Saturn, Mercury, three times round; the lord of nakshatra n is the $((n - 1) \bmod 9) + 1$ -th runner.

STORY: FOUR ROOMS ON ONE STREET. Every street in the kingdom, every nakshatra, has exactly four houses on it, and the houses are numbered round the whole kingdom without a break. Walk down Ashwini Street: house 1 is painted in Aries red, house 2 in Taurus earth, house 3 in Gemini's airy blue, house 4 in Cancer's water-purple. Turn into Bharani Street and the numbering simply continues (Leo, Virgo, Libra, Scorpio) and Krittika Street begins with Sagittarius. After twelve houses the painters run out of colours and start again from Aries red. Walk all 108 houses and you will have passed each of the twelve colours nine times. The colour of the house is the Navamsa sign. **Rule:** Each pada is one Navamsa sign; count padas from Ashwini pada 1 = Aries and cycle through the twelve signs.

STORY: THE FORD BETWEEN TWO RIVERS. Three times in the kingdom a water district ends and a fire district begins, and there is no bridge, only a ford. On the water bank the last street belongs to the young Prince, Mercury (Ashlesha, Jyeshtha, Revati); on the fire bank the first street belongs to the Headless Sadhu, Ketu (Magha, Mula, Ashwini). A traveller born while crossing the ford, the Queen Mother's carriage in the last $3^{\circ}20'$ of the water street or the first $3^{\circ}20'$ of the fire street, gets her feet wet: a turbulent start, feelings that run raw. But every pilgrim who reaches the far bank has crossed something the people on either shore never had to. **Rule:** Gandanta is the last $3^{\circ}20'$ of Ashlesha, Jyeshtha, Revati and the first $3^{\circ}20'$ of Magha, Mula, Ashwini; check the Moon and Lagna there and speak of intensity, not doom.

STORY: THE NINE GATES. From your birth street to any other street in the kingdom you must pass through gates, and the gates repeat in a cycle of nine. The first gate is your own front door (Janma, stay home, rest). The second opens onto the treasury (Sampat). The third is guarded by a suspicious sentry (Vipat, turn back). The fourth is the garden gate (Kshema). The fifth is where the rival's men wait (Pratyari, turn back). The sixth is the gate of the workshop where things get finished (Sadhaka). The seventh is the executioner's gate (Vadha, turn back). The eighth is your friend's door (Mitra) and the ninth your best friend's (Ati-Mitra). Then the cycle begins again at your own door. **Rule:** Count from birth star to today's star, both included, subtract nines; 2, 4, 6, 8, 9 are open gates, 3, 5, 7 are closed, 1 is home.

From Chapter 8: Which Planets Are Good FOR YOU: Functional Benefics and Malefics

STORY: THE STRICT UNCLE WHO IS ON YOUR SIDE. In every joint family there is one uncle the children fear: the one who checks homework, switches off the television at nine, and never gives sweets. In the Libra household that uncle, navy Saturn, has been made guardian of two rooms: the study (the 5th, intelligence and children) and the family home itself (the 4th). So the same strictness that frightens the other households builds this one. The Libra child complains about him at fifteen and thanks him at thirty-five, standing in a house she owns, holding a degree she finished. Meanwhile the jolly uncle who brings sweets, golden Jupiter, has been put in charge of the storeroom of debts and the room where the cousins quarrel (the 6th and 3rd). He is still jolly; he is just generous with the wrong things. **Rule:** Judge a planet by the houses it owns for this Lagna, not by its reputation in the neighbourhood.

STORY: THE COURTYARD WHERE EVERYONE IS EQUAL. The haveli has four rooms that open straight onto the central courtyard: the 1st, 4th, 7th and 10th, the pillars. The courtyard is public ground: whoever is appointed to guard those rooms stands in full daylight, watched by the whole family. The Royal Priest, who in a private room could hand out favours freely, finds that in the courtyard he must be fair to everyone; his generosity is flattened into mere duty. The old Judge, who in a private room could be harsh, finds that in the courtyard he too must be seen to be fair; his harshness is flattened into mere firmness. The courtyard makes everybody ordinary. Only the trines (the 5th and 9th, the lamp-lit rooms at the back) and the Lagna itself let a planet be fully good. **Rule:** Angle lords are neutral: natural benefics lose goodness there, natural malefics lose badness.

STORY: WHOSE EMPLOYEE IS THIS PLANET? A new steward arrives at the haveli and asks, sensibly, not "who is a nice man?" but "who works for whom?" He walks the twelve rooms and reads the nameplate on each door, the sign, and so its lord. Whoever's name is on the doors of the lamp-lit rooms (1, 5, 9) works for the family's good fortune and is paid well. Whoever's name is on the doors of the storeroom of debts, the sick-room and the room of losses (6, 8, 12), or on the rooms where the cousins fight and scheme (3, 6, 11), is employed to manage trouble, and trouble is what he will bring into any conversation. The steward writes two columns in his ledger, works for us and tests us, and only then asks about anybody's character. **Rule:** Read the lord of each house from the Lagna, sort by house quality, and you have the functional table without memorising it.

STORY: THE MINISTER WHO HOLDS TWO KEYS. The King keeps two rings of keys. One ring opens the pillar rooms on the courtyard, the angles, where the kingdom's strength is stored. The other opens the lamp-lit back rooms, the trines, where its grace and merit are kept. Most ministers are trusted with one key from one ring. But now and then a single minister is handed a key from each ring: he can walk from the strong-room to the shrine without asking anyone. In the Libra court that minister is the old Judge, Saturn, with the keys to the 4th and 5th. In the Cancer court it is the Commander, Mars, with the 5th and 10th. In the Capricorn court it is the Minister of Pleasure, Venus, with the 5th and 10th. When his years come round, the whole household rises with him. **Rule:** A yogakaraka owns one angle and one trine by itself; strengthen it, and its dasha is the best of the life.

STORY: THE TWO ROOMS TWELFTH FROM THE LIFE-ROOMS. In the haveli, the room twelfth from any room is its back door, the way things leave. Life itself is kept in the 8th room (longevity) and, as a second store, in the 3rd (which is the 8th from the 8th). Count twelve rooms on from the 8th and you arrive at the 7th; count twelve on from the 3rd and you arrive at the 2nd. Those two rooms, the 2nd and the 7th, are the back doors through which vitality slips out. Whoever holds the keys to those doors (their lords), whoever is standing in them (occupants), and the old Judge who patrols all exits (Saturn) are the marakas. In their years, the household runs low: illness, drained savings, a partnership that ends. That is all the word means in practice. **Rule:** Marakas are the 2nd and 7th lords, malefics in 2 or 7, the 12th lord, and Saturn; their periods call for care of health and money, never for a prophecy.

From Chapter 9: House Lords: Where Did the Owner Go?

STORY: THE OWNER WHO WENT TO ANOTHER ROOM. Each of the twelve rooms in the haveli has an owner whose name is on the door, but owners wander. The owner of the kitchen (the 4th, home and mother) is found every day in the office (the 10th), so the family's meals are eaten at the desk, the mother keeps the accounts, and the business is run from home. The owner of the marriage room (the 7th) is found in the guest-house at the edge of the estate (the 12th), so the spouse comes from far away and the couple's happiest hours are private ones. The owner of the treasury (the 2nd) is found lying in the sick-room (the 6th), so money goes on medicines and disputes until he recovers. Wherever the owner sits, that is where his room's business is done, and the state of the room he sits in decides how well it goes. **Rule:** A house lord carries its house's matters to the house it occupies; good destination, good results; difficult destination, struggle or transformation.

STORY: VISITING A HOUSE. When the steward is asked "how are the children of this family?", he does not guess. First he visits the children's room itself (the 5th) and sees who is living there and who keeps peering in through the windows, occupants and aspects. Then he goes looking for the landlord of that room, wherever he has wandered, and checks whether he is well-dressed or in rags, the lord and its dignity. Then he visits the shrine of the room's patron deity (the karaka, Jupiter for children) and sees whether the lamp is lit. Then he looks at the room's reflection in the Queen Mother's mirror, the same house counted from the Moon, to learn how the family feels about it. Last, he unrolls the district map for that matter, the divisional chart. Only then does he speak. **Rule:** House, lord, karaka, from the Moon, varga, five steps, every time.

STORY: WHO DOES YOUR LANDLORD PAY RENT TO? The young Prince rents a room in the Commander's house. Ask the Commander, and he admits he rents his house from the Royal Priest. The Priest, it turns out, rents from the Minister of Pleasure. And the Minister of Pleasure? She owns her house outright. So when the Prince's rent goes up, it is because the Minister raised it three landlords away. Follow the rent up the chain and you find who really runs the neighbourhood. In Chart A that is Venus: the Sun and Mercury pay Mars, Mars and Saturn pay Jupiter, Jupiter pays Venus, and Venus pays nobody. The Queen Mother, in her own Cancer house, is the one tenant on the street who is also her own landlord. **Rule:** A planet's dispositor is the lord of the sign it occupies; follow the chain to the planet in its own sign, the final dispositor, to find the chart's hidden centre.

STORY: TWO LANDLORDS SWAP KEYS. The Queen Mother owns the Cancer house in the 4th district; the Royal Priest owns the Sagittarius house in the 9th. One day they exchange keys: she moves into his house, he moves into hers. Now every repair she orders in his house is a repair to her own interest, and every blessing he gives in her house comes home to him. The two households become one estate, neither can be judged without the other. If both houses are in good districts, the estate prospers (Maha). If one of them is the cramped house of effort in the 3rd district, the swap is mischievous, profit, but with labour (Khala). If one of them is the sick-room, the storeroom of debts or the guest-house of losses, the good landlord is dragged into a bad neighbourhood (Dainya). **Rule:** Parivartana fuses two houses; judge it Maha, Khala or Dainya by the houses involved.

From Chapter 10: Yogas: When Planets Form a Team

STORY: THE PILLAR-KEEPER AND THE TREASURY-KEEPER. In the King's haveli there are two kinds of officers. The pillar-keepers hold the four corners of the building, the kendras (houses 1, 4, 7 and 10), where the doors open and the real business of the household happens. The treasury-keepers hold Lakshmi's three rooms, the trikonas (1, 5 and 9), where merit, children and fortune are stored. Most days they never meet: the pillar-keeper is busy with visitors, the treasury-keeper is counting. But when one pillar-keeper and one treasury-keeper are found in the same room, or looking at each other across the courtyard, or have swapped keys, the household rises. Effort has found its funding; fortune has found a door to walk through. The Lagna lord holds both kinds of key, since house 1 is a pillar and a treasury, so he can shake hands with either side. **Rule:** a kendra lord connected with a trikona lord makes a Raja yoga.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER WITH NO ATTENDANTS. The Queen Mother, the Moon, the mind, walks through the haveli every evening. Custom says an attendant walks one step ahead of her (the 2nd house from the Moon) and one step behind (the 12th). With attendants she is at ease: someone to lean on, someone to announce her. One evening both places are empty. The King (the Sun) does not count; he is too bright, too busy, no company at all. The Smoke-headed Stranger and the Headless Sadhu (Rahu and Ketu) do not count; they are shadows, not attendants. So she walks alone through a long, bare corridor, and that is how the mind feels in Kemadruma: unsupported, lonely, struggling without help, poor in the old texts. But look up. If any courtier stands at a pillar of the corridor, a kendra from her or from the Lagna, he steps forward and the loneliness ends. **Rule:** Kemadruma forms when the 2nd and 12th from the Moon are empty; any planet in a kendra from the Moon or Lagna cancels it.

STORY: THE THIEF WHO ROBS THE THIEF. Three shady characters lodge in the haveli's back rooms: the lords of the 6th, 8th and 12th, keepers of debt, death and loss. Each carries a bag of trouble meant for whichever room he enters. Now watch what happens when the keeper of the 12th, the room of loss, wanders into the 8th, the room of death and hidden things. He opens his bag of losses and finds nothing good there to spoil. Loss falls on loss. The two thieves rob each other, and the master of the house, who feared both, wakes to find his troubles have cancelled out. He gains what the other side lost; he survives what should have sunk him. That is **Viparita Raja yoga**; viparita means inverted. **Rule:** a dusthana lord placed in another dusthana turns its harm on the harm itself.

STORY: THE FALLEN MINISTER WHOSE LANDLORD IS THE KING'S FRIEND. A minister is posted to the one district where nobody respects him: the Sun sent to Libra, the Commander sent to Cancer. He arrives humiliated, his orders ignored. But every district has a landlord, the lord of that sign, and this landlord happens to hold a pillar of the palace: he stands in a kendra, in the King's own courtyard. One word from the landlord and the district falls in line behind the fallen minister. Or the minister's own patron, the lord of the sign where he would have been honoured, stands in a kendra and sends for him. Or the minister, though weak, is himself stationed in a pillar of the Queen Mother's house, a kendra from the Moon, where nobody can ignore him. The fall is real; the rescue is real too, and it always comes through the rescuer's hand, late and in the rescuer's style. **Rule:** a debilitated planet whose dispositor or exaltation lord stands in a kendra, or which stands in a kendra from the Moon, or exchanges signs with its dispositor, has its debility cancelled.

STORY: THE COMMANDER POSTED IN THE BEDROOM WING. The Commander (Mars) is a fine officer on the parade ground: the 3rd, 6th, 10th and 11th houses, where courage, competition and work live. Now post him inside the family wing of the haveli: the master's own room (1st), the dining hall where the family talks (2nd), the mother's quarters (4th), the bride's chamber (7th), the room where the marriage's long years are kept (8th), or the bedroom itself (12th). He does not become a villain. He simply behaves like a commander where a commander is not needed: he speaks in orders, he decides in a hurry, he keeps his sword on the table. Meals turn into arguments; the bride feels commanded rather than courted. That heat in the family wing is all Kuja dosha means: a tendency to friction in married life, not a prediction of widowhood, whatever your neighbour's aunt says. And a commander who is dignified, or watched by the Priest or the old

Judge, keeps his manners. **Rule:** Mars in 1, 2, 4, 7, 8 or 12 from the Lagna (also check from the Moon and Venus) gives Kuja dosha, subject to many cancellations.

STORY: THE TEAM THAT NEVER TOOK THE FIELD. The King has a brilliant pair in his court, the pillar-keeper Sun and the treasury-keeper Jupiter, who get on famously. But the haveli runs on a railway timetable (Chapter 13): each courtier is given the keys of the house for a fixed stretch of years, one after another, and only the key-holder's plans are carried out. For twenty years the keys are with the Minister of Pleasure, Venus. Sun and Jupiter sit in the courtyard, friends still, waiting. Their plans are real; they are simply not on the timetable yet. The clerk with three Raja yogas is not cursed. He is early. **Rule:** a yoga sleeps until the Mahadasha or Antardasha of one of its planets arrives.

From Chapter 11: Divisional Charts (Vargas): Zooming In

STORY: THE KING'S MAP ROOM. On the wall of the King's map room hangs one great map of the kingdom, cut into twelve districts: the Rasi chart. When a courtier is reported "in Taurus", the King knows roughly where he is. But the young Prince, Mercury, keeps sixteen smaller sheets in a drawer, one for each purpose: the marriage-district sheet, the office-district sheet, the children's-district sheet. On each sheet every district of the big map is cut into lanes, nine lanes on the marriage sheet, ten on the office sheet, seven on the children's sheet, and each lane is given a district name of its own. So the same courtier "in Taurus" may, on the marriage sheet, be standing in a lane called Pisces, and on the office sheet in a lane called Capricorn. The big map says which street; the sheet says which house on the street. **Rule:** a varga re-maps each sign by degree into slices, and each slice carries a sign of its own.

STORY: THE THREE BROTHERS OF EACH ELEMENT. Every element has three sign-brothers: fire has Aries, Leo and Sagittarius; earth has Taurus, Virgo and Capricorn; and so on. The eldest brother is the movable sign, the middle one the fixed sign, the youngest the dual sign. When the King's surveyors come to number the nine lanes of a district, custom says the numbering always begins at the eldest brother's door. So in a movable district the surveyors start at the district's own gate. In a fixed district they walk to the eldest brother, who lives nine districts on, and start there. In a dual district the eldest brother is five districts on, and they start there. That is the whole rule, and it is why the nine lanes of Aries, Leo and Sagittarius all read Aries, Taurus, Gemini... in the same order: they were all numbered from the same door. **Rule:** movable signs count from themselves; fixed from the 9th; dual from the 5th.

STORY: THE PRIEST IN BORROWED ROBES. On the big map the Royal Priest, Jupiter, is lodged in Taurus, the district of the Minister of Pleasure, his old rival, and he is walking backwards besides. Visitors see a tired, out-of-place priest and lower their expectations. But open the marriage-district sheet and there he is in Pisces, his own house, in his own robes, entirely himself. Which is the real Priest? Both. The Taurus lodging is what the world sees first; the Pisces home is what the family lives with. So I now describe Meera's Raja yoga as "slow to show but solid within", a better prediction than the D1 alone gave. The opposite case is the courtier grand on the big map and shabby on the sheet: the **hollow planet**, exalted in D1 and debilitated in D9. **Rule:** a planet's D9 dignity shows its inner strength; D1 grand and D9 fallen is hollow, D1 weak and D9 strong is quietly reliable.

STORY: THE TWINS AND THE OLD JUDGE'S LEDGER. Two babies are born four minutes apart. On the great map they are identical: same Lagna, same districts for every courtier. Even the marriage and office sheets agree. The family comes to the old Judge of Labour, Saturn, who keeps the finest ledger in the kingdom, sixty lines to every district, one for each half-degree. Only in his book do the twins part: the elder's Lagna falls on a line ruled by a kindly deity, the younger's on the next line, ruled by a harsh one. "Here," says the Judge, "is the debt each brought with him." But the Judge is strict about one thing: if the family cannot tell him the birth minute, he closes the ledger. **Rule:** the D60 separates twins and reads past-life residue, but only with a reliable, rectified birth time.

From Chapter 12: How Strong Is That Planet? Shadbala, Ashtakavarga and Avasthas

STORY: HOW STRONG IS THE SOLDIER? *The Commander, Mars, inspects a new recruit and asks seven quick questions before he trusts him with a post. Is he in his own regiment's uniform, or a borrowed one that fits badly? (Dignity.) Has he a fever from standing too long in the sun? (Combustion.) Is he marching backwards, which in this army means he is doubling his effort, though he looks odd? (Retrogression.) Has he been posted at a pillar of the fort or in the back rooms? (House.) Who is watching him, the Priest and the Minister of Arts, or the old Judge and the Stranger? (Aspects.) Does he carry the same colours on the district sheet as on the great map? (Vargottama.) And is he standing at the gate where his own kind fight best? (Directional strength.) Seven questions, two minutes, and the Commander knows what the man can carry. **Rule:** judge a planet by dignity, combustion, retrogression, house, aspects, Vargottama and directional strength, in that order.*

STORY: EACH OFFICER'S BEST GATE. *The haveli has four gates and each officer fights best at his own. At dawn the east gate, the 1st house, belongs to the Royal Priest and the young Prince: wisdom and wit are sharpest in the morning, so Jupiter and Mercury take the front door. The inner courtyard at midnight, the 4th, is the Queen Mother's and the Minister of Pleasure's: comfort, feeling and beauty rule the night, so the Moon and Venus are strongest there. The western gate at dusk, the 7th, is where the old Judge stands: Saturn, patient and unhurried, guards the door that others tire of. And the roof at noon, the 10th, belongs to the King and his Commander: the Sun and Mars blaze where everyone can see them. Post an officer at the gate opposite his own and he fights at half strength. **Rule:** Dig Bala: Jupiter and Mercury in the 1st; Moon and Venus in the 4th; Saturn in the 7th; Sun and Mars in the 10th.*

STORY: VOTES FROM EIGHT NEIGHBOURS. *A new well is to be dug in one of the twelve districts, and the King asks each of eight voters, the seven planets and the Lagna, to say which districts they favour. Each voter has a fixed list: the King himself, standing in his own district, approves of certain districts counted from where he stands (the 1st, 2nd, 4th, 7th, 8th, 9th, 10th and 11th from himself) and disapproves of the rest. Every voter has a different list and votes from a different standing place. When the votes are counted, each district has between 0 and 8 dots (bindus) from each voter, and a total; the district that all eight favoured is where the well is dug first. A district with many dots can bear a heavy visitor; a district with few dots cracks under him. **Rule:** each of the seven planets and the Lagna gives or withholds a dot for every sign; the totals show which signs (houses) can carry weight.*

STORY: THE OLD JUDGE AND THE INFANT. *In the odd-numbered districts of the kingdom the gate is at the near end: a courtier who has just entered (0°) is a newcomer, an infant in that district, and by the time he reaches the far wall (30°) he has spent his whole life there and has nothing left to give. In the even-numbered districts the gate is at the far end, so the same degrees read backwards: a courtier at 4° of an even district is standing by the exit, worn out, while one at 28° has just walked in fresh. The old Judge, Saturn, keeps this register; he does not care how grand the courtier looks, only how much life he has left in that district. **Rule:** Baladi avastha runs Bala, Kumara, Yuva, Vriddha, Mrita by 6° bands in odd signs and in reverse in even signs; Yuva gives full results, Mrita almost none.*

From Chapter 13: Vimshottari Dasha: The Timetable of Life

STORY: THE NINE TRAINS. Life, in this system, is a railway line 120 years long, and nine trains run on it, always in the same order and always for the same number of years each: the Headless Sadhu's train for 7 years, the Minister of Pleasure's for 20, the King's for 6, the Queen Mother's for 10, the Commander's for 7, the Smoke-headed Stranger's for 18, the Royal Priest's for 16, the old Judge's for 19, the young Prince's for 17. Nobody can change the order; nobody can lengthen a train. What differs from person to person is only this: which train you are already sitting in when you are born, and how far along its route it has come. A child born aboard the Priest's train near the end of its run will change to the Judge's train within a year or two; a child born as the Minister of Pleasure's train pulls out has twenty years of her hospitality ahead. Whoever drives the current train holds the keys to the haveli for those years, and only his plans are carried out. **Rule:** Vimshottari runs Ketu 7, Venus 20, Sun 6, Moon 10, Mars 7, Rahu 18, Jupiter 16, Saturn 19, Mercury 17, always in this order, 120 years in all.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER'S STREET DECIDES THE FIRST TRAIN. When the child is born, the court looks not at the King but at the Queen Mother, the Moon, and asks: on which of the twenty-seven streets of the kingdom is she standing? Every street has an owner, one of the nine lords, and the owner of that street is the driver of the first train. Then they ask a second question: how far along the street has she walked? If she has walked two-thirds of it, the child gets only the last third of that train's journey; the rest was spent before he was born. So the first dasha is nearly always a fraction of its full length, and the balance is what remains. **Rule:** the first Mahadasha is the lord of the Moon's nakshatra; its balance is $(\text{degrees still to travel in the nakshatra} \div 13^{\circ}20') \times \text{the lord's years}$.

STORY: THE KEY-HOLDER OPENS HIS OWN ROOMS. When a courtier's train is running, he holds the keys of the haveli. But a key-holder does not wander everywhere. He goes first to the rooms he owns, the houses whose signs are his, and throws them open: if the Minister of Pleasure owns the bride's chamber and the storeroom of expenses, those two rooms come alive in his years. Then he goes to the room where he happens to be sitting on the day the keys were handed over, the house he occupies, and that room is busy too. He behaves according to his standing (dignity) and his mood (aspects), he treats the household as his own party treats it (functional nature), and he looks at the Queen Mother's rooms as well, because the mind is where the years are actually lived. **Rule:** a dasha lord activates the houses it owns and the house it occupies, coloured by its functional nature, dignity, aspects, and its house from the Moon.

STORY: THE SUB-MINISTER WHO SITS IN THE WRONG ROOM. During the Minister of Pleasure's twenty years, each of the other courtiers takes a turn as her deputy. Most are placed in rooms where she can call them easily, the 2nd, 5th, 9th, 10th, 11th from her seat, and the household runs smoothly. But two deputies are lodged in rooms she never visits: the Commander in the 6th, the room of disputes, and the Royal Priest in the 8th, the room of hidden things. However able these men are, their years as deputy are awkward: messages are lost, plans are misread, expenses rise. It is not that either courtier is bad; it is that the deputy is sitting where the Minister cannot see him. **Rule:** an Antardasha lord in the 6th, 8th or 12th from the Mahadasha lord gives friction; in the 2nd, 5th, 9th, 10th or 11th it cooperates.

STORY: THE STRANGER SPEAKS WITH HIS HOST'S VOICE. The Smoke-headed Stranger owns no district in the kingdom; when his eighteen-year train runs, whose plans does he carry out? The court has an old answer. The Stranger is a guest, and a guest speaks with his host's voice: whichever courtier owns the district where Rahu is lodged becomes his host, and Rahu's years bring that host's affairs to the front, hugely, hungrily, with a foreign accent. If another courtier is lodged in the same room as the Stranger, that courtier's affairs come too, amplified. The Headless Sadhu does the same in reverse: he empties his host's rooms rather than filling them, and leaves the family wiser and lighter. **Rule:** Rahu and Ketu give the results of their sign lord and of any planet they sit with, in their own style.

From Chapter 14: Transits (Gochar): The Weather Report

STORY: WHERE EACH COURTIER MAY VISIT THE QUEEN MOTHER. The Queen Mother (the Moon) keeps a haveli of twelve rooms, and every courtier on his rounds must be received somewhere. The Commander (red Mars) and the old Judge (navy Saturn) are welcome only in the working rooms: the 3rd where the servants drill, the 6th where accounts and quarrels are settled, the 11th where the harvest is counted. Put either in her bedchamber (the 1st) or the family hall (the 4th) and the whole house falls silent. Guru-ji (gold Jupiter) is welcome wherever a blessing is needed: the treasury (2nd), the children's rooms (5th), the marriage pavilion (7th), the prayer room (9th), the harvest room (11th), and from any one of them his gaze reaches the others. Shukracharya (pink Venus) is welcome almost everywhere except the sickroom (6th), the guest-of-honour's seat (7th) and the office (10th), where he only distracts. The clever Prince (green Mercury) is useful wherever there is paperwork. **Rule:** malefics transit well only in 3, 6, 11 from the Moon; Jupiter in 2, 5, 7, 9, 11; each courtier is welcome where his nature is useful.

STORY: THE JUDGE'S SEVEN-AND-A-HALF-YEAR AUDIT. Once every twenty-nine and a half years the old Judge of Labour (Shani-ji) arrives to audit the Queen Mother's household, and he does it room by room, never hurrying. He begins in the **store-room** (the 12th): he counts the sacks, finds what has been wasted, and the household sleeps badly while the lamps burn late; some servants are sent to distant estates. Then he enters **her own chamber** (the 1st) and sits down: now the Queen Mother herself must answer for her health, her habits and her duties, and the whole court feels her weight. This is the peak. Finally he moves to the **family dining hall** (the 2nd): the accounts are read aloud, debts are settled, careless speech is corrected, and the deposit is refunded to whoever kept honest books. Then he bows and leaves for the next house. Nothing in it is personal; he audits every household in turn, three of the twelve at any moment. **Rule:** Sade Sati is Saturn in the 12th, 1st and 2nd from the natal Moon (expenses, then self, then family), about 7½ years; a quarter of the world is in it right now.

STORY: TWO SIGNATURES ON THE DEED. In this kingdom no land deed is valid with one signature. Guru-ji (gold Jupiter) must bless it: he walks briskly, visits every district within twelve years, and would happily bless everything he sees. The old Judge (navy Saturn) must stamp it: he takes twenty-nine and a half years for the same round and stamps only what has been earned. Guru-ji's blessing alone gives the wish and the wedding invitations; the Judge's stamp alone gives the paperwork and the wait. Only when both stand in the same room, or both look into it from where they stand, is the marriage registered, the child born, the post confirmed. **Rule:** a major event tends to come when Jupiter and Saturn by transit both touch the relevant house or its lord, in a dasha that promises it.

STORY: THE FOUR GATES. When a courtier enters a new district of the kingdom, the Queen Mother's own position that day decides which gate he is shown through. If she stands in a friendly place (the 1st, 6th or 11th from her home) the **gold gate** opens and he is received with garlands: his whole stay will be gentle. From the 2nd, 5th or 9th, the **silver gate**: a warm welcome. From the 3rd, 7th or 10th, the **copper gate**: correct, formal, mixed. From the 4th, 8th or 12th, the **iron gate**: he enters by the servants' entrance, and the stay is hard however good his intentions. The gate cannot be changed once he is inside. **Rule:** at a planet's ingress, count the transiting Moon from the natal Moon: 1/6/11 gold, 2/5/9 silver, 3/7/10 copper, 4/8/12 iron.

From Chapter 15: Beyond Vimshottari: Yogini, Jaimini Chara Dasha, and the Annual Chart

STORY: EIGHT SISTERS. In a village live eight sisters who take turns hosting every traveller, and each keeps him for as many years as her place in the family. Mangala, the eldest and gentlest, one year; Pingala, the fiery one, two; Dhanya, who keeps the granary, three; Bhramari, who never sits still, four; Bhadraka, the reader, five; Ulka, the stern one who works you hard, six; Siddha, in whose house everything comes right, seven; and Sankata, the youngest, in whose house the roof always seems to leak: eight. The order never changes; which sister opens the door first depends only on the street (the Moon's nakshatra) the traveller was born on. **Rule:** Yogini dasha runs 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8 years (Moon, Sun, Jupiter, Mars, Mercury, Saturn, Venus, Rahu), 36 in all; Ulka and Sankata test, Dhanya and Siddha reward.

STORY: SENIORITY, NOT BIRTH. In Parashara's court the offices are hereditary: the King (Sun) is always the father, the Queen Mother (Moon) always the mother. Jaimini runs his court differently. On the day of the birth he lines up the seven courtiers by how far each has walked into his own district (the degrees) and gives the offices by **seniority**. The one who has walked furthest becomes the soul's own minister, the Atmakaraka, whoever he happens to be; the next becomes minister of livelihood; and so on down to the one who has barely stepped through the district gate, who becomes the Darakaraka and stands for the spouse. In Meera's court the King has walked 28 steps and is Atmakaraka; the Commander, only 4, is Darakaraka. **Rule:** rank the planets by degree within their signs, highest first: AK, AmK, BK, MK, PK, GK, DK.

STORY: THE REFLECTION IN THE PALACE TANK. The Lagna is the palace door; the lord of the Lagna is the steward, who has wandered off to some other room. Stand at the door, walk to the steward, then walk the same distance again in the same direction: where you arrive there is a tank of still water, and in it the palace's reflection, the Arudha, the house as the world sees it. Two rules of the tank: it cannot lie on the doorstep itself, nor exactly opposite the door across the courtyard, for then the reflection would be the thing itself; if the walk lands there, move ten rooms on. **Rule:** $AL = \text{count Lagna} \rightarrow \text{lord}$, then the same count again from the lord; if it lands in the 1st or 7th, take the 10th from there.

STORY: THE KING'S HOMECOMING. Every year the King (the Sun) rides the full circuit of the twelve districts and returns to the exact milestone where he stood when the child was born. The court holds a fresh assembly at that minute: the annual chart. Whoever stands at the door that day (the Varsha Lagna), whichever courtier holds the strongest seat and can see the door (the Varshesha), and the room where the brass marker now stands (the Muntha) decide the year's business. The old contract, the natal chart, is not torn up; the assembly only decides this year's instalment of it. **Rule:** the Varshaphal is cast for the Sun's return to its natal degree; it refines the year, it never replaces the natal chart or the dasha.

STORY: THE YEAR'S BRASS MARKER. On the day of the birth the steward places a small brass marker in the front room, the Lagna. Every birthday he moves it one room on. At the first birthday it stands in the treasury (the 2nd), at the seventh in the marriage pavilion (the 7th), at the twelfth it is home again, and round it goes for as long as the person lives. Whatever room the marker stands in that year, and whichever courtier happens to be sitting there, colours the year's business. **Rule:** $\text{Muntha} = \text{natal Lagna} + (\text{age} \div 12, \text{remainder})$ signs; its house, its lord and its company set the tone of the year.

From Chapter 16: The Panchanga and Muhurta: Choosing the Right Moment

STORY: FIVE KINDS OF DAYS IN A VILLAGE. Watch a village through a fortnight and you see five kinds of days come round in turn. **Nanda** days (1, 6, 11) are for joy: a wedding song, a new sari, the fair. **Bhadra** days (2, 7, 12) are steady market days when the shop is opened and the ledger balanced. **Jaya** days (3, 8, 13) are for the wrestling pit and the panchayat, anything to be won. **Rikta** days (4, 9, 14) are the empty days: the well is cleaned, the old wall pulled down, nothing new begun; the elders sit in the shade. **Purna** days (5, 10, 15) are the full days: the harvest is in, the granary sealed, the house-warming held. Each kind of day has a weekday it loves: joy on Venus's Friday, the market on Mercury's Wednesday, the contest on Mars's Tuesday, the emptying on Saturn's Saturday, the fullness on Jupiter's Thursday. **Rule:** Nanda 1/6/11, Bhadra 2/7/12, Jaya 3/8/13, Rikta 4/9/14 (avoid for beginnings), Purna 5/10/15; Siddha when on its own weekday.

STORY: SEVEN GUARDS CHANGING SHIFT. Seven guards keep the palace gate in hour-long shifts, always in the same order of seniority, slowest first: the old Judge (Saturn), Guru-ji (Jupiter), the Commander (Mars), the King (Sun), Shukracharya (Venus), the Prince (Mercury), the Queen Mother (Moon), and then the Judge again. On Sunday the King takes the first shift at sunrise. Twenty-four shifts later (three full rounds and three more guards) it is the Queen Mother who stands at the gate as Monday dawns: Monday is hers. Three more past her: the Commander, Tuesday. Then the Prince, Guru-ji, Shukracharya, the Judge. Whoever holds the gate at dawn owns the day. **Rule:** hora order is Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Sun, Venus, Mercury, Moon, repeating from the day lord; every 25th hora gives the next weekday.

STORY: THE STREETS OF THE CAPITAL. The twenty-seven streets of the capital each have a temperament, and a wise builder chooses his street. On the **fixed** streets (Rohini, the three Uttaras) stand the temples and the banks: lay a foundation there. The **movable** streets (Swati, Punarvasu, Shravana, Dhanishta, Shatabhisha) lead to the bus stand and the river ghat: start a journey there. The **fierce** streets (Bharani, Magha, the three Purvas) hold the armoury and the demolition yard: go there only to break or to fight. The **quick** streets (Ashwini, Pushya, Hasta, Abhijit) are the bazaar: open a shop, learn a trade. The **soft** streets (Mrigashira, Chitra, Anuradha, Revati) are where the musicians and tailors live: begin a friendship, buy clothes. The **sharp** streets (Mula, Ardra, Jyeshtha, Ashlesha) hold the surgeon and the exorcist: necessary, but not where you begin anything you want to grow. Kritika and Vishakha are the **mixed** lanes of everyday errands. **Rule:** fixed for foundations, movable for travel, quick for trade, soft for arts, fierce and sharp only for harsh acts.

STORY: THE EIGHT WATCHES OF THE DAY. The daylight is cut into eight watches, and three unwelcome figures each take one watch a day, moving to a different watch as the week turns. The Smoke-headed Stranger (Rahu) takes his, Rahu Kaal, and during it nothing new is signed, though routine work goes on (South India keeps this watch more strictly than the North). Yama's runner takes Yamaganda, and no one sets out on a road. And Gulika, the old Judge's slow son (also called Mandi), takes his: whatever is begun in his watch is said to repeat itself, so begin nothing there you do not want twice; some cleverly use it for the first payment into a savings scheme. The rest of the day belongs to the household. **Rule:** divide sunrise-to-sunset by eight; each weekday has its own Rahu Kaal, Yamaganda and Gulika watches; nothing in the tradition is merely "bad", everything has a use.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER'S LOW DAYS. The Queen Mother (the Moon) walks through the twelve rooms of her haveli every month, two and a quarter days in each. In most rooms she is herself. But when she passes through the three rooms that stand 4th, 8th and 12th from the room where she was born, she is not: the 4th unsettles her, the 12th drains her, and the 8th, the room of hidden things, leaves her tired, forgetful and unlucky for two days. No one in the household asks her to sign anything then. Every person's Moon has her own three low rooms, which is why the same calendar day is good for one person and bad for another. **Rule:** avoid beginnings when the transiting Moon is in the 4th, 8th (Chandrashtama) or 12th from your natal Moon.

From Chapter 17: Prashna: When There Is No Birth Time

STORY: THE MESSENGER AT THE GATE. A messenger runs up to the palace gate with a sealed question and knocks. The court does not ask when the messenger was born. It notes which district's banner flies over the gate at that exact minute (the Prashna Lagna, the messenger himself), sees which courtiers are sitting in which rooms, and reads the answer from how the court happens to be arranged the moment the knock is heard. A knock a minute earlier or later, or at a different gate, would meet a different arrangement, which is why the moment must be the true one: when the question is really asked, where it is really received. **Rule:** cast the Prashna chart for the minute the sincere question is spoken, at the astrologer's place; the Lagna is the querent.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER CARRIES THE MESSAGE. In the Prashna court the Queen Mother (the Moon) is the one who carries the messenger's sealed question from room to room, and she is the quickest walker in the palace. Watch where she is heading. If her next stop is Guru-ji's room or the room of the matter's own lord, the question is about to be answered kindly; if she is walking toward the Commander or the old Judge with nothing gentle between, the answer is delayed or harsh; if she has just left the matter's lord and is walking away, the chance has passed. Her own mood (the district she stands in, the street she walks) is the querent's state of mind. **Rule:** the Moon is the querent's mind and the flow of the matter; what it applies to next is what comes next.

STORY: TWO COURTIER'S WHO MUST MEET. Every question is a meeting between two courtiers: the lord of the door (the querent) and the lord of the room the question is about. If they sit in the same room, or can see each other across the courtyard (mutual aspect), or have swapped rooms for the day (exchange), the business is done: yes. If one can see the other but not the reverse, the one who is looking will have to do the walking: yes, with effort. But the palace has wings with no windows between them: rooms 6, 8 and 12 from each other. Two courtiers in those wings can shout all day and never be heard: no, or not until one of them moves. **Rule:** Lagna lord and house lord together, in mutual aspect or in exchange → yes; in 6/8/12 from each other → no or delay.

STORY: THE JUDGE WALKS BACKWARDS. When a courtier walks backwards through his district (a retrograde planet) he goes over ground he has already covered, and that is exactly what a lost object needs. If the lord of the 4th room, or the 7th lord who stands for the taker, is walking backwards, the thing comes back, or the taker returns it. In a marriage question the same backward walk is less welcome: the proposal is reconsidered, the engagement retraced. **Rule:** a retrograde house lord means the matter turns back: good for recovery, cautionary for commitments.

From Chapter 18: Career and Wealth, "What Work Suits Me, and Will I Have Money?"

STORY: THREE ROOMS OF THE HAVELI. Walk through the old family haveli with me. The 10th house is the workshop on the roof terrace, open to the sky, where the world can see what you make, the King likes to inspect it at noon. The 2nd and 11th are the treasury: the 2nd is the locked iron chest where the family gold is kept, the 11th the front counter where the day's takings come in. And the 6th and 7th are the servants' hall and the shop front: in the 6th you work for the household under the old Judge's roster; in the 7th you open your own door onto the market and deal with strangers. A friend once asked me why his brilliant workshop had never filled the chest. His treasury doors, I showed him, opened outward, the 12th was stronger than the 2nd. **Rule:** 10th = what you do; 2nd and 11th = what you earn and keep; 6th and 7th = job or business. Judge career from all three rooms.

STORY: SALARIED IN THE JUDGE'S OFFICE, OR YOUR OWN SHOP IN THE MARKET. Two cousins left the village together. One took a post in Shani-ji's office, the old Judge of Labour keeps strict hours, pays on the first of the month, and promotes slowly but surely; the young Prince Mercury sits at the next desk keeping the ledgers. That is the 6th house: service, routine, a roof over your head that someone else owns. The other cousin rented a stall in the 7th-house market, where Shukracharya sells silks, Mercury brokers deals and Guru-ji advises for a fee. No salary, no roster, but every planet sitting in its own sign refuses to take orders, and every strong 7th wants its own signboard. The first cousin thought the second reckless; the second thought the first asleep. Both were reading their charts correctly. **Rule:** 6th strong, Saturn/Mercury on the 10th → service. 7th–10th linked, Mercury/Venus/Jupiter or own-sign planets there → business.

STORY: WHAT EACH COURTIER DOES WHEN HE LEAVES THE COURT. Imagine the court dissolved for a year and every courtier sent to earn his own bread. The King opens a government office or a hospital and gives orders. The Queen Mother runs a guest-house and feeds the town. The Commander joins the police, or builds houses, or operates. The young Prince opens a shop, an accountancy, a newspaper, a coaching class. Guru-ji teaches, judges, banks and blesses. Shukracharya opens a boutique, a jewellery house, a cinema. Shani-ji goes to the mines and the fields, the iron foundry and the old-age home, and is the last to leave every evening. The Smoke-headed Stranger sells foreign machines, flies aeroplanes and speculates. The Headless Sadhu sits under a tree doing mathematics and reading horoscopes. Nobody had to tell them where to go; their characters chose. **Rule:** a planet's profession is its court character taken to the market. Derive the table; never memorise it.

From Chapter 19: Marriage and Relationships, "When, With Whom, and Will It Last?"

STORY: THE GUEST WING. In the old haveli the family lived on the east side and the 7th house was the guest wing on the west, the rooms where the person who marries into the family will live. Before the wedding the elders would walk through it. Whose portrait hangs there? If Guru-ji's, the guest will be learned and generous; if the Commander's, quick-tempered and brave; if the old Judge's, older, quiet, late to arrive. Who holds the key, the wing's lord, and where is he? A lord standing in his own rooms keeps the wing in order; a lord away in the 12th (the store-room by the back gate) means the guest comes from far, or arrives late. And is the wing swept? Two malefics camped there make the guest's stay stormy. The elders never described the guest's face, only the rooms. **Rule:** the 7th house sign, its occupants and its lord's placement describe the partner and the partnership; read them before any koota.

STORY: TWO SIGNATURES ON THE MARRIAGE FILE. In our court a marriage is not fixed by a wish; it is fixed by a file, and the file needs two signatures. Guru-ji, the Royal Priest, signs first; he is generous and goes round the twelve districts once a year, blessing three at a time with his glance, so his signature is easy to get. Shani-ji, the old Judge, signs last. He spends two and a half years in each district, reads every page, and signs only when he has himself touched the house of marriage or its lord. Families who ran to the pandit the moment Guru-ji smiled at their district came back a year later asking why nothing happened: the Judge had not yet reached the file. And the railway timetable, the dasha, must have a marriage train running at all. Three things, one season. **Rule:** marriage is timed when Jupiter and Saturn both touch the 7th house or its lord by transit, inside a dasha of a marriage-giving planet.

STORY: THE COMMANDER BILLETED IN THE BEDROOM WING. After a campaign the Commander needs quarters. If the King bills him in the barracks (the 3rd, 6th, 10th, 11th) everyone sleeps well. But suppose he is billeted in the family's private rooms: the front hall (1st), the dining room (2nd), the inner courtyard (4th), the guest wing (7th), the in-laws' rooms (8th) or the bedroom by the back gate (12th). He does nothing wrong; he is simply loud. He argues at dinner, drills in the courtyard at dawn, and the new bride wonders what she has married into. That is the whole of Mangal dosha, a hot temperament in the rooms where a marriage is lived. The elders learned to soften it: if the Commander was in his own district or a friend's, or Guru-ji sat with him, or the other family also had a Commander in their private rooms, the two would understand each other. **Rule:** Mars in 1, 2, 4, 7, 8 or 12 (from Lagna, Moon or Venus) is heat in the marriage rooms; check cancellations; counsel temperament, never curse.

STORY: EIGHT GATEKEEPERS AT THE WEDDING GATE. At the wedding gate of the old kingdom stood eight gatekeepers, each allowed exactly one question, each holding a different number of coins to give if the answer pleased. The first, a thin old man with one coin, asked about temperament: Varna. The second, with two, asked whether the two would pull each other: Vashya. The third, with three, counted the stars between the bride's street and the groom's: Tara. The fourth, with four, asked which animals they were: Yoni. The fifth, with five, asked whether the lords of their two Queen Mothers were friends: Graha Maitri. The sixth, with six, asked whether they were of the gods, of men or of the wild: Gana. The seventh, with seven, measured the distance between their two Moons: Bhakoot. The eighth, tallest, with eight coins, felt their pulses: Nadi. Thirty-six coins in all; eighteen opened the gate. But the wise families knew the gatekeepers had never seen the couple, only their two Moons. Inside, the elders still walked the guest wing. **Rule:** Ashtakoota compares the two Moons in eight ways, 36 points; 18 is the gate; the 7th houses, Navamsa and dashas decide the marriage.

From Chapter 20: Health and Longevity, Reading the Body Without Frightening the Patient

STORY: THE COSMIC MAN ASLEEP ACROSS TWELVE ROOMS. Picture a giant lying asleep across the whole haveli: the Kala Purusha, the Man of Time. His head rests in the first room (Aries, the Commander's district), his face and throat in the second, his arms stretch through the third, his chest fills the fourth, his stomach the fifth, and so on down to his feet, which stick out of the twelfth room by the back gate. Now the courtiers walk through the rooms at night. Wherever the old Judge sits down, that part of the giant grows stiff and cold. Wherever the Commander stamps, it heats and bleeds. Wherever the Smoke-headed Stranger stands, it aches in a way no physician can name. And wherever Guru-ji lays his hand, the limb rests easy. Every birth chart is one night in that house; the astrologer only notes which rooms had which visitors. **Rule:** sign and house name the body part (head to feet, Aries to Pisces, 1st to 12th); the planet names the kind of trouble.

STORY: CLINIC, OPERATING THEATRE AND HOSPITAL WARD. Three rooms of the haveli were given to the physicians. The 6th room, near the servants' hall, was the clinic: fevers, cuts, stomach upsets, you walked in, were treated, and walked out; the Commander was its patron, and a strong clinic meant a household that fought off illness. The 8th room, deep inside and rarely opened, was the operating theatre and the family's long-term ledger: chronic complaints, surgeries, and the record of how long each member lived; the old Judge kept its key, and a well-placed Judge there meant a long ledger, not a short one. The 12th room, by the back gate, was the hospital ward: the bed where one lay when one could not rise, with the door to the outside world half open. The front room, the 1st, was the constitution, how sturdy the house itself was built. **Rule:** 1st = constitution; 6th = acute, treatable; 8th = chronic, surgery, longevity; 12th = hospitalisation. Their lords carry the same meanings wherever they sit.

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER'S HEALTH. The whole court takes its mood from the Queen Mother. When Rani Ma is bright, the waxing Moon, in her own district or a friend's, with Guru-ji calling on her, the kitchens sing and even bad news is borne. When the old Judge sits beside her, the palace grows quiet and heavy; when the Smoke-headed Stranger stands at her door, she cannot sleep for fears no one can name; when she is sent to the clinic, the theatre or the ward (the 6th, 8th or 12th) and the malefics follow her there, the court itself sickens. The young Prince, her son, carries her worries into his ledgers and his speech falters. The physician's wisdom was this: the Queen Mother is never dismissed as "just moody". She is attended at once, and by a real physician. **Rule:** the Moon is the mind; Saturn, Rahu, dusthana placement and affliction on Mercury are strain markers, and strain on the mind is referred to a professional, never remedied away.

STORY: THE OLD JUDGE WHO KEEPS THE KEYS. The family feared Shani-ji most of all, and he was the one who kept them alive longest. He is the Ayushkaraka, the keeper of the ledger of years. The households that treated him well, gave him his own quiet room in the 8th, or let him sit in his own districts of Capricorn and Aquarius, found their old people living to see great-grandchildren, slowly, stiffly, but surely. The households that panicked when he entered, and threw him out with stones and threats, lost the one servant who counted the years faithfully. Guru-ji's blessing on the front door and on the Queen Mother added the second protection. **Rule:** a well-placed Saturn is a long-life mark, not a death mark; Jupiter on the Lagna or Moon, a strong Lagna lord and benefics in kendras are the other protectors.

From Chapter 21: Children, Education, Property, Travel and the Spiritual Path

STORY: THE NURSERY AND THE FAMILY PRIEST. The 5th room of the haveli was the nursery, painted yellow, and Guru-ji, the family priest, was the one who blessed every birth in it. When he was strong, in his own district or exalted in Cancer, the Queen Mother's home, the cradles filled easily. When he was weak, far away in Capricorn under the old Judge's roof, or scorched standing too near the King, the family waited and prayed. And the nursery had visitors. If the old Judge sat in it, the children came late; if the Smoke-headed Stranger stood at its door, they came by an unexpected road, a clinic, an adoption, a surprise. The 9th room, the nursery's own nursery, five doors on, was where the grandmother kept the second cradle. **Rule:** 5th house and lord, Jupiter's dignity, the 9th as the 5th-from-5th; malefics there mean effort and a different road, never "no children".

STORY: THE SCHOOL-ROOM AND THE LAND DEED. The 4th room of the haveli did double duty. In the morning it was the school-room, where the Queen Mother sat the children down and the young Prince taught them letters; in the afternoon the same room held the iron box with the land deeds, because the 4th is home, mother, schooling and property all at once, the things that hold you up from below. The tutors who visited decided the subjects: the Commander taught drill and engineering, Guru-ji law and scripture, Shukracharya music and drawing, the old Judge history and patience (his pupils were slow and finished everything), the Headless Sadhu mathematics, and the Smoke-headed Stranger foreign tongues and strange machines. Upstairs, the 5th room was where the clever child read alone, and the 9th was the college in the next town. **Rule:** 4th = schooling and foundations; 5th = intelligence; 9th = higher learning; the planet dominating them and Mercury names the subject. The 4th also holds the land deed.

STORY: THE ROAD OUT OF THE KINGDOM. Three roads left the haveli. The 3rd-house road went to the neighbouring villages: the Prince rode it weekly with letters. The 9th-house road went to the far temple towns, where Guru-ji made his pilgrimages and the young went to the great university. The 12th-house road went out through the back gate, past the hospital ward, to the border and beyond, the road out of the kingdom altogether. At that gate stood the Smoke-headed Stranger, who knew every foreign tongue and whispered of lands where the family name meant nothing and anything was possible. When the keeper of the 4th room, the home, was found standing at the 12th gate, or talking with the Stranger, the elders knew: this child will not stay. The Judge and the Priest, arriving at that gate in the same season, stamped the passport. **Rule:** 3rd short, 9th long, 12th foreign; Rahu and movable signs add distance; 4th lord in 12th or with Rahu = leaving the homeland; double transit on 12th/9th times it.

STORY: THE QUIET WING. The west side of the haveli, the 4th, 8th and 12th rooms, was the quiet wing: the inner courtyard where the mother lit the evening lamp, the locked room where the family kept what it did not speak of, and the back room by the gate where the old ones sat with their beads. Three courtiers had leave to walk there. The Headless Sadhu, who had no face left to lose, sat in the courtyard and taught letting-go. Guru-ji came through the 9th-house door with the scriptures and showed the way. And the old Judge, who had served all his life, was the one who finally set down his keys, renunciation is his. Most of the family never left the haveli for the forest; they did their sadhana in the quiet wing between the kitchen and the shop. When the Stranger sat with Guru-ji, the elders did not panic: the Priest simply preached a stranger sermon. **Rule:** moksha lives in 4–8–12 with the 9th as the door; Ketu, Jupiter and Saturn are its karakas; householder spirituality is the norm; Jupiter–Rahu questions; it does not destroy.

From Chapter 22: Lal Kitab, the Red Book, Clearly Labelled

STORY: THE HAVELI WITH TWELVE FIXED ROOMS. In Parashari the court travels: the King holds durbar wherever the Lagna pitches his tent, and the twelve districts (signs) turn around him. Lal Kitab builds a haveli instead: one old house with twelve rooms that never move, and every courtier has a permanent room. The King (Sun) sleeps in room 1, by the front door. The Queen Mother (Moon) keeps room 4, the heart of the house. Guru-ji (Jupiter) has the run of rooms 2, 5, 9 and 11: treasury, nursery, prayer room and granary. Shukracharya (Venus) and the young Prince (Mercury) share room 7, the guest hall. The Commander (Mars) guards rooms 3 and 8, the door and the vault. Old Shani-ji (Saturn) keeps rooms 6 and 10, the vault and the workshop. The Smoke-headed Stranger (Rahu) sleeps in room 12, the outhouse; the Headless Sadhu (Ketu) in room 6, with the dogs. In his own room a courtier speaks with authority; in another's room he is a guest, treated as that host treats him. **Rule:** Pakka ghar is the planet's permanent room, strong there; elsewhere, read host and guest.

STORY: THE ELEPHANT AND THE DOG. Parashari seats the planets in a court; Lal Kitab seats them at a family dinner. The father breaks the wheat roti (Sun); the mother pours the milk (Moon); the brother argues over the red lentils (Mars); the daughter brings green moong (Mercury); the grandfather says grace with a turmeric mark on his forehead (Jupiter); the wife sets out curd and ghee (Venus); the old servant refills the mustard-oil lamp (Saturn). At the gate stand two who are not quite family: the in-laws' elephant, huge, smoke-blue and impossible to ignore (Rahu), and the loyal dog who guards the door and wants a blanket in winter (Ketu). Feed each what it eats and the dinner goes well. **Rule:** In Lal Kitab every planet is a family member with its own foods, metals, colours and animals, and its remedy feeds that member.

STORY: THE COMMANDER'S COMPANY. Senapati Mangal is a fine officer when he rides alone: he guards the brothers, protects the land, fights only when he must. But watch whom he drinks with. Seated beside old Shani-ji the Judge he turns sullen and cruel; beside the Smoke-headed Stranger he schemes; beside the Headless Sadhu he stops caring who gets hurt. And put him in room 4 (the Queen Mother's room) or room 8, the vault, and he is a soldier in the wrong place, breaking the crockery. That, as commonly taught in the Lal Kitab tradition, is Mangal Bad; the same man riding alone in the open is Mangal Nek. **Rule:** Mars with Saturn, Rahu or Ketu, or in the 4th or 8th, is read as Mangal Bad; Mars alone elsewhere is Mangal Nek (as commonly taught; verify your edition).

STORY: THE UNLIT ROOMS. Walk through the haveli at night. Rooms with someone in them have a lamp burning. Rooms with nobody in them are dark (not cursed, just unlit) and the tradition calls them asleep (soya ghar). Now notice a courtier in a lit room staring across the courtyard at a dark one: the room he "looks at" is empty, so he has nobody to talk to, and he dozes off: a sleeping planet (soya grah). A traveller (a transit) walks into the dark room and lights the lamp; the watcher wakes and begins to speak. In Parashari there is no such thing: an empty room is read through whoever owns it, and the Queen Mother in her own district is wide awake whether or not anyone sits opposite. **Rule:** In Lal Kitab an empty house, and a planet facing one, are dormant until a transit or related planet wakes them; rules vary by edition.

STORY: THE FAMILY LEDGER. In every old Punjabi house there was a ledger (bahi) of the family's debts: not one person's, the family's. Grandfather borrowed for a wedding; the loan passed down; nobody remembers the wedding, but the entry remains. Lal Kitab reads certain placements as entries in that ledger. Guru-ji sitting troubled in the treasury, the nursery, the prayer room or the outhouse: an unpaid debt to the ancestors. The Headless Sadhu in the Queen Mother's room: a debt to the mother's line. The young Prince at the front door: a debt to the brothers. Nobody argues about whose fault it is. Every blood relative puts an equal coin on the table, and the entry is struck out in one act. **Rule:** Rin is a family debt read from specific placements (lists vary by edition) and paid collectively, in equal shares by all blood relatives.

STORY: THE FAST THAT STARTS AGAIN. A grandmother keeps a forty-three-day upay for her grandson's Saturn. Every morning, before the sun is high, she puts grain out for the crows. On the twentieth morning she is unwell and forgets. That evening she does not double the next day's grain; she quietly turns the calendar back to day one. "Shani-ji does not count grain," she says. "He counts whether you kept your word." The remedy was never the grain. It was forty-three unbroken

mornings of remembering someone smaller than herself. **Rule:** An upay runs 40 or 43 consecutive days in daylight; a missed day restarts the count; the discipline, not the object, is the remedy.

From Chapter 23: Remedies (Upaya), Helping Without Harming

STORY: DON'T GIVE AWAY YOUR JUPITER. A family whose Guru-ji was frail (a weak Jupiter, lord of their Lagna) was told to "do Jupiter's daan". Every Thursday for a year they carried turmeric, gram and yellow cloth out of the house and gave them away. The Priest grew thinner. Daan is a farewell gift: it says to a planet, "I release what you grip; I ask nothing more of you." That is exactly what you say to the drunken Judge you want out of the hall. It is the opposite of what you say to the Priest whose blessing you need. For him you bring gifts in: his mantra, his Thursday, respect for teachers, and, if he is truly weak, his yellow stone. **Rule:** Donate the items of a functional malefic to pacify it; never donate the items of a functional benefic you need.

STORY: THE LOUDSPEAKER AND THE MUZZLE. A gemstone is a loudspeaker. Hang it on a courtier and everything he says is heard in every room of the haveli. Now picture the wedding at which Shani-ji, the old Judge of Labour, has had too much to drink and is lecturing the guests on their failings. The frightened host runs to the jeweller: "Give me a blue sapphire, for Saturn!" The jeweller, smiling, hands him a loudspeaker. The lecture is now audible in the street. What the host needed was a muzzle: a quiet word, a plate of food, a task for the old man's hands (daan, seva, mantra). No jeweller sells a muzzle. **Rule:** A stone strengthens; it never pacifies. Prescribe it only for a weak functional benefic, never for a functional malefic.

STORY: TWO PARTIES, ONE HAND. The court has two parties (Chapter 3). The Royal Party (the King, the Queen Mother, the Commander and Guru-ji the Priest) wears ruby, pearl, coral and yellow sapphire. The People's Party (the young Prince, Shukracharya the Minister of Pleasure and old Shani-ji the Judge, with the Smoke-headed Stranger and the Headless Sadhu at their table) wears emerald, diamond, blue sapphire, hessonite and cat's eye. Seat both parties on one small hand and they quarrel all day: the King's ruby shouting at the Judge's sapphire on the next finger, the Queen Mother's pearl flinching from the Stranger's hessonite. My client with three rings had seated the Priest beside the Judge. **Rule:** Never wear the stones of enemy planets together; keep the Royal Party's stones and the People's Party's stones apart.

STORY: THE JUDGE'S SATURDAY. Shani-ji, the old Judge of Labour, cannot be bribed and cannot be flattered: a stone does not impress him and a sweet does not soften him. He was a servant before he became a judge, and he remembers. What he watches is how you treat his people: the labourer, the sweeper, the old man nobody visits. Bring him nothing; instead, on his day, give your hour to someone who works with his hands. Then he nods, and the sentence he was about to pass becomes a lesson instead. Every planet has such a door, and it is always a person. **Rule:** Each planet is honoured by caring for the people it signifies, on its weekday; Saturn by seva to the poor, the old and those who labour.

STORY: THE VAIDYA'S SLIP OF PAPER. The old family vaidya in my mother's town never sold medicine. He listened, pressed the wrist, named the trouble, and wrote three lines on a slip of paper: one thing to stop, one thing to take, one thing to do. Then he named the day to return. He would not write a fourth line ("a patient with seven instructions follows none") and he would not write a tonic for a man who was already strong: "why fatten a healthy bull?" When a patient begged for the expensive syrup, he asked what it was for. That slip is what a remedy prescription should look like: the trouble named, tonic or sedative decided, two or three lines, a review date, no sale. **Rule:** Name the planet and house; decide strengthen or pacify; prescribe at most three things; write it down; review.

From Chapter 24: The Consultation, From Birth Details to a Client Who Comes Back

STORY: A PETITIONER COMES TO COURT. A farmer arrives at the haveli with a question about his land. The Queen Mother (Moon) receives him first and asks about his journey, was the road as he remembers it? That is the confirmation. Then the King (Sun) speaks for a minute, not more: "You are an honest man with a stubborn streak; your land is good, your well is shallow." That is the overview. The young Prince (Mercury) takes the petitions one at a time, in the order the farmer wrote them. The old Judge of Labour (Saturn) opens the railway timetable and says which season the water will come. The Royal Priest (Jupiter) gives him a blessing and a task for Thursdays. And the Secretary writes it all down and hands the farmer the page before he leaves. Nobody at that court answers the question before the journey has been checked.

Rule: Open, confirm, overview, questions, timing, remedies, written record, in that order, every time.

STORY: THE TWO HERALDS. The old Judge (Saturn) issues one decree for a village: "The granary must be filled before the rains, or there will be hunger." Two heralds ride out with it. The first stands in the square and shouts, "Hunger is coming! You will starve!" The village panics, hoards, and quarrels; half the fields go unsown. The second herald reads the same decree and says, "The Judge asks you to fill the granary before the rains. Those who fill it will eat well through the winter." The village plants. Same Saturn, same decree, two futures, and only the herald differed.

Rule: A malefic is a test. Say what the test asks for, never what failure would look like.

STORY: THE STRANGER'S SHOP. The Smoke-headed Stranger (Rahu) opens a gem shop outside the court gate. He makes a quiet arrangement with a junior secretary: for every frightened petitioner sent across the road with the words "only a blue stone can save you," a silver coin. Within a season the secretary has stopped reading the maps at all; he reads faces, finds the fear, and names the stone. The Royal Priest (Jupiter) notices that the petitioners come back poorer and no happier, and has the secretary's desk moved into the courtyard, where everyone can hear what he says. The shop closes within a month. The Priest's only comment: "A counsellor who profits from a fear will always find one."

Rule: No fear-selling, no gem commissions, and say your readings where they could be overheard.

From Chapter 25: Three Complete Readings: Meera, Arjun and Devika

STORY: THE QUEEN MOTHER'S EMPTY NEIGHBOURS. The Queen Mother (Moon) sits in the ninth room in her own colours, strong, serene. But look either side of her: the eighth room (Gemini) is empty, and in the tenth (Leo) there is only the Headless Sadhu (Ketu), who does not count as company. That is Kemadruma, the loneliness of a queen with no attendants. Then look across the courtyard: the Minister of Pleasure (Venus) sits in the fourth room from her, in a kendra, in her own silks, and the Royal Priest (Jupiter) sits in a kendra from the front door. A queen with a minister across the hall is not alone. She is only quiet.

Rule: Kemadruma forms when the 2nd and 12th from the Moon are empty; a planet in a kendra from the Moon or the Lagna cancels it.

STORY: THREE MINISTERS LOCKED IN THE EIGHTH ROOM. The eighth room of the haveli is the strong-room, vaults, old papers, the family's secrets, the insurance ledgers. Three men are shut in there together: the King (Sun), the young Prince-Secretary (Mercury) and the old Judge of Labour (Saturn). It is the Judge's own room; he has the keys and knows every ledger. But the King has brought his brazier, and the Judge, sitting seven feet from it, is sweating, half-blinded, working at half his strength. The Prince, sixteen feet away, is uncomfortable but clear-headed; he reads the ledgers aloud and turns them into reports. Nobody outside the room knows how much work is done in there. The family's fortune depends on that room, and the family barely remembers it exists.

Rule: Planets in the 8th work in hidden, technical, research-like fields; a planet within its combustion orb of the Sun loses strength even in its own sign.

STORY: THE COMMANDER WHO WALKS BACKWARDS. The Commander (Mars) is the one officer in this court whom the Lagna trusts completely, for a Cancer-born king, Mars is the yogakaraka, the single planet who can deliver a rise in status. He has been posted to the second room, the treasury and the family dining hall, in the King's own colours (Leo), which suits him. But he is walking backwards, retrograde. He does not charge; he re-checks, re-does, reworks the plan a third time, and gets there later than the others expected and more thoroughly than anyone else could. From that room he looks across at the fifth, where the Royal Priest (Jupiter) sits, and the two of them: Commander and Priest, quietly run the kingdom's real affairs.

Rule: A retrograde yogakaraka still gives its rise, but through repetition and depth rather than speed.

STORY: THE EXCHANGE OF KEYS. In Devika's haveli the Queen Mother (Moon) and the Royal Priest (Jupiter) have swapped rooms. The Queen Mother has moved into the ninth room, the family temple, with the Priest's books and lamps around her; the Priest has moved into the fourth, the mother's room at the heart of the house, and he has never been so well, sitting in his exaltation, with the King (Sun) beside him as his guest. Each holds the other's keys. Whatever happens to the home happens to the family's fortune, and whatever happens to their faith happens to their home. Then look up: from the temple in the ninth room the Priest's new seat is the eighth room away, the Shakata pattern, so the Queen Mother's fortunes rise and dip like a cart on a rutted road. But the cart is pulled by an exalted Priest and a King, so it never overturns.

Rule: Two lords in each other's signs fuse their houses (Parivartana); Jupiter exalted in a kendra is Hamsa yoga; Jupiter in the 6th, 8th or 12th from the Moon is Shakata, and one chart can hold all three.

STORY: THE JUDGE, THE STRANGER AND THE YOUNG PRINCE IN THE NURSERY. The fifth room is the children's room and the schoolroom. Devika's has three occupants: the old Judge of Labour (Saturn), sitting stiffly in the King's colours which do not suit him; the Smoke-headed Stranger (Rahu), who speaks of foreign universities and strange new sciences; and the young Prince (Mercury), bright, a little anxious, standing right at the threshold. It is not a warm nursery. But look at who owns it (the King (Sun), who is sitting next door with the exalted Priest) and who is its karaka: that same Priest. The child raised in this room learns discipline from the Judge, ambition from the Stranger and cleverness from the Prince, and inherits the King's and Priest's blessing from across the wall. Hard schooling; good ending.

Rule: Read a house's lord and karaka before you judge its occupants; malefics in a house whose lord and karaka are strong give struggle first and success after.

115 stories in all. If you can retell them, you can read a chart.

About the Author

Anushka Bharti is a practising astrologer. She came to Jyotish the way many people do, through curiosity about her own life and the lives of the people she loved, and she stayed because the subject would not let her go.

Her first years of study were frustrating. The classical texts assumed knowledge she did not have, and the modern courses handed her lists to memorise without the reasons behind them. Rather than give up, she rebuilt the subject for herself from first principles, insisting on a reason and a story for every rule. This book is the result of that rebuilding, written for the reader she once was.

She reads charts for people in the Parashari tradition, uses Lal Kitab as a clearly separate lens for remedies, and believes that the most important use of astrology is not prediction but understanding: of one's own nature, of one's seasons, and of the people one loves.

Astrology, Gently is her first book.

If this book helped you, the kindest thing you can do is tell someone else who is struggling with the same closed books. And if you find an error, please write; a second edition should be better than the first.